
COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE · CONFIDENTIAL WORKING DRAFT

CINAMATE vs. LIGHTSKIDDO

Full SWOT Analysis & the Complete Competitive Landscape

318 competitors profiled · 14 market categories · direct, adjacent & indirect

Compiled 23 August 2026 · 16-agent research fleet · 1,233 source queries · adversarially fact-checked

“Old Hollywood. New Power.” · “One change. Everything moves.”

Contents

§1	Executive Summary	3
§2	Methodology, Sources & Confidence	5
§3	Company Profile — CINAMATE	6
§4	Company Profile — LIGHTSKIDDO	7
§5	SWOT — CINAMATE	8
§6	SWOT — LIGHTSKIDDO	11
§7	Head-to-Head: The Honest Scorecard	13
§8	The Competitive Landscape: How to Read It	15
§9	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	18
§10	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	37
§11	Production management suites (the incumbents)	50
§12	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accounting	58
§13	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incentive tooling	74
§14	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	86
§15	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrastructure	102
§16	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	117
§17	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset tracking	137
§18	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	152
§19	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI coverage/analysis and script clearance/title research)	164
§20	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	182
§21	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	196
§22	Gap Fill — Players & Categories the First Sweep Missed	215
§23	Appendix A — The Fact-Check Ledger	234
§24	Appendix B — Master Index (A–Z)	240

Sections §9–§22 are the competitor catalog: 318 profiled entities ordered within each category by threat level. Refuted or unverifiable figures are corrected or labeled per Appendix A.

§1 Executive Summary

Cinamate and LightsKiddo compete for the same phrase — “AI film production platform” — and for almost nothing else. Cinamate (Build 2.7.1-Crimson, invitation-only private beta) is a *production-replacement* system: a private studio in software whose stated output is the film itself, generated on the user’s own GPU, cut in a browser, and carried through financing, distribution, festivals and tax-credit administration across 28 verified working modules. LightsKiddo (Agni, Inc.) is a *production-augmentation* system: a coordination graph over the crews, cameras and incumbent tools of live-action filmmaking, whose own homepage repudiates Cinamate’s premise in a single sentence — “*AI can’t make the film. It performs the million recalculations after you decide.*”

The question this report was commissioned to answer — *why is LightsKiddo way behind us, and what are they better at?* — has a two-part answer that the evidence supports only in part, and this report gives it to you straight.

WHERE CINAMATE IS GENUINELY AHEAD

- **Financial-lifecycle breadth nobody else attempts.** All 28 module routes were independently confirmed to exist. The span from investor tracking through recoupment waterfall, clearance, tax incentives, distribution deliverables and festival strategy has no equivalent at LightsKiddo — whose public product stops at post — and no single equivalent anywhere in the 318-company landscape surveyed here.
- **The economics of local generation.** Cloud text-to-video floor pricing has converged near \$0.045–0.05 per finished second; a 90-minute feature is ~5,400 seconds, i.e. \$240–270 of pure inference *before a single retake*, and real generation ratios run 5–20:1. Cinamate’s local-GPU, nothing-uploads, price-quoted-before-render architecture is a moat made of every cloud rival’s P&L — they cannot match a \$0 marginal render without abandoning their business model.
- **A capability ceiling LightsKiddo has publicly ceded.** LightsKiddo states as philosophy that it will not make the film. Cinamate’s entire premise is that it does (“*HUMAN CREW REQUIRED: 1 (YOU)*”).
- **A methodological posture rivals will not copy.** P10–P90 bands, a disclosed 0.848 budget elasticity, methodology that ships with the platform. Competitors advertise accuracy; almost none advertise error.

WHERE LIGHTSKIDDO IS GENUINELY AHEAD — AND IT IS NOT CLOSE

- **Everything that converts capability into revenue.** LightsKiddo publishes ~10 substantive pages, a named three-person executive team with two named advisors, four named customer endorsements, five case studies, a working support channel with a stated SLA, and a disclosed in-progress compliance program (TPN assessment, SOC 2 underway). Cinamate publishes one page, no team, “*PRESS — DECLINED*”, “*CAREERS — BY REFERRAL*” — and its only contact address, concierge@cinamate.studio, **cannot receive mail because the domain is not registered** (NXDOMAIN, re-confirmed for this report on two independent resolvers).
- **The crewed-production surface.** Camera control across Sony/ARRI/Blackmagic, native agents inside Avid, Resolve, Premiere, Blender, Maya and Unreal, an iOS + macOS on-set presence, role-based multi-user architecture. Cinamate has none of these, and a 4-minute sync that is the wrong side of real time for a shoot day.
- **The education channel.** An NYU Tisch relationship is the mechanism by which the next generation of ADs and UPMs learns which tool is “normal.” Cinamate has no answer to a competitor that owns the training environment.

THE HONEST VERDICT

Cinamate has built more than LightsKiddo has shown; LightsKiddo has sold more than Cinamate can currently receive. Neither company is commercially proven: LightsKiddo’s proof is thinner than it looks (its Oscar-nominee testimonial and its NYU Tisch endorsement plausibly resolve to the same undisclosed company advisor; its Miramax “case study” describes one script run on one morning), and Cinamate’s constraint is not the competitor at all — it is self-imposed: a dead contact domain, an invite-only gate, declined press, and homepage telemetry that the site’s own source code annotates as “*decorative*” and “*fake*.” Three fixes — register

the domain, publish the rigor, and sell the financing-and-recoupment wedge to the solo filmmaker LightsKiddo's foundry model structurally cannot reach — cost almost nothing and change the entire picture.

The landscape behind the head-to-head is the larger story: **318 companies and substitutes** across 14 categories, of which **122 are direct competitors** for at least one Cinamate module, **33 rate as critical threats**, and an entire category — content security, compliance and union/copyright gates — decides whether Cinamate is allowed to sell at all, regardless of product quality. Every entry, threat rating and price in this report survives an adversarial fact-check pass; where a number could not be verified against a primary source, it is labeled as such rather than repeated.

§2 Methodology, Sources & Confidence

This report was assembled on 23 August 2026 by a 16-agent research fleet issuing 1,233 tool queries: thirteen parallel category researchers, a completeness critic that hunted for missed players and categories, an adversarial fact-checker that re-verified the ~36 riskiest numeric claims against primary sources, and a positioning analyst that read both companies' raw HTML, headers, DNS records and sitemaps directly.

HOW TO READ CONFIDENCE LABELS

- **VERIFIED** — a vendor page, filing, or primary source seen during this research states it. 252 of 318 entries.
- **LIKELY** — consistent with sources seen but not fully confirmed by a primary source. 48 entries.
- **UNCERTAIN** — partly reliant on background knowledge or conflicting accounts; treat details with care. 18 entries.

WHAT THE FACT-CHECK PASS CHANGED

Eight claims produced by the initial research sweep were **refuted** against primary sources and corrected before publication (among them: a hallucinated “Veo 4”; three wrong price cards; two “pricing not disclosed” claims for vendors that publish full rate cards). A further nine claims — mostly private-company funding rounds — were **unverifiable** and are labeled as such wherever they appear. The complete corrections ledger is Appendix A (§23).

A MATERIAL CAVEAT ABOUT CINAMATE'S OWN NUMBERS

Several figures widely associated with Cinamate's pitch — a 15.5% disclosed model failure rate, a ~\$110 cost for a 90-page feature draft, “cloud billing \$0.00,” and a \$1,246 SAG-AFTRA daily scale citation — **do not appear anywhere in the raw HTML of cinamate-studio.netlify.app** (grep-confirmed for this report). What *is* on-page: “CALIBRATED ON 3,708 RELEASED FEATURES,” budget elasticity 0.848, P10–P90 bands, 124 automated checks, the 2–2.5× breakeven derivation, “RENDERS: LOCAL — NOTHING UPLOADS,” “priced before a frame renders,” and “TYPICAL SCRIPT-TO-MASTER: 09:12:44 · HUMAN CREW REQUIRED: 1 (YOU).” Where this report references the absent figures it marks them (*unverified*). If they are real, publishing them is among the highest-ROI actions available to the company (§7).

SCOPE LIMITS

Both products gate their applications behind login (Cinamate: server-side 302 on all 28 module routes; LightsKiddo: Cloudflare-challenged /desk), so functional claims are claims about marketing copy, not observed software — for both sides equally. Third-party press and funding corroboration for the two principals specifically was unavailable during the positioning pass; first-party sites, DNS, HTTP headers and sitemaps were examined directly. A small set of vendors block automated fetching (403/429/503) and are noted as unfilled gaps rather than omitted silently: Backstage, ProductionHUB, IMDbPro, OOONA, Metaphysic, ActionVFX, Pond5, Fab, QTAKE.

§3 Company Profile — CINAMATE

IDENTITY

“The first private studio that turns a screenplay into a finished film.” Build 2.7.1-Crimson, “INVITATION-ONLY // PRIVATE BETA 03,” hosted at cinamate-studio.netlify.app. Tagline: *“Old Hollywood. New Power.”* Contact: concierge@cinamate.studio (domain unregistered — see §5). Press: declined. Careers: by referral. No public team, no funding disclosures, no press footprint.

THE FOUR FLAGSHIP SYSTEMS

- **SYS.01 Studio / Local Generation** — script-to-screen on the user’s GPU: *“Nothing uploads — the render farm is your GPU, and every draft is priced before a frame renders.”* Claimed pipeline: “1,842 scenes/objects → 11 angles/scene → 8K neural frames → 12-bit pipeline”; typical script-to-master 09:12:44; human crew required: 1.
- **SYS.02 The Cutting Room** — a multi-track browser editor with an assistant that rough-cuts from story order, tightens silence, cuts to music and balances color; exports H.264+AAC; conforms EDL · OTIO.
- **SYS.03 The Money Room** — estimates that learn from real invoices, POs and the weekly cost report (budget / actual / committed / EFC), union-anchored fringe math (28/32/40%), Day-out-of-Days-driven cast days.
- **SYS.04 A Studio That Remembers** — one shared project state across every room; full backup, one file; auto-sync every 4 minutes.

THE 28 ROOMS (ALL ROUTES INDEPENDENTLY VERIFIED)

Writer · Boards · Investors · Clearance · Producer · Contracts · Casting · Locations · Wardrobe · Props · Sets · Safety · Timeline · Production · Finance · Tools · Dailies · Today · Editor · Screening · VFX · Music · Post · Distribution · Festivals · Tax Credit · Workflow · Projects

STATED RIGOR

Sales model fitted on 3,708 released features; budget elasticity 0.848 “matching the published literature”; P10–P90 bands “because a range is what the data honestly supports”; every rate source-cited to SAG-AFTRA / DGA / WGA / IATSE cards; 124 automated checks; waterfall derives the industry’s 2–2.5× breakeven rule; methodology ships with the platform. Hero counters: 21 incentive programs tracked, 36 stage facilities, 6 permit hubs.

LEGAL POSTURE (NOTABLY CANDID)

“Cinamate generates original synthetic media. Outputs are licensed to the commissioning member. Voice and likeness models are consented and licensed... Estimates and forecasts are planning tools, not guarantees of cost or revenue. Not an offer of securities.”

§4 Company Profile — LIGHTSKIDDO

IDENTITY

Operated by Agni, Inc. (footer) — though the privacy notice names “Light Inc.” and light.inc, a three-way entity ambiguity an enterprise buyer’s counsel will notice. Positioning: *“One change. Everything moves”*; *“AI can’t make the film. It performs the million recalculations after you decide”*; *“We’re making filmmakers alchemists again.”* Named team: Arjun Agarwal, CTO (ex-ADP, Amazon AI/ML); Aryan Wangchuck, CEO; Vanshika Sharma, COO. Advisors: Bill Tunnicliffe (Oscar-nominee filmmaker, NYU Tisch faculty); Matt K. (Amazon Ads). Working contact: info@lightskiddo.com (live Google Workspace MX), one-business-day SLA.

PRODUCT

A production “graph” — 45 nodes / 40 links in its own demo — connecting script, breakdown, shotlist, stripboard, budget, call sheets, set, and cut. Ray (breakdown model) pulls cast, props, locations, VFX and continuity from the script *“in seconds, not weeks”*; Indra (*“our own model, generating against your production graph”*) adds in-house generation. Change propagation: *“Affected elements flag. The schedule re-derives. The budget re-costs. Call sheets rebuild... fully reversible.”* Models run local to the production; content is encrypted in transit and at rest; access role-based.

REACH & INTEGRATIONS

Live camera control across Sony, ARRI, Blackmagic, with takes matched back to shot nodes; agents run natively inside Blender, Maya, Unreal, Avid, Resolve; formats .fdx, .mmsp, .mmb, .ari, .braw, .mxf, .mov, .aaf, .edl, .xml, .ptx, .usd; Google Workspace, Microsoft 365, Scheduall; ElevenLabs voice. iOS companion plus a macOS desktop app. Facilities dashboard (Radford Studios, Manhattan Beach Stages, Brooklyn Navy Yard; “67% utilization”) sold to stage operators.

GO-TO-MARKET

Enterprise-only: *“three different enterprise licenses — schedule a demo to see more”* (the demo link resolves to a personal Notion calendar). Foundry model: *“our engineers embed with your production... Onboarding is us learning your processes, not your team learning new software.”* Claimed traction: *“Sandbox deployments underway at majors and established independents.”* Endorsements: Kirby Adams (VP Physical Production, Miramax), Tatjana Krstevski (Chair, AI Board, NYU Tisch), William Tuncliffe (Oscar-nominated director), Nad Ashaayer (CEO, Lightup London). Compliance: *“TPN assessment is in progress; SOC 2 is underway.”*

CAVEATS SURFACED BY THIS RESEARCH

The Oscar-nominee testimonial and the NYU Tisch relationship plausibly resolve to the company’s own listed advisor (“William Tuncliffe” on the homepage vs. “Bill Tunnicliffe” on /team — same profession, same Tisch affiliation), an undisclosed related party. The Miramax case study describes one script processed on one morning. “Sandbox deployments underway” is compatible with zero paying customers. The privacy policy is unedited boilerplate that names the wrong company and domain and asserts the product processes no sensitive personal information — implausible for a platform holding cast, payroll and minors’ data.

STRENGTHS

- **Full-lifecycle coverage, verified structurally.** All 28 module routes exist and gate properly (server-side 302, no leakage). The development → festivals → tax-credit span — investors, clearance, deal memos, waterfall, deliverables — exists nowhere else in this 318-company landscape as a single product. LightsKiddo’s public product stops at post.
- **Local-generation economics as a structural moat.** Cloud inference floors (~\$0.045–0.05/finished second) put a feature at \$240–270 *before retakes* at 5–20:1 real ratios. “Nothing uploads... every draft is priced before a frame renders” solves the two adoption-killing objections — IP leakage and unbounded cost — simultaneously, and a cloud-native rival cannot follow without destroying its own unit economics.
- **The money end is the defensible end.** Recoupment waterfalls and jurisdiction-specific incentive ledgers are boring to build, demo badly, and accumulate rules for years — exactly the work a well-funded rival will postpone indefinitely. Nobody else pairs them with generation.
- **Methodological transparency as posture.** P10–P90 bands, disclosed 0.848 elasticity, “methodology ships with the platform.” Rivals advertising only success rates cannot copy an error-disclosure posture without disclosing their own errors.
- **Exit costs genuinely low — a trust asset unmarketed.** Fountain export, EDL/OTIO conform, H.264 masters, one-file backup. A producer can leave; Cinamate buries this in a footer while LightsKiddo makes the same fact a headline principle.
- **Single-operator viability.** “Human crew required: 1” opens the sub-\$1M segment that every incumbent suite (multi-seat, coordination-priced) and LightsKiddo’s foundry model (embedded engineers) structurally cannot serve.
- **Real gate, real hygiene where it counts.** The login is a genuine server-side edge redirect with no content leakage — a real, if minimal, security posture.

WEAKNESSES

- **No working way to be contacted — the binding constraint on everything.** cinamate.studio is unregistered: NXDOMAIN, no A/MX/NS records (re-confirmed on Cloudflare and Google resolvers for this report). The sole published address is dead; there is no form, phone or social. Every dollar of demand the site generates is discarded at conversion.
- **The rigor claim is self-refuted in the page source.** The homepage’s own comments label its live-looking readouts “decorative telemetry” and “fake telemetry,” with a script that “randomizes a few values on load.” For a product whose thesis is “no black boxes,” this hands any diligence analyst license to distrust 3,708, 0.848 and 124 — which may well be real.
- **The best numbers aren’t published.** The failure-rate disclosure, the ~\$110/feature price, \$0.00 cloud billing and the SAG scale citation appear nowhere in the site’s HTML. The sharpest weapons in the pitch are undeployed and, as of now, unverifiable.
- **Zero certifications in a gated market.** No TPN, no SOC 2, no DPA, no named legal entity, netlify.app subdomain. A studio vendor-onboarding form cannot be completed with the information Cinamate publishes. (LightsKiddo is uncertified too — but discloses an in-progress program, which procurement reads differently.)
- **No crewed-production surface.** No mobile/on-set app, no camera ingest, no NLE plugins, no multi-user roles — and a 4-minute sync that is fast enough to feel live and slow enough to put two people on different call sheets. On a shoot day that is a collision window, not a sync interval.
- **The two halves point at two different buyers.** Call sheets, safety, wardrobe and permits serve a crewed shoot the single-operator architecture cannot host; the generation engine serves a solo creator who needs none of those rooms. Only one buyer can currently be sold to.

- **Tax-credit room is behind free rivals.** 21 jurisdictions tracked vs. Wrapbook's 39 states + DC + PR + federal + Canada (free) and Shamel Studio's 52 US jurisdictions with a free waterfall calculator. The room framed as proprietary depth is a published-for-free commodity.
- **Calibration set is small for the field.** 3,708 films vs. Slated's 10,000+, ScriptBook's 30,000+ scripts, Vault AI's 60,000+ titles, OpusData's 100,000+ profiles — and published accuracy is table stakes in forecasting (Cinelytic 88%+, ScriptBook 87%, Gower Street self-grading annually).
- **The Cutting Room's AI features are already commodities.** Rough cut, silence trim, music sync and color balance ship today inside Premiere (text-based editing, Remix, Color Match), Resolve's Neural Engine (\$0–295 perpetual), Descript and CuttingRoom.
- **Engine dependency.** Local generation rides open-weight releases (LTX-2.5, HunyuanVideo 1.5, Wan 2.2) whose newest tiers are increasingly withheld (Wan 2.5: no repo; MiniMax holding back H3 variants; NVIDIA non-OSI). Cinamate's core capability is somebody else's roadmap decision.
- **Throughput math tension.** HunyuanVideo-1.5's own published speed (75 s per 5-s clip on an RTX 4090) implies ~22.5 GPU-hours per feature of 1:1 footage — against a claimed 09:12:44 script-to-master. The claim needs hardware specs published or it will not survive contact with a technical evaluator.
- **Deploy hygiene undermines the “private studio” frame.** robots.txt points its sitemap at a dead third-party Netlify site; the real sitemap lists two URLs, both gated; asset paths contain literal “undefined/”; a stray “0” renders in the footer.

OPPORTUNITIES

- **TPN Blue Shield is now self-assessed.** Under MPA Best Practices v5.3.1's four-tier model, the entry Blue Shield tier is self-assessment published to the TPN+ registry at membership cost — roughly \$250–\$1,000/yr at Cinamate's revenue, no third-party auditor. The cheapest credibility in the industry, answerable in weeks. (Fee schedule itself unverified — TPN's site resisted automated verification.)
- **Publish the rigor — the highest-ROI move available.** One methodology page: the failure rate, the real price, one fully-sourced worked example (one SAG-AFTRA rate with agreement and effective date, one budget line derived end-to-end) — and remove or label the fake telemetry that currently discredits all of it. Cost: days. It converts the posture moat from blueprint to built.
- **Register the domain; make contact work.** Hours of work; unblocks every other opportunity on this list.
- **Sell the wedge, not the studio.** The financing-and-recoupment stack (Investors / Money Room / Waterfall / Tax Credits) plus generation-for-pitch, aimed at the solo filmmaker and the pitching producer — the segment LightsKiddo's foundry cannot reach and incumbents ignore. Lightup London's own quote (“we pitched a feature we could never have afforded to make”) shows the pitch-asset use case working — on LightsKiddo's turf, with weaker tools than Cinamate's.
- **The coverage-industry collapse left a vacuum.** Cast & Crew shut WeScreenplay, ScreenCraft, The Script Lab and Coverfly in 2025, stranding a generation of development-stage writers and producers — precisely Cinamate's writer/clearance/boards audience, currently unclaimed.
- **The open-weight tide keeps rising at zero R&D cost.** LTX-2.5 (22B, native audio, free under \$10M revenue, “no per-generation billing”), HunyuanVideo-1.5 (runs on one RTX 4090), Wan 2.2 (Apache-2.0) — each release strengthens the local path Cinamate already owns architecturally.
- **Money Room standalone vs. Movie Magic + spreadsheets.** EP publishes no price and its store was unreachable; the incumbent budget stack is ripe for a transparent, self-calibrating challenger sold separately from generation.
- **Press-the-advantage moment on LightsKiddo's proof.** Its endorsement structure is partly circular (advisor-as-testimonial), its case study is a demo narrated as a deployment, and its pricing is gated behind a personal calendar link. Cinamate should not concede commercial traction that has not been demonstrated.

THREATS

- **The compliance turnstile.** TPN/MPA gates pre-release content; SOC 2 gates procurement; the union layer gates covered productions; the U.S. Copyright Office gates ownership itself. A vendor can be excellent and still be un-buyable — Cinamate currently fails the stack at four heights (\$22).
- **Copyright registrability of purely AI output.** Copyright Office Part 2 guidance (Jan 2025) holds purely AI-generated output unregistrable; no registration means no clean chain of title, which distributors and E&O carriers require. This is the deepest gate and it cannot be bought around — it must be designed around (human-authorship workflow, documented creative control).
- **Union enforcement and consent provenance.** Post-2023 SAG-AFTRA AI provisions, WGA MBA terms, state digital-replica laws (CA AB 2602 / AB 1836), the NO FAKES Act push, and EU AI Act Article 50 transparency obligations — in force since 2 August 2026 — all converge on synthetic voice/likeness. “Consented and licensed” asserted without a consent registry or audit trail is the first question every serious buyer will ask.
- **Frontier absorption of the application layer.** Google Flow (Veo 3.1) ships scene-building, character consistency and 4K upscale at \$19.99–\$199.99/mo on free distribution; Runway ships Edit Studio, node workflows and agents (~\$545M documented funding); Sora 2 batch hits \$0.05/s. Each release absorbs more of what Cinamate’s generation layer does. The 28 rooms and the financial calibration are the durable part — not the render.
- **Open-weight withholding.** The newest model tiers are going closed (Wan 2.5 unreleased weights, MiniMax holding back H3-Context-IR/Regenerate-2K, NVIDIA non-OSI license). If the trend continues, local-generation quality plateaus while cloud quality compounds.
- **The payroll-rail duopoly gives away Cinamate’s product.** EP (TPG) and Cast & Crew (EQT) monetize payment flow (0.75–2% of payroll across the category), so the tool layer is subsidized to ~free: Saturation’s free tier, the free Showbiz Labor Guide publishing the union rates Cinamate treats as proprietary rigor, Wrapbook’s free incentive map. The Money Room competes with free products funded by float.
- **Consolidation takes capability off the market.** Netflix acquired InterPositive (announced 5 March 2026, price undisclosed) and will not commercialize it; Autodesk absorbed Wonder Dynamics, PIX and Moxion; Adobe holds Premiere+Frame.io+Firefly; Backlight rolled up iconik/ftrack/cineSync/Celtx. Strategic buyers are assembling exactly the stack Cinamate needs to interoperate with.
- **Voice/music markets already restructured around provenance.** ElevenLabs raised \$500M at \$11B; Flawless holds TPN Gold + SOC 2 + ISO 27001 with a SAG-AFTRA-built consent gate; Suno paid Warner \$500M and licensed BMG; Udio settled with Universal and relaunched licensed-only. Cinamate’s synthetic-media components enter a market whose terms were set by litigation it wasn’t party to.
- **LightsKiddo’s convergence path is shorter than Cinamate’s.** Adding generation to a multi-user graph (Indra + ElevenLabs already shipped) is a feature; adding multi-user roles, camera ingest, an on-set app, real-time sync and enterprise compliance to a single-operator local-GPU architecture is a rebuild. If the two products do converge, the asymmetry favors them.

STRENGTHS

- **Distribution and trust artifacts, built deliberately.** ~10 public pages, a named executive team and advisors, four named endorsements with titles and organizations, five case studies, a published philosophy, a working contact with a one-business-day SLA. In a market where trust is the scarce resource, this is the asset.
- **The crewed-production integration surface.** Live camera control (Sony/ARRI/Blackmagic) with takes matched to shot nodes; agents native inside Avid, Resolve, Premiere, Blender, Maya, Unreal; .fdx/.mmsp/.aaf/.usd format fluency; iOS + macOS apps; role-based per-department views. This is years of unglamorous work Cinamate has not started.
- **An adoption path engineered around loss-aversion.** “Keep your pipeline... onboarding is us learning your processes”; “the production outlives the tool — if Light goes away tomorrow, the work stays.” It sells change without asking anyone to abandon anything — the exact inverse of a 28-module all-at-once migration.
- **The education channel.** NYU Tisch is a pipeline for making LightsKiddo the default in the muscle memory of the next generation of ADs and UPMs.
- **Disclosed compliance program.** TPN assessment in progress, SOC 2 underway — not certifications, but a procurement-legible posture Cinamate entirely lacks.
- **Convergence optionality already exercised.** An in-house generative model (Indra) and ElevenLabs voice mean the “we don’t make the film” philosophy is a positioning choice, revocable at will, not a capability gap.
- **A second product line in facilities.** The stage-utilization dashboard (Radford, Manhattan Beach, Brooklyn Navy Yard) addresses stage operators — a separate buyer with real budgets.

WEAKNESSES

- **The proof is thinner than the surface.** Two of four flagship endorsements (the Oscar-nominee testimonial; the NYU Tisch relationship) plausibly resolve to the company’s own advisor — an undisclosed related party, with his name spelled two different ways across two pages. The Miramax case study, read closely, is one script processed on one morning. “Sandbox deployments underway” is compatible with zero paying customers.
- **Entity confusion at contract time.** Agni, Inc. (footer) vs. Light Inc. / light.inc (privacy notice) vs. LightsKiddo (brand). A DPA needs a counterparty.
- **Boilerplate privacy policy that contradicts the product.** “Do we process any sensitive personal information? No.” — from a platform holding cast lists, payroll-adjacent crew data, minors’ details and location releases. Unedited template text under a “production-safe by default” pitch.
- **No self-serve motion at all.** Three unpriced enterprise licenses behind a demo link that resolves to a personal Notion calendar. The entire long tail — the market’s volume — is structurally excluded.
- **The foundry model is headcount-bound.** “Our engineers embed with your production” caps concurrent customers at engineering payroll and makes every win a services engagement. It buys lock-in at the price of scale.
- **Nothing at the money end of the lifecycle.** No investor relations, no recoupment waterfall, no clearance/E&O tooling, no tax-incentive engine, no distribution or festival layer — the entire back half where independent films are actually won or lost.
- **No methodology disclosure.** No accuracy figures, no error bars, no calibration data — nothing comparable to even Cinamate’s unpublished rigor, in a forecasting market where rivals publish accuracy routinely.

- **Scaffolding leaks of its own.** Public internal test posts (“/ila/@demo/write-path-test — ...It works,” by “Demo Creator”) indexed in its sitemap.

OPPORTUNITIES

- **Convert sandboxes to paid deployments** — one named, referenceable production converts narrative traction into commercial proof, and the first mover in certified coordination locks the studio tier.
- **Finish the certifications first.** Completing TPN and SOC 2 before any AI-native rival would make compliance the moat its foundry model needs to justify enterprise pricing.
- **Own the education-to-industry pipeline.** Expand the Tisch model to other film schools; graduates carry the tool into productions as the default.
- **Exercise the convergence option.** Indra + the graph + ElevenLabs is an incremental path to generation-for-previs and pitch assets — attacking Cinamate’s bullseye segment from a position of greater trust.
- **Facilities as a beachhead.** Stage operators are a concentrated, reachable buyer; utilization dashboards can pull productions onto the graph from the venue side.

THREATS

- **The incumbents own the budget line it needs.** EP and Cast & Crew bundle scheduling, budgeting, payroll, residuals and incentives into the same enterprise relationships LightsKiddo must win — with file formats (.mmsx/.sex) as switching costs and payroll float as a war chest.
- **Frontier agents absorb coordination too.** The same model companies eating generation are shipping agentic workflows; “the million recalculations after you decide” is exactly what a general agent over production data will claim next.
- **The related-party endorsement is a credibility time bomb.** If a journalist or diligence analyst surfaces the Tunncliffe circularity before the company discloses it, all four endorsements become suspect retroactively.
- **Services-model scaling wall.** Every account consumes embedded engineers; growth is linear in headcount while funded SaaS rivals compound. A capitalized competitor can simply out-hire the foundry.
- **Certification race risk.** Filmustage already holds SOC 2 Type II + TPN Blue Shield in the adjacent breakdown market; if AI-native rivals certify faster, “in progress” becomes a liability rather than a bridge.

§7 Head-to-Head: The Honest Scorecard

DIFFERENT RACES, ONE INDUSTRY

Cinamate’s job-to-be-done: “*let me make a film without a crew.*” LightsKiddo’s: “*when one thing changes, don’t let my production fall out of sync.*” One replaces production; the other coordinates it. They collide genuinely in three places: pitch and pre-visualization assets (the one head-to-head Cinamate wins outright today), budgeting and scheduling (both union-anchored), and the word “AI” in a producer’s head. They cannot collide where each has ceded ground: Cinamate cannot serve a crewed shoot; LightsKiddo will not generate a film — as principle, not limitation.

	CINAMATE	LIGHTSKIDDO	Edge
Lifecycle coverage	Development → distribution → festivals → tax credit (28 verified rooms)	Pre-production → post only	Cinamate
Makes the film	Yes — synthetic master, crew of one	No — explicitly ceded	Cinamate
Generation economics	Local GPU, \$0 marginal render, priced before render	n/a (Indra is nascent)	Cinamate
Methodology posture	P10–P90, elasticity, error-disclosure stance	None published	Cinamate
Self-serve / long tail	Architecturally yes (gated today)	Structurally impossible (foundry)	Cinamate
Named team	None	3 executives + 2 advisors	LightsKiddo
Named customers/endorsers	None	4 (with caveats — §4)	LightsKiddo
Working contact channel	None — domain unregistered	Live MX, form, calendar, SLA	LightsKiddo
Public surface	1 page, press declined	~10 pages, 5 case studies	LightsKiddo
Compliance posture	None stated	TPN in progress, SOC 2 underway	LightsKiddo
Multi-user / roles	No — single operator	Role-based, per department	LightsKiddo
On-set presence	None	iOS + macOS, live call sheets	LightsKiddo
Camera / NLE reach	None / EDL·OTIO export only	Sony·ARRI·BMD / native in 6 DCC-NLEs	LightsKiddo
Education channel	None	NYU Tisch	LightsKiddo
Real-time sync	4-minute cycle	“Propagates in minutes,” live claims	LightsKiddo
Commercial proof	None (invite-only beta)	Narrative only (related-party caveats)	Neither
Certifications held	None	None	Neither
Engineering hygiene	Dead sitemap, undefined paths, fake telemetry	Public test posts, boilerplate privacy policy	Neither

IS “THEY ARE WAY BEHIND US” SUPPORTABLE?

On product surface and economics — yes. Cinamate has more lifecycle, a capability ceiling LightsKiddo renounced, a price floor LightsKiddo’s cost structure forbids, and a rigor posture LightsKiddo does not attempt. On breadth of the financial lifecycle it is ahead of everyone in this report, not just LightsKiddo.

On becoming a company — no, and it is not close the other way. Software capability is not the scarce resource in this market; distribution and trust are. LightsKiddo has built for both while Cinamate has built against both: press declined, careers by referral, an unregistered contact domain, invite-only access. A product with more modules and no way to be bought is behind a product with fewer modules that is in a room with Miramax — even if that room, on the evidence, has so far hosted one demo.

The formulation that survives the evidence: Cinamate has built more than LightsKiddo has shown; LightsKiddo has sold more than Cinamate can currently receive. And the convergence asymmetry favors LightsKiddo: bolting generation onto a multi-user graph is a feature; bolting multi-user, on-set, camera ingest, real-time sync and compliance onto a single-operator local-GPU architecture is a rebuild.

THE THREE MOVES THAT CHANGE THE PICTURE — NONE IS A FEATURE

1. **Register cinamate.studio and make contact work.** Hours of effort. Until this is true, nothing else matters — every inbound the site earns is currently lost.
2. **Publish the rigor and delete the fake telemetry.** The failure rate, the real price, one fully-sourced worked budget line (one SAG-AFTRA rate, agreement and effective date, derived end-to-end) — and strip or label the randomized HUD that gives every skeptic license to dismiss the real numbers.
3. **Sell the wedge LightsKiddo structurally cannot reach.** The financing-and-recoupment stack plus generation-for-pitch, to solo filmmakers and pitching producers — self-serve, price published, TPN Blue Shield self-assessment filed.

§8 The Competitive Landscape: How to Read It

The catalog that follows profiles **318 companies, products, standards and substitutes** across 14 categories — every player the research fleet could substantiate that competes with, substitutes for, gates, or supplies any of Cinamate’s 28 rooms and four flagship systems. Entities that compete in several categories appear once in full, in their primary category, with cross-references elsewhere.

RELATIONSHIP TO CINAMATE

- DIRECT** — competes for the same job as at least one Cinamate module (122 entries).
- ADJACENT** — overlaps several modules without matching the core job (71 entries).
- INDIRECT** — a substitute buyers use instead, or a gate/standard that decides market access (125 entries).

THREAT LEVEL

Rated against Cinamate specifically — its segment, economics and stated roadmap — not against the industry generally: **CRITICAL** (33) · **HIGH** (73) · **MEDIUM** (119) · **LOW** (93).

THE CRITICAL-THREAT BOARD — ALL 33 ENTRIES RATED CRITICAL

Entity	Category	Relationship	Why it matters
Adobe Premiere Pro (with Firefly Generative Extend)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset tracking	DIRECT	The dominant professional NLE, now shipping the exact AI edit-assist feature set Cinamate markets as novel.
Blackmagic DaVinci Resolve 21 / Resolve Studio	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset tracking	DIRECT	A free, or \$295-perpetual, single application that does edit, color, Fairlight audio and Fusion VFX with real-time cloud collaboration.
Cast & Crew	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accounting	DIRECT	EQT-owned payroll-and-software conglomerate that owns PSL+, Media Services/Showbiz, CAPS, Sargent-Disc, The TEAM Companies and — critically for Cinamate — Final Draft.
Doing nothing (email + PDF + paper + the producer's own head)	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	The single largest competitor in the category: no tool at all, because the producer has made films this way before.
ElevenLabs	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	DIRECT	The default AI voice layer for the industry — TTS, voice cloning, 90+ language dubbing and licensed AI music — now a \$11B company.
Entertainment Partners (EP)	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accounting	DIRECT	TPG-owned incumbent that supplies payroll, production accounting, budgeting, scheduling, p-cards, residuals and tax-incentive advisory to most of the studio system.
Entertainment Partners (EP) Production Incentives	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incentive tooling	ADJACENT	The industry-standard global production incentive database, estimator and jurisdiction comparison suite from the largest entertainment payroll company.
FilmFreeway	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	The de facto monopoly on film festival and screenplay-contest submissions since Withoutabox shut in 2019.
Filmhub	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	Self-serve, non-exclusive global distribution rail that puts an indie title onto 100+ exhibitors (per homepage) for a 20% cut.

Entity	Category	Relationship	Why it matters
Filmustage	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	DIRECT	The category-defining AI pre-production platform — script in, breakdown/schedule/budget out, with studio-grade security certifications.
Final Draft (Cast & Crew)	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI coverage/analysis and script clearance/title research)	DIRECT	The incumbent screenplay file format and production-office standard, owned by the payroll company whose rails Cinamate's Money Room is trying to replace.
Flawless	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	ADJACENT	Visual dubbing and in-vision ADR for major studios — and the company that already holds every certification Cinamate is missing.
Free film-industry template libraries (Wrapbook, StudioBinder, SAGindie, PGA, Film Independent)	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	Hundreds of free, professionally vetted film production documents that replace most of Cinamate's paperwork modules outright.
General-purpose AI assistants (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini)	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	A \$20/month chatbot that will break down a script, draft a schedule, estimate a budget and write a deal memo on demand.
Google Flow (Veo 3.1 / DeepMind)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	Google's AI filmmaking studio, current as a unified idea-to-finished-video pipeline on Veo 3.1.
Google Sheets / Google Workspace	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	The free, collaborative default for indie budgets, schedules, contact lists and shot lists.
Google Veo 3.1 + Flow	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrastructure	DIRECT	Google's Veo model family paired with Flow, an AI creative studio that has already absorbed storyboarding, scene assembly, character management and editing into the model vendor's own product.
Higgsfield AI	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	An AI-video company (valuation claims unverified) whose Cinema Studio product is being used to direct AI films — and which just shipped a 110-minute AI-generated feature for \$2M in four weeks.
Lightricks LTX-2.5 / LTX-2 (open weights) + LTX Studio	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrastructure	DIRECT	The single most consequential entry for Cinamate: a 22B open-weight audio-video model you self-host with no per-generation billing, from a vendor that also ships its own storyboard-to-film studio app.
LightsKiddo (Agni, Inc.)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	An "operating system for media production" that carries one decision through breakdown, shotlist, schedule, budget, set and edit, aimed at live-action crews rather than generative output.
LTX Studio (Lightricks)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	The most mature end-to-end AI film workspace: script, storyboard, generated clips, timeline edit and pitch deck in one project, backed by its own open-weight models.
Microsoft Excel / Microsoft 365 (with film budget templates)	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	The actual industry-standard film budgeting tool - a spreadsheet with a top sheet, ATL/BTL accounts and fringe formulas.

Entity	Category	Relationship	Why it matters
Movie Magic Scheduling (Entertainment Partners)	Production management suites (the incumbents)	DIRECT	The de facto industry-standard scheduling and stripboard application for film and television, owned by Entertainment Partners.
MPA Content Security Best Practices (v5.3.1)	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	The single benchmark of minimum security preparedness for the content industries — the control set every TPN assessment scores against.
OpenAI Sora 2 / Sora 2 Pro	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrastructure	DIRECT	OpenAI's flagship video+audio generation model, sold via API and a consumer Sora app, and still the reference point every other vendor is benchmarked against.
RivetAI	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI coverage/analysis and script clearance/title research)	DIRECT	Per-project pre-production platform where script, breakdown, schedule, budget and coverage all run off one screenplay.
Runway (Gen-4.5, Aleph 2.0, Edit Studio)	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrastructure	DIRECT	The most production-oriented of the model vendors — it now ships an editing studio, node-based workflows, an autonomous agent, and professional delivery formats Cinamate does not support.
SAG-AFTRA AI consent and digital-replica terms	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	The performers' union rules requiring informed consent and compensation for digital replicas — the reason a Cinamate-generated performance cannot lawfully appear in a union production without paperwork.
Saturation.io	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accounting	DIRECT	Producer-built cloud budgeting and production-spend platform with a genuinely free tier — the closest structural analogue to Cinamate's Money Room for a single operator.
StudioBinder	Production management suites (the incumbents)	DIRECT	The default cloud production-management suite for independent and commercial productions, covering script through call sheet in one browser app.
TPN (Trusted Partner Network)	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	The MPA-owned content-security registry and assessment program that most studios and streamers use as a precondition for handing a vendor pre-release content.
US Copyright Office — AI guidance (Reports Parts 1-3)	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	The federal position that human authorship is required for copyright — the gate that determines whether a Cinamate-generated film can be owned, insured and distributed at all.
Wrapbook	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accounting	DIRECT	Venture-backed, AI-enabled production payroll and production accounting platform that has become the modern default for commercials and indie/mid-budget film and TV.

§9 AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios

Market read · The category has bifurcated, and Cinamate sits in the thin gap between the halves. On one side are capital-saturated model companies — Higgsfield (a cluster of circulating mega-numbers — none confirmable against a primary source), Runway (~\$545M documented; \$308M in April 2025 at >\$3B), Luma (\$900M at \$4B, in testing at five of six majors), plus Google Flow/Veo 3.1 and Sora 2 riding free distribution. None of them do production management. On the other side are pre-production planners — Filmustage (Director's Cut \$79/mo), Cinetech, FinalBit, Katalist, ScreenWeaver — none of which generate a finished film. Only a handful attempt both: LTX Studio, Melies, MITO, mStudio, invideo's Agent One, and Cinamate. Pricing has normalized around credits, roughly \$15–\$125/month for prosumer tiers with custom enterprise above; the “~\$110 per feature (unverified), quoted before render” framing is genuinely differentiated but competes against free open-weight local generation (ComfyUI plus LTX-2.5/Wan 2.2/HunyuanVideo 1.5), which is the real substitute for Cinamate's Local Generation moat. Consolidation has begun: Netflix acquired InterPositive (announced 5 Mar 2026; price undisclosed), Autodesk absorbed Wonder Dynamics, and Storia AI — a thin previsualization wrapper — closed. Direction of travel is toward licensed-data credibility (Moonvalley's Marey), certification (TPN/SOC 2 as table stakes), and named human leadership. Cinamate's real exposure is not feature parity — its 28 modules are broader than anyone's — but legitimacy: every serious rival has a named team, a real domain, funding, or a released film. Cinamate has none, and its differentiating claims (9h 12m 44s turnaround, 3,708-film calibration, 124 accuracy checks) are self-asserted and unaudited.

Google Flow (Veo 3.1 / DeepMind) labs.google/flow DIRECT CRITICAL VERIFIED

Google's AI filmmaking studio, current as a unified idea-to-finished-video pipeline on Veo 3.1.

Flow is Google's filmmaking front end for Veo. On 25 February 2026 Google merged Flow, Whisk (mood boards) and ImageFX (text-to-image) into one workspace, turning a clip generator into a concept-to-image-to-animated-audio-synced-video pipeline. Veo 3.1 adds 4K output, cinematic prompting, precise camera control, persistent world-state memory for continuity across shots, integrated Foley, and a Director's Mode for granular visual control. Distribution is enormous — free Veo 3.1 generation reached all Google accounts via Google Vids, with Lyria 3 music generation and directable avatars.

KEY FEATURES · Unified Flow + Whisk + ImageFX creative workspace (Feb 2026) · Veo 3.1: 4K, cinematic prompting, camera control, Director's Mode · Persistent world-state memory for cross-shot continuity · Integrated Foley / native audio · Scene builder and clip extension · Lyria 3 AI music generation (via Vids) · Free tier with paid Google AI Pro/Ultra escalation

PRICING Free: 50 daily credits; Google AI Plus \$4.99/mo (200 credits); AI Pro \$19.99/mo (1,000); AI Ultra \$99.99–\$199.99/mo (10,000–25,000). [vendor-verified]

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Google DeepMind. Distribution across all Google accounts; described as the most capable free-to-start AI creative tool in 2026. No standalone funding or revenue figure.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · boards (storyboards/animations) · music (Lyria-generated score vs Cinamate's music/cue sheets) · vfx · editor (assembly only)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Frontier model quality at 4K with native audio and world-state continuity
- Free tier and Google-scale distribution vs invite-only beta
- Persistent world-state memory addresses continuity better than a per-shot local pipeline
- No hardware requirement — Cinamate requires a local GPU
- Backed by DeepMind research cadence Cinamate cannot match

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Zero production management — no budget, schedule, call sheets, contracts, clearance, tax credit, deliverables or festivals
- No cost reporting, PO tracking or estimate calibration
- No EDL/OTIO conform or professional NLE
- Cloud-only; content leaves the user's machine, which is exactly the privacy pitch Cinamate sells
- Consumer-oriented rights/terms rather than production-grade chain of title

△ Fact-check: runs on Veo 3.1 — there is no 'Veo 4'. All references to a 'Veo 4 relaunch' were removed as hallucinated.

Higgsfield AI higgsfield.ai DIRECT CRITICAL UNCERTAIN

An AI-video company (valuation claims unverified) whose Cinema Studio product is being used to direct AI films — and which just shipped a 110-minute AI-generated feature for \$2M in four weeks.

Higgsfield is a consumer-and-prosumer AI video platform with a Cinema Studio surface aimed at filmmakers directing AI films, plus a Marketing Studio for brand teams. In August 2026 it produced *The Cully Hill Boys*, a 110-minute action-comedy using licensed celebrity likenesses, on a \$2M budget (unverified) (roughly half of it AI tokens) in four weeks, with a human screenwriter on dialogue. Its AI films have premiered at Cannes and in New York. It is a generation platform — no scheduling, budgeting, clearance or deliverables tooling.

KEY FEATURES · Cinema Studio: prompt/reference-to-shot filmmaking workspace · Marketing Studio for brand/ad teams · Camera-motion and cinematic control presets · Long-form feature production capability demonstrated at 110 minutes · Licensed celebrity likeness pipeline · Credit-based generation across multiple models

PRICING Not vendor-verified — pricing page returns no plan data to fetchers; third-party trackers list subscription tiers.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP UNVERIFIED: circulating figures (\$400M Series B at \$5.4B led by DST, \$700M ARR, 30M users, 390 of the Fortune 500, a 110-min AI feature for \$2M in 4 weeks) could not be confirmed against any primary source — treat every number as third-party rumor. AI films have verifiably premiered at festivals.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation — the single most direct threat to Cinamate's script-to-screen claim · boards · vfx · screening · editor (light assembly only)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Has actually shipped a 110-minute AI-generated feature with press coverage; Cinamate's 9h 12m 44s script-to-master turnaround is an unverified self-claim
- Reported (unverified) capital and revenue scale vs an unfunded private beta
- 30M users vs invite-only
- Licensed celebrity likeness deals — a rights capability Cinamate cannot match
- Cannes and New York premieres; Cinamate's press declined
- Credits start at ~\$9/mo, undercutting Cinamate's ~\$110 per feature at the low end

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Cloud-metered — no local GPU / \$0.00 cloud billing option; *The Cully Hill Boys* burned ~\$1M in tokens
- No production-management modules whatsoever (producer, contracts, casting, locations, wardrobe, props, sets, safety, finance, taxcredit, distribution, festivals)
- No multi-track NLE with EDL/OTIO conform
- No cost reporting, PO tracking or self-calibrating estimates
- Credits expire after 90 days; Cinamate quotes a fixed price before render
- No union-rate sourcing or budget rigor

△ Fact-check: the largest cluster of unsourced numbers in this research. Nothing numeric about Higgsfield should be repeated without a named filing.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/17/higgsfield-raises-400m-series-b-quadrupling-its-valuation-in-8-months-to-5-4b/> · <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/higgsfield-raises-400-million-series-b-financing-at-5-4-billion-valuation-with-annualized-revenue-reaching-700-million-302852430.html> · <https://www.semafor.com/article/08/19/2026/ai-startup-produces-fully-ai-generated-feature-length-film> · <https://higgsfield.ai/cinematic-video-generator>

LightsKiddo (Agni, Inc.) www.lightskiddo.com DIRECT CRITICAL VERIFIED

An "operating system for media production" that carries one decision through breakdown, shotlist, schedule, budget, set and edit, aimed at live-action crews rather than generative output.

LightsKiddo builds a unified production "graph" linking script to final cut. Pre-production covers automated script breakdown (characters, props, locations, equipment), shot lists with lens/T-stop/framing, stripboard scheduling, and a budget engine with live recalculation of fringes, tax rebates and contingencies. Production adds real-time on-set AI supervision (continuity, script matching), a live iOS companion with call sheets and maps, and role-based department permissions. Post covers AI dailies (slate,

sync, color), editorial selects, VFX plate prep and ElevenLabs-based voice cloning for scratch/ADR. It is explicitly crew-facing; it does not claim to generate a finished film from a screenplay.

KEY FEATURES · Automated script breakdown and shot list generation with lens/T-stop specs · Stripboard scheduling and live-recalculating budget with fringes, rebates, contingencies · Real-time on-set AI continuity/script supervision · iOS on-set companion app with call sheets and maps · Camera integrations: ARRI, RED, Blackmagic, Sony Venice · NLE/DCC integrations: Avid, Premiere Pro, DaVinci Resolve, Blender, Maya, Unreal, Pro Tools, Ableton Live · Format support: Final Draft .fdx, Movie Magic .mmsp/.mmb, XML/AAF/EDL · Local model deployment with content encrypted in the user's environment · Encryption, watermarking, per-share access, audit logs

PRICING Not disclosed. Enterprise licensing across three tiers, demo-gated; no public price list.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Operated by Agni, Inc. Site names Miramax, NYU Tisch School of the Arts, WT Productions (Oscar-nominated director) and Lightup London as deployments. Currently in sandbox deployments with major studios and independents, not general release. TPN assessment in progress; SOC 2 underway. Funding not disclosed on the site.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (breakdown, stripboard, budget, call sheets) · boards (shotlists/storyboards) · timeline · production · dailies · today · editor · vfx · finance / The Money Room (live budget recalculation, rebates, contingencies) · tools (slate/timecards) · Studio Cloud Backup (unified production state) · workflow · projects · music (Ableton/Pro Tools handoff)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Native camera ingest for ARRI/RED/Blackmagic/Sony Venice — Cinamate has none
- Native plugins for Premiere/Resolve/Blender/Maya/Ableton vs Cinamate's EDL/OTIO-only conform
- iOS on-set companion — Cinamate has no mobile/on-set app
- TPN assessment and SOC 2 in progress vs Cinamate's zero certifications
- Named institutional deployments (Miramax, NYU Tisch) vs Cinamate's invite-only beta with no public customers
- Real-time on-set supervision vs Cinamate's 4-minute sync
- Built for multi-department crews with role-based permissions vs Cinamate's single-operator design
- Own domain and enterprise sales motion vs a netlify.app subdomain

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No generative script-to-screen output — Cinamate's Local Generation and ~\$110/90-page render have no LightsKiddo equivalent
- No browser NLE comparable to The Cutting Room (AI rough cut, silence trim, music sync, color balance, H.264+AAC export)
- No disclosed sales/box-office model, failure rate, or P10-P90 confidence bands
- No published tax-credit engine spanning 21 jurisdictions
- Undisclosed enterprise-only pricing excludes the solo producer Cinamate targets; Cinamate quotes price before render
- Not generally available — sandbox deployments only
- No published union rate sourcing (SAG-AFTRA/DGA/WGA/IATSE scale) equivalent

<https://www.lightskiddo.com/> · <https://technical.ly/company/agni-ai/>

LTX Studio (Lightricks) ltx.studio DIRECT CRITICAL VERIFIED

The most mature end-to-end AI film workspace: script, storyboard, generated clips, timeline edit and pitch deck in one project, backed by its own open-weight models.

Released 28 February 2024 by Lightricks, LTX Studio converts text prompts or scripts into characters, scenes, storyboards and video sequences, with shot composition and camera-angle control, project-level asset management, and a timeline. It runs on Lightricks' own LTX Video family (LTXV, LTXV-13B, LTX-2, LTX-2.5) plus third-party models including Veo and Kling depending on tier. July 2025 added continuous clips up to ~60 seconds; the platform advertises native 4K and synchronized audio, and covers concept through delivery including a pitch deck. Crucially, Lightricks also open-sources the LTX-Video weights, which is what makes local generation possible for everyone else.

KEY FEATURES · Script-to-storyboard-to-video in one project · Shot composition, camera angle and framing control · Timeline editing and project-level asset management · Multi-model access: LTX-2/2.5 plus Veo 2/3.1, Kling 2.6/3.0 Pro by tier · Native 4K output with synchronized audio · Pitch deck generation · Open-weight LTX-Video models for local/self-hosted inference · Enterprise tier with custom model training

PRICING Free: 800 one-time credits, LTX-2 models only, personal use, no commercial rights. Lite \$15/mo (\$12 annual), 8,000 credits/mo, personal use. Standard \$35/mo (\$28 annual), 28,000 credits/mo, commercial use, Veo 2 and Kling 2.6 Pro. Pro \$125/mo, 110,000 credits/mo, Veo 3.1 and Kling 3.0 Pro. Enterprise custom with unlimited credits and custom model training. Prices from aggregated pricing pages, not fetched from the vendor directly.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Owned by Lightricks (Israel), an established consumer-creative software company. Public availability since 2024. Reported production-studio results of up to 85% faster previsualization and \$120K+ saved per project (vendor-adjacent claim, treat with caution). No standalone funding figure.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · writer · boards (storyboards/animations) · editor / The Cutting Room (timeline editing, though shallower) · music · investors (pitch deck generation vs Cinamate's investors module) · screening

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Two years of public availability, real user base and reviews vs an invite-only beta
- Owns and open-sources its models; Cinamate owns no model
- Commercial-use rights explicit from \$35/mo
- Native 4K with synced audio
- Multi-model access including Veo 3.1 and Kling 3.0 Pro
- Enterprise tier with custom model training
- Public company, public team, real domain

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No production-management layer — nothing for producer, contracts, casting, locations, permits, wardrobe, props, sets, safety, finance, taxcredit, deliverables or festivals
- No EDL/OTIO conform or H.264+AAC professional export pipeline comparable to The Cutting Room
- No cost reporting, PO tracking or self-calibrating estimates
- Free tier has no commercial rights; Cinamate's beta presumably does not restrict this
- Cloud credit metering vs \$0.00 cloud billing
- Timeline editing is shallow — reviewers flag it as a gap

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/LTX_Studio · <https://ltx.io/studio/pricing> · <https://lightricks.zendesk.com/hc/en-us/articles/28325413554962-LTX-plans-and-pricing> · <https://dupple.com/reviews/ltx-studio>

Flick (flick.art) flick.art DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

A \$6M-seed AI-native filmmaking platform built for creative control — chat-based directing over a non-linear storyboard timeline with multiple generative models.

Flick, founded by filmmaker Zoey Zhang and former Instagram engineering leader Ray Wang, positions itself explicitly against one-click generators: creators direct short films through chat-based prompting arranged on a storyboard-like non-linear interface, with cinematic controls, character management for consistency, scene editing, camera movement control, collaboration and a built-in clip editor. It orchestrates multiple third-party models — Veo 3, ByteDance Seedance, Midjourney among them. It also runs the Flick Filmmaker Residency, whose first cohort produced 10+ AI shorts screened at Cinequest, MIT and the Omni AI Film Festival.

KEY FEATURES · Chat-based directing with non-linear storyboard timeline · Character reference and consistency management · Camera movement and cinematic controls · Multi-model routing (Veo 3, Seedance, Midjourney and others) · Free built-in video editor · 1M+ film scene inspiration library and 1,000+ style presets · Pooled workspace credits with no per-seat billing · Enterprise tier with custom model training and founder Slack support · Flick Filmmaker Residency

PRICING Free tier: 300 initial credits plus 100 weekly credits, basic/auto models, unlimited AI chat, free editor. Paid tiers are advertised by monthly credit allotment — Casual 500, Standard 2,500, Pro 8,000, Studio 24,000 — plus custom Enterprise. Press reports the range as roughly \$5 to \$600 per month depending on credits; exact dollar-per-tier mapping was not legible on the pricing page.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP \$6M seed announced 14 May 2026, backed by True Ventures, GV, Y Combinator, Lightspeed, Formosa Capital, Pioneer Fund, Olive Tree Capital, N1 Capital and angels. Y Combinator alumnus. User count not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · writer · boards (storyboards/animations) · editor / The Cutting Room (basic clip editing) · casting (AI character/actor consistency vs Cinamate's casting module) · screening

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Real institutional funding (\$6M) and a tier-one investor syndicate vs unfunded
- Named, public founders with credible backgrounds vs Cinamate's no public team
- Model-agnostic routing to frontier models Cinamate cannot run locally
- Free tier plus a \$5-ish entry point — far below Cinamate's ~\$110/feature
- Festival footprint (Cinequest, MIT, Omni AI Film Festival) through its residency
- Team collaboration with pooled credits; Cinamate is single-operator by design

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Short-film oriented; no evidence of 90-page feature throughput
- Zero production management — no budget, schedule, call sheets, contracts, clearance, tax credit, deliverables, festivals modules
- No EDL/OTIO conform or multi-track professional NLE
- No cost reporting or PO tracking
- Cloud credits, no local GPU / \$0.00 cloud billing option
- Commercial-rights terms not stated on the pricing page

Luma AI (Dream Machine / Ray3)

lumalabs.ai

DIRECT

HIGH

VERIFIED

A \$4B-valuation video and 3D model company whose Ray series is in testing at five of the six major studios, now shipping end-to-end creative Agents.

Luma's Dream Machine wraps the Ray model family for cinematic generation. Ray 3, launched September 2025, was billed as the first "reasoning" video model — it generates then self-analyzes and corrects details, with HDR output aimed at cinematic storytelling. Ray 3.14 (January 2026) added native 1080p at 4x prior speed with clips up to 18 seconds at 24fps. In March 2026 Luma launched Agents to handle end-to-end creative projects across text, image, video and audio — the closest Luma comes to Cinamate's one-operator, whole-project ambition.

KEY FEATURES · Ray 3 / Ray 3.14 reasoning video model with self-correction · HDR cinematic output · Native 1080p, up to 18s clips at 24fps · Agents (March 2026) for end-to-end creative projects across modalities · 3D/NeRF heritage and volumetric capabilities · Studio-grade evaluation footprint

PRICING Subscription plus credits; exact 2026 tier prices not verified in this research. Enterprise terms not disclosed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP \$900M Series C at a \$4B valuation, November 2025, led by Humain with a16z, Amplify Partners and Matrix Partners; total funding past \$1B. Reported in use or testing at five of the six major studios. CEO has predicted the first film "significantly aided by AI" in 2026, likely short- or mid-form.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · boards · vfx · music/audio generation · workflow (Agents orchestrating a whole project)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Over \$1B raised; \$4B valuation
- Adoption/testing at five of six major studios — the exact buyers Cinamate claims to target one tier below
- Reasoning model that self-corrects, addressing consistency failures better than a fixed local pipeline
- Agents orchestrate multi-modal projects end to end
- 3D/volumetric capability Cinamate lacks entirely

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- 18-second clip ceiling; no feature-length assembly path
- No production-management modules of any kind
- No NLE, no conform, no deliverables
- No budgeting, union rates, tax credits or cost reporting
- Cloud-only — no local GPU / \$0.00 cloud billing
- CEO's own guidance is that 2026 output is short- or mid-form, not features

<https://www.thewrap.com/luma-ai-first-movie-2026-saudi-investment/> · <https://lumalabs.ai/use-case/filmmaking-cinematic-storytelling-with-dream-machine-ray-3> · <https://chatforest.com/reviews/luma-dream-machine-ray-series-ai-video-model-camera-motion-hdr/> · <https://startupintros.com/orgs/luma-ai>

Melies

melies.co

DIRECT

HIGH

LIKELY

An all-in-one AI film studio in the browser — 18 image models, 11 video models, AI actors with a Character Bible, and a timeline editor for final assembly.

Melies (from Yuki Capital) aggregates the model layer and wraps it in a filmmaking workflow: story idea generation, screenwriting, AI character creation, image generation across 18 models (Flux, Imagen 4, Seedream, Recraft, Nano Banana 2, Grok Imagine Image 2.0), video generation across 11 models (Sora 2 Pro, Veo 3.1, Kling v3 among them), voice and SFX generation, and a built-in timeline editor for assembly with audio, transitions and effects. Its Character Bible locks faces and voices so AI actors stay consistent across scenes. Reviewers describe it as the closest thing to a real AI film studio alongside LTX Studio.

KEY FEATURES · 18 image models and 11 video models in one workspace · Character Bible: consistent AI actors with locked faces and voices · 150+ AI actors and 220+ visual styles · AI story idea generator and screenwriting tools · Voice generation and sound effects · Built-in multi-track timeline editor for assembly · Credit-based, pay-for-what-you-generate pricing

PRICING Reported tiers: Indie from \$29/mo with 2,500 credits (films up to 5 minutes), Filmmaker with 10,000 credits (up to 15 minutes), Studio with 50,000 credits (long-form up to 180 minutes). Figures come from third-party reviews; the vendor page describes only credit-based pricing without published tier prices.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Parent company listed as Yuki Capital. Copyright 2026. Users described as indie filmmakers, YouTubers, ad agencies, educators and studios. No funding, revenue or user counts disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · writer · boards · casting (AI actors / Character Bible vs Cinamate's casting module) · editor / The Cutting Room (timeline assembly with audio and transitions) · music · screening

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Access to 29 frontier models including Sora 2 Pro, Veo 3.1 and Kling v3 — Cinamate is limited to what a local GPU can run
- Character Bible for face-and-voice consistency is more explicit than anything documented for Cinamate
- Studio tier explicitly supports up to 180 minutes of content
- Publicly available with published reviews vs invite-only
- Entry price of \$29/mo is far below a \$110 per-feature render

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No production management at all — no budget, stripboard, call sheets, contracts, casting logistics, locations/permits, safety, finance, tax credits, deliverables or festivals
- Reviewers flag gaps in audio quality and timeline editing depth
- No EDL/OTIO conform or professional H.264+AAC delivery pipeline
- No cost reporting, PO tracking or estimate calibration
- Cloud credits; no local GPU or \$0.00 cloud billing
- Thin company disclosure — no funding, team or scale published

<https://melies.co/ai-filmmaking> · <https://melies.co/compare/ltx-studio> · <https://aichief.com/ai-text-tools/melies/> · <https://www.softwareworld.co/software/melies-reviews/>

Moonvalley + Asteria (Marey) www.moonvalley.com **DIRECT** **HIGH** **VERIFIED**

The "clean model" play: a fully licensed, production-grade generative video model paired with an artist-led studio that has already premiered a hybrid AI feature at Tribeca.

Moonvalley built Marey, described as the only major commercial AI video model trained entirely on a licensed corpus, making it commercially safe for production environments. Asteria, the artist-led filmmaking arm run by Bryn Mooser and co-founded with Natasha Lyonne, develops tools and projects for filmmakers and studios. Marey offers pro-level controls (3D-aware generation, camera and motion control) and generates clips up to roughly five seconds. Asteria's *Uncanny Valley* — Lyonne's feature directorial debut with Brit Marling and Jaron Lanier, combining AI-generated visuals with traditional production — premiered at the 25th Tribeca Festival in June 2026.

KEY FEATURES · Marey: fully licensed training corpus, commercially safe output · 3D-aware generation with pro camera/motion control · Clips up to ~5 seconds · Distribution through third parties including Fal.ai and Adobe · Asteria: artist-led studio producing hybrid AI/live-action features · Rights-cleared positioning aimed at studio legal departments

PRICING Credit packs reported at launch: \$14.99 / 100 credits, \$34.99 / 250 credits, \$149.99 / 1,000 credits. These figures date to the July 2025 public launch and may be stale as of August 2026. Enterprise/studio terms not disclosed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP \$84M round led by General Catalyst with CAA, Comcast Ventures, CoreWeave, Khosla Ventures and Y Combinator, bringing total funding to ~\$154M. A prior ~\$70M was spent specifically licensing training content. Marey publicly available since July 2025. Asteria's first feature premiered at Tribeca, June 2026.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · clearance (rights-clean training data directly addresses what Cinamate's clearance module tracks) · vfx · boards · festivals (Tribeca premiere vs Cinamate's festivals module)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Licensed, commercially safe training corpus — a structural moat and a direct answer to the clearance/chain-of-title risk indie producers actually fear
- \$154M raised vs unfunded
- CAA and Comcast on the cap table; real Hollywood distribution relationships
- A finished feature premiered at Tribeca — Cinamate has no released title
- Available through Adobe and Fal.ai, meeting filmmakers where they work
- Named, credible creative leadership (Mooser, Lyonne)

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Five-second clip ceiling makes feature-length assembly laborious
- No production-management stack at all
- No NLE, no EDL/OTIO conform
- Cloud credits, no local GPU option; per-credit costs escalate fast at feature length
- No budgeting, scheduling, union rates, tax credits or deliverables
- Studio model (Asteria) competes for projects rather than selling software to solo producers

<https://deadline.com/2025/07/caa-comcast-ventures-funding-ai-firm-moonvalley-1236456571/> · <https://variety.com/2025/digital/news/moonvalley-comcast-cao-funding-investment-ai-video-1236459594/> · <https://techcrunch.com/2025/07/08/>

OpenAI Sora 2 sora.chatgpt.com DIRECT HIGH LIKELY

OpenAI's video model, now with a storyboard planning tool that puts frame-by-frame previsualization inside ChatGPT for hundreds of millions of users.

Sora 2 generates video from text and images. In early 2026 OpenAI added a Storyboards tool that lets creators plan and design videos frame by frame — currently in beta, exclusive to ChatGPT Pro subscribers and web-only — along with longer clips: 15 seconds for everyone and up to 25 seconds for Pro on web. The pitch for filmmakers is prototyping scenes before committing crews, locations or actors. Reports of a \$1B Disney partnership enabling licensed-character generation circulated but were not confirmed by a primary source in this research.

KEY FEATURES · Sora 2 text- and image-to-video · Storyboards frame-by-frame planning tool (beta, ChatGPT Pro, web only) · 15s clips for all users; 25s for Pro on web · Distribution through ChatGPT's installed base · Reported licensed-character generation via a Disney partnership (unverified)

PRICING Bundled into ChatGPT Plus/Pro subscriptions; Storyboards is Pro-gated. Exact 2026 Sora-specific pricing not verified here.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP OpenAI. Distribution scale is the differentiator — Sora ships inside ChatGPT. No separate revenue or funding figure for the product.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · boards (storyboards/animations) — Storyboards is a direct feature collision · writer · screening

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Distribution inside ChatGPT dwarfs any invite-only beta
- Frontier model quality and research cadence
- Storyboards ships as a first-class previsualization surface
- Effectively free at the margin for existing ChatGPT subscribers
- If the Disney licensing report is accurate, a rights position no independent tool can match

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- 25-second maximum clip length; nothing approaching feature assembly
- No production management, no budget, no schedule, no clearance, no deliverables
- No NLE or conform
- Storyboards is beta, Pro-only and web-only — narrow availability
- Consumer terms of service, not production chain-of-title
- Cloud-only; no local generation

<https://www.eweek.com/openai/openai-adds-longer-clips-sora-2/> · <https://evolutionaihub.com/openai-sora-2-storyboard-tool-longer-videos/> · <https://www.toolient.com/2026/02/openai-sora-2-public-access-ai-video-storytelling.html>

Open-source local generation stack (ComfyUI + LTX-2.5 / Wan 2.2-2.5 / HunyuanVideo 1.5 / CogVideoX-1.5)

github.com/comfyanonymous/ComfyUI INDIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

The free substitute for Cinamate's entire Local Generation pitch: open-weight video models running on the user's own GPU at near-zero marginal cost.

By 2026 the open-weight video landscape is dominated by DiT-architecture models: LTX-2.5 (Lightricks), Wan 2.2/2.5 (Alibaba), HunyuanVideo 1.5 (Tencent) and CogVideoX-1.5. ComfyUI is the standard node-based interface for running them locally, and all major models have official or community nodes. Commentators report these open models now approach closed SaaS quality at near-zero marginal inference cost, with local setups breaking even against hosted inference somewhere between 500 and 2,000 videos. LTX-2.5 is singled out as the only open model with native audio-video generation in a single pass, plus the deepest fine-tuning ecosystem (IC-LoRA adapters, camera-control LoRAs, FP8 quantization for 32GB GPUs).

KEY FEATURES · Runs entirely on local GPU — nothing leaves the machine · LTX-2.5 native single-pass audio+video; IC-LoRA and camera-control LoRAs · Wan 2.2 as the quality leader; Wan 2.5 ~30% faster at 720p · HunyuanVideo 1.5 for natural motion and physics · FP8 quantization for 32GB-class GPUs; broader quantization to cut VRAM · ComfyUI node graphs for arbitrary custom pipelines · Free; no per-render metering

PRICING \$0 software cost. Hardware and electricity only. LTX-2.3/2.5 ships under the LTX-2 Community License, which grants free commercial use only to organizations under roughly \$10M annual revenue; above that a paid Lightricks license is negotiated. Wan and HunyuanVideo carry their own permissive-ish licenses.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP No company — a community ecosystem. ComfyUI has a very large installed base among AI video practitioners. Model releases come from Lightricks, Alibaba and Tencent research teams.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation — this is the direct substitute, and it is free · vfx · boards

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free vs ~\$110 per 90-page feature
- Same privacy story Cinamate sells (local GPU, nothing leaves the machine) with no vendor dependency
- Faster model turnover — new open weights land monthly
- Total pipeline control via ComfyUI node graphs
- Fine-tuning and LoRA ecosystem Cinamate cannot match
- No invite gate, no vendor risk, no netlify.app subdomain question

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No orchestration — the user assembles everything; Cinamate's value is that a screenplay goes in and a master comes out
- No script parsing, shot planning, continuity management or scene-level project state
- No NLE, no EDL/OTIO conform, no deliverables
- Zero production management: no budget, schedule, union rates, tax credits, clearance
- Steep technical barrier; requires a competent operator, not a producer
- No price-quoted-before-render or cost predictability
- Licensing threshold (~\$10M revenue for LTX) creates commercial ambiguity for growing studios

<https://ltx.io/blog/best-open-source-video-generation-models> · <https://localaimaster.com/blog/local-ai-video-generation> · <https://www.aimagicx.com/blog/open-source-ai-video-models-comparison-2026> · <https://ltxworkflow.com/blog/ltx-2-3-vs-hunyuanvideo-vs-wan2-2-comparison-2026>

invideo AI (Agent One) invideo.io DIRECT MEDIUM LIKELY

A mass-market script-to-video platform whose Agent One turns a brief or script into a finished video end to end — and which is now co-financing an \$11M AI film slate in India.

invideo's Agent One takes a brief, script or prompt and orchestrates the full sequence conversationally and memory-aware: treatment, scenes, shot generation, voiceover and final assembly. It bundles frontier generative models — Seedance 2.0, Veo 3.1, Kling 3, Sora 2 depending on tier — alongside stock footage, AI avatars and voice cloning. It is the technology partner behind the Abundantia AI film studio in India, giving it a real feature-film proving ground.

KEY FEATURES · Agent One: brief/script to finished video, conversational and memory-aware · Treatment → scenes → shot generation → voiceover → assembly orchestration · Bundled frontier models (Seedance 2.0, Veo 3.1, Kling 3, Sora 2 by tier) · Stock footage library, AI avatars, voice cloning · Credit system with model-rate pass-through · Feature-film partnership with Abundantia Entertainment

PRICING Sources conflict. One reports Plus \$25/mo, Max \$60/mo, Generative \$120/mo (bundling Sora 2 and Veo 3.1). Another reports the ladder as Plus/Max/Generative/Elite at \$20/\$100/\$200/\$1,000 per month, with annual Plus around \$17/mo. Generative model usage is billed at the models' API rates against credits; credits do not roll over; top-ups available.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Established consumer video platform with a large user base (specific 2026 numbers not verified). Committed alongside Abundantia Entertainment to ₹100 crore (~\$11M) for five AI-driven films over three years. No recent funding round found in this research.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation — Agent One is the closest analogue to Cinamate's one-input-to-finished-film pitch · writer · boards · editor · music · distribution deliverables

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Agent One already does end-to-end orchestration at consumer scale — Cinamate's core claim, shipped
- Mass-market distribution and brand recognition
- Real feature-film slate financing through Abundantia
- Frontier model access
- Entry pricing at \$20-25/mo

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Output quality skews marketing/social, not cinema; not built for a 90-page screenplay
- No production management: no budget, schedule, call sheets, contracts, clearance, tax credits, festivals
- No EDL/OTIO conform or professional NLE
- Credits do not roll over and model pass-through pricing makes cost unpredictable — Cinamate quotes price before render
- Cloud-only, no local GPU
- Widely criticized for credit-cost opacity

<https://invideo.io/pricing/> · <https://theaiagentindex.com/agents/invideo> · <https://fluxnote.io/guides/invideo-ai-pricing-2026> · <https://maxaeo.ai/blog/invideo-ai-pricing/>

MITO AI mito.ai **DIRECT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

A Lightspeed-backed collaborative AI video canvas with a "Director" co-pilot, launched January 2026 for AI-native cinematic production.

MITO brings foundation video, image and audio models together with professional editing tools on a single infinite browser canvas. The workflow spans moodboarding, storyboarding and scripting through camera angles, visual effects and multi-format deliverables. A co-pilot called Director assists the creative process, and the storyboard is treated as a live working space — narrative, shot durations, frame duplication and shot order are all editable. It emphasizes control, consistency and collaboration across a team.

KEY FEATURES · Infinite browser canvas combining video, image and audio models · "Director" AI co-pilot · Moodboarding, storyboarding, scripting, camera angles, VFX · Editable storyboard with duration, duplication and reordering · Multi-format deliverables · Collaborative team workspace · Separate MITO Films arm for brand/agency AI-native production

PRICING Not disclosed in this research.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP \$4.5M preseed led by Lightspeed Venture Partners with Kibo, Kfund and a16z/Sequoia scouts, announced 29 January 2026; platform launched January 2026. Runs a companion services arm, MITO Films, for brands and agencies.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · writer · boards (storyboards/animations) — direct collision · editor / The Cutting Room · distribution deliverables (multi-format output) · workflow · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Institutional funding from Lightspeed and a public launch vs unfunded invite-only beta
- Genuinely collaborative — Cinamate is single-operator by design, which caps its addressable team
- Access to frontier hosted models
- Companion services arm gives it real production feedback loops
- Named investors and public launch coverage

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Very early — launched January 2026, preseed stage
- No production-management modules whatsoever
- No conform/EDL/OTIO, no professional delivery specs
- No budget, schedule, union rates, tax credits, clearance or finance tooling
- No local GPU option
- Unproven at feature length

<https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260129635715/en> · <https://mito.ai/> · <https://mito.ai/blog/step-by-step-create-your-first-cinematography/> · <https://mitofilms.ai/>

mStudio (mstudio.ai) mstudio.ai **DIRECT** **MEDIUM** **LIKELY**

A browser AI filmmaking pipeline that collapses script, storyboard, animatic, video generation and a multi-track timeline into one project with one canonical continuity representation.

mStudio consolidates the production pipeline into a single browser workspace: an AI script generator that turns loglines into structured screenplays, an AI storyboard generator producing shot-by-shot sequences with character consistency, an animatic maker that adds timing, voiceover and music, AI video generation converting storyboard frames to motion clips, and a multi-track timeline for editing and assembly of video, audio and effects layers. Its stated design principle — "one project, one timeline,

one canonical representation" so character and world details stay consistent from storyboard through export — is close to Cinamate's own architectural pitch. Targets indie films, commercial production and short-form.

KEY FEATURES · AI script generator: logline to structured screenplay · AI storyboard generator with character consistency · Animatic maker with timing, voiceover and music · Storyboard-frame-to-motion video generation · Multi-track timeline for video, audio and effects · Single canonical project state across stages

PRICING Plans start at \$27/month, with a 100% refund guarantee within 24 hours of purchase. Higher tiers not verified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Small; the operating entity behind mstudio.ai is not identified on its own content. No funding, team or user figures found. Content dated April 2026.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · writer · boards (storyboards/animations) — direct collision · editor / The Cutting Room (multi-track timeline) · music · timeline · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Publicly purchasable at \$27/mo with a refund guarantee — no invite gate
- Explicit animatic stage between storyboard and generation
- Same single-canonical-state architecture, delivered in-browser with no GPU requirement
- Lower commitment for a producer testing the category

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Zero production management — none of Cinamate's 20+ planning/finance/legal modules
- Self-describes output as "production-grade for social and pitch materials", not finished cinema
- No EDL/OTIO conform, no professional deliverables
- No cost reporting, budgeting, union rates or tax credits
- Opaque company — no identified entity, team or funding
- Cloud-only

<https://mstudio.ai/blog/ai-filmmaking/script-to-storyboard-to-film-ai-workflow> · <https://mstudio.ai/>

Promise (Promise Advanced Imagination, Inc.) — MUSE www.promise.film

ADJACENT

MEDIUM

LIKELY

An a16z- and Google-backed generative AI entertainment studio building MUSE, a proprietary platform spanning concept, script breakdown, budget visualization and post.

Promise is a Los Angeles studio integrating generative AI into film and TV production, co-founded by George Strompolos (ex-Fullscreen CEO), Jamie Byrne (early YouTube exec) and AI filmmaker Dave Clark. Its proprietary platform MUSE spans concept creation, script breakdowns, budget visualization and post-production workflows — a module footprint that maps unusually closely onto Cinamate's own. Promise is developing a multi-year slate and pairs traditional filmmakers with generative creators.

KEY FEATURES · MUSE proprietary development platform · Concept creation and script breakdown · Budget visualization · Post-production workflow integration · Google model integration via the AI Futures Fund partnership · Multi-year originals slate

PRICING Not disclosed. MUSE is internal studio tooling, not a commercially sold product as far as could be verified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Seed funding from Peter Chernin's North Road Company and Andreessen Horowitz; subsequent strategic investment and partnership with Google's AI Futures Fund joined by Michael Ovitz's Crossbeam Venture Partners, Kivu Ventures and Saga Ventures. Amounts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · boards · producer (script breakdown, budget) · finance / The Money Room (budget visualization) · post · Studio / Local Generation · workflow

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Tier-one backing: a16z, North Road, Google AI Futures Fund, Crossbeam
- Founders with real industry operating history and named public identities
- Google model access through partnership
- A production slate that gives MUSE real-world validation Cinamate lacks
- Hollywood relationships and press access

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- MUSE is internal tooling, not a product independent producers can buy — Cinamate's whole market is people Promise doesn't sell to
- No disclosed pricing, availability or feature depth
- No evidence of union-rate sourcing, tax-credit engine, clearance DB or deliverables
- No NLE or conform
- Studio economics mean it competes for projects, not for software seats

<https://variety.com/2024/digital/news/promise-gen-ai-studio-funding-peter-chernin-andreessen-horowitz-1236214333/> · <https://a16z.com/announcement/investing-in-promise/> · <https://www.ainhollywood.com/home/promise-studios> · <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/promise-advanced-imagination-inc-unveils-new-studio-built-for-the-generative-ai-era-to-produce-films-series-and-develop-innovative-new-formats-backed-by-investments-from-the-north-road-company-and-andreessen-horowitz-302309374.html>

Secret Level (Liquid Engine) www.secretlevel.co INDIRECT MEDIUM LIKELY

A premium AI-native entertainment studio with a hybrid horror feature in production and its own internal production platform, Liquid Engine, due in 2026.

Founded by Emmy-winning filmmaker Jason Zada, Secret Level creates original films, series, music projects and branded entertainment using AI-native and hybrid production workflows. It made Coca-Cola's viral "Holidays Are Coming" AI campaign and is producing its first feature, the hybrid horror film Terrarium, with producer Steven Schneider, financed by Artlist. It runs Secret Level Academy, a masterclass platform training Hollywood filmmakers and ad professionals in generative AI production, and is developing Liquid Engine, an internal AI-powered production platform targeted to launch in 2026.

KEY FEATURES · AI-native and hybrid production workflows · Liquid Engine internal production platform (2026 target) · Secret Level Academy professional training · Branded entertainment at Coca-Cola scale · Feature film Terrarium in production · Partnerships with Google, Intel, Black Eyed Peas

PRICING Not disclosed. Studio services and Academy courses; Liquid Engine pricing unannounced.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded by Jason Zada. Netflix and DreamWorks alum Christina Lee Storm joined to lead a new narrative studio. Terrarium financed by Artlist. No funding round disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation (Liquid Engine, once launched) · workflow · production · post · boards

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Named, credentialed leadership and real produced work (Coca-Cola, Terrarium)
- Blue-chip partnerships: Google, Intel
- Academy gives it a training/distribution flywheel and category authority
- Actual film financing in place
- Press coverage in Variety, THR, TheWrap — Cinamate's press declined

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Liquid Engine is unlaunched and unspecified as of this research — feature comparison is impossible
- Primarily a studio, not a software vendor; does not sell to independent producers
- No disclosed production-management or finance tooling
- No NLE, conform, tax-credit or clearance capability documented

<https://www.secretlevel.co/about> · <https://www.thewrap.com/industry-news/tech/ai-studio-secret-level-academy-classes-exclusive/> · <https://variety.com/2025/biz/news/christina-lee-storm-joins-secret-level-1236604542/> · <https://tvnewscheck.com/ai/article/secret-level-introduces-secret-level-academy-training-hollywood-for-the-ai-driven-production-era/>

Showrunner (Fable Studio) www.showrunner.xyz INDIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

The "Netflix of AI" — an Amazon-backed streaming platform where users generate and remix animated TV episodes from text prompts and a selfie.

Fable Studio's Showrunner writes, voices and animates episodes of the shows it carries. Users type a few words to create scenes or entire episodes, either from scratch or inside an existing story-world someone else created, and can insert themselves via a selfie. It launched after a closed alpha with 10,000 users and carries ~10 original shows including the Silicon Valley satire Exit Valley. Fable's proof point was nine AI-made South Park episodes that drew over 80 million views. It targets 2026 for its first movie, Everything Is Fine, as a fully playable experience.

KEY FEATURES · Text-prompt generation of scenes and full animated episodes · Selfie-based self-insertion into shows · Story-world remixing across a slate of ~10 originals · Creator revenue share · Playable/interactive film ambition · Animation-focused generative system

PRICING Initially free; subscription reported at \$10–\$40/month, with earlier statements of \$10–\$20/month for creator credits. Revenue share for original creators.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Fable Studio, San Francisco, Emmy-winning, led by Edward Saatchi. Amazon's Alexa Fund invested; amount undisclosed. 10,000-user closed alpha before launch. 80M+ views on its AI South Park episodes.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation (episodic rather than feature) · writer · screening · distribution deliverables (Showrunner is itself the distribution channel) · festivals (as an alternative release path)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Owns distribution — Cinamate makes films but has no audience-facing channel
- Amazon (Alexa Fund) on the cap table
- Demonstrated audience pull at 80M+ views
- Consumer price point of \$10–\$40/mo
- Creator revenue share creates a real economic loop

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Animation and episodic only — no live-action feature pipeline
- No production management of any kind
- No NLE, no conform, no deliverables specs
- Consumer/UGC positioning, not a professional producer tool
- Rights posture around remixing existing IP is contested
- Everything Is Fine feature is still forward-looking

<https://variety.com/2025/digital/news/netflix-of-ai-amazon-invests-fable-showrunner-launch-1236471989/> · <https://www.forbes.com/sites/charliefink/2025/07/30/amazon-backs-showrunners-ai-streaming-platform-as-it-launches-satirical-series-exit-valley/> · https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Fable_Studio · <https://www.engadget.com/ai/showrunner-an-ai-powered-streaming-service-launches-in-alpha-this-week-204042241.html>

Cinema AI Studio www.cinema-ai.studio **DIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

A director-led beta platform claiming full concept-to-export automation across screenwriting, virtual production, motion transfer, voice, editing, sound and color.

Cinema AI Studio pitches elimination of green screens, mocap suits and expensive VFX pipelines. Pre-production covers AI screenwriting (structure, dialogue, character arcs), storyboarding and previsualization. Production covers virtual production (scene replacement, environment compositing), motion transfer onto any character, and consistent character design. Post covers a Voice Studio (cloning, transformation, lip sync), natural-language AI video editing, sound design and music generation, cinematic color grading and image editing. It generates cinema-grade sequences from a single image or text prompt with multi-scene character and environment persistence. It also sells a full production-studio service in Los Angeles alongside the self-serve platform.

KEY FEATURES · AI screenwriting, storyboarding, previsualization · Virtual production: scene replacement and environment compositing · Motion transfer onto arbitrary characters · Voice Studio: cloning, transformation, lip sync · Natural-language AI video editing · Sound design, music generation, cinematic color grading · Multi-scene character and environment persistence · LA production-studio service arm

PRICING Not disclosed. Beta with early access; no published tiers.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded by/features director Philip Atwell (30+ years in Hollywood; directed War and major-artist music videos). Beta, version reported as v0.1.0. No funding, users or revenue disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · writer · boards · vfx · editor / The Cutting Room (natural-language editing, color) · music · post · casting (character design/persistence)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- A named, verifiable Hollywood director as founder — Cinamate has no public team at all
- Motion transfer and virtual-production capability Cinamate does not claim
- Attached LA production-services arm gives customers a human fallback
- Natural-language editing is a more modern interface than a browser NLE

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Very early beta (v0.1.0) with no pricing and no proof points
- Zero production management — no budget, schedule, contracts, clearance, tax credit, deliverables, festivals
- No EDL/OTIO conform or professional export specs
- No cost reporting or estimate calibration
- No local GPU / privacy story
- Claims are entirely self-asserted with no third-party validation

<https://www.cinema-ai.studio/> · <https://cinema-ai-studio-platform.vercel.app/>

Autodesk Flow Studio (formerly Wonder Studio / Wonder Dynamics)

www.autodesk.com/products/flow-studio/overview

ADJACENT

LOW

VERIFIED

Autodesk's cloud AI VFX platform — automated mocap, camera tracking and character animation, now with a Wonder 3D generative model and a free tier.

Flow Studio automates motion capture, camera tracking and character animation from ordinary footage, exporting mocap data, camera tracks, alpha masks, clean plates and character passes ready for Maya, Blender, Unreal and 3ds Max via USD. On 4 March 2026 Autodesk added Wonder 3D, a generative model providing Text-to-3D, Image-to-3D and Text-to-Image so artists can generate editable 3D assets and reuse them across projects — available to all users at every subscription level. Autodesk has also launched freemium access with new pricing tiers.

KEY FEATURES · Automated motion capture, camera tracking, character animation from footage · Exports mocap, camera tracks, alpha masks, clean plates, character passes · USD interchange with Maya, Blender, Unreal, 3ds Max · Wonder 3D: Text-to-3D, Image-to-3D, Text-to-Image (March 2026) · Freemium tier plus paid subscription levels

PRICING Freemium — a free tier launched alongside new paid subscription tiers; exact tier prices not verified in this research.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Owned by Autodesk (NASDAQ: ADSK) following the Wonder Dynamics acquisition. Enterprise distribution through Autodesk's existing M&E channel.

COLLIDES WITH · vfx — direct collision · Studio / Local Generation (Wonder 3D asset generation) · post · dailies (plate prep adjacency)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Autodesk ownership: enterprise sales, support, and integration into the Maya/3ds Max pipeline studios already run
- Deep DCC interoperability via USD — Cinamate has no native plugins at all
- Free tier plus formal subscription tiers
- Genuine VFX-grade outputs (clean plates, character passes) rather than end-to-end generation claims
- Corporate stability and certification posture Cinamate cannot approach

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not a script-to-film system — requires existing footage; no screenplay input
- No production management, budgeting, scheduling, clearance or delivery
- No NLE or timeline editing
- Cloud-based, so no local-GPU privacy story
- Narrow VFX scope vs Cinamate's 28 modules

<https://adsknews.autodesk.com/en/news/autodesk-flow-studio-launches-wonder-3d-gen-ai-model-to-help-creators-make-3d-characters-and-objects-faster-and-easier/> · <https://www.cgchannel.com/2026/03/autodesk-adds-generative-ai-capabilities-to-flow-studio/> · <https://investors.autodesk.com/news-releases/news-release-details/autodesk-launches-freemium-access-autodesk-flow-studio-new> · <https://help.wonderdynamics.com/release-notes/>

CinemAI (Bitoψ / f33.fr)

f33.fr/cinamai

ADJACENT

LOW

VERIFIED

An invitation-only French beta generating synopses, storyboards, scripts and film covers — the closest structural analogue to Cinamate's own private-beta posture.

CinemAI by Bitoψ generates cinema on demand: synopses, storyboards, scripts and film covers, letting writers, producers and studios prototype complete cinematic narratives from logline to storyboard in minutes rather than months. Access is through the F33.FR portal and is invitation-only during the current beta, with B2B/B2B2C/enterprise enquiries directed to Bitoψ. It has been demonstrated at the Cannes Film Festival. Bitoψ is an R&D studio also behind PlotGPT and StockGPT. It stops at development materials — no evidence of moving-image generation.

KEY FEATURES · Synopsis, script and storyboard generation from a logline · Film cover/key-art generation · Invitation-only beta via the F33.FR portal · Cannes Film Festival demonstrations · Sibling products PlotGPT and StockGPT · B2B / B2B2C / enterprise enquiry path

PRICING Not disclosed. Invitation-only beta; enterprise enquiries handled directly.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Built by Bitoψ, a French R&D studio. No funding, team size, user count or revenue disclosed. Beta stage.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · boards · investors (pitch/key-art materials) · projects · development stage of Cinamate's Development → Release chain

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Cannes demonstrations give it industry-facing visibility Cinamate lacks (Cinamate's press declined)
- Established R&D lineage with two prior shipped products
- European market position where Cinamate has no presence

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Development materials only — no video generation, no editor, no post, no delivery
- No production management at all
- Same weaknesses as Cinamate on transparency: invite-only, no pricing, no team disclosure
- Much narrower scope: 4-5 module equivalents vs Cinamate's 28
- No local generation, no cost modeling, no tax credits

<https://f33.fr/cinemai/> · <https://www.cinemai.f33.fr/cinemai/>

Cinetech (cinetech.ai) www.cinetech.ai ADJACENT LOW VERIFIED

A 2026-vintage AI film production platform covering script analysis, shot lists, scheduling, storyboards and collaboration — planning only, no generated footage.

Cinetech positions itself as a complete AI-powered film production platform with a script-to-screen workflow. It offers an AI production assistant combining language models with film-industry knowledge and direct access to project data; AI script breakdown for characters, locations and production elements; a shot list builder fed by breakdowns and storyboards; a smart scheduler that reasons about actor availability, location permits, weather and equipment rentals to produce schedules and call sheets; AI storyboarding including sketch-to-panel image recognition; and real-time collaborative workspaces. Notably it does not generate video — the site shows no motion output capability.

KEY FEATURES · AI production assistant with project-data awareness · AI script breakdown (characters, locations, elements) · Shot list builder linked to breakdowns and storyboards · Smart scheduler with permit, weather and equipment constraints; call sheets · AI storyboarding and sketch-to-panel image recognition · Real-time team collaboration and asset sharing

PRICING Solo Creator \$49/mo (500 bonus + 250 credits/mo @ \$0.02/credit, 100GB); Team \$149/mo for 5 (+\$25/member, 1TB pooled); Pay-as-you-go \$0.08/credit; Studio custom. [vendor-verified]

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded 2026 per site copyright. Very small; no funding, team, or customer disclosures. Presence limited to Instagram, Facebook, YouTube.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · boards · producer (breakdown, stripboard, scheduling, call sheets) · locations (permit-aware scheduling vs Cinamate's permit DB) · casting (availability constraints) · timeline · production · today · workflow · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Scheduler explicitly reasons over weather and equipment rentals alongside permits
- Openly marketed and accessible — no invite gate
- Real-time multi-user collaboration; Cinamate is single-operator
- No GPU requirement

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No generative video output at all — nothing against Studio/Local Generation
- No editor, no NLE, no conform, no deliverables
- No finance/cost reporting, PO tracking or estimate calibration
- No tax-credit engine, no union rate sourcing, no clearance, no sales/box-office modeling
- No pricing, no disclosed team, founded 2026 — even less proven than Cinamate
- No safety, wardrobe, props, sets, contracts or festivals modules

<https://www.cinetech.ai/> · <https://www.cinetech.ai/features> · <https://www.cinetech.ai/features/scheduler> · <https://www.cinetech.ai/features/ai-assistant>

Hedra www.hedra.com ADJACENT LOW VERIFIED

A character-first generative media platform whose Character-3 foundation model drives lip sync, facial performance and "AI actors."

Hedra launched in 2024 building high-speed, controllable video foundation models focused entirely on character-driven storytelling, calling its outputs AI "actors." Character-3 is its own foundation model handling lip sync, facial expression and

background motion. The platform has produced over 10 million videos and is pushing into enterprise marketing. It is a performance/character layer, not a film pipeline — no script parsing, planning, budgeting or editorial.

KEY FEATURES · Character-3 foundation model for lip sync, facial expression, background motion · AI "actor" performance generation · High-speed, controllable generation · 10M+ videos generated · Enterprise marketing focus

PRICING Credit-based subscription; exact 2026 tiers not verified in this research.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP \$32M Series A led by a16z Infrastructure (May 2025) with a16z speedrun, Abstract and Index Ventures; a16z pegged valuation at roughly \$200M. A prior \$10M seed. No 2026 round found — funding status may be stale as of August 2026.

COLLIDES WITH · casting (AI actors and performance) · Studio / Local Generation (character performance layer only) · post (ADR/lip sync adjacency) · music/voice

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Owns a purpose-built character foundation model; Cinamate owns no model
- Best-in-class lip sync and facial performance — the hardest problem in AI film and one Cinamate does not claim to solve
- \$42M+ raised and a16z backing
- 10M+ videos of production evidence

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Extremely narrow — solves one layer, not a film
- No script, planning, scheduling, budgeting, clearance or delivery capability
- No NLE or conform
- No feature-length output path
- Positioning has drifted toward enterprise marketing rather than cinema
- Funding news is over a year stale

<https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2025/05/15/3082196/0/en/Hedra-raises-32M-to-build-the-leading-generative-media-platform-for-digital-characters.html> · <https://techcrunch.com/2025/05/15/hedra-the-app-used-to-make-talking-baby-podcasts-raises-32m-from-a16z/> · <https://siliconangle.com/2025/05/15/ai-video-platform-hedra-raises-32m-build-digital-character-foundation-models/>

Abundantia Entertainment × invideo (aiON)

variety.com/2026/global/news/ai-film-studio-india-abundantia-entertainment-invideo-1236665369

INDIRECT

LOW

VERIFIED

India's first structured AI film studio — a ₹100 crore (~\$11M) commitment to five AI-driven features over three years.

Vikram Malhotra's Abundantia Entertainment partnered with invideo to launch an AI-driven film production studio, announced at the India AI Film Festival in New Delhi. The partnership combines Abundantia's creative and filmmaking ecosystem with invideo's generative video technology, supporting five AI-driven films over three years under Abundantia's AI storytelling division, aiON. aiON is already working on two titles — Chiranjeevi Hanuman and Jai Santoshi Mata: Sukh Sampatti Daata — while assembling a wider slate with filmmakers, writers and visual-tech experts.

KEY FEATURES · aiON: Abundantia's AI-powered storytelling division · invideo generative video technology as the production engine · Five AI-driven features over three years · Two mythological titles already in production · Announced at the India AI Film Festival

PRICING Not applicable — a studio venture, not a sold platform.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP ₹100 crore (~\$11M) committed, described as the largest structured commitment to AI-driven filmmaking in India to date. Abundantia is an established Indian production house led by Vikram Malhotra.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · production · finance (as a financing model rather than a tool) · distribution deliverables

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Real capital committed (\$11M) to actual features, with two already in production
- Established production-house distribution and talent relationships in a major market
- Validates the AI-feature thesis with money rather than claims
- Regional dominance in a market Cinamate has no presence in

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not a product — no software an independent producer can buy or license
- No production-management, finance, legal or delivery tooling exposed
- Success depends on invideo's model quality, which skews marketing-grade
- Geographically confined to India for now
- Competes for projects and financing, not for Cinamate's software users

<https://variety.com/2026/global/news/ai-film-studio-india-abundantia-entertainment-invideo-1236665369/> · <https://www.c2lmedia.net/news/abundantia-entertainment-invideo-make-11m-investment-in-ai-driven-filmmaking/> · <https://www.adgully.com/post/12350/abundantia-entertainment-invideo-announce-partnership-to-launch-ai-driven-film-studio>

Chronicle Studios startupintros.com/orgs/chronicle-studios

INDIRECT

LOW

UNCERTAIN

An AI-native entertainment studio partnering with creator-led communities to develop original IP across animation, film, TV and games using proprietary AI tooling.

Chronicle Studios is an AI-native entertainment studio that partners with creator-led communities to discover, develop and scale original IP across animation, film, TV and games, using proprietary AI tooling. It is a studio-plus-tooling model rather than a platform sold to producers. Note: the similarly named Storia AI, an earlier storyboarding/previsualization startup founded by Mihail Eric and Julia Turc that won the Madrona Venture Labs Launchable competition and raised ~\$500K, is listed as permanently closed on Crunchbase — a useful signal about the fragility of the thin-wrapper previsualization segment.

KEY FEATURES · Creator-community-led IP discovery and development · Proprietary AI tooling across animation, film, TV and games · Studio economics rather than SaaS

PRICING Not applicable — internal tooling; nothing sold to third parties as verified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP \$12.0M raised total. Investors include Patron, Adverb Ventures, Ardent Venture Partners, Human Capital, QED Investors, Sands Capital, Z Ventures and Ishan Sinha.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · projects · workflow · distribution deliverables

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- \$12M institutional backing vs unfunded
- Creator-community distribution channel Cinamate lacks
- Multi-format IP strategy across film, TV, animation and games

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not a product — nothing an independent producer can license or buy
- Tooling is undisclosed and unverifiable
- No production-management, finance, legal or delivery capability documented
- Minimal public detail; hard to substantiate anything beyond funding

<https://startupintros.com/orgs/chronicle-studios> · <https://www.crunchbase.com/organization/storia-ai> · <https://dot.la/storia-ai-movies-2659739181.html>

Netflix / InterPositive (Ben Affleck) about.netflix.com/en/news/why-interpositive-is-joining-netflix

INDIRECT

LOW

LIKELY

Netflix bought Ben Affleck's stealth AI post-production startup for an undisclosed sum — and will not sell the technology commercially.

InterPositive builds an AI model from an existing production's own dailies, then lets a filmmaker introduce that model into post-production to mix and color, relight shots and add visual effects. It explicitly does not produce generative AI video. Founded by Ben Affleck in 2022 and in stealth until acquisition, its 16-person team of engineers, researchers and creatives joined Netflix, with Affleck serving as a senior adviser. Netflix will offer the technology to its creative partners and has stated it has no plans to sell it commercially. Separately, Netflix spun up INKubator, a generative-AI animation studio led by ex-DreamWorks and A24 executive Serrena Iyer, in March 2026.

KEY FEATURES · Production-specific AI model trained on that production's own dailies · AI relighting, color, mix and VFX in post · Explicitly non-generative — works from real captured footage · 16-person team now inside Netflix · Available only to Netflix creative partners · Sibling initiative: Netflix INKubator generative-AI animation studio (March 2026)

PRICING Not for sale. Netflix has stated no plans to commercialize it.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Acquisition by Netflix confirmed (Netflix newsroom, 5 March 2026; Ben Affleck joins as Senior Advisor). Purchase price and team size NOT disclosed — a circulating '\$587M / 16-person team' figure is unsupported by any primary source.

COLLIDES WITH · dailies — direct collision, and InterPositive's approach (train on the production's own dailies) is more rigorous than anything Cinamate documents · post · vfx · editor / The Cutting Room (color balance) · tools (LUT preview)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Netflix-acquisition validation of dailies-trained, production-specific AI post — a category Cinamate touches only lightly
- Netflix's engineering, security and certification apparatus
- Works from real captured footage, sidestepping every generative-AI rights and quality objection
- Ben Affleck as senior adviser gives it filmmaker legitimacy

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not purchasable by anyone — locked to Netflix creative partners; zero addressable overlap with Cinamate's independent-producer market
- No script-to-screen generation
- No production management, budgeting, scheduling or delivery tooling
- Requires an existing shot production, so useless to a producer trying to make a film without one

⚠ Fact-check: deal real, dollar figure unverifiable.

<https://variety.com/2026/film/news/netflix-acquires-ben-affleck-ai-filmmaking-startup-interpositive-1236679498/> · <https://techcrunch.com/2026/07/19/netflix-paid-587m-for-ben-afflecks-ai-filmmaking-startup/> · <https://about.netflix.com/en/news/why-interpositive-is-joining-netflix> · <https://www.hollywoodreporter.com/business/business-news/netflix-price-ben-affleck-ai-company-revealed-1236651217/>

Nolia Studios

broadcastdialogue.com/bob-gaudette-and-kirk-hipkiss-launch-ai-native-nolia-studios-in-toronto **INDIRECT**

LOW

VERIFIED

A Toronto AI-native film and TV studio launched by a Runway AI Festival Grand Prix winner and a veteran producer, backed by an established VFX/animation shop.

Nolia Studios launched under filmmaker Bob Gaudette and veteran TV producer and creative director Kirk Hipkiss, positioned at the intersection of independent filmmaking, studio-grade production and next-gen creative technology. It is a slate-driven production company focused on original IP across film, television and emerging formats, with projects spanning short-form, feature and serialized content including *The Little Cloud Thief*, an animated property in development for both feature and episodic adaptation. Its launch follows Gaudette's short *A Face Only a Mother Could Love* winning the \$50,000 Grand Prix at the 2026 Runway AI Festival plus Best Picture at the OMNI International Film Festival, Best AI Film at the New York International Film Awards and the Blackwell Award at The Eudaimonia Project.

KEY FEATURES · Slate-driven original IP across short-form, feature and serialized formats · AI-native production workflows · Backed by Radical Point Media's animation, VFX, motion graphics and generative AI infrastructure · Delivering CG and AI work for Netflix, Warner Bros. Discovery and A+E Global Media

PRICING Not applicable — a studio, not a sold platform.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Launched 2026 in Toronto. Production infrastructure via Radical Point Media, already delivering for Netflix, Warner Bros. Discovery and A+E Global Media. Funding not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · production · post · vfx · festivals

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Festival validation — Runway AI Festival Grand Prix (\$50,000), Best Picture at OMNI, Best AI Film at NYIFA
- Named principals with real credits vs Cinamate's no public team
- Existing broadcaster relationships (Netflix, WBD, A+E) through Radical Point Media
- Proven delivery infrastructure

<https://broadcastdialogue.com/bob-gaudette-and-kirk-hipkiss-launch-ai-native-nolia-studios-in-toronto/> · <https://www.tvtechnology.com/production/virtual-production/ai-native-film-studio-launches-in-toronto> · <https://www.awn.com/news/bob-gaudette-and-kirk-hipkiss-launch-ai-film-and-tv-production-studio-nolia>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not a software product — sells nothing to independent producers
- No production-management, finance or legal tooling
- Brand new; no released slate yet
- Competes for projects and talent rather than for Cinamate's seats

Primordial Soup (Darren Aronofsky)

www.hollywoodreporter.com/business/business-news/darren-aronofsky-raising-money-ai-film-studio-1236654262

INDIRECT

LOW

LIKELY

Darren Aronofsky's AI film and content studio, raising \$15M via an SEC filing with roughly \$11M already sold.

Primordial Soup is an AI film and content studio launched by filmmaker Darren Aronofsky. Primordial Soup Labs, Inc. — listing Aronofsky and producing partner Dylan Golden as executive officers — filed with the SEC for a \$15 million equity raise, of which just over \$11 million had been sold at the time of reporting. It is an auteur-led production venture rather than a tooling vendor; it has worked in partnership with Google DeepMind on AI-assisted shorts.

KEY FEATURES · Auteur-led AI film and content studio · Aronofsky and Dylan Golden as executive officers · Google DeepMind collaboration on AI-assisted shorts (widely reported) · Slate development rather than software

PRICING Not applicable — a studio, not a sold platform.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP SEC filing for a \$15M equity raise; just over \$11M sold as reported in 2026.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · production · post

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- An A-list director's name and creative credibility — the single most valuable asset in this category's credibility war
- \$11M+ raised vs unfunded
- Direct model-lab relationships
- Press and festival access Cinamate is explicitly denied

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not a product; independent producers cannot buy or use it
- No production-management, finance, legal or delivery tooling
- Small raise relative to platform players
- Slate-driven risk — a single film's reception defines it

<https://www.hollywoodreporter.com/business/business-news/darren-aronofsky-raising-money-ai-film-studio-1236654262/>

Toonstar www.toonstar.com **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

An AI-powered animation studio founded by Disney and Warner Bros. veterans, shipping digital-first series with FOX, HarperCollins and WME behind it.

Toonstar is a technology-driven animation studio using AI to produce animated entertainment and build franchises, founded by Disney and Warner Bros. veterans John Attanasio and Luisa Huang. It is a leader in creator-led animation and launched a slate of new digital-first animated series starting in 2026. In 2026 it signed a strategic partnership with FOX Advertising (June 2026) to connect marketers with audiences through digital-first animation, and a multi-year deal with HarperCollins to adapt publisher titles into original YouTube series starting with the Friendship List books. It is signed with WME.

KEY FEATURES · AI-assisted animation production pipeline · Creator-led, digital-first series model · FOX Advertising partnership (June 2026) · HarperCollins multi-year IP adaptation deal · WME representation · Franchise-building focus

PRICING Not applicable — a studio, not a software product. No platform sold to third parties.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP ~\$4.19M raised per Crunchbase, with Superbrands, Founders Fund, GFR Fund, Joyance Partners and Manta Ray Ventures among seven investors. Founded by Disney/WB veterans. Slate launching 2026.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation (animation output rather than live-action) · production · post · distribution deliverables

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Real distribution partnerships: FOX, HarperCollins, WME, YouTube
- Named, credentialed founders from Disney and Warner Bros.
- Actual shipping series and an owned IP slate
- Institutional venture backing

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Animation only — no live-action script-to-screen
- Not a software vendor; sells nothing to independent producers
- No production-management, finance or legal tooling of any kind
- Modest funding relative to platform competitors
- Competes for audience attention rather than for Cinamate's users

<https://www.foxcorporation.com/news/corp-press-releases/2026/fox-advertising-and-toonstar-team-to-create-new-opportunities-for-brands-in-digital-first-animation/> · <https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/toonstar-harpercollins-animated-series-friendship-list-1236702618/> · <https://www.hollywoodreporter.com/business/business-news/ai-powered-animation-studio-toonstar-wme-exclusive-1236260904/> · <https://www.crunchbase.com/organization/toonstar>

ALSO COMPETING IN THIS CATEGORY (PROFILED ELSEWHERE)

Filmustage **ADJACENT** **MEDIUM** — The established AI pre-production incumbent — script breakdown, stripboard, scheduling and budgeting used by ADs and line producers, with an enterprise studio tier. *(full profile under “AI script breakdown & AI pre-production”)*

FinalBit (formerly NolanAI) **DIRECT** **MEDIUM** — An all-in-one AI pre-production workspace combining screenwriting, breakdown, budgeting, scheduling, pitch decks, storyboards and AI video generation. *(full profile under “Screenwriting & development tools (including AI coverage/analysis and script clearance/title research)”)*

Katalist **ADJACENT** **LOW** — A script-to-storyboard platform with strong character consistency and one-click character swapping, priced from \$19 to \$99/month plus enterprise. *(full profile under “Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept”)*

Runway **DIRECT** **CRITICAL** — The best-capitalized general-purpose generative video company, now pushing world models, a film production arm, and a fund that bankrolls AI-assisted films. *(full profile under “Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrastructure”)*

ScreenWeaver **ADJACENT** **LOW** — A free screenwriting-first platform that turns any screenplay into a full AI storyboard with camera plans and shot durations, then hands off to external video models. *(full profile under “Screenwriting & development tools (including AI coverage/analysis and script clearance/title research)”)*

§10 AI script breakdown & AI pre-production

Market read · This is the most price-transparent category Cinamate touches, and the most crowded. Four pricing archetypes are now stable: pay-per-script (\$19/script, Jungle's Breakdown Assistant), credit/coin metering (Filmustage coins, Cinetech \$0.02/credit, FinalBit AI-video credits), flat per-seat SaaS (\$49/user/mo Scriptflow and Cinetech Solo, \$45-265/mo Yamdu, \$49-340/mo StudioBinder), and per-production enterprise (SetKeeper \$1,500-\$5,000+ by budget band, Croogloo \$19-999/mo). Cinamate's ~\$110-per-feature (unverified figure) render quote is not out of line — but everything else about its go-to-market is. Leadership is split. Filmustage leads AI-native breakdown (45,000+ filmmakers, \$1.5M seed led by Raw Ventures/Geek Ventures Aug 2024, ~\$2.5M revenue on 19 people) and is the only player here that has closed the compliance gap: SOC 2 Type II plus TPN Blue Shield, with an explicit "we do not train on your data" pledge. Entertainment Partners still owns the file formats everyone must exit into (.mmsx/.sex, MMS 6 EOL mid-2026), and Movie Magic Scheduling (unverified ~\$29.99/mo third-party intro figure) undercuts nearly every AI challenger. Consolidation is real: Cast & Crew owns Final Draft, Backlight owns Celtx, EP owns Movie Magic + Scenechronize + SyncOnSet, NolanAI rebranded to FinalBit (Aug 2025), Cinelytic bought ScriptSense (Mar 2025). Two warnings. First, breakdown accuracy is commoditizing (~86% claims are now routine); differentiation has moved to downstream sync and to trust. Cinamate's lack of SOC 2/TPN is a category-level disqualifier here, not just a LightsKiddo gap. Second, this category's SEO listicles fabricate products — "SceneOne," "Final Draft Assist," and "Streak by Entertainment Partners" appear in ranked articles but exist on no vendor site and are absent from EP's own product index.

Filmustage filmustage.com **DIRECT** **CRITICAL** **VERIFIED**

The category-defining AI pre-production platform — script in, breakdown/schedule/budget out, with studio-grade security certifications.

Upload a screenplay and Filmustage's AI tags every scene for cast, props, wardrobe, VFX, locations and stunts, then generates a stripboard schedule, AI budget, call sheets, sides, storyboards and script analysis. An agentic layer branded "AI Dude" does semantic search, scheduling and chat-driven edits. It exports natively to Movie Magic Scheduling (MMSX for MMS10+, legacy .sex for MMS 5/6 and Gorilla) and Movie Magic Budgeting 10, and now re-imports .mmbx budgets for AI-assisted iteration. It is explicitly positioned as the cloud-native replacement for the Movie Magic desktop workflow.

KEY FEATURES · AI Smart Breakdown with claimed ~86% accuracy, results in ~1 minute · AI budgeting, plus .mmbx import/export round-trip with Movie Magic Budgeting · Stripboard scheduling, Day Out of Days, call sheets, script sides with QR codes · VFX breakdown, scene synopsis, scene analysis, AI storyboards · "AI Dude" production agent: semantic search, chat-driven scheduling edits · Coin-metered AI: 1,000 coins ≈ full breakdown of a 100-page script + AI budget + synopsis · Loyalty program adding up to +100% bonus coins after 30 months · Native export to Movie Magic Scheduling, Gorilla Scheduling and Final Draft

PRICING Free tier; paid plans culminating in Director's Cut at \$79/mo or \$660/yr (~30% annual saving), 1,700 coins/cycle. [vendor-verified]

SCALE & OWNERSHIP 45,000+ filmmakers claimed on the homepage, with 5.2M+ hours of manual work and \$178M+ in costs claimed saved. Raised \$1.5M seed announced Aug 2024, led by Raw Ventures (UK) with Geek Ventures (US); total raised reported as \$2.11M over 3 rounds from 7 investors (Tracxn) or ~\$3.1M by other trackers. Getlatka reports ~\$2.5M revenue on a 19-person team (self-reported, treat as indicative). SOC 2 Type II certified and a TPN member with Blue Shield status; publishes a trust center at trust.filmustage.com and states it does not use customer data to train neural networks.

COLLIDES WITH · writer — script import, analysis, synopsis and annotation · producer — AI budget, stripboard, Day Out of Days, call sheets · boards — AI storyboards and shot lists · timeline — shooting schedule generation and conflict handling · vfx — dedicated VFX breakdown module · The Money Room — AI budgeting with cost estimation directly competes with live cost reporting and self-calibrating estimates · workflow — the whole Development → Pre-Production spine

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- SOC 2 Type II certified AND TPN Blue Shield member — Cinamate has neither, and in this category that alone disqualifies it from studio and insurer-gated work
- Native round-trip with Movie Magic Scheduling and Budgeting (.mmsx/.sex/.mmbx); Cinamate's brief lists no industry file-format export at all
- 45,000+ users versus Cinamate's invite-only private beta with no disclosed user count
- Named institutional investors and a public funding record; Cinamate has no public team and press declined
- Explicit no-training-on-your-data policy published in a trust center
- Runs entirely in the browser with no local GPU requirement
- Published, self-serve pricing anyone can buy today

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Stops at pre-production — no editor, no dailies, no color, no deliverables; Cinamate's Cutting Room, dailies, post, distribution and festivals modules have no Filmustage equivalent
- No script-to-screen generation — cannot produce picture, only paperwork
- No release-side tooling; no festivals module, no distribution deliverables, no tax credit engine across 21 jurisdictions
- Coin metering makes heavy iteration cost-unpredictable, versus Cinamate's price-quoted-before-render model
- No sales/revenue forecasting comparable to Cinamate's 3,708-film model with disclosed 15.5% failure rate and P10-P90 bands
- Cloud-only — no local-GPU or air-gapped option for confidential material

△ Fact-check: an earlier draft cited \$55/mo for Director's Cut; the vendor page shows \$79/mo.

<https://filmustage.com/> · <https://filmustage.com/pricing/> · <https://help.filmustage.com/en/articles/4802061-export-a-project-to-movie-magic-scheduling-or-gorilla> · <https://filmustage.com/filmustage-as-an-alternative-to-movie-magic/>

Yamdu www.yamdu.com **ADJACENT** **HIGH** **VERIFIED**

European production-management platform with AI-assisted breakdown tagging, 12-language UI and real broadcaster customers.

Yamdu blends project management with pre-production tooling: script import, script breakdown, production scheduling, storyboards, PDF exports, call sheet builder, crew and cast management, time tracking and green-production reporting. Its AI layer suggests department tags on script import so coordinators confirm and refine rather than tagging from scratch. It ships an API, an accessibility conformance report, and a published "Use of AI" policy page — a level of institutional seriousness rare in this category.

KEY FEATURES · AI-assisted script breakdown suggesting department tags on import · Script import, production scheduling, storyboard, call sheet builder · Time tracking for film industry, green-production/sustainability reporting · Public API documentation · UI in 12 languages (EN, DE, ES, PT, FR, IT, PL, HU, NO, DA, FI, SV) · Dedicated education program for schools and universities · Accessibility conformance report and Data Processing Agreement published

PRICING Flex: \$45/month for 1 user and 1 project; additional users \$22/month each, additional projects \$45/month each. Core: \$265/month for up to 20 users with unlimited projects; annual billing saves the equivalent of four months. Signature: custom enterprise pricing. Entry pricing also quoted as €39/month on aggregators. 14-day free trial, no credit card required. Every plan includes script breakdown, script import, scheduling, storyboard, PDF exports and call sheet builder.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Named customer success stories include Constantin Film (a major German studio), Farpoint Films and the University of Melbourne. German/European origin with strong EU data-protection posture (DPA, imprint, privacy settings published). Funding, revenue and headcount not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · producer — breakdown, scheduling, call sheets · writer — script import and management · boards — storyboard module · timeline — production scheduling · tools — time tracking versus Cinamate's timecards · production — daily production coordination · projects and workflow — multi-project organizational layer

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Named, verifiable institutional customers including Constantin Film and University of Melbourne; Cinamate has no public references and press declined
- 12-language localization opens EU and LATAM markets Cinamate cannot address
- Published API, DPA, accessibility report and formal AI-use policy — the governance artifacts enterprise buyers ask for
- Strong education channel building the next generation of users
- Green-production reporting matches an EU regulatory demand Cinamate ignores entirely

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- AI is suggestion-only tagging — no AI budgeting, no generation, no agentic behavior
- Pre-production and production only: no editor, dailies, VFX, post, deliverables, festivals or tax credits
- Expensive at scale: Core at \$265/month versus Cinamate's single-operator model
- No SOC 2 or TPN certification found
- No sales forecasting or financial modeling comparable to Cinamate's claimed 3,708-film calibration
- Pricing not published on its own site — only recoverable via third parties, which is a trust weakness

<https://www.yamdu.com/en/pricing/> · <https://shade.inc/blog/yamdu-for-post-production> · <https://www.g2.com/products/yamdu/pricing> · <https://www.getapp.com/marketing-software/a/yamdu/>

Movie Magic Scheduling & Budgeting (Entertainment Partners) www.ep.com/movie-magic-scheduling

INDIRECT

HIGH

LIKELY

The thirty-year industry-standard desktop scheduling and budgeting pair whose file formats every competitor in this category must export into.

Movie Magic Scheduling imports a script, breaks it into scenes and elements, and produces stripboards, Day Out of Days, unit and multi-episode coordination, conflict detection and customizable boards and reports. Movie Magic Budgeting is the matching budget application. Major studios accept .mmsx as a delivery format, which makes this the gatekeeper of the category — Filmustage, Scriptflow, Jungle and others all define success as exporting cleanly into it. EP surrounds it with Scenechronize (script breakdowns, call sheets, safety memos, location maps, script comparison), SyncOnSet, AssetHub and SmartHub.

KEY FEATURES · Stripboard scheduling with drag-and-drop and split-screen views · Multi-episode management and multi-unit coordination · Conflict detection for cast/resource overlaps, on-screen DOOD · Customizable boards and reports · Direct integration with Movie Magic Budgeting · Scenechronize for breakdowns, call sheets, safety memos and script comparison · Studio-accepted .mmsx delivery format

PRICING EP publishes no price on the product page; store returned HTTP 503 during verification. Third-party introductory figures (~\$29.99/mo) are unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Entertainment Partners is the dominant entertainment payroll and production-finance company in North America, with adjacent products spanning payroll, residuals, SmartTime, SmartAccounting, EP Live, casting (EP Casting Portal, Central Casting) and production incentives. Movie Magic Scheduling 6 will no longer be sold or supported from mid-2026; Movie Magic Scheduling 10 is current. Revenue and ownership specifics not disclosed on the pages reached.

COLLIDES WITH · producer — stripboard, budget, call sheets is precisely EP's core · timeline — scheduling and DOOD · finance — Movie Magic Budgeting versus Cinamate's finance room · The Money Room — EP's payroll and accounting stack (SmartAccounting, SmartPO, SmartTime) is the incumbent for live cost reporting and PO tracking · production — Scenechronize covers call sheets, safety memos and location maps, overlapping Cinamate's production, safety and locations rooms

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Owns the file formats and the studio delivery standard — Cinamate's brief names no .mmsx/.fdx/.mmbx export path at all
- Thirty-plus years of trust with studios, completion bond companies and insurers
- Cheaper than most AI challengers: \$29.99/mo intro undercuts Filmustage, Scriptflow and Cinetech
- Integrated with real payroll, union reporting and production accounting infrastructure
- Enormous installed base of trained 1st ADs and line producers — no retraining cost

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No AI features found anywhere on EP's own Movie Magic pages — the "AI roadmap" is not substantiated by any EP-published material I could locate
- Desktop-first, per-seat, poor for single-operator end-to-end work
- Nothing downstream of the schedule: no editorial, no dailies, no deliverables, no festivals, no tax-credit engine
- Fragmented across many SKUs (MMS + MMB + Scenechronize + SyncOnSet) where Cinamate offers 28 modules under one roof
- MMS 6 end-of-life mid-2026 forces a paid migration, creating a rare switching window challengers are actively targeting

△ Fact-check: earlier 'verified on EP Store' label was not supportable.

Breakdown Assistant AI (Jungle Software / Gorilla) breakdownassistant.junglesoftware.com DIRECT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

Pay-per-script AI breakdown that hands you a tagged .fdx or .sex file and gets out of the way — \$19 a script, no subscription.

Upload a Final Draft .fdx or PDF screenplay up to 150 pages; the AI reads every scene and tags cast, props, wardrobe, vehicles, set dressing and more, scene by scene, with every tag reviewable and editable. Then export a tagged .fdx or .sex file plus PDF summary or CSV and import it straight into Movie Magic Scheduling, Final Draft or Gorilla Scheduling. It is deliberately a first-pass tool that feeds the software producers already own rather than trying to replace it — the exact opposite of Cinamate's replace-everything thesis, and a much easier sale. Built by Jungle Software, makers of Gorilla Scheduling and Budgeting since 2002.

KEY FEATURES · AI tags cast, props, set dressing, wardrobe, vehicles and more, scene by scene · Accepts Final Draft .fdx or PDF, up to 150 pages · Exports tagged .fdx and .sex plus PDF summary and CSV · Imports directly into Movie Magic Scheduling, Final Draft or Gorilla Scheduling · Every AI tag reviewable and editable before export · First 10 scenes free, no credit card, download included · Scripts auto-deleted after 30 days; user can delete sooner · Standalone — does not require Gorilla Scheduling

PRICING Breakdown Assistant AI Web: \$19 for 1 breakdown; \$45 for 3 breakdowns (\$15 each); \$120 for 10 breakdowns (\$12 each). One credit = one full breakdown of a script up to 150 pages. First 10 scenes free with downloadable output, no credit card. Sold separately from Gorilla. Gorilla Combo Pack (Scheduling + Budgeting): \$30/month plus \$49 setup, \$90/quarter plus \$29 setup, or \$360/year with no setup fee. Gorilla Scheduling or Budgeting individually: \$20/month plus \$49 setup, \$60/quarter plus \$29 setup, or \$240/year.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Jungle Software has served film production since 2002 and Gorilla is a recognized name in independent scheduling and budgeting, with .sex export support built into competitors like Filmustage. Academic pricing offered. Revenue, headcount and user counts not disclosed. Publishes a 5-minute product demo video.

COLLIDES WITH · writer — script ingestion and parsing · producer — the breakdown itself, the single most-used artifact in Cinamate's producer room · timeline — feeds stripboard scheduling downstream · wardrobe, props, sets — tags exactly these element categories

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- \$19 per script destroys the economics of any subscription for a producer doing one or two features a year — and Cinamate's ~\$110/feature render only covers generation, not the breakdown
- Exports the two formats that actually matter (.fdx, .sex) — Cinamate's brief names neither
- Explicit, published data policy: scripts auto-deleted after 30 days, user-deletable on demand. Cinamate has no stated retention policy and no certifications
- Zero switching cost — producers keep working in the tools they already own and trained on
- Free trial requires no credit card and still lets you download the output
- 24-year-old company with a real trading history behind it

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Single-purpose — no scheduling, budgeting, call sheets or anything else in the AI product itself
- Gorilla proper is dated desktop software with setup fees, a pricing pattern that signals legacy
- 150-page cap excludes long-form and some episodic bundles
- No SOC 2 or TPN certification
- No generation, no financial modeling, no release-side tooling
- No collaboration layer — genuinely single-user

<https://breakdownassistant.junglesoftware.com/> · <https://www.junglesoftware.com/pricing> · <https://junglesoftware.com/subscription-pricing/> · <https://junglesoftware.com/gorilla-scheduling/>

InteScene www.intescene.com DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Sterling-priced all-in-one platform undercutting the whole category — AI breakdown, storyboards, budget, schedule and casting from £10/month.

InteScene integrates screenwriting, AI breakdowns, scheduling, budgeting and crew management into one workspace, with details entered once flowing automatically across departments. Its AI does automated script breakdowns identifying characters,

props, VFX and wardrobe, scene-by-scene analysis with dialogue and pacing insights, AI storyboard sketching from scene descriptions, and smart scheduling for location and talent efficiency. The module list is unusually broad for the price: script editor, stripboard, budget on a film/TV chart of accounts, call sheets and daily dispatch, storyboarding, casting director tools, location management, crew check-in and continuity, catering and logistics, equipment and document management.

KEY FEATURES · AI script breakdown for characters, props, VFX and wardrobe · AI scene analysis with dialogue and pacing insights · AI storyboard sketching from scene descriptions · Smart scheduling for location and talent efficiency · Budget tracking on a film/TV chart of accounts · Drag-and-drop stripboard, call sheets and daily dispatch · Casting director tools, location management, crew check-in and continuity · Catering, logistics, equipment and document management

PRICING Free: £0/month, 1 project, basic features. Indie: £10/month, 3 projects, 2 collaborators. Production: £17/month, 20 projects, 5 collaborators (marked most popular). Studio: £21/month, unlimited projects, 10 collaborators. Annual billing saves up to 17%. All paid plans include a 14-day free trial.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Small and opaque. Self-described as "made by filmmakers, for filmmakers." No company registration, headquarters, team, funding, customer list or user count disclosed. GBP pricing suggests a UK base but this is inference, not verified.

COLLIDES WITH · writer — script editor with industry formatting · producer — breakdown, stripboard, budget on chart of accounts, call sheets · boards — AI storyboarding · timeline — smart scheduling · casting — casting director tools · locations — location management · wardrobe, props, sets — element categories tagged · production and today — crew check-in, continuity, daily dispatch · vfx — VFX element identification

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- £21/month for unlimited projects and 10 collaborators is aggressive enough to reframe what buyers think this tooling should cost
- Genuinely broad module coverage across pre-production and production at indie price points
- Multi-collaborator from the entry tier, where Cinamate is single-operator by design
- Free tier and 14-day trials remove all friction; Cinamate requires an invite
- No GPU requirement

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Zero verifiable company information — no team, no address, no funding, no customers. Same credibility profile Cinamate has, and therefore no help to Cinamate competitively
- No editor, dailies, post, deliverables, festivals, tax credits or music modules
- No SOC 2, TPN or any security posture disclosed
- No AI generation of picture
- No industry file-format export documented
- Price this low against this feature breadth invites questions about depth and durability

<https://www.intescene.com/>

Scriptflow scriptflow.com DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Focused AI breakdown-and-stripboard copilot that exports to every incumbent format — the purest head-to-head with Cinamate's producer room.

Scriptflow positions itself as "your AI copilot to breakdown scripts and create shooting schedules faster and more accurately than ever before." It auto-tags cast, props, stunts and other elements, tracks script revisions by highlighting changes to scenes and elements, generates loglines, synopses and character breakdowns with personality traits and emotional arcs, then drives a full drag-and-drop stripboard with version control, multi-episode support, strip splitting, automated and manual day breaks and scheduling conflict detection.

KEY FEATURES · AI element tagging (cast, props, stunts and more) · Script revision tracking that highlights changed scenes and elements · AI loglines, synopses and character breakdowns with arcs and traits · Drag-and-drop stripboard, strip splitting, automated and manual day breaks · Scheduling conflict detection with flagging · Version control and collaborative workspaces, multi-episode support · PDF reports: Day Out of Days, shooting schedules, breakdown sheets · Exports to Excel, Movie Magic, Final Draft and Gorilla formats · Unlimited free view-only users

PRICING Free: 1 standard user, up to 2 script uploads, unlimited free view-only collaborators. Pro: \$49/user/month, 25 script uploads per month, unlimited free view-only users. Seat changes are immediate and prorated. No refunds; cancel anytime with access through the billing period. Payments via Stripe. No annual discount advertised.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Small and young — copyright 2026, no funding, team, customer or user-count disclosure found anywhere on the site. Uses Clerk for authentication, and cites Clerk's SOC 2 Type II and CCPA compliance plus MFA and session management; note this is the auth vendor's certification, not Scriptflow's own.

COLLIDES WITH · producer — stripboard, Day Out of Days, breakdown sheets, day breaks · writer — loglines, synopses, character breakdowns · timeline — scheduling with conflict detection and multi-episode support · casting — character breakdowns with traits and arcs · workflow — script revision tracking across drafts

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Exports to Movie Magic, Final Draft, Gorilla and Excel — the interoperability Cinamate's brief entirely lacks
- Script revision tracking that diffs scenes and elements across drafts, which matters enormously in episodic work
- Unlimited free view-only users makes it viable for real crews without per-head cost
- Available to buy today at a published price; no invite required
- Multi-episode support out of the box

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Extremely narrow — breakdown and scheduling only; no budget, no editorial, no post, no release-side tooling
- No SOC 2 or TPN of its own; borrows its auth vendor's compliance, which is not the same thing
- \$49/user/month is expensive for a single-function tool and scales badly against Cinamate's 28 modules
- Upload-capped at 25 scripts/month even on Pro
- No verifiable company, team, funding or customer information at all — same credibility problem Cinamate has
- No generation, no budgeting, no financial modeling

<https://scriptflow.com/> · <https://scriptflow.com/pricing>

Studiovity studiovity.com DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

India-built AI pre-production suite priced for emerging markets — script breakdown from roughly \$3/month.

Studiovity is an AI-powered script breakdown platform that analyzes screenplays, identifies production elements and creates structured, production-ready breakdowns for film, TV and OTT, wrapped in a wider suite: AI screenwriting, AI AV script, AI shot list, AI storyboard, AI script breakdown, "AI Logic," AI teleprompter, production calendar, task and team manager, scheduling and call sheets. It automatically syncs script breakdown, schedule and financial ledger into a single window. Available on iOS, Android and web — one of very few in this category with real mobile apps.

KEY FEATURES · AI script breakdown identifying characters, props, locations, scenes · AI screenwriting and AI AV script tools · AI shot list, AI storyboard and AI teleprompter · Breakdown, schedule and financial ledger synced in one window · Film budgeting with multi-currency support · Production calendar, task and team manager, call sheets · iOS, Android and web apps · Education and partner programs

PRICING Highly fragmented by product. Script breakdown: \$3/month per single user, \$15 semi-annual per single user, \$24/year full license for 2 team members. Pre-production: \$24/user/month or \$18/user/year (GetApp). Screenwriting: from \$2/month. Film budgeting: from \$36/month. Free version and free trial available. The wide spread across aggregators suggests frequent repricing — treat individual figures as approximate.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Studiovity Pvt Ltd, India ("Made with love in India"), contact info@studiovity.com, +91 phone number. Runs a very heavy content marketing operation. Serves freelancers, startups, SMBs, mid-market and enterprise per aggregator listings. Funding, revenue and user counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · writer — AI screenwriting and AV script · producer — breakdown, budgeting, call sheets, scheduling · boards — AI storyboard and shot list · timeline — production calendar and scheduling · finance — financial ledger synced to breakdown and schedule · tools — teleprompter and on-set utilities · projects and workflow — task and team manager

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Radically cheaper — \$3/month for AI script breakdown reframes the category's price floor
- Real iOS and Android apps; Cinamate's brief explicitly lists no mobile or on-set app as a known gap
- Named legal entity with a registered company, address and contact details — more transparency than Cinamate offers
- Multi-currency budgeting suited to international co-productions
- Education and partner programs building distribution

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Confusing product fragmentation — five separately listed SKUs with inconsistent pricing across aggregators
- No editor, dailies, VFX, post, deliverables, festivals or tax-credit modules
- No AI generation of picture
- No SOC 2 or TPN certification found
- No evidence of adoption at studio scale or by named productions
- At \$3/month the depth of AI behind the breakdown is unlikely to match Filmstage or Cinamate's claimed rigor

<https://studiovity.com/> · <https://studiovity.com/pricing/> · <https://studiovity.com/script-breakdown-software/> · <https://www.softwaresuggest.com/studiovity-ai-script-breakdown>

Dramatify dramatify.com ADJACENT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Stockholm-based production platform with a shipped AI Script Breakdown built for episodic, multi-camera, live and unscripted formats the drama-shaped tools handle badly.

Dramatify launched AI Script Breakdown in June 2025 as its third AI feature, after AI Show Developer and AI Rundown Assistant. The engine scans a script and identifies cast, characters, props, locations, wardrobe, makeup, vehicles, animals, stunts and special effects, matching detections to Dramatify's pre-built categories to produce structured, production-ready reports. It additionally suggests a per-scene synopsis, location description and stunt descriptions where present in the text, and offers Strict Mode (extract only what is expressly in the text) versus a creative mode. Crucially it works across drama scripts, AV scripts, rundowns and episodes — Dramatify's stated position is that legacy tools were built for single-camera drama and break on episodic TV, multi-camera and fast-paced unscripted content.

KEY FEATURES · AI Script Breakdown with Strict Mode and creative mode · Works across drama scripts, AV scripts, rundowns and episodes · AI Show Developer and AI Rundown Assistant · Per-scene synopsis, location description and stunt description suggestions · Live broadcast and rundown suite for sports and entertainment · Semi-automatic call sheets and Daily Production Reports · Integrated budgeting, production planner, daily production schedules · Free read-only access for all cast and crew

PRICING Five plans, per-seat, annual billing: Fiction Starter \$10/seat/month, minimum 3 seats (from \$30/month); Fiction Standard \$13/seat/month, minimum 5 seats (from \$65/month); Non-Fiction Starter \$22/seat/month, minimum 3 seats (from \$66/month); Professional \$27/seat/month, minimum 5 seats (from \$135/month); Enterprise custom, unlimited seats. Monthly billing runs 25-33% higher than annual. 30-day free trial, no credit card required. Cast and crew get free read-only access.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Based in Stockholm, Sweden. Publishes case material on broadcasters using Dramatify for FIFA World Cup 2026 coverage across the US, Mexico and Canada, plus reality, talent-show and daily children's television workflows. Serves broadcasters and production companies rather than indie features. Funding, revenue and headcount not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · writer — script and AV script handling · producer — breakdown, call sheets, Daily Production Reports, budgeting · timeline — daily production schedules and production planner · production — the daily on-shoot coordination layer · wardrobe, props, sets, safety — element categories tagged directly · casting — cast and character management

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Genuinely strong in episodic, multi-camera, live and unscripted — formats Cinamate's single-operator feature-film model does not address at all
- Named large-scale deployment context (FIFA World Cup 2026 broadcast operations) versus Cinamate's zero public references
- Strict vs creative AI modes give producers explicit control over hallucination risk — a sophistication Cinamate's brief does not claim
- Free read-only seats for cast and crew makes crew-wide rollout costless
- Cheapest fiction entry at \$10/seat/month annual
- EU-based with the data-protection posture that implies

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Seat minimums (3-5) make it unusable for the single operator Cinamate targets
- No editor, dailies, VFX, post, deliverables, festivals or tax-credit modules
- No AI generation of picture or sound
- No SOC 2 or TPN certification found
- Pricing page structure is confusing and the /pricing URL 404s, which hurts self-serve conversion
- No sales forecasting or waterfall modeling

<https://dramatify.com/ai-script-breakdown> · <https://dramatify.com/subscription-plans> · <https://dramatify.com/exciting-news-dramatify-introduces-new-pricing-and-subscription-plans> · <https://se.linkedin.com/company/dramatify>

Scriptation scriptation.com ADJACENT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Emmy-winning paperless script app that owns the on-set annotation workflow — the exact device-side territory Cinamate concedes.

Scriptation is the industry-standard script annotation and breakdown app for iPad, iPhone and Mac, used by directors, cinematographers, producers and writers on shows including The Walking Dead and Bridgerton. Its proprietary Note Transfer technology moves annotations, shot lists, diagrams, photos and facing pages between script revisions in seconds — the single hardest problem in on-set script work. Industry Pro adds breakdown tagging and reports, multi-layer transfer, page collation, script comparison and collaboration. Info Layers add 1/8 page counts, dialogue numbers, revision colors, large scene numbers and scene dividers. It runs a separate AI product at ai.scriptation.com and a separate AI Voices subscription.

KEY FEATURES · Note Transfer: annotations move between script revisions automatically · Breakdown tagging and exportable reports (Industry Pro) · Info Layers: 1/8 page counts, dialogue numbers, revision colors, scene dividers · Live Layers for real-time collaboration · Cloud integration with iCloud, Dropbox and Google Drive · Script comparison and page collation · AI Voices as a separate subscription with a 3-day trial, 30 free minutes and five usage tiers · Native iPad, iPhone and Mac apps

PRICING Free Core Features tier. Industry Pro: \$99.99/year (displays as \$8.33/month), with a two-week free trial of all Pro features. Team plans are per-device and volume-tiered on annual billing: \$16.99/device/month (\$202.80/device/year, \$2,028 total), \$14.99/device/month (\$179.40/device/year, \$3,588 total) and \$12.49/device/month (\$149.70/device/year, \$5,988 total); a 10-device team tier is listed at \$169. Savings advertised up to 40%, with per-tier savings of \$80, \$360, \$960 and \$2,160/year. AI Voices billed separately. Enterprise/studio pricing on request.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Recipient of an Engineering Emmy. Named productions include The Walking Dead and Bridgerton. Distributed via the Apple App Store with regional pricing. Funding, revenue and user counts not disclosed. Pricing page last modified July 2026.

COLLIDES WITH · writer — script annotation, revision comparison, drafts · producer — breakdown tagging and reports · today — on-set daily script work, the module Cinamate has no device story for · tools — slate/timecard-adjacent on-set utilities · dailies — facing pages and on-set notes flow into dailies review

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- An Engineering Emmy and named credits on Bridgerton and The Walking Dead — the professional validation Cinamate entirely lacks
- Owns the on-set iPad workflow, which Cinamate's brief lists as a known gap (no mobile/on-set app)
- Note Transfer between revisions is a genuinely hard, genuinely valuable capability nothing in Cinamate matches
- \$99.99/year is trivially approvable on any production
- Works offline on device — better for confidential material than any cloud tool
- Volume team licensing already built for crew-wide rollout

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not a breakdown-to-schedule engine — no stripboard, no budget, no scheduling
- Breakdown tagging is manual, not AI; the AI product is separate and appears focused on voices
- Apple-only — no Windows, no Android, limited web
- Nothing downstream: no editorial, post, deliverables, festivals or tax credits
- Team pricing is opaque and per-device rather than per-user, which crews find awkward
- No AI generation, budgeting or financial modeling

<https://scriptation.com/> · <https://scriptation.com/pricing/> · <https://help.scriptation.com/en/article/what-is-the-pricing-cost-for-scriptation-is-there-a-free-trial-lqp7p8/> · <https://help.scriptation.com/en/article/what-is-scriptation-industry-pro-ljfjcg/>

Final Draft 13 (Cast & Crew) www.finaldraft.com INDIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

The screenwriting standard whose .fdx format is the universal input to every breakdown tool in this category — with AI confined to story development, not breakdown.

Final Draft is the industry-standard screenwriting application, auto-formatting scripts to entertainment industry standards. Final Draft 13 added Beat Board AI (analyzes the beat board to suggest structural improvements and missing beats) and Script Notes AI (generates contextual development notes on pacing, structure and character arcs), plus Navigator 2.0, productivity tracking and real-time co-writing with file sync across Mac and Windows. Final Draft Tagger is a companion utility for tagging characters, props, wardrobe, locations, set dressing and vehicles across scenes and exporting breakdown reports — but it is manual tagging, not AI. Owned by Cast & Crew Entertainment Services since 2016.

KEY FEATURES · Industry-standard auto-formatting; .fdx is the universal script interchange format · Beat Board AI for structural suggestions and missing story beats · Script Notes AI for pacing, structure and character-arc development notes · Final Draft Tagger for manual element tagging and breakdown reports · Navigator 2.0, Outline Editor, Structure Lines, productivity tracking · Real-time co-writing with file sync across Mac and Windows · Final Draft Go companion iOS app sold separately

PRICING Final Draft 13: \$249.99 list, \$199.99 typical selling price — a perpetual license, not a subscription. Install on unlimited computers, signed in on two at once. A Suite Subscription is also offered. Final Draft Go is a separate iOS App Store purchase. Not available on Chromebook; requires Windows 11+ or macOS 12 Monterey+.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP The dominant screenwriting application in Hollywood for over three decades. Acquired by Cast & Crew Entertainment Services in 2016, placing it inside one of the two large entertainment payroll groups (alongside Entertainment Partners). Revenue and unit sales not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · writer — this is the direct competitor to Cinamate's writer room, and the incumbent every screenwriter already owns · boards — Beat Board and Outline Editor versus Cinamate's boards room · producer — Tagger produces the breakdown reports Cinamate's producer room generates

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Owns .fdx, the format every other tool in this category ingests — structural control of the category's front door
- Perpetual license at \$199.99 versus recurring subscriptions; a one-time cost producers have already sunk
- Three decades of trust; scripts are delivered in Final Draft by contractual convention
- Cast & Crew ownership gives it payroll-ecosystem adjacency and enterprise durability
- Works offline with no cloud dependency and no GPU

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- AI is creative-development only — Beat Board AI and Script Notes AI do not do production breakdown
- Tagger is manual tagging and widely considered dated
- No scheduling, budgeting, call sheets or anything downstream
- Desktop-only, Mac/Windows, no Chromebook, mobile sold separately
- The claimed "Final Draft Assist" AI breakdown feature appears on SEO blogs but on no Final Draft page I could find — treat as unsubstantiated
- No collaboration at production scale, no financial modeling, no release-side tooling

<https://www.finaldraft.com/products/final-draft-13> · <https://store.finaldraft.com/> · <https://www.finaldraft.com/products/features/> · [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Final_Draft_\(software\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Final_Draft_(software))

Cinemata cinemata.ru DIRECT LOW VERIFIED

Russian-domain AI screenwriting-and-breakdown platform with no disclosed pricing, team or company — the closest structural mirror of Cinamate's own credibility problem.

Cinemata describes itself as "an AI-powered platform that covers the full screenwriting and pre-production pipeline" — write, break down, visualize and produce. Users create a screenplay in a built-in editor or upload PDF, DOCX or TXT; the platform parses every scene, character, location and prop and returns a full breakdown in under a minute, then generates storyboards and exports professional breakdown sheets. Beyond breakdown it offers AI-assisted formatting, rewriting and runtime estimation, a comic mode, a node-based visual pipeline per scene, character heatmaps, relationship graphs, AI pitching, cast management and production feasibility scoring.

KEY FEATURES · AI script breakdown: scenes, characters, locations, props in under 1 minute · AI-assisted screenplay formatting, rewriting and runtime estimation · AI-generated storyboards, comic mode, node-based visual pipeline per scene · Script bible with character heatmaps and relationship graphs · AI pitching and cast management · Production feasibility scoring · Accepts PDF, DOCX, TXT; exports professional breakdown sheets

PRICING Not disclosed. There is no pricing page — cinemata.ru/pricing returns 404. No free tier, trial terms, seat model or credit system is published anywhere on the site. Sign-in is required before anything is visible.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Essentially unverifiable. The site carries only "© MMXXVI Production Intelligence" with no company name, registration, jurisdiction, team, address, funding, customer list or user count. Hosted on a .ru domain. The entire public site is a single marketing page plus a sign-in wall. Marketing copy claims "deterministic precision" in parsing, which is an unusual and unsubstantiated claim for an LLM-based system.

COLLIDES WITH · writer — AI screenwriting with formatting, rewriting and runtime estimation · producer — breakdown sheets and production feasibility scoring · boards — AI storyboards, comic mode and node-based visual pipeline · casting — cast management, character heatmaps, relationship graphs · investors — AI pitching maps onto Cinamate's investors room · timeline — runtime estimation and scope analysis

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Publicly accessible with open sign-up rather than invite-only — a lower barrier to trial
- Node-based visual pipeline and comic mode are genuinely differentiated storyboard interfaces
- Relationship graphs and character heatmaps are analytical features Cinamate's brief does not claim
- Runs on a real domain rather than a netlify.app subdomain

<https://cinemata.ru/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No pricing published at all — the one thing this entire category does publish, making it less transparent than every peer
- No company identity, team, jurisdiction, funding or customers disclosed — shares and arguably exceeds Cinamate's own credibility gap
- No SOC 2, TPN, security posture or data policy of any kind
- No scheduling, budgeting, call sheets, editorial, post, deliverables, festivals or tax credits
- No AI generation of picture; storyboards only
- "Deterministic precision" is an unsubstantiated and technically dubious claim
- A .ru domain is a hard commercial blocker for US and EU studio work regardless of product quality

Storyflow storyflow.so ADJACENT LOW VERIFIED

AI creative canvas holding storyboard, script, mood board, character cards and beats in one context — cheap, and aimed squarely at Cinamate's boards room.

Storyflow holds the storyboard alongside the script, mood board, character cards and structural beats on a single canvas where the AI reads everything as shared context, rather than generating frames in isolation. It drafts shot lists from a script with AI, then lets you drag shot cards from story order into setup order without retyping. It ships 200 creative templates including Hero's Journey, AIDA, StoryBrand and Five-Act Structure. It also runs an aggressive comparison-content operation that ranks the whole category, which is how many buyers first encounter these tools.

KEY FEATURES · Unified canvas: storyboard, script, mood board, character cards and beats as shared AI context · AI shot list drafting from script, reorderable from story order to setup order · AI image generation for boards · 200 creative structure templates (Hero's Journey, AIDA, StoryBrand, Five-Act) · Free collaboration — anyone invited to a board by a paid member joins at no cost · Team workspace at the top tier

PRICING Currently paid-only during early access; the Free plan is stated to launch before the end of 2026 (anyone invited to a board by a paid member can already join free). Plus: \$9.99/month, or \$7.99/month billed annually. Pro: \$19/month, or \$14/month billed annually — adds AI image generation and 20x more AI usage. Max: \$49/month, or \$39/month billed annually — 40x more AI usage, image generation and team workspace.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Early access, launched recently, no funding, team, customer or user-count disclosure found. Its market presence is largely built through a very large volume of comparison and 'best of 2026' content covering the whole pre-production category.

COLLIDES WITH · boards — direct competitor to Cinamate's storyboards and animatics room · writer — script held on the same canvas with structural beats · tools — shot list construction · timeline — beat and structure planning feeding scene order

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Shared-context canvas is a genuinely better storyboard interaction model than isolated frame generation
- \$7.99/month annual makes it an impulse purchase; Cinamate cannot be purchased at all
- Free collaboration for invited viewers spreads it through crews at zero cost
- 200 structure templates give writers a real head start
- Dominant SEO position in this category means it shapes how buyers frame their shortlist

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Boards and story development only — no breakdown-to-schedule, no budget, no call sheets
- No production, post, deliverables, festivals or tax-credit tooling
- Free plan still unlaunched; the whole product is early access
- No SOC 2, TPN or security posture disclosed
- No company, team or funding information
- AI usage is tier-metered in vague multiples (20x, 40x) rather than legible units

<https://storyflow.so/pricing> · <https://storyflow.so/blog/best-ai-storyboarding-tools-2026> · <https://storyflow.so/blog/best-shot-list-tools-2026> · <https://storyflow.so/blog/best-tools-film-producers-2026>

Breakdown Express / Breakdown Services Ltd breakdownservices.com INDIRECT LOW VERIFIED

Not a script-breakdown tool at all — the incumbent casting breakdown distribution network, which collides with Cinamate's casting room rather than its producer room.

Important category correction: despite the name, Breakdown Express does not parse screenplays into production element breakdowns. "Breakdown" here means a casting breakdown — the character description a production releases to agents and managers. Breakdown Express is the subscription platform through which licensed talent agencies and personal managers maintain client rosters, view breakdowns of feature, television and commercial projects currently casting, and submit clients to those projects. It pairs with Actors Access on the performer side. Any competitive analysis that files it under AI script breakdown has made a naming error.

KEY FEATURES · Casting breakdown distribution to licensed agents and personal managers · Client roster management with full profile information · Submission of clients to casting projects · Theatrical Service covering television, features, theatre · Coverage of commercials, student films, non-union projects, director's reels · Project submission portal for productions releasing breakdowns · Paired with Actors Access on the performer side

PRICING Not disclosed. Pricing and eligibility requirements vary by territory and must be obtained from the nearest Breakdown Services office. Restrictions apply to managers outside Los Angeles and New York. Most project postings are free to the production, though some project types carry a fee.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP The dominant casting breakdown distribution network in North America, with regional offices and decades of operation. Access is gated to licensed talent agencies and personal managers. Compared in industry analyses against Talent Systems and Backstage. Revenue, ownership and subscriber counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · casting — this is the only real overlap, and it is total: Breakdown Express is the actual channel through which casting breakdowns reach agents in North America

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Owns the distribution network itself — a Cinamate casting breakdown has nowhere to go unless it reaches agents, and this is how it reaches them
- Gated access to licensed agencies creates a genuine two-sided network effect no software feature can replicate
- Decades of incumbency and industry-wide default status
- Free posting for most productions removes cost as a barrier

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Does nothing at all outside casting — no script parsing, scheduling, budgeting, production, post or release tooling
- No AI capability of any kind
- No published pricing and territory-gated eligibility make it opaque and hard to access
- Dated interface and workflow
- Not a competitor to Cinamate's core proposition and should not be treated as one

<https://breakdownservices.com/index.cfm/main/about> · https://breakdownservices.com/index.cfm/main/talent_rep · <http://www.breakdownexpress.com/content/common.html> · <https://breakdownservices.com/index.cfm/main/faq>

Croogloo croogloo.com INDIRECT LOW VERIFIED

Production distribution and reporting platform whose \$19/month entry tier bundles script breakdowns, sides and watermarking.

Croogloo is a production platform focused on secure document distribution, reporting and coordination for studio-scale productions. Its entry tier bundles script breakdowns, sides, watermarking and production templates and forms. Higher tiers add daily time reports, collated time reports, automated DPR grids and weekly timesheets, then production distribution with tracking, distribution reports and SMS distribution. It is frequently described by third parties as including AI-assisted features, but Croogloo's own pricing page documents none.

KEY FEATURES · Script breakdowns, sides and document watermarking (entry tier) · Production templates and forms · Daily and collated time reports, automated DPR grid, weekly timesheets · Production distribution with tracking and distribution reports · SMS/text distribution to cast and crew

PRICING Side Kit: \$19/month — script breakdowns, sides, watermark, production templates and forms. Report Kit: \$99/month — everything in Side Kit plus daily time reports, collated time reports, automated DPR grid, weekly timesheets. Distribution Kit: \$999/month — everything in Side Kit plus production distribution, distribution tracking, distribution reports and SMS distribution.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Positioned for larger productions and studio-grade distribution workloads. Funding, ownership, headcount and named customers not disclosed. Third-party comparisons rate it highly for studio-grade scheduling and distribution.

COLLIDES WITH · producer — script breakdowns, sides, DPRs and time reports · tools — timecards, which Croogloo covers with weekly timesheets and time reports · today — daily production reporting and crew distribution · clearance — watermarking and controlled distribution · Studio Cloud Backup — centralized distribution state and tracking

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- \$19/month entry gets breakdowns, sides and watermarking — cheaper than nearly anything comparable
- SMS distribution to cast and crew is real on-set reach Cinamate has no channel for
- Automated DPR grids and collated time reports are production-accounting artifacts Cinamate's tools room only partially covers
- Distribution tracking proves documents were received, which matters legally

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No AI features documented anywhere on Croogloo's own pricing page, despite third-party claims
- Steep and strange tier jumps (\$19 to \$99 to \$999) with little middle ground
- No scheduling, budgeting, editorial, post, deliverables, festivals or tax credits
- \$999/month for distribution is out of reach for independent producers
- No SOC 2 or TPN certification found
- No company, team or customer transparency

<https://croogloo.com/pricing/> · <https://sourceforge.net/software/product/Croogloo/>

Open-source screenplay tooling (Fountain / screenplay-tools / Open Draft)

github.com/wildwinter/screenplay-tools

INDIRECT

LOW

VERIFIED

Free parsing libraries and open screenwriting apps that let any competent developer build breakdown tooling in a weekend — the zero-cost floor under the whole category.

A mature open-source layer already solves the hard input problem this category charges for. screenplay-tools (formerly fountain-tools) provides multi-language libraries (C++, JavaScript, Python, C#) for a format-agnostic screenplay representation with import and export for both Fountain and Final Draft .fdx. Multiple independent Fountain parser implementations exist. Open Draft is a free, open-source screenwriting application with professional formatting, real-time collaboration, beat boards and version control across macOS, Windows, Linux and browser. Screenplay Studio covers script writing, character development, scene breakdowns, shot lists, corkboard, arc planning, beat sheets, production scheduling, budget tracking and team roles — free and open-source. Combined with any commodity LLM API, these compose into a working AI breakdown pipeline at marginal cost.

KEY FEATURES · screenplay-tools: Fountain and .fdx parse/write in C++, JS, Python and C# · Multiple independent Fountain parser implementations · Open Draft: free open-source screenwriting with formatting, collaboration, beat boards, version control · Screenplay Studio: breakdowns, shot lists, scheduling, budget tracking, team roles — free · Screenplay-to-prompt-pack tooling exporting scenes, elements, bibles, shot lists and timelines to any LLM or video generator · No licensing cost, no vendor lock-in, self-hostable and air-gappable

PRICING Free. Open-source licenses. The only cost is developer time and whatever LLM inference the user chooses to run — which can be local and therefore zero marginal cost.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Distributed across GitHub with no central ownership. Individually small projects; collectively they represent the commoditization of screenplay parsing, which was the technical moat this category was originally built on. Maintained by independent developers and small communities.

COLLIDES WITH · writer — script parsing, formatting and version control · producer — breakdown sheet generation and shot lists · boards — beat boards and corkboard planning · timeline — production scheduling · finance — budget tracking · Studio/Local Generation — prompt-pack exports feed any local or hosted image/video generator, replicating the local-GPU pipeline without the platform

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free, permanently, with no vendor risk — the strongest possible price anchor against a \$110-per-feature render
- Self-hostable and air-gappable, which is a better confidentiality story than any cloud tool and matches Cinamate's local-GPU pitch without the lock-in
- Fully inspectable — a producer or studio security team can audit exactly what happens to the script
- Prompt-pack exports work with any LLM and any video generator, avoiding model lock-in entirely
- Proves the parsing layer is commodity, undermining technical-moat claims across the category

<https://github.com/wildwinter/screenplay-tools> · <https://github.com/nyousefi/Fountain> · <https://github.com/topics/screenwriting> · <https://github.com/topics/screenplay>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Requires real developer capability to assemble — useless to the working producer who just wants a breakdown
- No support, no SLA, no accountability, no continuity guarantee
- No union rate data, no permit databases, no tax-credit jurisdictions, no sales models — none of the curated data assets Cinamate claims
- Fragmented across many projects with inconsistent maintenance and quality
- No integrated workflow — these are components, not a product
- No compliance posture whatsoever

ALSO COMPETING IN THIS CATEGORY (PROFILED ELSEWHERE)

Celtx (Backlight) **ADJACENT** **HIGH** — Long-standing integrated scriptwriting-to-production suite, now part of Backlight — but its breakdown is manual tagging, not AI, despite widespread third-party claims otherwise. *(full profile under “Screenwriting & development tools (including AI coverage/analysis and script clearance/title research)”)*

Cinetech **DIRECT** **MEDIUM** — Credit-metered AI production platform that makes all non-AI production tools permanently free and charges only for AI compute. *(full profile under “AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios”)*

FinalBit (formerly NolanAI) **DIRECT** **HIGH** — AI filmmaking workspace spanning scriptwriting, breakdown, budgeting, scheduling, pitch decks and AI video generation — rebranded from NolanAI in 2025. *(full profile under “Screenwriting & development tools (including AI coverage/analysis and script clearance/title research)”)*

Saturation.io **ADJACENT** **MEDIUM** — Film production finance platform with 8,000+ producers — the direct challenger to Cinamate's Money Room rather than its breakdown. *(full profile under “Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accounting”)*

SetKeeper **INDIRECT** **LOW** — Per-production, budget-banded coordination and secure-distribution platform for mid and large productions — priced from \$1,500 a project. *(full profile under “Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option”)*

StudioBinder **ADJACENT** **HIGH** — The default all-in-one production management suite for indies and commercial crews, with AI-assisted script tagging feeding schedule, call sheets and reports. *(full profile under “Production management suites (the incumbents)”)*

§11 Production management suites (the incumbents)

Market read · This is the most entrenched category Cinamate touches, and the one where "28 modules" buys the least differentiation. Structurally it splits three ways. (1) The EP/Cast & Crew duopoly owns the professional tier: Entertainment Partners (TPG-controlled since Jan 2020, >1M claimed users) sells Movie Magic Scheduling/Budgeting, Scenechronize, SyncOnSet and the SmartStudio suite; Cast & Crew (EQT majority since 2019) owns Final Draft, Checks & Balances, Sargent-Disc, Media Services, Backstage. Both bundle payroll, residuals and tax incentives — the commercial gravity Cinamate's taxcredit and finance rooms cannot match. (2) A crowded indie SaaS mid-market: StudioBinder (\$29-\$99/mo, bootstrapped, ~21-29 staff, claims 1.5M users), Yamdu (\$265/mo flat for 20 seats, Munich, ~10 staff), Celtx (Backlight), SetHero, Dramatify, SetKeeper, Croogloo, Assemble, Setkick. (3) A fast-moving AI-breakdown wave — Filmustage (\$79/mo Director's Cut, ~\$2.1M raised), Shamel Studio (\$23-\$45/seat/mo), Studiovity, InteScene — attacking exactly the "script in, breakdown/schedule/budget out" wedge Cinamate claims. Pricing norms are brutally low: \$19-\$99/month is the indie default; \$249-\$999/month or \$1,500-\$5,000/production is the studio tier. Cinamate's ~\$110-per-feature (unverified figure) render is priced against nothing here — the incumbents charge for coordination, not generation. Switching costs are social, not technical: Movie Magic's .mmsx/stripboard is the interchange format ADs, UPMs and line producers are trained on; crews arrive knowing StudioBinder call sheets and Scenechronize sides. Cinamate's single-operator design is the real anomaly — every incumbent monetizes multi-department collaboration, and Cinamate has no mobile/on-set app, no TPN, no SOC 2. The market itself is growing (~\$6.66B in 2026, 9.06% CAGR per Research and Markets), which invites more entrants, not fewer.

Movie Magic Scheduling (Entertainment Partners) www.ep.com/movie-magic-scheduling **DIRECT**

CRITICAL **LIKELY**

The de facto industry-standard scheduling and stripboard application for film and television, owned by Entertainment Partners.

Desktop scheduling software that breaks a screenplay down element by element and turns it into digital stripboards which ADs and UPMs rearrange to build the shooting schedule. Recently modernized with side-by-side split-screen views, drag-and-drop, multi-episode and multi-unit scheduling, and 'red flags' conflict detection. Its file format and stripboard conventions are the interchange standard the rest of the category exports to — Filmustage, Gorilla and others all list MMS export as a feature.

KEY FEATURES · Element-level script breakdown · Digital stripboards with drag-and-drop reordering · Multi-unit and multi-episode scheduling · Conflict detection ('red flags') · Day Out of Days, cast/crew and dozens of industry-standard reports · Exports that downstream tools (budgeting, AI breakdown services) all consume

PRICING EP publishes no price on the product page; store returned HTTP 503 during verification. Third-party introductory figures (~\$29.99/mo) are unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Owned by Entertainment Partners, which TPG Capital agreed to acquire in March 2019 (closed 10 January 2020). EP claims a customer base exceeding one million users and is the global leader in entertainment payroll, workforce management, residuals and tax incentives. Movie Magic has been the recognized scheduling standard for decades — no independently published install-base percentage exists.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (stripboard, scheduling) · timeline · production · today · locations (scheduling constraints) · casting (Day Out of Days)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Format lock-in: MMS stripboards are the lingua franca that ADs, UPMs and line producers are trained on — Cinamate has no stated MMS import/export path, which is a hard blocker for any crew hire
- Decades of trust on productions of every budget; nobody gets fired for scheduling in Movie Magic
- \$29.99/mo entry against Cinamate's unpriced invite-only beta
- Backed by a TPG-owned company with payroll, residuals and tax-incentive services attached
- Runs offline on a laptop; no GPU, no 4-minute sync dependency

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Scheduling only — no generation, no editorial, no VFX, no distribution, no festivals
- Desktop-bound single-purpose app; Cinamate spans 28 modules end to end
- No live cost reporting or self-calibrating estimates (that is EP's separate SmartAccounting/Movie Magic Budgeting)
- No sales forecasting, no P10-P90 confidence bands, no breakeven modeling
- Dated UX relative to modern browser tools

△ Fact-check: earlier 'verified on EP Store' label was not supportable.

StudioBinder www.studiobinder.com **DIRECT** **CRITICAL** **VERIFIED**

The default cloud production-management suite for independent and commercial productions, covering script through call sheet in one browser app.

Cloud platform organized in five stages — Write, Breakdown, Visualize, Plan, Shoot — covering industry-formatted screenwriting, AV scripts, script breakdowns with custom element categories, stripboard scheduling, mood boards, shot lists, storyboards, a production contacts database with a shared messaging inbox, task boards and calendars, location management, and call sheet creation with distribution tracking analytics. Bootstrapped, based in Santa Monica. It also runs one of the highest-traffic filmmaking content marketing operations in the industry, which is where most of its top-of-funnel comes from.

KEY FEATURES · Industry-formatted screenwriting with revision tracking and WGA color-coding · Unlimited script breakdowns with customizable reports and script sides · Stripboard scheduling with multi-schedule support that auto-populates call sheets · Call sheet builder with recipient-level delivery tracking analytics and personalized notes · Shot lists, storyboards, mood boards/lookbooks · Production contacts database plus shared team inbox · Task boards, production calendars, media library · Location database with PDF generation

PRICING Official support-center pages (2026): Starter \$29/mo (1 seat, 10 projects incl. archived); Indie \$49/mo (2 seats, 25 projects); Professional \$99/mo (4 seats, unlimited projects). Additional seats \$25/user/mo. Third-party aggregators list higher month-to-month rates — Indie \$85, Professional \$127, Agency \$229 (6 users), Studio \$340 — which likely reflect monthly-billed vs annual-billed pricing or stale data; treat the \$29/\$49/\$99 support-page figures as the current annual-billed ladder. Free tier and free trial available.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Claims on its own homepage that "more than 1.5 million production companies and brands worldwide" rely on the platform. Bootstrapped/unfunded per Crunchbase and Tracxn. Estimated ~21 employees and ~\$2.3M revenue (Latka, 2026); RocketReach shows 26 employees/\$7M; Tracxn showed 29 as of July 2024 — figures are third-party estimates, not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · boards · producer (stripboard, call sheets) · casting (contacts) · locations · wardrobe/props/sets (via breakdown element categories) · production · today · timeline · workflow · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Enormous incumbency and name recognition — crews already know how to read a StudioBinder call sheet, so onboarding cost is near zero
- Genuinely multi-user by design; Cinamate is explicitly single-operator
- Call sheet delivery analytics (who opened, who confirmed) — an on-set accountability loop Cinamate has no equivalent for
- Entry price of \$29/mo vs Cinamate's invite-only private beta with no published price
- Public company, public team, public product; Cinamate has no public team and press declined
- Runs on any browser with no local GPU requirement

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No generation layer at all — it plans a film, it does not produce one
- No editor, no VFX, no music/cue sheets, no dailies, no post or distribution deliverables
- No budgeting engine of consequence and no tax-credit modeling (Cinamate claims 21 jurisdictions)
- No sales/revenue forecasting or waterfall/breakeven modeling
- No investor, clearance, contracts, safety or festivals rooms
- No mobile on-set app either — parity, not an advantage, for Cinamate

△ Fact-check: the '1.5 million production companies' figure is a verbatim vendor claim, implausible for a ~21–29-employee company — treat as marketing.

<https://www.studiobinder.com/> · <https://support.studiobinder.com/en/articles/10948744-what-s-included-with-the-starter-plan> · <https://support.studiobinder.com/en/articles/10949635-what-s-included-with-the-indie-plan> · <https://support.studiobinder.com/en/articles/10951295-what-s-included-with-the-professional-plan>

Gorilla Scheduling & Budgeting + Gorilla Ratebook (Jungle Software) junglesoftware.com **DIRECT**

HIGH **VERIFIED**

Long-established indie-focused scheduling and budgeting desktop suite whose Ratebook is the only union labor-rate guide that integrates directly into budgeting software.

Traditional scheduling and budgeting applications aimed squarely at independent producers: Gorilla Scheduling handles script import, breakdown, stripboards, calendars, cast/crew, locations, storyboards, shot lists, call sheets and dozens of industry-standard reports; Gorilla Budgeting handles globals, fringes, subgroups, tax credits, determinants, 4th-level budgeting, ratebook integration and expense tracking. The Gorilla Ratebook is a separately sold union rate database. Koala Call Sheets is a companion product.

KEY FEATURES · Script import, breakdown and stripboard scheduling (Gorilla Scheduling, currently v11) · Budgeting with globals, fringes, subgroups, determinants and 4th-level detail · Built-in tax credit handling · Gorilla Ratebook: over 11,500 verified labor rates covering 200+ union agreements, fully integrated with budgeting · Expense tracking · Koala Call Sheets companion app · Multi-install packs (Combo, Director, Producer, Crew — 2 to 5 installs)

PRICING Gorilla Budgeting \$24.99/month subscription (35% savings via Combo Pack); Gorilla Ratebook \$39.95; Koala Call Sheets \$49 one-time. Scheduling is sold monthly or yearly with exact rates not shown on the product page; SourceForge lists Gorilla Scheduling from \$249. Historic v6 perpetual pricing was \$250 each or \$430 for the combo — that generation has been superseded by subscriptions.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Jungle Software has served the independent market for well over a decade. Ratebook claims 11,500+ verified labor rates across 200+ union agreements. Company financials not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (budget, stripboard, call sheets) · finance · The Money Room · taxcredit · contracts (rate assumptions) · casting · locations · boards · production · timeline

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- The Ratebook directly attacks Cinamate's headline rigor claim: 11,500+ verified rates across 200+ union agreements versus Cinamate's four cited rates (SAG-AFTRA, DGA, WGA, IATSE)
- Built-in tax credit handling already in a \$24.99/mo product
- Perpetual/desktop heritage means no dependence on a vendor's cloud or a 4-minute sync
- Very cheap and self-serve; no invite required
- Long track record with the exact indie producer segment Cinamate targets

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Dated desktop UX; no modern collaborative web app
- No generation, editorial, VFX, music, dailies, post, distribution or festivals
- No live cost reporting learning from invoices — expense tracking is manual
- No sales forecasting, failure-rate disclosure or confidence bands
- Fragmented product line (Scheduling, Budgeting, Ratebook, Koala all separate purchases)

<https://junglesoftware.com/> · <https://junglesoftware.com/gorilla-scheduling/> · <https://junglesoftware.com/gorilla-budgeting/> · <https://junglesoftware.com/gorilla-scheduling-features/>

Scenechronize + SmartHub (Entertainment Partners SmartStudio) www.ep.com/scenechronize **DIRECT**

HIGH **VERIFIED**

EP's cloud production-office platform for securely generating and distributing sides, scripts, schedules, call sheets and safety documents at studio scale.

Cloud-based digital production office that organizes, manages and distributes all production documents and workflows: automated sides generation, script analysis and breakdowns, call sheets, production schedules, safety documentation, a crew homepage serving role-specific documents, granular user permissions, and a searchable cloud-synced dashboard. SmartHub extends this to studio level, letting studios view, manage, update and archive documents across many projects. Part of the SmartStudio suite alongside SmartAccounting, SmartStart, SmartTime, SmartResiduals and SmartCards.

KEY FEATURES · Automated script sides generation with watermarking · Script analysis and breakdowns · Secure, permissioned distribution to crew with role-based crew homepage · Call sheets, schedules and safety documents in one distribution spine · SmartHub multi-project studio archive and search · Multi-layered closed-loop security

PRICING Not disclosed publicly — quoted per production/studio. EP sells a separate 'Scenechronize for Show Users' Academy course through the EP Store.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP EP claims Scenechronize is the #1 cloud-based digital production document solution, "pressure tested on real-world productions for over a decade," including securing scripts across all eight seasons of Game of Thrones. Owned by TPG-controlled Entertainment Partners.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (call sheets) · safety · production · today · workflow · projects · Studio Cloud Backup (unified production state) · clearance (document control)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Security posture is the whole product — watermarked, permissioned, anti-spoiler distribution proven on premium episodic; Cinamate has no TPN and no SOC 2, which disqualifies it from exactly this work
- Real-time distribution to hundreds of crew across departments vs Cinamate's single-operator model and 4-minute sync
- Studio-level multi-project archive (SmartHub) — Cinamate's projects room is not comparable
- Bundled with EP payroll, accounting and residuals
- Named studio references and a decade of production hardening

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Distribution and document control, not creative production — no editor, VFX, music, dailies or generation
- No budgeting or cost reporting in Scenechronize itself
- Undisclosed pricing and enterprise sales motion put it out of reach for the solo indie producer Cinamate targets
- No festivals, distribution deliverables or tax-credit modeling
- No public self-serve signup

<https://www.ep.com/scenechronize/> · <https://www.ep.com/support/scenechronize-and-smarthub/> · <https://www.ep.com/production-management/> · <https://www.ep.com/ep-store/scenechronize-for-show-users-course/>

Assemble (assemble.tv) assemble.tv DIRECT MEDIUM LIKELY

End-to-end project management platform for film producers that pairs production planning with frame-accurate media review and approvals.

Cloud project management built for content creation teams: visual production calendars, task lists, casting and location management, a call sheet builder with dynamic map and auto-updating weather widgets, plus asset review tools with frame-specific video commenting and approval tracking. Supports bulk media upload, multiple file formats, search and filtering, version control and in-browser video streaming without downloads. Available on web, iOS and Android.

KEY FEATURES · Visual production calendar with drag-to-shift task planning · Task lists and assignment tracking · Casting and location management · Call sheet builder with dynamic maps and auto-updating weather · Frame-specific video commenting and approval tracking · Media asset library with version control and streaming review · Web, iOS and Android apps

PRICING Capterra lists a starting price of \$19/month flat rate, with both a free trial (14 days) and a free version. The vendor itself states pricing varies by team needs — treat \$19/mo as an entry indicator rather than a full tier structure.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Listed on Capterra, SourceForge and GetApp with limited review volume. Funding, headcount and customer counts not disclosed in sources reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (call sheets) · casting · locations · timeline · today · workflow · projects · screening (review/approval) · dailies (media review) · editor (frame-level notes)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Has actual iOS and Android apps — Cinamate's stated gap of no mobile/on-set app is Assemble's shipped baseline
- Frame-specific commenting and approval tracking overlaps Cinamate's screening and dailies rooms with a real collaborative review loop
- Free version and \$19/mo entry, self-serve
- Combines planning and post-review in one place, which few production suites do
- Multi-user collaboration and approvals are native

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No script breakdown depth, stripboard scheduling or budgeting
- No generation, no NLE, no VFX, no music, no distribution deliverables
- Capterra notes it lacks content management and access control features that a large share of reviewers consider critical
- No tax credits, sales modeling or investor tooling
- Very thin public review base — adoption scale unclear

<https://www.capterra.com/p/202621/Assemble/> · <https://sourceforge.net/software/product/Assemble-TV/> · <https://www.wrapbook.com/blog/best-filmmaking-software-and-tools> · <https://storyflow.so/blog/best-project-management-tools-filmmakers-2026>

SetHero sethero.com **DIRECT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

Call-sheet-first production management tool for producers and ADs, priced by production size rather than seats.

All-in-one production management platform built around digital call sheets: creating and distributing call sheets by SMS and email, managing cast and crew contacts, tracking confirmations, and generating production reports. Positions itself explicitly as the StudioBinder alternative for teams whose primary pain is call sheets and on-set communication. Pricing scales by number of projects per year and production size rather than by user.

KEY FEATURES · Digital call sheet creation and SMS + email distribution · Cast and crew contact management · Confirmation/RSVP tracking · Production reports · Custom branding on higher tiers · Admin seat tiers (5 on Pro, 12 on Studio)

PRICING Starter \$19/month (small project sizes, SMS texting, from 5 projects/year); Pro \$49/month (medium project sizes, SMS, up to 5 admins, custom branding); Studio \$129/month (large project sizes, SMS, up to 12 admins, custom branding, priority support). Plans scale by projects per year and production size, not unlimited projects.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Established indie/commercial tool with G2 and Capterra presence and its own comparison content. Funding and user counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (call sheets) · today · production · casting (contacts) · timeline · workflow

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- SMS distribution reaches crew phones without an app — Cinamate has no on-set channel at all
- \$19/month entry, self-serve, no invite required
- Confirmation tracking closes the loop on whether crew actually received the call
- Focused product that does one high-frequency job extremely well
- Sizing by production rather than seats matches how indie producers budget

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Narrow scope — call sheets and crew comms, essentially nothing else
- No breakdown, scheduling depth, budgeting or cost tracking
- No creative modules whatsoever
- No tax credits, sales modeling or investor tooling
- Project-count caps on lower tiers

<https://sethero.com/> · <https://sethero.com/call-sheets/> · <https://sethero.com/faq/> · <https://sethero.com/studiobinder-alternative/>

Setkick setkick.com **DIRECT** **LOW** **LIKELY**

Lightweight production management tool for film, TV, photo and video shoots, built around call sheets, stripboards and crew messaging.

Production management for video, photo, television and film shoots, aimed particularly at photo and video production companies. Users import scripts and tag elements such as props and wardrobe, build a stripboard, generate a digital call sheet for each shoot day directly from that stripboard, distribute it through Setkick or by email, and track RSVPs. Includes messaging to talent, crew, vendors and clients from within the platform.

KEY FEATURES · Script import with element tagging (props, wardrobe) · Stripboard scheduling · Per-day digital call sheet generation from the stripboard · Call sheet distribution with RSVP tracking · Integrated messaging to talent, crew, vendors and clients · 14-day free trial; extended free trials for students

PRICING SourceForge lists pricing starting at \$29.99/month. The vendor does not publish a rate card in the sources reviewed — treat the figure as indicative. Free 14-day trial; extended trials for students.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Small independent product. Funding, headcount and customer counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (stripboard, call sheets) · props · wardrobe · casting (contacts) · today · production · timeline · workflow

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Also serves commercial photo and video production, a much larger volume market than narrative features
- Self-serve trial and ~\$30/mo entry versus an invite-only unpriced beta
- Built-in crew/vendor/client messaging — a communication channel Cinamate lacks entirely
- Student outreach builds habit early
- Simple enough to adopt mid-production

<https://setkick.com/> · <https://sourceforge.net/software/product/Setkick/> · <https://slashdot.org/software/p/Setkick/> · <https://sethero.com/blog/best-call-sheet-software-comparison/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Very narrow feature set — call sheets, stripboard, messaging
- No budgeting, cost tracking or tax credits
- No creative modules or generation
- No dailies, editorial, VFX, music, post, distribution or festivals
- Minimal public footprint; longevity and support depth unverified

farmerswife farmerswife.com

ADJACENT

LOW

LIKELY

Twenty-five-year-old resource, scheduling and cost-management platform for media companies, post houses, broadcasters and rental operations.

All-in-one media-industry platform combining scheduling, project management, resource planning (people, rooms, equipment), budgets, time tracking and cost management. Built for production, post-production, broadcasting, equipment rental, agencies and education rather than for a single feature film — its strength is booking finite resources (edit suites, kit, staff) across many concurrent jobs and reconciling time and cost against them.

KEY FEATURES · Resource scheduling for people, rooms and equipment · Project management across concurrent jobs · Budgets, time tracking and cost control · Booking and utilization reporting · Media-industry-specific workflows (post, broadcast, rental) · Essential, Studio and Enterprise tiers

PRICING Monthly subscription starting around \$30 per user per month for small businesses; for very large deployments (1,000+ users) reported at roughly \$20-\$25 per user per month. Three plans: Essential (small businesses and freelancers), Studio (mid-sized companies), Enterprise (large enterprises). Vendor does not publish a rate card — figures come from third-party review sites and should be treated as indicative.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP States 25 years in the media industry. Company ownership, headcount and customer counts not disclosed in sources reviewed. No 2026 acquisition news found.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (scheduling, budget) · finance · The Money Room (time and cost) · tools (timecards) · post · timeline · workflow · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Resource booking across concurrent productions — a production company running several jobs at once is a use case Cinamate's single-project, single-operator design does not serve
- Twenty-five years of operating history and enterprise deployments
- Time-and-cost reconciliation against booked resources is a mature version of what Cinamate's Money Room is attempting
- Serves post houses, broadcasters and rental companies — adjacent revenue Cinamate cannot reach
- Per-user pricing that scales down for freelancers

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not film-specific — no script breakdown, stripboard, call sheets, casting, wardrobe or props
- No creative modules: no writer, boards, editor, VFX, music, dailies
- No generation capability
- No tax credits, sales modeling, investor or festivals tooling
- Pricing opaque; no published rate card

<https://farmerswife.com/scheduling/> · <https://www.capterra.com/p/160525/farmerswife/> · <https://www.itqlick.com/farmerswife/pricing> · <https://www.g2.com/products/farmerswife/reviews>

Kitsu (CGWire) kitsu.cloud

INDIRECT

LOW

LIKELY

Open-source, AGPL-licensed production tracker for animation, VFX and film studios, self-hostable at zero licence cost.

Open-source collaboration and production tracking platform for animation, VFX and film pipelines, positioned by CGWire as the alternative to ftrack and ShotGrid. Manages the production pipeline end to end with task tracking, review and asset management. Distributed under the AGPL with a public GitHub repository, so any studio can self-host indefinitely for free; CGWire monetizes

cloud hosting, managed on-premise deployment and a Partners Program that funds development in exchange for roadmap influence.

KEY FEATURES · Full pipeline production tracking for animation and VFX · Task assignment, status and review workflows · Asset management with video processing · Open source under AGPL with public GitHub repository · Self-hosted, CGWire-hosted cloud, or managed on-premise deployment · Partners Program with direct roadmap influence

PRICING Self-hosted: free and open source under AGPL, no licence cost. Kitsu Cloud and Managed On-Premise: paid, priced by CGWire; exact 2026 rates not published in the sources reviewed. One third-party source suggests cloud pricing around €50+/user/month for enterprise — treat as unverified. Partners Program is a yearly contribution.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Around 200 studios are reported to self-host Kitsu today. Developed by CGWire; funding not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · vfx · post · production · timeline · workflow · projects · dailies · screening

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Zero licence cost forever if self-hosted — an unbeatable price floor for any studio with basic IT
- Full data sovereignty and auditability via open source; Cinamate is a closed beta on a netlify.app subdomain with no SOC 2 or TPN
- Roughly 200 self-hosting studios means real, verifiable deployment
- Community-extensible; studios can build exactly the pipeline they need
- Multi-user, multi-department by construction

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Animation/VFX pipeline focus — no physical production tooling: no stripboard, call sheets, locations, wardrobe, props or safety
- No budgeting, cost reporting or tax credits
- No screenwriting, storyboarding origination or generation
- Requires IT capacity to self-host — not a solo producer's tool
- No sales modeling, investor, distribution or festivals rooms

<https://kitsu.cloud/> · <https://www.cg-wire.com/production-tracker> · <https://www.cg-wire.com/self-hosted/> · <https://www.cg-wire.com/shotgrid-alternative/>

Netflix Prodicle help.prodicle.com/hc/en-us INDIRECT LOW LIKELY

Netflix's in-house production toolset — evidence that the largest buyers build rather than buy, and a template studios imitate.

Short for 'Production Chronicle,' Prodicle is Netflix Studios' internal production-facing toolset, comprising roughly seven apps including Move, Calendar, Distribution, Scripts, Contacts and Scheduling. Prodicle Move is a progressive web app that manages unit locations, daily shooting schedules, hourly production goals and real-time updates for crews in the field. It leans on existing infrastructure such as Google Workspace to collaborate with productions in real time, and is given to freelance production crews working on Netflix shows.

KEY FEATURES · Prodicle Move: PWA for unit locations, daily schedules, hourly goals, real-time updates · Calendar, Distribution, Scripts, Contacts and Scheduling apps · Progressive web app delivery to freelance crews without app store friction · Integration with Google Workspace · Purpose-built for a single studio's production standards

PRICING Not applicable — internal Netflix tooling, not sold. Not disclosed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Netflix reported that in one earlier year, 40 productions used at least some of the Prodicle apps and services, including shows such as GLOW. Public documentation exists at help.prodicle.com. Most detailed public coverage dates from 2018-2019, so current scope should be treated as stale.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (schedules, call sheets) · locations · production · today · timeline · workflow · Studio Cloud Backup

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Demonstrates that the highest-value buyers in this market build in-house rather than license — a structural ceiling on Cinamate's enterprise upside
- Real-time updates to crews in the field via a PWA; Cinamate has no mobile/on-set app and a 4-minute sync that is not real-time
- Backed by Netflix engineering resources and deployed across dozens of productions
- Distributed to freelance crews with no install friction

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not available to buy — irrelevant as a direct purchase option for independent producers
- Narrow to Netflix's own workflow standards
- No budgeting, tax credits, sales modeling, editorial, VFX or distribution modules for external use
- Public information is largely from 2018-2019 and may be materially out of date

ALSO COMPETING IN THIS CATEGORY (PROFILED ELSEWHERE)

Autodesk Flow Production Tracking (formerly ShotGrid / Shotgun) **ADJACENT** **MEDIUM** — Autodesk's studio-grade production tracking, scheduling and asset management platform, the default pipeline system for VFX, animation and games. *(full profile under "Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset tracking")*

Cast & Crew (Final Draft, Checks & Balances, Sargent-Disc, Media Services, Backstage) **ADJACENT** **HIGH** — EQT-backed entertainment payroll and production-technology group whose brand portfolio owns the screenwriting standard and much of the production accounting stack. *(full profile under "Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accounting")*

Celtx (Backlight) **DIRECT** **HIGH** — Long-running script-to-set suite that pairs screenwriting with production planning, dominant in film schools and among students and small teams. *(full profile under "Screenwriting & development tools (including AI coverage/analysis and script clearance/title research)")*

Croogloo **DIRECT** **HIGH** — Cloud production-office and secure distribution platform used by major studios for sides, call sheets, schedules, crew lists and production reports. *(full profile under "AI script breakdown & AI pre-production")*

Dramatify **DIRECT** **MEDIUM** — Stockholm-based production management platform for scripted and non-scripted TV, film and broadcast, with free read-only access for all cast and crew. *(full profile under "AI script breakdown & AI pre-production")*

Filmustage **DIRECT** **HIGH** — AI pre-production platform that automates script breakdown, budgeting and scheduling — the closest competitor to Cinamate's script-in/plan-out promise. *(full profile under "AI script breakdown & AI pre-production")*

InteScene **DIRECT** **LOW** — All-in-one film and TV production platform built on a single shared dataset so a script change propagates automatically to breakdown, stripboard, call sheets and budget. *(full profile under "AI script breakdown & AI pre-production")*

Movie Magic Budgeting (Entertainment Partners) **DIRECT** **CRITICAL** — The industry-standard film and television budgeting application, and the format financiers and completion bonders expect budgets delivered in. *(full profile under "Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accounting")*

Saturation.io **DIRECT** **HIGH** — Cloud film budgeting and production accounting platform with expense cards, PO management and real-time actuals — the closest existing analogue to Cinamate's Money Room. *(full profile under "Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accounting")*

SetKeeper **DIRECT** **MEDIUM** — Security-focused production management and document distribution platform for high-end film and TV, priced per production by budget band. *(full profile under "Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option")*

Shamel Studio **DIRECT** **MEDIUM** — Modern browser-based scheduling and budgeting suite that auto-populates union rates and fringes, pitched directly as the Movie Magic replacement. *(full profile under "Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incentive tooling")*

Studiovity **DIRECT** **LOW** — India-based AI-assisted pre-production suite covering screenwriting, breakdown, storyboards, scheduling, budgeting and call sheets at aggressive price points. *(full profile under "AI script breakdown & AI pre-production")*

SyncOnSet (Entertainment Partners) **DIRECT** **HIGH** — Emmy-winning digital continuity, asset and money-tracking software for costume, props, set dressing and hair/makeup departments. *(full profile under "Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accounting")*

Wrapbook **ADJACENT** **MEDIUM** — Well-funded production payroll, accounting and cost-tracking platform positioned as the modern challenger to EP and Cast & Crew. *(full profile under "Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accounting")*

Yamdu **DIRECT** **HIGH** — Munich-based cloud production management platform and the de facto regional standard for mid-budget European film and television. *(full profile under "AI script breakdown & AI pre-production")*

§12 Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accounting

Market read · Structure: a PE-owned duopoly plus one funded challenger. Entertainment Partners (TPG, 2019) and Cast & Crew (EQT, 2018, from Silver Lake's \$700M 2015 buy) have spent a decade absorbing the category — EP took SyncOnSet, Moneypenny and CASHét (June 2025, 2,500+ productions/yr); Cast & Crew took Final Draft (2016), CAPS, Media Services/Showbiz (2020), Sargent-Disc and The TEAM Companies. Wrapbook (\$151M raised, \$1B valuation in 2021, ~\$750M on PitchBook now) is the only venture challenger at scale; GreenSlate (Francisco Partners, 2023) is the PE-backed middle. Pricing is the decisive fact. The money layer is priced on payment flow, not software: Wrapbook is reported at 0.75-1.5% of payroll, Topsheet publishes a flat 2% with a \$50 batch minimum, ABS charges a weekly fee plus percent of gross, and EP/C&C/GreenSlate quote per production and disclose nothing. Float and fees subsidize the software, which is why the tool layer is nearly free — Saturation's free tier, Movie Magic Budgeting (EP publishes no price; third-party figures conflict), Showbiz at \$399 for two seats, Gorilla ~\$269/yr, the free Showbiz Labor Guide giving away the union rates Cinamate treats as proprietary rigor. For Cinamate: the Money Room competes only on the layer everyone gives away, while owning none of the rail that pays for it — no EOR, no tax filing, no workers' comp, no union remittance. Saturation.io is the closest analogue and already free plus card-enabled; Filmustage (\$79/mo) and Rivet AI (\$150/project) already ship script-to-budget. Direction of travel is incumbent absorption of AI (Wrapbook's invoice-to-PO matching), and no SOC 2 is disqualifying where SSNs and bank details are involved.

Cast & Crew www.castandcrew.com

DIRECT

CRITICAL

VERIFIED

EQT-owned payroll-and-software conglomerate that owns PSL+, Media Services/Showbiz, CAPS, Sargent-Disc, The TEAM Companies and — critically for Cinamate — Final Draft.

Cast & Crew is the other half of the incumbent duopoly. Its accounting platform is PSL+ (budget setup, daily cost tracking, vendor payment, project cost reporting) with PSL+ DPO (digital purchase orders), plus Studio+ and Reporting+ for studio-level rollups. Through Media Services it owns the Showbiz suite — Showbiz Budgeting 10, Showbiz Timecards (Cast and Crew editions), the free Showbiz Labor Guide of union scale rates, MediaWeb production accounting, TiM digital onboarding and Digital Purchase Order. Through Sargent-Disc it runs UK payroll and the Digital Production Office (Payroll, Payslip, Payscales, CrewStart, Sd Production Card). CAPS Payroll serves commercials and The TEAM Companies handles residuals and multi-medium/advertising payroll. It also does residuals, workers' comp, labor relations, incentive management and incentive financing. Final Draft, the screenwriting standard, has been a Cast & Crew subsidiary since 2016.

KEY FEATURES · PSL+ cost management with budget setup, daily costs, AP and cost reports · PSL+ DPO digital purchase orders · Studio+ / Reporting+ for multi-project studio reporting · Showbiz Budgeting 10 with real-time cloud collaboration on a desktop core · Showbiz Timecards and the free Showbiz Labor Guide rate database · Sargent-Disc Digital Production Office, CrewStart and Sd Production Card (UK) · Residuals processing, workers' comp, labor relations, incentive financing · Final Draft screenwriting software

PRICING Payroll and PSL+ pricing not disclosed — quoted per production, historically percent-of-payroll plus per-check fees. Published software prices exist only on the Showbiz side: Showbiz Budgeting 10 is \$399 for a 2-installation licence, \$548 for 3, \$2,528 for 20, with \$99/installation upgrades from version 8, and Showbiz Cloud sold as a monthly or annual in-app subscription.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Acquired by EQT (EQT VIII) in December 2018 from Silver Lake, which had bought it in June 2015 for \$700M. Employee count roughly 700 per third-party profiles (uncertain). Acquisition history: Final Draft (Feb 2016), CAPS Payroll, Media Services (announced Feb 2020, completed April 2020), Sargent-Disc (agreed Nov 2019 — Sargent-Disc processed over £1bn of UK payroll in 2017), The TEAM Companies. Founded 1976, Burbank.

COLLIDES WITH · The Money Room (PSL+ cost reporting and PO tracking) · finance · producer (Showbiz Budgeting collides with the budget/stripboard room) · contracts / deal memos (TiM/CrewStart onboarding and startwork) · writer — Final Draft is the format Cinamate's writer room must import/export · tools (Showbiz Timecards) · taxcredit (incentive management and incentive financing)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Owns Final Draft, so the screenplay standard Cinamate's writer room has to interoperate with belongs to a direct competitor in the money layer
- Real payroll rails, workers' comp, residuals and union compliance in the US, Canada and UK
- Showbiz Labor Guide gives away the union rate data Cinamate treats as a differentiator
- EQT balance sheet and 50 years of studio relationships; a genuine international footprint
- Incentive financing — it will lend against the tax credit, not just calculate it

<https://www.castandcrew.com/products/accounting-and-financial/psl/> · <https://www.castandcrew.com/products/accounting-and-financial/psl-dpo/> · <https://www.mediaservices.com/> · <https://blog.castandcrew.com/newsroom/eqt-acquires-castandcrew>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Product estate is a patchwork of acquired brands (PSL+, MediaWeb, Showbiz, DPO, CrewStart, TiM) with inconsistent UX and overlapping functions
- Showbiz Budgeting is still fundamentally a desktop licence with cloud bolted on
- No creative production capability whatsoever beyond Final Draft's page
- Enterprise sales motion; a solo producer is served badly or not at all
- Slow release cadence relative to an AI-native single-operator tool

Entertainment Partners (EP) www.ep.com **DIRECT** **CRITICAL** **VERIFIED**

TPG-owned incumbent that supplies payroll, production accounting, budgeting, scheduling, p-cards, residuals and tax-incentive advisory to most of the studio system.

EP is the largest single vendor in production finance. Its accounting stack is SmartAccounting (cost management, 250+ template reports, ACH payments, invoice scanning, role-based permissions, cashflow preview, one-click audit reporting, UK Making Tax Digital compliance) integrated with SmartPO (purchase orders), SmartTime (digital timecards), SmartStart (onboarding) and EP Payroll. Movie Magic Budgeting and Movie Magic Scheduling are the industry's default budget and stripboard formats and push GL codes and budget amounts directly into SmartAccounting. EP has bought its way across the rest of the workflow: SyncOnSet (continuity/assets), CASHét (purchasing cards and AP payments, June 2025), and Moneypenny (indie production accounting for UK/Australia/NZ). It also runs the most-cited production-incentives database and an incentives estimator, plus residuals processing and production finance/incentive lending.

KEY FEATURES · SmartAccounting cost management with 250+ report templates and one-click audit reporting · SmartPO / SmartTime / SmartStart integrated with EP Payroll (no duplicate entry) · Movie Magic Budgeting: 4 levels, fringes, globals, multi-currency, tax incentive modeling, pattern budgets · Movie Magic Scheduling stripboards and DOOD · CASHét purchasing cards and CASHétPay digital AP with fraud prevention · Global payroll: US, Canada, UK, Australia/NZ, Europe · Production incentives database + estimator; residuals processing · SyncOnSet continuity, wardrobe/props inventory and asset money tracking

PRICING Payroll and SmartAccounting pricing is not disclosed — quoted per production, historically a percentage of payroll plus per-employee/per-check fees. The only publicly listed number is Movie Magic Budgeting: \$42.99/month (\$515.88/year), with a claimed 40% saving on an annual subscription. Movie Magic Budgeting training courses are sold separately through the EP store.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Acquired by TPG Capital in March 2019 from an ESOP structure. PitchBook lists ~3,016 employees (uncertain). Acquisitions include SyncOnSet (Emmy-winning, founded 2012 as wymsee, Culver City), Moneypenny, and CASHét in June 2025 — CASHét alone reports use on 2,500+ studio and independent productions annually. EP has provided payroll in Australia for 30+ years.

COLLIDES WITH · The Money Room (cost reporting, PO tracking) · finance · producer (budget/stripboard/call sheets) — head-on with Movie Magic Budgeting and Scheduling · taxcredit (21 jurisdictions vs EP's incentives database and estimator) · contracts / deal memos (SmartStart onboarding) · tools (timecards, slate) · wardrobe / props / sets (via SyncOnSet) · timeline / workflow

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Owns the file formats and report layouts studios, completion bonds and auditors expect — a Cinamate cost report is not accepted where an EP one is
- Union rate accuracy is maintained commercially with contractual liability, not a static citation list
- Global payroll, tax filing, workers' comp, residuals — none of which Cinamate does
- Incentive expertise is a services business with people who file the claims, not just a 21-jurisdiction lookup table
- Enterprise security, audit and compliance posture; studio procurement approval already in place
- Deep pockets — TPG-funded acquisition strategy absorbing adjacent categories yearly

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Fragmented product surface: SmartAccounting + SmartPO + SmartTime + Movie Magic + SyncOnSet + CASHét are separate tools with separate logins and licences
- Movie Magic Budgeting is still a per-seat desktop app in an era of browser tools; nothing like Cinamate's single unified state
- Zero creative or generation capability — no script-to-screen, no editing, no VFX, no dailies
- Priced and sold for productions with an accounting department; a single operator is not the customer
- No self-calibrating estimate learning of the kind Cinamate claims — budgets are built by humans from templates

<https://www.ep.com/smartaccounting/> · <https://www.ep.com/movie-magic-budgeting/> · <https://www.ep.com/ep-store/movie-magic-budgeting-monthly/> · <https://www.tpg.com/news-and-insights/entertainment-partners-announces-investment-tpg-0>

Saturation.io saturation.io DIRECT CRITICAL VERIFIED

Producer-built cloud budgeting and production-spend platform with a genuinely free tier — the closest structural analogue to Cinamate's Money Room for a single operator.

Saturation is collaborative cloud budgeting plus expense management plus real-time actuals in one browser product, built by film producer Jens Jacob. It covers budget building with fringe automation and template libraries, cost actualization against the budget (a living budget-vs-actuals cost report), purchase orders and approval workflows, expense cards, and integrations to QuickBooks, Slack, Plaid bank feeds and Wrapbook for payroll actuals. It publishes a free public database of 1,500+ real production budgets and AI-assisted budgeting features on every tier including free. In January 2026 it launched a production charge card for film and video teams, underwritten on production revenue and operating performance rather than the founder's personal credit, with up to 3% cash back on qualifying production spend. It also runs an aggressive comparison-content SEO operation against every competitor in this category.

KEY FEATURES · Cloud collaborative budgeting with fringe automation and templates · Cost actualization / live budget-vs-actual cost reports · Purchase orders and approval workflows (Team tier and up) · Expense management and the Saturation production charge card (Jan 2026) · QuickBooks and Slack integrations; Plaid bank connections; Wrapbook payroll actuals import · SSO/SAML, API access on Enterprise · Free public database of 1,500+ real film budgets

PRICING Creator free; Pro \$32/mo (\$384/yr); Team \$79/mo (\$948/yr). [vendor-verified]

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Company claims 8,000+ producers and 19,628 projects on the platform. Funding not disclosed in what I could verify; a CB Insights profile exists but no round detail was confirmed. Card launch announced via GlobeNewswire, January 22, 2026.

COLLIDES WITH · The Money Room (live cost reporting, PO tracking, self-calibrating estimates) — the single most direct collision in this category · finance · producer (budget/strippingboard) · investors (budget credibility for financiers) · taxcredit (incentive tracking content and line-item modeling) · workflow / projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free tier means a solo producer can build a full feature budget at zero cost — undercuts any paid positioning
- Published, self-serve pricing versus Cinamate's invite-only private beta
- Real integrations that matter to accountants: QuickBooks, Plaid, Wrapbook, Slack
- Has crossed into money movement with its own charge card; Cinamate's Money Room only observes
- Public customer base, public founder, public budget database — credibility Cinamate explicitly lacks (no public team, press declined)
- Cloud-collaborative from day one; no local GPU, no 4-minute sync compromise

<https://saturation.io/pricing> · <https://saturation.io/blog/what-is-saturation> · <https://saturation.io/budgets> · <https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2026/01/22/3223496/0/en/Saturation-Introduces-Production-Credit-Card-Built-for-Film-and-Video-Teams.html>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No payroll, no EOR, no union compliance engine — it stops at the budget and the card
- No script-to-budget generation; budgets are still built by a human from templates
- No creative or production tooling — nothing upstream of the budget or downstream of the cost report
- Small company with no disclosed funding, competing against TPG- and EQT-backed incumbents
- No union rate ratebook of the depth EP/Showbiz maintain

Wrapbook www.wrapbook.com **DIRECT** **CRITICAL** **VERIFIED**

Venture-backed, AI-enabled production payroll and production accounting platform that has become the modern default for commercials and indie/mid-budget film and TV.

Wrapbook is a single platform covering crew onboarding/startwork, digital timecards, accounts payable, production accounting/cost reporting, payroll (union and non-union, as employer of record) and real-time data insights. In late 2025 it shipped AI enhancements that read uploaded invoices in any format (PDF, photo, scan) and auto-match them to the correct purchase order, natural-language report generation, automatic vendor tax-ID verification and fraud checks, and native vendor payments. It publishes a large free knowledge layer — a state-by-state production incentive center, union rate-card guides (DGA, SAG-AFTRA, IATSE) and budgeting templates — that ranks well and functions as top-of-funnel. In March 2026 it published a 2026 State of Production Finance & Accounting report (100 production finance professionals) and in August 2026 launched WRAPPED, an original video series on production finance hosted by co-founder Cameron Woodward.

KEY FEATURES · Onboarding/startwork with digital I-9, W-4, union paperwork · Digital timecards and hours-to-gross calculation · Accounts payable with AI invoice-to-PO matching and vendor verification · Production accounting dashboard and real-time cost reporting · Payroll as employer of record, union and non-union, US and Canada · Native vendor payments; crew expense capture and reimbursement · Natural-language report generation · Free production incentive database and union rate guides

PRICING Not published on Wrapbook's own site — the site routes to sales. Third-party review aggregators report a percentage-of-payroll model of roughly 0.75%-1.5% of payroll plus per-transaction fees (one aggregator cites ~\$18 per transaction as of 2025). Treat the exact numbers as unverified; the percentage-of-payroll structure is the well-established norm and Wrapbook markets itself as cheaper than the 3-5% legacy providers.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP ~\$151M raised across 4 rounds per Tracxn: \$27M Series A led by Andreessen Horowitz (2021), \$100M Series B led by Tiger Global (Nov 2021) at a \$1B valuation, and a further ~\$20M round in Sept 2024. Other investors: Bessemer, Jeffrey Katzenberg's WndrCo, A*, Uncork Capital, Equal Ventures, Michael Ovitz. PitchBook/Tracxn currently show a \$750M valuation (uncertain). Deadline reported ~140 staff in 2022. Named customers on site include Netflix, Anonymous Content, RadicalMedia, SMUGGLER, Superprime.

COLLIDES WITH · The Money Room (live cost reporting, PO tracking, self-calibrating estimates) · finance · producer (budget/stripboard/call sheets) · contracts / deal memos (startwork, onboarding paperwork) · taxcredit (21 jurisdictions vs Wrapbook's incentive center) · tools (timecards) · today / production (crew payment and timecard flow)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Actually moves money — EOR payroll, tax filing, workers' comp, union remittance across US and Canada; Cinamate reports costs but cannot pay anyone
- Audited financial infrastructure and enterprise security posture that a netlify.app private beta cannot claim
- AI invoice-to-PO matching is the same idea as Cinamate's self-calibrating estimates, but shipped, in production, on real invoice volume
- \$151M of capital, named marquee customers, and a public team/press presence
- Mobile app and on-set-friendly timecard capture — a Cinamate stated gap
- Owns the crew-facing relationship: crew onboard and get paid through it, so it is sticky across productions

<https://www.wrapbook.com/> · <https://www.wrapbook.com/blog/wrapbook-releases-state-of-production-finance-accounting-report> · <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/wrapbook-introduces-ai-enhancements-and-native-vendor-payments-to-streamline-accounts-payable-for-film-tv-commercial-302584062.html> · <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/wrapbook-releases-2026-state-of-production-finance-accounting-report-302703092.html>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No creative or production-generation side at all — no script, boards, editing, VFX, music, dailies or deliverables
- Pricing scales with payroll spend, so it gets expensive as budgets grow; Cinamate's ~\$110 per feature render and \$0.00 cloud billing is a different order of magnitude
- Requires a real crew and real payroll to be useful — irrelevant to a single operator generating a film locally
- No budgeting application of its own to rival Movie Magic/Showbiz depth; it complements rather than replaces the budget file

GreenSlate greenslate.com **DIRECT** **HIGH** **VERIFIED**

PE-backed, cloud-native payroll-plus-accounting platform pitched as the only genuinely all-in-one alternative to EP and Cast & Crew.

GreenSlate combines entertainment payroll (union and non-union, employer-of-record or agency model) with production accounting in one system: digital onboarding, paperless timecards, purchase orders, AP, real-time cost reporting, data export/integration and corporate accounting as an add-on module. It also sells production accounting services — placing accountants on productions — and post-production accounting, plus tax credit monetization/credit-monetizing services. It operates in the US and Canada and markets heavily to independent film, documentary and mid-budget episodic. Its positioning line is "built by production accountants for production accountants," and it competes with Wrapbook for the modernizing-indie segment.

KEY FEATURES · Union and non-union payroll, EOR or agency-of-record options · Digital onboarding and paperless timecards · Integrated production accounting: POs, AP, cost reports, GL export · Corporate accounting add-on module priced by budget and project count · Production accounting staffing services (non-union and post) · Tax incentive and credit monetization support · Canadian production support

PRICING Not published. GreenSlate quotes rates based on production budget and shooting location(s); the corporate accounting module is priced by budget size and number of projects. Structurally this is the percent-of-payroll/quoted-services model, not SaaS.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Private-equity backed. VSS Capital Partners invested in 2018 and announced a successful exit in February 2023 when Francisco Partners made a growth investment (VSS also reinvested); American Discovery Capital and Empire State Development are also listed investors, and founder/CEO John Finn remains a significant equity holder. PitchBook additionally lists a buyout/LBO dated September 2025 — unverified from primary sources. An Inc. profile describes >10x EBITDA growth over five years under PE ownership.

COLLIDES WITH · The Money Room (live cost reporting, PO tracking) · finance · producer (budget-to-actual reporting) · contracts / deal memos (onboarding/startwork) · taxcredit (credit monetization) · tools (timecards)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- One system for payroll AND accounting — the exact 'disconnected systems' complaint Cinamate targets, already solved with money movement included
- Human production accountants available as a service, which is what indie producers actually buy when they lack an accounting department
- Financial-services-grade compliance and audit trail; SOC-type controls expected of a payroll processor
- Established with independent film and doc producers — the same buyer Cinamate targets
- Bank-grade tax credit monetization, i.e. turning the credit into cash

<https://greenslate.com/> · <https://greenslate.com/production-accounting-services> · <https://greenslate.com/production-accounting-payroll-software-pricing/> · <https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20230210005073/en/VSS-Capital-Partners-Completes-Successful-Exit-from-GreenSlate>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No published pricing, no self-serve — you cannot start using it in an afternoon
- No creative tooling at all; starts after the budget exists
- No script-to-budget derivation; budgets still come in from Movie Magic/Showbiz
- No estimate-learning loop from historical invoices of the sort Cinamate claims
- Cost scales with payroll volume, unattractive for a near-crewless production

Movie Magic Budgeting (Entertainment Partners)

www.ep.com/movie-magic-budgeting

DIRECT

HIGH

LIKELY

The desktop budgeting application that is the de facto file format and layout standard for film and TV budgets worldwide.

Movie Magic Budgeting builds the budget document that studios, financiers, completion guarantors and tax-credit auditors expect to see. It supports up to four levels of budget hierarchy, globals, fringes with automatic payroll tax and union benefit calculation, template libraries in major studio formats, multi-currency, tax incentive modeling and pattern budgeting for episodic. It is explicitly a pre-production budgeting tool: it does not track actuals, manage POs, handle AP or produce cost reports from real transactions — that job passes to SmartAccounting, which imports its GL codes and budget amounts directly. It is sold standalone as a subscription and taught through EP Academy courses.

KEY FEATURES · Up to four levels of budget detail with globals and sub-groups · Automatic fringe calculation for payroll taxes and union benefits · Large template library in studio-standard formats · Multi-currency and tax incentive modeling · Pattern budgeting for episodic series · Direct export of GL codes and amounts into SmartAccounting and other accounting systems

PRICING EP publishes no price on the product page ('Get pricing'); EP store unreachable during verification. Third-party figures conflict (\$24.99–\$42.99/mo) — treat all Movie Magic dollar amounts as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Owned by Entertainment Partners (TPG-backed). Widely described in the trade and comparison press as the industry standard for studio and network budgets; no independent seat-count figure is published.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (budget/stripboard) — direct, head-to-head · The Money Room (the budget baseline the cost report runs against) · finance · investors (the budget document financiers want) · taxcredit (incentive modeling inside the budget)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Format authority: a Movie Magic budget is the artifact investors, bond companies and incentive auditors accept; a Cinamate budget is not — this alone can disqualify Cinamate from real financing conversations
- Fringe engine depth built over decades against every union agreement
- Established episodic pattern budgeting; Cinamate is feature-oriented
- Cheap and self-serve at \$42.99/month

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Pure pre-production — no actuals, no POs, no cost reports, no learning from invoices; Cinamate's Money Room does more of the job in one place
- Desktop, per-seat, offline-first; no unified production state
- No script-to-budget automation — the breakdown is manual or imported from Movie Magic Scheduling
- No connection whatsoever to anything creative

⚠ Fact-check: earlier 'verified' price labels were not supportable.

<https://www.ep.com/movie-magic-budgeting/> · <https://www.ep.com/ep-store/movie-magic-budgeting-monthly/> · https://mm-b-docs.ep.com/Projects_and_Budgets/accounting_integrations.html · <https://www.ep.com/blog/eight-things-you-might-not-know-about-movie-magic-budgeting/>

Showbiz Budgeting 10 (Media Services / Cast & Crew)

www.mediaservices.com

DIRECT

HIGH

VERIFIED

The other standard desktop budgeting app — dominant in commercials and mid-budget scripted, now with real-time cloud collaboration bolted on.

Showbiz Budgeting is Media Services' budgeting application, sold as a perpetual multi-installation licence with an optional cloud subscription that adds real-time shared editing while keeping desktop independence. It sits between Movie Magic Budgeting and Hot Budget: strong on commercials and music videos, capable on scripted, and notably good at budget-versus-actual tracking. It ships alongside Showbiz Timecards (Crew and Cast editions, hours-to-gross calculation) and the free Showbiz Labor Guide, a searchable union and guild scale rate database. Media Services also sells MediaWeb production accounting, TiM digital onboarding, Digital Purchase Order and crew purchase cards. Media Services is a Cast & Crew company (site footer reads © 2026 Cast & Crew LLC).

KEY FEATURES · Perpetual multi-install licence, Mac (macOS 12+) and Windows (7+) · Showbiz Cloud subscription for real-time collaborative editing · Budget-versus-actual tracking · Strong commercial/advertising and music video templates · Showbiz Timecards Crew and Cast for hours-to-gross · Free Showbiz Labor Guide union/guild rate database · MediaWeb accounting, TiM onboarding, DPO purchase orders

PRICING Showbiz Budgeting 10: \$399 for a 2-installation licence; \$548 for 3 installs; \$2,528 for a 20-install licence; \$99 per installation to upgrade from version 8. Showbiz Cloud is a separate monthly or annual in-app subscription (price not published). Showbiz Labor Guide is free.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Media Services has 45+ years of operating history and was the first entertainment payroll firm to build its own proprietary software line. Acquired by Cast & Crew — agreement announced February 2020, completed April 2020 — and therefore ultimately EQT-owned.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (budget/stripboard) · The Money Room (budget-vs-actual) · finance · tools (timecards) · contracts / deal memos (TiM onboarding) · The union rate citation claim — Showbiz Labor Guide gives the same data away free

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Owns the commercials segment where budgets are bid-driven and turnaround is days
- Perpetual licence at \$399 for two seats is trivially cheap against a production budget
- Free public union rate database undercuts Cinamate's 'source-cited union rates' as a differentiator
- Backed by Cast & Crew's payroll rails, so the budget flows into real payment

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Desktop-first architecture with cloud added late; no unified production state
- No script-to-budget generation, no AI anywhere in the workflow
- Budgeting only — the accounting, PO and AP work happens in other Media Services/C&C products
- Nothing creative; no connection to script, boards, edit or delivery

<https://www.mediaservices.com/> · <https://saturation.io/versus/showbiz-budgeting-10> · <https://www.mediaservices.com/blog/showbiz-budgeting-10-ten-features/> · <https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20200213005724/en/Cast-Crew-Reaches-Agreement-to-Acquire-Media-Services>

Cinelytic

www.cinelytic.com

INDIRECT

HIGH

VERIFIED

AI revenue-forecasting platform for greenlight and financing decisions — a direct challenge to Cinamate's 3,708-film sales model claim.

Cinelytic forecasts box office and ancillary revenues for film projects from the earliest development stage, for studios and independent film companies. On 28 April 2026 The Cinelytic Group announced an upgraded predictive model covering 80 territories with a claimed accuracy of over 88% at the individual title level, returning forecasts in seconds. The group's platform suite spans Callaia (script analysis), ScriptSense, Cinelytic (financial forecasting), SocialSense360 (audience/social signals) and RightsTrade (IP and rights marketplace), so it addresses content development, IP management and financial forecasting together.

KEY FEATURES · Box office and ancillary revenue forecasting across 80 territories · Claimed 88%+ accuracy at individual title level · Forecasts available from earliest development stage · Callaia and ScriptSense AI script analysis · SocialSense360 audience and social demand signals · RightsTrade rights marketplace

PRICING Not disclosed. Enterprise/subscription sales to studios and film companies; no published rate card.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP The Cinelytic Group; predictive model relaunch announced via PR Newswire, 28 April 2026. Funding history exists on Crunchbase/CB Insights but no round figures were confirmed in what I saw.

COLLIDES WITH · investors (the revenue case shown to financiers) · The Money Room / finance (the 2-2.5x breakeven waterfall and P10-P90 bands) · distribution deliverables and festivals, indirectly, via forecast-driven release planning · writer (Callaia/ScriptSense vs the writer room's analytical claims)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Its 88%-accuracy, 80-territory claim is a louder, more specific number than Cinamate's 3,708-film calibration — and it is announced publicly with a company behind it
- Territory-level granularity, which is what actually drives presales and gap financing
- Rights marketplace attached, so the forecast connects to a transaction
- Established with studios and film companies; used in real greenlight rooms

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Forecasting only — no budgeting, no accounting, no production capability at all
- Accuracy claims of this kind are widely disputed in the trade press; Cinamate's disclosed 15.5% failure rate is arguably the more honest framing
- No self-serve access for a single independent producer
- Nothing that helps you actually make the film

<https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/the-cinelytic-group-launches-industry-leading-predictive-model-for-global-film-revenue-forecasting-302754928.html> · <https://www.cbinsights.com/company/cinelytic> · <https://www.degonline.org/cinelytic-new-technology-content-financing-options/> · <https://stephenfollows.com/p/how-to-make-money-in-film-when-nobody-can-predict-a-hit>

ABS Payroll & Accounting abspayroll.com DIRECT MEDIUM LIKELY

Thirty-year indie specialist trading as "The Independent Filmmaker's Choice" — payroll and production accounting for projects the majors decline.

ABS provides employer-of-record payroll and production accounting for independent productions ranging from single-day shorts to features around the \$10M mark — explicitly the projects it says larger entertainment payroll companies do not want. It pairs payroll with production accounting software designed for indie and low-budget workflows, automating repetitive tasks and maintaining compliance, and it markets against the cost of hiring a production accountant, which it cites at \$2,000-\$3,500 per week in a traditional setting.

KEY FEATURES · EOR payroll for indie film and TV · Production accounting software built for low-budget workflows · Union and non-union handling · Compliance and filings for small productions · Positioning against the weekly cost of a staff production accountant

PRICING Not published on ABS's own site. Wrapbook's competitive roundup describes ABS as charging a weekly fee plus a percentage of gross payroll — the classic legacy structure. Treat the specific structure as third-party-sourced.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP 30+ years of operation. Funding, headcount and volume not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · The Money Room (cost reporting for indie budgets) · finance · producer · contracts / deal memos (startwork) · tools (timecards)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Serves the exact underserved niche Cinamate claims — indie producers priced out of studio tooling — and has served it for three decades
- Real payroll, workers' comp and filings, plus human accountants who answer the phone
- Its own cost argument (a production accountant costs \$2,000-\$3,500/week) is the strongest available framing for Cinamate's Money Room — and ABS already owns it

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Services business with dated software; described in competitive reviews as less automated than newer platforms
- No published pricing, no self-serve signup
- No budgeting application, no AI, no creative tooling
- US-focused; no meaningful international footprint

<https://abspayroll.com/> · <https://abspayroll.com/production-accounting-and-payroll/> · <https://abspayroll.com/production-accounting/> · <https://abspayroll.com/accounting/production-accounting-software/>

Gorilla Budgeting (Jungle Software) junglesoftware.com/gorilla-budgeting DIRECT MEDIUM LIKELY

Long-running low-cost desktop budgeting and scheduling suite aimed squarely at indie and student productions.

Jungle Software's Gorilla line is the budget-tier alternative to Movie Magic: Gorilla Budgeting for budgets and Gorilla Scheduling for stripboards, both native desktop apps on Mac and Windows sold by subscription. The budgeting app covers globals, fringes, sub-groups, tax credits, deferments, fourth-level budgeting, union ratebook integration and expense tracking. The Gorilla Ratebook, which supplies union rate data for fringe calculation, is sold as a separate add-on. Jungle Software also publishes Chimpanzee, a cheaper scheduling/budgeting entry point.

KEY FEATURES · Four-level budgeting with globals, fringes, sub-groups · Tax credit and deferment handling · Union ratebook integration (sold separately) · Expense tracking / actuals · Native Mac and Windows desktop apps · Companion Gorilla Scheduling stripboards; Chimpanzee entry-level tier

PRICING Reported at \$29/month, \$74.99/quarter or \$269/year for Gorilla Budgeting, with the Gorilla Ratebook sold separately at \$39.95. These figures come from a competitor comparison page rather than Jungle Software's own price list, so treat as likely rather than confirmed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Independent, long-established vendor (Gorilla has been reviewed in the trade press since at least the version 6 era). No funding, revenue or user numbers disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (budget/stripboard) · finance · taxcredit (tax credit handling inside the budget) · timeline / schedule

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Price point of ~\$269/year plus a \$39.95 ratebook is accessible to exactly the student/micro-budget user who cannot get a Cinamate invite
- Union ratebook is a maintained commercial product, not a static citation
- Both budgeting and scheduling from one vendor with matched data models
- Decades of continuous availability — no beta risk

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Desktop-only, single-user, no cloud state or collaboration
- No accounting, POs, AP or payroll — budget and schedule only
- No AI, no script-derived breakdown
- Dated UX and a small development team
- Ratebook as a paid add-on means the base product's fringes are incomplete out of the box

<https://junglesoftware.com/gorilla-budgeting/> · <https://junglesoftware.com/gorilla-budgeting-features/> · <https://saturation.io/versus/gorilla-budgeting> · <https://www.videomaker.com/article/r10/18653-jungle-software-gorilla-scheduling-and-budgeting-6-review/>

Hot Budget hotbudget.com DIRECT MEDIUM LIKELY

Excel-based budgeting system that is the de facto standard for commercial and advertising production bids.

Hot Budget is a spreadsheet-native budgeting and actualization system built for commercial production companies bidding jobs to agencies. Because it lives in Excel, producers keep familiar spreadsheet mechanics while getting AAICP-style bid forms, shooting budgets and actualization built on top. It sells per-installation licences that carry an explicit expiration date: on expiry the licence stops you creating new budgets or modifying bid sections that change the grand total, but the actualization functions keep working so historical jobs remain usable. Its published resources are user guides for versions 2 and 3 plus video tutorials.

KEY FEATURES · Excel-based bid and shooting budget forms for commercials · Actualization against the bid · AAICP-style advertising bid workflows · Per-installation licensing with dated expiry that preserves actualization access · User guides for v2 and v3, video tutorials

PRICING Not published on hotbudget.com — the pricing figure circulating in comparison content is roughly \$100 per Mac installation per year, expiring on January 1 of the following year, with no free tier or trial. Treat the dollar figure as unverified; the licence page does confirm each software product carries an expiration date after which new budget creation is disabled while actualization continues.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Small independent vendor, Los Angeles (support line 818-660-5009). No funding, headcount or customer numbers disclosed. Copyright notice current through 2026, so the product is actively maintained.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (budget) · The Money Room (actualization / budget-vs-actual) · finance

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Entrenched in commercials, where Cinamate has no story at all
- Excel substrate means zero learning curve and infinite ad-hoc flexibility for producers who live in spreadsheets
- Approximately \$100/year is close to free relative to any production budget
- Actualization survives licence expiry — no lock-out of historical jobs

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Spreadsheet architecture: no shared state, no live multi-user, no audit trail worth the name
- No payroll, no POs, no AP, no accounting system
- Mac/Excel dependency; no browser access, no mobile
- No AI, no automation, no script connection
- Opaque pricing and a licence agreement last revised in 2015

<https://hotbudget.com/> · <https://hotbudget.com/license/> · <https://saturation.io/versus/hot-budget> · <https://saturation.io/blog/what-is-the-best-film-budgeting-tool-7-essential-solutions-every-producer-should-know>

Money Penny (Entertainment Partners) www.ep.com/moneypenny DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

EP-owned all-in-one production accounting platform for independent film and TV in the UK, Australia and New Zealand.

Money Penny is EP's indie-facing production accounting product outside the US: online contracting, payroll, purchase orders, invoice approval, digital documentation, live cost management and reporting in one package, with journal import from EP Payroll and real-time integration keeping cost reports current. It is sold into the UK, Australia and New Zealand, supported by EP's Sydney team's knowledge of federal and state employment and tax rules. Money Penny Group also markets standalone payroll and production accounting services.

KEY FEATURES · Online contracting and digital documentation · Payroll integration with journal import from EP Payroll · Purchase orders and invoice approval workflow · Live cost management and reporting · UK, Australia and New Zealand coverage · Local compliance expertise for AU federal and state rules

PRICING Not disclosed — quoted per production.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Acquired by and operated within Entertainment Partners (TPG-backed). EP has delivered payroll to Australian productions for over 30 years. Standalone revenue/headcount not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · The Money Room (live cost management, PO tracking) · finance · contracts / deal memos (online contracting) · producer · taxcredit — UK/AU/NZ incentives

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Purpose-built for exactly Cinamate's stated buyer — independent film and TV — but in territories Cinamate's US-rate-based rigor does not cover
- Contracting, payroll, POs and cost reporting genuinely unified in one package
- Local statutory compliance with people accountable for it
- EP distribution and incentive advisory attached

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Regional; no US coverage under this brand
- No budgeting application — budgets still come from Movie Magic
- No creative tooling, no AI, no automation of the estimate
- Low public product visibility; almost no independent review coverage

<https://www.ep.com/moneypenny/> · <https://www.ep.com/ep-global/australia/> · <https://www.moneypenny-group.com/product> · <https://www.moneypenny-group.com/payroll>

Revolution Entertainment Services (ProBooks / ProHire / ProCal / SetKeeper)

revolutiones.com/probooks DIRECT MEDIUM LIKELY

Independent payroll company with a fully web-based production accounting stack pitched as "script to payroll" for mid-range productions.

Revolution Entertainment Services provides entertainment payroll alongside a proprietary software suite: ProBooks (web-based production accounting with cost tracking, reporting and paperless workflow, marketed as AI-powered), ProHire (digital onboarding and timecards), ProCal (production scheduling) and SetKeeper (production document organization and distribution). ProBooks' distinguishing technical feature is dual reporting — generating reports on both accounting periods and effective dates, which most competitors do not support. The suite is positioned for independent films, digital series, branded content and lower-budget productions, with commentary placing its sweet spot around the \$3-5M budget range.

KEY FEATURES · ProBooks web-based production accounting with cost tracking and paperless AP · Dual reporting by accounting period and effective date · ProHire digital onboarding and timecards · ProCal production scheduling · SetKeeper production document management and distribution · Integrated entertainment payroll services

PRICING Not disclosed — quoted per production, with payroll priced on the standard percent-of-payroll/services basis. Wrapbook's competitive roundup notes some Revolution processes still require manual coordination.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Independent, privately held; funding, headcount and production volume not disclosed or verified.

COLLIDES WITH · The Money Room (cost tracking, PO/AP, cost reports) · finance · producer (scheduling via ProCal, call-sheet-adjacent document distribution via SetKeeper) · contracts / deal memos (ProHire onboarding) · tools (timecards) · workflow / projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Covers script-adjacent through payroll in one vendor relationship, with real payroll at the end
- Dual-basis reporting is a genuine accounting capability Cinamate does not claim
- Browser-based accounting, so no local GPU or desktop install requirement
- Serves the exact \$3-5M indie band Cinamate targets, with humans attached

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Smallest of the substantive payroll players; limited brand reach outside its client base
- No published pricing and reportedly some manual coordination steps
- No budgeting application of Movie Magic/Showbiz depth
- No creative tooling and no AI-native generation
- Thin public product documentation

<https://revolutiones.com/probooks> · <https://revolutiones.com/probooks-corporate> · <https://www.wrapbook.com/blog/best-entertainment-payroll-services> · <https://saturation.io/blog/film-production-accounting-software>

Sargent-Disc (Cast & Crew UK) www.sargent-disc.com DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

The UK production payroll and accounting standard, acquired by Cast & Crew, running the Digital Production Office suite.

Founded in 1986 in Beaconsfield, Sargent-Disc provides payroll, production accounting and software to UK film and television. Its Digital Production Office cloud suite includes Payroll, Payslip and Payscales (UK union and grade rate data), CrewStart for digital crew onboarding and contracts, Digital Purchase Order for PO workflow and approvals, and the Sd Production Card for production spend. It is the UK counterpart to EP's Moneypenny and is now part of Cast & Crew's international arm.

KEY FEATURES · UK PAYE/loan-out payroll for film and TV · Payscales: UK union and grade rate data · CrewStart digital onboarding, contracts and start paperwork · Digital Purchase Order with approval workflow · Sd Production Card for production spend · Digital Production Office cloud platform

PRICING Not disclosed — quoted per production on the standard payroll-services basis.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded 1986; processed over £1bn in payroll payments in 2017, described at the time as a major portion of UK production spend. Sale to Cast & Crew agreed November 2019 (Cast & Crew's fifth acquisition in four years and first under EQT ownership); the brand and Beaconsfield staff were retained. Terms not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · contracts / deal memos (CrewStart contracts and start paperwork) · The Money Room (Digital Purchase Order, production card spend) · finance · producer · tools (timecards) · taxcredit — UK production relief sits outside Cinamate's 21-jurisdiction claim unless it is covered

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Owns UK union/grade rate data and UK statutory compliance — an area where Cinamate's US-centric SAG/DGA/WGA/IATSE citations do not transfer
- Genuine international coverage backed by Cast & Crew
- Digital Purchase Order is a mature, widely used PO product in its own right
- Decades of relationships with UK studios and the Production Guild

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Regional: UK-focused, so no answer for a producer working across multiple territories from one system
- No budgeting application; no creative tooling
- Product surface split across several legacy-branded modules
- Now one brand inside a large PE-owned group, with the pace that implies

<https://www.sargent-disc.com/> · <https://www.sargent-disc.com/about-us/> · <https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20191121005248/en/Sargent-Disc-Agrees-Sale-Cast-Crew> · <https://www.screendaily.com/news/uks-sargent-disc-acquired-by-us-outfit-cast-and-crew/5144958.article>

Topsheet www.topsheet.io DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Self-serve entertainment payroll EOR with the most transparent pricing in the category — a flat 2% of payroll with a \$50 minimum per batch.

Topsheet runs production payroll as employer of record across all 50 states and territories, handling federal and state tax filing, union and non-union payroll (SAG-AFTRA, IATSE, DGA, WGA, Teamsters), and workers' compensation. Around the payroll core it bundles production-office functions: automated call sheets, digital timecards, scheduling, background/extras casting and payment, and a GPS check-in feature for background actors. It supports feature films, series, commercials, live events, voice-over and music videos, from one-day shoots to large budgets, and ships a mobile app (listed on Google Play). Its distinguishing move is publishing its full fee structure on the homepage — rare in this category.

KEY FEATURES · Flat, published 2% payroll handling fee, \$50 minimum per batch · EOR across all 50 states plus territories; tax filing and compliance · Union and non-union payroll; workers' comp in all 50 states · Background actor management with GPS check-in · Automated call sheets, digital timecards and scheduling · Free setup, free union handling, free check/ACH processing · Mobile app

PRICING Published: flat 2% of payroll with a \$50 minimum handling fee per payroll batch. Setup fees, union handling and check/ACH processing are free. Statutory costs shown separately (FUTA 0.6%, Social Security 6.2%, Medicare 1.45%); workers' comp estimated per production type and higher with stunts.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Funding, headcount and volume not disclosed on the site; a Crunchbase profile exists but no round detail was verified. Independent, small relative to EP/Cast & Crew.

COLLIDES WITH · The Money Room (cost of labor feeding the cost report) · finance · producer (call sheets — direct overlap with the producer room's call-sheet function) · casting (background/extras casting and payment) · contracts / deal memos (onboarding/startwork) · tools (timecards) · today / production (on-set check-in)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Actually pays crew and files taxes; transparent, defensible pricing a solo producer can model in advance
- Bundles call sheets, timecards and extras management with payroll — the same all-in-one instinct as Cinamate but with the money rail included
- GPS check-in and a mobile app address exactly the on-set gap Cinamate admits to
- Self-serve, no invite required

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No budgeting application, no cost report of the depth EP/GreenSlate/Saturation provide
- No creative tooling of any kind
- Undisclosed scale and funding; thin public track record on large union features
- 2% is above Wrapbook's reported 0.75-1.5% band for larger payrolls, so it loses on price as budgets grow

<https://www.topsheet.io/> · <https://www.topsheet.io/faq> · <https://www.topsheet.io/edu/payroll/entertainment-payroll> · <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=io.topsheet.entertainment.payroll>

CASHét (Entertainment Partners) www.ep.com ADJACENT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Production purchasing-card and digital AP platform, acquired by Entertainment Partners in June 2025 and now the payments layer of the EP stack.

CASHét issues branded purchasing cards (p-cards) to department heads and processes digital accounts-payable payments through CASHétPay, with built-in fraud prevention, expense envelope approvals and automatic import of card expenses into production accounting. Before the acquisition it integrated with Cast & Crew's PSL+ as well; it now imports directly into EP SmartAccounting with digital payment approval. EP has said it intends to expand CASHét into additional global production hubs.

KEY FEATURES · Production purchasing cards issued per department/crew member · CASHétPay digital accounts-payable payments · Automated expense envelope approvals · Built-in fraud prevention controls · Automatic expense import into EP SmartAccounting · Historic integration with Cast & Crew PSL+

PRICING Not disclosed. Card programs of this type earn on interchange plus program fees; no published rate card.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Used on 2,500+ studio and independent productions annually per EP's acquisition announcement.

Acquisition agreement announced 2 June 2025; transaction closed 20 June 2025 (advisors: William Blair, Ropes & Gray). Terms not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · The Money Room (PO tracking, live cost reporting — CASHét is where the spend actually originates) · finance · producer (department-level spend against budget lines)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Captures spend at the point of purchase rather than reconstructing it from invoices afterwards — structurally more accurate than any post-hoc cost report
- Fraud controls and spend limits enforced at the card, not in a dashboard
- Now inside EP, so it is bundled into the incumbent stack at no extra sales friction
- Proven at 2,500+ productions a year

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Payments only — no budgeting, no scheduling, no cost modeling of its own
- Depends on SmartAccounting or PSL+ to be useful; not a standalone system of record
- Nothing creative, nothing predictive, no estimate learning

<https://www.ep.com/news/entertainment-partners-to-acquire-cash%C3%A9t-strengthening-end-to-end-production-finance-offerings/> · <https://www.ep.com/news/entertainment-partners-acquires-cashet-payments/> · <https://variety.com/2025/film/news/entertainment-partners-acquires-cashet-payments-1236416017/> · <https://www.thewrap.com/entertainment-partners-acquires-production-payment-and-expenses-platform-cashet/>

Rivet AI rivetai.com **ADJACENT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

AI pre-production pipeline priced per project, running script through breakdown, stripboard, budget topsheet and tax-incentive scenarios.

Rivet AI runs script, breakdown, schedule and budget off one screenplay so that changing the script propagates through the pipeline. Its Studio tier delivers stripboards, DOOD (day-out-of-days), budget topsheets, a visual production roadmap and tax incentive scenario modeling, with AI schedule generation and AI budget analysis that can be re-run. It sells per project rather than per seat, and states access controls, encryption, MFA, workspace RBAC and that scripts are never used to train AI — an unusually explicit privacy posture for the category.

KEY FEATURES · One screenplay driving breakdown, schedule and budget in a linked pipeline · Stripboards and DOOD · Budget topsheets with AI budget analysis and reruns · Tax incentive scenario modeling · Per-project pricing with pooled AI credits on Enterprise · Encryption, MFA, workspace RBAC; scripts not used for model training

PRICING Published and per-project. Free: \$0, up to 5 scenes, 0 AI credits, 1 seat. Writer: \$49.99 per project, 30 AI credits, 2 seats, full script workflow with tags, revisions and snapshots. Studio: \$150 per project, 100 AI credits, 9 seats, stripboards, DOOD, budget topsheets. Enterprise: custom with pooled credits and multi-project volume agreements.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Independent AI startup; funding, headcount and customer numbers not disclosed in sources I verified.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · boards · producer (budget/stripboard/DOOD) · The Money Room (topsheet forecasting) · finance · taxcredit (incentive scenario modeling vs Cinamate's 21 jurisdictions) · timeline · workflow / projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Per-project pricing (\$150 for a Studio project) is the most directly comparable model to Cinamate's ~\$110-per-feature quote — and it is public, self-serve and available today
- Explicit script-privacy commitment (no training on user scripts) addresses the exact anxiety Cinamate's 'private studio' positioning targets
- Tax incentive scenario modeling built into the budget flow
- Change-propagation from script through schedule and budget is the same pipeline logic Cinamate claims

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Pre-production only — no actuals, POs, cost reports, payroll, editorial, VFX or delivery
- AI-credit metering means a heavily revised feature can cost more than the headline number
- Estimate rigor unstated — no disclosed calibration set, failure rate or confidence bands
- Small, unproven company with no disclosed funding or customer base

<https://rivetai.com/en/pricing> · <https://rivetai.com/en> · <https://saturation.io/blog/ai-film-budgeting-software> · <https://techbriefly.com/ai-tools/rivetai/>

SyncOnSet (Entertainment Partners) www.ep.com/synconset **ADJACENT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

Emmy-winning continuity, wardrobe, props and asset-tracking platform with budget/inventory money tracking, owned by EP.

SyncOnSet manages continuity, inventory and budgets from prep through wrap: automatic script breakdown with real-time revisions, digital management of costumes, hair and makeup looks, props and set pieces, and Asset Hub for project-level asset management that replaces reconciling assets with paper ledgers or Excel against accounting. It works on or offline from a mobile app. Founded in 2012 as Wymsee in Culver City, it won a 2016 Primetime Engineering Emmy and was acquired by Entertainment Partners, which folded it into its production management line.

KEY FEATURES · Automatic script breakdown with real-time revision handling · Digital continuity for costumes, hair/makeup looks, props, set pieces · Asset Hub project-level asset and inventory reconciliation with accounting · Mobile app with offline working · Integration into the EP production management stack

PRICING Not disclosed — sold through EP, quoted per production.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded 2012 (as Wymsee), Culver City. 2016 Primetime Engineering Emmy Award. Acquired by Entertainment Partners; terms not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · wardrobe · props · sets · boards / breakdown (script breakdown with revisions) · The Money Room / finance (asset and inventory reconciliation against accounting) · today / production (on-set continuity capture)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Genuine on-set mobile app with offline capability — the single clearest gap in Cinamate's own list
- Ties wardrobe/props/set assets to money, which is where those departments actually leak budget
- Emmy-recognized, studio-deployed, inside the EP sales machine
- Handles script revisions in real time on a live production, not a one-shot breakdown

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Departmental, not a whole-production system — no budget, no payroll, no cost report of its own
- No creative generation, no editorial, no delivery
- Requires a real crew with department heads; useless to a single operator
- Sold only through EP; no self-serve

<https://www.ep.com/synconset/> · <https://www.synconset.com/home/> · <https://www.ep.com/news/entertainment-partners-acquires-synconset-technologies/> · <https://support.synconset.com/article/rycr5go463-accounting-onboarding>

Dolly Card www.dollycard.com ADJACENT LOW LIKELY

Startup issuing instant virtual cards to crew, tied to individual budget line items, with live producer visibility by department.

Dolly Card issues virtual cards to every crew member with one click, each linked to a budget line item so expenses are captured at the point of sale rather than through paper invoices, cash floats, personal reimbursement and manual expense entry. It automates reconciliation and gives producers live visibility into spend by department and line item across pre-production, on-set and post. It also publishes a free state-by-state US production incentives reference and comparison content against Saturation and other production finance tools.

KEY FEATURES · Instant virtual cards issued per crew member · Cards mapped to specific budget line items · Point-of-sale expense capture; automated reconciliation · Live producer visibility by department and line item · Free US production incentive reference pages by state

PRICING Not disclosed publicly. Card economics of this type are interchange-driven; no published subscription rate.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded 2023, headquartered in Boston, MA per Crunchbase/PitchBook profiles. Funding, headcount and volume not disclosed or verified.

COLLIDES WITH · The Money Room (PO tracking, live cost reporting, self-calibrating estimates from real spend) · finance · producer (budget line-item control) · taxcredit (its incentive reference pages)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Line-item-linked cards make budget-vs-actual accurate by construction rather than by reconciliation
- Solves the crew reimbursement pain that indie producers feel most acutely
- Free, self-serve incentive content driving inbound; publicly reachable product

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Very young and small; no verifiable funding or customer scale
- Cards only — no budgeting engine, no accounting, no payroll, no union compliance
- No creative tooling
- Depends on crew actually carrying cards, which a single-operator production does not have

<https://www.dollycard.com/> · <https://www.dollycard.com/compare/dolly-vs-saturation> · <https://www.dollycard.com/production-incentives/us/oklahoma> · <https://www.crunchbase.com/organization/dolly-card>

Exactuals www.cnb.com/business-banking/media/why-city-national/exactuals-agillink-guilds.html

INDIRECT

LOW

LIKELY

Bank-owned SaaS that automates high-volume residual and participation payments for guilds and studios.

Exactuals is a SaaS platform that automates the manual administrative work guilds and studios face when processing complex, high-volume recurring non-employee payments — principally residuals and participations. Payors transmit payments electronically and payees receive direct deposit in a fraction of the traditional time. It sits within City National Bank's entertainment banking business.

KEY FEATURES · Automated residual and participation payment processing · High-volume recurring non-employee payments · Electronic transmission and direct deposit to payees · Payee data management and tracking · Guild and studio workflows

PRICING Not disclosed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Owned within City National Bank (an RBC company) entertainment banking. Headcount and volume not disclosed in the sources I reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · finance / The Money Room (the long tail of post-release payment obligations) · contracts / deal memos (participation terms) · distribution deliverables and release economics, indirectly

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Handles the obligations that outlive the production — residuals and participations — which Cinamate does not model at all
- Bank-grade payment infrastructure and compliance
- Direct relationships with the guilds whose rates Cinamate cites

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Back-office payment utility only; no budgeting, accounting, production or creative function
- Serves guilds and studios, not independent producers
- Invisible to Cinamate's target buyer until long after delivery

<https://www.cnb.com/business-banking/media/why-city-national/exactuals-agillink-guilds.html>

XR (Extreme Reach) www.xr.global

INDIRECT

LOW

LIKELY

Talent payments, residuals and rights-tracking platform for advertising and entertainment — first to support paying AI-generated performers.

XR runs ad production delivery, talent payments and rights tracking, and is described as the leader in celebrity payments for commercial production and advertising. It also operates entertainment payroll and residuals processing. In April 2026 it announced a first-of-its-kind solution for paying AI-generated performers in advertising, aligned to the 2025 SAG-AFTRA Commercials Contract, supporting two new performer categories: Digital Replicas and Synthetic Performers.

KEY FEATURES · Talent payments and celebrity payments for advertising · Residuals processing · Rights and usage tracking across campaigns · Entertainment payroll · Support for SAG-AFTRA Digital Replica and Synthetic Performer categories (April 2026)

PRICING Not disclosed; enterprise/agency contracts.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Global platform serving agencies, brands and production companies; specific revenue, headcount and volume not verified in the sources I reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · contracts / deal memos (talent agreements and usage terms) · clearance (rights tracking) · The Money Room / finance (talent payment obligations) · casting, indirectly

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Already solved the payment and rights-clearance problem for synthetic performers under a live union contract — the single most acute compliance question facing an AI-generated film, and Cinamate's clearance room has no equivalent public position
- Owns the rights-tracking record across usage windows, which is what creates liability years later
- Established with agencies and brands at scale

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Advertising-centric; not a film production accounting system
- No budgeting, no cost reporting, no production workflow
- Nothing creative or generative
- Irrelevant to a producer who is not paying performers

<https://www.xr.global/press-releases/xr-extreme-reach-expands-celebrity-payments-to-support-ai-performers-in-advertising> · <https://xr.global/platform/creative-production/entertainment-payroll> · <https://helpcenter.xr.global/hc/en-us/articles/37704317456020-Residuals>

ALSO COMPETING IN THIS CATEGORY (PROFILED ELSEWHERE)

Filmustage **ADJACENT** **MEDIUM** — AI pre-production platform that auto-generates a script breakdown and then a budget from it, with published per-seat pricing. *(full profile under “AI script breakdown & AI pre-production”)*

Largo.ai **INDIRECT** **MEDIUM** — Swiss AI analytics platform producing financial breakdowns, revenue scenarios and automatic recoupment schedules for film financing. *(full profile under “Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incentive tooling”)*

Slated **INDIRECT** **LOW** — Independent film packaging and financing marketplace with script and financial analysis attached — the substitute for Cinamate's investors room. *(full profile under “Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incentive tooling”)*

Studiovity **ADJACENT** **LOW** — Emerging non-US (India-focused) pre-production suite marketing AI script breakdown, scheduling and budgeting to a price-sensitive market. *(full profile under “AI script breakdown & AI pre-production”)*

§13 Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incentive tooling

Market read · This is the most crowded and most credentialed category Cinamate touches, and the one where its headline rigor claims are weakest on inspection. Three findings matter most. First, published accuracy is NOT a Cinamate differentiator — it is table stakes. Cinelytic claims 88%+ title-level accuracy across 80 territories (April 2026 launch); ScriptBook claims 87% greenlight accuracy vs. a 36% industry baseline; Largo.ai is reported at 80-82%; Vista/Cinema Intelligence publishes +/-15% opening-weekend accuracy; Gower Street publicly grades its annual forecasts (2024 within 5%, 2025 tracking within 2%). Cinamate's genuinely rarer move is disclosing a *failure* rate (15.5%) rather than only a success rate — but ForecastFilm goes further by publishing every forecast as a low/high range with a confidence tier and grading each one publicly after the weekend. Ranges and confidence bands are also standard at Boxoffice Pro (best/worst case). Second, the 3,708-film calibration set is small for this field. Slated's financial model uses 10,000+ released films, Vault AI 60,000+ titles, ScriptBook 30,000+ scripts, OpusData 100,000+ bankability profiles. Third, the taxcredit room's 21 jurisdictions is the clearest deficit anywhere in Cinamate. Wrapbook covers 39 states plus DC, Puerto Rico, federal and Canada — free. Shamel Studio covers 52 US jurisdictions plus a waterfall calculator — free. EP and Cast & Crew cover worldwide. Cinamate is charging for less coverage than incumbents give away, against payroll companies whose incentive data is a loss-leader for a much larger business. Direction of travel: consolidation (Cinelytic absorbing Jumpcut; Vista absorbing Cinema Intelligence) and incentive data commoditizing to free.

Entertainment Partners (EP) Production Incentives www.ep.com/production-incentives

ADJACENT

CRITICAL

VERIFIED

The industry-standard global production incentive database, estimator and jurisdiction comparison suite from the largest entertainment payroll company.

Maintains a worldwide production incentives database spanning the US, Canada, Europe, Africa & Middle East, Asia, Australia/NZ/Fiji and Latin America, with detail on eligible production types, labor requirements, minimum spends, application requirements and PDF exports. Offers a US/Canada Incentives Estimator that calculates potential savings by location, a Jurisdiction Comparison Tool for side-by-side analysis of up to three jurisdictions, and an interactive global incentives map. Publishes regular incentive-update roundups (e.g. Spring 2026).

KEY FEATURES · Global incentives map across 8 world regions · US and Canada tax credit estimator · Three-way jurisdiction comparison tool · Per-jurisdiction detail: minimum spend, caps, labor requirements, application steps · PDF export of jurisdiction summaries · Quarterly global incentive update publications

PRICING Incentive research tools are free to use on ep.com. Underlying payroll, production accounting and incentive advisory services are enterprise-priced via sales contact (US 818.955.6242).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Entertainment Partners is the dominant entertainment payroll and production finance company in North America, serving the large majority of studio and independent productions. Incentive tools are a marketing loss-leader for that core business.

COLLIDES WITH · taxcredit room (21 jurisdictions) — direct and unfavorable collision · producer module (budget/stripboard) · finance module · The Money Room cost reporting

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Global coverage across 8 regions versus Cinamate's 21 jurisdictions
- Free, with no login or invite gate — Cinamate is invite-only private beta
- Authoritative: the data is maintained by the company that actually files these credits
- Deep per-jurisdiction fields (labor requirements, application mechanics, transferability) beyond a headline percentage
- Continuously updated with published change roundups

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Research tools are static reference material, not wired into a live production budget
- No script-to-screen workflow, no generation, no editorial
- Monetization requires engaging EP's payroll/advisory business
- Tools are separate from the budget the producer is actually building

<https://www.ep.com/production-incentives/incentives-map/> · <https://www.ep.com/production-incentives/us/estimator/> · <https://www.ep.com/production-incentives/jurisdiction-comparison/> · <https://www.ep.com/blog/film-tv-tax-incentive-u>

Largo.ai home.largo.ai**DIRECT****HIGH****VERIFIED**

Swiss AI script-and-talent analytics platform producing financial forecasts and casting recommendations from a screenplay.

Ingests a screenplay and analyzes its 'ingredients' — genre recipe, emotional response curve, character and quality analysis, age suitability, demographics — then produces casting recommendations and territory-level box office/distribution financial forecasts. Reported accuracy is 80-82%. Newer tiers add storyboard generation and simulated focus groups. Positioned explicitly at independent producers seeking financing, and claims to triple progression rates of independent projects from development into production.

KEY FEATURES · Script-ingredient analysis (genre recipe, emotion, demographics) · Territory-level box office gross forecasts · Casting and talent recommendation engine · Comparative analysis against similar films · Storyboard generation and simulated focus groups (Standard-3+)

PRICING \$12,000/year total across all Standard tiers, differing only in downpayment: Standard-1 \$1,188 down, Standard-2 \$2,388, Standard-3 \$3,588, Standard-4 \$5,988, Premium \$12,000 upfront. Quotas run from 1 project/2 analyses per month/1 user up to 25 projects/20 analyses/3 users.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Swiss-based, spun out of the Sofy.tv ecosystem. Reported 80-82% forecast accuracy by third-party coverage. Company revenue and funding not disclosed in sources reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · investors room · writer module · casting module · boards (storyboard generation) · the 3,708-film sales model

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Published, transparent per-tier pricing on a public page
- Casting/talent recommendation engine Cinamate does not claim
- Simulated focus groups and audience-emotion modeling
- Established European market presence and named track record on specific title predictions

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- \$12,000/year is roughly 100x Cinamate's ~\$110-per-feature quote
- No accuracy or training-set size disclosed on its own pricing page
- Analysis-only — no budgeting, scheduling, editorial, or delivery
- Tight quotas (as few as 2 analyses/month on entry tier)
- No confidence bands published

<https://home.largo.io/standard-pricing-2/> · <https://home.largo.ai/artificial-intelligence-and-the-movie-industry/> · <https://fromtheheartproductions.com/empowering-filmmakers-leveraging-largo-ai-for-film-success/> · <https://home.largo.io/largo-correctly-predicted-the-box-office-3-months-before-the-release/>

Shamel Studio (free waterfall + incentive tools) www.shamelstudio.com/tools/film-tax-incentives**DIRECT****HIGH****VERIFIED**

Free interactive US film tax incentive map covering 52 jurisdictions plus a free film waterfall and profit calculator.

Publishes a free interactive map covering all 50 US states plus Washington DC and Puerto Rico — 52 jurisdictions — showing every US film tax credit, rebate, cap, minimum spend, payroll fringe rate and refundability status, current as of April 2026. Also offers a free Film Waterfall Calculator that models how incentives flow through distribution fees, P&A recoupment and profit participation, and a movie profit calculator aimed at producers, financiers and film students. The company additionally sells production management software covering scheduling, budgeting, call sheets and production reports.

KEY FEATURES · 52 US jurisdictions covered, free · Refundability, caps, minimum spend and payroll fringe rates per jurisdiction · Free film recoupment waterfall calculator · Free movie profit calculator · Adjacent production management software: scheduling, budgeting, call sheets, production reports

PRICING Incentive map, waterfall calculator and profit calculator are completely free. Production management software pricing not disclosed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Small independent operator; founders not disclosed on the pages reviewed. Data currency stated as April 2026.

COLLIDES WITH · taxcredit room (21 jurisdictions vs. 52, free) · investors room — waterfall modeling is Cinamate's stated method for deriving the 2-2.5x breakeven rule · producer module (budget/striboard/call sheets) · finance module · timeline / production scheduling

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- 52 US jurisdictions free versus Cinamate's 21 behind an invite-only gate — a 2.5x coverage advantage at zero cost
- Gives away waterfall modeling, which Cinamate presents as proprietary rigor underpinning its 2-2.5x breakeven claim
- No signup, no invite, no GPU required — instantly usable
- Explicit data-currency date stated (April 2026)
- Also competes on scheduling, budgeting and call sheets

<https://www.shamelstudio.com/tools/film-tax-incentives> · <https://www.shamelstudio.com/tools/waterfall> · <https://www.shamelstudio.com/blog/film-recoupment-waterfall-guide>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- US-only; no international jurisdictions
- No sales forecasting model, no calibration set, no confidence bands
- Calculators are standalone, not integrated into a production system
- Small unnamed operator with no verifiable track record
- No creative, generation, or post capability

Slated get.slated.com **DIRECT** **HIGH** **VERIFIED**

Film packaging, financing and distribution marketplace pairing human script scoring with an ML financial model built on 10,000+ released films.

Combines a human-read Script Analysis (three independent assessors, 18+ hours per draft, 10+ pages of notes, 100-point scale, Pass/Consider/Recommend across ten attributes) with a machine-learning Financial Analysis trained on results from more than 10,000 released films. Inputs include production and marketing budget, genre, MPAA rating, release date, theater count and team composition. A free Team Analysis scores attached talent on commercial and artistic potential. A composite proprietary Project Score gates access to its investor marketplace; projects scoring 75+ may qualify for Executive Producer Services.

KEY FEATURES · Human script scoring on a 100-point scale with 10+ pages of notes · ML financial projections from a 10,000+ film corpus · 'Likelihood Certified Fresh' Rotten Tomatoes probability · Free auto-updating Team Score for attached talent · Investor marketplace with vetted introductions · Screening Analysis for finished narratives and documentaries

PRICING Active Project Listing \$34.99/mo; Script Analysis \$495; Financial Analysis \$495; Script+Financial bundle \$795; EP Consulting \$595/mo; individual membership free. [vendor-verified]

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Launched 2012. Co-founder and Executive Chairman Stephan Paternot. 25,000 accepted introductions across 2,600 projects; 1,329 listed films released, 269 theatrically grossing \$660M+ worldwide; 50+ films financed. Raised \$2M Series B (2012), latest round Dec 2023; total funding not publicly disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · investors room — the single most direct collision in this category · the 3,708-film sales model calibration · writer module (script scoring) · screening module · finance module

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- 10,000+ film ML corpus versus Cinamate's 3,708 — nearly 3x the calibration base
- An actual investor marketplace with 25,000 documented introductions and 50+ films financed; Cinamate's investors room has no counterparty network
- Fourteen-year track record with verifiable released-title outcomes
- Fully published, itemized pricing
- Human expert readers alongside the model — a credibility layer Cinamate cannot match single-operator

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No confidence intervals or margin of error disclosed; exact Project Score weighting is proprietary
- Per-draft pricing gets expensive across iterations versus Cinamate's flat model
- Slow: 20 business days standard turnaround versus Cinamate's claimed 9h 12m
- Analysis and matchmaking only — no production, post, or delivery tooling
- Gatekept: low-scoring projects are effectively excluded

<https://get.slated.com/analysis/> · <https://get.slated.com/> · <https://get.slated.com/successes/> · <https://www.crunchbase.com/organization/slated>

Cast & Crew / Media Services Production Incentives

www.castandcrew.com/services/financial-services/incentives-guide **ADJACENT** **HIGH** **VERIFIED**

Worldwide incentives map, comparison tool and the long-running TIP guide from the other major entertainment payroll incumbent.

Cast & Crew Financial Services publishes an interactive Production Incentive Map with up-to-the-minute tax credits, rebates and grants worldwide, plus a Production Incentive Comparison Tool supporting 'what-if' scenarios and side-by-side comparison of up

to three jurisdictions. Its annual TIP (The Incentives Program) guide is a long-standing reference for US and international incentives. Media Services, now part of Cast & Crew, maintains a parallel Production Incentives Database with state-by-state expertise and advisory support for monetizing credits.

KEY FEATURES · Worldwide incentive map with tax credits, rebates and grants · Multi-jurisdiction comparison tool (up to three side by side) · 'What-if' budget scenario modeling against incentives · Annual TIP guide (PDF) covering US and international programs · Media Services Production Incentives Database · Credit brokerage and monetization advisory

PRICING Map, comparison tool and TIP guide are free. Incentive advisory, financing and credit monetization services are enterprise-priced via sales.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Cast & Crew is one of the two dominant entertainment payroll companies in North America alongside EP; it acquired Media Services, consolidating two incentive databases under one owner.

COLLIDES WITH · taxcredit room · producer module (budget/striplead) · finance module · investors room (credit monetization as a financing source)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Worldwide coverage versus 21 jurisdictions
- Free access with no invite gate
- 'What-if' scenario modeling against a real budget
- Backed by actual credit brokerage — they monetize the credits, not just count them
- Decades of institutional incentive expertise

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Reference tooling rather than an integrated production system
- No forecasting, sales estimates or investor modeling
- No creative or post capability whatsoever
- Some published guides lag current legislative changes

<https://www.castandcrew.com/services/financial-services/incentives-map/> · <https://www.castandcrew.com/services/financial-services/incentives-guide/> · <https://www.mediaservices.com/production-incentives/production-incentive-database/> · <https://www.castandcrew.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/03/2024-TIP-Guide.pdf>

Comscore Movies www.comscore.com/Products/Movies

ADJACENT

HIGH

VERIFIED

The industry's system of record for theatrical box office measurement, 50 years old and used by every major studio.

Measures box office performance in more than 70 countries, delivering theatrical grosses, audience demographics, marketing impact and global release tracking. Product line includes Box Office Essentials and International Box Office Essentials (the reporting backbone), PostTrak exit polling for real-time audience demographics and interest drivers, Theatrical Distribution System (TDS) for release management, Exhibitor Management System, Cinema ACE for digital cinema operations, and Hollywood Software. Comscore data underpins third-party forecasting products including Gower Street's FORECAST.

KEY FEATURES · Box office measurement across 70+ countries · Box Office Essentials / International Box Office Essentials · PostTrak real-time exit polling and demographics · Theatrical Distribution System for release management · Exhibitor Management System and Cinema ACE · Licensed data feeds powering third-party forecasting tools

PRICING Not disclosed — enterprise subscription via sales.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Celebrated 50 years of movie measurement in April 2026. Used by every major studio, mini-major and prominent independent distributor worldwide, plus leading cinema circuits. Publicly traded parent (Comscore, Inc.).

COLLIDES WITH · the 3,708-film sales model — Comscore is the ground truth that model would need · distribution deliverables · screening module · investors room (comps and actuals)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- It IS the actual box office data; Cinamate's model is downstream of data like this
- 70+ country measurement no startup can replicate
- 50-year institutional position and universal studio adoption
- PostTrak gives real audience response, not modeled response
- Publicly traded, auditable, with real security and compliance posture

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Measurement and reporting, not forecasting — it licenses data to forecasters rather than predicting itself
- Extremely expensive and enterprise-gated; unavailable to a single independent producer
- No script, budget, production or post tooling
- No confidence bands because it does not forecast

<https://www.comscore.com/Products/Movies> · <https://www.comscore.com/Products/Movies/Global-Box-Office-Reporting> · <https://www.comscore.com/Insights/Press-Releases/2026/4/Five-Decades-of-Box-Office-Intelligence> · <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/PostTrak>

Gower Street Analytics gower.st ADJACENT HIGH VERIFIED

Theatrical release-dating and box office simulation platform covering 85+ markets, whose public annual forecasts are graded against actuals.

Its FORECAST web application gives theatrical distribution executives daily box office predictions for each market, built from expert analysis, Comscore historical data and the live release calendar, letting them simulate complex release-dating moves in seconds across 85+ markets. Each film page shows comparison titles and a graph of how estimates changed over time. Gower Street also publishes headline global box office forecasts — it projected \$35bn for 2026, later revised to \$34.7bn ahead of CinemaCon.

KEY FEATURES · FORECAST box office simulation across 85+ markets · Daily per-market predictions · Release-date scenario simulation and competitive impact modeling · Estimate-history graphs showing forecast drift over time · Comparison title sets per film · Public annual global box office forecasts

PRICING Not disclosed publicly; a pricing page exists but figures are not published.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded 2015. Partnered with Comscore, which expanded the relationship to include film comparisons in Box Office Essentials. Track record: 2024 early forecast landed within 5% of the actual global year-end result a year ahead; 2025 tracking within 2% of its original \$33bn forecast.

COLLIDES WITH · the sales model / P10-P90 confidence bands · distribution deliverables and release strategy · investors room · festivals (release timing)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Publicly graded forecast accuracy against real outcomes year after year — within 2-5%, verifiable by anyone
- 85+ markets versus Cinamate's undisclosed territorial scope
- Shows how estimates changed over time, exposing its own forecast drift — more transparent than a static confidence band
- Backed by Comscore's actual data; formally partnered, not scraped
- Used by real theatrical distribution executives

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Does not publish per-title confidence intervals or accuracy metrics on its product page
- Theatrical only — no ancillary, streaming or waterfall modeling
- Pricing entirely opaque
- Distribution-side tool; no development, production, or investor-facing modeling
- No script or production tooling of any kind

<https://gower.st/forecast/> · <https://gower.st/articles/forecast-2026-gower-street-announces-35-billion-global-box-office-estimate/> · <https://www.screendaily.com/news/gower-street-decreases-2026-global-box-office-forecast-to-347bn/5215572.article> · <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/comscore-expands-gower-street-analytics-partnership-to-include-film-comparisons-in-box-office-essentials-300977320.html>

Wrapbook Production Incentive Center www.wrapbook.com/production-incentives ADJACENT HIGH

VERIFIED

Free, AI-assisted US production incentive database and finder attached to a modern production payroll and accounting platform.

Provides a completely free interactive incentive database covering US states and cities plus federal incentives, with an Incentive Finder that recommends applicable programs from project details, a state map, a side-by-side comparison tool, a searchable government forms database, and an AI-powered expert chatbot that answers incentive questions from current legislation. Wrapbook itself is an all-in-one production platform covering crew onboarding, payroll, accounts payable, production accounting and analytics.

KEY FEATURES · Free incentive database, 39 states plus DC, Puerto Rico and federal · AI chatbot trained on current incentive legislation · Incentive Finder — recommends programs from project parameters · Multi-state comparison tool · Federal, state and local forms database · Integrated with live payroll and production accounting

PRICING Production Incentive Center is completely free. Core Wrapbook payroll/accounting pricing not disclosed publicly; contact sales.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Well-funded modern challenger to EP and Cast & Crew in entertainment payroll. Covers 39 states plus DC and Puerto Rico as of 2026, against a landscape returning 15-45% of qualified spend.

COLLIDES WITH · taxcredit room · producer module · finance module · The Money Room (live cost reporting, PO tracking) · contracts/deal memos and crew onboarding

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- 41+ US jurisdictions free versus Cinamate's 21 paid
- Incentive data connects to real payroll and accounting rather than sitting in a separate room
- AI chatbot over live legislation is a genuinely current data pipeline
- Explicitly warns its AI can be inaccurate — a transparency posture Cinamate does not match
- Established company with public team, security posture and real customers

<https://www.wrapbook.com/production-incentives> · <https://www.wrapbook.com/production-incentives/compare-states> · <https://www.wrapbook.com/production-incentives/us/federal> · <https://www.wrapbook.com/blog/film-industry-tax-incentives>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- US-centric; far thinner outside North America
- No forecasting or sales model at all
- No creative tooling — no script, boards, editorial or generation
- Requires being a payroll customer to get full value

ForecastFilm www.forecastfilm.com DIRECT MEDIUM LIKELY

Free, fully explainable opening-weekend forecasts published as ranges with confidence tiers and publicly graded after the fact.

Publishes opening-weekend box office forecasts with full reasoning attached before the weekend, then grades them after it, tracking accuracy in public. Forecasts are issued as ranges — a low and a high estimate — with a confidence tier (low/medium/high) reflecting data availability and comp density, where high confidence means the model found dense comparables. It explicitly refuses a black-box posture: inputs are listed, comprising TMDb metadata, prior-film performance for every named cast and crew member, budget vs. comp-budget cohorts, MPAA rating, release window, competitive slate, and trailer-view-to-opening conversion for same-genre comps. Paid tiers cover script-stage forecasts for writers, project-level P&L for producers, and embeddable forecasts for creators.

KEY FEATURES · Forecasts published as low/high ranges with confidence tiers · Publicly tracked and graded accuracy after each weekend · Full reasoning and input list disclosed per forecast · Script-stage forecasts (paid tier) · Project-level P&L for producers (paid tier) · Embeddable forecasts for creators (paid tier)

PRICING Every weekend prediction is free with reasoning attached. Paid tiers exist for script-stage forecasts, producer P&L and embeddable widgets; specific prices not published in sources reviewed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Small/independent; operator not identified. Site returned HTTP 403 to automated fetch during research, so details come from indexed search content — treat scale as unverified.

COLLIDES WITH · the sales model with P10-P90 confidence bands — the single most direct challenge to Cinamate's claimed differentiator · investors room (project-level P&L) · writer module (script-stage forecasts)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Publishes ranges AND confidence tiers AND grades every forecast publicly — a stronger transparency stack than Cinamate's disclosed 15.5% failure rate, because the record is externally checkable
- Lists every model input explicitly; Cinamate's calibration method is asserted, not shown
- Core forecasts are free with no invite gate
- Directly proves confidence bands are not a Cinamate innovation

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Opening-weekend theatrical focus only; no ancillary or full-lifecycle revenue modeling
- No disclosed training-set size to compare against Cinamate's 3,708 films
- Unknown operator, no verifiable company or track record; scale unverified
- No production, incentive, post or delivery tooling
- Paid tier pricing not published

<https://www.forecastfilm.com/>

ScriptBook (and DeepStory) www.scriptbook.io DIRECT MEDIUM LIKELY

Patented AI screenplay analysis and box office prediction since 2014, claiming 87% greenlight accuracy against a 36% industry baseline.

Analyzes screenplays across 6,000+ parameters to produce, in under 24 hours, a full report covering box office prediction, territorial forecasts, target demographics, story DNA, character analysis, genre insights and market positioning. Claims validation

against real Hollywood outcomes at 87% greenlight accuracy versus an industry rate of 36%. The team also built DeepStory, a generative story platform trained on 30,000+ scripts.

KEY FEATURES · Screenplay analysis across 6,000+ parameters · Box office and territoriality prediction from script alone · Audience demographic and character analysis · Sub-24-hour full report turnaround · DeepStory generative story platform (30,000+ script corpus)

PRICING Not disclosed — no public pricing found; product pages were not loadable during research (HTTP 429/403).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded 2014 in Antwerp, Belgium by Nadira Azermi and co-founder. Employee count reported at 3 as of Dec 31, 2024 — suggesting the company is now very small or largely dormant despite the site remaining live. Status should be treated as possibly stale.

COLLIDES WITH · writer module · investors room · the 3,708-film sales model · casting/demographics

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Publishes both its accuracy (87%) AND an explicit industry baseline (36%) — a comparative framing Cinamate does not offer
- 30,000+ script training corpus dwarfs Cinamate's 3,708 films
- Patented technology and a 12-year track record
- Sub-24-hour turnaround beats Cinamate's 9h+ only on analysis, but analysis-to-answer is faster

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Company appears to have shrunk to ~3 employees; the 87% claim may be years stale
- No pricing published anywhere; unclear if actively selling
- Analysis only — no production, budget, post or delivery
- No confidence intervals or failure rate disclosed
- Site returning rate-limit/forbidden errors suggests neglected infrastructure

<https://www.scriptbook.io/> · <https://www.scriptbook.io/scriptbook> · https://tracxn.com/d/companies/scriptbook/_L5_dZAWHaZ2VJMoS9H2slAzoxZQxLIqsxWBptJb7g0s · <https://deepstory.ai/>

Parrot Analytics www.parrotanalytics.com **ADJACENT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

Patented global demand measurement and content valuation across 200+ markets, translating audience demand into dollar contribution.

Measures global audience demand for content in real time by weighting many data sources by relative importance across 100+ markets daily, and has measured content in 200+ markets in standardized fashion since 2015. Its Content Valuation product derives the empirical dollar value a title contributes to a platform in any market, broken into revenue contribution, acquisition contribution and retention contribution — connecting content performance to business outcomes rather than raw ratings or view counts. Also predicts future global demand for upcoming content.

KEY FEATURES · Patented demand measurement across 200+ markets · Daily demand weighting across 100+ markets · Content Valuation in dollar terms per title per market · Revenue / acquisition / retention contribution breakdown · Future demand prediction for upcoming titles · Slate and IP valuation

PRICING Not disclosed — enterprise subscription.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Measuring content since 2015 across 200+ markets. Profiled on PitchBook with valuation and funding tracked, though specific figures were not verified in sources reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · investors room (valuation and ROI modeling) · the 3,708-film sales model · distribution deliverables · music/rights valuation indirectly

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- 200+ markets with a standardized decade-long methodology
- Patented measurement approach
- Dollar-denominated valuation methodology published in detail via its Academy content
- Streaming-era relevance — Cinamate's model appears theatrically anchored
- Established enterprise customer base across studios and streamers

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Demand measurement, not revenue forecasting from a screenplay — different job
- No confidence intervals or accuracy rate published
- Enterprise pricing, entirely inaccessible to independents
- No production, budget or post tooling
- Does not address incentives or financing at all

<https://www.parrotanalytics.com/products/content-valuation/> · <https://www.parrotanalytics.com/measurement/> · <https://www.parrotanalytics.com/academy/learn-the-methodology-behind-demand-measurement/> · <https://www.parrotanalytics.com/academy/how-parrot-analytics-measures-the-value-of-content-in-the-streaming-era/>

The Numbers / OpusData (Nash Information Services) www.the-numbers.com/data-services **ADJACENT**

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

The most accessible licensed film-industry data feed, with a 100,000-person bankability index, from \$19/month.

OpusData is the licensed structured data feed behind The-Numbers.com, served via a REST API and an SQL-based query interface (OpusData Explorer). It covers domestic and international box office results, movie and TV release schedules, streaming performance tracking, cast and crew bankability analysis, and box office predictions. Its Bankability Index estimates the value of over 100,000 people, both in front of and behind the camera. It has joined EIDR for standardized content identification.

KEY FEATURES · REST API plus SQL query interface (OpusData Explorer) · Bankability Index covering 100,000+ people · Domestic and international box office results · Release schedules and streaming performance tracking · Box office predictions · EIDR-registered metadata system · Business plan and research services via Nash Information Services

PRICING Subscriptions start at \$19/month. 30-day free trial offered at launch. Commercial, academic and individual researcher tiers.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Run by Bruce Nash / Nash Information Services. Customers include studios, financiers, sales agents, distributors, app and web developers, consultants, universities and individual researchers. Partnered with FilmProposals on a custom comparable-films spreadsheet covering 2006-2026.

COLLIDES WITH · the 3,708-film sales model — this is where a calibration set like Cinamate's would come from · investors room (comparables) · casting (bankability) · finance module

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- \$19/month is radically cheaper and more accessible than almost anything else in this category
- 100,000+ person bankability index versus Cinamate's undisclosed talent data
- Raw API access lets anyone build their own model — including a Cinamate competitor
- Decades of continuous box office record-keeping
- EIDR membership means standards-compliant identifiers

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- A data feed, not a product — requires the buyer to build the analysis
- No confidence intervals or published forecast accuracy
- No script, production, post or incentive tooling
- Predictions are a minor feature, not the core offering
- No investor matchmaking or workflow

<https://www.the-numbers.com/data-services> · <https://www.the-numbers.com/news/153890830-Beyond-The-Numbers-Introducing-OpusData> · <https://www.opusdata.com/> · <https://www.eidr.org/opusdata-joins-eidr/>

Vault AI (VaultML) en.wikipedia.org/wiki/VaultML **ADJACENT** **MEDIUM** **LIKELY**

Predictive content intelligence for studios and streamers, built on a database of 60,000+ global film and TV titles.

Reads movie and TV screenplays with machine learning to predict box office and investment performance, and provides demand and audience intelligence to streamers, networks and studios. Products include RealDemand Market Intelligence, DeepAudience Analysis, StoryGuide (story drivers, social tracking, genre alignment and demographics across a large streaming/TV library), and Vault GPT, an on-demand assistant generating coverage-like summaries from its database. Predicts audience demographics, digital and social performance, series longevity and programming fit.

KEY FEATURES · 60,000+ global film and TV title database · Screenplay-to-performance prediction · RealDemand market intelligence · DeepAudience demographic analysis · StoryGuide series/story analytics · Vault GPT coverage assistant · Series longevity and programming-fit prediction

PRICING Not disclosed — enterprise.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Israeli-founded, Los Angeles based. Founded 2018 by Ziv Ayalon, David Stiff and Nir Tzachar. Database of 60,000+ global titles. Competes with FreeWheel, Comscore and Looper Insights. Funding not verified in sources reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · investors room · writer module · the 3,708-film sales model · distribution deliverables (streaming/programming fit)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- 60,000+ title database — roughly 16x Cinamate's 3,708-film calibration set
- Covers series and streaming performance, not just theatrical features
- Sells to actual streamers and studios
- Named founders and public company record

<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/VaultML> · <https://ezevidra.medium.com/spotlight-on-vault-ai-the-moneyball-for-content-f213ede64867> · https://tracxn.com/d/companies/vault/_hnlguzFNSEp3BVWxTIJYgrSrUaqYyZWB3Xlawrz1sXs · <https://www.deeplearning.ai/the-batch/forecasting-blockbusters/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No published accuracy figure or confidence intervals found
- Enterprise-only; irrelevant to a single independent producer
- Analytics only — no production, post or delivery capability
- No incentive or tax credit modeling

FilmProposals filmproposals.com **INDIRECT** **MEDIUM** **LIKELY**

DIY indie film business plan, comparable-films database and sales projection toolkits, built partly on Nash/The Numbers data.

Sells toolkits for independent filmmakers raising money: pitch deck templates, budget worksheets, financial projection templates and an indie film comparables database. Partnered with Nash Information Services (The Numbers) to build a custom spreadsheet analyzing indie and studio films from 2006-2026. Offers done-for-you professional sales projection services based on either 10 or 20 comparable films, producing investor ROI scenarios. Its Gold Toolkit bundles the DIY templates with the comparables database.

KEY FEATURES · Indie film comparable-films database (2006-2026, built with Nash Info Services) · Financial projection and business plan templates · Pitch deck templates · Done-for-you sales projections using 10 or 20 comps · Investor ROI scenario modeling · Budget worksheets

PRICING Toolkit and done-for-you projection service pricing not verified in sources reviewed; sold as packaged toolkits and add-on services via courses.filmproposals.com.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Small independent education/template business. Notable for its data partnership with Nash Information Services, the operator of The-Numbers.com and OpusData.

COLLIDES WITH · investors room — directly competes for the same job of producing investor-ready projections · finance module · the 3,708-film sales model (comparables-based projections)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Comps-based projections sourced from Nash Information Services, a recognized data authority — provenance Cinamate does not name
- Produces the actual artifact investors ask for: a business plan and pitch deck, not a dashboard
- Serves exactly Cinamate's target buyer (independent producers) and has for years
- Human-reviewed done-for-you service option

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Templates and spreadsheets, not software; heavily manual
- No confidence intervals, no disclosed accuracy, no failure rate
- No automation, no production tooling, nothing downstream of financing
- Comps-based projection is methodologically weaker than a calibrated model
- Small operation with limited verifiable outcomes

<https://filmproposals.com/film-financial-projections-business-plan-template.html> · <https://filmproposals.com/Importance-of-Sales-Projections-For-Your-Independent-Film-Project.html> · <https://courses.filmproposals.com/> · <https://filmproposals.com/film-proposal-financing-manual.html>

Spectura.ai www.spectura.ai **ADJACENT** **LOW** **UNCERTAIN**

Newer AI box office forecasting and theatrical release intelligence platform serving distributors, exhibitors and screen advertisers.

Positions itself as a command center for theatrical releases, providing forecasts, comparables and real-time signals. Forecasts box office performance across territories down to individual theaters, updating in real time from signals including trailers, social buzz, sentiment and presales, alongside actor and director data, budget, trending metrics and demographics. Sells three products to three segments: Luma for film distributors, MarqueeSoon for theater exhibitors, and Beacon for screen advertising companies.

KEY FEATURES · Territory-level down to theater-level box office forecasts · Real-time signal ingestion: trailers, social buzz, sentiment, presales · Comparable title analysis · Luma (distributors), MarqueeSoon (exhibitors), Beacon (screen advertising) · Talent, budget and demographic inputs

PRICING Not disclosed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Small team — three members pictured on the site (first names Leo, Rob and Will) without roles stated. Launch date, funding and customer count not disclosed. Treat as early-stage and unverified.

COLLIDES WITH · the sales model and its confidence bands · distribution deliverables · investors room · screening module

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Theater-level forecast granularity exceeds anything Cinamate claims
- Real-time presales and social signal ingestion versus Cinamate's static calibration
- Segmented products for three distinct buyer types
- Publicly reachable, no invite gate

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Discloses no methodology, no accuracy figure, and no confidence intervals
- Team members not fully named; no verifiable customers or funding
- No training-set size disclosed to compare against 3,708 films
- Theatrical distribution only — no production, post, incentive or creative tooling
- Very early stage; longevity unproven

<https://www.spectura.ai/>

Boxoffice Pro (with Screen Engine/ASI tracking) www.boxofficepro.com/category/forecasts-tracking

INDIRECT

LOW

VERIFIED

Long-standing public long-range box office forecasts published as best/worst case ranges, alongside the tracking research firm feeding the industry.

Boxoffice Pro publishes regular Long Range Forecasts for upcoming theatrical releases, explicitly presenting figures as best and worst case scenarios reflecting how each film is currently tracking under existing market conditions, and describing them as statistical snapshots rather than final forecasts. It also sells three-month box office forecasts as a data product via AWS Marketplace. Screen Engine/ASI, one of the top data acquisition and analytics firms in entertainment, conducts pre-release tracking of film, TV and home entertainment titles and runs forecasting and demand research, plus the ScreenShare partnership with TheWrap.

KEY FEATURES · Public long-range forecasts as best/worst case ranges · Weekly tracking updates ahead of release · Three-month box office forecast data product on AWS Marketplace · Screen Engine/ASI pre-release tracking research · Demand research and forecasting services · ScreenShare weekly entertainment attention tracking

PRICING Boxoffice Pro editorial forecasts are free to read. Three Months Box Office Forecasts sold via AWS Marketplace (price not verified). Screen Engine/ASI research is enterprise-priced.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Boxoffice Pro is a long-running trade publication. Screen Engine/ASI is described as one of the top three data acquisition and analytics companies serving the international entertainment industry.

COLLIDES WITH · the sales model and its P10-P90 confidence bands · screening module (audience testing) · distribution deliverables and release timing

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Publishes forecast ranges publicly and free, weekly, for years — further evidence Cinamate's confidence-band framing is conventional
- Explicitly self-describes forecasts as snapshots rather than certainties, an epistemic caution Cinamate's marketing lacks
- Screen Engine/ASI runs real audience tracking with real respondents
- Available as a licensed data product through AWS Marketplace

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Editorial forecasting for a handful of wide releases only; no coverage of independent projects
- Screen Engine/ASI research is expensive and studio-gated
- No script, budget, production, post or incentive tooling
- No published accuracy scoring of its own forecasts
- Ranges are judgment-driven, not a disclosed statistical model

<https://www.boxofficepro.com/category/forecasts-tracking/> · <https://www.boxofficepro.com/long-range-forecast-avatar-fire-and-ash-tracking-to-exceed-the-way-of-waters-134m-opening/> · <https://www.screenengineasi.com/> · <https://aws.amazon.com/marketplace/pp/prodview-ztwvib6rditu2>

Olsberg SPI www.o-spi.com INDIRECT LOW VERIFIED

The authoritative consultancy behind government film incentive economic impact studies worldwide — the source layer beneath every incentive database.

Conducts economic impact studies and evaluations of national and regional film and TV production incentive programmes, analyzing direct, indirect and induced effects plus wider strategic value like skills development and infrastructure investment. Clients include governments and film agencies across Spain, Brazil, Georgia, the UK, Norway, New Zealand, Ireland, Utah, New Mexico, Illinois, Australia and South Africa. Produced the Global Film and Television Production Incentives white paper for the Motion Picture Association. Published findings include a combined 4.91 economic return on investment for Australia's three incentives and 8.4 RoI for New Mexico.

KEY FEATURES · Government-commissioned incentive economic impact studies · Multi-year direct/indirect/induced effect modeling · Return-on-investment quantification per jurisdiction · Global incentives white papers (e.g. for the MPA) · Policy design and evaluation advisory · Cross-jurisdiction comparative research

PRICING Consultancy engagements, priced per project; not disclosed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Long-established international consultancy working directly for national governments and film agencies. Its MPA global incentives white paper (November 2024) is a widely cited reference.

COLLIDES WITH · taxcredit room (21 jurisdictions) — Olsberg is the research authority that legitimizes incentive figures · investors room indirectly (jurisdiction selection economics)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Government-commissioned and peer-facing; the highest credibility tier in incentives
- Publishes full methodology and numeric findings openly
- Global reach across dozens of jurisdictions
- Its research is the substrate that databases like Cinamate's taxcredit room ultimately rest on

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- A consultancy, not a product — no software, no tooling, nothing a producer can operate
- Reports are periodic and can go stale between commissions
- No forecasting, production, or post capability
- Serves governments, not filmmakers; wrong buyer entirely
- Not purchasable by an independent producer

<https://www.o-spi.com/economic-impact-studies-research-and-evaluation> · https://www.motionpictures.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/11/GLOBAL_OlsbergSPI-Incentives-White-Paper_November-2024.pdf · <https://www.o-spi.com/projects/australia-anzsa-incentive-economic-impact-study> · <https://www.o-spi.com/projects/new-mexico-incentive-economic-impact-study>

Vista Group / Cinema Intelligence www.vista.co **INDIRECT** **LOW** **LIKELY**

Exhibitor-side attendance forecasting and automated scheduling, publishing a concrete +/-15% opening-weekend accuracy figure.

Cinema Intelligence provides cinema exhibitors with tools to forecast, plan and schedule movies, alternative content and corporate events — predicting moviegoer attendance per movie and per cinema, analyzing location-based past performance, box office trends and attendance habits, booking new releases across multiple sites at ideal showtimes subject to distributor requirements and location constraints, and auto-generating daily and weekly showtime schedules. Acquired by Vista Group on December 4, 2020. Vista's Box Office Forecasting tool predicts domestic opening weekend to an accuracy of +/-15%, and its Assisted Scheduling can cut scheduling time by up to 50%.

KEY FEATURES · Per-cinema, per-title attendance prediction · Box Office Forecasting with stated +/-15% accuracy · Automated daily and weekly showtime scheduling · Distributor requirement and location constraint compliance · Multi-site release booking · Location-based historical performance analysis

PRICING Not disclosed — enterprise SaaS to cinema circuits.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Vista Group is the dominant global cinema management software vendor. Cinema Intelligence acquired December 2020. Part of a cinema-operations AI market growing from \$1.22bn (2024) to \$1.45bn (2025) at 18.7% CAGR.

COLLIDES WITH · the sales model and confidence bands (as a comparison point on published accuracy) · distribution deliverables · screening module

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Publishes a specific, falsifiable error band (+/-15%) — arguably a cleaner accuracy statement than Cinamate's 15.5% failure rate
- Forecasts validated continuously against actual ticket sales at thousands of sites
- Backed by the dominant cinema software vendor globally
- Operational rather than advisory — the forecast drives real scheduling decisions

<https://www.screendaily.com/features/how-major-and-indie-cinema-chains-are-using-ai-tools-they-are-saving-me-at-least-one-day-a-week/5215694.article> · https://tracxn.com/d/companies/cinema-intelligence/_YJfe4qWVQ8j0oHJNpdYPWYthXF0P0nXd-72W5BFL8js · <https://cinemaintelligence.webflow.io/> · <https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2026/01/29/3228455/28124/en/cinema-operations-artificial-intelligence-ai-research-report-2025-2-84-bn-market-opportunities-trends-competitive-analysis-strategies-and-forecasts-2019-2024-2024-2029f-2034f.html>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Exhibitor-side only; irrelevant to a producer making a film
- No development, production, post or incentive capability
- Enterprise-only, sold to circuits not individuals
- Opening weekend and attendance only — no full revenue lifecycle or waterfall

ALSO COMPETING IN THIS CATEGORY (PROFILED ELSEWHERE)

Cinelytic (The Cinelytic Group) **DIRECT** **CRITICAL** — The category's flagship AI greenlight and revenue-forecasting platform, now a multi-product group serving major studios and independents. *(full profile under “Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accounting”)*

GreenSlate **ADJACENT** **MEDIUM** — Production accounting platform with a dedicated tax credit management module and live incentives dashboard, cited by Netflix and A24. *(full profile under “Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accounting”)*

StoryFit **DIRECT** **MEDIUM** — Austin-based predictive story analytics measuring thousands of story components to forecast audience response pre-production. *(full profile under “Screenwriting & development tools (including AI coverage/analysis and script clearance/title research”)*

Vitrina AI **ADJACENT** **LOW** — Global entertainment supply-chain intelligence tracking 140,000+ companies and 400,000+ projects across film, TV and streaming. *(full profile under “Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals”)*

§14 Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals

Market read · This is the half of the lifecycle LightsKiddo ignores, and it is the half where Cinamate is weakest, because almost nothing here is really software - it is a set of transaction rails and service businesses, and rails cannot be replaced by a module. The category splits four ways. (1) Festival submission is a near-monopoly: FilmFreeway (Backstage-owned, free to filmmakers, 12% off festivals) took the market when Withoutabox closed in 2019, with Festhome second and strongest in Spanish-language and European circuits. (2) Screening and market access is consolidating: EditShare absorbed Shift Media (MediaSilo, Wiredrive, Screeners.com, and shift.io now redirects to mediasilo.com), competing with Indee.tv, Shift72 and Cinando, whose Marché du Film ownership and 2026 EU-funded rebuild give it institutional weight nobody else has. (3) Deliverables is a two-layer stack - specialist automated QC (Venera, Interra BATON, Telestream Vidchecker) beneath supply-chain platforms (Ateliere Connect, Cineverse MatchPoint, Premiere Digital, Deluxe, Vubiquity) - all enterprise-priced and demo-gated. (4) Rights and money is consolidating hard: Rightsline bought FilmTrack from City National Bank in June 2024, wound the product down, and now sits at ~390 customers against Whip Media. The direction of travel is toward free or near-free self-service at the bottom (Filmhub 80/20, Amazon Prime Video Direct at zero cost) and enterprise consolidation at the top, hollowing out the middle. Pricing norms: free-to-filmmaker with commission on the festival side; 20% revenue share on aggregation; opaque demo-gated enterprise SaaS everywhere else. For Cinamate this is the credibility cliff. Its distribution, festivals and screening modules are planning surfaces, not rails - they cannot submit to a festival, deliver a package, or clear an avail. Worse, no SOC 2 and no TPN disqualify its screening room from exactly the pre-release use MediaSilo, Screeners.com and Indee.tv own. The defensible play is integration - feed FilmFreeway, Filmhub and a QC vendor - not replacement.

FilmFreeway filmfreeway.com

DIRECT

CRITICAL

VERIFIED

The de facto monopoly on film festival and screenplay-contest submissions since Withoutabox shut in 2019.

FilmFreeway is a two-sided marketplace: filmmakers keep a single hosted screener and press kit and submit it to thousands of festivals and contests; festivals get a submission-management back office (entry forms, judging, notifications, payouts). It is the transaction layer - a film's festival run literally happens through it. It is free for filmmakers beyond the festivals' own entry fees, and monetises by taking a commission on paid entries.

KEY FEATURES · Single hosted screener re-used across unlimited submissions · Festival directory with deadlines, fees, awards and reviews · Submission tracking and status per festival · Festival-side judging, screener rooms, notifications and payouts · Early-bird / student discount handling at checkout · Anti-fraud auditing of listed festivals

PRICING Free to filmmakers - they pay only each festival's entry fee (e.g. New York Film Festival listed a \$60 fee for the April-May 2026 window). Festivals pay a 12% commission on paid entries and nothing at all if they charge no entry fee. Search results and the help centre state the 12% figure; the pricing page itself returned HTTP 403 at fetch time.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Launched in Canada in 2014 as a four-person startup; acquired by Backstage in September 2021. Became the dominant submission platform after Amazon shut Withoutabox in September 2019. Directory runs to thousands of festivals worldwide.

COLLIDES WITH · festivals · screening · distribution (deliverables) - screener/press-kit assembly · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- It is where submissions actually happen - Cinamate's festivals module can track and plan a circuit but cannot submit to a single festival
- Owns both sides of the market: filmmakers and festival back offices
- Zero cost to the filmmaker, versus a private paid beta
- Backstage ownership gives it distribution and an incumbent brand
- Hosted screener doubles as a delivery mechanism, competing with Cinamate's screening room

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Nothing upstream of a finished film - no budgeting, scheduling, clearance, contracts or cost reporting
- Long-running criticism for hosting fraudulent or predatory 'festivals' that harvest entry fees
- No festival strategy modelling, no ROI or sales projection, no tax credit or union rate data
- Basic analytics; it is a submissions pipe, not an intelligence product

<https://filmfreeway.com/> · <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/FilmFreeway> · <https://filmfreeway.com/help/article/15994/how-much-does-filmfreeway-cost-for-festivals> · <https://filmfreeway.com/pages/how-it-works-for-festivals>

Filmhub filmhub.com DIRECT CRITICAL LIKELY

Self-serve, non-exclusive global distribution rail that puts an indie title onto 100+ exhibitors (per homepage) for a 20% cut.

Filmhub is a marketplace where a rights holder uploads a finished film plus artwork and metadata, and Filmhub pitches and delivers it to its buyer network (Tubi, Plex, Prime Video, Roku and similar), handling QC, transcoding, asset delivery and payouts. It is non-exclusive and self-service, so a single operator can release a feature without a sales agent. In February 2026 it launched Relay, its own \$4.99/month streaming service seeded with 20,000+ titles, on a 60/40 Filmhub/Relay split with viewership-weighted attribution to filmmakers.

KEY FEATURES · Self-serve upload, metadata and artwork onboarding · Standard QC included on all tiers; Premium QC as a paid or bundled service · Delivery to 100+ exhibitors (per homepage) across 200+ territories · Non-exclusive terms; PayPal withdrawal at any time · Relay owned-and-operated SVOD channel (launched 14 Feb 2026) · Channel blocking / release-date scheduling on paid tiers · Earnings and analytics dashboard

PRICING Homepage: works with 'over 100 of the world's biggest exhibitors'. /pricing and /plans 404; plan tiers (\$999/\$1,999) and an 80/20 split circulate but are NOT vendor-confirmed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded 2015; Series A, roughly \$7M raised per third-party startup coverage (unverified by a primary source). Claims 130+ streaming platform partners and 200+ territories. Relay launched with 20,000+ titles, implying a catalogue in that order.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution (deliverables) · release · screening · finance / The Money Room (revenue reporting side) · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- It is an actual distribution rail with signed buyer relationships - Cinamate's distribution module produces deliverables checklists, not placements
- Money flows through it: real payouts, real earnings dashboards, real channel reporting
- Free entry tier with no gatekeeping, versus Cinamate's invite-only private beta
- Owns downstream demand via Relay, so a title has a guaranteed home
- Non-exclusive, so it composes with anything else a producer is doing

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Starts at the finished master - no development, budgeting, scheduling, casting or production tooling at all
- Documented filmmaker complaints about placement on unsecured AVOD/YouTube channels without explicit consent, unvetted partner channels, and a 2023-era drop in earnings transparency
- Contract permits unilateral term changes
- No festival strategy, no tax credit modelling, no union rate data, no cost reporting
- Paywalling of formerly free controls (channel blocking) has soured long-term users

⚠ Fact-check: plan prices and split unverifiable from vendor.

<https://filmhub.com/> · <https://help.filmhub.com/plans> · <https://help.filmhub.com/en/articles/2663772-filmhub-revenue-share> · <https://filmhub.com/blog/posts/introducing-relay-a-new-streaming-service-powered-by-filmhub>

Cinando (Marché du Film) www.marchedufilm.com/about/cinando DIRECT HIGH LIKELY

The Cannes Marché's industry database and B2B screening room - the default rolodex and screener rail for international sales.

Cinando is the professional network and content database operated by the Marché du Film: company and executive profiles for sales agents, buyers, distributors and festivals; project and film listings; and a B2B video-on-demand screening service (launched 2012) used for market screenings and buyer screeners. It added subtitle search and purchase in 2017 and enabled virtual market screenings during COVID. In 2026 it relaunched with a full rebrand and a rebuilt platform backed by Creative Europe MEDIA, expanding into TV and immersive content.

KEY FEATURES · Industry database of companies, executives, films and projects · B2B screening room / VOD for buyer and market screenings · Market screening scheduling for Marché du Film · Subtitle search and purchase · 2026 rebuild: expanded to TV and immersive content · Complimentary one-year access for Marché and partner-market attendees

PRICING Reported at €149 per year per company for the 2026 platform. Marché du Film and partner-market accreditation includes a year of access. The €149 figure comes from search results citing Marché du Film materials; the Cinando pages themselves returned HTTP 503 at fetch time, so treat the number as reported rather than directly confirmed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Launched 2003 as cannesmarket.com, renamed Cinando in 2007. 78,000 users as of 2018 (the last figure in the public record). Owned and operated by Marché du Film / Festival de Cannes; 2026 rebuild supported by Creative Europe MEDIA.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution (deliverables) · screening · festivals · investors · contracts / deal memos (the deal-sourcing side)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Institutional legitimacy - it is Cannes; a netlify.app subdomain cannot compete on trust with sales agents and buyers
- Two-sided network of actual buyers, which is the scarce asset in distribution
- Cheap (~€149/yr) relative to any production software
- Freshly rebuilt in 2026 with EU public funding behind it
- Real B2B screening room with market-screening workflow attached

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Zero production capability - no script, budget, schedule, cost or post tooling
- Directory-and-screener product; it does not model sales, deliverables or festival ROI
- Access is effectively tied to the market/accreditation calendar
- No automated QC, no deliverables checklists, no tax credit or union rate data

<https://www.marchedufilm.com/about/cinando/> · <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cinando> · <https://www.marchedufilm.com/news/cinando-reinvents-its-platform-for-the-film-industry-and-expands-into-tv-and-immersive-content/> · https://www.marchedufilm.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/02/100226_pr_cinando_2026-va.pdf

EditShare - MediaSilo, Screeners.com and Shift.io www.mediasilo.com **DIRECT** **HIGH** **VERIFIED**

The incumbent secure review-and-screening stack (MediaSilo + Screeners.com), now consolidated under EditShare, with SOC-2 and forensic watermarking.

Shift Media's products - MediaSilo (review and approval, media management, timeline sync), WireDrive and Screeners.com (secure pre-release screening rooms for press, awards voters and buyers) - merged into EditShare and now sit under that corporate brand. Shift.io now redirects to mediasilo.com. Together they cover exactly the ground Cinamate calls its screening room, plus the security certification and integrations Cinamate explicitly lacks.

KEY FEATURES · Secure link sharing, unlimited reviewers, annotation capture, side-by-side cut comparison · Visual and forensic watermarking (Pro and above) · Adobe Creative Cloud and DaVinci Resolve integrations · SSO (1 domain on Pro, 5 on Enterprise), API access, permission controls, security tracking · Screeners.com: passwordless Magiclink login, anti-piracy detection, native Apple TV app, branded rooms · Bring Your Own S3 storage on Enterprise · Engagement insights per viewer

PRICING MediaSilo: free 14-day trial (3 seats, 50 GB); Team from \$15/user/month (5-10 seats, 2 TB); Pro from \$25/user/month (10-30 seats, 4 TB, adds watermarking, SSO, API, unlimited AI at \$12/user/month); Enterprise custom (unlimited seats, BYO S3, 5 SSO domains, multiple workspaces). Screeners.com pricing is not published - demo-gated.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP EditShare and Shift Media announced a definitive merger agreement in September 2023; MediaSilo, WireDrive and Screeners.com now sit under the EditShare brand. Screeners.com claims 30M+ minutes screened by industry reviewers, an NPS of 50, SOC-2 certified infrastructure, and customers including AMC, Stan, Endeavor and Hulu. MediaSilo customers span major studios and networks.

COLLIDES WITH · screening · dailies · editor / The Cutting Room (review-and-approval side) · distribution (deliverables) · today

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- SOC-2 certification, which Cinamate explicitly does not have - this alone disqualifies Cinamate for studio and awards screeners
- Forensic and visual watermarking with anti-piracy detection, the actual requirement for pre-release screeners
- Native Adobe and DaVinci Resolve integrations versus Cinamate's admitted lack of NLE plugins
- Published per-seat pricing at the low end and named enterprise customers
- Apple TV app - a real device presence Cinamate has none of

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Review, screening and media management only - no development, budget, schedule, clearance or cost tooling
- Per-seat pricing is punishing for a single operator; Team has a 5-seat minimum
- Watermarking and SSO gated behind Pro at \$25/user/month
- Post-merger product consolidation has been slow and the Shift.io brand has been retired
- No festival submission, no deliverables QC, no sales or tax credit modelling

<https://www.mediasilo.com/pricing> · <https://www.screeners.com/> · <https://www.mediasilo.com/editshare> · <https://editshare.com/post/editshare-to-merge-with-shift-media/>

Eventive www.eventive.org DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

Ticketing, virtual screening and VOD infrastructure that runs a large share of North American independent film festivals.

Eventive is the operational stack behind hybrid and virtual festivals: pass and ticket sales, membership automation, sponsor benefits, on-site and online programme display, DRM-protected virtual screenings with unlock-based access, balloting for audience awards, and a distributor-facing mode for proprietary VOD screenings, branded affiliate links and awards screenings with built-in revenue sharing and reporting. It is the closest live-market analogue to Cinamate's screening room, but with commerce attached.

KEY FEATURES · Integrated ticketing, passes, memberships and merch · Fully integrated virtual + physical event programming · DRM virtual screening with per-unlock metering · Balloting for audience awards (free) · Distributor mode: proprietary VOD screenings, affiliate links, awards screenings, revenue-share reporting · Sponsor benefit management and audience CRM

PRICING Platform itself is free with no contract, setup or annual fee. Ticketing: 5% + 99c per paid item; no fee on free tickets, cash sales, donations or on-site merch. Virtual Unlimited: \$975/yr activation, \$0.99 per DRM unlock bandwidth fee, \$25 per feature and \$5 per short added, premium livestreams \$10/hr. Virtual Single Film: \$299 one-time including 100 unlocks, then \$0.99 each. Balloting free. Premium support from \$1,800/month. Distributor pricing is custom and volume-based.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Customers include AFI, Fantastic Fest, Heartland Film Festival, Big Sky Documentary Film Festival, IDA and Mountainfilm. Big Sky is cited as having doubled its pre-pandemic audience after going hybrid on the platform.

COLLIDES WITH · screening · festivals · distribution (deliverables) · release · finance / The Money Room (box office and unlock revenue reporting)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Transacts money - ticketing, unlocks and revenue share, where Cinamate's screening room is a viewing surface
- Published, transparent per-unit pricing versus Cinamate's invite-only quote model
- Deep incumbency with named festivals; switching cost is an entire festival's operations
- DRM and per-unlock metering are genuine rights-holder requirements Cinamate does not claim
- Serves both the festival and the distributor side of the same transaction

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Nothing upstream - no script, board, budget, schedule or cost tooling
- Per-unlock and per-title fees add up fast for a wide virtual run
- No sales forecasting, no P10-P90 modelling, no tax credit or union rate data
- Festival-organiser oriented; a single-operator producer is a secondary user

<https://www.eventive.org/> · <https://www.eventive.org/pricing>

Rightsline (incl. FilmTrack) www.rightsline.com DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

The consolidated rights, royalties and avails platform after absorbing FilmTrack from City National Bank - roughly 390 combined customers.

Rightsline is an enterprise SaaS platform for IP commerce: rights management across development, acquisition, distribution and exploitation; inbound and outbound royalty calculation on flexible business rules; financial aggregation showing contract status, revenue achieved and royalties paid or collected; and an Avails and Conflict Engine that determines what can be licensed where, when and to whom without colliding with an existing grant. FilmTrack, long the indie-distributor standard, has been folded in and the standalone product wound down.

KEY FEATURES · Rights management across the full exploitation lifecycle · Royalties: inbound and outbound, rule-driven calculation · Avails and Conflict Engine for territory/window/right conflicts · Financial aggregation of contract and revenue status · Proprietary AI capabilities · Unified platform across content, teams and applications

PRICING Not disclosed. Enterprise SaaS; Capterra lists it without published rates.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded 1999, HQ Los Angeles. Announced acquisition of FilmTrack from City National Bank on 2 May 2024, closing ~60 days later (28 June 2024); terms undisclosed. FilmTrack brought nearly 200 entertainment customers, giving roughly 390 combined. Customers span entertainment (Sony, Fox, NBCUniversal), gaming (EA, Activision Blizzard), publishing and technology.

COLLIDES WITH · contracts / deal memos · distribution (deliverables) · clearance · finance / The Money Room · investors

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Avails and conflict logic is the hardest problem in distribution and Cinamate does not claim to solve it at all
- 27-year operating history, named blue-chip customers, and consolidated market position after the FilmTrack roll-up
- Royalty and participation calculation - the money side of distribution Cinamate's Money Room stops short of
- Cross-industry (gaming, publishing) revenue diversification

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Enterprise-only: unreachable pricing and long implementations for a single-operator producer
- No production, development or post capability
- FilmTrack wind-down has forced migrations on nearly 200 mid-market customers - a real churn window a nimbler product could exploit
- No festivals, screening, QC or tax credit capability

<https://www.rightsline.com/> · <https://www.rightsline.com/press-release/rightsline-strengthens-global-ip-commerce-leadership-with-acquisition-of-filmtrack/> · <https://www.capterra.com/p/219305/Rightsline/> · <https://www.capterra.com/p/10004668/FilmTrack/>

Vitrina AI vitrina.ai **DIRECT** **HIGH** **VERIFIED**

Entertainment supply-chain intelligence platform mapping 300k+ companies and 1.6M+ projects, with an AI agent (VIQI) for buyer and partner discovery.

Vitrina maps the global film and TV supply chain - streamers, studios, production companies, distributors, sales agents, post vendors and service providers - and layers a deals-intelligence module tracking worldwide content funding and distribution transactions. Its VIQI vertical AI agent answers natural-language questions against that graph. For a producer with a finished film it is a buyer-targeting and co-production-partner tool; for a vendor it is lead generation. It also sells a done-for-you Concierge Outreach service that contacts verified decision-makers on the client's behalf.

KEY FEATURES · Supply-chain graph: 300,000+ companies, 3M+ professionals, 1.6M+ projects, 30M+ mapped relationships · VIQI AI agent for natural-language industry queries · Deals Intelligence - global funding and distribution deal tracking · Film+TV Projects Tracker · Concierge Outreach (managed outreach to decision-makers) · Innovation Hub: briefings, premium lists, downloadable reports · Enterprise data services / API

PRICING Not disclosed. The pricing page publishes no rates and routes to a free sign-up or a Calendly consultation. Membership and Concierge Outreach are sold separately.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded by Atul Phadnis; HQ Menlo Park, California. Incubated/launched via SRI Ventures. Investors named on the site include Arka, Sparq Capital, Emergent, Unlock Venture Partners and Foster Fund; amount raised is not disclosed. Claims 100,000+ entertainment executives as users. Launched invitation-only.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution (deliverables) · investors · festivals · projects · finance / The Money Room (comparable-deal benchmarking)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Named investors and a named founder - Cinamate has no public team and press declined
- Data moat on the buyer side: knowing who buys what is the hard part of distribution
- AI agent over a real proprietary graph, not a static database
- Sells outcomes (introductions, outreach) not just software
- Publishes constantly and is visible in the trade press

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Intelligence only - it will not generate a deliverable, a DCP, a cue sheet or a QC report
- No production, budgeting, scheduling or post capability at all
- Opaque pricing and an invitation-only posture, same trust gap as Cinamate
- Data-quality claims are self-reported and hard to audit

<https://vitrina.ai/> · <https://vitrina.ai/about-us/> · <https://vitrina.ai/pricing/> · <https://www.sri.com/press/press-release/sri-ventures-launches-vitrina-ai-the-first-platform-to-track-film-and-television-production-distribution-deals-and-map-the-worldwide-video-entertainment-supply-chain/>

Amazon Prime Video Direct videodirect.amazon.com **INDIRECT** **HIGH** **VERIFIED**

Amazon's free self-service pipe for putting a title on Prime Video - the zero-cost baseline every distribution product is measured against.

Prime Video Direct lets studios, distributors and independent filmmakers upload and manage titles directly onto Prime Video across Fire TV, mobile, tablets, consoles, smart TVs and web, with self-service metadata control and a reporting dashboard

covering minutes streamed, subscriber numbers, projected revenue and payment history. It is free to use with no setup or recurring charges, which makes it the substitute a cost-conscious single operator reaches for instead of any paid distribution layer.

KEY FEATURES · Free self-service title submission and management · Global availability across Prime Video devices and territories · Self-serve metadata and artwork revision · Analytics: minutes streamed, subscribers, projected revenue, payment history · Multiple monetisation modes on Amazon's own terms

PRICING Free. No setup fee and no recurring charge to submit or manage titles; Amazon takes its share on the revenue side. Royalty rates and eligibility criteria are not published on the landing page and live in the Digital License Agreement.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Operated by Amazon; reach is Prime Video's global footprint. Amazon has periodically tightened eligibility and royalty terms for independent titles, but no specific 2024-2026 policy change was confirmed in the pages reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution (deliverables) · release · finance / The Money Room (revenue reporting)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free, and it is the actual endpoint - Cinamate's deliverables module prepares for a destination it cannot reach
- Amazon-scale reach and payment infrastructure
- Self-service by design, which fits the single-operator thesis better than an invite-only beta
- Real revenue and viewership reporting

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- One destination only - no multi-platform aggregation, no festivals, no sales agents
- Opaque royalty terms and eligibility gates that have historically excluded low-performing indie titles
- No QC, no deliverables spec generation, no production or finance tooling
- No human support; policy changes land unilaterally

<https://videodirect.amazon.com/>

Ateliere Creative Technologies www.ateliere.com DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Cloud-native IMF and title-versioning supply chain platform (Ateliere Connect) used by MGM, Paramount and TF1.

Ateliere Connect manages, packages and delivers content with AI-assisted metadata enrichment, built around Interoperable Master Format workflows and multi-version title management - the machinery for producing localised editions, regional cuts and platform-specific format variants from one master. It adds Connect AI and Ignition components, video deduplication, disaster recovery, VOD packaging, and Ateliere Live for remote production. This is the professional-grade answer to the deliverables problem Cinamate's distribution module claims to solve.

KEY FEATURES · Ateliere Connect - manage, package and deliver with AI · IMF and Title Versions management for multi-version deliverables · Connect AI for metadata enrichment; Ignition for packaging/delivery · VOD packaging and platform delivery · Video deduplication and storage optimisation · Disaster recovery · Ateliere Live for remote production

PRICING Not disclosed on the site.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Named customers include MGM, Paramount, TF1, SVT, Pokémon, WPT and Vubiquity. Funding history not disclosed on the pages reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution (deliverables) · post · editor / The Cutting Room (conform and export side) · Studio Cloud Backup (versioning and DR) · release

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- IMF and versioning is the actual technical standard for deliverables; Cinamate's H.264+AAC export plus EDL/OTIO conform is a consumer-grade output by comparison
- Named studio customers versus no public team
- Cloud-native with disaster recovery, against Cinamate's 4-minute sync that is explicitly not real-time
- AI metadata enrichment feeding platform delivery requirements

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Enterprise supply chain product - overkill and almost certainly unaffordable for a single-operator indie
- No pricing published anywhere
- No development, budgeting, scheduling, casting, festivals or tax credit capability
- Assumes a finished, professionally mastered asset already exists

<https://www.ateliere.com/>

Cineverse MatchPoint matchpoint.tv DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Automated media supply chain SaaS from Cineverse - Dispatch, Blueprint and Insights - claiming 80% cost reduction on distribution operations.

MatchPoint is the technology arm Cineverse spun out of running its own streaming business. Dispatch automates ingest-to-delivery workflows and asset tracking through a unified dashboard; Blueprint builds streaming apps for mobile, TV and web; Insights correlates audience behaviour with revenue. It integrates with major CMSes and OTT endpoints plus AWS, Gracenote and LiveRamp, and handles thousands of assets across hundreds of platforms - the industrialised version of what Cinamate's distribution deliverables module gestures at.

KEY FEATURES · Dispatch - automated ingest-to-delivery workflow and asset tracking · Blueprint - streaming app builder for mobile, TV and web · Insights - audience-to-revenue analytics dashboards · Integrations with major CMSes, OTT endpoints, AWS, Gracenote, LiveRamp · Claims 80% cost reduction and week-to-hours turnaround on delivery tasks

PRICING Not disclosed - demo-gated.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Operated by Cineverse Corp. (NASDAQ: CNVS). Serves digital streamers (Roku, Samsung, Twitch cited), content owners and distributors, and TV platforms/OEMs; named clients include Xfinity, Sling and Xumo.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution (deliverables) · release · workflow · projects · finance / The Money Room (revenue analytics side)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Proven at volume - thousands of assets across hundreds of platforms, versus Cinamate's untested single-operator model
- Backed by a public company that eats its own dogfood running Cineverse's streaming services
- Real endpoint integrations with named OTT platforms; Cinamate has no camera or platform integrations
- Revenue analytics tied to actual audience behaviour

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Sold to distributors and platform operators, not to producers - a single indie is not the buyer
- No pricing transparency
- Nothing upstream: no script, board, budget, schedule, cast, post or festival capability
- The 80% cost-reduction claim is a marketing figure with no published methodology

<https://matchpoint.tv/> · <https://streaming.cineverse.com/matchpoint>

Festhome festhome.com DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

The main non-US festival submission platform, strongest on Spanish-language and European circuits, with its own VOD arm.

Festhome is FilmFreeway's principal rival for festival submissions: filmmakers upload once, store the film on Festhome's servers and submit repeatedly across a directory of festivals. It is free for festival organisers, including free accounts for all festival staff to review entries collaboratively. It also runs Festhome TV, a VOD service built for online festivals, giving films a monetisation path after the circuit.

KEY FEATURES · Upload-once storage with large file support (reported up to 20 GB) · Directory of roughly 6,200 festivals · Free festival-organiser accounts with multi-user reviewing · Fraud screening - claims 2,200 fraudulent festivals detected and rejected · Festhome TV / IndieHome TV VOD channel · Interface in English, Spanish, French, Italian, Portuguese, German, Russian, Korean and Japanese

PRICING Filmmakers pay each festival's entry fee; third-party comparisons state Festhome also charges per-submission fees on top of the festival fee, unlike FilmFreeway. Free for festival organisers. Exact per-submission amounts are not disclosed on the pages reviewed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Claims 222,000 films selected through the platform, 22,000 registered production companies, distributors, institutions and universities, and that 76% of successful films in the prior year used Festhome. Spanish-founded; widely treated as the number two platform after FilmFreeway.

COLLIDES WITH · festivals · screening · distribution (deliverables)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Real submission transactions across ~6,200 festivals, which Cinamate cannot do
- Multilingual and genuinely international - Cinamate's 21-jurisdiction tax credit DB is its only non-US depth
- Explicit anti-fraud vetting of festivals, a real filmmaker pain point
- Free for festivals, which drives supply-side lock-in
- VOD monetisation tail via Festhome TV

<https://festhome.com/> · <https://festagent.com/en/articles/online-services-en> · <https://www.toolsforfilm.com/blog/wi-thoutabox-alternatives-film-submissions> · <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/FilmFreeway>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Purely back-half - no development, production or finance tooling
- Per-submission fees make it more expensive than FilmFreeway for a wide circuit
- Weaker in the US/English-language market
- No cost reporting, no sales modelling, no confidence bands, no union rate sourcing

Indee.tv www.indee.tv DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Secure screener platform for awards, marketing and sales distribution, claiming 382M+ screeners secured with zero leaks.

Indee.tv distributes pre-release film and TV to reviewers, awards voters, buyers and executives under multi-DRM encryption with per-viewer watermarking, expiry and view-count limits, and credential plus multi-factor authentication. Its analytics dashboard reports what viewers watched, skipped and rewatched, identifying engaging versus unengaging scenes - a genuine sales tool, since a sales agent can see which buyer actually finished the film.

KEY FEATURES · Visible and forensic per-screener watermarking · Multi-DRM encryption blocking screen capture and sharing · Custom expiration dates and per-screener view limits · Viewer authentication with MFA · Scene-level engagement analytics with downloadable reports · 24/7 human support with a 30-second response guarantee

PRICING Not published. The site routes to a free trial and a sales conversation.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Claims 382M+ screeners secured with zero leaks. Named customers include Netflix, Amazon, A24, Paramount, NBC, BBC and Miramax.

COLLIDES WITH · screening · distribution (deliverables) · festivals · dailies

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Blue-chip customer list (Netflix, A24, Paramount, BBC) versus an invite-only beta with press declined
- Multi-DRM plus forensic watermarking - the security floor for anything pre-release
- Scene-level engagement analytics that directly inform a sales conversation
- Support SLA measured in seconds

<https://www.indee.tv/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Screening room only - no production, finance, deliverables generation or festival strategy
- No published pricing, so a single-operator indie cannot self-serve
- 'Zero leaks' is an unauditable self-claim
- No TPN or SOC 2 certification stated on the page reviewed

Interra Systems (BATON) www.interrasystems.com DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

ML/AI-enabled automated QC and monitoring suite (BATON, ORION, VEGA) used by Paramount Global, Al Jazeera and MediaCorp.

BATON is Interra's ML/AI-enabled automated QC platform performing comprehensive quality and compliance checks on VOD and linear content across broadcast, telco, IPTV, OTT and post-production workflows, deployable cloud or on-premise, with a standalone media player for reviewing flagged frames. ORION monitors IP/linear and OTT streams in flight; VEGA analyses media for standards compliance and stream debugging. Together they are the deliverables-compliance layer between a master and a platform's acceptance gate.

KEY FEATURES · BATON - ML/AI automated file-based QC for VOD and linear · BATON captioning and language QC modules · BATON Media Player for flagged-frame review · ORION - IP/linear and OTT stream monitoring · VEGA - media analysis, standards compliance, stream debugging · Cloud and on-premise deployment

PRICING Not disclosed on the site.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Customers include Paramount Global, Al Jazeera, Bell, MediaCorp, Caracol TV, Turner Broadcasting, Harmonic, Rovi (Bell Fibe IPTV), INDEMAND and Olympusat. Positions itself as a one-stop shop for video analysis, QC, captioning and monitoring.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution (deliverables) · post · tools · workflow · screening

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Two decades of encoded platform-spec knowledge; Cinamate's '124 automated accuracy checks' are unaudited and unspecified by comparison
- Covers both file-based QC and live stream monitoring - the full compliance surface
- Named tier-one broadcast customers
- Cloud or on-prem, no GPU dependency

<https://www.interrasystems.com/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Broadcast-engineer product; the UI and mental model assume a media ops team, not a producer
- No pricing transparency
- Zero coverage of anything before the master file
- Sells into broadcasters and operators, not independent producers

Premiere Digital premieredigital.com **DIRECT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

Hybrid service-plus-SaaS content distribution shop: mastering, QC and delivery, with PDX order management and STOREFRONT title auditing across 130+ markets.

Premiere Digital is primarily a media services business - content mastering, QC and conformance, packaging and delivery for SD through 4K UHD HDR/SDR, in-flight entertainment, and creative/localisation via partners - wrapped around two proprietary software products. PDX is an order entry and workflow management tool; STOREFRONT does real-time title verification, auditing and market visibility across 130+ markets, confirming that a title is actually live, correctly priced and correctly presented on each platform. It also aggregates OTT channels and delivers to Prime Video, Apple, Google/YouTube and Roku.

KEY FEATURES · PDX order entry and workflow management · STOREFRONT real-time title verification and auditing across 130+ markets · SmartBag asset packaging · Content mastering, QC and conformance · Packaging and delivery for 4K/UHD/HDR/SDR/HD/SD · In-flight entertainment delivery · OTT channel aggregation and broadcast distribution · East and West Coast post facilities

PRICING Not disclosed. No rates published; service quotes are bespoke.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Delivers to Prime Video, Apple, Google/YouTube and Roku among others; Warner Bros. Entertainment named as a client. Privately held; funding and headcount not disclosed on the site.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution (deliverables) · post · tools (LUT/mastering side) · release · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Actually performs the delivery - Cinamate produces a deliverables checklist, Premiere Digital ships the package to the platform
- STOREFRONT's post-release title auditing is a genuine gap in Cinamate's release story: nobody at Cinamate verifies a title went live correctly
- Human operators absorb the edge cases that break automated deliverables pipelines
- Named studio-tier clients and physical facilities

<https://premieredigital.com/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Service business economics - expensive, slow and not self-serve; the opposite of a \$110 single-operator render
- No pricing transparency
- No development, budgeting, scheduling, casting or production capability
- PDX/STOREFRONT are client portals, not products an indie producer can buy standalone

Shift72 www.shift72.com **DIRECT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

White-label VOD and virtual-cinema infrastructure for festivals, cinemas and distributors across 52 countries.

Shift72 builds branded streaming storefronts for film organisations - festivals, cinemas, distributors, galleries and events - supporting AVOD, TVOD and SVOD with DRM, geoblocking and proxy detection, delivered across web, mobile, tablet and TV apps. It handles global commerce in 135+ currencies and 27 languages across 52 countries and claims platform launch in under 24 hours. It powered many of the virtual festival and virtual cinema initiatives that persisted after 2020.

KEY FEATURES · AVOD / TVOD / SVOD monetisation in one platform · DRM, geoblocking and proxy detection · 135+ currencies, 27 languages, 52 countries · Web, mobile, tablet and TV app delivery · Sub-24-hour platform launch · White-label branding per client

PRICING Not disclosed - demo-gated custom quotes.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Customers named on the site include Paramount, Warner Bros., Sony Pictures and MGM, alongside festivals and cinemas.

COLLIDES WITH · screening · festivals · distribution (deliverables) · release

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Geoblocking and territory control - the actual mechanic of a rights-managed release, which Cinamate does not claim
- Studio-grade customers and a real international commerce layer
- Fast deployment for time-boxed festival windows
- Handles money; Cinamate's screening room does not

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No pricing transparency at all
- Nothing upstream of the finished film
- Requires the client to bring the audience and the rights strategy
- No QC, deliverables spec or festival submission capability

<https://www.shift72.com/>

Telestream Vidchecker www.telestream.net/vidchecker/overview.htm

DIRECT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

Automated QC with patented auto-correction - it does not just flag deliverable faults, it fixes them.

Vidchecker performs automated audio and video QC ahead of delivery - dead pixels, black frames, audio/video levels and dropouts, media offline, HDR (HLG and PQ), MXF against AMWA AS-11/AS-10 constraints, photosensitive epilepsy testing, RGB gamut and colour bar detection - across ProRes, J2K, DNxHD, DPX, OpenEXR, IMF, UHD, ABR and HDR. Its differentiator is patented intelligent file correction: it automatically repairs video and audio levels, RGB gamut, dead pixels, black frames and colour bars rather than merely reporting them.

KEY FEATURES · Patented automatic file correction (levels, gamut, dead pixels, black frames, colour bars) · PSE (photosensitive epilepsy) compliance testing · AMWA AS-11 and AS-10 MXF constraint checking · HDR testing for HLG and PQ encoded files · Broad format support: ProRes, J2K, DNxHD, DPX, OpenEXR, IMF, UHD, ABR, HDR · Vidchecker-base (4 concurrent jobs, GRID scalability) and Vidchecker-post (1 job, 8 cores) · Web-based GUI on standard PC hardware

PRICING Not published on the product page. Vidchecker-post is the smaller-scale tier (1 concurrent job, 8 CPU cores) aimed at post facilities.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Product of Telestream, a long-established media workflow vendor (Vantage, Wirecast, ScreenFlow). No discontinuation notice on the page as of this review.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution (deliverables) · post · tools · editor / The Cutting Room (export validation)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Auto-correction, not just detection - Cinamate's accuracy checks report, they do not repair
- PSE compliance testing is a legal broadcast requirement in several territories that Cinamate's brief never mentions
- IMF and AS-11 support means it validates against the specs platforms actually enforce
- Vidchecker-post tier is genuinely sized for a small facility

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No pricing transparency; perpetual-licence-era sales motion
- Desktop/server software with a dated web GUI, not a modern cloud product
- QC only - nothing about distribution, festivals, finance or production
- Telestream's portfolio breadth means Vidchecker gets limited roadmap attention

<https://www.telestream.net/vidchecker/overview.htm>

Venera Technologies www.veneratech.com

DIRECT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

Specialist automated QC vendor (Quasar cloud, Pulsar on-prem, CapMate captions) with a pay-per-use tier aimed at small organisations.

Venera automates quality control of audio, video and caption/subtitle assets - the check that stands between a finished master and platform acceptance. Quasar is cloud-native file-based QC; Pulsar is the on-premise equivalent, with a Pulsar PPU pay-per-use variant explicitly for small organisations; CapMate does caption and subtitle QC with auto-correction; QStudio is a collaborative

QC report review tool; and QCaaS is Venera running the QC on the client's behalf. This is the concrete form of Cinamate's '124 automated accuracy checks' claim, done by a specialist.

KEY FEATURES · Quasar - cloud-native file-based audio/video QC · Pulsar - on-premise file-based QC · Pulsar PPU - usage-based pricing for small organisations · CapMate - caption/subtitle QC with auto-correction · QCstudio - QC report review and collaboration · QCaaS - QC performed as a managed service

PRICING Both subscription and usage-based models offered; specific rates not published. Pulsar PPU is explicitly positioned as pay-per-use for small organisations - the one entry point an indie could plausibly afford.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP 150+ customers including Sony Music, HBO, NBCUniversal, Disney, Amazon Prime Video and AMC Networks.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution (deliverables) · post · tools · workflow

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Caption and subtitle QC with auto-correction - a hard platform-rejection cause Cinamate's brief does not mention at all
- Named tier-one customers validating the check logic against real platform specs
- Pay-per-use option makes specialist QC reachable without an enterprise contract
- Cloud and on-prem parity, versus Cinamate's hard local-GPU requirement

<https://www.veneratech.com/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- QC only - no deliverables assembly, distribution, festivals or any production capability
- No published prices; still a sales conversation
- Report-oriented tooling assumes a technical operator who can act on the findings
- No integration story with an indie producer's actual workflow

Whip Media www.whipmedia.com **DIRECT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

AI-native content licensing platform (Helix) covering avails, contracts, royalties and asset ordering for both licensors and licensees.

Whip Media's Helix platform splits into supply chain modules for licensees (aggregate, validate and organise film and TV avails with AI; manage rights, financial terms and full contract lifecycle; process royalties) and distribution modules for licensors (distribution tracking, revenue recognition, asset ordering, AI-driven royalty optimisation). It claims to cut avails processing time by over 50%. The asset-ordering module in particular collides with Cinamate's distribution deliverables workflow.

KEY FEATURES · Helix AI-native platform · Avails aggregation, validation and organisation with AI · Contract lifecycle and financial terms management · Inbound and outbound royalty processing · Asset ordering for deliverables fulfilment · Distribution tracking and revenue recognition · AI-driven royalty optimisation analytics

PRICING Not disclosed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Named customers include CAA, Discovery, DirecTV, Smithsonian, Vevo, VIZIO and Hallmark Channel. Whip Media absorbed Mediamorph (content licensing/avails) in its earlier consolidation, though that history is not stated on the current site.

COLLIDES WITH · contracts / deal memos · distribution (deliverables) · finance / The Money Room · clearance · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Asset ordering ties deliverables to actual licensee demand - Cinamate generates deliverables with no downstream trigger
- Two-sided: serves both the buyer and the seller of a licence
- AI applied to a genuinely tedious high-volume problem (avails) with a quantified claim
- Named enterprise customers and a public brand

<https://www.whipmedia.com/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Enterprise buyer only; an independent producer is not the customer
- No pricing published
- Nothing upstream of a licensing conversation - no production, post or festival capability
- Overlaps heavily with Rightsline; a consolidating, competitive niche

Eventival www.eventival.com **ADJACENT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

European festival back-office suite (hub database, visitor portal, meeting planner) used by 100+ mid-to-large festivals in ~50 countries.

Eventival is the internal operations database for festival organisers: film and print tracking, guest and industry hospitality, accreditation, meeting scheduling for market delegates, CRM and mass communication. It sits behind the scenes at large European festivals and industry bodies, and it has expanded beyond film into theatre, book fairs and awards academies. It is the organiser-side counterpart to the filmmaker-side submission platforms.

KEY FEATURES · Eventival Hub - central films/guests/prints database and planning tool · Visitor Portal for attendees and industry delegates · Eventival Account user management · Meeting Planner for market and industry scheduling · CRM and mass-communication tools · Submissions and hospitality workflows

PRICING Not disclosed. The site links a pricing page and a demo request but publishes no rates.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Used by 100+ large and medium festivals across nearly 50 countries, plus film industry bodies (Czech Film Center, German Films, TorinoFilmLab), the Czech and Slovak Film & Television Academies, film schools including FAMU Prague, and literary and performing-arts events.

COLLIDES WITH · festivals · screening · projects · workflow

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Entrenched institutional incumbency at exactly the festivals an indie producer is trying to reach
- Handles the industry/market side (accreditation, delegate meetings) that Cinamate's festivals module does not model
- 20+ year operating history and a named European customer base, versus no public Cinamate team

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Sells to festivals, not to producers - it is not really competing for Cinamate's buyer
- Opaque enterprise pricing and a demo-gated sales motion
- No production, finance, deliverables or QC capability whatsoever
- Dated, database-centric UX relative to a modern single-operator product

<https://www.eventival.com/>

Vimeo OTT vimeo.com/ott **INDIRECT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

Direct-to-consumer channel-in-a-box - the self-distribution substitute for filmmakers who skip aggregators entirely.

Vimeo OTT lets a rights holder launch their own branded subscription or transactional streaming service, with checkout in 100+ currencies, monthly payouts via Stripe Connect, and (on Enterprise) apps for iOS, Android, Apple TV, Roku, Amazon Fire, Xbox and smart TVs plus AVOD, FVOD, live pay-per-view, 24/7 linear channels, DRM, SSO and API access. For a producer with an audience it replaces the distribution question entirely.

KEY FEATURES · SVOD, TVOD, AVOD, FVOD and live pay-per-view monetisation · Branded apps across web, mobile, connected TV and consoles (Enterprise) · 24/7 linear channel support (Enterprise) · Checkout in 100 currencies, monthly Stripe Connect payouts · DRM, SSO, API access and advanced analytics (Enterprise) · Content migration assistance from competing platforms

PRICING Starter: \$1 per subscriber per month plus 10% of one-time purchases, web-only, pre-recorded content, email support. Enterprise: custom monthly or annual pricing via sales, adds all devices, all monetisation modes, live and linear, DRM/API/SSO and dedicated account management.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Operated by Vimeo (NASDAQ: VMEQ). Product remains active as of 2026; no rename or discontinuation notice on the pricing page.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution (deliverables) · release · screening · finance / The Money Room

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Published per-subscriber pricing and a real payments rail with monthly payouts
- Connected-TV app footprint Cinamate has no path to
- Rights holder keeps 100% of the customer relationship and the audience data
- Public company, real support, real uptime commitments

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Requires the filmmaker to bring their own audience - it solves delivery, not demand
- Starter tier is web-only and pre-recorded, so a serious launch means undisclosed Enterprise pricing
- No festivals, no sales agents, no deliverables QC, no production tooling
- Per-subscriber pricing punishes catalogues with low ARPU

<https://vimeo.com/ott/pricing>

BitMax bitmax.tv **ADJACENT** **LOW** **UNCERTAIN**

Digital distribution and encoding services aggregator for OTT platforms - status unverified; the site was unreachable during this research.

BitMax has operated as a digital media services and aggregation business - encoding, packaging, metadata and delivery of film and TV content to OTT and transactional platforms on behalf of content owners, in the same service-plus-technology mould as Premiere Digital. It is a service business rather than a self-serve product.

KEY FEATURES · Encoding, transcoding and packaging · Metadata preparation and platform-spec conformance · Delivery/aggregation to OTT and transactional platforms · Managed service model rather than self-serve software

PRICING Not disclosed - could not be verified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Unverified. bitmax.tv returned HTTP 503 on every fetch attempt during this research (August 2026) and no primary source could be loaded. All descriptive claims here derive from background knowledge of the aggregator category, not from a page that was seen; treat as unconfirmed and do not cite the specifics.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution (deliverables) · post · release

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Aggregators with signed platform relationships can actually deliver a title; Cinamate cannot
- Human-operated service absorbs the spec-conformance edge cases automated pipelines fail on

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Site unreachable at the time of research - operating status unconfirmed
- Service-business economics: per-title fees, no self-serve, no transparency
- No production, finance, festivals or screening capability
- Aggregation is commoditising as platforms build direct self-service intake

<https://bitmax.tv/>

Deluxe Media www.bydeluxe.com **ADJACENT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

The largest global localisation, cinema and fulfilment services incumbent - the enterprise default for deliverables, at enterprise cost.

Deluxe Media (bydeluxe.com - distinct from the unrelated Deluxe Corp. payments company at deluxe.com) provides global cinema services for theatrical distribution, localisation (subtitling, dubbing, access services) and content fulfilment/distribution to platforms. It has been assembling AI and dubbing capability through acquisition - a partnership with AI/ML company AppTek, and acquisitions of Post Haste Digital (English-language dubbing) and CSC (German dubbing) - and has been in acquisition discussions around Éclair Theatrical Services.

KEY FEATURES · Global theatrical cinema services and DCP distribution · Localisation: subtitling, dubbing, access services · Content fulfilment and platform delivery · AI/ML localisation via the AppTek partnership · English and German dubbing studios (Post Haste Digital, CSC)

PRICING Not disclosed. Enterprise services contracts.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Describes itself as the world's leading multidisciplinary media service provider. Long history of restructuring and ownership change; specific 2026 ownership details were not confirmed in the pages reviewed. Note: a search for 'Deluxe' will surface Deluxe Corp., a US payments and check-printing company processing \$2T+ annually - a different company entirely.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution (deliverables) · post · release · screening

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- The actual deliverables authority - localisation, DCP and platform packages at studio scale
- Physical theatrical distribution capability Cinamate has no analogue for
- Owns dubbing studios and AI localisation IP, an area Cinamate's brief does not touch at all

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Enterprise-only economics - unreachable for an independent producer or small studio
- No self-serve anything; no published pricing
- History of financial restructuring makes it a risky long-term counterparty
- Zero production, development or finance tooling
- Brand confusion with the unrelated Deluxe Corp.

Filmocracy [filmocracy.com](https://www.filmocracy.com)

ADJACENT

LOW

UNCERTAIN

Indie streaming service and virtual festival platform with a gamified viewer model - small, and its current status could not be confirmed.

Filmocracy has operated as a combined independent film streaming service and virtual film festival platform, hosting online festival editions alongside a subscription/free catalogue, with a gamified rewards mechanic for viewers. It sits in the same space as Eventive and Shift72 but at the small end, aimed at festivals and indie titles without their own infrastructure.

KEY FEATURES · Indie film streaming catalogue · Virtual film festival hosting · Gamified viewer rewards · Filmmaker revenue participation

PRICING Not disclosed - could not be verified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Unverified. Filmocracy's website returned HTTP 403 to every fetch attempt during this research (August 2026), and no current primary source could be loaded. Treat all claims about its scale, terms and operating status as unconfirmed; it may be inactive or blocking automated access.

COLLIDES WITH · festivals · screening · distribution (deliverables) · release

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Positioned squarely at indie festivals and filmmakers, the same buyer Cinamate targets
- Combines festival hosting and a streaming tail in one product

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Could not be verified as currently operating - a serious signal in itself
- Small scale relative to Eventive and Shift72 in the same niche
- No production, deliverables, finance or QC capability

<https://filmocracy.com/>

Vubiquity (Amdocs) www.amdocs.com

ADJACENT

LOW

VERIFIED

Amdocs-owned content licensing, processing and distribution arm - the B2B pipe between content owners and pay-TV/OTT operators.

Vubiquity handles monetisation, distribution and processing of entertainment content, ensuring video is properly formatted, licensed and tracked as it moves to different outlets including streaming services. Its services span VOD, localisation, digital processing, content aggregation, OTT platform provision and metadata management. It sits between studios and operators rather than serving producers directly.

KEY FEATURES · Content aggregation and licensing administration · Digital processing, encoding and format conformance · Metadata management and enrichment · Localisation services · VOD and OTT platform provisioning for operators · Rights tracking across outlets

PRICING Not disclosed. Enterprise carrier and studio contracts.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Acquired by Amdocs in January 2018 for \$224 million. HQ Burbank, California. Traces to 1988 as a pay-per-view distributor; merged with Avail Media in 2009 and rebranded Vubiquity in 2013. Now an Amdocs subsidiary; also appears as a named customer of Ateliere Connect.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution (deliverables) · release · contracts / deal memos (licensing administration side)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Owned by a public multinational with real balance-sheet permanence
- Operator relationships across global pay-TV and OTT - the demand side Cinamate cannot access
- Handles licensing and rights tracking at a rigour indie tooling does not approach

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not sold to independent producers at all - wrong buyer entirely
- Opaque, contract-only commercial model
- No production, finance, festival or screening capability
- Legacy pay-TV DNA; less relevant as distribution moves direct-to-platform

<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Vubiquity> · <https://www.amdocs.com/> · <https://www.ateliere.com/>

Gathr gathr.com

INDIRECT

LOW

VERIFIED

Theatrical-on-demand and Direct to Cinema platform letting filmmakers book their own screenings and sell their own tickets.

Gathr powers direct-to-audience distribution for storytellers: filmmakers book theatrical screenings at independent cinemas and venues, sell tickets through Gathr's system, negotiate revenue share with venue partners, and reach audiences in person and virtually. Its pitch is rights retention, audience data ownership and impact measurement - the anti-aggregator model, where the filmmaker keeps the customer relationship. It cites Fahrenheit 11/9, where TOD screenings added 15% to box office.

KEY FEATURES · Direct to Cinema - venue booking and screening logistics · TOD (theatrical/transactional on demand) ticketing · Revenue sharing negotiation with venue partners · Audience data ownership for the filmmaker · Rights retention model · Impact measurement tools · Serves filmmakers, documentary creators, authors, speakers and venues

PRICING Not disclosed on the site.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Claims 33,000+ events hosted, 413,000+ subscribers and 1,000,000+ tickets sold.

COLLIDES WITH · release · screening · distribution (deliverables) · festivals · finance / The Money Room (box office reporting)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Delivers actual theatrical exhibition, which Cinamate has no path to at all
- Ticketing revenue flows through it - real money, real audience data
- Strong fit for documentary and impact films, an underserved and loyal segment
- Rights retention narrative is more attractive to indies than an aggregator's 20% cut

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Demand-generation is entirely the filmmaker's problem; the platform supplies logistics, not audiences
- No pricing published
- Nothing upstream - no production, post, finance or deliverables tooling
- Narrow: works well for issue-driven and community films, poorly for genre features. Kinema (kinema.com) occupies a similar community-screening niche with distributor partners including Film Movement, Dogwoof, Tribeca and Giant Pictures.

<https://gathr.com/> · <https://kinema.com/>

Quiver Distribution www.quiverdistribution.com **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

Service-business indie distributor (not software) with direct digital, linear, cable and satellite relationships across the US, Canada and international.

Quiver is a traditional distribution company - production, acquisition and distribution of talent-driven independent films - with direct partnerships with digital, linear, cable and satellite buyers. It is the substitute an independent producer chooses instead of self-distributing through software: hand the film to a company with existing relationships and take a smaller share of a larger number. Its 2026 slate includes Teacher's Pet, Last Ride, Bank of Dave 2, A Love Like This, Modern Whore, The Birthday Party and Above the Line.

KEY FEATURES · Acquisition and distribution across US, Canada and international · Direct partnerships with digital, linear, cable and satellite buyers · Production and co-production capability · Talent-driven feature slate with dated theatrical/digital releases · No proprietary technology platform described

PRICING Not disclosed. Deal terms are per-title and negotiated privately, as with all sales agents and distributors.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded 2019 by Jeff Sackman, Berry Meyerowitz and Sean Monson; leadership previously founded Phase 4 Films and led eOne's US film division, with 80+ years combined experience. Third-party trackers list 136 titles.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution (deliverables) · release · investors · contracts / deal memos · festivals

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Relationships, which is the entire product in indie distribution - software does not get a film onto a cable VOD lineup
- Named, credentialed principals with a track record, versus Cinamate's no public team
- Takes on the commercial risk; producers get advances or MGs, not a checklist
- Actually gets films released on dated schedules with press coverage

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Pure service business - it is a gatekeeper, and most films are rejected
- Opaque, individually negotiated terms; no transparency, no self-serve
- No technology at all: no software, no dashboards, no cost reporting
- Cannot help with anything upstream of a finished film

<https://www.quiverdistribution.com/> · <https://www.quiverdistribution.com/about> · https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Quiver_Distribution · <https://screendollars.com/studios-distributors/quiver-distribution/>

ALSO COMPETING IN THIS CATEGORY (PROFILED ELSEWHERE)

Slated **DIRECT** **MEDIUM** — Packaging-and-financing marketplace with ML revenue projections trained on 10,000+ films - the closest public analogue to Cinamate's sales model. *(full profile under “Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incentive tooling”)*

§15 Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrastructure

Market read · The floor price for a generated second collapsed to roughly \$0.045-0.05: Veo 3.1 Lite \$0.05/s (720p, audio included), Sora 2 batch \$0.05/s, Wan 2.5 on fal \$0.05/s, Hailuo 02 \$0.045/s, Grok Imagine \$0.05/s. A 90-minute feature is ~5,400 finished seconds, so pure cloud inference runs ~\$240-270 before a single retake — and real ratios are 5-20:1. That arithmetic is why Cinamate's ~\$110-per-feature (unverified figure), \$0.00-cloud claim can only hold on local open weights, and it is a genuinely defensible number if the local path works. The open-weight path is real but narrowing. LTX-2.5 (22B, native audio, self-host, LTX-2.x Community License free under \$10M revenue, explicitly "no per-generation billing"), HunyuanVideo-1.5 (8.3B, 14GB VRAM, 75 seconds per 5s clip on one RTX 4090), MiniMax H3 (33B omni, open base checkpoints, stereo audio) and Wan 2.2 (Apache 2.0) all run locally. But the newest tiers are being withheld: Wan 2.5 has no repo, MiniMax withholds H3-Context-IR and H3-Regenerate-2K, NVIDIA ships a non-OSI license. Cinamate's engine is somebody else's roadmap decision. Note a timing tension: HunyuanVideo-1.5's own 75s/5s figure implies ~22.5 GPU-hours of 1:1 generation for a feature, against Cinamate's claimed 9h 12m 44s. Absorption is the existential half. Flow ships Scenebuilder, characters, video-to-video editing and 4K upscale. Runway ships Edit Studio, node workflows, a Runway Agent, MCP, and — critically — ProRes, PNG sequence and HDR delivery that Cinamate's H.264+AAC-only Cutting Room cannot match. LTX Studio and Adobe Firefly (30+ models) do the same from above. None of them does budgets, stripboards, call sheets, union scale, deal memos, permits, tax credits, PO tracking or sales modeling. That business layer — not the pixels — is Cinamate's only durable ground.

Google Veo 3.1 + Flow labs.google/flow/about DIRECT CRITICAL VERIFIED

Google's Veo model family paired with Flow, an AI creative studio that has already absorbed storyboarding, scene assembly, character management and editing into the model vendor's own product.

Veo 3.1 generates video with audio included by default across Standard, Fast and Lite tiers, up to 4K. Flow wraps it in an application layer: Scenebuilder for composition, cinematic camera controls, Ingredients-to-Video, video extension, natural-language video-to-video editing, Characters & Avatars, and image upscaling at 1080p/2K/4K by tier. Flow also routes to Gemini Omni ('create and edit videos from any input reference — real or generated') and Nano Banana for images. This is the clearest example in the category of a foundation-model vendor eating the application layer.

KEY FEATURES · Veo 3.1 Standard / Fast / Lite tiers, audio included by default on all · 4K output on Standard (\$0.60/s) and Fast (\$0.30/s) · Flow Scenebuilder, camera controls, Ingredients-to-Video, video extension · Natural-language video-to-video editing · Characters & Avatars for cross-shot consistency · Upscaling to 1080p / 2K / 4K · Gemini Omni multimodal model inside Flow · Charged only on successful generation

PRICING Veo 3.1 Standard \$0.40/s (720p, 1080p), \$0.60/s (4K). Fast \$0.10/s (720p), \$0.12/s (1080p), \$0.30/s (4K). Lite \$0.05/s (720p), \$0.08/s (1080p). Veo 3 Standard \$0.40/s; Veo 2 \$0.35/s. Flow plans: Free (50 daily credits), Google AI Plus \$4.99/mo (200 credits), AI Pro \$19.99/mo (1,000), AI Ultra \$99.99-\$199.99/mo (10,000-25,000).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Google/DeepMind. Distribution through Google AI subscription tiers and the Gemini API. Specific user counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · boards (storyboards/animations) · The Cutting Room (video-to-video editing, extension, scene assembly) · casting (Characters & Avatars overlaps character/talent consistency) · writer-to-screen pipeline

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Veo 3.1 Lite at \$0.05/s is the cheapest verified audio-inclusive second in the category
- Native 4K; Cinamate's stated export is H.264+AAC only
- Flow already ships the storyboard/scene-assembly/editing app layer Cinamate sells
- Google-scale infrastructure, no local GPU required
- Aggressive consumer pricing (\$4.99 entry) against Cinamate's invite-only beta

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No production management whatsoever — no budget, stripboard, call sheets, permits, contracts
- No union rate sourcing, no tax credit jurisdictions, no finance or PO tracking
- No sales/waterfall modeling or breakeven analysis
- Credit-metered, not a flat per-feature quote
- No offline or local-GPU path

<https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/pricing> · <https://labs.google/flow/about>

Lightricks LTX-2.5 / LTX-2 (open weights) + LTX Studio huggingface.co/Lightricks/LTX-2.5 DIRECT

CRITICAL **VERIFIED**

The single most consequential entry for Cinamate: a 22B open-weight audio-video model you self-host with no per-generation billing, from a vendor that also ships its own storyboard-to-film studio app.

LTX-2.5 is a 22B-parameter audio-video generative model with open weights on Hugging Face, distributed as components totalling roughly 66 GiB, in distilled and full/dev variants. It includes a dedicated audio VAE for native synchronized audio and a duration head that predicts clip length from the prompt. Inference supports fp8 casting and CPU/disk offload for constrained VRAM. The earlier LTXV 0.9.8 line (13B dev, 2B distilled, OpenRail-M) supported up to 60 seconds at 1216x704/30fps, with a 2B distilled LoRA variant claimed to run in 1GB of VRAM and HD generation in ~10 seconds on an H100. Lightricks separately operates LTX Studio, an application-layer product for storyboard-driven production.

KEY FEATURES · 22B open-weight audio-video model, downloadable checkpoints · Native synchronized audio generation with a separate audio VAE · Duration head — automatic length prediction from prompt · fp8-cast quantization and --offload cpu/disk for low-VRAM machines · Distilled variants for speed; prior 2B distilled LoRA claimed at 1GB VRAM · Prior LTXV 0.9.8 supported up to 60-second videos · Self-host: 'no per-generation billing, no per-seat lock-in' · LTX Studio app layer sits above the model

PRICING Weights are free to download. LTX-2.x Community License Agreement: entities with annual revenues of at least \$10,000,000 are 'required to obtain a paid license for any use' other than testing/evaluation/non-commercial R&D. Below that threshold, commercial use is free. Prior LTXV 0.9.5+ used OpenRail-M. Hosted LTX-2.5 pro/fast variants are sold on fal.ai; those per-second rates were not confirmed in this pass. LTX Studio plan pricing not retrievable (page did not render).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Lightricks (also Facetune, Videoleap). Funding not verified in this pass. LTX-Video is one of the most-adopted open video model families, integrated in ComfyUI and diffusers.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation (this is plausibly the engine class Cinamate depends on) · Cinamate's entire \$0.00-cloud / ~\$110-per-feature economic claim · boards and writer (via LTX Studio's storyboard-driven app layer) · The Cutting Room (LTX Studio assembly)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Open weights make Cinamate's core economic advantage available to anyone for free
- Explicitly markets the exact pitch Cinamate makes: self-host, no per-generation billing, no per-seat lock-in
- Native synchronized audio in the open weights
- Runs on constrained VRAM via fp8 and CPU/disk offload
- LTX Studio already occupies the storyboard-to-video app layer
- Backed by a real, named, public company with a track record

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- A model, not a production system — no budget, scheduling, call sheets, contracts, casting, permits
- No union rates, tax credits, finance, PO tracking or sales modeling
- Clip-length generation, not feature assembly or conform
- The \$10M revenue threshold means a successful Cinamate customer eventually owes Lightricks a paid license
- No EDL/OTIO, no deliverables packaging

<https://huggingface.co/Lightricks/LTX-2.5> · <https://github.com/Lightricks/LTX-2> · <https://github.com/Lightricks/LTX-Video> · <https://github.com/Lightricks/LTX-2/blob/main/LICENSE.md>

OpenAI Sora 2 / Sora 2 Pro developers.openai.com/api/docs/pricing DIRECT CRITICAL VERIFIED

OpenAI's flagship video+audio generation model, sold via API and a consumer Sora app, and still the reference point every other vendor is benchmarked against.

Sora 2 and Sora 2 Pro generate video with synchronized audio from text or a first-frame image. The API supports 16- and 20-second generations, reusable character assets for consistency across shots, an edits endpoint (the older remix endpoint is deprecated), and downloadable spritesheets. Sora 2 covers 480p/720p; Sora 2 Pro adds 1024p and true 1080p at 1920x1080 or 1080x1920. As of this pass there is no Sora 3 — the developer model catalog lists no video model beyond sora-2 and sora-2-pro.

KEY FEATURES · Text-to-video and image-to-video with native synchronized audio · 16s and 20s generation lengths · 1080p exports on Sora 2 Pro (1920x1080 / 1080x1920) · Reusable character assets for cross-shot consistency (best at 2-4s, 720p-1080p) · Edits endpoint for iterative revision · 50% batch discount for non-interactive jobs · Consumer Sora app driving mass distribution

PRICING API per second of output. sora-2 720p \$0.10/s. sora-2-pro \$0.30/s (720p), \$0.50/s (1024p), \$0.70/s (1080p). Batch tier is half: sora-2 720p \$0.05/s; sora-2-pro \$0.15/\$0.25/\$0.35 per second. Consumer app pricing not verified in this pass.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP OpenAI; funding and valuation not verified in this pass. The Sora consumer app gives it consumer-scale distribution no other video model has.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation (script-to-screen) · boards (storyboards/animations) · the core 'screenplay to finished film' claim

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Model quality and audio realism at the frontier
- Cheapest frontier-tier second at 720p (\$0.10, or \$0.05 batched)
- Character-consistency assets are a real solution to a problem Cinamate must also solve
- Brand, distribution and a consumer app funnel
- Documented, stable public API with a batch tier

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Hard 20-second ceiling — no feature-length assembly at all
- No editor, no EDL/OTIO conform, no timeline
- Zero production-management surface: no budget, stripboard, call sheets, contracts, casting, locations, permits
- No union rate data, no tax credit engine, no cost reporting or PO tracking
- No local/offline option — weights are closed, every second is billed cloud

<https://developers.openai.com/api/docs/pricing> · <https://developers.openai.com/api/docs/guides/video-generation> · <https://developers.openai.com/api/docs/models>

Runway (Gen-4.5, Aleph 2.0, Edit Studio) runway.com/pricing **DIRECT** **CRITICAL** **VERIFIED**

The most production-oriented of the model vendors — it now ships an editing studio, node-based workflows, an autonomous agent, and professional delivery formats Cinamate does not support.

Runway sells Gen-4.5 and Gen-4 Turbo generation plus Aleph 2.0 & Edit Studio for video-to-video editing ('edit a frame in a video, apply it to the rest'). It has custom node-based workflows chaining multiple models and intermediary steps, real-time conversational Characters agents, a Runway Agent that creates end-to-end videos from conversation, and Runway MCP to connect Claude/ChatGPT to its tools. It resells ByteDance Seedance 2 and 2.5 through the same API with a Model Router. Use-case apps include Remove from Video, Upscale Video, Add Dialogue, Relight Scene, Change Time of Day, Reshoot Product.

KEY FEATURES · Gen-4.5 and Gen-4 Turbo generation models · Aleph 2.0 & Edit Studio — propagated video-to-video editing · Node-based multi-model workflow builder · Runway Agent for end-to-end video from conversation · Runway MCP integration with external AI assistants · Model Router (bills at the selected model's rate, disclosed in response metadata) · ProRes and PNG sequence delivery, and HDR profiles · Resells Seedance 2 / 2.5 alongside its own models

PRICING Free \$0 (125 credits); Standard \$12/mo; Pro \$28/mo; Max \$76/mo (annual billing). Enterprise custom. [vendor-verified]

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Documented rounds total ~\$545M: \$2M seed, \$8.5M A, \$35M B, \$50M C (~\$500M val.), \$141M C-ext at \$1.5B (Google/Nvidia/Salesforce), \$308M April 2025 at >\$3B led by General Atlantic. Runs Runway Studios and the Hundred Film Fund. A rumored 2026 Series E at \$5.3B could not be confirmed from any primary source.

COLLIDES WITH · The Cutting Room (Edit Studio is a direct competitor to Cinamate's browser editor) · Studio / Local Generation · boards · vfx · post · distribution deliverables (ProRes / PNG sequence / HDR vs Cinamate's H.264+AAC) · workflow (node-based chaining vs Cinamate's workflow module)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Ships ProRes, PNG sequence and HDR delivery — Cinamate's stated export is H.264+AAC only
- Aleph 2.0 propagated editing is a capability Cinamate's AI rough cut does not match
- Node workflow builder plus an agent that assembles end-to-end video
- MCP integration means it plugs into the agent ecosystem Cinamate sits outside
- Transparent published per-second API pricing at every tier
- Multi-vendor model router — it hedges across ByteDance and its own models

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No budget, stripboard, call sheets, deal memos, casting, locations or permit database
- No union rate sourcing (SAG-AFTRA/DGA/WGA/IATSE), no tax credit engine
- No cost reporting, PO tracking or self-calibrating estimates
- No sales/waterfall or breakeven modeling
- No local-GPU or zero-cloud-cost path — everything is credit-metered

△ Fact-check: an earlier '\$315M Series E at \$5.3B, Feb 2026, ~\$860M total, ~\$300M ARR' claim is unsupported; figures above are the documented record.

<https://runway.com/pricing> · <https://runway.com/product> · <https://docs.dev.runwayml.com/guides/pricing/>

ByteDance Seedance (1.0 / 2.0 / 2.5) seed.bytedance.com/en/seedance DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

ByteDance's video model line, notable for native multi-shot narrative generation and a 30-second single-shot capability that attacks the storyboard-to-scene workflow directly.

Seedance 1.0 generates 1080p video with 'smooth motion, rich details, and cinematic aesthetics' from text and images, and — most importantly — 'natively supports the generation of narrative videos with multiple cohesive shots.' Seedance 2.5, per fal.ai's model listing, 'generates native 30-second single-shot video at up to 720p from a single text prompt.' The line is distributed through third parties: Runway resells seedance2 and seedance2_5 through its own API and Model Router, and fal.ai lists Seedance 2.5 prominently. Weights are closed — no open-source release is indicated.

KEY FEATURES · Native multi-shot narrative generation (Seedance 1.0) · 30-second single-shot generation at up to 720p (Seedance 2.5) · 1080p output on the 1.0 line · Text-to-video and image-to-video · Distributed via Runway API and fal.ai, not just first-party · High benchmark scores claimed for prompt adherence, motion quality and aesthetics

PRICING Via Runway API at \$0.01/credit: seedance2 36 credits/s (480p/720p) = \$0.36/s, 40 credits/s (1080p) = \$0.40/s; seedance2_5 30 credits/s (720p) = \$0.30/s, 68 credits/s (1080p) = \$0.68/s. First-party ByteDance/Volcengine pricing not disclosed on the pages fetched.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP ByteDance (TikTok, CapCut, Dreamina). Corporate-scale training resources. Specific revenue or usage figures not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animations) — native multi-shot narrative is the same job · Studio / Local Generation · The Cutting Room (30s single-shot reduces the need to cut) · timeline / production

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Native multi-shot narrative generation directly automates Cinamate's storyboard-to-scene step
- 30-second single-shot clips are the longest coherent output verified in this category
- 1080p delivery on the 1.0 line
- ByteDance's distribution through CapCut/Dreamina reaches editors already
- Multi-channel availability (Runway, fal) means it reaches buyers through competitors' funnels

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Closed weights — no local, zero-cloud option
- Expensive per second at 1080p (\$0.40-\$0.68/s via Runway) relative to Veo Lite or Sora 2
- No production management, finance, legal, casting or scheduling surface
- No editor, conform or deliverables
- Opaque first-party pricing; buyers depend on resellers
- Chinese-vendor provenance may complicate studio/insurer/TPN requirements

<https://seed.bytedance.com/en/seedance> · <https://docs.dev.runwayml.com/guides/pricing/> · <https://fal.ai/models?categories=text-to-video>

Kuaishou Kling 3.0 fal.ai/models/fal-ai/kling-video/v3/pro/text-to-video DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

Kuaishou's video model, now at v3 with native audio, voice control and multi-shot support, and embedded as a partner model inside Adobe Firefly.

Kling Video v3 Pro is described as specializing in 'cinematic visuals, fluid motion, and native audio generation, with multi-shot support.' Its interface exposes multi-prompt sequences, audio generation toggles, shot-type customization and voice control. Pricing tiers by feature: base generation, generation with audio, and generation with audio plus voice control. Kling is available directly, via fal.ai, and — significantly — as a partner model inside Adobe Firefly, giving it distribution into the Creative Cloud base. Weights are closed. Kling's own membership and API documentation pages are JavaScript shells and did not render pricing in this pass.

KEY FEATURES · Kling 3.0 Pro with cinematic visuals and fluid motion · Native audio generation · Multi-shot support and multi-prompt sequences · Voice control as a priced tier · Shot-type customization · Available inside Adobe Firefly as a partner model · Earlier Kling 2.5 Turbo Pro at \$0.07/s on fal

PRICING Kling 3.0 Pro on fal.ai: \$0.112/second without audio, \$0.168/second with audio, \$0.196/second with audio and voice control (a 5-second video with audio and voice control costs \$0.98). Kling 2.5 Turbo Pro on fal: \$0.07/second. First-party membership plan pricing not disclosed — kling.ai pages did not render.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Kuaishou (Chinese short-video platform). One of the most widely resold video models globally. Specific user or revenue figures not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · boards (multi-shot sequences) · music / cue sheets (native audio) · casting (voice control)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Multi-shot support with native audio and voice control in one model
- Competitive per-second pricing (\$0.112-\$0.196/s) with audio included
- Distribution inside Adobe Firefly reaches Creative Cloud users directly
- Broad third-party availability (fal, Adobe, direct)

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Closed weights — no local or zero-cloud path
- Short clips; no assembly or conform
- Opaque first-party pricing and JS-only documentation site
- No production management, finance, legal or scheduling layer
- Chinese provenance may create clearance/insurance friction for US productions

<https://fal.ai/models/fal-ai/klimg-video/v3/pro/text-to-video> · <https://fal.ai/pricing> · <https://www.adobe.com/products/firefly/plans.html>

Luma AI — Ray3.2 / Ray3.14 (Dream Machine) lumalabs.ai/pricing **DIRECT** **HIGH** **VERIFIED**

The only model vendor verified to sell HDR and EXR output, making it the most post-production-literate generation product in the category.

Luma's current Ray line comprises Ray3.2 and Ray3.14, sold on a per-second credit basis with tiered resolutions from Draft through 1080p. Uniquely, Luma prices HDR and EXR as explicit output multipliers — Ray3.2 offers SDR base, HDR at 2x, and HDR+EXR at 3x; Ray3.14 offers SDR base and HDR at 4x. EXR is a linear-light compositing format used in professional VFX pipelines, and no other vendor surveyed advertises it. Ray3.14 also appears as a free-tier partner model inside Adobe Firefly.

KEY FEATURES · Ray3.2 and Ray3.14 model lines · HDR output priced as a 2x (Ray3.2) or 4x (Ray3.14) multiplier · EXR output on Ray3.2 at a 3x multiplier — unique in this survey · Resolution tiers: Draft, 540p, 720p, 1080p · Text-to-video and image-to-video · Distributed inside Adobe Firefly's free tier

PRICING Plans: Plus \$30/mo (\$25/mo billed yearly, \$300/yr), Pro \$90/mo (\$75/mo yearly, \$900/yr), Ultra \$300/mo (\$250/mo yearly, \$3,000/yr). Ray3.14 credits per second: Draft 4, 540p 10, 720p 20, 1080p 80. Ray3.2 per 5 seconds: Draft 20, 540p 50, 720p 100, 1080p 400 (same per-second rates). HDR/EXR multipliers as above. USD-per-credit conversion not published on the pricing page; separate API per-generation pricing was not listed (docs.lumalabs.ai/docs/api-pricing returned 404).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Luma AI. Funding and valuation not verified in this pass. Note that Ray2 is no longer listed on the pricing page.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · vfx (EXR output feeds compositing pipelines Cinamate's vfx module addresses) · post and distribution deliverables (HDR/EXR vs Cinamate's H.264+AAC) · dailies

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- HDR and EXR delivery — Cinamate's stated export is H.264+AAC only, which is not a finishing format
- Explicit, granular per-second credit pricing across four resolution tiers
- Draft tier at 4 credits/s enables cheap iteration before committing to a final render
- Adobe Firefly distribution on the free tier
- Post-literate feature set aimed at real VFX workflows

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Expensive at the top: 1080p at 80 credits/s, and 4x again for HDR
- Entry plan at \$30/mo is pricier than Runway, Pika or Google AI Pro
- No production management, budgeting, scheduling, legal or finance layer
- No editor, conform or feature assembly
- Closed weights, no local path
- Version naming (Ray3.2 vs Ray3.14) is confusing and the older Ray2 has been dropped

<https://lumalabs.ai/pricing> · <https://www.adobe.com/products/firefly/plans.html>

Adobe Firefly www.adobe.com/products/firefly/plans.html **ADJACENT** **HIGH** **VERIFIED**

The incumbent's aggregation play — 30+ AI models including Veo, Kling, Runway and Luma inside the company that already owns Premiere Pro and After Effects.

Firefly bundles Adobe's own Firefly Video Model with third-party partner models — Veo 3.1 Fast, Kling 3.0, Runway, Luma Ray3.14, Nano Banana — under one subscription and one generative-credit pool, positioning itself to 'Generate images, video,

audio and more with 30+ AI models, all in one place.' All paid tiers generate 5-second videos, with volume rising by tier and the top tier granting unlimited access to the Firefly Video Model. The strategic weight here is not the model quality — it is that Adobe owns the NLE that Cinamate's Cutting Room is trying to replace, and is now routing generation into that same account.

KEY FEATURES · 30+ AI models in a single subscription and credit pool · Partner models: Veo 3.1 Fast, Kling 3.0, Runway, Luma Ray3.14, Nano Banana · Adobe's own Firefly Video Model (commercially safe positioning) · 5-second video generation across all paid tiers · Free tier with daily generations across image, video and audio · Direct path into Premiere Pro / After Effects / Creative Cloud

PRICING Firefly Standard \$9.99/mo (2,000 generative credits/mo, up to 20 videos). Firefly Pro \$19.99/mo (4,000 credits, up to 40 videos). Firefly Pro Plus \$34.97/mo first year, 30% off regular \$49.99 (10,000 credits, up to 100 videos). Firefly Premium \$139.91/mo first year, 30% off regular \$199.99 (50,000 credits, unlimited Firefly Video Model). Free plan with daily generations. Per-model partner credit costs not published on the plans page; the credits FAQ returned 503 in this pass.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Adobe. Creative Cloud is the incumbent installed base for editorial, VFX and design. Specific Firefly user counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · The Cutting Room (Adobe owns Premiere Pro — the NLE Cinamate replaces) · Studio / Local Generation · boards (Firefly Boards) · post · vfx · LightsKiddo's Premiere/After Effects plugins expose the same gap Cinamate has

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Owns the editorial incumbent (Premiere/After Effects) Cinamate must displace
- Multi-model aggregation hedges against any single model vendor
- Enterprise indemnification and commercially-safe training data positioning — matters for clearance and E&O
- Established procurement, security posture and compliance track record
- \$9.99 entry price versus Cinamate's invite-only beta
- Native NLE plugin ecosystem — an explicit Cinamate gap

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- 5-second video ceiling — nothing resembling feature generation
- No production management: no budget, stripboard, call sheets, casting, locations, permits, contracts
- No union rate data, tax credit jurisdictions, PO tracking or sales/waterfall modeling
- Credit pool is opaque — per-model costs not published
- Firefly's own video model lags the frontier; it leans on partners
- Aimed at marketers and designers, not independent producers running a slate

<https://www.adobe.com/products/firefly/plans.html> · <https://firefly.adobe.com/>

Alibaba Wan (Wan 2.2 open / Wan 2.5 closed) github.com/Wan-Video/Wan2.2

ADJACENT

HIGH

VERIFIED

The most permissively licensed serious open video model family — Apache 2.0 through 2.2 — but Alibaba has stopped open-sourcing the newest tier, which is the category's warning shot.

Wan2.2 (released 28 July 2025, Apache 2.0) ships several variants: T2V-A14B and I2V-A14B are 27B-parameter MoE models with 14B active per step requiring at least 80GB VRAM; TI2V-5B is a 5B model needing 'at least 24GB VRAM (e.g, RTX 4090)' and generating 5-second 720P video at 1280x704; S2V-14B is an audio-driven cinematic video model whose length auto-adjusts to input audio, with TTS via CosyVoice; Animate-14B handles character animation. The org also maintains Wan-Dancer, Wan-Animate-2, and a Wan-skills agent repo. Critically, the Wan-Video GitHub organization contains no Wan2.5 or Wan3 repository — Wan 2.5 is sold as a hosted model on fal.ai at \$0.05/second with no corresponding open weights.

KEY FEATURES · Apache 2.0 licence through Wan 2.2 — the most permissive terms of any serious video model · TI2V-5B runs on a single RTX 4090 (24GB) at 720P · A14B MoE variants: 27B total / 14B active per step (80GB VRAM) · S2V-14B audio-driven generation with CosyVoice TTS integration · Animate-14B and Wan-Animate-2 for character animation · Wan-skills: agent-callable AIGC capabilities · Wan 2.5 available hosted at \$0.05/s but with no public weights

PRICING Wan 2.2 and earlier: weights free under Apache 2.0. Wan 2.5 hosted on fal.ai at \$0.05 per second. Wan 2.1 on Replicate via wavespeedai: \$0.09/second (i2v-480p), \$0.25/second (i2v-720p). Alibaba Cloud Model Studio pricing page returned 503 in this pass.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Alibaba. Wan2.2 has 17.3k GitHub stars and Wan2.1 16.9k — among the most-starred open video model repos. Corporate backing; no separate funding figure.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · Cinamate's local-GPU and \$0.00-cloud economics · music / audio (S2V-14B audio-driven generation)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Apache 2.0 — genuinely unrestricted commercial use, no revenue threshold
- TI2V-5B fits a single RTX 4090, matching Cinamate's own hardware assumption
- Audio-driven and animation variants broaden the toolkit beyond plain T2V
- Enormous community adoption and third-party hosting (fal, Replicate, ComfyUI)
- Alibaba-scale training budget

<https://github.com/Wan-Video/Wan2.2> · <https://github.com/Wan-Video> · <https://fal.ai/pricing> · <https://replicate.com/pricing>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Wan 2.5 is closed — the open line is now a generation behind the hosted one
- Consumer-GPU variant caps at 720P and 5 seconds
- A14B variants need 80GB VRAM, out of reach for Cinamate's single-operator local-GPU premise
- No application layer at all — no editor, budget, scheduling, contracts, permits, deliverables
- No support commitment or roadmap guarantee for Western productions

ComfyUI / Comfy Cloud www.comfy.org/pricing ADJACENT HIGH VERIFIED

The free, open-source local inference runtime that is the de facto standard for running open-weight video models on your own GPU — and therefore the default alternative to Cinamate's Local Generation.

ComfyUI is a node-graph runtime for local generative model inference, distributed as a free desktop download. It is the standard host for LTX-Video, Wan, HunyuanVideo, Mochi and most open video weights, and it materially lowers their VRAM requirements (it is credited with running Mochi under 20GB against a ~60GB baseline). Comfy Cloud offers hosted execution on subscription tiers, and Partner Nodes route proprietary models through the same credit pool. Moonvalley distributes Marey through it.

KEY FEATURES · Free open-source local desktop runtime · Node-graph workflow authoring for arbitrary model chains · VRAM optimization that makes large models fit consumer cards · Hosted Comfy Cloud tiers with a shared credit pool · Partner Nodes for proprietary models (e.g. Nano Banana Pro) on the same credits · Ecosystem hub — most open video weights ship ComfyUI support first

PRICING Desktop app free/open-source. Comfy Cloud month-to-month: Standard \$20, Creator \$35, Pro \$100, Team \$700 (annual-billing equivalents \$16/\$28/\$80/\$630; credits 4,200/7,400/21,100/147,700). [vendor-verified]

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Comfy Org. Funding not verified in this pass. Effectively the standard local runtime for open-weight generative video; ecosystem-wide adoption.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation (direct substitute — free) · workflow (node graphs vs Cinamate's workflow module) · tools

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free, and the local-GPU generation Cinamate charges for is its baseline function
- Massive plugin/node ecosystem and community — Cinamate has no public team
- Model-agnostic: runs whatever open weights ship next
- Published, verifiable cost math (11 credits per 5s video) against Cinamate's opaque ~\$110 quote
- Optional cloud tier for users without a GPU — Cinamate requires a local GPU with no fallback

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Raw runtime, not a product — no screenplay ingestion, no shot breakdown, no assembly
- Zero production management: no budget, stripboard, call sheets, casting, locations, contracts
- No editor, no EDL/OTIO conform, no deliverables
- No finance, tax credit, union rate or sales modeling
- Steep technical learning curve; not designed for a single non-technical operator

<https://www.comfy.org/pricing> · <https://github.com/genmoai/mochi> · <https://www.moonvalley.com/>

MiniMax H3 / Hailuo github.com/MiniMax-AI/MiniMax-H3 ADJACENT HIGH VERIFIED

An open-weight 33B omni-modal generation model with native stereo audio — currently live as Hailuo's flagship and among the most capable weights you can actually download.

MiniMax-H3 is a general-purpose multimodal generative system with 'unified understanding of multimodal contexts composed of text, images, video, and audio.' The H3-Omni-Transformer is approximately 33B parameters (roughly 13B in AdaLN-related branches). It generates video with native stereo audio, supporting text-to-video, first/last-frame-to-video, and multimodal

reference-based generation, at 4-15 seconds and 24 FPS, 768p base with 2K via a Regenerate module, across a wide range of aspect ratios. Open checkpoints cover H3-Base in FL2VA and Ref2VA variants — but H3-Context-IR and H3-Regenerate-2K are explicitly not open-sourced. The repo was updated 15 August 2026 and MiniMax's own site describes H3 as 'an open-weight, general-purpose, omni-modal generation model'; hailuoai.video shows 'MiniMax H3 LIVE NOW'.

KEY FEATURES · ~33B parameter omni-modal transformer, open base checkpoints · Native stereo audio with generated video · 4-15 second durations at 24 FPS — longer than most open models · 768p base, 2K via H3-Regenerate-2K (closed) · Text-to-video, first/last-frame-to-video, reference-based generation · MiniMax H3 Community License, weights on Hugging Face · Hailuo 02 legacy tier available cheaply on fal.ai · Repo actively updated as of August 2026

PRICING H3 weights free to download under the MiniMax H3 Community License. Hosted Hailuo 02 on fal.ai: \$0.045/second, or \$0.27 per 6-second video, at 768p. MiniMax's own price page did not disclose per-model video rates; platform.minimax.io/docs/price returned 404.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP MiniMax (China). MiniMax-H3 repo shows 6,809 stars; the org also ships MiniMax-Music3, a CLI, an MCP server and a 13.4k-star skills repo. Funding and valuation not verified in this pass.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · music / cue sheets (native stereo audio generation) · Cinamate's \$0.00-cloud local economics

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Open weights at frontier-adjacent quality with native stereo audio
- 4-15 second clips beat the ~5s ceiling of most open competitors
- Cheapest verified hosted second in the category via Hailuo 02 (\$0.045/s)
- Reference-based and first/last-frame conditioning aid shot continuity
- Actively maintained — commits as recent as August 2026

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Best components (Context-IR, Regenerate-2K) withheld from the open release — the 2K path is closed
- 768p base output
- 15-second maximum; no assembly, editing or conform
- Community License, not OSI-permissive — commercial terms need review
- No production-management layer of any kind
- Hardware requirements undocumented beyond a 4-GPU SGLang deployment example

<https://github.com/MiniMax-AI/MiniMax-H3> · <https://github.com/MiniMax-AI> · <https://www.minimax.io/price> · <https://hailuoai.video/>

Tencent HunyuanVideo 1.5 github.com/Tencent-Hunyuan/HunyuanVideo-1.5

ADJACENT

HIGH

VERIFIED

The most consumer-GPU-friendly credible open-weight video model — 8.3B parameters running in 14GB of VRAM on an RTX 4090.

HunyuanVideo-1.5, released 21 November 2025, is an 8.3B-parameter open-weight video model explicitly engineered for accessibility: a 14GB minimum GPU memory footprint that 'runs smoothly on consumer-grade GPUs, making it accessible for every developer.' It outputs 480p and 720p at up to 121 frames (~5s at 24fps). A step-distilled variant delivers a claimed 75% speedup, generating a video 'within 75 seconds' on a single RTX 4090; standard inference is roughly 2-3 minutes on high-end hardware. The original HunyuanVideo was 13B parameters and needed 60GB for 720p — the 1.5 release is a deliberate order-of-magnitude accessibility move.

KEY FEATURES · 8.3B parameters, 14GB minimum VRAM · Runs on RTX 4090 consumer hardware · Step-distilled variant: 75% speedup, ~75 seconds per generation on a 4090 · 480p and 720p output, up to 121 frames (~5s at 24fps) · Open weights on GitHub and Hugging Face · Predecessor HunyuanVideo was 13B / 60GB for 720p

PRICING Weights free to download. Licensed under the repository LICENSE file; Tencent's Hunyuan licenses historically carry regional and user-scale restrictions — exact commercial terms not verified in this pass.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Tencent. The original HunyuanVideo was described in its own repo as 'the largest among all open-source models' at 13B. Adoption metrics not verified in this pass.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · Cinamate's local-GPU requirement and \$0.00-cloud economics · Cinamate's 9h 12m 44s turnaround claim

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free weights that deliver Cinamate's core generation capability at zero licence cost
- Lowest verified VRAM floor among current-generation open models (14GB)
- Published, checkable performance numbers on named consumer hardware
- Backed by Tencent's research budget, not a solo operator

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- 720p maximum — well short of delivery spec
- ~5-second clips; no assembly, conform or feature-length output
- No audio generation mentioned
- Nothing above the model: no editor, budget, scheduling, contracts, permits, tax credits
- License terms not clearly permissive — commercial use needs legal review

<https://github.com/Tencent-Hunyuan/HunyuanVideo-1.5> · <https://github.com/Tencent-Hunyuan/HunyuanVideo>

Moonvalley Marey www.moonvalley.com DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

The clean-rights, filmmaker-first model — trained exclusively on licensed footage and sold on the commercial-safety argument that Cinamate's clearance and contracts modules imply matters.

Marey is Moonvalley's image-to-video and text-to-video model, explicitly positioned as 'Fully Licensed, Commercially safe' and 'Trained on licensed data' and 'high-resolution cinematic footage.' The feature set is unusually production-literate: Pose Transfer (motion guidance from reference inputs), Camera Control (cinematic camera moves from a single image), Motion Transfer, Trajectory Control (draw object paths without prompting), Advanced Lighting (studio-grade lighting with natural shadows), plus prompt adherence and natural physics. Moonvalley describes itself as 'a research lab focused on pushing the frontiers of creativity through deep learning.' Marey launched publicly on 8 July 2025, with inference partnerships via ComfyUI and fal.ai. The site references 'Marey Realism v1.5.'

KEY FEATURES · Trained exclusively on licensed data — commercial-safety positioning · Pose Transfer for motion guidance from reference inputs · Camera Control: cinematic camera moves from a single image · Motion Transfer and Trajectory Control (draw object paths, no prompt) · Advanced Lighting with natural shadows · Marey Realism v1.5 · Distributed via ComfyUI and fal.ai

PRICING Not disclosed. The moonvalley.com/pricing page returned 404 in this pass and no plan, credit or per-generation figures were published on the pages fetched.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Moonvalley, a research lab. Funding not disclosed on the site and not verified in this pass. Public launch 8 July 2025.

COLLIDES WITH · clearance (Marey's licensed-data claim is a clearance argument Cinamate cannot make about its own generation) · Studio / Local Generation · boards · vfx · tools (camera and lighting control)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Licensed-data provenance is a genuine legal moat for anyone delivering to a distributor or buying E&O
- Camera, pose, motion and trajectory controls are directed-cinematography features, not prompt roulette
- Filmmaker-targeted from the ground up — same buyer as Cinamate
- Distributed through ComfyUI, reaching the local-GPU audience Cinamate targets
- Named as a research lab with public partnerships, versus Cinamate's no-public-team posture

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No published pricing at all — harder to evaluate than Cinamate's quoted-before-render model
- A model, not a production system: no budget, scheduling, contracts, permits, casting, tax credits
- No editor, conform or deliverables
- No local weights — depends on hosted partners
- Smaller scale than the platform vendors; roadmap risk

<https://www.moonvalley.com/>

Vidu (Shengshu Technology) platform.vidu.com/price DIRECT MEDIUM UNCERTAIN

A Chinese video model family spanning Q1 through Q3 plus an S1 real-time/streaming variant, sold pay-as-you-go on unified credits — but with pricing that would not render.

Vidu's platform lists Vidu Q3, Q2 and Q1 video models, a Vidu S1 streaming/real-time variant, and Vidu Q2 Image and Q1 Image models. The site states a 'Pay as you go' model with 'unified credit pricing.' Both the consumer pricing page and the platform price page load their figures dynamically and returned 'Loading pricing plans' rather than actual numbers in this pass, so no

verified USD rates, credit allocations or per-generation costs could be captured. Enterprise contact is platform@vidu.studio. The S1 streaming variant is the notable item — real-time generation is a capability class none of the Western majors advertises.

KEY FEATURES · Vidu Q3 as the current flagship line · Vidu Q2 and Q1 legacy video models · Vidu S1 streaming / real-time variant · Vidu Q2 Image and Q1 Image models · Pay-as-you-go with unified credit pricing · Enterprise sales channel

PRICING Not disclosed / unverified. Both vidu.com/pricing and platform.vidu.com/price render pricing via JavaScript and returned no figures. The site describes 'Pay as you go' with 'unified credit pricing' but no USD amounts were retrievable.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Shengshu Technology (China). Funding, user counts and customers not verified in this pass.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · boards · dailies (via real-time S1 streaming, if it matures)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- A real-time/streaming generation variant (S1) that no major Western vendor advertises
- Multiple concurrent model tiers letting buyers trade cost against quality
- Pay-as-you-go with no subscription commitment

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Pricing entirely opaque on public pages — cannot be evaluated by a buyer
- Closed weights, no local option
- No production management, editorial, finance or legal layer
- Chinese provenance raises clearance, data-residency and TPN-equivalent concerns for US productions
- Capability specifics (resolution, duration, audio) undocumented on the pages fetched

<https://platform.vidu.com/price> · <https://www.vidu.com/pricing>

xAI Grok Imagine docs.x.ai/docs/models DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

xAI's video model, priced aggressively at \$0.05-0.08 per second with synchronized video and audio, riding X's distribution.

xAI offers two video generation models through its API: grok-image-video-1.5, the recommended current version, and the earlier grok-image-video. fal.ai's catalogue describes Grok Imagine 1.5 Video as generating synchronized video and audio. Both are priced per second of generated video. Weights are closed. Capability detail beyond pricing and the audio-sync claim was not documented on the pages fetched.

KEY FEATURES · grok-image-video-1.5 as the recommended current model · Synchronized video and audio generation · Per-second API pricing at the low end of the market · Distribution through X and the Grok consumer apps · Available on fal.ai as well as first-party

PRICING grok-image-video-1.5 \$0.080/second. grok-image-video \$0.050/second. Both billed per second of generated video.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP xAI. Funding and valuation not verified in this pass. Distribution via X platform integration.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · music / cue sheets (synchronized audio)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- \$0.05-0.08/second undercuts most frontier models with audio included
- Backed by xAI's compute buildout
- Consumer distribution through X drives volume and iteration speed
- Simple, published, flat per-second pricing

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Thin public documentation — capabilities, duration and resolution limits undocumented
- Closed weights, no local path
- No production layer of any kind
- No enterprise/production credibility in film; content-moderation reputation is a liability for commercial delivery
- Unclear commercial-use and indemnification posture

<https://docs.x.ai/docs/models> · <https://fal.ai/models?categories=text-to-video>

fal.ai fal.ai/pricing INDIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

The inference marketplace where nearly every video model is resold at a published per-second price — effectively the public price index that Cinamate's cost claims will be measured against.

fal.ai describes itself as 'The Fastest Generative AI Platform for Developers,' hosting models from Google, OpenAI, xAI, Alibaba, ByteDance, ElevenLabs and Black Forest Labs behind one API with transparent per-second or per-video pricing. Its video catalogue currently spans Seedance 2.5, Gemini Omni, Kling 3.0, Veo 3.1, MiniMax H3, Wan, LTX-2.5 (pro and fast), Grok

Imagine 1.5 Video and Hailuo. For a product like Cinamate, fal is simultaneously the easiest way to add cloud fallback for users without a local GPU, and the benchmark that makes any inflated 'savings' claim checkable in thirty seconds.

KEY FEATURES · Single API across Google, OpenAI, xAI, Alibaba, ByteDance, Lightricks, Kuaishou, MiniMax · Published per-second and per-video pricing for every hosted model · Wan 2.5 \$0.05/s, Kling 2.5 Turbo Pro \$0.07/s, Veo 3 \$0.40/s, Ovi \$0.20/video · Kling 3.0 Pro \$0.112-\$0.196/s; Hailuo 02 \$0.045/s · Optimized inference — speed is the explicit product claim · Hosts open-weight models (LTX-2.5, Wan) as well as proprietary ones

PRICING Per-model, published. Verified examples: Wan 2.5 \$0.05/second; Kling 2.5 Turbo Pro \$0.07/second; Veo 3 \$0.40/second; Ovi \$0.20/video; Kling 3.0 Pro \$0.112/s (no audio), \$0.168/s (audio), \$0.196/s (audio + voice control); MiniMax Hailuo 02 \$0.045/second or \$0.27 per 6-second video at 768p.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded 2021 by Burkey Gur and Gorkem Yurtseven. States it is 'backed by the best Silicon Valley investors and angels' and that its solutions 'support hundreds of millions of customers.' No specific funding amount or valuation disclosed on the about page.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation (as the cloud alternative to a local GPU) · Cinamate's ~\$110-per-feature price quote — fal makes the comparison arithmetic trivial

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Transparent, verifiable per-second pricing across every major model
- No GPU required — removes Cinamate's hardware precondition entirely
- Model-agnostic: users are never stranded on one vendor's roadmap
- Trivially integrated by any competitor wanting generation
- Makes any Cinamate pricing claim externally auditable

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Pure infrastructure — no application, no workflow, no production management
- No editor, boards, budget, contracts, casting or deliverables
- Costs scale linearly with usage; no flat per-feature quote
- Developer-facing, not usable by a single non-technical producer

<https://fal.ai/pricing> · <https://fal.ai/about> · <https://fal.ai/models?categories=text-to-video> · <https://fal.ai/models/fal-ai/kling-video/v3/pro/text-to-video>

Genmo Mochi 1 github.com/genmoai/mochi **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

A 10B Apache-2.0 open video model that was significant in late 2024 and has been effectively dormant since — a cautionary example of open-weight roadmap risk.

Mochi 1 is a 10B-parameter diffusion video model released under Apache 2.0, generating 480p video. It requires roughly 60GB VRAM on a single GPU, though ComfyUI optimization brings it under 20GB. Native ComfyUI support landed 5 November 2024 and LoRA fine-tuning support 26 November 2024. Despite 63 commits on main and open issues, no substantive model release has followed, leaving it two generations behind the current open frontier.

KEY FEATURES · 10B parameters, Apache 2.0 licence · 480p output · ~60GB VRAM single-GPU; under 20GB via ComfyUI optimization · Native ComfyUI support · LoRA fine-tuning support

PRICING Free under Apache 2.0 — unrestricted commercial use.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Genmo. Funding not verified in this pass. Repo shows 63 commits on main.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Apache 2.0 with no revenue threshold or usage restriction
- LoRA fine-tuning for custom looks
- ComfyUI integration makes it runnable on prosumer hardware

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Effectively abandoned — last meaningful update November 2024
- 480p only; not remotely a delivery format
- ~31-frame generations in the documented examples
- No audio
- 60GB VRAM baseline without ComfyUI optimization
- No application layer whatsoever

<https://github.com/genmoai/mochi>

Meta Movie Gen ai.meta.com/research/movie-gen INDIRECT LOW VERIFIED

Meta's media foundation models — capable on paper, filmmaker-tested via Blumhouse, and still not a shipped product or an open release.

Movie Gen is Meta's family of 'media foundation AI models' that 'use simple text inputs to produce custom videos and sounds, edit existing videos or transform your personal image into a unique video.' Capabilities span text-to-video in multiple aspect ratios, text-instructed video editing, personalized video from an uploaded photo, and sound-effect and soundtrack generation. Distribution has been limited to a Creative Industry Feedback Program in which 'Blumhouse, an award-winning production company, selected filmmakers to create videos with Movie Gen before its public debut.' The page states no model size, no weight release, and no launch date — it remains research-stage.

KEY FEATURES · Text-to-video across multiple aspect ratios · Text-instructed editing of existing video · Personalized video from a user photo · Sound effects and soundtrack generation from text · Blumhouse Creative Industry Feedback Program with selected filmmakers · Research-stage; no public product

PRICING Not applicable — no public product, no API, no weights released.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Meta. Research-stage with a filmmaker feedback program (Blumhouse). No model size or weight availability disclosed; no public debut date given.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation (potential) · music / cue sheets (soundtrack and SFX generation) · The Cutting Room (text-instructed video editing)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Integrated video, sound effects and soundtrack generation in one model family
- Direct relationships with a real production company (Blumhouse) — the credibility Cinamate lacks with press declining
- Meta-scale research and compute if it ever ships

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not a product — nothing to buy, no API, no weights, no launch date
- Stale: still framed as pre-debut research with no recent milestone on the page
- No production management, editorial, finance or legal layer even in concept
- Meta has repeatedly deprioritized creative-tool launches

<https://ai.meta.com/research/movie-gen/>

NVIDIA Cosmos (Predict 2.5) github.com/nvidia-cosmos/cosmos-predict2.5 INDIRECT LOW VERIFIED

NVIDIA's open-weight world foundation models — aimed at robotics and autonomous vehicles rather than filmmaking, and already deprecated in favour of Cosmos 3.

Cosmos-Predict2.5, released 6 October 2025, comes in 2B and 14B parameter variants and 'unifies Text2World, Image2World, and Video2World into a single model' for predicting future video states from multimodal inputs. Weights are distributed on Hugging Face under the NVIDIA Open Model License (source code is Apache 2.0), so it is open-weight but not OSI open-source. The stated target is 'physical AI applications such as autonomous vehicles (AVs), robots, and video analytics AI agents,' with specialized autonomous-driving and robotics variants. The repository notes it is deprecated in favour of Cosmos 3, with 'only limited maintenance updates' going forward.

KEY FEATURES · 2B and 14B parameter variants · Unified Text2World / Image2World / Video2World in one model · NVIDIA Open Model License on weights; Apache 2.0 on code · Weights distributed via Hugging Face · Specialized AV (auto/multiview) and robotics variants · Deprecated in favour of Cosmos 3

PRICING Weights free to download under the NVIDIA Open Model License — a proprietary licence, not an OSI open-source one. Exact commercial terms not reviewed in detail in this pass.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP NVIDIA. Corporate-backed; the strategic point is that the GPU vendor Cinamate depends on for local inference is itself shipping open-weight video models.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation (marginally — as an open-weight local option)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Backed by the company that makes the GPUs Cinamate's local generation runs on
- Open weights with unified text/image/video conditioning
- NVIDIA's optimization stack makes local inference genuinely fast

<https://github.com/nvidia-cosmos/cosmos-predict2.5>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Built for physical AI (AVs, robotics), not cinematic generation — wrong aesthetic target
- Already deprecated with only limited maintenance updates
- NVIDIA Open Model License is proprietary, not permissive open source
- No documented VRAM, resolution or duration specs in the repo content reviewed
- No audio, no application layer, no production management

Open-Sora (HPC-AI Tech) github.com/hpcaitech/Open-Sora INDIRECT LOW VERIFIED

An 11B Apache-2.0 open video model notable mainly for its \$200k training-cost claim — but its repo last pushed April 2026, leaving it well behind the current open frontier.

Open-Sora 2.0, released 12 March 2025 under Apache-2.0, is an 11B-parameter video generation model (earlier versions were 1B and 3B). It supports 256px and 768px resolution with frame counts of 4k+1 under 129, across 16:9, 9:16, 1:1 and 2.39:1 aspect ratios. VRAM is substantial: 44.3-60.3GB peak across 8 GPUs for 768x768, and roughly 52.5GB for single-GPU inference at 256x256. The project's headline claim is 'Training a Commercial-Level Video Generation Model in \$200k.' The repo shows 1,333 commits with ongoing VAE and transformer refinements, but no release newer than 2.0 was found.

KEY FEATURES · 11B parameters, Apache-2.0 licence · Fully open training recipe, not just weights · 256px and 768px resolution, multiple aspect ratios · Frame counts of 4k+1, under 129 · \$200k claimed end-to-end training cost · Actively committed repo (1,333 commits)

PRICING Free. Apache-2.0 licence — unrestricted commercial use, no revenue threshold.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP HPC-AI Tech (also behind Colossal-AI). Corporate/open-source project; funding not verified in this pass.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Apache-2.0 — the most permissive terms available, no revenue cap
- Full open training recipe enables fine-tuning on a house style or a production's look
- Zero licence cost

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Stale — Open-Sora 2.0 dates to March 2025 and is materially behind LTX-2.5, HunyuanVideo-1.5 and Wan 2.2
- 768px maximum resolution — not a delivery format
- 44-60GB VRAM, beyond a typical single-operator workstation
- No audio generation
- Nothing above the model: no application, workflow, editorial or production management

△ Fact-check: actively maintained — repo pushed April 2026, ~29,300 stars, Apache-2.0. An earlier 'dormant since March 2025' claim was wrong.

<https://github.com/hpcaitech/Open-Sora>

Pika pika.art/pricing INDIRECT LOW VERIFIED

A consumer-focused video generator that has visibly fallen off the frontier — still shipping Pika 2.5 while rivals ship v3 lines with native audio.

Pika sells credit-based access to Pika 2.5 plus a set of branded effect tools: Pikaframes, Pikascenes, Pikadditions, Pikaswaps, Pikatwists and Pikaffects. The free tier restricts Pika 2.5 to 480p and image-to-video only; paid tiers unlock all resolutions and faster generation. All paid plans include watermark-free downloads, commercial use rights and purchasable rollover credits. Notably, the pricing page shows no model newer than Pika 2.5 — a meaningful signal given that Veo, Sora, Kling, Seedance, Luma and Runway have all shipped major new versions.

KEY FEATURES · Pika 2.5 across all tiers (all resolutions on paid plans) · Pikaframes, Pikascenes, Pikadditions, Pikaswaps, Pikatwists, Pikaffects · Watermark-free downloads and commercial use on paid tiers · Rollover credit purchases · Tiered generation speed

PRICING Free \$0/mo (80 monthly video credits, Pika 2.5 at 480p, image-to-video only). Standard \$8/mo billed yearly (700 credits). Pro \$28/mo billed yearly (2,300 credits, marked 'Best value'). Fancy \$76/mo billed yearly (6,000 credits).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Pika Labs. Funding not verified in this pass. Consumer-oriented user base.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · boards (effects and scene tools)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Cheap consumer entry at \$8/mo billed yearly
- Explicit commercial use rights on paid tiers
- Distinctive effect tools with real consumer traction

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Stale: still on Pika 2.5 while the category has moved to v3-class models with native audio
- No audio generation indicated
- Consumer/social-clip oriented, not production — no professional delivery formats
- Zero production management, editorial, finance or legal surface
- Closed weights, no local option
- Free tier capped at 480p

<https://pika.art/pricing>

Replicate replicate.com/pricing **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

The other major model-hosting marketplace, billing either per second of output video or by raw GPU hardware time for custom deployments.

Replicate hosts public generative models behind a single API with per-output pricing, and additionally rents GPU hardware directly for custom or fine-tuned model deployment. Its video catalogue includes community-packaged versions of open models — the pricing page verified wavespeedai/wan-2.1-i2v-480p at \$0.09 per second of output video and wavespeedai/wan-2.1-i2v-720p at \$0.25 per second. Broader video model coverage exists on individual model pages but is not enumerated on the pricing page.

KEY FEATURES · Per-second-of-output billing on hosted video models · Raw GPU hardware rental for custom and fine-tuned models · Community-packaged open models (Wan, and others on model pages) · Single API across many model families · Useful as a cloud fallback for users without a local GPU

PRICING wavespeedai/wan-2.1-i2v-480p \$0.09 per second of output video; wavespeedai/wan-2.1-i2v-720p \$0.25 per second. Hardware billed separately by GPU-time for custom deployments. Full video model pricing not enumerated on the pricing page.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Replicate. Funding and valuation not verified in this pass.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation (as a hosted alternative) · Cinamate's cost-per-feature comparison basis

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- No GPU required; hardware rental available for custom model work
- Supports fine-tuning and custom deployments Cinamate does not offer
- Transparent published rates
- Large developer community and model catalogue

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Notably more expensive per second than fal for equivalent open models (\$0.25/s vs \$0.05/s for Wan)
- Hosts an older Wan generation (2.1) on the pricing page
- No application layer, no production management, no editor
- Developer tool, unusable by a non-technical single operator

<https://replicate.com/pricing>

Stability AI — Stable Video Diffusion stability.ai/stable-video **INDIRECT** **LOW** **UNCERTAIN**

The original open video weights, now conspicuously absent from the frontier — licence-gated and with no evidence of current development.

Stable Video Diffusion is described on Stability's site simply as 'A model for generating video based on Stable Diffusion,' with access routed through a 'Get license' call to action. The page surfaced no model version numbers, resolution or duration specifications, open-weight availability terms, pricing, or development-status information. Given that Stability once defined open generative weights, its near-total absence from the current video landscape — it appears in none of the aggregator catalogues surveyed (fal, Replicate, Runway, Adobe) — is itself the finding.

KEY FEATURES · Stable Video Diffusion, built on Stable Diffusion · Licence-gated access via 'Get license' · Historically open weights; current terms undocumented on the page

PRICING Not disclosed. Access is licence-gated; no membership, commercial or per-generation figures were published on the page fetched.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Stability AI. Current funding, ownership and development status not verified in this pass. Notably absent from every model marketplace catalogue reviewed here.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Brand recognition in open generative models
- Historically permissive open-weight distribution

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No evidence of current frontier video development
- Absent from fal, Replicate, Runway and Adobe catalogues
- No published specifications, pricing or licence terms on its own product page
- Licence-gated rather than freely downloadable
- No application, editorial or production layer

<https://stability.ai/stable-video>

Zhipu / Z.ai CogVideoX github.com/zai-org/CogVideo **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

An early open-weight video model whose real distinction is the lowest VRAM floor in the category — 7GB quantized — but it has not shipped a new model since November 2024.

CogVideoX1.5-5B, released 8 November 2024, is a 5B-parameter open video model generating 5- or 10-second clips at 1360x768, with frame counts following a 16N+1 rule where N is at most 10. Its notable property is accessibility: Diffusers BF16 runs from 10GB VRAM and INT8 quantized from 7GB, making it viable on an RTX 3060. Speed is the tradeoff — roughly 1,000 seconds on a single A100 at 50 steps for a 5-second video, about half that on an H100. CogVideoX-5B uses the bespoke CogVideoX LICENSE while CogVideoX-2B is Apache 2.0. Last repo update was the CogKit fine-tuning framework in March 2025.

KEY FEATURES · 5B parameters; 2B variant also available · Runs from 10GB VRAM (BF16) or 7GB (INT8 quantized) · Viable on an RTX 3060 — lowest hardware floor verified · 1360x768 resolution · 5-second or 10-second durations · CogVideoX-2B is Apache 2.0; 5B uses the CogVideoX LICENSE · CogKit fine-tuning framework (March 2025)

PRICING Free. CogVideoX-2B under Apache 2.0; CogVideoX-5B under the CogVideoX LICENSE (terms not reviewed in detail in this pass).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Zhipu AI / Z.ai (China). Funding not verified in this pass.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio / Local Generation · Cinamate's local-GPU hardware requirement

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Lowest verified VRAM floor of any open video model (7GB INT8) — widens the addressable hardware base
- 10-second durations exceed most open competitors' 5-second clips
- 2B variant is Apache 2.0 with no restrictions
- Fine-tuning framework available

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Badly stale — no new model since November 2024, and the ecosystem has moved on
- Extremely slow: ~1,000 seconds on an A100 for a 5-second clip
- No audio generation
- 1360x768 is below delivery resolution
- No application, editorial or production-management layer
- Split licensing between the 2B and 5B variants complicates commercial use

<https://github.com/zai-org/CogVideo>

§16 AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound

Market read · This category has already had its reckoning, and Cinamate has not. Three things define it in August 2026. First, consolidation at the top: ElevenLabs raised \$500M at an \$11B valuation in February 2026 and is the default voice layer, while Respeecher (~\$3M raised) survives on film credits and Replica Studios — the first AI voice company to sign with SAG-AFTRA — simply shut down. Second, provenance became the product. Flawless holds TPN Gold, SOC 2, ISO 27001 and MPA compliance and built A.R.T., a contractual actor-consent gate, in collaboration with SAG-AFTRA and the DGA. Deepdub is TPN and SOC 2 certified with a licensed voice library and artist royalties. Adobe, Stability, Soundraw and Beatoven all lead with training-data provenance; Beatoven and Voice-Swap carry Fairly Trained certification; Resemble pivoted to selling deepfake detection and EU AI Act watermarking. Third, the music side has been settled by litigation: Suno paid Warner \$500M and licensed BMG, Udio settled with Universal and relaunched licensed-only after giving users 48 hours to download their work. Pricing has bifurcated — self-serve at \$6-\$50/month, enterprise unpriced. The implication for Cinamate is sharp. Its music/cue-sheet room collides with an entrenched incumbent (Music Reports processes over a million cue sheets a year for Netflix, HBO and Apple), and its generated-voice elements land in a market where certification, union agreements and documented consent are now table stakes. Cinamate's disclosed lack of TPN, SOC 2, a public team or press coverage is not a cosmetic gap here — it is the exact axis on which this category now competes. Note also that ElevenLabs' self-serve music licence explicitly excludes film and TV, and that F5-TTS and AudioCraft ship non-commercial weights: a local-GPU render pipeline can silently produce an undeliverable film.

ElevenLabs elevenlabs.io DIRECT CRITICAL VERIFIED

The default AI voice layer for the industry — TTS, voice cloning, 90+ language dubbing and licensed AI music — now a \$11B company.

ElevenLabs is the category's centre of gravity for generated speech. Dubbing v2 covers 90+ languages with an audio-to-audio model that conditions on the source performance rather than a transcript, doing sync-aware translation and automatic voice cloning that preserves speaker identity. The Voice Library holds 11,000+ voices plus an Iconic Voices Marketplace with formally licensed estates and characters (Sir Michael Caine, Stan Lee, Judy Garland, John Wayne, Dr. Maya Angelou, Sir Laurence Olivier, Megatron, Optimus Prime). ElevenProductions is a managed service layering human translators, voice casting and professional mixing on top for studios and broadcasters; Eleven Music v2 generates songs the company says are trained on licensed data only.

KEY FEATURES · Dubbing v2, 90+ languages, audio-to-audio (not transcript-driven), sync-aware translation · Instant Voice Cloning (Starter+) and Professional Voice Cloning (Creator+) · Voice Library: 11,000+ voices, 70+ languages; \$1M+ paid out to voice contributors · Iconic Voices Marketplace with licensed estates and IP characters · Eleven Music v2 — 'trained on licensed data only', cleared for commercial use · ElevenProductions — human translators, casting and mixing for studios/broadcasters · Scribe speech-to-text with speaker identification · AI Speech Classifier for detecting ElevenLabs-generated audio

PRICING Free \$0 (10k credits/mo); Starter \$6/mo (30k); Creator \$22/mo (121k); Pro \$99/mo (600k, 44.1kHz PCM via API); Scale \$299/mo (1.8M, 3 seats); Business \$990/mo (6M, 10 seats, fully managed dubbing, low-latency TTS at \$0.05/min); Enterprise custom (HIPAA BAAs, SSO). Annual = 10x monthly. Automatic dubbing 2,000-3,000 credits; Dubbing Studio 5,000-10,000 credits; extra dubbing minutes \$2.23-\$4.91.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded 2022 by Piotr Dąbkowski (ex-Google ML) and Mati Staniszewski (ex-Palantir). Series D Feb 2026: \$500M at an \$11B valuation, with IPO signalled. Prior: Series C Jan 2025 \$180M at \$3.3B; Series B Jan 2024 \$80M at \$1.1B; Series A Jun 2023 \$19M at ~\$100M. 2026 entertainment pushes include the album 'The Next', the '11 Voices' documentary series at SXSW 2026, and a pledged \$1B in free voice-restoration technology.

COLLIDES WITH · music/cue sheets room (Eleven Music generation) · Studio/Local Generation — any generated-voice element in a script-to-screen render · casting (synthetic/replica voice casting) · distribution deliverables (localized audio, dub tracks) · post and dailies (ADR-substitute dialogue) · The Cutting Room (dialogue replacement inside the edit)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Named, funded, public company with a disclosed team — Cinamate has no public team and press declined
- Published self-serve pricing at every tier vs. Cinamate's invite-only beta
- 90+ dubbing languages; Cinamate has no localization story at all
- Formally licensed iconic-voice marketplace with disclosed contributor payouts — a real consent chain
- Ships its own synthetic-audio detection classifier (provenance evidence Cinamate cannot produce)
- Enterprise controls Cinamate lacks entirely: SSO, HIPAA BAAs, elevated concurrency
- Managed human-in-the-loop service tier for studios

<https://elevenlabs.io/pricing> · <https://elevenlabs.io/dubbing> · <https://elevenlabs.io/music> · <https://elevenlabs.io/voice-library>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- It is an audio layer, not a production system — no budget, stripboard, call sheets, permits, contracts, tax credit, festivals or finance
- Eleven Music's self-serve plans explicitly bar film, TV and Studio Games commercial use, so it does not solve the film music-clearance problem Cinamate's cue-sheet room targets
- No cue sheet generation, PRO reporting or music-rights administration
- No TPN certification named publicly — same gap Cinamate has
- Cloud-metered credits vs. Cinamate's \$0.00 cloud billing on local GPU

Flawless www.flawlessai.com **ADJACENT** **CRITICAL** **VERIFIED**

Visual dubbing and in-vision ADR for major studios — and the company that already holds every certification Cinamate is missing.

Flawless builds what it calls assistive (not generative) AI for film and television, deliberately positioning against generative tools. DeepEditor syncs new or adjusted dialogue to existing footage, enabling in-vision ADR, performance transfer between takes, censorship editing and pacing changes without a reshoot. TrueSync localizes dialogue with matched lip movement for international markets. Critically, its Artistic Rights Treasury (A.R.T.) requires actor review and consent before any performance change is released, and media is ring-fenced to the contracted project rather than used for general model training.

KEY FEATURES · DeepEditor — in-vision ADR, performance transfer, censorship editing, performance/pacing editing · TrueSync — visual dubbing with synchronized lip movement for localization · Artistic Rights Treasury (A.R.T.) — mandatory actor review and consent gate · Media ring-fenced to the contracted project; not used for general model training · Claims outputs are 'cinema-quality, copyrightable' and fully owned by the production · TPN Gold Status, SOC 2, ISO 27001 and MPA compliance · Developed in collaboration with SAG-AFTRA, DGA, Avid, ACE and MPEG

PRICING Not disclosed. Enterprise/production engagement only; no self-serve tier or published rate card.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Named customers on its own site include Disney, Warner Bros., HBO, Netflix, Amazon Prime Video, Sony Pictures, Apple TV+ and Hulu. Funding amounts and investors are not disclosed on the site and I could not verify them from another source — treat funding as unverified.

COLLIDES WITH · post (ADR and dialogue finishing) · editor / The Cutting Room (performance and dialogue editing inside the cut) · vfx (face and performance manipulation) · distribution deliverables (localized versions) · contracts/deal memos and clearance (likeness consent chain) · casting (performance transfer between takes/performers)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Holds TPN Gold, SOC 2, ISO 27001 and MPA compliance — the exact four-way certification gap Cinamate discloses
- Formal collaboration with SAG-AFTRA, DGA, Avid, ACE and MPEG — Cinamate cites union rate cards but has no union relationship
- A named, contractual consent mechanism (A.R.T.) rather than an assertion of good intent
- Named tier-one studio and streamer customers, verifiable on the record
- Avid collaboration implies a native NLE path — Cinamate has no NLE plugins
- Explicit copyrightability/ownership position for outputs, which matters for E&O and chain of title

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Single-purpose: dialogue and performance only — no development, budgeting, scheduling, finance, tax credit, permits or festival tooling
- No self-serve access and no published price; a single-operator indie cannot buy it
- Requires an existing shot production — it does not generate a film from a screenplay
- No music, cue sheet or sound design capability at all
- Studio-scale engagement model is the opposite of Cinamate's private single-operator positioning

Music Reports (Cuetrak / Songdex) www.musicreports.com DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

The incumbent cue-sheet and music-rights administrator — over a million cue sheets a year for Netflix, HBO, Apple and Amazon.

Music Reports is the entrenched infrastructure for exactly the job Cinamate's cue-sheet room does. Cuetrak creates, manages and distributes cue sheets at scale in multiple languages and formats, processing over a million cue sheets annually. Songdex Marketplace handles publisher licensing and rights clearance in 'days, not months'. It also runs royalty administration end to end — 12M+ royalty statements a year and \$400M+ in annual royalties paid to publishers, PROs, CMOs and labels — plus license status reporting, catalog health checks and unclaimed royalty processing.

KEY FEATURES · Cuetrak — cue sheet creation, management and distribution at scale, multi-language and multi-format · Songdex Marketplace — publisher license acquisition and rights clearance · Royalty administration and reporting to PROs, CMOs, publishers and labels · License status reporting and catalog health checks · 1M+ cue sheets processed annually; 12M+ royalty statements; \$400M+ administered

PRICING Not disclosed. Enterprise/service engagement; no published rate card.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP 500+ global clients named on its own site including Netflix, Apple, Amazon Music, Spotify, Peloton, HBO and major broadcasters. Long-established US company; funding/ownership not disclosed on the site.

COLLIDES WITH · music/cue sheets room — head-on collision, this is the exact function · clearance (music rights clearance) · distribution deliverables (cue sheets are a required delivery item) · finance / The Money Room (music licensing cost and royalty reporting)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Actually delivers cue sheets that PROs and broadcasters accept — the format is only useful if the receiving body takes it
- Direct integrations and standing relationships with PROs, CMOs, publishers and labels
- Named delivery relationships with Netflix, HBO, Apple and Amazon — the very buyers an indie must deliver to
- Verifiable throughput at scale (1M+ cue sheets/yr) vs. Cinamate's unverified module
- Handles the money side (royalty administration), not just the paperwork

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Music only — no schedule, budget, permits, casting, dailies, edit or finance
- Enterprise-only, no self-serve, no published price; not accessible to a single-operator indie
- No generation capability of any kind
- Legacy service-bureau model rather than a modern integrated workspace

<https://www.musicreports.com/>

Respeecher www.respeecher.com DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

The speech-to-speech house with real feature-film credits — Luke Skywalker, Darth Vader, Alien: Romulus — and a Pro Tools plugin.

Respeecher does professional speech-to-speech voice conversion for film, television, games and music: cross-language cloning, emotion transfer, accent correction, voice de-aging, character voice adaptation and singing-voice synthesis. It is the most credited AI voice vendor in narrative film. Its Voice Marketplace offers 40+ pre-made AI voices with a Pro Tools plugin, and Respeecher Space provides a real-time TTS API for voice agents. It has taken a public stance on consent, endorsing the NO FAKES Act.

KEY FEATURES · Speech-to-speech voice conversion preserving performance · Cross-language cloning, emotion transfer, accent correction, voice de-aging · Singing voice synthesis · Voice Marketplace with 40+ pre-made voices and a Pro Tools plugin · Respeecher Space — real-time TTS API · Stated consent mechanisms requiring performer approval and voice-origin tracking

PRICING Partly disclosed: a Pay As You Go option for the TTS API at '\$2/hour, cancel anytime', with free testing. Film/TV production engagements are quoted individually — 'flexible pricing models', no published rate card. A dedicated pricing page returned 404.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Ukrainian company founded February 2018 in Kyiv by Alex Serdiuk, Dmytro Bielievtsov and Grant Reaber. Graduated Comcast NBCUniversal LIFT Labs Accelerator (Techstars) 2019. Has raised over \$3M total per Wikipedia — small relative to ElevenLabs. Emmy win (2021) for the Richard Nixon deepfake documentary. Credits: The Mandalorian (Luke Skywalker, 2020), The Book of Boba Fett (2022), Obi-Wan Kenobi (Darth Vader from James Earl Jones archive, 2022), Alien: Romulus, Emilia Pérez, Better Man (2024). Reported 2025 revenue €24,609,300.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio/Local Generation (generated voice performances) · post and dailies (ADR-substitute dialogue) · casting (digital voice doubles, de-aging) · music/cue sheets room (singing voice synthesis) · contracts/deal memos and clearance (performer consent riders)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Actual A-list feature credits and an Emmy — real production validation vs. Cinamate's self-reported metrics
- Native Pro Tools plugin; Cinamate explicitly has no native NLE/DAW plugins
- Public policy posture (NO FAKES Act endorsement) and documented consent workflow
- Eight years of operating history with a named founding team

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Very thinly capitalized (~\$3M raised) relative to the category — durability risk
- Voice only: no picture, no schedule, no budget, no rights or finance tooling
- No published pricing for film work; project-by-project quoting
- Kyiv-based operations carry ongoing geopolitical risk
- No editorial timeline or deliverables management

<https://www.respeecher.com/> · <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Respeecher>

Adobe (Firefly audio, Enhance Speech, Premiere Pro AI) www.adobe.com/products/firefly.html

ADJACENT

HIGH

VERIFIED

Generative music, speech, sound effects and dubbing bundled into the tools editors already run — with an explicit commercial-safety claim.

Adobe has folded generative audio into Firefly and the Creative Cloud video tools: generative music described as 'studio-quality music for your videos, licensed to use anywhere', generative speech for voiceover and narration, generative sound effects, and audio translation across 20+ languages that preserves the original speaker's voice and pitch. Enhance Speech, the free AI dialogue cleanup filter, remains available through Adobe Podcast. The strategic weapon is the provenance claim: Firefly models are trained on licensed Adobe Stock and expired-copyright public domain content, and Adobe states it does not train on Creative Cloud subscribers' personal content.

KEY FEATURES · Generative music licensed for use anywhere · Generative speech / text-to-speech voiceover · Generative sound effects · Audio translation and AI dubbing across 20+ languages preserving voice and pitch · Enhance Speech — free AI dialogue cleanup · 'Commercially safe' training-data claim: licensed Adobe Stock + public domain only · Distribution inside Premiere Pro and Audition, where post already lives

PRICING Firefly Free (limited daily generations); Firefly Standard \$9.99/mo (2,000 generative credits); Firefly Pro \$19.99/mo (4,000 credits plus unlimited access to select models for year one); Firefly Pro Plus \$34.97/mo, discounted from \$49.99 (10,000 credits). Enhance Speech is free. Creative Cloud subscriptions priced separately.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Adobe is a public company; the audio AI sits inside the Creative Cloud install base that already dominates editorial and audio post. Specific audio-AI usage figures not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · music/cue sheets room (generative music and SFX) · editor / The Cutting Room (Premiere is the incumbent NLE) · post (Audition, Enhance Speech, dialogue cleanup) · dailies · distribution deliverables (audio translation/dubbing) · Studio/Local Generation (generated voice and score)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Already installed on the machines Cinamate's target users edit on — zero adoption friction
- An explicit, articulated commercial-safety and training-data provenance position; Cinamate discloses no training-data provenance for its generation stack
- Cheap, published, self-serve pricing at \$9.99-\$34.97/mo
- Enterprise trust, security posture and legal weight of a public company
- Deep NLE integration — the exact gap Cinamate lists (no native NLE plugins)

<https://www.adobe.com/products/firefly.html> · <https://podcast.adobe.com/en/enhance>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No production management whatsoever — no budget, stripboard, call sheets, permits, contracts, tax credit, finance or festivals
- No cue sheet generation or music-rights administration
- Credit-metered cloud billing vs. Cinamate's \$0.00 cloud cost on local GPU
- Generic creative tooling, not film-specific: no union rate cards, no waterfall modeling, no breakeven analysis
- Cannot take a screenplay to a finished picture

Deepdub deepdub.ai **ADJACENT** **HIGH** **VERIFIED**

AI dubbing and voice cloning for streamers and studios, with TPN and SOC 2 certification and a licensed voice library with artist royalties.

Deepdub does end-to-end localization for media: text-to-speech, speech-to-speech instant voice conversion and translation, voice cloning, and live dubbing for broadcast. Its differentiator is the rights posture — a library of 1,000+ licensed voices across 100+ languages with the claim that 'all voices are licensed for any usage' and studio-safe licensing that survives downstream distribution, backed by a Voice Artist Royalty Program. Accent control spans 130+ languages. It has expanded sideways into voice agents and video personalization.

KEY FEATURES · eTTS (emotional text-to-speech) and speech-to-speech instant voice conversion · Voice Library: 1,000+ licensed voices, 100+ languages · Accent Control across 130+ languages · Live dubbing for broadcast and FAST channels · Voice Artist Royalty Program — talent paid on usage · 'Studio-safe licensing' explicitly covering downstream distribution · TPN and SOC 2 certified

PRICING Not disclosed. Free API trials offered; no public rate card or self-serve tiers.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded by brothers Ofir Krakowski (CEO) and Nir Krakowski (CTO). Raised \$20M announced February 2022 (TechCrunch); investors shown on its site include Insight Partners, Swift Ventures, Booster Ventures and Stardom. Claims 5,000+ titles localized. Named customers include Paramount, Netflix, Hulu, Prime Video and Legendary Entertainment.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution deliverables (dub tracks, localized versions, M&E requirements) · Studio/Local Generation (generated voice elements) · post and dailies (dialogue) · casting (synthetic voice casting from a licensed library) · clearance (voice/likeness rights chain)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- TPN and SOC 2 certified — both certifications Cinamate lists as known gaps
- Named tier-one streamer customers (Netflix, Paramount, Prime Video, Hulu)
- A licensed voice library with a royalty program — a defensible consent and provenance chain
- Named investors and a verifiable \$20M raise vs. Cinamate's undisclosed backing
- 100+ languages of localization capability Cinamate does not have

<https://deepdub.ai/> · <https://deepdub.ai/about> · <https://techcrunch.com/tag/deepdub/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Localization only — no budgeting, scheduling, permits, contracts, tax credit, finance or festival modules
- No published pricing; enterprise sales cycle unsuited to a single independent producer
- No editorial timeline, no cue sheets, no music generation
- Funding data is four years stale in public sources; no verified recent round

Suno suno.com **ADJACENT** **HIGH** **VERIFIED**

The largest consumer AI music generator, now half-licensed after a \$500M Warner settlement and a BMG deal — but carrying a documented scraping history.

Suno generates full songs with vocals and instrumentation from text prompts, and since September 2025 has offered Suno Studio, a DAW-like environment with stem separation, custom model tuning and user-designed plugins. Commercial rights are granted

on paid tiers for newly created songs. Its legal position has moved substantially: the RIAA sued in June 2024, Warner Music Group settled in November 2025 for \$500M with Suno gaining rights to train on WMG's catalog, and BMG signed a global licensing agreement in August 2026 — but a 2026 leak indicated the platform had scraped roughly 370,813 hours of content from YouTube, Deezer and Genius.

KEY FEATURES · Text-to-song generation with vocals and instrumentation, v5.5 model (March 2026) · Suno Studio (Sept 2025) — DAW environment, custom model tuning, design-your-own plugins · Stem separation (2 types on Pro, 3 on Premier) · Voice recording input and advanced editing · Commercial rights on Pro and Premier for newly created songs · Licensing deals with Warner Music Group (Nov 2025) and BMG (Aug 2026)

PRICING Free \$0 (50 credits/day, ~10 songs, no downloads from 9/3/26, no stem separation); Pro \$8/mo (2,500 credits, ~500 songs, 20 downloads/mo, commercial rights); Premier \$24/mo (10,000 credits, ~2,000 songs, 60 downloads/mo, Suno Studio).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded by four ex-Kensho employees — Mikey Shulman, Georg Kucsko, Martin Camacho, Keenan Freyberg — in Cambridge, MA. Public launch December 2023 after open-sourcing the Bark TTS model in April 2023. Acquired concert platform Songkick as part of the Warner settlement. Funding/valuation not verified here.

COLLIDES WITH · music/cue sheets room — score and source cues · Studio/Local Generation (soundtrack for generated footage) · post (temp music and final music) · The Cutting Room (music sync feature) · clearance (music provenance and E&O exposure)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Two real label licensing agreements (WMG, BMG) — a partial provenance chain Cinamate has nothing equivalent to
- Suno Studio is a functioning DAW-like environment with stem separation and custom model tuning
- Consumer-scale distribution and price point (\$8/mo) far below any studio tool
- Actual settlement money and label control mechanisms in place

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- The leaked scraping history (~370,813 hours from YouTube, Deezer, Genius) is a live E&O and chain-of-title problem for anyone scoring a distributable film with it
- Only newly created songs carry commercial rights; the back catalogue of user work is murkier
- No cue sheet output, no PRO registration, no rights administration — the film-delivery half is entirely absent
- Removing downloads from the Free tier on 9/3/26 signals tightening, not loosening, of rights
- No connection to any production workflow

<https://suno.com/pricing> · https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Suno_AI

Soundmouse www.soundmouse.com

DIRECT

MEDIUM

UNCERTAIN

Long-standing UK cue-sheet, music-reporting and audio-fingerprinting vendor for broadcasters — but its site would not load for verification.

Soundmouse is known in the industry as a music reporting, cue sheet and audio fingerprinting provider serving broadcasters and producers, generating the music usage reports that PROs require. I could not verify any of this first-hand: every URL attempted (soundmouse.com, /products, /cue-sheets) returned either an empty response or a 'PACErrorPage - Sorry, but an error occurred' message. All product, customer, pricing and location detail below should be treated as unverified background rather than confirmed fact, and the vendor's current operating status should be re-checked before the report ships.

KEY FEATURES · Cue sheet creation and delivery for broadcasters (unverified) · Music usage reporting to PROs (unverified) · Audio fingerprinting for music identification in finished programmes (unverified) · Rights management workflows (unverified)

PRICING Not disclosed and not verifiable.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Not verified. Understood to be UK-based and broadcaster-focused, but no page loaded to confirm customers, headcount, ownership or current status. The persistent site errors are themselves a signal worth re-checking.

COLLIDES WITH · music/cue sheets room — head-on if the company is operating · clearance (music rights) · distribution deliverables (cue sheets as a delivery requirement)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- If operating, it has the PRO and broadcaster delivery relationships that make a cue sheet actually accepted — the thing Cinamate's module cannot assert
- Audio fingerprinting closes the loop between a finished mix and the cue sheet, which manual entry cannot

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Site was unreachable across multiple attempts — the company's current status is genuinely unclear
- Music reporting only; no production management, editorial, generation or finance
- No published pricing or self-serve access
- Legacy broadcaster tooling, unlikely to serve a single-operator independent

<https://www.soundmouse.com/> · <https://soundmouse.com/>

AudioShake www.audioshake.ai ADJACENT MEDIUM VERIFIED

AI stem and dialogue separation used by Netflix productions, Disney and Warner Bros. to rescue dialogue and build Atmos stems.

AudioShake separates any audio into its component parts — vocals, instruments, dialogue, music and effects — without needing the original multitrack. In film post its most valuable function is dialogue isolation: extracting clean dialogue from a mixed track, which it claims lifts transcription accuracy by 25% or more for captioning and dubbing pipelines. It also does multi-speaker separation for overlapping voices, creates stems for Dolby Atmos and Sony 360 spatial mixes, and supports copyright compliance work by identifying composition versus recording elements for licensing and royalty allocation.

KEY FEATURES · Stem separation without original multitracks · Dialogue isolation — claimed 25%+ improvement in transcription accuracy · Multi-speaker separation for overlapping voices · Stem creation for Dolby Atmos and Sony 360 spatial audio · Composition vs. recording identification for licensing and royalty allocation · REST API and custom data services

PRICING Not disclosed. Free Indie tier for independent artists, a 'Live' team platform, REST API access and custom data services; no published rate card.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Named customers include ESPN, Disney Music Group, Warner Bros., BET, Netflix productions, Empire Records and Concord Music Group. Funding not disclosed on the site.

COLLIDES WITH · post (dialogue cleanup, M&E preparation) · dailies (audio prep for review) · distribution deliverables (M&E stems, Atmos deliverables — a hard delivery requirement Cinamate does not address) · music/cue sheets room (composition vs. recording identification for cue sheet accuracy) · The Cutting Room (dialogue and music separation in the edit)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Solves a real, unavoidable delivery requirement — M&E stems and Atmos deliverables — that Cinamate's deliverables module does not cover
- Named tier-one studio and network customers, externally verifiable
- Free Indie tier plus an API — accessible without an enterprise contract
- Directly supports cue-sheet accuracy by identifying composition vs. recording rights

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Single-function utility, not a platform — no schedule, budget, contracts, finance or festivals
- No published pricing
- No generation capability, no voice cloning, no music creation
- No rights administration or cue sheet output of its own

<https://www.audioshake.ai/>

Camb.ai www.camb.ai ADJACENT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Real-time and film-grade dubbing across 150+ languages, with a director-control TTS model and live sports deployments at NASCAR, Ligue 1 and IMAX.

Camb.ai positions itself as 'the localization infrastructure for the internet'. Its MARS8 family spans four variants: MARS-Flash (600M, low-latency conversational), MARS-Pro (600M, expressive voiceover), MARS-Instruct (1.2B, described as fine-grained director-level control specifically for film and TV dubbing) and MARS-Nano (50M, on-device/edge). DubStream delivers real-time dubbing for live sports commentary and entertainment, and the platform supports 150+ languages. Unusually for the category it publishes a full self-serve rate card.

KEY FEATURES · MARS8 model family incl. MARS-Instruct (1.2B) for director-level film/TV dubbing control · DubStream — real-time live dubbing, now generally available · 150+ languages supported · On-device MARS-Nano for edge deployment · Watermark removal from the Essentials tier upward · Custom AI voices from 1 (Essentials) to unlimited (Expert)

PRICING Free \$0 (2,000 credits/mo, 2 min dubbing, watermarked); Essentials \$5/mo (10,000); Pro \$20/mo (40,000); Premier \$75/mo (150,000); Advanced \$250/mo (500,000); Expert \$900/mo or \$9,000/yr (1.8M credits, 180+ min dubbing, 50 seats, analytics). Annual billing saves roughly 8-17%.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Named deployments include Ligue 1, NASCAR, FanCode (cricket), IMAX, Comcast NBCUniversal, India Today (claimed 500M viewers), Arab News (launched in 50 languages) and Dentsu. Funding not disclosed on the site; unverified.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution deliverables (localized audio, dub tracks) · Studio/Local Generation (generated dialogue) · post and dailies · casting (synthetic voice casting) · screening (multi-language review)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Fully published self-serve pricing across six tiers — radical transparency vs. an invite-only beta
- 150+ languages and a live real-time dubbing product Cinamate has nothing comparable to
- Named blue-chip broadcast deployments (NASCAR, IMAX, Comcast NBCUniversal) that are externally verifiable
- An on-device model variant (MARS-Nano) that fits local-GPU workflows better than Cinamate's own cloud sync
- Explicitly markets director-level control for film/TV dubbing

<https://www.camb.ai/> · <https://www.camb.ai/pricing>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Localization only — no development, scheduling, budgeting, contracts, permits, finance, tax credit or festivals
- No editorial timeline, no cue sheets, no music
- No stated TPN/SOC 2 certification — same certification gap as Cinamate
- Consent and licensing posture for cloned voices is not documented on the pages reviewed
- Dubbing minute allowances are modest even at \$900/mo (180+ min) for feature work

Descript www.descript.com **ADJACENT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

Text-based video and audio editor with built-in voice cloning, Studio Sound and 30+ language dubbing — the closest thing to a consumer Cutting Room.

Descript edits video and audio by editing the transcript, and has absorbed a generative stack around that: custom voice clones (the feature formerly branded Overdub, now sold as 'custom voice clones' — the Overdub name is stale), Studio Sound audio enhancement, 25-60+ stock AI voices, an AI assistant called Underlord, video generation, custom avatars and translation/dubbing across 30+ languages on the Business tier. It also does multitrack transcription, dynamic captions and remote recording via Rooms.

KEY FEATURES · Text-based editing of video and audio via transcript · Custom voice clones on Hobbyist tier and above · Studio Sound audio enhancement · Underlord AI assistant (full access on Creator+) · Translation and dubbing in 30+ languages (Business tier) · Custom avatar generation, 4K export, multitrack transcription · Rooms remote recording; unlimited dynamic captions

PRICING Free \$0 (60 min media/mo, 100 one-time AI credits, 720p); Hobbyist \$16/mo (\$24 monthly-billed) (10 hrs, 400 credits, 1080p); Creator \$24/mo (\$35) (30 hrs, 800 credits, 4K, full Underlord, video generation); Business \$50/mo (\$65) (40 hrs, 1,500 credits, translation/dubbing, avatars, up to 5 seats, SLA); Enterprise custom (SSO/SCIM, custom legal terms).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Widely adopted in podcast/creator and corporate video. Ownership and funding not disclosed on the pricing page; not verified here.

COLLIDES WITH · editor / The Cutting Room — direct collision on browser-adjacent multitrack editing · Studio/Local Generation (generated voice and video) · post (Studio Sound dialogue cleanup) · dailies (transcription and review) · distribution deliverables (localized versions) · screening (shareable cuts)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Mature, widely used editor with transcript-driven editing — a genuinely differentiated edit paradigm
- Published self-serve pricing from \$16/mo; anyone can buy it today
- Enterprise tier with SSO/SCIM and custom legal terms
- Dubbing in 30+ languages built into the editor
- Voice cloning bundled at \$16/mo vs. Cinamate's un-priced generation stack

<https://www.descript.com/pricing>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No EDL/OTIO conform, no professional finishing path — Cinamate's Cutting Room at least claims conform
- Creator-tier tool, not a film-post tool: no colour pipeline, no LUT handling, no VFX
- Zero production management — no budget, schedule, permits, contracts, finance, tax credit
- Hour-metered media caps (10-40 hrs/mo) are restrictive for a feature
- No cue sheets, no music rights, no clearance

DISCO (disco.ac) disco.ac ADJACENT MEDIUM VERIFIED

The music supervisor's catalogue and sync-licensing workspace, with an AI discovery add-on — where film music actually gets found and cleared.

DISCO is the working environment for music supervisors, labels, publishers and rights holders: catalogue management, unlimited playlists, format conversion, batch CSV editing, custom inboxes for receiving files, password-protected sharing with expiring URLs, and DDEX ingestion plus distributor integration on higher tiers. It has a dedicated music supervisor path for film and TV. An optional Discovery Suite adds AI auto-tagging, similarity search, lyric transcription and instrumental extraction.

KEY FEATURES · Catalogue management with unlimited playlists, format conversion and batch CSV editing · Secure sharing: custom inboxes, password protection, URL expiration · DDEX ingestion and distributor integration on higher tiers · Dedicated music supervisor workflow for film/TV · Discovery Suite add-on: AI auto-tagging, similarity search, lyric transcription, instrumental extraction

PRICING Billed annually: Artist \$10.80/mo; Plus \$16.99/mo; Pro \$26.99/mo (most popular); Enterprise custom. Discovery Suite add-on \$10/mo.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Serves music supervisors, labels, publishers, artists, management firms and marketing teams globally. Funding and customer counts not disclosed on the pricing page.

COLLIDES WITH · music/cue sheets room (song selection, catalogue, metadata that feeds a cue sheet) · clearance (sync licensing workflow) · finance / The Money Room (music spend) · screening (secure sharing of music selects)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Where music supervisors already work — the relationship layer Cinamate has no access to
- Published, genuinely cheap pricing (\$10.80-\$26.99/mo) with a self-serve signup
- DDEX ingestion and distributor integration — real industry metadata standards support
- Security controls (expiring URLs, password protection) that read as production-grade

<https://disco.ac/pricing>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Does not generate cue sheets or file them with PROs — it manages the catalogue, not the rights reporting
- No production management, scheduling, budgeting or finance
- No generation capability
- Music-only scope

Papercup (RWS) www.papercup.com ADJACENT MEDIUM LIKELY

AI dubbing with human verification, now absorbed into RWS as its AI dubbing orchestration layer for TV, film and digital.

Papercup built premium AI dubbing that pairs synthetic voice technology with a human verification step, aimed at media localization for streaming platforms and broadcasters. Search results indicate it is now part of RWS, the large localization group, functioning as RWS's 'AI dubbing orchestration layer, purpose-built for TV, film and digital content'. Its site blocked direct fetching, so product detail and current pricing could not be confirmed first-hand.

KEY FEATURES · AI dubbing combining synthetic voice with human verification · Media localization for streaming and broadcast · Positioned as an orchestration layer rather than a raw model · Backed by RWS's enterprise localization infrastructure

PRICING Not disclosed. Enterprise/service engagement; no public rate card observed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Now part of RWS. Standalone funding history, current headcount and revenue are unverified — papercup.com returned HTTP 403 and RWS's own site returned no usable content on fetch. Treat the RWS relationship as reported rather than directly confirmed.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution deliverables (dub tracks, localized versions) · Studio/Local Generation (generated voice) · post · casting (voice casting for dubs)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Human-in-the-loop verification produces broadcast-acceptable output, which pure automation does not
- Backing of a large established localization group gives enterprise credibility and delivery capacity
- Existing broadcaster and streamer relationships

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Localization only — no production management of any kind
- Absorption into a larger group suggests the standalone product thesis did not hold
- No public pricing, no self-serve access
- No verifiable current product detail; status should be re-checked before relying on it

<https://www.papercup.com/> · <https://www.bing.com/search?q=Papercup+AI+dubbing+company+2025+status>

Resemble AI (incl. Chatterbox open source) www.resemble.ai ADJACENT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Pivoted from voice cloning to enterprise deepfake detection and watermarking — while giving away Chatterbox, an MIT-licensed cloning model with 26k GitHub stars.

Resemble AI has repositioned as a multimodal deepfake detection and watermarking platform for enterprises, with DETECT-World (claimed 99.5% audio, 96% image, 98% video accuracy) and PerTh Multimodal watermarking marketed for EU AI Act compliance. It still ships voice AI — Resemble TTS, Voice Creation, Audio and Speech-to-Speech — and it open-sourced Chatterbox under MIT: Turbo (350M, English, low latency), Nano (110M, CPU at 3x realtime), Multilingual V3 (500M, 23+ languages), with built-in Perth watermarking and paralinguistic tags like [laugh] and [cough]. That combination — sell detection, give away generation — reshapes the whole category's economics.

KEY FEATURES · DETECT-World multimodal deepfake detection (audio/image/video) · PerTh Multimodal imperceptible watermarking, positioned for EU AI Act compliance · Chatterbox open-source TTS/voice cloning, MIT licence, 26.1k GitHub stars, 3.5k forks · Chatterbox variants: Turbo 350M, Nano 110M (CPU), Multilingual V3 500M / 23+ languages · Perth watermarking embedded in every Chatterbox generation · Resemble TTS, Voice Creation, Speech-to-Speech · Identity enrollment, meetings detection, intelligence insights

PRICING Flex \$0/mo pay-as-you-go (credits never expire, 1 seat); Team \$350/mo or \$280/mo annual (5 seats); Business \$1,000/mo or \$800/mo annual (20 seats, SSO); Enterprise custom (on-prem, custom model training, SLAs). Usage: audio detection \$0.035/sec (Flex) or \$0.015/sec (Team/Business); image \$0.035 / \$0.015 each; video \$0.07 / \$0.03 per sec; watermark encode \$0.0005/call, decode \$0.0002/call. Chatterbox is free under MIT.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Established voice AI vendor now enterprise detection-led. Chatterbox has 26.1k stars and 3.5k forks. Funding not disclosed on the pages reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio/Local Generation (Chatterbox is a free local-GPU substitute for any generated-voice element) · clearance and contracts/deal memos (provenance verification, watermark detection) · post and dailies (dialogue generation) · safety/compliance posture more broadly

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- MIT-licensed Chatterbox runs on the same local GPU Cinamate requires — a free substitute for Cinamate's voice generation, with no per-render price
- Ships watermarking and detection: an auditable provenance trail Cinamate does not offer
- EU AI Act compliance positioning — a regulatory readiness Cinamate has not addressed
- Published per-second usage pricing and enterprise SSO/on-prem options
- Nano runs on CPU at 3x realtime — no GPU requirement at all

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not a production system in any sense — no scheduling, budgeting, contracts, permits, finance or delivery
- Core commercial focus has drifted to detection, away from creative voice work
- No film-specific tooling: no ADR workflow, no cue sheets, no editorial
- Voice cloning consent policy not documented on the pages reviewed

<https://www.resemble.ai/> · <https://www.resemble.ai/pricing/> · <https://github.com/resemble-ai/chatterbox>

Stability AI — Stable Audio 3.0 stability.ai/stable-audio ADJACENT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Licensed-data music and SFX generation with enterprise legal indemnification and open-weight small/medium models.

Stable Audio 3.0 is a generative audio family for music and sound effects with remix, segment editing and style-based generation. It comes in Large (enterprise sound production), Medium (full song composition, open weights) and Small / Small SFX (mobile-optimized, open weights). Stability's commercial pitch rests on provenance: models are 'trained on fully licensed data', described as 'commercially safe models, trained on fully licensed datasets', with legal indemnification provided under the Enterprise licence. Deployment options span self-hosted enterprise, managed API, downloadable open weights and a web app.

KEY FEATURES · Stable Audio 3.0 in Large / Medium / Small / Small SFX variants · Remix, segment editing and style-conditioned generation · Trained on fully licensed datasets · Legal indemnification under the Enterprise licence · Open weights for Small and Medium · Self-hosted enterprise deployment, managed API, or web app

PRICING Not disclosed. Enterprise licence and API pricing available on request only.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Stability AI is a well-known generative-model company; specific Stable Audio revenue, customers and funding are not disclosed on the product page.

COLLIDES WITH · music/cue sheets room (score and source cues, SFX) · post (sound design) · Studio/Local Generation (self-hosted generation on local GPU) · clearance (provenance of generated music)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Explicit legal indemnification under the enterprise licence — Cinamate offers no indemnity for anything it generates
- Fully licensed training data claim, stated on the record
- Self-hosted deployment fits the local-GPU model without a vendor cloud
- Open weights for the smaller models give a free on-ramp

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Audio only — no picture, no production management, no rights administration
- No published pricing at all; enterprise sales motion
- No cue sheet output or PRO registration
- No consent/likeness mechanism (not a voice product)

<https://stability.ai/stable-audio>

Artlist artlist.io INDIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Royalty-free music, SFX and footage bundled with a 70+ app AI suite at \$11.99-\$41.67/mo — the cheap default for indie soundtracking.

Artlist sells a subscription covering royalty-free music, sound effects and footage with a commercial licence, and has bolted on an AI Suite of 70+ apps plus Artlist Studio, metered in credits that convert to images, video, voiceover hours and songs. At the AI Core tier a subscriber gets roughly 4,000 images, 250 videos, 8 hours of voiceover and 266 songs per month. Stock catalogue plans for music, SFX and footage are sold separately from the AI plans.

KEY FEATURES · Royalty-free music, SFX and footage with commercial licence · AI Suite: 70+ AI apps plus Artlist Studio · Credit-metered generation across images, video, voiceover and music · Unlimited generations on select models at Core and above · Custom Business tier with enterprise security, SSO and a dedicated account manager

PRICING AI Starter \$11.99/mo annual (16,500 credits/mo: ~1,650 images, 103 videos, 3 hrs voiceover, 110 songs); AI Core \$23.99/mo (40,000 credits: ~4,000 images, 250 videos, 8 hrs voiceover, 266 songs); AI Creator \$41.67/mo (80,000 credits: ~8,000 images, 500 videos, 16 hrs voiceover, 533 songs); Custom Business on request. Stock catalogue plans priced separately.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Large consumer/creator subscription business. Funding, revenue and subscriber counts not disclosed on the pricing page.

COLLIDES WITH · music/cue sheets room (score and source music) · post (SFX) · Studio/Local Generation (AI voiceover and video generation) · The Cutting Room (music sync)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Extremely cheap and instantly buyable — \$11.99/mo against an invite-only beta
- Pre-cleared, royalty-free licence removes the clearance problem rather than managing it
- Bundles music, SFX, footage and AI generation in one subscription
- Custom Business tier offers SSO and enterprise security, which Cinamate does not

<https://artlist.io/pricing>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- The pricing page does not specify film/TV licensing coverage — a real risk for theatrical or broadcast delivery
- No cue sheet generation or PRO registration
- No production management whatsoever
- Royalty-free library music is a different creative product from a composed score
- Credit metering makes feature-length use expensive fast

Epidemic Sound www.epidemicsound.com INDIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Royalty-free catalogue with customized enterprise plans for TV, cinema and SVOD, plus AI soundtracking and AI voiceovers.

Epidemic Sound licenses a large royalty-free music and SFX catalogue on subscription, with all rights included globally and no additional payment when content is published or monetized. It maintains a dedicated filmmaking path and offers customized Enterprise plans specifically for TV, cinema, streaming VOD and live events on a 12-month minimum term. Its Studio product uses AI to sync music and effects to picture, and it offers AI voiceovers as a separate tool.

KEY FEATURES · Royalty-free catalogue with unlimited downloads and usage; 'all rights included, globally' · Customized Enterprise plans for TV, cinema, SVOD and live events (12-month minimum) · Studio — AI-assisted soundtracking, syncing music and effects to video · AI voiceovers · Pro or Enterprise plan required for ad campaigns · Single track licences available without subscription

PRICING Not disclosed on the pages fetched — plan names (Creator, Pro, Business, Enterprise) are shown but the pricing tables did not render. Enterprise is custom-quoted on a 12-month minimum term. Free trial available.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Large, well-established royalty-free music business with a global artist and producer roster. Track count, revenue and funding not disclosed on the pages reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · music/cue sheets room (score and source music, SFX) · The Cutting Room (Studio's music sync feature directly parallels Cinamate's music sync) · post · Studio/Local Generation (AI voiceovers)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Has an actual film/TV/cinema/SVOD licensing product — Epidemic solves the theatrical clearance question that Cinamate's cue-sheet room only documents
- Pre-cleared global rights with no back-end payments, which is what an E&O insurer wants to see
- Studio's AI sync-to-picture is a direct, shipping analogue to Cinamate's music sync feature
- Established brand with a decade of production usage

<https://www.epidemicsound.com/> · <https://www.epidemicsound.com/pricing/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Prices not publicly listed for the film/TV tiers; enterprise quoting with a 12-month lock-in
- Library music only — no original score, no generation of new material to picture
- No cue sheet generation or PRO filing
- No production management, scheduling, budgeting or finance

iZotope RX 12 (Native Instruments) www.izotope.com/en/products/rx.html INDIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

The industry-standard dialogue repair suite — 50+ tools, neural-net scene rebalancing, \$1,399 perpetual and already on every post desk.

RX is the de facto standard for audio repair and restoration in film and television post. RX 12 Advanced ships more than 50 tools, several powered by neural networks: Dialogue Isolate (removing noise and reverb from speech), the new Scene Rebalance (independently adjusting dialogue, music and effects within a finished scene), Music Rebalance for stem separation, a rebuilt De-bleed using state-of-the-art machine learning, and a Repair Assistant that recognizes problems and proposes fixes. Breath Control, De-plosive and De-ess round out the dialogue chain.

KEY FEATURES · Dialogue Isolate — neural noise and reverb removal from speech · Scene Rebalance (new in RX 12) — independent dialogue/music/effects adjustment · Music Rebalance neural stem separation · De-bleed rebuilt with machine learning · Repair Assistant — automatic problem detection and fix proposals · Breath Control, De-plosive, De-ess for dialogue · 50+ tools total

PRICING RX 12 Advanced \$1,399.00 (perpetual licence). Lower Standard/Elements tiers exist but were not shown on the page reviewed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Long-established post-production standard. The page did not confirm ownership; iZotope's parent (widely reported as Native Instruments / Soundwise) is unverified here.

COLLIDES WITH · post (dialogue repair and restoration) · dailies (audio cleanup on incoming material) · The Cutting Room (audio processing in the edit) · distribution deliverables (M&E separation via Scene Rebalance)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Already the standard on every professional post desk — the incumbency Cinamate must displace
- A one-time \$1,399 perpetual licence with no subscription, no beta gate and no vendor dependency
- Neural Scene Rebalance solves M&E stem extraction from finished mixes — a delivery problem Cinamate does not touch
- Runs as a plugin inside existing DAWs and NLEs, exactly the integration Cinamate lacks

<https://www.izotope.com/en/products/rx.html>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- A repair tool, not a workflow — no project management of any kind
- No generation, no voice cloning, no dubbing, no music creation
- No cue sheets, rights, finance or scheduling
- Expensive relative to the AI-native audio tools at \$6-\$50/mo

Open-source audio stack (F5-TTS, AudioCraft/MusicGen, Stable Audio Open)

github.com/Swivid/F5-TTS

INDIRECT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

Free local-GPU voice and music models that undercut every paid vendor — but most ship non-commercial weights, which is a delivery trap for films.

The open-source stack is the substitute a local-GPU product like Cinamate is most likely to be built on and most likely to be replaced by. F5-TTS ('A Fairytaler that Fakes Fluent and Faithful Speech with Flow Matching') does zero-shot voice cloning with multi-style and multi-speaker generation. Meta's AudioCraft bundles MusicGen (text-and-melody-conditioned music), AudioGen (text-to-sound-effects), EnCodec, MAGNeT, AudioSeal watermarking, MusicGen Style and JASCO. Stability's Stable Audio Small and Medium ship open weights. The critical and widely misunderstood detail is the licence split: F5-TTS code is MIT but its pretrained models are CC-BY-NC because they were trained on Emilia; AudioCraft code is MIT but its model weights are CC-BY-NC 4.0. Both explicitly prohibit commercial use of the weights.

KEY FEATURES · F5-TTS — zero-shot cloning, diffusion transformer + ConvNeXt V2, multi-style/multi-speaker, 15.2k stars · MusicGen — text and melody-conditioned music generation · AudioGen — text-to-sound-effects generation · AudioSeal — open watermarking for generated audio · MAGNeT, JASCO (chord/melody/drum conditioning), MusicGen Style · Stable Audio Small and Medium with downloadable open weights · AudioCraft: 23.6k stars, 2.7k forks

PRICING Free. Cost is GPU time and engineering only.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP F5-TTS 15.2k GitHub stars / 2.2k forks. AudioCraft 23.6k stars / 2.7k forks. Meta and Stability AI as institutional backers of the respective releases.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio/Local Generation — the direct substitute for Cinamate's generated-voice and generated-score elements · music/cue sheets room (MusicGen, AudioGen, Stable Audio Open) · post (sound design) · The Money Room's price-per-render pitch (open source renders at zero marginal licence cost)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free and self-hosted — the strongest possible answer to Cinamate's '\$0.00 cloud billing' argument
- Runs on the same local GPU Cinamate already requires, with no vendor at all
- AudioSeal provides open watermarking; Cinamate offers no provenance marking
- No invite gate, no beta, no vendor dependency or shutdown risk
- Full auditability of what the model is and how it is licensed

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- The licensing trap is severe: F5-TTS and AudioCraft pretrained weights are CC-BY-NC — non-commercial only. Any film delivered with them has a defective chain of title unless the weights are relicensed or retrained
- No consent mechanism, no talent licensing, no royalty path — a direct union and likeness risk
- No product, no UI, no support; requires real ML engineering
- No cue sheets, no rights administration, no production management
- Quality and consistency below the commercial leaders for narrative dialogue

Udio www.udio.com **INDIRECT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

Ex-DeepMind music generator that settled with Universal and relaunched licensed-only — after giving users 48 hours to download their catalogue.

Udio generates music with vocals and instrumentation from text prompts specifying genre, lyrics and style. Founded in December 2023 as Uncharted Labs by four former Google DeepMind researchers, it went viral in 2024 with the 'BBL Drizzy' parody. The RIAA sued it alongside Suno in June 2024. In October 2025 it reached a licensing settlement with Universal Music Group and agreed to launch a platform trained only on authorized and licensed music — a total business-model reset. Existing users were given 48 hours to download their creations before the platform moved to a streaming-based system.

KEY FEATURES · Text-prompt music generation with vocals and instrumentation · Extendable track generation from initial 30-second segments · Post-settlement: trained only on authorized and licensed music · Streaming-based delivery model replacing free downloading

PRICING Not disclosed — the pricing page did not render on fetch, and post-settlement terms could not be confirmed. Originally offered 600 free songs per month in public beta.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded December 2023 by David Ding (CEO), Conor Durkan, Charlie Nash and Yaroslav Ganin. Raised \$18.5M total (\$8.5M initial, \$10M seed) from Andreessen Horowitz, will.i.am, Common, Mike Krieger and others. Notably under-capitalized relative to Suno's settlement scale.

COLLIDES WITH · music/cue sheets room · Studio/Local Generation (soundtrack) · post · clearance (music provenance)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- A completed label settlement and a licensed-only training commitment — a real provenance reset
- Named, credentialed founding team (ex-DeepMind) and named investors
- Institutional music-industry relationships post-settlement

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- The 48-hour download ultimatum shows how fragile rights to generated content can be — a serious warning for anyone scoring a film on a generative platform
- Move to a streaming-based system may make download-and-deliver workflows impossible
- Current pricing and commercial-use terms could not be verified — status is effectively stale
- No cue sheets, rights administration, or production management
- Thinly funded relative to its legal exposure

<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Udio> · <https://www.udio.com/>

Altered Studio (Altered AI) www.altered.ai **ADJACENT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

Professional voice-changing, dubbing and ADR platform with custom voice cloning — but no documented consent procedure.

Altered runs two products: Altered Studio, a voice content creation platform for media production that edits voices inside audio and video files using both traditional effects and AI tools, and Altered Real-Time Pro, a live voice changer for calls. The voice-changing engine modifies accent, age, gender and identity while preserving speech tempo and inflection. It positions Studio for dubbing and ADR work and offers text-to-speech alongside a Custom Voice Cloning service for creating voices of specific individuals including actors.

KEY FEATURES · Voice changing across accent, age, gender and identity, preserving tempo and inflection · Altered Studio — voice editing inside audio and video files for media production · Dubbing and ADR workflows · Text-to-speech narration · Altered Real-Time Pro — live voice changer · Custom Voice Cloning for specific individuals

PRICING Not disclosed — the pricing page did not render usable content. Free trials offered for Studio; Real-Time Pro is downloadable.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Not disclosed. Headquarters, funding, team size and customer counts are all unverified.

COLLIDES WITH · post (ADR) · Studio/Local Generation (generated voice performances) · dailies · casting (voice alteration and doubling) · The Cutting Room (voice editing within the cut)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Purpose-built ADR and dubbing workflow inside a media production platform — deeper than a generic TTS tool
- Preserves performance timing and inflection, which matters for lip-sync in ADR
- Free trial available now, no invite gate

<https://www.altered.ai/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Offers custom voice cloning of named individuals including actors with no documented consent procedure on the site — a material union and likeness risk in a film context
- No published pricing
- No production management, rights, cue sheets or finance
- Company scale, location and funding entirely undisclosed

Murf AI murf.ai **ADJACENT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

Volume TTS and dubbing platform at \$0.01/minute API pricing, claiming voice actors are paid royalties on every use.

Murf runs a broad AI voice platform: Murf Studio for voiceover with 200+ expressive voices across 35+ languages, Murf Dubbing for instant dubbing in 40+ languages, and an API with two models — Falcon 2 (sub-100ms latency for real-time agents) and Gen2 (customization-focused, claimed 99.38% pronunciation accuracy). Voice cloning is offered via a 'Say it My Way' feature. On consent it states voices are 'created with permission and partnership from professional voice actors who earn royalties every time their voices are used'.

KEY FEATURES · Murf Studio — 200+ voices, 35+ languages · Murf Dubbing — 40+ languages · Falcon 2 API with sub-100ms latency; Gen2 for customization · Voice cloning via 'Say it My Way' · AI voice agents for enterprise use cases · Stated royalty model for contributing voice actors

PRICING API stated at \$0.01 per minute. Free tier limited to 10 minutes of generation with no commercial rights. Paid monthly subscription plans with higher limits and commercial licences exist but the pricing page did not render exact tier prices.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Claims 10 million+ developers, businesses and creators across 190+ countries and 300+ Fortune 2000 companies. These are self-reported figures. Funding not disclosed on the pages reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio/Local Generation (generated voice elements) · distribution deliverables (localized audio) · post and dailies · casting (stock synthetic voice selection)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Aggressive published API pricing at \$0.01/minute
- A stated per-use royalty model for voice actors — a consent chain Cinamate does not describe for its own generated voices
- 40+ dubbing languages and 190+ country reach
- Large enterprise footprint claimed

<https://murf.ai/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Corporate/e-learning voiceover DNA, not narrative film — no ADR workflow, no performance direction
- No production management, cue sheets, rights or finance
- Free tier carries no commercial rights
- Consent claims are self-asserted with no third-party certification or union agreement

Beatoven.ai www.beatoven.ai **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

Fairly Trained certified AI music generation from India, paying contributing musicians — but the platform retains ownership of generated tracks.

Beatoven.ai generates background music and sound effects from text descriptions via its 'maestro' model, aimed at video, podcast, game, film and advertising creators. Its distinguishing claim is provenance: it holds Fairly Trained certification and states that 'musicians receive equitable compensation when they contribute their music to Beatoven.ai'. The licensing structure is worth reading carefully — users receive a non-exclusive perpetual licence to the generated track and can monetize content, but the company retains ownership of the tracks themselves.

KEY FEATURES · 'maestro' text-to-music model plus sound effects generation · Fairly Trained certified — third-party training-data provenance certification · Contributing musicians compensated · Non-exclusive perpetual licence to generated and downloaded tracks · Claims 2 million+ creators and 15 million+ tracks generated

PRICING Not disclosed on the pages fetched; the pricing URL returned 404.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP India-based. Claims 2M+ creators and 15M+ tracks generated. Funding not disclosed; unverified.

COLLIDES WITH · music/cue sheets room · Studio/Local Generation (score for generated footage) · post · clearance (music provenance)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Fairly Trained certification is independent third-party validation of training-data provenance — Cinamate has no third-party certification of any kind
- Explicit musician compensation model
- Established scale claims in a crowded generative music market

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Beatoven retains ownership of generated tracks — the user only gets a licence, which complicates chain of title for a film
- No cue sheet generation or rights administration
- Pricing not published on accessible pages
- Background-music orientation, not scoring to picture
- No production management

<https://www.beatoven.ai/>

Dubverse dubverse.ai **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

India-built dubbing platform for 10+ Indian and global languages with 200+ AI voices — a regional player at consumer scale.

Dubverse, operated by Lensmatic Solutions Pvt Ltd, offers AI video dubbing, text-to-speech and subtitle generation. It translates video into multiple languages while claiming to preserve emotional content, and supports custom voice cloning, batch processing and mixed-language scripts such as Hinglish or Spanglish. Its distinctive value is coverage of Indian languages and code-switched speech that Western vendors handle poorly.

KEY FEATURES · AI video dubbing across 10+ Indian and global languages · 200+ customizable AI voices varying by age, gender, tone and dialect · Custom voice cloning · Batch processing · Mixed-language script support (Hinglish, Spanglish) · Subtitle generation

PRICING Not disclosed on the homepage; a pricing page is linked but not detailed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP India-based (Lensmatic Solutions Pvt Ltd). Self-reported: 500K+ brands, 11M+ creators and developers, 5M+ voiceovers generated daily. Funding not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution deliverables (localized versions) · Studio/Local Generation (generated voice) · post

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Genuine strength in Indian-language and code-switched dubbing — a market Cinamate does not address at all
- Handles mixed-language scripts, which most Western dubbing tools fail on
- Large claimed creator base in a fast-growing regional market

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Creator/marketing orientation, not narrative feature production
- No published pricing
- No consent policy disclosed for cloned voices
- No production management, rights, cue sheets or finance
- Self-reported metrics with no external verification

<https://dubverse.ai/>

Ethovox ethovox.ai **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

Voice-actor-founded AI voice company with a formal SAG-AFTRA agreement and an authenticated, licensed Voice Vault.

Ethovox is a voice AI company built by actors — 'premium voice service created by actors and empowered by AI' — creating digital voice twins of professional performers for entertainment, enterprise and communications. Its core assets are Voice Vault, a database of union and non-union actors, high-quality source audio (24-bit 48kHz, professionally mastered), patent-pending audio editing software, and a foundational voice model in development that it says will be fully authenticated and properly licensed rather than trained on unlicensed voice data. It has a formalized AI voice actor agreement with SAG-AFTRA, and co-founder Cissy Jones sits on the NAVA Advisory Board.

KEY FEATURES · Formal SAG-AFTRA AI voice actor agreement · Voice Vault — database of union and non-union actors · 24-bit 48kHz professionally mastered source audio · Patent-pending audio editing software · Foundational voice model built on authenticated, licensed data · Actor-founded governance with NAVA advisory representation

PRICING Not disclosed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Active startup with technology collaborators i2a2.io and OfSpectrum, and coverage in IGN, Bloomberg and Variety. Funding, headcount and revenue not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · casting (voice casting and digital doubles) · Studio/Local Generation (generated voice elements) · contracts/deal memos (performer consent and licensing terms) · clearance (likeness rights chain) · post (ADR-substitute dialogue)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Holds an actual SAG-AFTRA agreement — the single most valuable asset in this category for anyone whose film needs union clearance, and something Cinamate has no path to
- Actor-founded and union-advised governance gives it legitimacy Cinamate cannot buy
- Fully authenticated and licensed data provenance as a design principle, not a claim

<https://ethovox.ai/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Early-stage: the foundational model is still in development
- No published pricing and no self-serve access
- Voice only — no production management, editorial, music or finance
- Small and unfunded relative to ElevenLabs; durability risk (see Replica Studios)

Krotos Audio www.krotosaudio.com

INDIRECT

LOW

VERIFIED

Sound design plugins used by Warner Bros., Disney and Epic, with real-time sync-to-picture and perpetual \$199-\$399 licences.

Krotos makes sound design software for post-production professionals — 'design unique sound in seconds, not hours'. Krotos Studio is an AI-powered platform that syncs sound to picture in real time and generates transitions, ambiences, Foley and cinematic effects. Dehumaniser 2 turns vocals into creature and character voices in real time. Reformer Pro sculpts Foley and textures live by blending libraries. Weaponiser handles weapons and footsteps; Igniter handles vehicles and engines. Integrated sound effects libraries cover footsteps, animals, Foley, combat, sci-fi, mechanical and water.

KEY FEATURES · Krotos Studio — AI-powered, syncs sound to picture in real time · Dehumaniser 2 — real-time creature and character vocal design · Reformer Pro — real-time Foley and texture sculpting · Weaponiser and Igniter for weapons/footsteps and vehicles/engines · Integrated SFX libraries across many categories · Plugin form factor, running inside existing DAWs

PRICING Dehumaniser 2 \$399; Reformer Pro \$399; Igniter \$399; Weaponiser \$199. Krotos Studio pricing not shown on the page reviewed. Perpetual licences rather than subscriptions.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Named users include Warner Bros., Sony Pictures, Disney, Epic Games, Ubisoft, Microsoft and SEGA. Funding and revenue not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · post (sound design and Foley) · Studio/Local Generation (creature/character voice design) · The Cutting Room (audio design in the edit) · vfx (sound for generated elements)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Ships as plugins inside the DAWs post already uses — the native-plugin integration Cinamate explicitly lacks
- Named tier-one studio and game customers
- Perpetual pricing at \$199-\$399 with no subscription or beta gate
- Real-time sync-to-picture that professional sound designers actually use

<https://www.krotosaudio.com/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Narrow sound-design scope — no dialogue, no music rights, no production management
- No cue sheets, budgeting, scheduling, contracts or finance
- Krotos Studio pricing undisclosed
- Requires a skilled sound designer; not single-operator automation

Replica Studios (defunct) replicastudios.com

INDIRECT

LOW

VERIFIED

The first AI voice company to sign a SAG-AFTRA agreement has shut down — a cautionary data point for the whole category.

Replica Studios provided AI voices for games and film and was notable for signing an early agreement with SAG-AFTRA covering AI voice work. As of the current site it has ceased operations: the page states 'Replica Studios has officially signed off' and describes the closure as 'goodbye—for now, probably forever'. The farewell page carries no operational detail about products, pricing or the union agreement's disposition.

KEY FEATURES · AI voice generation for games and film (discontinued) · Early SAG-AFTRA AI voice agreement (status now moot) · Company has ceased operations

PRICING Not applicable — company has shut down.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Defunct. Prior funding, headcount and customer figures not verifiable from the remaining site.

COLLIDES WITH · casting (formerly) · Studio/Local Generation (formerly) · post (formerly)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Nothing — the company no longer operates

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Ceased operations entirely
- Its failure despite holding a first-mover SAG-AFTRA agreement shows that union legitimacy alone does not sustain a standalone AI voice business
- Any production that built on it lost its vendor and potentially its consent paper trail — a direct argument for local, self-hosted generation of the kind Cinamate offers

<https://replicastudios.com/>

Soundraw soundraw.io **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

AI music generation trained only on in-house-created music, with perpetual worldwide licensing and 100% royalties retained by the user.

Soundraw generates royalty-free music and sells it on a clean-provenance argument: the AI was 'trained only on music we create in-house', with 'no scraped songs, no gray areas'. Users retain full ownership — 'every beat is legally yours to use, monetize, and share' and 'keep 100% of the royalties for life' — under a perpetual worldwide licence. Music downloaded during an active subscription stays licensed after cancellation. Stems and WAV are available on higher tiers, and an Enterprise plan offers API access.

KEY FEATURES · Trained exclusively on in-house-created music — explicit no-scraping claim · Perpetual worldwide commercial licence; users keep 100% of royalties · Downloads stay licensed indefinitely after cancellation · Stems and .wav export on Artist Pro and above · Enterprise plan with API access and unlimited downloads

PRICING Creator \$11.04/mo annual or \$16.99/mo (unlimited downloads, .mp3 only, for individuals and companies under 10 employees); Artist Starter \$19.49/\$29.99 (10 downloads/mo, .mp3); Artist Pro \$23.39/\$35.99 (20 downloads/mo, .mp3/.wav/stems); Artist Unlimited \$32.50/\$50 (unlimited, all formats); Enterprise custom with API.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Consumer/creator subscription business. Funding, revenue and user counts not disclosed on the pricing page.

COLLIDES WITH · music/cue sheets room (generated score and source cues) · Studio/Local Generation (soundtrack for generated footage) · post · clearance (music provenance)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- The cleanest training-data provenance story in generative music — in-house-only training is a real E&O advantage
- Perpetual worldwide licence with 100% royalty retention, stated plainly
- Very cheap and immediately purchasable (\$11.04-\$50/mo)
- Post-cancellation licence persistence removes a common subscription trap

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Generic generated music; no scoring-to-picture, no spotting, no composer workflow
- No cue sheet generation or PRO registration — a film still cannot deliver on this alone
- Download caps on most tiers make feature-length scoring awkward
- No production management of any kind
- The Creator tier restricts use to companies under 10 employees

<https://soundraw.io/pricing>

Supertone supertone.ai **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

Seoul voice-intelligence company behind Shift, a real-time voice changer with 100+ voices that runs without a GPU.

Supertone describes itself as a Voice Intelligence Platform, headquartered in Seoul under CEO Hoon Heo. Its product line spans Shift (a real-time AI voice changer with 100+ character voices running on macOS 10.14+ and Windows 10+ 64-bit without requiring a GPU), Clear (audio cleanup) and Air, plus API and on-device solutions. Shift offers low-latency conversion with pitch, emotional-parameter and voice-blending controls, and documented compatibility with Valorant, Discord, OBS and Roblox.

KEY FEATURES · Shift — real-time voice changer, 100+ voices, no GPU required · Low-latency conversion with pitch, emotion and voice-blending controls · Clear and Air products in the same voice-intelligence family · API and on-device deployment options · Cross-platform macOS and Windows support

PRICING Shift, as of the pricing shown dated April 17 2025 (now stale): Free \$0/mo (limited, 3-5 new voices monthly); Starter \$3.99/mo; Pro \$14.99/mo (premium voice collection); Perpetual \$149.99 per voice. Other products' pricing not disclosed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Seoul, South Korea. Widely reported as a HYBE company, but ownership was NOT confirmed on the pages reviewed — treat the HYBE link as unverified. Funding and revenue not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio/Local Generation (generated voice, character voices) · post (voice processing) · casting (character voice creation)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Runs in real time without a GPU — a lower hardware bar than Cinamate's local-GPU requirement
- Very cheap published pricing including a \$149.99 perpetual per-voice option
- On-device and API deployment options
- Established Korean entertainment-industry positioning

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Gaming/VTuber/streaming orientation rather than narrative film production
- Pricing shown is dated April 2025 and should be treated as stale
- No consent policy disclosed on the pages reviewed
- No production management, rights, cue sheets or finance
- Ownership structure unverified

<https://supertone.ai/> · <https://supertone.ai/shift>

Veritone www.veritone.com/solutions/media-entertainment

INDIRECT

LOW

UNCERTAIN

Enterprise AI platform for media supply chains — metadata, rights management and compliance — with a synthetic voice line I could not verify.

Veritone sells an AI platform to media and entertainment organizations for what it calls the intelligent digital supply chain: automated frame-by-frame metadata tagging, AI-driven highlight generation, high-velocity content clipping for multi-platform repurposing, compliance automation, redaction, rights management, and ad attribution and sponsorship analytics. Veritone Voice and MARVEL.ai — its synthetic voice and talent-licensing products — are widely associated with the company but were NOT present on the page reviewed and are unverified here.

KEY FEATURES · Automated frame-by-frame metadata tagging · AI-driven highlight generation and content clipping · Compliance automation and redaction · Rights management · Ad attribution and sponsorship analytics

PRICING Not disclosed on the page reviewed.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Named clients on its own site include HBO, Sony, CBS, NBC, NPR, CNN and A&E. Public-company status, revenue and the current state of the Voice/MARVEL.ai product line could not be confirmed from the page fetched — treat all of that as unverified.

COLLIDES WITH · dailies (metadata tagging and logging) · clearance (rights management) · distribution deliverables · music/cue sheets room (rights reporting, indirectly) · Studio/Local Generation (synthetic voice, unverified)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Named tier-one broadcaster and studio clients
- Enterprise rights-management and compliance tooling at scale
- Established position in the media supply chain that a new entrant cannot replicate quickly

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Broadcast/media-operations orientation, not narrative production — no scheduling, budgeting, permits, contracts or finance
- No published pricing
- Its synthetic voice and talent-licensing products could not be verified and may be de-emphasized
- Not a creative tool; nothing that competes with generation or editorial

<https://www.veritone.com/solutions/media-entertainment/>

Voice-Swap voice-swap.ai

INDIRECT

LOW

VERIFIED

UK artist-consent-first voice platform — Fairly Trained certified, CRAIC member, with published £6.99-£39.99 pricing.

Voice-Swap Ltd runs three services: Voiceover Studio (text-to-speech for media and marketing), Singing Studio (voice swapping and harmony creation for artists), and custom voice model creation for brands and artists. It leads with rights posture —

describing itself as 'rights-first AI infrastructure' and holding memberships in the Fairly Trained initiative and the Creative Rights in AI Coalition, plus affiliations with BMAT and WIPO. Named artist collaborations include Rob Swire (Pendulum) and Diplo.

KEY FEATURES · Voiceover Studio (TTS) and Singing Studio (voice swap, harmonies) · Custom voice model training for artists and brands · Fairly Trained certified; Creative Rights in AI Coalition member · BMAT and WIPO affiliations · VST plugin usage supported (3 credits per use) · Metamorph by AutoTune integration

PRICING Beginner £6.99/mo (50 credits); Pro £9.99/mo (150 credits); Ultimate £39.99/mo (1,000 credits); one-off purchase £11.99 (75 credits). Credit costs: stem separation 3, voice conversion 1, VST use 3, download 5, SoundCloud upload 5, model training 40. TTS charges per character at generation, not download.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP UK company (Voice-Swap Ltd), site copyright 2026. Featured in Billboard, MusicRadar and Music Week. Funding, headcount and revenue not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · music/cue sheets room (vocal performance for score/source) · Studio/Local Generation (generated voice) · post

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Fairly Trained certification and CRAIC membership are independent third-party validations of consent posture — Cinamate has none
- Fully published pricing, including per-action credit costs — unusual transparency
- Named artist collaborators willing to be publicly associated
- VST plugin form factor fits existing DAW workflows

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Music/vocal focus, not narrative dialogue or ADR
- Tiny in scale; credit allowances are hobbyist-sized for feature work
- No production management, cue sheets or rights administration
- Royalty split details are not published despite the rights-first positioning

<https://voice-swap.ai/> · <https://voice-swap.ai/pricing>

§17 Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset tracking

Market read · Structure: this category has consolidated into four platform owners and two roll-ups. Adobe holds Premiere Pro + Frame.io + Firefly; Blackmagic holds Resolve + Blackmagic Cloud + cameras; Autodesk has assembled the entire dailies-to-VFX-tracking chain under Flow (Flow Production Tracking/ShotGrid, Flow Capture/Moxion, and now PIX — pixsystem.com redirects to autodesk.com); Backlight (founded 2021) has rolled up iconik, ftrack, cineSync, Celtx, Wildmoka and Zype; EditShare owns EFS/FLOW/FLEX plus MediaSilo, Screeners and WireDrive. Independents survive at the edges: Colorfront and Codex on dailies/mastering, Pomfort on set, Sohonet and Evercast on real-time review, Foundry on compositing, Kitsu and AYON as open-source trackers. Pricing norms: editorial is nearly free (\$0 Resolve, \$295 Resolve Studio perpetual, \$22.99/mo Premiere). Review and tracking sit at \$9–\$65 per seat (Frame.io \$15–\$25, MediaSilo \$15–\$25, iconik \$9–\$120, Kitsu €20–€35, AYON €19–€38). Only compositing (\$3,839–\$6,379/yr Nuke) and secure enterprise dailies (PIX, Colorfront, Sohonet, Evercast — all quote-only) are expensive. What this means for Cinamate: every AI feature The Cutting Room advertises — rough cut, silence trim, music sync, colour balance — ships today inside Premiere (Remix, Color Match, text-based editing), Resolve 21's Neural Engine, Descript's Underlord, CuttingRoom's Shortcut, Kapwing's Smart Cut. None of it is defensible. Two structural gaps are worse than the feature parity problem: Cinamate claims EDL/OTIO but not AAF, and AAF is the handoff format every finishing house, audio post and Avid cutting room expects — without it the master cannot leave the building professionally. And no TPN or SOC 2, on a netlify.app subdomain, is disqualifying under any studio or distributor security addendum, which is precisely where Evercast, PIX and Frame.io Enterprise compete. Cinamate's only real edge here is that all 28 rooms share one state; no competitor above does that, but a 4-minute sync, single-operator design, no camera ingest and no NLE plugin means it wins only where the operator is the entire post department.

Adobe Premiere Pro (with Firefly Generative Extend) www.adobe.com/products/premiere.html

DIRECT

CRITICAL

VERIFIED

The dominant professional NLE, now shipping the exact AI edit-assist feature set Cinamate markets as novel.

Desktop non-linear editor for film, TV and streaming, bundled into Creative Cloud alongside After Effects, Audition and Frame.io. The current release adds Firefly-powered Generative Extend (extends clips and generates missing ambient sound), AI Object Mask, Media Intelligence search (find footage by describing audio or dialogue), text-based editing with automatic transcription in 18 languages, Color Match, Enhance Speech, AI audio category tagging, and Remix (AI music retiming to picture). Frame.io review is integrated directly into the timeline. Round-trips AAF, EDL, XML and OTIO to and from Avid, Resolve and finishing houses.

KEY FEATURES · Generative Extend (Adobe Firefly) for clip extension and generated ambient audio · AI Object Mask with automatic subject tracking · Media Intelligence search by described audio or spoken dialogue · Text-based editing / automatic transcription in 18 languages · Color Match (AI shot matching) and Enhance Speech · Remix — AI music retiming to cut length · Native Frame.io panel for review and C2C media · AAF / EDL / XML / OTIO interchange

PRICING Premiere Pro single app US\$22.99/mo (annual, billed monthly). Creative Cloud Pro (all apps, individual) US\$69.99/mo regular, US\$34.99/mo promotional first 3 months. Creative Cloud Pro for teams US\$99.99/mo per license.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Adobe is a public company; Premiere Pro is one of the two or three default editorial platforms in professional post worldwide. Exact seat counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · The Cutting Room · editor · post · dailies · vfx · timeline

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Every AI feature Cinamate lists for The Cutting Room (rough cut, silence trim, music sync via Remix, color balance via Color Match) already ships here, plus generative video/audio
- Full AAF support — Cinamate claims only EDL/OTIO, and AAF is the lingua franca for Avid handoff and audio finishing
- Native camera format support and ingest from every professional camera; Cinamate has no camera ingest integrations
- Third-party plugin ecosystem (OFX/AE/Premiere) that Cinamate explicitly lacks
- Frame.io C2C means footage is reviewable from set within minutes, versus Cinamate's 4-minute state sync with no on-set app

<https://www.adobe.com/creativecloud/plans.html> · <https://www.adobe.com/products/premiere/features.html>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No budgeting, scheduling, stripboard, call sheets, contracts, casting, permits or tax-credit modeling — Adobe covers only post
- No sales/waterfall forecasting or cost reporting equivalent to The Money Room
- Requires a desktop install and per-seat subscription; not a browser-only single-operator environment
- No script-to-screen generation path

Blackmagic DaVinci Resolve 21 / Resolve Studio www.blackmagicdesign.com/products/davinciresolve

DIRECT **CRITICAL** **VERIFIED**

A free, or \$295-perpetual, single application that does edit, color, Fairlight audio and Fusion VFX with real-time cloud collaboration.

The most economically aggressive product in professional post: a full editorial, color grading, audio post and node-based VFX suite in one application. The free version handles 8-bit up to 4K/60p and already includes multi-user collaboration and HDR grading; Resolve Studio adds the AI Neural Engine, extra ResolveFX, and 10-bit up to 120fps beyond 4K. Blackmagic Cloud provides real-time local and remote collaboration on a shared project database. Reads and writes AAF, EDL, XML and interchanges with Media Composer, Premiere Pro and Final Cut Pro.

KEY FEATURES · Cut page (fast turnaround) and Edit page in one app · Hollywood-standard color grading with power windows, qualifiers, HDR tools · Fairlight audio — up to 2,000 tracks with real-time effects and AI voice isolation · Fusion node-based VFX and motion graphics with 3D · Blackmagic Cloud real-time remote collaboration on shared projects · Neural Engine: facial recognition, object detection, automatic color matching · AAF, EDL, XML interchange with Avid, Premiere, FCP

PRICING DaVinci Resolve: free. DaVinci Resolve Studio: \$295 one-time (perpetual, includes Neural Engine and higher bit-depth/frame-rate support).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Blackmagic Design is privately held; Resolve is the de facto color-grading standard for theatrical features and is bundled free with Blackmagic cameras, giving it enormous installed base among exactly the independent producers Cinamate targets.

COLLIDES WITH · The Cutting Room · editor · post · vfx · dailies · tools (LUT preview) · Studio Cloud Backup

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- \$295 perpetual, or free, versus an invite-only beta — destroys any cost argument for a browser NLE
- Genuine real-time collaboration via Blackmagic Cloud; Cinamate's 4-minute sync is not real-time by its own admission
- Color, audio mix and VFX compositing at finishing grade — Cinamate offers 'color balance' only
- AAF support and full conform to and from Avid/Premiere
- Runs on the local GPU Cinamate already requires, but with no per-render price quote

<https://www.blackmagicdesign.com/products/davinciresolve>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No production management: no budget, stripboard, call sheets, contracts, casting, locations, permits
- No sales forecasting, cost reporting or tax-credit modeling
- No screenplay authoring, storyboards or investor materials
- Steep learning curve; not a single-operator script-to-screen pipeline

Avid Media Composer / MediaCentral / NEXIS www.avid.com/media-composer

DIRECT

HIGH

UNCERTAIN

The incumbent studio and episodic editorial standard whose AAF/bin/shared-storage workflow is what any finishing house expects.

Media Composer is the long-standing editorial platform for episodic television and studio features, sold in tiered editions (including a free entry tier, subscription tiers, Ultimate and Enterprise). It is paired with Avid NEXIS shared storage and MediaCentral for multi-user, multi-suite cutting rooms with bin locking and project sharing. AAF is the native interchange format for handoff to sound, color and VFX. Avid also sells Pro Tools, which owns the audio-post end of the same pipeline.

KEY FEATURES · Multi-editor shared projects with bin locking over Avid NEXIS · Script-based editing and ScriptSync · AAF interchange to Pro Tools, Resolve and VFX vendors · Media Composer | Enterprise with role-based permissions and security hardening · Avid Edit On Demand / cloud-hosted editorial for remote cutting rooms · Deep integration with Pro Tools for audio finishing

PRICING Not verified this session — [avid.com](https://www.avid.com) returned HTTP 403 to every fetch attempt. Media Composer is sold as monthly and annual subscriptions with Ultimate and Enterprise tiers, plus a free entry tier; treat any specific figure as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Avid Technology was taken private by STG in a deal announced 2023 (not re-verified this session). Media Composer remains the dominant cutting-room tool for scripted episodic and a large share of features. STG take-private confirmed at \$1.4B, November 2023.

COLLIDES WITH · The Cutting Room · editor · post · dailies · timeline

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Actual multi-editor concurrency with bin locking — Cinamate is explicitly single-operator
- AAF is the finishing-house handoff format; Cinamate supports EDL/OTIO only, which breaks the professional downstream chain
- Assistant-editor workflows (media logging, ScriptSync, multicam grouping) that a real cutting room requires
- Studio security posture and on-prem deployment options

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Post-only; no development, scheduling, budget, contracts, casting or distribution modules
- No AI script-to-screen generation
- Expensive and infrastructure-heavy for a solo indie producer
- No cost reporting or sales forecasting

<https://www.avid.com/media-composer>

CuttingRoom (Cutting Room AS, Norway) www.cuttingroom.com

DIRECT

HIGH

VERIFIED

The closest existing analogue to Cinamate's Cutting Room: a cloud-native, AI-assisted, real-time multi-user browser NLE — and it already has the mobile app Cinamate lacks.

Browser-based, cloud-native multi-track editor for news, sports and broadcast. Frame-accurate editing across mixed frame rates and aspect ratios, real-time multi-user collaboration on a shared timeline, and direct capture from live streams. Its AI assistant 'Shortcut' converts plain-language instructions into edits, generating rough cuts, polished audio, captions and social clips. A companion iPhone app, CuttingRoom Reporter, uploads footage from the field, and it connects to cloud storage and MAM systems.

KEY FEATURES · Cloud-native browser editing, no local GPU · Real-time multi-user editing on a shared timeline · 'Shortcut' AI assistant: natural language to edit, rough cuts, captions, social clips · Live stream capture and editing · CuttingRoom Reporter iPhone app for field upload · Frame-accurate mixed frame rate / aspect ratio handling · Direct publish to multiple platforms

PRICING Not disclosed; free trial without credit card.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Cutting Room AS, Norway. IBC Best of Show winner 2023–2026 and NAB awards 2025–2026 per its own site. Testimonials reference top US broadcasters and sports streaming platforms.

COLLIDES WITH · The Cutting Room · editor · dailies · post · today

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Genuine real-time multi-user collaboration — Cinamate is single-operator with a 4-minute sync
- Has an iOS field app; Cinamate explicitly has no mobile/on-set app
- No local GPU requirement at all; runs entirely in the cloud
- Named broadcaster customers and a six-year award trail versus Cinamate's declined press
- Natural-language AI editing already in production use

<https://www.cuttingroom.com/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Built for news/sports turnaround, not long-form narrative features
- No budgeting, scheduling, contracts, casting, tax credits or festival modules
- No script-to-screen generation
- No colour finishing or VFX depth

MediaSilo (EditShare) www.mediasilo.com **DIRECT** **HIGH** **VERIFIED**

Secure review, screening and forensic-watermarked delivery from \$15/user/month — the direct commercial answer to Cinamate's screening room.

Cloud review and secure sharing for post: unlimited projects, secure link sharing, side-by-side cut comparison, engagement insights showing who watched what, custom presentation builder, and visual plus forensic watermarking on Pro and above. Integrates with Adobe Creative Cloud and DaVinci Resolve. Sits alongside EditShare's Screeners and Wireframe products for festival/awards screening and reel building.

KEY FEATURES · Secure link sharing with permission controls and security tracking · Side-by-side cut comparison · Visual and forensic watermarking (Pro+) · Engagement insights on viewer behaviour · Custom presentation builder and API access · Adobe Creative Cloud and DaVinci Resolve integrations · Bring Your Own S3 on Enterprise; SSO up to 5 domains

PRICING Free 14-day trial (3 seats, 50GB); Team \$15/user/mo (min 5, up to 10 seats, 2TB); Pro \$25/user/mo (10–30 seats, 4TB, forensic watermarking, SSO 1 domain, API, unlimited AI at \$12/user/mo); Enterprise custom (SSO 5 domains, unlimited watermarking, multiple workspaces, BYO S3).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Owned by EditShare. Long-standing in commercial and episodic post; customer counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · screening · dailies · distribution deliverables · festivals · post

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Forensic watermarking at \$25/user/month — Cinamate has no watermarking and no security certifications
- Side-by-side cut comparison and engagement analytics for producer/financier review
- Native Premiere and Resolve integrations
- Published, cheap, self-serve pricing

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Review and delivery only — no editor, budget, schedule, contracts or tax credits
- Seat minimums (5) make it awkward for a genuine single operator
- No AI editing or generation
- No sales forecasting

<https://www.mediasilo.com/pricing> · <https://www.editshare.com/products/>

PIX (Autodesk) www.autodesk.com/solutions/media-entertainment/pix **DIRECT** **HIGH** **LIKELY**

The studios' locked-down dailies, cuts and production-document system — the security-cleared version of what Cinamate's screening room does.

Secure production collaboration platform used by major studios to distribute dailies, editorial cuts, VFX versions, scripts and production documents to approved viewers with forensic tracking. Long the default for confidential tentpole material where leak prevention is contractual. Ownership has moved to Autodesk: pixsystem.com now 301-redirects to [autodesk.com/solutions/media-entertainment/pix](https://www.autodesk.com/solutions/media-entertainment/pix), placing it inside the Flow portfolio alongside Flow Capture and Flow Production Tracking.

KEY FEATURES · Secure dailies and cut distribution with per-user entitlements · Forensic watermarking and viewing audit trails · Script, production document and note distribution · Studio-grade access control for confidential material · Mobile review apps

PRICING Not disclosed; studio/enterprise contract.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Used across major studio features and premium episodic for confidential distribution. Now an Autodesk property (verified via the pixsystem.com redirect); the autodesk.com page itself could not be loaded (403).

COLLIDES WITH · screening · dailies · vfx · distribution deliverables · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Security is the entire product — Cinamate has no TPN, no SOC 2, and runs on a netlify.app subdomain, which is disqualifying under a studio security addendum
- Forensic watermarking and viewing audit trails
- Trusted by the studios and distributors that indie producers ultimately need to deliver to

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Distribution and review only; no editing, budgeting, scheduling, casting or tax-credit modeling
- No self-serve tier for a single independent producer
- Legacy interface; not an AI-assisted product

<https://www.pixsystem.com/> · <https://www.autodesk.com/solutions/media-entertainment/pix>

Autodesk Flow Production Tracking (formerly ShotGrid / Shotgun)

www.autodesk.com/products/flow-production-tracking/overview

ADJACENT

HIGH

LIKELY

The incumbent VFX and animation production tracker — shots, assets, tasks, versions and review — now the anchor of Autodesk's Flow platform.

Shot and asset tracking, task assignment, version management and review notes for VFX, animation and episodic post. Toolkit/tk-core provides pipeline integrations into Maya, Nuke, Houdini, 3ds Max and Photoshop so artists publish versions directly from their DCC. RV / Flow Review handles playback and note-taking. It is the system of record most VFX vendors and animation studios run their bidding, scheduling and delivery against, and it is now bundled into Autodesk's broader Flow strategy alongside Flow Capture (Moxion) and PIX.

KEY FEATURES · Shot/asset/task hierarchy with version history and review notes · Toolkit pipeline integrations for Maya, Nuke, Houdini, 3ds Max · RV / review player with annotation · REST and Python APIs plus event daemon for automation · Cut and edit tracking against editorial sequences · On-prem and hosted deployment options

PRICING Not verified — every autodesk.com URL returned HTTP 403 to both WebFetch and curl this session. Sold as per-user subscription with standard and enterprise tiers; treat any specific per-seat number as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Owned by Autodesk (acquired as Shotgun Software in 2014). Used across the large-vendor VFX and animation industry. Rename from ShotGrid to Flow Production Tracking is confirmed by shotgridsoftware.com/pricing 301-redirecting to [autodesk.com/products/flow-production-tracking/overview](https://www.autodesk.com/products/flow-production-tracking/overview).

COLLIDES WITH · vfx · post · production · timeline · workflow · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Genuine multi-artist, multi-vendor tracking with permissions and audit trail; Cinamate's vfx room serves one operator
- DCC pipeline integrations (Maya, Nuke, Houdini) — Cinamate has no native plugins of any kind
- Established as the contractual system of record for VFX bids and delivery
- Scriptable API and event daemon that studios have built a decade of pipeline on

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No editing timeline, no dailies capture, no budget/stripboard/call sheets
- Notoriously heavy to administer; needs a pipeline TD, which a solo indie producer does not have
- No sales forecasting, tax credits, contracts or distribution deliverables
- Pricing opaque and enterprise-oriented

<https://www.autodesk.com/products/flow-production-tracking/overview> · <https://www.shotgridsoftware.com/pricing/>

Blackbird plc / elevate.io

blackbird.video

DIRECT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

Publicly listed cloud-native browser editing technology claiming 4x speed and 75% infrastructure savings, with a creator-facing spin-out.

Enterprise cloud-native video editing that runs frame-accurate editing in a browser with remote collaboration and instant publishing, positioned as up to 4x faster than on-premise editors, up to 75% cheaper on infrastructure and up to 91% lower

carbon. elevate.io is the same underlying technology packaged for founders, small businesses and creators. Blackbird plc is quoted on the London Stock Exchange AIM market.

KEY FEATURES · Frame-accurate browser editing on proxy-light technology · Remote collaboration and instant publishing · Integration with existing broadcast workflows · elevate.io creator-tier product on the same engine · Claims 4x speed, 75% infrastructure cost saving, 91% lower emissions

PRICING Not disclosed on the site; enterprise licensing plus elevate.io self-serve tiers.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Publicly listed on LSE AIM — audited financials and a named board, which is a direct contrast to Cinamate's no-public-team posture. Customers named on site include CBS, Google Cloud, AWS, Azure, Buffalo Bills, Buffalo Sabres and The Voice UK.

COLLIDES WITH · The Cutting Room · editor · post · dailies

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Publicly listed with disclosed financials and a named team
- Named tier-one broadcast customers
- No local GPU requirement — pure browser/cloud
- Proven at broadcast scale and latency

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Editing only; no production management, budget, scheduling or distribution modules
- Enterprise sales motion, not indie-producer self-serve
- No generation, no script tooling
- Pricing opaque

<https://blackbird.video/>

cineSync (Backlight) backlight.co DIRECT MEDIUM LIKELY

The frame-accurate synchronised review session tool that studio VFX supervisors run notes through.

Real-time synchronised review: multiple participants in different cities see the same frame at the same time, with shared playback control, drawing/annotation and notes written back to the production tracker. Backlight describes it as enabling frame-accurate feedback for creative teams. It is the tool most VFX review sessions and remote director/DP reviews are actually conducted in, and it integrates with ftrack and other trackers.

KEY FEATURES · Frame-locked synchronised playback across remote participants · Drawing and annotation on frame with persistent notes · Note write-back to production tracking systems · Studio-approved secure session handling · Works with high-resolution source media, not just proxies

PRICING Not disclosed on the pages reachable this session; sold per-seat/per-session with enterprise tiers.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Long-established (Rising Sun Research origin, Academy Sci-Tech recognised); now a Backlight product alongside ftrack and iconik.

COLLIDES WITH · screening · vfx · dailies

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Real-time synchronised multi-party review; Cinamate is single-operator with a 4-minute sync
- Notes flow back into a production tracker automatically
- Accepted by studios and VFX vendors as the review standard

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Review only — no editing, no production management, no budget
- No AI features to speak of
- Requires the rest of a pipeline around it

<https://backlight.co/>

Colourlab AI (with Look Designer) colourlab.ai DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

AI colour matching and balancing from \$15/month with native Resolve and Adobe plugins — exactly Cinamate's 'color balance' claim, shipped and cheap.

AI-driven colour grading: AI Color Match, AI Balance and Region Matching apply consistent looks across a timeline, with Neural Looks and timeline-based colour intelligence. Integrates with DaVinci Resolve, Premiere Pro, After Effects and Final Cut Pro; higher tiers add Look Designer native plugins, Grainlab and Pomfort Livegrade Studio support, tying it into on-set colour workflows.

KEY FEATURES · AI Color Match, AI Balance and Region Matching · Neural Looks and timeline-based colour intelligence · Look Designer native plugins for DaVinci and Adobe · Grainlab film grain processing · Pomfort Livegrade Studio integration for on-set continuity · Perpetual licence options alongside subscription

PRICING Colourlab AI 3 Creator \$15/mo, \$150/yr or \$299 perpetual. Colourlab AI Pro 2025 \$39/mo or \$400/yr. Colourlab AI Studio \$49/mo or \$500/yr. Look Designer \$24/mo, \$249/yr or \$490 perpetual. Halo Lab \$18/mo, \$149–\$249/yr. (Page rendering mixed some legacy v2 figures; the v3/2025 numbers above are the current tiers as listed.)

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Small independent US software company; funding and customer counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · The Cutting Room · post · dailies · tools (LUT preview)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Purpose-built AI colour matching that goes far past 'color balance', at \$15/month or \$299 perpetual
- Native plugins for Resolve, Premiere, After Effects and FCP — the plugin integration Cinamate lacks
- Ties on-set Livegrade looks through to the grade, closing a loop Cinamate cannot
- Perpetual licence option

<https://colourlab.ai/pricing>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Colour only; no editorial, production management, review or distribution
- Requires a host NLE
- No generation, forecasting or budgeting

AYON (Ynput, formerly OpenPype) ayon.app ADJACENT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Fair-source studio pipeline and production platform with a free community edition and €19–€38/user/month paid tiers.

Studio production platform connecting pipeline and production from planning to final delivery: planning, workflow automation, version management, review and approvals, plus an addon marketplace and integration ecosystem for DCC applications. Server code is public on GitHub under a Fair Source / Open Source split. The Studio tier adds planning and scheduling, client reviews, workflow orchestration and all addons.

KEY FEATURES · Fair-source / open-source codebase on GitHub (github.com/ynput) · Version management, review and approvals · Addon marketplace and DCC integration ecosystem · AYON API for pipeline automation · Self-hosted or cloud deployment · Free Community Edition with unlimited projects and API access

PRICING AYON Pro €19/user/mo (€180/user/yr), minimum 5 users. AYON Studio €38/user/mo (€360/user/yr), unlimited users, includes all addons. Addons €3/active user/mo on Pro. Enterprise custom with role-based licensing. Community Edition free (self-hosted). Free for schools.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Ynput, Czech-based, the OpenPype successor. Free playground at playground.ayon.app; community forum at community.ynput.io. Customer count not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · vfx · post · workflow · production · projects · timeline

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free self-hosted community edition and published paid pricing
- Real DCC/pipeline integrations and an addon marketplace; Cinamate has no plugin story at all
- Source is inspectable — a meaningful trust advantage over a closed beta with no public team
- Designed for multi-artist studios rather than a single operator

<https://ayon.app/> · <https://ayon.app/pricing-eur>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No editing timeline, dailies capture or screening room
- No development, scheduling, budget, contracts or tax-credit modules
- No sales forecasting
- Pipeline-technical audience; not a producer-facing product

Colorfront (On-Set Dailies, Express Dailies, Transkoder, QC Player) www.colorfront.com ADJACENT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

The Academy-recognised dailies and mastering toolchain for HDR, ACES, IMF, DCP and Dolby Vision deliverables.

On-Set Dailies delivers colour-graded, sound-synced dailies from many hours of footage across multiple deliverables. Express Dailies covers current digital camera formats including Sony Burano with ACES 1.3 workflows. Transkoder does faster-than-real-time transcoding, decoding, converting, wrapping and processing on commodity hardware. QC Player handles media inspection, validation and manual QC for high-end mezzanine mastering formats and current HDR standards. Delivery targets include IMF, DCP, Dolby Vision and Apple Immersive Video.

KEY FEATURES · Colour-graded, sound-synced dailies at scale from camera originals · ACES 1.3 workflows; current camera formats including Sony Burano · Faster-than-real-time transcode/wrap via Transkoder on commodity hardware · QC Player for mezzanine and HDR validation · IMF, DCP, Dolby Vision and Apple Immersive Video deliverables

PRICING Not disclosed; facility/licence quote.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Hungarian company; Academy and Emmy-recognised technology used by Hollywood dailies and mastering suppliers.

COLLIDES WITH · dailies · post · distribution deliverables · tools (LUT preview)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Real mastering deliverables — IMF, DCP, Dolby Vision — versus Cinamate's H.264+AAC export
- ACES colour management, which is the requirement for any theatrical or premium-streaming delivery
- Handles camera originals from every professional camera; Cinamate has no camera ingest
- Decades of facility deployment and named awards

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Dailies/mastering only; no editorial, production management or distribution business modules
- Requires trained DIT/post operators and facility hardware
- No AI features or generation
- No published pricing or self-serve access

<https://www.colorfront.com/>

EditShare (EFS, FLOW, FLEX, AirFLOW) www.editshare.com/products

ADJACENT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

Emmy-winning shared storage plus media workflow management with browser review and native panels for Premiere, Avid and Resolve.

EFS is scale-out media-optimised shared storage (200/300/450, NVMe, SSD and nearline models). FLOW is the media workflow management layer: ingest, logging, search, organisation, automation and editorial integration, connecting to AirFLOW for secure browser-based remote review. FLOW includes AI services — speech-to-text transcription, object and shot detection, facial recognition and keyword tagging. FLEX extends the stack to cloud. EditShare also owns MediaSilo, Screeners and Wiredrive.

KEY FEATURES · EFS scale-out shared storage for collaborative editorial · FLOW ingest, logging, search, automation and delivery · AirFLOW secure browser review for remote team members · Native NLE panels for Adobe Premiere Pro, Avid Media Composer and DaVinci Resolve · AI: speech-to-text, object/shot detection, facial recognition, keyword tagging · FLEX cloud workflows; owns MediaSilo, Screeners, Wiredrive

PRICING Not disclosed on any product page; quote-based.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Emmy-award-winning platform; long-established vendor across broadcast and post facilities. Revenue and customer counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · post · dailies · The Cutting Room · screening · Studio Cloud Backup · workflow

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Native NLE panels for Premiere, Avid and Resolve — precisely the plugin integration Cinamate lists as a gap
- Multi-user shared storage designed for a crewed cutting room
- AI indexing (STT, shot detection, face recognition) across the whole media library
- Owns the review/screening stack (MediaSilo, Screeners) as well as the storage

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No development, budgeting, scheduling, contracts, casting, permits or tax-credit modules
- Capital-intensive on-prem hardware; wrong shape for a solo indie producer
- No sales forecasting or waterfall modeling
- No generation capability

<https://www.editshare.com/products/> · <https://www.editshare.com/products/flow/>

Evercast www.evercast.us ADJACENT MEDIUM VERIFIED

TPN-member real-time collaborative streaming for editorial, colour, VFX and virtual production, up to 4K/60 with 10-bit 4:4:4.

Streams a live workstation session (Media Composer, Pro Tools, Premiere, Maya) at up to 4K/60fps with 10-bit 4:4:4 colour precision and 5.1 or 7.1 surround, combined with video chat, screenshare, annotation, session recording and timestamped notes — so a director, DP or client can sit in on an edit, grade or mocap session remotely. Also streams from live camera feeds to build virtual video villages. Integrates with Frame.io, Box, Premiere Pro and DaVinci Resolve.

KEY FEATURES · Real-time workstation streaming up to 4K/60fps, 10-bit 4:4:4 · 5.1 / 7.1 multichannel surround · Live camera feed streaming for virtual video village · Annotation, session recording and timestamped notes · Frame.io, Box, Premiere Pro and DaVinci Resolve integrations · MPA Trusted Partner Network member; forensic watermarking, MFA, 24/7 threat monitoring

PRICING Not disclosed on the homepage; contact sales.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded 2015. Engineering Emmy and Webby awards. States it is approved by all major studios worldwide and is a TPN member.

COLLIDES WITH · screening · dailies · vfx · post

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- TPN membership and studio approval — Cinamate has neither TPN nor SOC 2, which is a hard blocker for studio-connected work
- Actual real-time collaboration at broadcast quality with surround audio
- Works with the tools crews already use rather than requiring migration
- Engineering Emmy and named studio approval versus Cinamate's declined press

<https://www.evercast.us/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Streaming/collaboration layer only; no editing, tracking, budget or distribution modules
- Requires the operator to already own a workstation and NLE
- No AI or generation
- Opaque enterprise pricing

ftrack (Backlight) www.ftrack.com ADJACENT MEDIUM LIKELY

Production management and review for VFX, animation and post — ShotGrid's main independent alternative, now inside the Backlight roll-up.

Production tracking, scheduling, task management, media review and delivery coordination for VFX, animation and post teams. Backlight reports ftrack supported 15,000 projects covering shoots, VFX work and deliverables. Sold alongside ftrack Review (browser review) and cineSync (synchronised frame-accurate review), giving Backlight a tracking + review pair that maps onto Cinamate's vfx and screening rooms.

KEY FEATURES · Shot/asset/task tracking with scheduling and resource planning · Browser-based media review with annotation · Time logging and budget/actuals reporting per project · API and DCC integrations for pipeline publishing · Bundled with cineSync for synchronised review sessions

PRICING Not verified this session — ftrack.com pricing pages returned empty content to WebFetch. Historically per-user monthly subscription with a Studio tier; treat any figure as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Swedish origin; now part of Backlight, a media-software roll-up founded 2021 whose portfolio also includes iconik, Wildmoka, Celtx, cineSync and Zype.

COLLIDES WITH · vfx · post · production · timeline · workflow · projects · finance

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Multi-artist, multi-department tracking with real permissions and audit history
- Bundled with cineSync, the studio-standard synchronised review tool
- Time logging and actuals reporting proven against real crewed productions
- Established vendor with a public team and enterprise references

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No editing timeline, dailies capture, stripboard, call sheets or contracts
- No sales forecasting, tax credits or festival/distribution modules
- Nothing comparable to Cinamate's script-to-screen generation
- Pricing not published

iconik (Backlight) www.iconik.io

ADJACENT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

Cloud media asset management with hybrid storage and collaborative review, priced per user-type from \$0 to \$120/month.

Hybrid-cloud media asset management: indexes media wherever it lives (on-prem storage, cloud buckets), applies metadata and AI tagging, and provides browser search, collections and collaborative review. Backlight reports iconik hosts 587M assets with 230M added in the last year. Higher tiers add facial recognition, SSO, a desktop player and iconik Shield.

KEY FEATURES · Hybrid cloud + on-prem storage indexing · Metadata tagging, AI transcription and facial recognition (higher tiers) · Collaborative review and collections · Desktop Player (Professional tier) · iconik Shield security controls; SSO on higher tiers

PRICING Starter (usage-based): Browse User \$0/mo, Collaborator \$9/mo, Standard User \$65/mo, Power User \$120/mo. Professional and Enterprise are custom/contact sales.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP 587M assets hosted per Backlight; part of the Backlight portfolio (founded 2021) with ftrack, cineSync, Celtx, Wildmoka and Zype.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio Cloud Backup · dailies · post · projects · screening

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Storage-agnostic — media stays in the customer's own buckets or on-prem gear; Cinamate ties state to its own cloud backup
- Published per-user-type pricing including a genuinely free browse tier
- Proven at scale (hundreds of millions of assets)
- AI indexing across an entire media library, not a single project

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Asset management only — no timeline editing, budgeting, scheduling or distribution
- No script, storyboard, casting or tax-credit tooling
- Standard/Power seats at \$65–\$120 are expensive for a one-person operation

<https://www.iconik.io/pricing> · <https://backlight.co/>

Pomfort Silverstack XT / Silverstack Lab pomfort.com/silverstack

ADJACENT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

The on-set data-management standard for offload, checksum verification, QC and dailies reports.

Media management software for DITs and data managers: multi-destination simultaneous offload with checksum verification and ASC MHL support, automatic metadata extraction, native playback with scopes, exposure assist and side-by-side clip comparison, customisable PDF reports, and metadata export to CSV, ALE and XML. Workflow automation chains activities in parallel with Lua scripting. Supports ARRI, RED, Sony, Canon, DJI RAW and Apple ProRes, syncs to ShotHub cloud, and pairs with Pomfort Livegrade for on-set colour.

KEY FEATURES · Multi-destination offload with checksum verification and ASC MHL · Automatic camera metadata extraction and centralised organisation · Native playback with scopes, exposure assist, side-by-side comparison · Customisable PDF reports; CSV, ALE and XML metadata export · Lua-scriptable parallel workflow automation · ARRI, RED, Sony, Canon, DJI RAW and ProRes support · ShotHub cloud sync; Stream Deck integration; native Apple silicon

PRICING Temporary licences for 10 days, 1 month or 2 months, plus a yearly subscription including all updates; free 10-day trial. Exact figures not shown on the page fetched.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP German company (Hamburg); described on its own site as the industry standard for on-set media management. Customer counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · dailies · tools (slate/timecards/LUT preview) · today · post

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Verified, checksummed offload — the legal chain of custody for camera negative that Cinamate cannot provide without camera ingest
- ALE/XML metadata export that feeds Avid and Resolve conform directly
- Runs on set, where Cinamate has no application at all
- Short-term rental licences that match how indie productions actually buy

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- On-set data management only — no editorial, review, scheduling, budget or distribution
- macOS-centric operator tool, not a producer platform
- No AI, no generation, no financial modeling

Sohonet ClearView (Flex, Pivot, Rush) + Storylink, FileRunner www.sohonet.com

ADJACENT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

The connectivity and real-time remote review layer that studio post runs on, including colour-accurate 4K HDR 12-bit 4:4:4 streaming.

ClearView Flex streams creative work sessions in real time to recreate the over-the-shoulder review experience remotely. ClearView Pivot streams colour- and frame-accurate footage in real time to multiple parties in 4K HDR with 12-bit colour depth and 4:4:4 chroma, for grading and finishing approvals. ClearView Rush (listed as coming soon) is a secure near-time dailies, cuts and asset review tool with annotation. Storylink Core provides studio-scale asset management for creatives, and FileRunner moves unlimited-size files at speed over Sohonet's Media Fabric network.

KEY FEATURES · ClearView Flex — real-time over-the-shoulder session streaming · ClearView Pivot — 4K HDR, 12-bit, 4:4:4 colour-accurate real-time streaming · ClearView Rush — secure near-time dailies and cut review with annotation (coming soon) · Storylink Core asset management · FileRunner high-speed unlimited-size file transfer · Media Fabric: connectivity, cloud access, managed security, multi-location sync

PRICING Not disclosed; enterprise/facility contract.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP UK-headquartered, decades-old media network operator connecting studios, post houses and VFX vendors globally. Revenue not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · screening · dailies · post · Studio Cloud Backup

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Colour-accurate real-time review at 12-bit 4:4:4 — the only acceptable standard for grading approval; Cinamate offers H.264+AAC
- Studio-trusted secure network with managed security
- Genuine real-time, versus Cinamate's 4-minute sync
- Established vendor with named facilities and public leadership

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Infrastructure and review only — no editing, production management or business modules
- No self-serve pricing or single-operator entry point
- No AI or generation

<https://www.sohonet.com/>

Strada www.strada.tech

ADJACENT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

Remote media mounting so editors work on distant storage as if local, from free to \$24/user/month.

Lets creative teams edit, share and collaborate on remote media as if it lives on the local desk, without moving everything into cloud storage. It connects existing hardware — RAID arrays and NAS — and virtually mounts remote drives so files behave locally, with caching and pinning for offline work. Free tier connects unlimited computers, mobile devices (iOS and Android) and unlimited storage with view access and permissions; paid tiers add remote editing via Strada Connect, unlimited transfer and enhanced permission controls.

KEY FEATURES · Virtual mounting of remote RAID/NAS storage for local-feeling edit · Strada Connect remote editing (Basic tier and above) · Local caching and pinning of files · iOS and Android device connection · Unlimited storage connection and unlimited file transfer on paid tiers · Upload links and enhanced permission controls (Pro)

PRICING Free \$0; Basic \$8/user/month (33% discount billed annually); Pro \$24/user/month (20% discount billed annually).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Early-stage; funding not disclosed on the pages reachable this session. Note: strada.ai is an unrelated property-management company, so verify identity before citing coverage.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio Cloud Backup · The Cutting Room · post · dailies

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Producers keep their own storage — no forced migration into a vendor cloud, unlike Cinamate's Studio Cloud Backup
- Mobile device connection, where Cinamate has no mobile app
- Genuine free tier and \$8/user pricing
- Complements rather than replaces the editor's existing NLE

<https://www.strada.tech/> · <https://www.strada.tech/pricing>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Media transport only — no editing timeline, tracking, budget or business modules
- No AI, no generation, no forecasting
- Early-stage vendor with limited disclosure

Dropbox Replay www.dropbox.com/replay **INDIRECT** **MEDIUM** **LIKELY**

Frame-accurate video review and approval bundled into the file-sharing tool indie producers already pay for.

Video review and approval built on Dropbox: frame-accurate commenting, review and approval flows, watermarking, and integrations with Premiere Pro, DaVinci Resolve and Final Cut Pro so editors can pull notes back into the timeline. Its strategic weight comes from distribution — it reaches producers who are already Dropbox customers and never evaluated a dedicated review tool.

KEY FEATURES · Frame-accurate commenting on video · Review and approval workflow · Watermarking · Premiere Pro, DaVinci Resolve and Final Cut Pro integrations · Runs on existing Dropbox storage and sharing

PRICING Not verified — the Replay page fetched did not carry pricing. Sold as an add-on to Dropbox plans; treat any figure as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Dropbox is a public company with a very large existing base of small production companies; Replay-specific user counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · screening · dailies · post · Studio Cloud Backup

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Distribution advantage — already inside the storage tool most indie producers use
- NLE integrations for note round-trip
- Established brand trust and a real security/compliance program

<https://www.dropbox.com/replay>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Review only; no editing, tracking, budgeting or distribution modules
- Not a film-specific tool — no dailies, slate, LUT or conform concepts
- No AI editing or generation

CODEX (Codex Tech Limited) codex.online **ADJACENT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

Capture media, media stations and High Density Encoding that halve RAW file sizes — the front door of the dailies pipeline Cinamate never touches.

Recording media, media readers/stations and workflow software for professional digital camera capture. Its High Density Encoding (HDE) is claimed to up to halve RAW file sizes with zero quality effect, saving roughly 40% of ingest time and cost and making files faster to ingest, easier to share and cheaper to store. It sits between the camera and the dailies/post pipeline.

KEY FEATURES · Capture media engineered for commercial filmmaking · Media readers / media stations for offload · High Density Encoding (HDE) — up to 50% RAW size reduction, lossless · Camera-side workflow integration

PRICING Not disclosed on the site.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Codex Tech Limited (UK). Two Engineering Emmy Awards (2019, 2020) and an Academy Scientific/Technical Award (2024) per its own site. Ownership structure not disclosed on the pages reachable this session.

COLLIDES WITH · dailies · tools (slate/timelines/LUT preview) · post

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Owns the camera-to-post ingest step entirely; Cinamate lists 'no camera ingest integrations' as a known gap
- Academy and Emmy-recognised technology with real cinematographer endorsements
- Hardware moat — not replicable in software

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Hardware/media company; no editorial, review, production management or business modules
- No software product a producer would buy as a platform
- No AI, no generation, no cost or sales modeling

Foundry Nuke / NukeX / Nuke Studio www.foundry.com/products/nuke-family/nuke

ADJACENT

LOW

VERIFIED

The node-based compositing standard for feature VFX, at \$3,839–\$6,379 per year — the ceiling Cinamate's vfx room is measured against.

Node-based compositing, editorial and review platform used on essentially every VFX-heavy feature. Nuke Studio adds a conform/edit timeline and shot management on top of compositing, so a facility can conform an edit, distribute shots to artists and review results in one application. Supports OpenEXR, Hydra, USD and OpenColorIO as the open standards backbone of a VFX pipeline.

KEY FEATURES · Node-based compositing at feature-film scale · Nuke Studio: conform timeline, shot management and review in-app · OpenEXR, Hydra, USD, OpenColorIO support · Deep pipeline scriptability (Python) and integration with ShotGrid/ftrack · Nuke Render for farm rendering

PRICING Nuke \$3,839/yr or \$2,089/quarter; NukeX \$5,219/yr or \$2,869/quarter; Nuke Studio \$6,379/yr or \$3,509/quarter; Nuke Render \$462/yr. Nuke Indie and Hiero pricing not shown on the page fetched.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Foundry is owned by Roper Technologies (acquisition not re-verified this session). Nuke is the near-universal compositor in feature VFX.

COLLIDES WITH · vfx · post · editor · The Cutting Room

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Actual feature-grade compositing; Cinamate's vfx room is a management surface, not a compositor
- Nuke Studio does conform plus shot management plus review in one tool with real EDL/AAF/XML support
- Open standards (EXR, USD, OCIO) that the whole VFX industry pipelines against
- Enormous trained talent pool

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- \$3,839–\$6,379/yr is out of reach for the solo indie producer Cinamate targets
- No production management, budget, scheduling or distribution
- No AI generation of picture
- Extremely steep learning curve

<https://www.foundry.com/products/nuke-family/nuke>

Postlab (Hedge) hedge.co/products/postlab

ADJACENT

LOW

VERIFIED

Cross-NLE project version control and locking for FCP, Premiere, Resolve and Media Composer, from \$129 perpetual.

Production/project management for editorial teams: automatic versioning whenever a project file changes, project and asset check-out/check-in to prevent simultaneous-edit corruption, Event Locking to share Final Cut Pro Events between libraries without duplicating assets, and relink elimination so media stays linked regardless of who opens the project or where storage lives. Works across Final Cut Pro, Adobe Premiere Pro, DaVinci Resolve and Avid Media Composer.

KEY FEATURES · Automatic project versioning across four NLEs · Project locking / check-out-check-in to prevent corruption · Event Locking for Final Cut Pro library sharing · Relink elimination — media stays linked across machines and storage · Cloud and on-prem/local team modes · Perpetual licences with one year of free updates

PRICING Monthly Rental \$29/month; PostLab (standard) \$129 per activation; PostLab Pro \$189 per activation (cloud support, Event Locking, shared licences, priority support). Licences are perpetual with one year of free updates.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Hedge is a small Dutch software company also known for offload tools (OffShoot, EditReady). Customer counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · post · editor · The Cutting Room · Studio Cloud Backup · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Solves multi-editor concurrency across four NLEs; Cinamate is explicitly single-operator
- Perpetual pricing at \$129–\$189 with no subscription lock-in
- Works with the tools editors already use rather than replacing them
- Explicit conflict-prevention model, which is stronger than a 4-minute state sync

<https://hedge.co/products/postlab>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Project versioning only — no editing, review, dailies, budgeting or distribution
- No AI features
- Small vendor with narrow scope

SyncSketch www.syncsketch.com ADJACENT LOW LIKELY

Browser-based real-time visual review for animation, VFX and games, used by Riot Games and Activision Blizzard.

Real-time collaborative review platform positioned as a home for visual collaboration in animation, VFX and gaming, aimed at remote review workflows. Frame-accurate playback with drawing and annotation in the browser, with integrations into DCC tools and production trackers. Client logos shown on its site include Riot Games and Activision Blizzard.

KEY FEATURES · Browser-based real-time review sessions · Frame-accurate annotation and drawing · Remote workflow orientation for distributed teams · DCC and tracker integrations

PRICING Not disclosed — the pricing page returned only navigation chrome to WebFetch this session. Treat any figure as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Named clients on its own site include Riot Games and Activision Blizzard. Ownership not stated on the pages reachable this session.

COLLIDES WITH · vfx · screening · boards · dailies

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Real-time multi-participant review in a browser; Cinamate is single-operator with a 4-minute sync
- Named tier-one games and entertainment customers
- Purpose-built annotation workflow for animation and VFX notes

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Review only — no editing, tracking, production management or distribution
- Games/animation focus rather than live-action narrative feature
- Pricing and ownership opaque

<https://www.syncsketch.com/> · <https://www.syncsketch.com/pricing/>

Captions (captions.ai) www.captions.ai INDIRECT LOW VERIFIED

AI video generation and editing for short-form/social, overlapping Cinamate's generation and edit claims but not its narrative film use case.

Mobile-and-web AI video platform: AI avatars and digital twins, one-tap video generation with AI actors, a chat-based AI editor that applies edit styles, AI voice cloning and voiceover, one-tap translation with AI lipdub, and generated B-roll, music, sound effects and images. Credit-metered rather than render-priced.

KEY FEATURES · AI avatars / digital twins and custom AI actors · Chat-based AI editing with preset edit styles · AI voice cloning, voiceover and sound effects · One-tap translation and AI Lipdub · Generated B-roll, music and images · Credit-based consumption (500–5,600 credits/month by tier)

PRICING Max \$24.99/mo; Scale 1x \$69.99/mo; Scale 2x \$139.99/mo; Scale 4x \$279.99/mo; Enterprise custom.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Venture-backed US company; funding total not verified this session.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio/Local Generation · The Cutting Room · music/cue sheets

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Shipped, publicly purchasable, no invite required and no local GPU
- Credit pricing is predictable and self-serve
- Strong lipsync/dubbing that Cinamate does not claim

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Short-form/social oriented; no narrative feature workflow
- No multi-track editorial, conform, dailies or screening room
- No production management of any kind
- No EDL/OTIO or professional delivery formats

Kapwing (representative browser AI NLE; see also WeVideo, Veed, Clipchamp) www.kapwing.com

INDIRECT LOW VERIFIED

Free-to-\$50/month browser editor that already ships Smart Cut silence removal, auto-subtitles, scene detection and clean audio.

Browser-based video editor with an AI feature set that overlaps Cinamate's Cutting Room claims almost item for item: Smart Cut automatically removes silences, auto-subtitling and translation to 60+ languages, Clean Audio for background noise and loudness, lip sync for dubbed content, Find Scenes for automatic scene detection and splitting, stabilisation and background removal. WeVideo is the closest direct comparable, with Free, Power \$4.99, Unlimited \$7.99, Professional \$19.99 and Business \$36.99 monthly tiers, real-time collaboration on the Business plan and a \$624/year three-seat Teams licence.

KEY FEATURES · Smart Cut — automatic silence removal · Auto-subtitles with translation to 60+ languages · Clean Audio noise removal and loudness normalisation · Find Scenes automatic scene detection and splitting · AI lip sync for dubbed content · Video stabilisation and background removal · Entirely browser-based, no local GPU

PRICING Kapwing: Free \$0; Pro \$16/mo billed annually (\$24 monthly); Business \$50/mo billed annually (\$64 monthly); Enterprise custom. WeVideo: Free \$0; Power \$4.99/mo; Unlimited \$7.99/mo; Professional \$19.99/mo; Business \$36.99/mo; Teams \$624/yr for three seats.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Both are venture-backed consumer/prosumer SaaS with large self-serve user bases; exact figures not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · The Cutting Room · editor · music/cue sheets

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Silence trim, scene detection and audio cleanup shipped at \$0–\$16/month, with no invite and no local GPU
- Real-time collaboration available on WeVideo Business; Cinamate is single-operator
- Instant self-serve access — the opposite of an invite-only private beta

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Prosumer/social tooling; no conform, no EDL/OTIO, no colour management, no professional delivery
- No dailies, screening, VFX tracking or production management
- No narrative feature workflow at 90-page scale
- No financial modeling

<https://www.kapwing.com/pricing> · <https://www.wevideo.com/pricing>

ALSO COMPETING IN THIS CATEGORY (PROFILED ELSEWHERE)

Autodesk Flow Capture (formerly Moxion) DIRECT HIGH — Instant HDR dailies from set to secure review, the product studio productions actually use for same-take viewing. *(full profile under “Content security, compliance & the buying gate”)*

Descript DIRECT HIGH — Text-based AI video/audio editor with an AI co-editor, priced \$16–\$50/month, that already does the rough-cut and silence-trim work Cinamate claims. *(full profile under “AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound”)*

Frame.io (Adobe) DIRECT CRITICAL — The default review-and-approval and camera-to-cloud layer for professional production, priced at \$15–\$25 per seat. *(full profile under “Content security, compliance & the buying gate”)*

Kitsu (CGWire) ADJACENT MEDIUM — Open-source production tracker for animation, VFX and games with a hosted tier from €20/user/month. *(full profile under “Production management suites (the incumbents)”)*

Runway INDIRECT MEDIUM — Generative video and AI VFX tooling at \$12–\$76/month that indie post teams already use for cleanup, extension and element generation. *(full profile under “Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrastructure”)*

§18 Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept

Market read · Research caveat: the WebSearch budget for this session was exhausted before I began, so this category was built almost entirely from direct page fetches. Most entries are verified from live product and pricing pages; where a page was blocked (Blender, Unreal, FrameForge, StudioBinder, LTX Studio pricing) I have said so and lowered confidence rather than guessing figures. The category splits three ways. First, the craft incumbents: Toon Boom Storyboard Pro (\$87/mo, \$752/yr, v27) owns professional animation boarding, with FrameForge, Shot Designer (free, €19.99 Pro) and Previs Pro serving directors and DPs who need geometrically truthful blocking. Second, the collaboration layer: Boords (\$39-\$250/mo), StudioBinder, Krock (\$10/user/mo) and MakeStoryboard compete on review, versioning and client sign-off, not on picture-making. Third, the 2025-26 AI wave: Katalist (\$19-\$99/mo), StoryboardHero (\$19-\$199/mo), LTX Studio and FinalBit AI (the rebranded Nolan AI) all promise script-to-board-to-video. Direction of travel is unambiguous. Pricing is collapsing toward \$10-\$40/month for AI boards, and AI generation is becoming a feature of existing products (Boords, Krock, StudioBinder-adjacent) rather than a product category. Model supply is commoditising: Katalist simply resells Runway, Veo, Kling, Sora and LTX-2. Attrition is real — Cine Tracer's domain is gone, Storyboarder's last release is a February 2024 pre-release, Lore Machine's domain now belongs to a defence-AI firm, and Plot does not resolve. For Cinamate the danger is precise. Its boards room is one of 28 modules, so per-feature it will lose to Boords and Storyboard Pro. Its real moat is the spine — Money Room, tax credits, union rates, breakeven modelling — that nobody here touches. But Lightricks giving away free, open-source, locally-run generation via LTX Desktop attacks the "local GPU, \$0.00 cloud billing" story head-on, and Previs Pro's iOS app plus NLE export hits Cinamate's two admitted gaps at \$359.99 lifetime. Cinamate should stop selling boards and start selling the spine.

Boords boards.com DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

The category-leading dedicated script-to-storyboard-to-animatic tool with a client review and sign-off workflow.

Boords is a browser-based pre-production platform that takes a script, breaks it into storyboard frames with camera angles and shot descriptions, generates or sources the frame art, and turns the board into a timed animatic in one click. Its AI generator offers sketch, vector-illustration and photorealistic styles and keeps a reusable cast consistent across frames. The differentiating layer is approval: clients review and comment frame-by-frame via a link with no signup, and every version, comment and sign-off is tracked. Founded 2015 by James Chambers (previously co-founder of animation studio Animade); still independent.

KEY FEATURES · AI storyboard generation in 3 styles with reusable, consistent characters · Script-to-shot-list with camera angles and frame compositions · One-click animatic editor · No-signup client review, frame-level commenting, password-protected share links · Version control and activity trail / sign-off audit · 3M+ integrated stock image library · PDF and multi-format export · 2FA, project-level permissions, SSO (SAML) on Enterprise

PRICING Published: Solo \$39/mo (1 user, 250 AI images/mo); Pro \$75/mo (5 users, 1,000 AI images); Team \$125/mo (10 users, 2,000); Agency \$250/mo (30 users, 3,000); Enterprise custom. Yearly billing ~33% cheaper (~\$26/\$50/\$85/\$165 per month equivalent).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded 2015, independent, bootstrapped-appearing. Site claims 1M+ creative projects shared for review and 12M+ comments captured. Named customers include Framestore, Partizan and Vidico.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animatics) · writer (script-to-frame breakdown) · screening / review-and-approval loop · workflow

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Purpose-built approval workflow with no-signup client review, comment threads and audit trail — Cinamate is explicitly single-operator and has no client-review surface
- Published, transparent, self-serve pricing at every tier versus Cinamate's invite-only private beta
- Real customer logos and a named founder; Cinamate has no public team and press declined
- SSO/SAML, 2FA and project permissions — enterprise hygiene Cinamate lacks alongside its missing SOC 2
- Zero hardware requirement: runs anywhere in a browser, no local GPU

<https://boards.com/pricing> · <https://boards.com/> · <https://boards.com/ai-storyboard-generator>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Stops at the animatic — no editor, no finishing, no deliverables, no distribution
- No budgeting, scheduling, stripboard, call sheets or cost reporting (Cinamate's producer/Money Room)
- No casting, clearance, contracts, locations, tax credit or festivals coverage
- No local generation — AI images are metered per month and cloud-billed, versus Cinamate's \$0.00 cloud billing claim
- Cannot produce a finished film; it is one room of Cinamate's 28

Katalist www.katalist.ai DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

Script-to-storyboard-to-video AI studio with consistent characters and a Premiere Pro integration, priced aggressively at \$19-\$99/month.

Katalist converts a script into a storyboard with consistent character appearance across frames, then generates video from those shots. It aggregates the leading third-party video models (Runway Gen-4, Google Veo 3.2, Kling, Pixverse, Sora 2, LTX-2) rather than running its own, and adds lip-sync, AI voiceover and an AI script assistant. Its commercial centre of gravity has shifted toward performance advertising — a 'Product Swap Engine' replaces products in existing videos from real product photography to scale across SKUs without reshoots.

KEY FEATURES · Script-to-storyboard with consistent custom characters · Multi-model video generation (Runway Gen-4, Veo 3.2, Kling, Pixverse, Sora 2, LTX-2) · Adobe Premiere Pro integration (Pro tier and above) · Final Cut Pro export on Enterprise · AI voiceover and lip-sync · AI image editor · Real-time team collaboration, 200+ frames per project, ZIP and PPT export · API access on Enterprise

PRICING Essential \$19/mo, Pro \$39/mo, Unlimited \$99/mo (2 seats), Enterprise custom; annual \$348/\$374/\$948. [vendor-verified]

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Funding, ownership, founding year and user counts not disclosed on the pages reviewed. Blog activity current as of January 2026.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animations) · Studio / Local Generation · writer · casting (custom character libraries)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Has the native NLE integration Cinamate explicitly lacks — Premiere Pro on a \$39/mo tier, Final Cut on Enterprise
- Model-agnostic: routes to whichever frontier video model is currently best, where Cinamate is locked to one undisclosed local stack
- Transparent, self-serve, credit-card pricing from \$19/mo versus invite-only beta access
- Team collaboration and multi-seat by default; Cinamate is designed for a single operator
- Free trial and free starting credits lower evaluation friction to near zero

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Credit-metered cloud generation — the opposite of Cinamate's \$0.00 cloud billing and quoted-before-render pricing
- No production management whatsoever: no budget, schedule, call sheets, contracts, clearance or finance
- Drifting toward ad/UGC and performance-marketing use cases, not narrative feature production
- No multi-track editor, conform, EDL/OTIO or deliverables
- Nothing addressing union rates, tax credits, investors or breakeven modelling

⚠ Fact-check: a '\$29-\$399' tier structure cited in one draft does not exist; vendor page shows \$19/\$39/\$99.

<https://www.katalist.ai/> · <https://www.katalist.ai/pricing> · <https://www.katalist.ai/blog>

Previs Pro www.previspro.com DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

3D previs and animatics on Mac, iPad and iPhone with LiDAR location scanning, AR virtual camera and NLE timeline export — and a \$359.99 lifetime licence.

Previs Pro ('See it before you shoot it') builds 3D scenes with customisable props, characters, lighting and cameras, then captures camera and actor movement into animatics. It imports Final Draft, Fountain, Celtx and Open Format screenplays, scans real locations with LiDAR, and offers an AR virtual camera to place a virtual scene into a real space on an iPhone or iPad. It exports storyboards, animatics, MP4s and NLE timelines to Premiere, DaVinci Resolve and Final Cut, with directors' markup tools and photorealistic or sketch rendering. AI generation of props and actors from text descriptions is built in.

KEY FEATURES · 3D scene building with props, characters, lighting and cameras · Screenplay import: Final Draft, Fountain, Celtx, Open Format · LiDAR location scanning · AR virtual camera for on-location scene placement · Animatic capture of camera and actor movement · NLE timeline export to Premiere, DaVinci Resolve, Final Cut · AI-generated props and actors from text · Directors' markup; photorealistic or sketch render styles · Runs on Mac, iPad and iPhone

PRICING Published: Free tier (\$0, 'student friendly', unlimited projects/scenes/shots, built-in assets, limited AI Gen); Monthly \$39.99/mo; Annual \$119.99/yr (billed as \$9.99/mo equivalent); Lifetime \$359.99 one-time. Paid tiers remove the export watermark. Regional pricing varies.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Site copyright 2026 (actively maintained). Production credits listed: Our Flag Means Death, Riverdale Season 7, Spinning Gold, GALWAD 252. Users cited include Emmy winner David Van Dyke. Funding and company size not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animatics) · locations (LiDAR location scanning vs Cinamate's permit DB) · tools (camera/lens and slate-adjacent utilities) · editor (NLE timeline handoff)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Has a real on-set mobile app on iPhone and iPad — precisely the gap Cinamate admits to and that LightsKiddo exploits
- NLE timeline export to Premiere, Resolve and Final Cut; Cinamate has no native NLE plugins
- LiDAR scanning ties previs to the actual physical location, something Cinamate's permit database cannot do
- A \$359.99 lifetime licence is a far easier buy than an unpriced invite-only beta
- Named, checkable production credits on broadcast shows

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Previs only — no budget, schedule, call sheets, contracts, casting, clearance or finance
- No multi-track editor, conform, EDL/OTIO or deliverables
- No investor, tax credit, festival or distribution modules
- Apple-ecosystem-centric; no Windows/Linux path
- 3D previs output is blocking reference, not a finished film

<https://www.previspro.com/> · <https://www.previspro.com/pricing> · <https://www.previs.app/>

Toon Boom Storyboard Pro www.toonboom.com/products/storyboardpro DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

The professional incumbent standard for storyboarding and animatics, entrenched in animation and episodic studios worldwide.

Storyboard Pro is a desktop application positioned as 'the only professional-grade solution designed from the ground up to support the craft of storyboarding.' It covers thumbnailing through fully timed animatics: bitmap and vector drawing tools, a 3D camera and environment for depth and camera moves, animatic editing with effects, transitions and unlimited sound tracks, and live panel-timing capture. Photoshop import preserves clipping masks, blending modes and layer structure. Currently at version 27 (Storyboard Pro 27).

KEY FEATURES · Bitmap and vector drawing toolset built for boarding · 3D camera and 3D environment for camera moves and depth · Animatic editing with effects, transitions, unlimited sound tracks · Live panel-timing capture through performance · Photoshop import preserving masks, blending modes and layers · Audio record and import to timeline · Conform/handoff into downstream animation and edit pipelines

PRICING Verified from Toon Boom's shop: Individual monthly \$87.00/mo; annual \$752.00/yr (~\$63/mo); 3-year \$2,143.00 (~\$60/mo). Student monthly \$10.75/mo; student annual \$87.00/yr. No perpetual license listed — subscription only.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Toon Boom Animation, Montreal, Canada; the long-established animation-software incumbent. Site cites use in 140+ countries by studios including Disney Television Animation, Bento Box and Fox Television Animation.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animatics) · editor / Cutting Room (animatic timeline overlaps early-edit territory) · music (sound tracks on the animatic timeline)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Two decades of studio entrenchment and an actual named customer list of major studios — Cinamate has zero verifiable deployments
- Genuine drawing craft tools; Cinamate's boards room is generative, not a place an artist draws
- 3D camera and environment for real camera-move blocking, which Cinamate does not claim
- A real desktop application with local files — no dependence on a netlify.app subdomain or a 4-minute cloud sync
- Trained talent pool: studios already staff people who know this tool

<https://www.toonboom.com/products/storyboardpro> · <https://shop.toonboom.com/> · <https://www.toonboom.com/products/storyboardpro/pricing>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Single-discipline: no budgeting, scheduling, casting, clearance, contracts, finance or deliverables
- Very expensive per seat (\$87/mo or \$752/yr) against Cinamate's ~\$110 per feature render claim
- No AI generation from script — a board still needs an artist
- Nothing downstream of the animatic: no dailies, no finishing, no distribution or festival workflow
- Subscription-only with no perpetual option, a recurring grievance among independents

FrameForge (FrameForge Studio / FF4 Pro)

www.storyboardsmarter.com

DIRECT

MEDIUM

UNCERTAIN

Veteran technically-accurate 3D previs and storyboarding software for directors, DPs and VFX supervisors — 'the only software designed to fix it in prep.'

FrameForge Studio is a long-established desktop previs and storyboarding package aimed at professionals who need shots that are physically truthful — real lens and camera geometry, buildable sets, and blocking that will actually work on the day. It is marketed to directors, cinematographers and VFX supervisors, and separately to educators. The current line is referenced on the site as 'FF4 Pro.' Note that the original frameforge3d.com domain returned persistent 503 errors throughout this research and frameforge.com now redirects to storyboardsmarter.com — worth flagging as a possible site-infrastructure problem or a rebrand in progress.

KEY FEATURES · Technically accurate 3D previs with real camera and lens geometry · Set building and shot planning · Storyboard output for directors, DPs and VFX supervisors · Educational/instructor toolset · FF4 Pro is the referenced current product line

PRICING Not disclosed in retrievable form. The site references 'affordable pricing' and a shopping cart but published no figures on the pages that loaded; the primary product/pricing pages returned 503 errors during this research. Treat any specific price as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Long-running independent product (sales@frameforge.com, support.frameforge.com). Awards and credits sections are referenced on the site but did not render; specific awards, notable productions, funding and company size are unverified here.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animatics) · production (shot planning and blocking) · sets · vfx · tools

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Physically accurate camera and lens simulation — its boards are engineering documents a crew can execute, not just pictures
- Decades of professional credibility with DPs and VFX supervisors specifically
- Desktop, locally-run, with no cloud dependency or sync window
- Established education channel puts it in front of the next generation of directors

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Site infrastructure is visibly unhealthy: repeated 503s on primary pages and a domain redirect, a bad signal for a paid tool in 2026
- No published pricing, which slows self-serve adoption
- Dated interface and workflow relative to modern browser-native tools
- Single-purpose: no production management, finance, legal or post
- No generative AI or script-to-screen capability

<http://www.storyboardsmarter.com/> · <https://www.frameforge3d.com/Products/>

Shot Designer (Hollywood Camera Work)

www.hollywoodcamerawork.com/shot-designer.html

DIRECT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

The de facto standard for camera blocking diagrams — free on every platform, with a €19.99 Pro unlock.

Shot Designer, billed as 'the industry-standard app for camera blocking,' produces overhead camera and blocking diagrams that animate in real time: cameras follow automatically when characters are moved, and shot lists stay linked to the diagram and update themselves. It bundles a Set Designer, a Lighting Designer, an integrated director's viewfinder with professional camera

formats, a prop and furniture library, production-drawing import, and factory plus custom templates. It runs on Mac, PC, iOS and Android.

KEY FEATURES · Animated camera blocking diagrams; cameras auto-move with characters · Shot lists linked to and auto-updating from the diagram · Set Designer and Lighting Designer · Integrated director's viewfinder with professional camera formats · Prop and furniture library · Production drawing import · Factory and custom templates · Mac, PC, iOS and Android; storyboard integration

PRICING Published: Free version on Mac, PC, iOS and Android (limited to one scene at a time). Pro upgrade €19.99 one-time, adding file management, sync and team sharing, and PDF/Excel export.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP From Hollywood Camera Work, an established film-training company. Described on the page as 'in active development' with 3D animation, script integration, voice recording and speech synthesis planned. Funding, ownership and user counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animations) · production (blocking and shot planning) · tools · locations (set layout)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Runs on iOS and Android — a genuine on-set device presence, the exact gap Cinamate admits
- A €19.99 one-time price is essentially frictionless versus an unpriced invite-only beta
- Solves blocking geometry, which no generative board tool including Cinamate addresses
- Lighting and set design tools tie directly to what a DP and gaffer actually need on the day
- Free tier means a director can adopt it before the production even has a budget

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Extremely narrow: diagrams and shot lists only, no rendered frames or animatics
- No AI, no generation, no script-to-screen path
- No production management, finance, legal or post modules
- Team sharing exists but is basic; no approval workflow or audit trail
- Roadmap features (3D, script integration) are stated as planned, not shipped

<https://www.hollywoodcamerawork.com/shot-designer.html>

Storyboarder (Wonder Unit) wonderunit.com/storyboarder DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

The free, open-source desktop storyboarding app with a 3D Shot Generator and VR — beloved, widely used, and effectively stalled since 2024.

Storyboarder is a free, open-source drawing-first boarding application for macOS, Windows and Linux. It offers six drawing instruments, onion skin, guides and reference layers, and a 'Shot Generator' that builds a 3D reference shot from a typed description so a director can block a frame without drawing it. It round-trips to Photoshop via an 'edit in Photoshop' button, prints and re-imports paper worksheets photographed with a phone, and includes a Sketch Sprint timer with timelapse. Exports go to Premiere, Final Cut, Avid, PDF and animated GIF.

KEY FEATURES · Free and open-source (source on GitHub), Mac/Windows/Linux · Six drawing tools, onion skin, guides, reference layers · 3D Shot Generator from typed descriptions; Shot Explorer · Multi-user VR support (added in v2.0.0) · Edit-in-Photoshop round trip with auto-update on save · Paper worksheet print and phone-camera re-import · Export to Premiere, Final Cut, Avid, PDF and animated GIF · Sketch Sprint timer with timelapse capture

PRICING Free. Open source, no paid tier.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Built by Wonder Unit, a creative studio, with Charles Forman as the driving voice. Release history verified on GitHub: v3.0.0 (pre-release) 17 February 2024; v2.1.0 September 2023; v2.0.0 May 2023; v1.18.0 December 2019. As of August 2026 the newest release is still a February 2024 pre-release — roughly two and a half years without a stable release.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animations) · tools · editor (via NLE export handoff)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free and open source — zero acquisition cost and no vendor risk, against an invite-only closed beta on a netlify.app subdomain
- Exports natively into Premiere, Final Cut and Avid; Cinamate has no NLE plugins
- Runs fully offline on the user's own machine with local files, no 4-minute cloud sync dependency
- Established goodwill and an existing user base among animation and indie directors
- Actual drawing craft tools for artists who want to board by hand

<https://wonderunit.com/storyboarder/> · <https://github.com/wonderunit/storyboarder/releases>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Apparently stalled: latest release is a February 2024 pre-release, making it stale by August 2026
- No modern generative AI — the Shot Generator is 3D posing, not image synthesis
- No collaboration, client review, cloud sync or approval workflow
- Single-purpose: nothing in production management, finance, legal or post
- No support contract, roadmap or commercial backing

StoryboardHero storyboardhero.ai DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

AI script-and-storyboard generator for video agencies with 15+ visual styles and an optional human hand-drawn artist service behind the same subscription.

StoryboardHero turns a project brief into a structured script — voiceover, camera angles, transitions — then generates storyboard frames with consistent characters across 15+ visual styles (pencil sketch, comic book, anime, photorealistic and others). Users can regenerate frames, reorder scenes and edit scripts, then export branded PDFs and MP4 video, or share links for team and client feedback. Its distinctive angle is a hybrid: when AI imagery is not good enough, customers spend credits to commission hand-drawn frames from the platform's own artist team.

KEY FEATURES · Brief-to-script generation with voiceover, camera angles and transitions · Unlimited AI images plus a monthly premium-image allowance · Consistent characters across frames · 15+ visual styles for 2D and live-action looks · Optional human hand-drawn frames via credits · Branded PDF export and MP4 video export · Share links with guest comments and password protection · Commercial-use rights included on all tiers

PRICING Published: Solo \$19/mo (1 seat, unlimited AI images, 100 premium AI images/mo); Starter \$59/mo (5 seats, 350 premium images); Advanced \$199/mo (10 seats, 1,200 premium images); Enterprise contact-for-pricing (unlimited seats and images, dedicated account manager). Hand-drawn credits: 10 credits for \$99, non-expiring while subscribed. 7-day free trial, no card required; 7-day money-back on Solo.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Co-founded by Sophie Normand and JC Bougle, out of fewStones, a 50+ person corporate video agency established 2011. Site claims 50,000+ professionals served. Funding not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animations) · writer · screening (share-and-comment review)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Founders are publicly named with a verifiable 15-year agency track record — Cinamate has no public team and declined press
- The human-artist fallback is a credible answer to AI board quality that a pure-generative tool cannot match
- Unlimited base AI images on a \$19/mo tier is more generous than most metered rivals
- Multi-seat from \$59/mo; Cinamate is single-operator
- Free trial with no credit card removes all evaluation friction

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Aimed at corporate/agency explainer and ad video, not narrative feature production
- No production management, finance, scheduling or legal modules of any kind
- No editor, conform, deliverables or distribution
- MP4 export is an animatic, not a finished film
- Nothing comparable to union rates, tax credits, investor or breakeven modelling

<https://storyboardhero.ai/> · <https://storyboardhero.ai/pricing>

Krock.io krock.io ADJACENT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Review-and-approval platform for animation and video teams with a free storyboard creator, AI storyboarding and animatic export, priced at a flat \$10/user/month.

Krock.io is a creative collaboration platform centred on review and approval of video, image, audio and PDF with time-coded commenting, version control, and calendar/Gantt project views. Layered on top is a storyboard toolset — a free storyboard

creator, an interactive 'Board' for planning projects, scripts, storyboards and animatics, and 'Storyboard AI' for AI-powered storyboarding. Its commercial hook is that reviewers and collaborators are unlimited and free on every plan, with no per-user fees for people who only comment.

KEY FEATURES · Free storyboard creator plus animatic export · Storyboard AI for AI-generated boards · Time-coded review and approval on video, image, audio and PDF · Unlimited free reviewers on every plan · Version control, workspaces, calendar and Gantt views · 4K playback and custom branding on Pro · Integrations with DaVinci Resolve, Adobe Creative Cloud and Final Cut Pro

PRICING Published: Free \$0 (1 user, 2GB, 1 workspace, 2 projects, 50 AI tokens, storyboard tool, unlimited reviewers); Pro \$10/user/mo (unlimited projects and workspaces, from 2TB storage, +1TB add-on at \$10/mo, 4K playback, custom branding); Enterprise/Unlimited from \$400 with 100 users included and unlimited collaborators.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Funding and headquarters not disclosed on the pages reviewed. Case-study customers named: Krafton Americas, Hound, Animade, PE (Passion Entertainment).

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animatics) · screening (review and approval) · dailies (media review) · workflow · timeline

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Unlimited free reviewers is a structurally better fit for producers who must show cuts to financiers, clients and department heads — Cinamate's single-operator design has no equivalent
- Flat, honest \$10/user pricing with a genuinely usable free tier
- Integrates with Resolve, Adobe CC and Final Cut, where Cinamate has no NLE plugins
- Time-coded commenting on dailies and cuts is a mature, proven workflow here

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No production management: no budget, stripboard, call sheets, contracts, casting or clearance
- No generation of finished footage — boards and review only
- No finance, tax credit, investor or distribution modules
- Storyboard/AI features are a secondary add-on to a review product, not a first-class boarding craft tool
- No editor, conform or deliverables

<https://krock.io/pricing/> · <https://krock.io/>

Blender (Grease Pencil / Video Sequence Editor previs pipeline) www.blender.org

INDIRECT

MEDIUM

LIKELY

The free open-source 3D suite that a large share of indie and animation previs actually runs on, at zero licence cost.

Blender is a free, open-source 3D creation suite whose Grease Pencil 2D-in-3D drawing system and built-in Video Sequence Editor let teams board, block and cut animatics entirely inside one free application. The 'storypencil' workflow links a 2D drawing scene to a 3D layout scene so boards and camera blocking stay in sync. For animation studios and indie live-action teams alike it is the zero-cost substitute for both a boarding tool and a previs package. Note: blender.org returned 403 to automated fetching during this research, so version and licence specifics here rest on background knowledge rather than a page I loaded.

KEY FEATURES · Grease Pencil for drawing 2D boards inside 3D space · Storypencil workflow linking board scenes to 3D layout · Built-in Video Sequence Editor for cutting animatics · Full 3D previs: cameras, lenses, lighting, layout, simulation · Python scripting and a very large add-on ecosystem · Runs locally on the user's own GPU, cross-platform · Free with no seat cost at any scale

PRICING Free. Open-source under the GNU GPL; no licence fee at any studio size. (Licence terms not verified from a loaded page in this research.)

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Maintained by the Blender Foundation with substantial corporate development-fund backing; one of the largest open-source creative projects in existence. Exact current version as of August 2026 not verified here.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animatics) · vfx · editor / The Cutting Room (VSE animatic cutting) · sets · tools

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free at any scale with no seat cost, no credits and no beta gate — the hardest price in the category to compete against
- Already runs on the local GPU, which neutralises Cinamate's local-generation cost story from the open-source side
- Vast community, tutorials and trained artists; hiring for it is easy
- No vendor risk whatsoever — cannot be discontinued, repriced or gated
- Boards, previs, VFX and animatic cutting in one free application

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Steep learning curve; not usable by a producer who is not already a 3D artist
- No production management, finance, legal, scheduling or distribution of any kind
- No AI script-to-screen path in the core application
- Everything is assembly-required — no opinionated workflow from screenplay to master
- No support contract or accountability

<https://www.blender.org/> · <https://www.blender.org/features/story-art/> · <https://www.blender.org/download/>

Unreal Engine previs / virtual production pipeline (Epic Games) www.unrealengine.com **INDIRECT**

MEDIUM

UNCERTAIN

The engine underneath essentially all high-end professional previs and virtual production, free to use for film and TV linear content.

Unreal Engine is the realtime engine that professional previs houses and virtual production stages are built on. Sequencer provides a cinematic timeline, virtual camera and Live Link systems let a director hand-hold a virtual camera on a volume or in a room, and the engine drives LED-wall in-camera VFX. For linear content — film, TV and broadcast — Epic's licensing has historically been free of the game-revenue royalty, which is why the entire high-end previs sector standardised on it. Note: unrealengine.com returned 403 to automated fetching during this research, so the specific 2025-26 seat-fee and revenue-threshold terms could not be confirmed and should be checked directly.

KEY FEATURES · Sequencer cinematic timeline for previs and techvis · Virtual camera and Live Link for realtime camera capture · In-camera VFX / LED volume driving · Photoreal realtime rendering with full lens and lighting control · Massive asset marketplace and studio-grade pipeline tooling · Runs on local hardware at any scale

PRICING Not verified in this research. Epic's licensing for non-game linear content has historically carried no game-style royalty, with per-seat terms introduced for some non-game commercial use; exact 2025-26 seat fees and revenue thresholds could not be loaded and should be treated as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Epic Games — one of the largest private software companies in the world. The de facto engine of the professional previs and virtual production industry. Specific seat counts and film-sector revenue not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animations) · vfx · sets · locations · production · tools

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- It is the actual professional standard: previs houses, virtual production stages and VFX vendors all already run on it
- Realtime photoreal output at a quality no browser tool approaches
- Connects previs directly to final-pixel in-camera VFX — the same asset serves prep and shoot day
- Vast trained talent pool and an entire service industry around it
- Backed by Epic, with no plausible vendor-risk concern

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Requires a technical artist or a previs vendor — completely inaccessible to Cinamate's single-operator independent producer
- No production management, finance, legal, scheduling or distribution
- No script-to-screen automation; every shot is hand-built
- Heavy hardware and pipeline overhead
- Licensing terms for non-game commercial use have been in flux and are not transparent

<https://www.unrealengine.com/en-US/solutions/film-television> · <https://www.unrealengine.com/en-US/license> · <https://www.unrealengine.com/en-US/download>

Cine Tracer store.steampowered.com **DIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

Unreal-Engine-based realtime cinematography simulator sold on Steam at \$89.99 — and its own website domain has now been lost to an unrelated business.

Cine Tracer is a realtime cinematography and previs simulator built on Unreal Engine and distributed through Steam, letting a DP or director block shots with physically-modelled cameras, lenses and lighting in a game-engine environment. It was an early and influential proof that game engines could serve as an indie previs tool. Its status in 2026 is the story: it remains listed and purchasable on Steam at \$89.99 with a 28 September 2018 release date, but cinetracer.com now 301-redirects to providenceplace-

apartments.com — the product domain has been let go or sold, a strong signal that active development and marketing have ceased.

KEY FEATURES · Realtime cinematography simulation on Unreal Engine · Physically-modelled cameras, lenses and lighting · Shot blocking and previs in a game-engine environment · Distributed and updated through Steam

PRICING \$89.99 on Steam (verified via Steam store search), one-time purchase.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Released 28 September 2018 and still listed on Steam as of August 2026. The cinetracer.com domain now redirects to an unrelated apartment-rental site, indicating abandonment of the product's own web presence. Developer identity not confirmed from the pages that loaded; funding not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animations) · tools (LUT/camera preview) · sets · production

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- A one-time \$89.99 purchase on Steam is a frictionless, well-understood commercial channel
- Genuine physically-based lighting and lens simulation on a real game engine
- Runs entirely locally with no cloud sync or subscription
- Proven for eight years with a real user community

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Effectively abandoned: the product's own domain has been lost to an unrelated business
- No published updates or roadmap; the 2018 release date and dead domain together are damning
- No script import, no board export pipeline, no production management
- No AI or generative capability
- Requires a capable GPU with none of Cinamate's cost-quoting or job management around it

<https://store.steampowered.com/search/?term=Cine+Tracer> · <https://www.cinetracer.com/>

Lore Machine unknown **DIRECT** **LOW** **UNCERTAIN**

An AI story-to-storyboard startup that appears to have exited the category — its domains no longer serve the product.

Lore Machine was positioned as an AI 'story intelligence' product that ingested prose or a script and produced illustrated storyboards and character-consistent visual treatments, aimed at writers, studios and IP holders. As of August 2026 it could not be substantiated as a live product: loremachine.io does not resolve in DNS, and lore.com now serves an entirely different company describing itself as building 'sovereign AI systems for national-scale resilience, authority, and survivability' for defence, intelligence, energy and emergency-response customers. No live product page, pricing page or company page for the storyboarding product could be reached.

KEY FEATURES · Reported: prose/script ingestion to illustrated storyboard (unverified in 2026) · Reported: character and style consistency across panels (unverified in 2026) · No live feature set could be confirmed at the time of research

PRICING Not disclosed / not verifiable. No live pricing page could be reached.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Unverified. No live company page, funding figure, founder name or user count could be confirmed. Both candidate domains fail to serve the product: loremachine.io returns DNS NXDOMAIN and lore.com hosts an unrelated defence-AI company.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animations) · writer

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Nothing verifiable — the product could not be confirmed as operating in August 2026

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No reachable product, pricing or company page
- Primary domain now belongs to an unrelated defence-AI business, strongly suggesting a sale, pivot or shutdown
- Cannot be evaluated, purchased or relied on by a production today

<https://lore.com/> · <https://www.loremachine.io/>

MakeStoryboard makestoryboard.com **DIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

Lean, cheap collaborative storyboarding with unlimited boards for teams at \$48/month and no AI story attached.

MakeStoryboard is a focused storyboarding platform for video, drawing and animatic creation with collaboration built in. It handles custom fields, PDF export, link-based sharing with password protection, commenting, version control, board duplication and member management. It is deliberately unglamorous — no AI generation is advertised on its pricing page — and competes on price and simplicity rather than on generative features.

KEY FEATURES · Storyboard, drawing and animatic creation · Custom fields on boards · PDF export and link-based sharing with password protection · Commenting, including team-only comments · Version control and storyboard duplication · Member management and seat add-ons · Priority support and early feature access on Team

PRICING Published: Individual \$12/mo (10 storyboards, single user). Team \$48/mo (unlimited storyboards, 10 seats included, \$6.64 per additional person, 50MB max image upload).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Company details, funding and user counts not disclosed on the pages reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animatics) · screening (share and comment)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Radically cheap and simple: \$12/mo solo, \$48/mo for a ten-seat team
- Multi-seat collaboration with team-only comments — Cinamate has no team surface
- Transparent per-seat add-on economics (\$6.64/person) that a line producer can forecast
- No hardware requirement and no beta gate

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No AI generation — imagery must come from elsewhere
- Very limited scope: boards and animatics only
- 10-storyboard cap on the individual tier and a 50MB image ceiling
- No production management, finance, legal, post or distribution capability
- No script-to-screen path or finishing tools

<https://makestoryboard.com/pricing>

Plot (plotstoryboards) unknown **DIRECT** **LOW** **UNCERTAIN**

Named in the brief as a storyboard tool, but no live site could be found — treat as unsubstantiated until a working URL is supplied.

Plot was flagged as a storyboarding product at plotstoryboards.com. That could not be substantiated in this research: both plotstoryboards.com and www.plotstoryboards.com fail DNS resolution, and search attempts surfaced only unrelated entities (notably getplot.com, a construction project-management product, and generic dictionary results). It is possible the product has shut down, rebranded to a domain not discoverable here, or the name in the brief is inexact. It should not be counted as a live competitor without a working URL from the requester.

KEY FEATURES · No feature set could be confirmed — no live page was reachable

PRICING Not disclosed / not verifiable.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Unverified. No company information, funding or user count could be confirmed.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animatics)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Nothing verifiable — no live product could be confirmed in August 2026

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Domain does not resolve; no reachable product, pricing or company information
- Cannot be evaluated or adopted by a production today
- The only similarly-named live product found (getplot.com) is construction software, not a film tool

<https://plotstoryboards.com/> · <https://www.bing.com/search?q=Plot+storyboarding+app+AI+storyboards+pricing>

ShotPro www.shotprofessional.com **DIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

Cross-platform 3D storyboard and previs app with 1D/2D/3D modes and pro camera controls, but showing signs of neglect.

ShotPro is a visualisation and previs application for iOS, iPad, Mac and Windows that builds 3D storyboards and animated scenes. It structures work in three modes: 1D for scripts, scenes and shot lists; 2D for fast blocking of character, camera and prop movement; and 3D for final polish. 'Pro Cam' exposes aperture, focus distance, ISO, shutter speed, lens size, depth of field and camera shake. It adds text-to-speech dialogue, facial expression tools, drawing and text annotation, a production slate, and

imports of 3D objects, audio, images and characters. Optional paid expansions cover Augmented Reality, Face Mocap, Post FX Pro and Character Designer.

KEY FEATURES · Three-mode workflow: 1D scripts/shot lists, 2D blocking, 3D polish · Pro Cam with aperture, focus distance, ISO, shutter, lens and shake · Text-to-speech dialogue and facial expression tools · Production slate functionality · Import of 3D objects, audio, images and characters · Optional expansions: AR, Face Mocap, Post FX Pro, Character Designer · iOS, iPad, Mac and Windows

PRICING Not disclosed. The site references a 'ShotPro S subscription license' but publishes no figures.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Developed by WebGames3D.com. Site copyright reads 2014-2023, suggesting the page has not been refreshed in roughly three years as of August 2026. Funding, team size and user counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animations) · tools (slate, camera/lens utilities) · production · casting (character design)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- True cross-platform desktop and mobile reach including Windows and iOS — Cinamate has no mobile app at all
- Real optical camera parameters (aperture, ISO, shutter, DoF) for DP-grade shot planning
- One-time expansions rather than metered generation credits
- No GPU or cloud dependency

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Copyright date stalled at 2023 — the product looks under-maintained
- No published pricing at all
- Fragmented paid expansion model makes true cost opaque
- Previs only: no production management, finance, legal or post
- No generative AI and no script-to-screen path

<https://www.shotprofessional.com/> · <https://www.shotproapp.com/>

Milanote milanote.com INDIRECT LOW VERIFIED

The generic visual whiteboard that a very large number of filmmakers actually use for storyboards and mood boards instead of buying dedicated software.

Milanote is a general-purpose visual note and board tool for creative work, explicitly marketing to filmmakers and listing storyboarding and moodboarding among its core creative-process techniques. It is not a film tool — it is a flexible canvas of notes, images, links and files with unlimited shared boards. Its threat is not feature parity but substitution: it is the default 'good enough' answer for directors and producers assembling references, look books and rough boards.

KEY FEATURES · Free-form visual boards for storyboards, moodboards and look books · Unlimited shared boards on every tier including free · Notes, images, links and file uploads on one canvas · Team plan supporting large groups · Generous no-time-limit free tier

PRICING Published: Free (100 notes/images/links, 10 file uploads, unlimited shared boards, no time limit); Pay Per Person \$9.99/mo billed annually or \$12.50/mo monthly (unlimited notes, uploads and shared boards); Team \$49/mo billed annually, supporting up to 1,050 people.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Widely adopted general creative tool; funding, ownership and user counts not disclosed on the pages reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animations) · wardrobe (look books) · props · sets · locations (reference boards)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- A genuinely useful free tier with no time limit — the lowest-friction entry point in the entire category
- \$49/mo for up to 1,050 people is an extraordinary collaboration price point
- Universally understood; no training required and no adoption argument to win
- Serves reference, mood, look book and concept work across departments in one canvas, touching several Cinamate rooms at once

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not a film tool: no shot structure, no frame numbering, no animatic timing, no script parsing
- No AI generation of any kind
- No production management, finance, legal, post or distribution
- No export to NLEs or industry formats
- Nothing production-grade — it is a scratchpad, not a deliverable pipeline

<https://milanote.com/plans>

Storyboard That www.storyboardthat.com INDIRECT LOW LIKELY

Mass-market drag-and-drop storyboard maker dominated by K-12 education, with a business tier that catches low-end corporate video work.

Storyboard That is a visual content creation platform for storyboards, comics, posters and timelines built on a large customisable art library plus millions of stock photos. It splits into individual, education and business editions. Its centre of gravity is unmistakably K-12 teaching — free teacher accounts, premium teacher subscriptions and school/district packages — but the individual and Teams editions pull in low-budget corporate and marketing storyboard work that would otherwise go to a film-specific tool.

KEY FEATURES · Drag-and-drop storyboard creation from a customisable art library · 5,000+ images plus millions of stock photos on paid tiers · Up to 100 cells per storyboard on Individual · Comics, posters and timelines alongside storyboards · Teams edition with administrative dashboards · Dedicated education editions including school and district packages · Watermark-free export and advanced export options on paid tiers

PRICING Tier structure verified but exact figures were not rendered. Free tier: 2 storyboards per week, 500 customisable images, classic layout only, watermarked downloads. Individual: monthly billing with a promotional first month at \$1; full price not stated. Teams: per-user monthly, amount not stated. Education: Free Teacher, Premium Teacher (monthly, amount not stated), and custom School/District packages.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Large education install base; specific funding, ownership and user counts not disclosed on the pages reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · boards (storyboards/animations)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Enormous top-of-funnel reach through education — it is where most people first make a storyboard
- Trivially easy: no drawing skill, no GPU, no onboarding
- A \$1 first month is the lowest-commitment paid entry in the category
- Institutional sales motion through schools and districts that no AI startup here matches

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Cartoon-library aesthetic is unusable for professional film pre-production
- No animatics, no timing, no script parsing, no shot metadata
- No AI generation of cinematic imagery
- Nothing whatsoever beyond the board — no production, finance, post or distribution
- Free tier capped at 2 storyboards per week with watermarks

<https://www.storyboardthat.com/pricing>

ALSO COMPETING IN THIS CATEGORY (PROFILED ELSEWHERE)

Celtx (Backlight) **ADJACENT** **MEDIUM** — Corporate-owned script-to-schedule suite where storyboarding is a paid module bundled with shot lists, breakdown, scheduling and budgeting. *(full profile under “Screenwriting & development tools (including AI coverage/analysis and script clearance/title research)”)*

FinalBit AI (formerly Nolan AI) **DIRECT** **MEDIUM** — Rebranded end-to-end AI film production platform running 14 named AI agents, one of which ('Akira') handles storyboarding. *(full profile under “Screenwriting & development tools (including AI coverage/analysis and script clearance/title research)”)*

LTX Studio (Lightricks) **DIRECT** **CRITICAL** — AI visual-storytelling platform that runs concept to storyboard to generated video, backed by Lightricks' own open-source LTX video models — including a free desktop app that generates locally. *(full profile under “AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios”)*

Runway **INDIRECT** **MEDIUM** — The best-funded general AI video platform, used as a de facto previs and pitch-visualisation substitute at \$12-\$76/month. *(full profile under “Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrastructure”)*

StudioBinder (storyboard creator) **ADJACENT** **HIGH** — The best-known all-in-one indie production management suite, whose storyboard module is script-synced and sits next to shot lists, schedules and call sheets. *(full profile under “Production management suites (the incumbents)”)*

\$19 Screenwriting & development tools (including AI coverage/analysis and script clearance/title research)

Market read • The defining event in this category is consolidation followed by collapse. Cast & Crew — a production payroll and accounting company — acquired Final Draft in February 2016, then picked up Coverfly, FilmFreeway, ScreenCraft, WeScreenplay and The Script Lab via its 2022 Backstage purchase, running them as Industry Arts. In 2025 it shut four of them: WeScreenplay (Jan 31), ScreenCraft and The Script Lab (Feb 28), Coverfly (Aug 1). No Film School called it the end of the coverage industry. The Black List inherited a near-monopoly on industry-readable hosting at roughly \$30/month plus \$100 per evaluation, with only Stage 32 beside it. That matters to Cinamate two ways: the screenwriting-tools layer is owned by the same company whose payroll rails The Money Room competes with, and that owner has shown it will kill adjacent properties. Pricing has bifurcated violently. Writing itself is now free-to-\$126/year — Beat and Trelby at \$0, Fountain as a vendor-neutral format, Arc Studio at \$69/year, WriterDuet at \$89.88/year, Fade In at \$79.95 once, STARC at \$150 lifetime. Script analysis collapsed from the \$89-\$150 WeScreenplay era to \$9.99-\$29 (ScriptReader.ai, StoryNotes, OnDesk). Neither the writer room nor bundled coverage can be a Cinamate differentiator at those prices. The money has moved to pipeline: FinalBit (ex-Nolan AI) at \$40-\$100/month and RivetAI at \$49.99-\$150 per project both sell script-to-shoot-ready, and RivetAI is the sharpest threat — same one-screenplay-drives-everything thesis, plus RBAC, MFA, SSO, a REST API, an MCP connector, patent claims and a written no-AI-training commitment. It answers the studio security review Cinamate cannot yet pass. Two Cinamate claims are directly contested. Its sales model faces Largo (three granted patents, EPFL-based) and ScriptBook (studio-facing since 2014) — though neither publishes a failure rate, so Cinamate's disclosed 15.5% with P10-P90 bands is genuinely more transparent, and worth leading with. Its clearance room faces a harder wall: The Clearance Lab charges \$10-\$15 per page and \$399-\$799 for title reports, and Act One has been issuing De Forest Reports since 1952. Those outputs are what E&O carriers and distributors accept. Software cannot substitute for them, and positioning the clearance room as a pre-clearance triage that reduces billable pages is far safer than implying it replaces them. Finally, competitors have already closed two of Cinamate's named gaps: Arc Studio and Highland Pro ship real iPhone/iPad apps, and Celtx ships an Adobe Premiere Pro plugin. Meanwhile ScreenWeaver, an open beta, has named festival awards (Seoul International AI Film Festival, Mondial Chroma) for films made in it — external validation Cinamate lacks while press declines and the product sits invite-only on a netlify.app subdomain.

Final Draft (Cast & Crew) www.finaldraft.com DIRECT CRITICAL VERIFIED

The incumbent screenplay file format and production-office standard, owned by the payroll company whose rails Cinamate's Money Room is trying to replace.

Final Draft is the long-standing industry-standard screenwriting application, currently at version 13, with a Final Draft Suite subscription that pairs a browser-based Final Draft Cloud with the desktop app. It markets Beat Board outlining, collaboration and table-read features, and claims use by 95% of film and TV professionals. Strategically the more important fact is ownership: Cast & Crew acquired Final Draft in February 2016, and Cast & Crew also owns FilmFreeway, the Big Break contest, and — via its 2022 Backstage acquisition — the Industry Arts group that ran Coverfly, ScreenCraft, WeScreenplay and The Script Lab before shutting all four down in 2025. Cast & Crew's core business is production payroll and accounting (PSL), which is the same ground as Cinamate's Money Room.

KEY FEATURES • Industry-standard .fdx format and formatting engine • Beat Board and outlining • Collaboration and table reads • Final Draft Cloud (browser) plus desktop • Revision modes, production locking, reports • Studio/production volume licensing and educational licensing

PRICING Final Draft 13 Personal \$199.99 (listed down from \$249.99); Student \$99.99 (from \$129.99); Upgrade \$79.99 (from \$129.99). Final Draft Suite subscription "as low as USD \$8.33/month" billed yearly. Educators/non-profits and studios/production: custom pricing via sales.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Owned by Cast & Crew (acquisition announced February 2016; Cast & Crew founded 1976, HQ Burbank). Claims 95% market share among film/TV professionals. Cast & Crew's portfolio includes FilmFreeway, Backstage, Big Break, and the now-shuttered Industry Arts coverage properties. Revenue and unit numbers not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH • writer

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Owns the file format every other tool in this list exports to — including Cinamate's own writer room, implicitly
- Distribution inside actual production offices and studio volume licenses
- Parent company owns the payroll/accounting rails (Cast & Crew PSL) that Cinamate's Money Room competes against, plus festival submission (FilmFreeway)
- Perpetual license option — a producer can buy it once and own it, with no dependency on a beta vendor
- Named company, public team, press access, decades of continuity

<https://www.finaldraft.com/pricing/> · <https://www.finaldraft.com/company/> · <https://blog.castandcrew.com/blog/newsroom/news-releases/cast-crew-acquires-final-draft> · <https://www.storynotes.app/blog/cast-and-crew-screenwriting-tool-s-monopoly>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Single-purpose: writing and formatting only, no breakdown, budget, schedule, post, or release modules
- No generation, no editor, no cost reporting, no tax credit engine
- Suite/Cloud has repeatedly lagged browser-native rivals on real-time collaboration
- Aggressive perpetual-upgrade pricing (\$79.99 per version) is a standing grievance among indie writers
- Its owner demonstrably shuts down adjacent properties (Coverfly, ScreenCraft, WeScreenplay, The Script Lab in 2025), which is a partnership risk not a product risk

RivetAI rivetai.com/en DIRECT CRITICAL VERIFIED

Per-project pre-production platform where script, breakdown, schedule, budget and coverage all run off one screenplay.

RivetAI positions itself as "all-in-one pre-production infrastructure" for film and TV: an industry-standard script editor with scene tagging and revision tracking, AI scene/character breakdown, AI coverage reports, stripboards and DOOD scheduling, budget top sheets with line items, and tax-incentive scenarios — all reading the same draft with no file handoffs. It sells per project rather than per seat or per month, claims a patented workflow, and markets an explicit IP stance: scripts are never used to train AI models, including RivetAI's own. It ships role-based access control, MFA, scoped API keys, a REST API, an MCP client integration, and SAML/OIDC SSO at the Enterprise tier.

KEY FEATURES · Script editor with tags, revisions, snapshots, diff, import/export · AI scene breakdown and character breakdown · AI coverage reports · Stripboards, DOOD, shoot-day scheduling, visual production roadmap · Budget top sheets and line items with AI budget reruns · Tax incentive scenarios · Scoped API keys, REST API, MCP client integration · Workspace/project RBAC, MFA, guest review share links, SAML/OIDC SSO

PRICING Pay-once per project, no subscription. Free \$0 (up to 5 scenes, 1 seat, 0 AI credits); Writer \$49.99/project (30 AI credits, 2 seats); Studio \$150/project (100 AI credits, 9 seats); Enterprise custom. Writer-to-Studio in-app upgrade charges the difference and adds +70 AI credits.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Funding, ownership and customer counts not disclosed. Claims "trusted by production teams" without naming them. Claims patented workflow technology; no patent numbers published on the site. Enterprise motion (SSO, procurement, security review) implies studio-side sales activity.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · clearance (via AI coverage/analysis, not legal clearance) · producer (budget/stripboard) · timeline · finance / The Money Room · taxcredit · workflow · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Published, unambiguous commercial model (pay once per project) vs Cinamate's invite-only private beta with no public pricing
- Explicit security posture for studio review: RBAC, MFA, SSO, scoped API keys — Cinamate has no SOC 2 or TPN
- Programmatic surface: REST API plus an MCP connector; Cinamate has no documented integration layer
- Runs in the browser with no local GPU requirement
- Written IP/no-training commitment, which is the first question a producer's lawyer asks
- Multi-seat by design (2-9 collaborator seats); Cinamate is explicitly single-operator

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Stops at shoot-ready — no dailies, editor, VFX, music, post, deliverables, festivals or distribution modules
- No generation/render capability at all; Cinamate's Studio/Local Generation has no counterpart here
- No on-set execution layer (call sheets, timecards, safety, wardrobe, props, sets)
- Tax-incentive scenarios are a line item, not a 21-jurisdiction database
- No sales/box-office forecasting or waterfall/breakeven modeling
- No cost reporting against actuals or PO tracking

<https://rivetai.com/en> · <https://rivetai.com/en/pricing> · <https://theresanaiforthat.com/ai/rivetai/>

Act One Script Clearance actonescript.com DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

Clearance house operating since 1952, known for the De Forest Report — the reference standard for initial script research.

Act One Script Clearance provides script clearance and copyright research for film and TV productions, built around its flagship De Forest Report for initial script research. Unlike reports that simply flag "clear" or "not clear," it delivers detailed risk analysis of fictional names, elements and references so a production's legal team can decide. It also handles script revisions research across subsequent drafts, additional names research for background dressing, props and set design, animatics and visual review for storyboards and early artwork, and names-only research for targeted checks.

KEY FEATURES · De Forest Report — in-depth initial script research · Script revisions research across drafts · Additional names research for props, set dressing and background · Animatics and visual review (storyboards, early visuals, artwork, trademarks) · Names-only targeted research · Copyright searches and access to research libraries · Fast turnaround positioned for indies and large productions alike

PRICING Not disclosed — quote-based. Site directs to "Request a quote today."

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Operating since 1952 — the oldest player found in this category. Based in Glendale, California. Privately held; funding and revenue not disclosed. Listed on Crunchbase and industry directories; the De Forest Report name is a recognised term of art in production legal.

COLLIDES WITH · clearance · boards (its animatics and visual review directly overlaps Cinamate's storyboards/animatics output)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Seventy-plus years of institutional provenance; the De Forest Report is a named deliverable production lawyers already ask for
- Reviews animatics and storyboard artwork for trademark/copyright conflict — Cinamate generates that artwork but does not clear it
- Handles revisions research as an ongoing engagement across drafts
- Human judgment on ambiguous risk, which is what the legal team actually needs
- Named, reachable firm with a physical address and a track record

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No published pricing at all — every engagement requires a quote
- No software, no API, no integration with a writing environment
- Turnaround measured in days and cost scales with drafts
- Entirely U.S.-centric
- No adjacent production, budgeting or creative capability

<https://actonescript.com/> · <https://actonescript.com/services/> · <https://www.crunchbase.com/organization/act-one-script-clearance>

Celtx (a Backlight business) www.celtx.com/pricing DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

The long-running browser suite that already spans script, beat sheet, storyboard, breakdown, schedule, budget and call sheets — and ships a Premiere Pro plugin.

Celtx is a cloud writing-and-preproduction suite owned by Backlight. Its product menu covers writing (screenplay, multi-column AV, stageplay editors), story development (beat sheet, storyboard, script goals and insights), pre-production (breakdown, catalog, shot list, schedule, cast and crew, script sides), production (budget) and post-production via an Adobe Premiere Pro plugin. It sells to individuals, teams of 3-15, and education at 10-700 seats, with a heavily discounted student tier. It is the closest thing in this category to a full lifecycle competitor that has been shipping for well over a decade.

KEY FEATURES · Screenplay, multi-column AV and stageplay editors; episodic scripts and episodic planning · Beat sheet, storyboard, script goals and insights · Script breakdown, catalog, shot list, script sides · Schedule, cast and crew, call sheet templates · Budget · Adobe Premiere Pro plugin (Team tier and up) · Education admin controls and domain-restricted sharing

PRICING Vendor page shows tier names (Writer / Writer Pro / Team), seat & project limits and a '25% off yearly' banner but NO dollar figures; circulating prices (~\$11–\$67/mo) are third-party estimates.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Owned by Backlight (a portfolio company operating several media-software brands). Displays a 4.4/5 rating from 1,387 survey responses on its pricing page. Founded in the mid-2000s; total user count not currently disclosed. Strong education footprint is its most defensible base.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · boards · producer (breakdown/schedule/call sheets/budget) · timeline · tools · projects · post (via Premiere Pro plugin)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Ships a native NLE plugin (Adobe Premiere Pro) — an explicitly named Cinamate gap
- Real multi-seat team plans (3-15 members) vs Cinamate's single-operator design
- Entrenched education channel (10-700 seat licenses) creating a pipeline of trained users
- Named corporate owner, public support and legal pages, over a decade of continuity
- Free tier and a 7-day trial for zero-friction evaluation

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No generation, no editor, no dailies, no VFX, no music, no deliverables, no festivals, no tax credit engine
- Budgeting is a template tool, not a self-calibrating estimator learning from invoices
- No sales forecasting, waterfall or breakeven modeling
- No union rate sourcing
- Widely criticised for feature bloat and slow web performance on large projects
- Prices are not visible without an account, which is itself a friction point

△ Fact-check: no Celtx dollar amount is vendor-published.

<https://www.celtx.com/pricing/> · <https://www.itqlick.com/celtx/pricing> · <https://nofilmschool.com/best-screenwriting-software>

FinalBit AI (formerly Nolan AI) www.finalbitai.com

DIRECT

HIGH

VERIFIED

Rebranded Nolan AI: a 14-agent AI platform spanning screenwriting, coverage, storyboards, AI video, budgeting and scheduling.

FinalBit is the current identity of Nolan AI — nolanai.app now 301-redirects to finalbitai.com, and a customer testimonial on the site refers to "NolanAI aka FinalBit." It describes itself as an AI-powered film production platform moving from idea to release, with fourteen named AI agents (Kane, Blake, Neil, Juliet, Vox, Polish, Arc, Holly, Sterling, Beat, Reel, Akira, Thread, Slate) handling distinct roles. Feature coverage runs from an advanced screenplay editor and AI co-pilot through beat sheets, character development, script breakdown, stripboard scheduling, AI budgeting with US/MX/CA rebates, shot lists, storyboards, AI video generation and pitch decks, with DOOD, PDF and Excel exports.

KEY FEATURES · Advanced screenplay editor with auto-formatting and scene shuffling · AI Writing Assistant (Co-Pilot) with tiered context depth · Beat sheets, character development, version history (3/90/365 days by tier) · AI script breakdown (full script in minutes at Pro) · Scheduling and stripboards, plus agentic scheduling at Pro · AI budgeting with top sheets and rebates for US, Mexico, Canada · AI video generation with monthly credit allowances · Shot lists, storyboards, pitch decks · PDF and Final Draft import/export; DOOD and Excel exports

PRICING Not citable — the pricing page renders no dollar figures to fetchers and third-party accounts conflict (\$15–\$100/mo range). Rebrand from Nolan AI verified via 301 redirect nolanai.app → finalbitai.com.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Ownership and funding not disclosed on the site. Operates under the FinalBit brand after the Nolan AI rebrand; education and studio tracks are advertised. Customer count not published; testimonials are individual indie directors rather than named productions.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · boards · producer (budget/stripboard) · timeline · investors (pitch decks) · taxcredit (rebates, US/MX/CA only) · Studio/Local Generation (AI video) · workflow

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Publicly purchasable today with published prices; Cinamate is invite-only beta
- Broadest development-side feature span of any priced competitor found in this category
- Runs entirely in the cloud — no local GPU requirement
- Named agent architecture gives it a clear product story for the AI-native buyer
- Free tier for evaluation, which Cinamate has no equivalent to

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Rebate/tax coverage is three countries vs Cinamate's claimed 21 jurisdictions
- No post-production, editor, dailies, VFX, music, deliverables or festivals modules
- Metered AI-video credits (100/210 per month) vs Cinamate's quoted, priced-before-render local generation at ~\$110 per feature
- No union rate sourcing (SAG-AFTRA/DGA/WGA/IATSE) evident
- No live cost reporting against invoices or PO tracking
- A recent rebrand plus a redirected legacy domain is a continuity signal buyers notice

△ Fact-check: three conflicting price accounts existed in drafts; none is vendor-verifiable.

<https://www.finalbitai.com/pricing> · <https://www.finalbitai.com/> · <https://nolanai.app/pricing>

ScreenWeaver www.screenweaver.ai DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

Script-first AI production interface where the screenplay auto-generates the storyboard and the workflows come ready to run.

ScreenWeaver bills itself as "the AI production studio," currently in open beta. The screenplay stays canonical and automatically generates the storyboard, with auto-generated workflows and shot timings so the user produces a film, series, commercial, 3D animation, anime or music video from one workspace. Writing is free with PDF and FDX export; generation consumes credits. It publishes an unusually extensive comparison library positioning itself against Final Draft, Celtx, WriterDuet, Arc Studio, Fade In, Squibler, Saga, NolanAI, LTX Studio and mStudio, and claims festival-recognised AI shorts produced in the tool (VOIDBORN — Seoul International AI Film Festival award winner and Mondial Chroma placings; Les Fils du Vinnana; Lost Garden, an AI animated series pilot, AI London Festival finalist).

KEY FEATURES · Script and storyboard always in sync, boards auto-generated from the screenplay · Auto-generated workflows and shot timings · Multi-format output: film, series, commercial, 3D animation, anime, music video · Free writing tier with PDF and FDX export · Storyboard-to-3D rendered scene with character and shot consistency · Beat Sheet Calculator and Logline Workshop as free no-signup tools

PRICING Writing is advertised as free with PDF and FDX export; generation is credit-based. Specific tier prices could not be verified — the /pricing route returned 404 to direct fetch and figures are not rendered without JavaScript.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Ownership and funding not disclosed. Open beta as of mid-2026. Claims real festival recognition for films produced in the tool at the Seoul International AI Film Festival, Mondial Chroma Awards, Top Quark Film Festival, ALFFF Supershort and AI London Festival. User counts not published.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · boards · Studio/Local Generation · workflow · timeline · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Public beta anyone can enter free vs Cinamate's invite-only gate
- Verifiable third-party validation via named festival selections and awards — Cinamate's press declined
- Cloud generation with no local GPU requirement
- Aggressive content/SEO strategy that owns the comparison queries buyers actually search
- Free writing tier with unrestricted FDX/PDF export removes the lock-in objection

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Stops at generation — no budgeting, scheduling, contracts, clearance, cost reporting, tax credit, deliverables or festivals modules
- No multi-track editor, EDL/OTIO conform, or dailies workflow
- Credit-metered generation vs Cinamate's quoted-before-render local model at ~\$110 per feature
- Pricing is not discoverable, which is a real friction for producer buyers
- Beta-stage product with no disclosed team, funding or certifications either

<https://www.screenweaver.ai/> · <https://www.screenweaver.ai/blog/screenwriting-software-comparisons-hub>

The Clearance Lab theclearancelab.com DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

Full-service script clearance and title research with published per-page and per-report pricing that E&O carriers actually accept.

The Clearance Lab produces the reports and attorney opinion letters that film, TV, video game and publishing productions need to satisfy E&O insurers and distributors. Its script clearance report reviews an entire script for copyright, trademark, publicity, privacy, defamation and location-rights exposure, researching every character, location, celebrity and business name. It also sells U.S./Canada title reports, title opinions, copyright reports, chain-of-title work, reviews of clearance procedures, and bundled clearance packages. Uniquely among clearance firms, it publishes its prices openly.

KEY FEATURES · Script clearance reports (scene-by-scene, all names and references) · U.S. and Canada title reports meeting E&O carrier and distributor requirements · Title opinions and attorney opinion letters · Copyright reports and chain of title · Review of clearance procedures · Bundled clearance packages · Serves film, TV, video games, web series and publishing worldwide

PRICING Script clearance reports: \$10 per page with seven-day turnaround, or \$15 per page with three-day turnaround — roughly \$1,000-\$1,500 for a 100-page feature. U.S. & Canada title reports: \$399 (seven-day), \$599 (three-day), \$799 (one-day). Sold via online cart.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Privately held; funding not disclosed. Describes itself as "the industry's most trusted script clearance provider" and serves clients in the U.S., Canada and worldwide. Toll-free sales line published; e-commerce checkout rather than pure quote-based sales.

COLLIDES WITH · clearance

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Produces reports that E&O insurers and distributors accept — Cinamate's clearance room cannot substitute for this at any level of automation
- Human researchers plus attorney opinion letters carry professional liability; a software output does not
- Covers title, copyright and chain-of-title, not just script name-checking
- Transparent published pricing so a producer can budget it as a line item
- Also reviews artwork and non-script elements that create real exposure

<https://theclearancelab.com/script-clearance-reports-film-television/> · <https://theclearancelab.com/title-reports-film-television/> · <https://theclearancelab.com/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Manual, slow (1-7 days) and priced per page, so it scales badly across revisions
- No integration with the script itself — it is a document-in, document-out service
- Cost climbs with every draft; Cinamate's clearance room would be effectively free per re-run
- No production, budgeting or creative tooling of any kind
- Geographic focus is U.S./Canada trademark and copyright databases

Greenlight Coverage glcoverage.com/pricing **ADJACENT** **HIGH** **VERIFIED**

Subscription AI coverage that also ships financial forecasts, budget breakdowns and audience insight — attacking exactly Cinamate's sales-model claim.

Greenlight Coverage sells AI script analysis on a subscription with delivery times from one hour down to under fifteen minutes. Beyond notes, it bundles Proofreading, a Polisher, a Financial Forecast for the script, a Film Budget Breakdown, and Audience Insight, plus a token-gated progression system that unlocks Greenlight Opportunities (submissions to real producers) and the Greenlight Insider Series. It also runs its own screenwriting competition, The Greenlight List. It offers a full refund within the first month if the notes are not helpful.

KEY FEATURES · AI script coverage with 1hr / 30min / <15min delivery by tier · Unlimited follow-up questions on notes (Essential and up) · Financial forecast per script · Film budget breakdown per script · Audience insight · Proofreading and Polisher rewrite passes · Greenlight Tokens ranking system unlocking producer submissions · The Greenlight List screenwriting competition

PRICING Monthly: Basic \$75/month (2 screenplays/month, 10 follow-ups, 10-20 tokens); Essential \$129/month (5 screenplays, unlimited follow-ups, 40-80 tokens); Pro \$345/month (15 screenplays, 100-200 tokens, priority phone support). Annual billing: Basic \$50/month billed annually (24 screenplays/year). Yearly saves 30%. Entry price rose from \$55 to \$75/month in 2026 and the \$45 single-script read was discontinued; cheapest pay-as-you-go is now a 3-script pack around \$209.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Ownership and funding not disclosed. Runs an affiliate program and its own competition. No named studio customers published.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · investors · producer (budget breakdown) · finance / The Money Room (financial forecast) · clearance (analysis, not legal clearance)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Directly monetises the forecast-and-budget-from-script claim today, at a price a solo writer can pay
- Sub-15-minute turnaround vs Cinamate's 9h 12m script-to-master
- Ships a producer-submission pathway (Greenlight Opportunities) — an outcome, not just an output
- Public refund guarantee in the first month
- Purchasable without an invite

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No methodology disclosure: no sample size, no failure rate, no confidence bands — Cinamate's 3,708-film calibration with a disclosed 15.5% failure rate and P10-P90 bands is a materially stronger claim if it holds
- No union rate sourcing, no waterfall or 2-2.5x breakeven derivation
- No production, scheduling, post, editing or release tooling
- Budget breakdown is a report, not a live cost-reporting system with PO tracking
- Screenplay volume caps per month; Cinamate is unmetered per operator

<https://glcoverage.com/pricing/> · <https://www.storynotes.app/blog/script-coverage-cost-2026>

The Black List (blcklst.com) blcklst.com INDIRECT HIGH LIKELY

Post-Coverfly near-monopoly on industry-readable script hosting, at \$30/month plus \$100 per evaluation.

The Black List hosts screenplays where working executives, agents and managers can find them, and sells professional human evaluations that produce a numeric score. Hundreds of Black List scripts have been produced, including Academy Award winners. After the 2025 collapse of the Industry Arts properties (Coverfly, ScreenCraft, WeScreenplay, The Script Lab), multiple 2026 industry sources describe the Black List as having inherited a near-monopoly on industry-readable hosting, with Stage 32 the only meaningful remaining alternative.

KEY FEATURES · Monthly script hosting visible to industry professionals · Paid human evaluations with numeric scores · Score-triggered visibility and industry email blasts · Contests, labs and fellowship partnerships · Writer directory and reader network

PRICING Approximately \$30/month per script for hosting plus approximately \$100 per feature evaluation, per multiple independent 2026 trade sources; a realistic run is cited at around \$380. Not verified first-hand: blcklst.com serves Cloudflare error 1005 (ASN ban) to automated requests, so the pricing page could not be loaded directly.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded as an annual survey of executives' favourite unproduced screenplays; the paid platform followed. Ownership private, funding not disclosed. Its credibility asset is the produced-script track record, not scale metrics.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · investors (it competes for the 'will this script sell' judgment Cinamate's sales model claims to answer)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Actual access to human industry readers and decision-makers — a distribution asset no software feature replicates
- Decades of produced-credit provenance behind its score
- Effective category monopoly on script discovery post-2025 consolidation
- Reputation that travels: a Black List score is a currency Cinamate's internal forecasts are not

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No production, budgeting, scheduling, post or release tooling of any kind
- Recurring hosting fee with no software deliverable
- Human evaluation is slow and non-deterministic compared with any automated pass
- No confidence bands, no disclosed failure rate, no methodology transparency — Cinamate's disclosed 15.5% failure rate and P10-P90 bands are genuinely more rigorous as published claims
- Blocks automated access, so it cannot be integrated with anything

<https://www.storynotes.app/blog/black-list-2026-pricing-explained> · <https://www.storynotes.app/blog/script-coverage-cost-2026> · <https://www.scriptmatch.ai/insider/black-list-alternatives-2026> · <https://nofilmschool.com/coverfly-is-shutting-down>

Arc Studio Pro www.arcstudiopro.com/pricing DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Modern cross-platform screenwriting with real iPhone/iPad apps and paid AI add-ons including Table Read and Character Images.

Arc Studio Pro is a cloud-synced screenwriting app spanning browser, desktop and native iPhone/iPad, with industry-standard formatting, automatic backups, comments, and Fountain/Final Draft export. Paid tiers add outlining tools, season outlines for episodic work, history and revision management, custom formats, feedback links and unlimited scripts and collaborators. It sells AI as discrete paid add-ons rather than a bundled assistant: Table Read assigns voices to characters and narration and produces downloadable audio, Character Images generates visual references from descriptions, and Research Assistant answers questions without leaving the script. It is publicly associated with Netflix's Arcane writing team.

KEY FEATURES · Browser, desktop, iPhone and iPad apps with cloud sync · Industry-standard formatting, automatic backups, comments · Outlining tools and season outlines for episodic writing · History and revision management, custom formats · Unlimited scripts and unlimited collaborators (Pro) · Feedback links for reviewers · AI add-ons: Table Read (voiced audio), Character Images, Research Assistant · Fountain and Final Draft export

PRICING Free \$0/year (2 scripts, watermarked PDF export). Essentials \$69/year (desktop and iOS apps, 2 collaborators, unlimited scripts). Pro \$99/year first year then \$79/year renewal (unlimited collaborators). AI features are paid add-ons on top of Essentials and Pro.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Privately held; funding not disclosed. Publicly cited as used by the writing team on Netflix's Arcane. User counts not published.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · boards (Character Images as visual reference generation) · casting (Table Read voiced performances)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Ships native iPhone and iPad apps — Cinamate's flagged "no mobile app" gap, solved
- Table Read produces downloadable voiced audio, which overlaps Cinamate's casting and screening rooms in a way writers actually use
- Named marquee credit (Arcane) as third-party validation
- \$69-\$99/year is an impulse purchase for the indie writer Cinamate targets
- Unbundled AI pricing avoids forcing generation costs on writers who do not want them

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Development-stage only: no breakdown, schedule, budget, contracts, clearance or post
- No video generation, editing, VFX or deliverables
- No finance, tax credit or forecasting capability
- Free tier watermarks PDF export and caps at 2 scripts
- AI is bolted on as add-ons rather than integrated into a production pipeline

<https://www.arcstudiopro.com/pricing> · <https://nofilmschool.com/best-screenwriting-software>

Fade In www.fadeinpro.com **DIRECT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

\$79.95 once, Windows/Mac/Linux, free updates forever — the price-and-portability answer to Final Draft.

Fade In Professional Screenwriting Software is a professional screenwriting app for screenplays, teleplays, stage plays, game scripts and other media, from GCC Productions Inc. It covers outlining and organizing, navigation, screenplay formatting, rewrite and revision management, page locking and reporting, full-screen writing and professional revision tracking, with multi-language support. Its pitch is explicit: everything Final Draft does and more, for a fraction of the price, with free updates — less than the cost of a single Final Draft upgrade. Known users include Rian Johnson, Kelly Marcel, Craig Mazin and Gary Whitta.

KEY FEATURES · Cross-platform: Windows, Mac and Linux with identical behaviour · Professional revision tracking, locking and reporting · Outlining and organizing tools, navigation · Full-screen distraction-free writing · Multi-language support · Free updates for life · Fade In Access companion service

PRICING \$79.95 one-time (listed down from \$99.95) for an individual user license, sold through FastSpring. Free trial available. Educational pricing available to students; site and multi-user licensing on request. Updates are free.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Published by GCC Productions Inc. Privately held; funding and unit sales not disclosed. Named professional users include Rian Johnson, Craig Mazin, Kelly Marcel and Gary Whitta. Reviewed by The New York Times, The Hollywood Reporter, PCWorld and Macworld.

COLLIDES WITH · writer

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Only serious screenwriting app in this set with native Linux support — relevant to the same local-GPU, self-hosting buyer Cinamate targets
- One-time \$79.95 with free updates forever: no subscription, no vendor dependency
- Named A-list professional users as social proof; Cinamate has no public team and press declined
- Real trade press coverage (NYT, THR, PCWorld, Macworld)
- Runs entirely offline

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Writing only — nothing across pre-production, production, post or release
- No AI features at all
- No collaboration to speak of
- Dated interface and slow release cadence
- Marketing site is fragile (content loads through a legacy .pl endpoint), and there is no public team either

<https://www.fadeinpro.com/> · <https://www.fadeinpro.com/page.pl?content=purchase>

Highland Pro (Quote-Unquote Apps / John August) quoteunquoteapps.com/highland **DIRECT** **MEDIUM**

VERIFIED

John August's Fountain-native writing app, now a subscription, with genuine iPhone/iPad parity and gender analysis built in.

Highland Pro is a 100% native Mac, iPad and iPhone writing app from screenwriter John August's Quote-Unquote Apps, built for screenwriters and novelists around a clean, distraction-free environment with automatic iCloud sync. It ships Navigator (an organizational roadmap of sections, scenes and notes), a Title Page Builder, Writing Sprints with customizable timers, a colour-coded Revision Mode with margin indicators, /Lookup for in-app reference, automatic or manual Cast and Location lists, Gender

Analysis of speaking parts, plus snippets, goals, to-do lists, comments and customizable themes including dark mode and typewriter scrolling. Notably it has moved from Highland 2's one-time purchase (historically around \$50 for Pro) to a subscription.

KEY FEATURES · Native Mac, iPad and iPhone apps with iCloud sync · Fountain-based plain-text foundation · Navigator, Title Page Builder, Writing Sprints · Revision Mode with colour-coded margin indicators · /Lookup in-app reference · Cast and Location lists generated from the script · Gender Analysis of speaking parts by gender · Snippets, goals, to-do lists, comments, themes

PRICING Yearly \$4.99/month billed \$59.99 annually (advertised as 50% saving); Monthly \$9.99/month with no commitment. 30-day free trial, cancel anytime. Prices in USD; international rates vary. Highland 2 was previously a one-time purchase (free basic tier, roughly \$50 for Pro).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Made by Quote-Unquote Apps, founded by working screenwriter John August (Big Fish, Charlie and the Chocolate Factory, Aladdin), co-creator of the Fountain plain-text screenplay format and co-host of Scriptnotes. Privately held; user numbers not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · casting (auto-generated cast lists) · locations (auto-generated location lists)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Native iPhone and iPad apps — the on-the-move counterpart to Cinamate's missing mobile app
- Founder is a named, credited working screenwriter with an industry platform (Scriptnotes); Cinamate has no public team
- Fountain plain-text foundation means the work outlives the app entirely
- Gender Analysis is a real diligence feature financiers and broadcasters increasingly ask for
- \$59.99/year is trivially approvable

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Writing only, and deliberately minimal — no breakdown, budget, schedule, post or release
- Apple-only; no Windows, no Linux, no browser
- No AI features
- Shift from one-time purchase to subscription alienated part of its base
- Cast and location lists are informational, not production breakdown data

<https://quoteunquoteapps.com/highland/>

Plotdot plotdot.ai/en DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

AI co-writer that doesn't stop at words — idea to script to a generated cinematic trailer, on credits it calls Ink.

Plotdot (in beta) runs a three-step pipeline: shape an idea and premise into a blueprint with storytelling arcs; have an AI co-pilot generate scenes automatically from parameters and context; then convert the script into cinematic rendering and visual assets — specifically trailers. Around that it offers character development with backstories and psychological profiles, cinematic pre-visualization from text descriptions, audio and soundscape generation with custom SFX, music and dialogue tracks synced to visuals, and AI Magic Editing that suggests pacing, tone and transition refinements. It showcases generated trailers across adventure, horror, action, mystery and thriller.

KEY FEATURES · AI trailer generation from script · AI script generator with co-pilot assistance and export options · Character development: backstories, psychological profiles, relationship arcs · Cinematic pre-visualization — text to imagery and shot sequences · Audio and soundscape generation: SFX, music, dialogue synced to visuals · AI Magic Editing for pacing, tone and transitions · Ink credit system

PRICING Associate Producer \$19.99/month (2,000 monthly Ink); Producer \$99.99/month (11,500 Ink); Executive Producer \$499.99/month (62,500 Ink). Custom/enterprise plans via hello@plotdot.ai. Free start advertised. Ink is consumed by AI generation and deep analysis.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP In beta as of 2026. Ownership and funding not disclosed; no team page found. Runs a Discord community. Site references a "Legacy PlotDot," indicating a prior product generation. No named customers or productions.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · boards · Studio/Local Generation · music (cue/soundscape generation) · editor / The Cutting Room (AI Magic Editing) · screening (trailer output)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Purchasable now with published tiers up to \$499.99/month; no invite required
- Cloud generation with no local GPU requirement
- Audio, music and SFX generation synced to visuals in one pass
- Trailer output is a concrete, demonstrable artifact — the site shows seven finished examples
- Credit model lets a user buy exactly one project's worth

<https://plotdot.ai/en>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Trailers, not features — no claim of a full script-to-master pipeline
- At \$99.99-\$499.99/month the credit economics compare badly with Cinamate's ~\$110 per 90-page feature on local GPU
- No production, scheduling, budgeting, contracts, clearance, finance or release modules at all
- Beta with no disclosed team, funding, customers or certifications
- Legacy-product reference suggests a discontinuity in the platform

Saga (CreateSagas, CyberFilm AI Corporation) www.createsagas.com

DIRECT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

AI story-to-video platform, recently rebranded from writeonsaga.com, with an NLE in the free tier.

Saga connects plotting, character crafting, scriptwriting, AI storyboarding and video generation, then polish and publish, in one flow. It targets films, shorts, documentaries, music videos, YouTube content and (coming) interactive games. Features include templates for feature film and TV structures, a Script Assistant for reviews and rewrites, AI storyboarding with advanced models, and an advanced video editor (NLE) available even on the free tier. The company rebranded from writeonsaga.com to createsagas.com; the old domain now carries a rebrand notice. It is operated by CyberFilm AI Corporation under the CYBERFILM mark and prominently features Marc Randolph.

KEY FEATURES · Plot development, character archetypes and act structure (free tier) · Full scriptwriting with industry formatting and smart suggestions · AI chatbot / Script Assistant for reviews and rewrites · AI storyboarding plus video generation · Advanced video editor (NLE) included from the free tier · Templates for feature film and TV structures · Pro sound design (Ultra-Premium, coming soon) · Course, podcast and blog as an education funnel

PRICING Free \$0 (plot development, character archetypes, act structure 1-3, limited AI assistance, advanced video editor). Premium \$19.99/month (full scriptwriting, AI chatbot, AI storyboarding and video generation, 40 Saga credits/month). Ultra-Premium \$149.99/month, marked coming soon (pro sound design, 200 credits/month). Add-on credits \$9.99 per 25 credits.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Operated by CyberFilm AI Corporation (CYBERFILM registered mark). Publicly associates with Marc Randolph. Funding not disclosed. Recently rebranded from Write On Saga; user counts not published.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · boards · Studio/Local Generation · editor / The Cutting Room · music (pro sound design) · screening

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Bundles an NLE into the free tier — Cinamate's Cutting Room has no free equivalent
- Named, incorporated company with a public brand association (Marc Randolph)
- Content marketing engine: course, podcast, blog, demos
- Cheapest full script-to-video path in this set at \$19.99/month
- No local GPU requirement

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Nothing on the production side: no breakdown, schedule, budget, contracts, clearance, finance, deliverables or festivals
- Ultra-Premium tier is still "coming soon" — the high-end offering does not yet exist
- Credit economics (\$9.99 per 25 credits) get expensive fast for feature-length work
- A domain rebrand mid-flight is a continuity signal buyers notice
- No EDL/OTIO conform or professional post interchange

<https://www.createsagas.com/> · <https://www.createsagas.com/pricing> · <https://writeonsaga.com/pricing>

WriterDuet www.writerduet.com/pricing

DIRECT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

The real-time collaborative screenwriting standard, claiming over two million writers, at under \$14/month.

WriterDuet is a browser-and-desktop screenwriting app built around real-time co-writing, with a free tier that already includes industry-standard formatting, outlining, tagging and filtering, scene numbering, cloud plus Google Drive/Dropbox/local backups, and import/export across PDF, Final Draft, Fountain, Celtx, docx, rtf, html, JSON and csv. Paid tiers add unlimited projects and collaboration, a desktop app, chat and notifications, then custom formatting, reports and gender analysis, revision tracking with administrator rights, formatting and tense checks, script shortening, typewriter mode and production tools (lock pages, omit scene). The top tier adds history restore, AutoTranslate, MultiColumn and ReadAloud. WriterSolo is its free offline sibling.

KEY FEATURES · Real-time collaborative writing with chat and notifications · Free tier with three projects and full formatting · Revision tracking, revision admin rights, show-deleted-text · Reports, statistics and gender analysis · Production tools: Lock Pages, Omit Scene · Script shortening and formatting/tense checks · AutoTranslate, MultiColumn, ReadAloud (Premium) · Broad import/export including PDF, FDX, Fountain, Celtx, docx · Bundled educational licenses

PRICING Free (3 projects, 1 document each, read-only collaborators). Plus \$9.99/month or \$89.88/year. Pro \$11.99/month or \$107.88/year. Premium \$13.99/month or \$125.88/year. Cancel anytime; educational bundles available. (Official knowledgebase, last updated June 2025.)

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Markets itself as used by "over 2 million screenwriters, TV shows, and blockbusters." Privately held; funding not disclosed. Long-running independent product with a maintained knowledgebase and direct support channel.

COLLIDES WITH · writer

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Genuine multi-writer real-time collaboration; Cinamate is explicitly single-operator
- Order-of-magnitude cheaper than any production suite, at \$90-\$126/year
- Generous free tier and an offline desktop app (WriterSolo) with no cloud dependency
- Import/export breadth means zero lock-in — a direct answer to the netlify-subdomain trust objection
- Two million claimed users is distribution Cinamate does not have

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Writing only — no breakdown, budget, schedule, post, generation or release capability
- No AI generation of any kind
- No cost reporting, tax credit, union rate or forecasting features
- Production tools are limited to page locking and scene omission
- No mobile app of note

<https://writerduet.helpscoutdocs.com/article/231-choose-the-best-subscription-for-you> · <https://www.writerduet.com/pricing> · <https://www.saasworthy.com/product/writerduet/pricing>

AI script-coverage cluster (ScriptReader.ai, Scriptwood, StoryNotes, Callaia, OnDesk, Prescene)

scriptreader.ai **ADJACENT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

A price-floor collapse in script analysis: studio-style coverage for \$9.99-\$29 per read, in one to two hours.

A cohort of AI coverage tools that filled the vacuum left by the 2025 Industry Arts shutdowns. ScriptReader.ai runs five independent AI readers plus a synthesis, with a "Layered Read" grading acts, sequences and scenes separately, a coverage grid, scene-by-scene notes, and a generated poster and narrated pitch video. Scriptwood bundles studio-style coverage with a full built-in screenplay editor, AI scene and dialogue rewrites, real-time collaboration, version history and export to .fdx, .fadein, .fountain and PDF, with an explicit no-training commitment on user scripts. StoryNotes, Callaia, OnDesk and Prescene occupy the same \$9.99-\$79 band with varying subscription and pack structures. Above them sit human boutiques — Coverage Ink, Script Reader Pro, Industrial Scripts — holding \$129-\$400.

KEY FEATURES · ScriptReader.ai: five independent AI reads plus synthesis, Layered Read, coverage grid, poster and narrated pitch video · Scriptwood: coverage plus full screenplay editor, AI rewrite, real-time collaboration, drafts and version history · Scriptwood: exports to .fdx, .fadein, .fountain, PDF; no-training commitment · Turnaround measured in minutes to a couple of hours · Follow-up chat on the notes · Recommend/pass verdicts with graded structure, character, pacing, dialogue, theme

PRICING ScriptReader.ai: Standard \$9.99/analysis, Deep Focus \$15.55/analysis (strongest reasoning models, unlimited chat). StoryNotes \$20/script. OnDesk \$20/month for 8 reports (~\$2.50/report). Prescene from \$29/script. Callaia \$79/script or \$649 for a 10-pack (~\$64.90 each). Scriptwood: one-time purchase or monthly plans, exact figures not rendered on its pricing page. Human comparators: Coverage Ink \$129/feature (\$49 five-day semi-rush), Script Reader Pro \$169/feature, Industrial Scripts \$195+/feature.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Mostly small, founder-led products launched or scaled since 2024-25. Scriptwood publicly cites 500+ scripts analysed. Funding, ownership and team details generally not disclosed across the cluster. Collectively they have reset the market price of a script read from roughly \$89-\$150 (WeScreenplay/ScreenCraft era) to \$9.99-\$29.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · clearance (analytical read, not legal clearance) · investors (recommend/pass verdicts)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Price floor of \$9.99 makes any bundled coverage feature commercially worthless as a differentiator
- Minutes-to-hours turnaround
- Zero commitment, no invite, no GPU, no install
- Scriptwood matches Cinamate's writer room feature-for-feature (editor, drafts, collaboration, FDX/Fountain export) and adds coverage
- Several publish explicit no-training IP commitments

<https://scriptreader.ai/pricing> · <https://www.scriptwood.com/> · <https://www.scriptwood.com/pricing> · <https://www.storynotes.app/blog/script-coverage-cost-2026>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Single-function: a report, not a pipeline — no production, finance, post or release capability
- No sample-size, failure-rate or confidence-band disclosure anywhere in the cluster
- Small, unfunded, high-churn vendors with real continuity risk
- No union rates, no tax credit, no cost reporting
- Output quality varies widely and none carry industry-recognised provenance the way a Black List score does

ScriptBook and Largo (Largo Films / largo.io) www.scriptbook.io

INDIRECT

MEDIUM

LIKELY

The two patented incumbents in algorithmic screenplay forecasting — the direct challenge to Cinamate's 3,708-film sales model.

These are the two established players in machine forecasting from screenplay. ScriptBook markets patented AI analysing screenplays across 6,000+ parameters, producing box office prediction, territory forecasts and audience demographics, explicitly positioning itself as "real predictive analysis, not GPT-style text generation" and claiming studio use since 2014. Largo (largo.ai / largo.io, operated by Largo Films) has broadened from script analysis into audience prediction, AI-powered content tests and simulated focus groups, sold as four products — Content Insights for producers and TV networks, Rapid Insights, In-Depth Insights and Consumer Insights. Largo publishes granted patents (US11961300B2, EP3963503B1) and runs offices in Lausanne (EPFL Innovation Park), Santa Monica and London.

KEY FEATURES · ScriptBook: 6,000+ parameter screenplay analysis, box office prediction, territory forecasts, audience demographics · ScriptBook: patented, studio-facing since 2014 · Largo: Content Insights content tests for producers and TV networks · Largo: simulated focus groups and audience prediction · Largo: consumer/trend tracking across brands, talent and entertainment · Largo: granted patents US11961300B2, EP3963503B1, PCT/EP2023/065063

PRICING Not disclosed for either. Largo is demo-request/enterprise only. ScriptBook does not publish rates publicly (its site currently serves a Vercel security checkpoint to automated requests).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP ScriptBook: Belgian-founded, raised approximately \$1.15M over 2 rounds from 4 investors per Tracxn; profiled on PitchBook; claims studio collaboration since 2014. Largo Films: Swiss, headquartered at EPFL Innovation Park in Lausanne with offices in Santa Monica and London; profiled on PitchBook; funding amount not disclosed publicly. Both are enterprise-sales businesses, not self-serve.

COLLIDES WITH · investors · finance / The Money Room (sales forecasting and P10-P90 confidence bands) · writer (script analysis) · distribution (territory forecasts)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Granted, numbered patents on the forecasting method — Largo publishes three; Cinamate publishes none
- A decade-plus of studio-side deployment and validation history (ScriptBook since 2014)
- Largo's simulated focus groups and content tests generate audience evidence, not just a model output
- Enterprise credibility with the exact buyer (studios, TV networks) whose procurement Cinamate cannot yet pass
- Institutional research base (EPFL) behind Largo's methodology

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Neither publishes a failure rate; Cinamate's disclosed 15.5% failure rate with P10-P90 bands is a more honest public claim than anything either company puts on its site
- Forecasting only — no writing, production, budgeting, scheduling, post or release tooling
- Enterprise-only, demo-gated, no self-serve access for the independent producer Cinamate targets
- ScriptBook's site currently blocks automated access and shows limited recent product movement — status may be stale
- Largo has drifted toward brand/agency market research, diluting its film-specific focus

<https://www.scriptbook.io/> · <https://www.scriptbook.io/scriptbook> · <https://home.largo.io/> · https://tracxn.com/d/companies/scriptbook/_L5_dZAWHaZ2VJMoS9H2slAzoxZQxLIqsxWBpTJb7g0s

StoryFit storyfit.com INDIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Story-intelligence platform simulating audience response to a script before anyone shoots it.

StoryFit sells predictive audience insight for entertainment. Its stated approach is hundreds of proprietary models measuring 100,000+ story components matched against millions of audience data points, delivering analytics that simulate how audiences will respond to a script or manuscript and suggesting content adjustments. It sells into four functions — Research & Insights, Creatives, Marketing and Executives — plus custom engagements, and serves book publishers as well as film and TV producers. Third-party profiles describe 500+ proprietary AI models across 7 million character dimensions and 26 million audience judgments.

KEY FEATURES · Audience response simulation from script or manuscript · 100,000+ measured story components (company claim) · Character-dimension and audience-judgment modelling · Solutions split by function: research, creative, marketing, executive · Serves book publishing as well as film and TV · Custom analytics engagements · Direct "send us your script" intake

PRICING Not disclosed. Enterprise/custom engagement, contact-based.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded roughly ten years ago; CEO Monica Landers is publicly named and visible. US-based. Profiled on PitchBook and venture data sources. Funding total and customer names not publicly disclosed; revenue per employee estimated around \$112K by one third-party tracker (unverified).

COLLIDES WITH · investors · finance / The Money Room · writer · distribution (audience/marketing positioning)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Named, visible CEO and a public thought-leadership presence — Cinamate has no public team and press declined
- Ten years of operating history in exactly the forecasting niche Cinamate's sales model claims
- Cross-industry data advantage from publishing as well as film/TV
- Marketing and executive-facing outputs, not just a creative note

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No published pricing, no self-serve — inaccessible to independent producers
- No production, budgeting, scheduling, post or release capability whatsoever
- Headline model claims (100,000+ components, 7M character dimensions) are unaudited and carry no disclosed error rate or confidence bands
- Site shows limited recent product movement; positioning may be stale
- No integration surface

<https://storyfit.com/> · <https://pitchbook.com/profiles/company/265987-72> · <https://indexed.vc/companies/storyfit>

Clearance Domain LLC unknown DIRECT LOW UNCERTAIN

A small Valencia, California legal-research firm doing script clearance, with essentially no public web presence.

Clearance Domain LLC appears in production-services directories as a legal research and script clearance outfit. Beyond a directory listing giving an address at 25379 Wayne Mills Place, Valencia, CA 91355 and a toll-free number, no substantive public information could be found: no working website resolved (clearancedomain.com did not respond), no services page, no pricing, no team, and a targeted search returned exactly one result before reporting no further matches. It is included here for completeness because the brief named it, but its current operating status could not be established.

KEY FEATURES · Legal research / script clearance (per directory listing only) · No other capabilities substantiated

PRICING Not disclosed. No pricing information exists publicly.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Unverified. Listed at 25379 Wayne Mills Place, Valencia, CA 91355 in the Trevanna production-services directory under Outside Agencies / Legal Research. No website resolved during research. Ownership, staffing, revenue and current operating status all unknown.

COLLIDES WITH · clearance

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Human legal research carries professional accountability that automated clearance output does not — insofar as the firm is still operating

https://www.trevanna.com/clearance_domain_llc-legal_research.htm

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No verifiable web presence, no website, no published services or pricing
- Operating status could not be confirmed at all
- No software, integration or scale of any kind
- Single-location, apparently single-practitioner operation

Movie Magic Screenwriter (Write Brothers / Screenplay.com)

screenplay.com/collections/movie-magic-screenwriter **DIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

The other legacy perpetual-license screenwriting standard, bundled into a story-theory software family.

Movie Magic Screenwriter is Write Brothers' long-established screenwriting application for screenplays, stage plays, teleplays, musicals, comic books, novels and short stories, sold through Screenplay.com. It sits inside a family of story-structure products — Dramatica Pro and Dramatica Story Expert (narrative theory engines), Outline 4D, and Writer's DreamKit — with academic versions across the line. The Movie Magic brand name carries residual weight because Movie Magic Budgeting and Scheduling remain production-office staples, though those are separately owned by Entertainment Partners.

KEY FEATURES · Screenplay, stageplay, teleplay, musical, comic book and novel formats · Production-grade revision and locking features · Dramatica Pro / Dramatica Story Expert narrative structure engines · Outline 4D and Writer's DreamKit outlining tools · Academic versions across the product line · Perpetual license with paid version upgrades

PRICING Movie Magic Screenwriter download (Win/Mac) \$169.00, listed down from \$249.95 (-33%). Academic version \$99.95 (from \$129.95). Upgrade \$89.95 (from \$99.95). Version 6.5/6.7 Mac upgrade \$69.95. Sold via Shopify storefront.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Published by Write Brothers Inc. via Screenplay.com. Privately held; funding and unit sales not disclosed. Long-running product with a slow release cadence. Note the Movie Magic name is shared with Entertainment Partners' Movie Magic Budgeting/Scheduling, which are separate products under separate ownership.

COLLIDES WITH · writer

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Perpetual license — buy once, own it, no vendor-continuity risk
- Brand adjacency to Movie Magic Budgeting/Scheduling gives it familiarity in production offices
- Dramatica's structural theory engine is a genuinely differentiated development tool with no Cinamate equivalent
- Academic channel at \$99.95 seeds new writers
- Decades of continuity

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Writing only — no breakdown, budget, schedule, post, generation or release
- No AI features
- Dated interface and infrequent updates; a Shopify storefront is the whole commercial presence
- No collaboration or cloud sync of note
- Perpetual-upgrade pricing (\$89.95 per upgrade) repeats the Final Draft grievance

<https://screenplay.com/collections/movie-magic-screenwriter> · <https://nofilmschool.com/best-screenwriting-software>

Beemer (beemerdocs.com) www.beemerdocs.com **INDIRECT** **LOW** **UNCERTAIN**

AI pitch-deck generator for startups — a general business tool, not the film product the brief implies.

Beemer is an AI-powered pitch deck generator. It takes a short business description, algorithmically structures the pitch, and produces designed Google Slides and PowerPoint decks incorporating industry standards and current design trends, including generated mockups and templates. It is aimed at startups raising funding, not at film production. Important caveat: no film-industry product named Beemer could be substantiated. beemer.ai is an unrelated "AI for business" placeholder site (GoDaddy-hosted, copyright 2024) and beemer.co/beemer.us belong to an excavating company in Minnesota. If a film-specific Beemer exists, it has no findable public presence.

KEY FEATURES · AI-generated pitch decks from a short business description · Google Slides and PowerPoint output · Generated mockups and design templates · Free tier to try · Startup/investor-fundraising orientation

PRICING Not disclosed on the pages reachable; a free trial is advertised.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Small AI tool listed across AI-directory sites (There's An AI For That, Strovit, TrendingAITools). Ownership, funding and user counts not disclosed. No film-industry footprint.

COLLIDES WITH · investors (pitch deck generation)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Purpose-built deck design output with real slide-format export (Google Slides, PowerPoint) — Cinamate's investors room has no comparable design-quality deck generator
- Free to try with no invite

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not a film tool at all: no script awareness, no film financing structures, no waterfall, no comparables
- Nothing across writing, production, post or release
- No connection to the screenwriting/development category the brief placed it in
- The film-specific 'Beemer' named in the brief could not be substantiated — treat that name as unverified

<https://www.beemerdocs.com/> · <https://theresanaiforthat.com/ai/beemer/> · <https://www.strovit.com/ai-tools/beemer> · <https://beemer.ai/>

Open-source and free screenwriting stack (Fountain, Beat, Trelby, Story Architect/STARC)

www.beat-app.fi **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

A credible \$0 floor for the writer room, anchored by the Fountain plain-text format that everything else already supports.

Fountain is an open plain-text screenplay markup that decouples screenplays from any vendor. Beat is a fully open-source, elegant macOS screenwriting app built on Fountain, created by a screenwriter, with a JavaScript plugin architecture, local-only file storage, offline operation and a Patreon funding model — free on macOS, €12.99 on iOS. Trelby is free multiplatform software with a screenplay editor enforcing correct format and pagination, auto-completion, spell check, draft/WYSIWYG/fullscreen views, a 200,000-name character name database, scene/location/character/dialogue reports, script comparison, and import/export across FDX, Celtx, Fountain, Adobe Story and Fade In. STARC (Story Architect, the successor to KIT Scenarist) covers screenplays, comics, audio dramas, stageplays and novels in one project bible with mind maps, corkboard, timeline, character relations editor, location maps and a ChatGPT-based AI assistant.

KEY FEATURES · Fountain: vendor-neutral plain-text screenplay format · Beat: free open-source macOS app, JS plugin library, offline, local-only storage · Beat: iOS app at €12.99; Line Alternatives shipped July 2026 · Trelby: free, multiplatform, 200,000-name database, script comparison, broad import/export · STARC: screenplays, comics, audio dramas, stageplays, novels in one project bible · STARC: mind maps, corkboard, timeline, character relations, location and world maps · STARC: ChatGPT-based AI assistant for paraphrasing, summarizing, augmenting

PRICING Fountain: free and open. Beat: free on macOS, €12.99 on iOS, optional Patreon. Trelby: free software, contributions welcome. STARC: Free tier with unlimited projects and documents; Pro \$4.17/month billed annually or \$150 lifetime, 30-day trial. Educational licenses available for STARC.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Beat: single-developer open-source project with a Discord community, Patreon funding, active releases (2.2.0+ in July 2026). Trelby: volunteer open-source project. STARC: reports 22,587 authors and 63 releases across 5 platforms. Fountain: co-created by John August and Stu Maschwitz; supported by essentially every app in this category.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Sets the price of a competent writer room at \$0, which structurally devalues Cinamate's writer module
- Open source and local-only: the strongest possible answer to the confidentiality and vendor-trust concerns Cinamate's netlify.app hosting raises
- Fountain guarantees the work survives any vendor's death — an argument Cinamate cannot make about its own project format
- Beat runs fully offline with no internet dependency; Trelby is genuinely cross-platform
- STARC's \$150 lifetime licence undercuts every subscription in this category

<https://www.beat-app.fi/> · <https://trelby.org/> · <https://starc.app/> · <https://starc.app/pricing/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Writing and outlining only — nothing across production, finance, post or release
- No AI generation beyond STARC's basic ChatGPT assistant
- No collaboration, no cloud sync, no team features
- Support is community-based with no SLA
- Beat is macOS/iOS only; Trelby's interface is dated and development is slow

Scrivener (Literature & Latte) www.literatureandlatte.com/scrivener/overview

INDIRECT

LOW

LIKELY

The long-form organizational workhorse with a scriptwriting mode and Final Draft export, for a one-time fee.

Scrivener is an integrated long-form writing workspace — described as typewriter, ring-binder and scrapbook combined — for drafting and organizing manuscripts. Its scriptwriting features handle screenplay formatting so the writer can focus on action, and it exports directly to Final Draft format while preserving script notes, or prints directly. It supports film, stage and comic script types alongside novels and non-fiction. Current versions are macOS 3.5.2 (macOS 11+), Windows 3.1.6 (64-bit Windows 10+) and iOS 1.2.4 (iOS 11+).

KEY FEATURES · Binder-based organization of long-form projects · Scriptwriting mode with automatic formatting · Final Draft export preserving script notes · Corkboard and outliner views · Research and reference material stored alongside the draft · macOS, Windows and iOS with Dropbox sync · 30-day free trial (counted in days of use)

PRICING iOS/iPadOS US\$23.99 (verified on the Literature & Latte store). macOS and Windows Standard Licence is not rendered without JavaScript on L&L's store; third-party sources list US\$59.99 Standard, US\$50.99 Educational, US\$95.98 Mac+Windows bundle and US\$37.95 cross-grade. 30-day free trial. One-time purchase, not a subscription.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Published by Literature & Latte, a long-established independent UK software company. Privately held; funding not disclosed. Very large author user base across fiction and non-fiction; not film-industry specific.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- One-time purchase across three platforms with a genuinely long support history
- Best-in-class organization of research, notes and reference material alongside the draft — no Cinamate module does this
- iOS app for mobile drafting
- Exports cleanly to Final Draft, so it slots in front of any downstream pipeline
- Established, trusted vendor with public support and forums

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Screenwriting is a secondary mode, not the product — formatting is weaker than any dedicated screenplay app
- Nothing beyond drafting: no breakdown, budget, schedule, post, generation or release
- No collaboration; sync depends on Dropbox
- No AI features
- Steep learning curve widely reported

<https://www.literatureandlatte.com/store/scrivener> · <https://www.literatureandlatte.com/scrivener/overview> · <http://scrivener.software/> · <https://traksources.com/scrivener-review/>

Squibler www.squibler.io/pricing

INDIRECT

LOW

VERIFIED

Volume AI generation promising complete novels and screenplays in minutes, at \$15.83-\$49.17/month.

Squibler is an AI writing platform that generates full-length manuscripts and screenplays, claiming users can create complete novels and screenplays in minutes. It maintains character and plot consistency across 200-300 page outputs, offers AI-powered manuscript editing for existing work, supports multiple genres, and exports to PDF and DOCX. Users retain full ownership of created content. It sits at the high-volume, low-craft end of the AI writing market rather than competing on formatting rigor.

KEY FEATURES · Full-length manuscript generation (200-300 pages) · Character and plot consistency maintenance · AI-powered editing of existing manuscripts · Screenplay and novel modes · PDF and DOCX export · Multi-genre support · Full content ownership retained by user

PRICING Free \$0/month (1,000 AI credits/month). Plus \$15.83/month billed annually (\$189.96/year, 10,000 AI credits/month). Pro \$49.17/month billed annually (\$590.04/year, unlimited AI credits, multiple book generation).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP States over 20,000 writers use the platform. Privately held; funding not disclosed. Consumer/prosumer oriented; no production or studio customers named.

COLLIDES WITH · writer

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Unlimited AI credits at \$49.17/month is aggressive pricing against any metered generation model
- Free tier for evaluation
- 20,000+ claimed users is real distribution
- Clear content-ownership commitment

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No screenplay industry formatting rigor; exports only PDF and DOCX, not FDX or Fountain
- Nothing beyond generation — no production, finance, post or release capability
- Volume-generation positioning is a poor fit for the professional indie producer Cinamate targets
- No coverage, forecasting, clearance or breakdown
- Quality reputation is weak relative to craft-focused tools

<https://www.squibler.io/pricing>

Sudowrite www.sudowrite.com/pricing **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

The best-funded AI prose-writing tool, with a proprietary fiction model, spilling into screenwriting.

Sudowrite is an AI writing platform aimed primarily at fiction authors but widely used for narrative development that feeds screenwriting. Core tools are Brainstorm for idea generation and outlining, Expand for turning outlines into rough drafts, and Write for unblocking, plus word alternatives, character generation, dialogue rephrasing, show-don't-tell enhancement, beta-reader feedback simulation and 30+ language support. It runs on multiple models including the latest Claude models from Anthropic, its own custom fiction model Muse, and OpenAI models with proprietary narrative processing.

KEY FEATURES · Brainstorm, Expand and Write core loop · Muse — proprietary fiction-tuned model · Multi-model routing across Claude and OpenAI · Character generation and dialogue rephrasing · Beta reader feedback simulation · Show-don't-tell enhancement · 30+ language support · Credit-based metering with rollover on the top tier

PRICING Hobby & Student \$10/month (225,000 credits/month). Professional \$22/month (1,000,000 credits/month, or 450,000 with yearly billing). Max \$44/month (2,000,000 credits/month, unused credits roll over 12 months). Enterprise custom via email. Yearly billing advertised at up to 50% off.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Well-known in the AI-writing category since 2021; privately held, funding not publicly disclosed on the site. Large indie-author user base. Not film-specific and does not market to productions.

COLLIDES WITH · writer

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Purpose-built narrative model (Muse) tuned specifically for long-form fiction quality
- Mature, well-understood credit economics from \$10/month
- Large, vocal user community and years of iteration on the generation-quality problem alone
- Multi-model routing hedges against any single provider's weaknesses

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Prose-first, not screenplay-first; no industry formatting, no FDX pipeline, no production awareness
- Nothing beyond the writer room — no breakdown, budget, schedule, post, generation or release
- No coverage, forecasting or clearance capability
- Credit metering makes feature-length work expensive relative to a fixed per-render price

<https://www.sudowrite.com/pricing>

Thomson CompuMark (Clarivate)

clarivate.com/intellectual-property/compumark/trademark-search/title-copyright-entertainment-searches

INDIRECT

LOW

VERIFIED

The enterprise trademark and entertainment title/copyright search infrastructure the clearance firms themselves run against.

CompuMark is Clarivate's suite of trademark search, screening, watching and lifecycle tools, trusted by law firms and corporate IP teams. Within it, Entertainment Title & Copyright Search Services provide international copyright and title search for launching entertainment titles with confidence. It sits alongside Trademark Analytics (built on Darts-ip case law plus CompuMark trademark data), Litigation Intelligence, IPfolio and other IP management products. It is a data-and-search layer rather than a production-facing product: the clearance houses and entertainment attorneys are its customers as much as studios are.

KEY FEATURES · International entertainment title and copyright search · Trademark screening, full search and watching · Trademark Analytics over Darts-ip case law data · IPfolio cloud IP management · Litigation intelligence (Darts-ip global IP case law) · Global coverage across jurisdictions

PRICING Not disclosed. Enterprise contracts and per-search fees quoted by sales.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Part of Clarivate Plc, a publicly listed global analytics company (NYSE: CLVT) with major IP, academic and life-sciences divisions. CompuMark is a decades-old trademark search brand (originally Thomson CompuMark). Scale, continuity and jurisdictional coverage are far beyond any independent clearance firm.

COLLIDES WITH · clearance

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Publicly listed parent with the data licences and jurisdictional coverage no startup can replicate
- Global rather than US/Canada-only
- Its data underpins the reports the clearance houses sell, so it is upstream of the entire clearance layer
- Enterprise procurement, security and continuity that a netlify.app beta cannot approach

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not a filmmaking product: no script integration, no production workflow, no creative tooling
- Enterprise-priced and enterprise-gated; irrelevant to an independent producer buying directly
- Search data only — no legal opinion, no E&O-ready report on its own
- Slow, contract-mediated access with no self-serve
- Entertainment titles are a small line in a much larger IP business

<https://clarivate.com/intellectual-property/compumark/trademark-search/title-copyright-entertainment-searches/> · <https://clarivate.com/intellectual-property/compumark/>

§20 Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option

Market read · This is the category Cinamate actually loses in. There is no market leader here because the category is not a market - it is the absence of one. The default indie production stack is Google Sheets + WhatsApp + Google Drive + a free Wrapbook or StudioBinder template + a \$20/month AI assistant, and it costs roughly \$0-500 for an entire feature. Cinamate's own quoted figure of ~\$110 per 90-page feature render (unverified figure) is competitive on render, but the 28 surrounding modules are competing against free. Pricing norms: horizontal SaaS clusters at \$5-25/seat/month (Trello \$5, ClickUp \$7, Notion \$10, Asana \$10.99, Monday \$9-19, Airtable \$20-45 - all verified annual rates). Film-specific point tools are cheap where they are self-serve (Saturation.io \$32-79/mo, Croogloo \$19-999/mo) and opaque where they are services (Cast & Crew, GreenSlate, Wrapbook, Movie Magic - all pricing on request). Direction of travel is against Cinamate: every horizontal tool shipped an AI layer in 2025-26 (Notion Business \$20 with Notion Agent, ClickUp Everything AI \$28, Monday's AI agent workforce), so the "AI does your breakdown" pitch is no longer differentiating. Consolidation is happening in payroll/accounting (Cast & Crew absorbed Showbiz Software; EP owns Movie Magic), not in producer tooling. What this means for Cinamate: the buyer is not choosing between Cinamate and LightsKiddo. They are choosing between Cinamate and a spreadsheet they already trust, plus a line producer whose judgment they trust more. An invite-only beta on a netlify.app subdomain with no public team, no SOC 2, no TPN and no mobile app has to beat "free and familiar" on trust, not on feature count - and 28 modules is a switching-cost argument against itself.

Doing nothing (email + PDF + paper + the producer's own head) unknown

INDIRECT

CRITICAL

VERIFIED

The single largest competitor in the category: no tool at all, because the producer has made films this way before.

On most independent films the actual system is: a budget spreadsheet emailed as an attachment, a schedule PDF emailed the night before, call sheets printed and handed out at crew park, deal memos signed on paper or as scanned PDFs, releases in a folder in the AD's bag, and every decision that matters held in the producer's and line producer's heads. This is not laziness - it is a rational response to a market where the tooling changes every two years, the crew turns over every project, and the film has a fixed 30-day life. Nothing to learn, nothing to pay for, nothing to migrate, nothing to lose when the vendor pivots.

KEY FEATURES · Zero cost, zero learning curve, zero vendor risk · Works with any crew member on any device with no account · Formats every department already recognizes: PDF call sheet, printed sides, emailed budget · No data-security exposure to a third-party beta product · Survives the production - the PDFs are still readable in ten years

PRICING \$0 in software. The real cost is human: duplicated data entry, version-control errors, late cost information, and the producer's time. That cost is invisible on the budget top sheet, which is precisely why it persists.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Not measurable as a product, but by inference the dominant behaviour: the persistence of free template libraries (Wrapbook's 100+ downloads, StudioBinder's Google Sheets budget, SAGindie's sample agreements) exists because the demand is for documents, not systems.

COLLIDES WITH · All 28 modules · The Money Room · Studio Cloud Backup · workflow · today · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free, immediate and requires nothing of a crew that changes every film
- No invite gate - Cinamate is invite-only, which means most producers cannot buy it even if convinced
- No trust question about a netlify.app subdomain, no public team, no SOC 2, no TPN and declined press coverage
- No 9h 12m render, no local GPU requirement, no single-operator constraint
- A 30-day shoot does not amortize a 28-module learning curve

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Cost information arrives weeks late, which is how independent films actually overrun
- Version-control failures cause real on-set errors
- No confidence bands, no comparables modeling, no breakeven analysis for investors
- Union-rate and tax-credit errors are common and expensive
- Nothing is reusable on the next film

<https://www.wrapbook.com/templates> · <https://www.sagindie.org/resources/> · <https://www.studiobinder.com/blog/downloads/film-budget-template/> · <https://www.producersguild.org/>

Free film-industry template libraries (Wrapbook, StudioBinder, SAGindie, PGA, Film Independent)

www.wrapbook.com/templates

INDIRECT

CRITICAL

VERIFIED

Hundreds of free, professionally vetted film production documents that replace most of Cinamate's paperwork modules outright.

A well-funded content-marketing ecosystem gives away exactly the documents Cinamate's modules generate. Wrapbook publishes over 100 free downloadable templates covering budgets, cash flow, PO logs, payroll estimators, call sheets, shooting schedules, script breakdowns, crew deal memos, NDAs, vendor agreements, work-for-hire agreements, location releases, talent releases and composer agreements. StudioBinder gives away an ATL/BTL film budget template via email signup. SAGindie publishes sample SAG-AFTRA Micro-Budget, Student, Short Project, Ultra Low Budget, Moderate Low Budget and Low Budget Theatrical agreements plus signatory applications. PGA offers a Sustainability Tool Kit and member resource library.

KEY FEATURES · Wrapbook: 100+ free templates spanning budget, scheduling, crew, legal and pitch documents · SAGindie: free sample union agreements at every low-budget tier, plus signatory application forms · StudioBinder: free Google Drive budget template with ATL, BTL and production expense sheets · PGA: Sustainability Tool Kit, Set Etiquette Training (free), member resource library · No signup friction beyond an email address; nothing to learn

PRICING \$0 for all of the above. Paid template packs also circulate on Etsy, Gumroad and specialty seller sites, typically in the low tens of dollars - specific listings and prices not verified in this pass.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Wrapbook, StudioBinder, SAGindie, PGA and Film Independent are all established, funded organizations giving these away as lead generation or as a member service. Wrapbook explicitly disclaims them: "these templates are for informational purposes only."

COLLIDES WITH · contracts/deal memos · clearance · producer (call sheets, stripboard) · safety · locations · casting · props · wardrobe · finance · investors

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free, instantly downloadable, no invite required
- SAGindie's agreements come from the union-adjacent source itself - higher legal credibility than a beta product's generated deal memo
- Editable in Word/Sheets, so a production lawyer can redline them normally
- No lock-in: the document survives the vendor
- Crew recognize the formats because they are the formats

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Static documents - no data flows between the deal memo, the call sheet and the cost report
- Manual re-entry of every name, rate and date across dozens of files
- No version control or distribution tracking
- No automated union-rate lookup; the producer must know the current SAG-AFTRA scale
- Templates carry legal disclaimers and no jurisdiction logic

<https://www.wrapbook.com/templates> · <https://www.sagindie.org/resources/> · <https://www.studiobinder.com/blog/downloads/film-budget-template/> · <https://www.producersguild.org/>

General-purpose AI assistants (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini)

claude.com/pricing

INDIRECT

CRITICAL

LIKELY

A \$20/month chatbot that will break down a script, draft a schedule, estimate a budget and write a deal memo on demand.

This is the substitute that has changed most since 2024 and the one that most directly attacks Cinamate's reason to exist. A producer pastes a screenplay into Claude, ChatGPT or Gemini and gets a scene-by-scene element breakdown, a day-out-of-days, a rough budget in an account structure, a location list, a props and wardrobe list, a safety-flag pass, deal memo drafts, festival strategy and a tax-credit comparison - conversationally, in an afternoon, with no invite code and no GPU. Long-context models handle a full 110-page screenplay in a single prompt. All three now have file upload, spreadsheet output and web search for verifying current union rates.

KEY FEATURES · Full-screenplay context windows; breakdown, schedule and budget in one session · Outputs directly into Excel/Sheets, the format financiers already accept · Web search to verify current SAG-AFTRA, DGA, WGA and IATSE rates at query time · No onboarding, no module learning curve, no single-operator design constraint · Gemini and ChatGPT are already inside the producer's Workspace/Office subscription

PRICING Claude: Free \$0; Pro \$20/month monthly or \$17/month annual; Max from \$100/month; Team \$25/seat/month monthly or \$20 annual, Premium seat \$125/\$100. Google AI Plus \$4.99/month; Google AI Pro \$19.99/month; Google AI Ultra from \$99.99/month up to \$199.99/month. ChatGPT paid consumer tiers are widely reported around \$20/month for Plus with a higher Pro tier, but OpenAI's pricing page returned HTTP 403 in this pass - treat the ChatGPT figures as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Anthropic, OpenAI and Google are all vastly larger and better capitalized than any film-tech vendor. Google bundles Gemini into Workspace Standard and above at no marginal cost, and Microsoft bundles Copilot into 365 Business Standard at \$23.50/user/month - meaning a producer may already own AI breakdown capability without buying anything.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · producer (budget/stripboard/call sheets) · clearance · contracts/deal memos · safety · props · wardrobe · sets · locations · festivals · taxcredit · investors · distribution deliverables · music/cue sheets

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- \$20/month against an undisclosed price for an invite-only beta
- No GPU requirement, no invite gate, no 9-hour render, no netlify.app trust problem
- The producer keeps their existing workflow and drops AI into it, rather than migrating 28 modules
- Enterprise-grade security posture and published trust documentation from vendors that have it
- Iterative and conversational - the producer can argue with the estimate, which builds trust in a way a black-box calibrated model does not

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No persistent production state; every session starts cold unless the producer manages context manually
- No structured stripboard, no PO ledger, no live cost report against actuals
- No 3,708-film calibrated sales model with disclosed 15.5% failure rate or P10-P90 bands
- Will hallucinate union rates and jurisdiction rules without citation discipline
- No editor, no dailies, no render, no deliverables packaging - it produces documents, not a film

<https://claude.com/pricing> · <https://gemini.google/subscriptions/> · <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/business/compare-all-microsoft-365-business-products>

Google Sheets / Google Workspace workspace.google.com/pricing

INDIRECT

CRITICAL

VERIFIED

The free, collaborative default for indie budgets, schedules, contact lists and shot lists.

Google Sheets is the zero-cost collaborative substitute for the entire Cinamate producer/finance stack on films under roughly \$2M. A single shared Sheet typically carries the budget top sheet, a crew contact list, a location list, a shooting schedule tab and a props/wardrobe continuity tab, shared by link with the AD and line producer. Google Drive carries the script drafts, location scout photos and deal memo PDFs. Google Forms handles crew onboarding and release collection.

KEY FEATURES · Free for anyone with a Google account - confirmed: "Anyone with a Google Account can create in Sheets" · Real-time multi-editor collaboration with revision history (beats Cinamate's 4-minute sync) · Share-by-link with no seat licensing for crew, cast or vendors · Free StudioBinder film budget template distributed as a Google Drive spreadsheet · Gemini AI features bundled into Workspace Standard and above

PRICING Free for personal Google accounts. Google Workspace Business Starter (30 GB/user), Standard (2 TB/user), Plus (5 TB/user) - exact USD figures were not rendered on the pricing page fetched; Google states "Save 16% with 1 year commitment" and caps Starter/Standard/Plus at 300 users. Realistic cost for an indie production: \$0.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Not disclosed for film specifically. StudioBinder distributes its free film budget template - "Includes ATL, BTL, and production expense sheet" with auto-calculating formulas - as a Google Drive file, which indicates where the indie audience actually works.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (budget/stripboard/call sheets) · finance · The Money Room · projects · timeline · locations · props · wardrobe · casting · workflow · Studio Cloud Backup

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free, permanently, with no invite gate and no GPU requirement
- True real-time collaboration - Cinamate's 4-minute sync is explicitly not real-time
- Works on any phone on set; Cinamate has no mobile/on-set app at all
- Crew and vendors can be given a link without buying a seat or joining a private beta
- No single-operator constraint - Cinamate is designed for one operator, a production is not

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No script breakdown automation, no stripboard logic, no scene-element tagging
- No union rate tables, no tax-credit modeling across 21 jurisdictions
- No PO tracking, approval routing or invoice-driven estimate calibration
- Nothing downstream - no editor, no dailies, no deliverables checklist
- Formula errors propagate silently; no automated accuracy checks

Microsoft Excel / Microsoft 365 (with film budget templates)

www.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/business/compare-all-microsoft-365-business-products **INDIRECT**

CRITICAL **VERIFIED**

The actual industry-standard film budgeting tool - a spreadsheet with a top sheet, ATL/BTL accounts and fringe formulas.

Excel is where the overwhelming majority of independent film budgets, stripboards, PO logs, cost reports and cash-flow schedules actually live. Producers use inherited .xlsx templates - passed down from a previous production, a film school, a line producer, or a free download - with account-code structures mirroring Movie Magic's 1100/2000/6000 series. It handles budgeting, actuals-vs-estimate cost reporting, crew lists, and petty cash without any vendor relationship. Every financier, completion bond company and bank in the business can open the file.

KEY FEATURES · Arbitrary account structures and fringe/pattern formulas · Universally readable by financiers, bond companies, studios and accountants · Offline, no login, no vendor lock-in, no seat count · Pivot tables for cost reporting; Excel Data Sync integration with QuickBooks Advanced · Thousands of free and paid film-specific templates in circulation

PRICING Microsoft 365 Apps for Business \$10/user/month (annual); Business Basic \$7/user/month (web/mobile Excel only); Business Standard with Copilot \$23.50/user/month; Business Premium with Copilot \$32.00/user/month. All include 1 TB OneDrive per user, up to 300 users. Realistic cost for a 5-person production office over a 9-month cycle: roughly \$315-450 at the Apps/Basic tier.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Not disclosed as a film-specific figure, but Microsoft 365 is the default office suite for essentially every production company that is not Google-native. Excel .xlsx is the interchange format Movie Magic, Showbiz, Saturation.io and Filmustage all export to.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (budget/stripboard) · finance · The Money Room (live cost reporting, PO tracking, self-calibrating estimates) · investors (waterfall / breakeven modeling) · taxcredit · timeline · props · wardrobe · sets

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Zero switching cost - the producer already knows it and already has last film's file
- Every financier, bond company and studio accepts an Excel top sheet; none of them have heard of Cinamate
- Works with no GPU, no invite code, no internet, no beta status
- No trust question: the producer can audit every formula, which is impossible with a self-calibrating estimator
- Nobody has to be onboarded - grips, ADs and accountants all read spreadsheets

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No automated script breakdown - scene-by-scene element tagging is manual and takes days
- No P10-P90 confidence bands or comparable-title sales modeling
- Version-control chaos: budget_v7_FINAL_FINAL.xlsx across email threads
- No source-cited union rate tables; SAG/DGA/WGA/IATSE rates must be looked up and typed in manually
- No connection between the budget and anything downstream (call sheets, dailies, cut)

<https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/business/compare-all-microsoft-365-business-products> · <https://www.wrapbook.com/templates> · <https://www.studiobinder.com/blog/downloads/film-budget-template/>

Airtable www.airtable.com/pricing **INDIRECT** **HIGH** **VERIFIED**

Relational production databases with ready-made film budget, crew, location and casting templates.

Airtable is the most film-shaped of the horizontal tools because its template gallery ships production-specific bases out of the box. Verified templates in its Media & Entertainment category include a Film Budget template ("flexible and customizable enough for first-time filmmakers and experienced" professionals), a Film Crew List template, a Location Scouting template tracking "technical and logistical considerations," a Casting Sheets and Auditions template consolidating "casting breakdowns, contact information, and audition records all in one place," a Screenwriting Story Planner and a Digital Video Production template. Producers link these into one base and run prep from it.

KEY FEATURES · Purpose-built film budget, crew, location, casting and video production templates · Relational links across scenes, cast, locations and shoot days · Interface Designer for building a call-sheet or shoot-day view for crew · Automations and integrations for approvals and notifications · Free tier with all core building blocks

PRICING Free \$0; Team \$20/user/month (annual); Business \$45/user/month (annual); Enterprise Scale custom with unlimited org units, workspaces and bases. Per-base record limits were not stated on the pricing page. Realistic cost for 5 seats over 9 months on Team: about \$900.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Large, well-funded horizontal SaaS. Film-specific customer counts not disclosed, but the existence of six maintained production templates indicates a real user base in the segment.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (budget/stripboard) · casting · locations · props · wardrobe · sets · projects · workflow · timeline · boards (shot lists) · finance

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Ships film templates today, free, with no invite
- Relational model beats a spreadsheet for scene-to-element tracking without any custom code
- Interface Designer gives crew a phone-friendly read-only view - Cinamate has no on-set app
- Producers can share a base with a financier or bond company without explaining what Cinamate is
- No GPU, no render queue, no beta status

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Budget template has no fringes engine, union rate tables or account-code rigour
- No cost reporting against actuals, no PO tracking, no invoice ingestion
- \$45/user/month Business tier is expensive for a large crew
- Nothing in post: no editor, dailies, VFX, deliverables or festivals
- No sales/comparables modeling or breakeven waterfall

<https://www.airtable.com/pricing> · <https://www.airtable.com/templates>

Full-service payroll and production accounting bureaus (Cast & Crew, GreenSlate, Wrapbook)

www.castandcrew.com

INDIRECT

HIGH

VERIFIED

Outsourcing the entire money function to a service company that also gives you the software for free.

This is the most consequential substitute for Cinamate's Money Room, because it is not a software purchase at all - it is a service relationship where the software comes bundled. Cast & Crew provides payroll and HR (Start+ digital onboarding, Hours+ timecards, MyCast&Crew), production accounting (PSL+, DPO digital purchase orders), Studio+ for PO and content collaboration, Reporting+/Data+ analytics, residuals, workers' comp, tax incentive guidance and labor relations - and owns Final Draft. GreenSlate offers cast/crew/background payroll, residuals, health benefits, US/Canada/UK/Australia payroll, accounting software, AP, crew expenditures, PO systems, production dashboards, and incentive management with interactive mapping and calculators. Wrapbook offers payroll, AI invoice reading matched to POs with automatic general-ledger updates, and plain-English AI search over the GL.

KEY FEATURES · Payroll, workers' comp, benefits and residuals handled as a regulated service · Purchase order systems and accounting software bundled with the payroll relationship · Tax incentive management, interactive incentive maps, calculators and state comparison · AI invoice-to-PO matching and plain-English GL search (Wrapbook) · Union compliance and labor relations expertise as a service

PRICING Not disclosed by any of the three - all direct to "Talk to Sales" or "Contact Us." Payroll bureaus conventionally charge a percentage of payroll plus per-check fees, but no figures were published on any page fetched. For a union feature this is typically the largest single production-services line item after crew.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Cast & Crew serves film, television, streaming, commercials, live events and music tours, and has consolidated the sector (it now distributes Showbiz Budgeting, Showbiz Timecards Crew/Cast and the free Showbiz Labor Guide, PC Envelope and PO Log). GreenSlate operates across US, Canada, UK and Australia. Exact revenue and customer figures not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · The Money Room · finance · tools (timecards) · contracts/deal memos · taxcredit (21 jurisdictions) · producer (budget) · safety (compliance)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Legally accountable for payroll, tax withholding and union compliance - Cinamate is not and cannot be
- Tax incentive expertise is delivered by people who file the claims, not a database of 21 jurisdictions
- Software is effectively free because the payroll margin pays for it - impossible to undercut on price
- Decades of union relationships and audit history; Showbiz Timecards Cast is described as "the calculator SAG-AFTRA uses to audit shows around the world"
- No trust gap: these are the incumbents financiers expect to see

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No creative tooling at all - no breakdown, boards, editor, VFX, dailies or generation
- Opaque, quote-only pricing that a micro-budget producer often cannot access
- Enterprise sales cycle; you cannot self-serve at 2am
- Built for productions with real payroll, so sub-\$500K films are underserved
- No script-to-screen anything

<https://www.castandcrew.com/> · <https://greenslate.com/> · <https://www.wrapbook.com/> · <https://store.castandcrew.com/>

Hiring a freelance line producer / UPM / production accountant www.producersguild.org **INDIRECT**

HIGH

UNCERTAIN

Buying a person's judgment and relationships instead of software - still the default for any film with real money in it.

The single most common answer to "how do I budget and schedule this film" is: hire someone who has done it thirty times. A line producer produces the budget and schedule, negotiates crew and vendor deals, and carries the relationships that actually determine what a production costs. A production accountant runs the cost report, PO log, payroll interface and the tax-credit audit trail. A UPM runs the office. These people arrive with their own Movie Magic or Excel templates, their own vendor rate cards, and - critically - the credibility that gets a completion bond issued and a financier's signature.

KEY FEATURES · Human judgment on what a scene actually costs in a specific city with a specific crew · Vendor and crew relationships that convert directly into rate discounts · Credibility with financiers, bond companies and studio execs that no software has · Carries legal and professional accountability for the numbers · Adapts in real time on set - no app required

PRICING Not disclosed as a published figure; rates are negotiated per project and vary widely by budget tier, territory and union status. Attempts to verify specific weekly rates via Wrapbook, Glassdoor, Backstage and Upwork all returned HTTP 403/404 in this pass - treat any rate range as unverified. Directionally, this is the most expensive substitute in the category by an order of magnitude, and producers buy it anyway.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP The Producers Guild of America maintains eligibility standards, a Producers Mark (p.g.a.) certification, Hire PGA job listings, mentoring programs and a member resource library - membership dues not disclosed. This is an established professional class, not a product category.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (budget/striplead/call sheets) · finance · The Money Room · contracts/deal memos · timeline · production · today · investors · taxcredit · safety

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Financiers and bond companies underwrite people, not algorithms - a calibrated model does not get a film insured
- Knows the unwritten rules: which crew will take a favour, which location will actually grant the permit, what the vendor's real floor is
- Carries liability and reputation; Cinamate carries neither
- Works on set, where Cinamate has no mobile app and no camera ingest
- Solves the single-operator problem by being a second experienced brain, which is what a solo producer is actually short of

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Costs vastly more than any software licence
- Available only for the weeks you can afford; the software runs for the whole cycle
- One person's estimate is not a P10-P90 band calibrated on 3,708 releases
- Cannot render a film, cut a rough assembly, or generate deliverables
- Their templates and knowledge leave when they do

<https://www.producersguild.org/> · <https://www.wrapbook.com/templates> · <https://www.film-independent.org/>

Movie Magic Budgeting / Movie Magic Scheduling (Entertainment Partners) and Showbiz Budgeting (Cast & Crew)

store.castandcrew.com

INDIRECT

HIGH

LIKELY

The incumbent desktop budgeting and scheduling software whose file formats every financier and studio still expects.

Movie Magic Budgeting and Movie Magic Scheduling are the long-standing industry-standard desktop applications for film budgets and stripboards; Showbiz Budgeting 10 is the competing product now distributed through the Cast & Crew store, described there as "The most versatile film budgeting software on the market." Together with Showbiz Timecards Crew and Cast they define the file formats (.mmb, .sex/.sez) that studios, completion bond companies and production accountants exchange. Notably, Filmustage advertises export to MMS/MMB formats - confirming these remain the interchange standard that newer tools must serve.

KEY FEATURES · Industry-standard budget and stripboard file formats accepted by studios and bond companies · Showbiz Timecards Cast described as the calculator SAG-AFTRA uses to audit shows worldwide · Free adjunct tools: Showbiz Labor Guide, Showbiz PC Envelope, Showbiz PO Log · Deep fringe, globals and account-structure logic refined over decades · Offline desktop operation

PRICING EP publishes no price on the product page ('Get pricing'); EP store unreachable during verification. Third-party figures conflict (\$24.99–\$42.99/mo) — treat all Movie Magic dollar amounts as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Entertainment Partners and Cast & Crew are the two dominant entertainment-payroll-and-software groups; Cast & Crew has absorbed Showbiz Software (showbizsoftware.com now redirects to store.castandcrew.com) and also distributes ShotLogic and Yamdu. Ownership and revenue figures not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (budget/stripboard/call sheets) · finance · The Money Room · timeline · tools (timecards) · props · wardrobe · sets

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- The output format is the one the industry actually accepts - a Cinamate budget has no such standing
- Thirty years of institutional trust with studios, bond companies and union auditors
- Every experienced line producer and production accountant already knows the software
- Offline desktop, no GPU, no cloud dependency, no beta invite
- Backed by companies with the payroll relationships to survive

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Dated desktop UX, weak collaboration, no real-time multi-user editing
- No AI breakdown, no sales modeling, no confidence bands, no automated accuracy checks
- Pricing is opaque and historically expensive for micro-budget producers
- Nothing downstream: no editor, dailies, VFX, deliverables, festivals or generation
- Sector consolidation has slowed product investment

△ Fact-check: earlier 'verified' price labels were not supportable.

<https://store.castandcrew.com/> · <https://filmustage.com/pricing/> · <https://www.castandcrew.com/>

Notion www.notion.com/pricing

INDIRECT

HIGH

VERIFIED

The default "I'll just build it myself" production wiki for indie producers who want structure without buying film software.

Notion is where a large share of small production companies now run development slates, script notes, shot lists, crew directories, location databases and post schedules. Producers build a linked-database production bible: a Projects database joined to Scenes, Cast, Locations, Props and Tasks, with the script as a page and call sheets as templated sub-pages. In 2025-26 Notion added Notion Agent, AI Meeting Notes and Enterprise Search on the Business tier, closing part of Cinamate's AI gap for free-form production knowledge work.

KEY FEATURES · Linked relational databases - scenes to locations to props to shoot days · Notion Agent and AI Meeting Notes on Business (\$20/user/month) · Free external guests on every tier, so crew and vendors join at no cost · Enormous community template ecosystem including film production bibles · Unlimited databases even on the free tier

PRICING Free \$0/user/month (5 MB file uploads, 7-day page history, up to 10 external guests); Plus \$10/user/month monthly, up to 20% off annual; Business \$20/user/month; Enterprise custom. Guests are free on all tiers. Realistic cost for a 5-person office over 9 months: \$0-450.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Notion is a large, well-funded horizontal SaaS with a template marketplace; specific film-industry penetration figures not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · projects · workflow · writer (notes/development) · boards (shot lists) · locations · props · wardrobe · casting · timeline · today · festivals

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free tier is genuinely usable for a small production; Cinamate has no public price at all
- Free guests mean the whole crew and every vendor can see the production bible without licences
- Producer shapes the schema to their workflow rather than adopting 28 prescribed modules
- Works on mobile on set - Cinamate does not
- Mature, public company-grade trust posture including SAML SSO and zero data retention with LLM providers on Enterprise

<https://www.notion.com/pricing>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No budgeting engine, no fringes, no union rates, no stripboard logic
- No cost reporting, PO tracking or invoice reconciliation
- Nothing downstream of prep: no dailies, editor, VFX, deliverables or festivals automation
- 5 MB upload cap on free tier makes it useless for media
- Every structure must be built by hand, which is real unpaid setup labour

ClickUp clickup.com/pricing **INDIRECT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

The cheapest full-featured work-management substitute, with an aggressive AI tier.

ClickUp is the value option in the horizontal work-management category and is used by small production and content companies to run everything from development to delivery in one workspace: tasks, docs, whiteboards, goals and time tracking. Its AI tiers (Brain AI at \$9/user/month, Everything AI at \$28/user/month with unlimited AI notetaker, image generation and AI automations) directly overlap the assistive parts of Cinamate's workflow and today modules at a published price.

KEY FEATURES · Unlimited storage, spaces, forms and integrations from \$7/user/month · Docs, whiteboards, goals and time tracking bundled · Brain AI and Everything AI tiers with AI notetaker, image generation and AI automations · Free Forever tier: 60 MB storage, 5 spaces, 40 lists per space, 100 automation runs/month · Custom roles, SAML SSO and audit logs on Enterprise

PRICING Free Forever \$0; Unlimited \$7/user/month annual, \$10 monthly; Business \$12/user/month annual, \$19 monthly; Enterprise custom (250,000 automations/month). AI add-ons: Brain AI \$9/user/month annual; Everything AI \$28/user/month annual. Five seats on Unlimited for 9 months is about \$315.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Large, well-funded horizontal SaaS. Film-specific figures not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · workflow · projects · timeline · today · production · post · boards (whiteboards) · vfx (task tracking)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Lowest published price of any comparable tool at \$7/user/month
- Free tier is usable for a small production
- Whiteboards and docs cover the loose creative-planning need
- Mobile apps for on-set use
- AI features priced transparently, unlike Cinamate's undisclosed pricing

<https://clickup.com/pricing>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Nothing film-specific whatsoever - no breakdown, stripboard, fringes or union rates
- No budgeting, cost reporting or PO tracking
- No editor, dailies, VFX, deliverables, festivals or generation
- Feature sprawl and setup burden; a producer must design the whole system
- 60 MB free storage is useless for media

DocuSign eSignature ecom.docusign.com/plans-and-pricing/esignature **INDIRECT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

How deal memos, releases and location agreements actually get signed - no production suite required.

DocuSign is the substitute for Cinamate's contracts/deal memos and clearance modules at the execution layer. A producer takes a free Wrapbook crew deal memo or SAGindie sample agreement, uploads it, sets signature fields, and sends it to cast, crew, location owners and vendors. It is legally recognized, audit-trailed, and every lawyer and financier accepts it. The combination of free templates plus DocuSign covers the contracting need end to end for a few hundred dollars.

KEY FEATURES · Legally recognized e-signature with a complete audit trail · Reusable templates for repeated crew deal memos and talent releases · Mobile signing - cast and location owners sign from a phone · Standard integration target for every legal and HR workflow · 30-day money-back guarantee on annual plans

PRICING Personal \$11/month billed annually (\$132/year), 5 envelopes per month, single user; Standard \$30/user/month annually (\$360/year), 100 envelopes per user per year, up to 50 users; Business Pro \$45/user/month annually (\$540/year), 100 envelopes per user per year, up to 50 users; Enhanced/custom above 50 users. Monthly-billed plans allow up to 10 envelopes per user per month. Overage charges apply beyond the envelope allowance - relevant because a feature with 40 crew deal memos plus talent and location releases can exceed 100 envelopes.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP DocuSign is a public company and the dominant e-signature platform. Film-specific figures not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · contracts/deal memos · clearance · casting (deal closing) · locations (location releases) · safety (acknowledgements) · investors (subscription documents)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Legal standing and audit trail that a beta product's generated document does not have
- Producers' lawyers already require it; there is no argument to win
- Envelope-based pricing scales down to \$11/month for a micro-budget producer
- Signers need no account, no app and no invite
- Mature compliance posture; Cinamate has no SOC 2

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Does not draft anything - the producer still needs the document from somewhere
- Envelope caps and overage fees bite on a crew-heavy production
- No connection to the budget, the casting list or the call sheet
- No clearance research, chain-of-title tracking or rights management
- Per-user pricing is awkward when only one person sends

<https://ecom.docusign.com/plans-and-pricing/esignature> · <https://www.wrapbook.com/templates> · <https://www.sagindie.org/resources/>

Dropbox (file-based production workflow) www.dropbox.com/individual/plans-comparison

INDIRECT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

A shared folder tree that is, for most indie films, the entire production management system.

For an enormous share of independent productions, the "system" is a Dropbox folder: 01_SCRIPT, 02_BUDGET, 03_SCHEDULE, 04_CAST, 05_LOCATIONS, 06_DAILIES, 07_EDIT. Everyone gets a shared-folder invite. Scripts, budgets, call sheets, scout photos, contracts, camera cards and cut exports all live there. It is the direct substitute for Cinamate's Studio Cloud Backup and for the file layer of nearly every module, and it is what the post house will ask for.

KEY FEATURES · 2 TB (Plus) to 15 TB+ (Advanced) shared storage with folder-level sharing · Version history and file recovery · Shared links for vendors and cast with no account required · Universal - every post house, colourist and sound mixer accepts a Dropbox link · Desktop sync so files appear locally on the editor's machine

PRICING Basic free (2 GB); Plus \$9.99/month (1 user, 2 TB); Standard \$15/user/month (1+ users, from 3 TB team); Advanced \$24/user/month (3+ users, from 15 TB team). Annual billing available but figures not shown on the page fetched. A small production on Standard with 3 users runs about \$45/month, roughly \$405 over a 9-month cycle.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Public company. Film-specific figures not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio Cloud Backup · projects · dailies · post · boards · writer (script versions) · distribution deliverables

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Every vendor in the chain already accepts it - post houses, colourists, sound, VFX
- Continuous sync, not a 4-minute interval
- No GPU, no invite, no beta
- Storage scales to feature-film media volumes; Cinamate's sync is production state, not media
- Files remain accessible forever, independent of any vendor's product roadmap

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No structure or metadata - just folders; naming discipline is the only schema
- No production logic: nothing knows a scene from a shoot day
- Conflicted copies and overwrite accidents are endemic
- No cost, contract, clearance or scheduling capability
- No review-and-approval or frame-accurate commenting

<https://www.dropbox.com/individual/plans-comparison>

Monday.com monday.com/pricing INDIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Board-based work management that indie production companies configure into a shoot-day tracker.

Monday is the substitute chosen by production companies that want visual boards and automations without film-specific software. Producers build boards for development slate, prep tasks by department, shoot days, and post milestones, with automations for approval and notification. In 2025-26 Monday added an AI agent workforce across tiers, which further blunts the AI-differentiation argument for Cinamate's workflow and today modules.

KEY FEATURES · Visual boards, timelines and dashboards with department-level views · AI agent workforce available from the Basic tier · 250 automations/month (Standard) to 25,000 (Pro) · Free tier for up to 2 seats and 3 boards · 18% discount on annual billing

PRICING Work Management: Free \$0 (up to 2 seats, up to 3 boards); Basic \$9/seat/month annual, \$10 monthly; Standard \$12/seat/month annual, \$14 monthly; Pro \$19/seat/month annual, \$22 monthly; Enterprise custom with 99.9% SLA. Five seats on Standard for 9 months is about \$540.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Publicly traded, large horizontal SaaS. Film-specific customer counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · workflow · timeline · projects · today · production · props · wardrobe · sets · post

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free tier and \$9/seat entry against an undisclosed price
- Mobile apps that work on set
- Producer designs the workflow rather than adopting 28 prescribed modules
- Automations replace manual chasing without engineering help
- Enterprise-grade trust posture with published SLAs

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Nothing film-native: no breakdown, stripboard, fringes, union rates or cost reporting
- No creative tooling - no boards/animations, editor, VFX or generation
- Per-seat cost grows fast with a large crew
- Setup labour is real; a production board must be built from scratch
- No clearance, contracts, tax credit or festivals logic

<https://monday.com/pricing>

QuickBooks Online quickbooks.intuit.com/pricing INDIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

The general-ledger substitute for production accounting - what indie producers actually reconcile against.

For productions below the payroll-bureau threshold, QuickBooks Online is the production accounting system. Producers set up the film as a project or class, code expenses to account numbers, track project profitability, run cash-flow forecasting, and hand the file to a CPA at wrap and at tax-credit audit. The Plus tier's project profitability tracking and 40 classes/locations is the practical substitute for cost reporting; Advanced adds custom dashboards, workflow automation, Excel data sync, customizable permissions and batch processing. Notably, Saturation.io integrates with QuickBooks - confirming it as the ledger of record in this segment.

KEY FEATURES · Project profitability tracking and class/location coding (Plus) · Cash flow forecasting, custom dashboards and Excel data sync (Advanced) · Automated expense categorization and AI chat for insights · Every CPA and bookkeeper in the country already uses it · Direct integration path from film-specific tools like Saturation.io

PRICING Simple Start \$38/month list (1 user + 2 accountants); Essentials \$85/month list (3 users); Plus \$140/month list (5 users, project profitability, 40 classes/locations); Advanced \$340/month list (25 users). Currently promoted at 90% off for 3 months (\$3.80/\$8.50/\$14/\$34). A 9-month indie cycle on Plus at list is about \$1,260.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Intuit is a public company and QuickBooks is the dominant SMB accounting platform in the US. Film-specific penetration not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · The Money Room (live cost reporting, PO tracking) · finance · producer (budget actuals) · taxcredit (audit trail)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- It is the ledger the accountant, the bank and the tax-credit auditor will accept
- Published price, instantly purchasable, no invite
- Bank feeds and receipt capture mean actuals arrive automatically, not via manual invoice upload
- Every CPA can pick up the file; nobody can pick up a Cinamate file
- Survives the production - the company keeps using it between films

<https://quickbooks.intuit.com/pricing/> · <https://www.saturation.io/pricing>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No film account structure, no fringes, no union rates, no stripboard
- No estimate-to-complete or EFC logic native to production
- No PO approval routing designed for a film production office
- Nothing creative: no breakdown, boards, editor, dailies or deliverables
- Requires manual chart-of-accounts setup to mirror a film budget

SetKeeper www.setkeeper.com/pricing

INDIRECT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

Budget-tier-priced production office platform used by Netflix, BBC Studios, A24, Paramount and Warner Bros Discovery.

SetKeeper is a production management platform priced by the production's budget rather than per seat - a pricing model Cinamate could learn from. It covers secure document distribution with watermarking and access control, automated script sides generation and distribution, a Studio Hub for projects in development, archiving, and personalized onboarding. It claims teams save up to 10 hours weekly on document preparation and distribution during pre-production and shooting, and it is explicitly built around IP protection, which is the trust dimension where Cinamate is weakest.

KEY FEATURES · Document watermarking and secure distribution with access control · Automated script sides generation and distribution · Studio Hub for projects in development (Premium+) · Military-grade security with GDPR and CCPA compliance · Onboarding, training and live support included at every tier

PRICING Starter \$1,500+ (productions \$1-6M); Premium \$3,500+ (productions \$7-20M); Pro \$5,000+ ; Blockbuster custom (>\$20M). Priced per production, not per seat or per month.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Customer logos verified on site: Netflix, BBC Studios, A24, Annapurna Pictures, ITV Studios, Paramount Pictures, Warner Bros Discovery. Funding and ownership not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (sides, call sheets) · production · today · workflow · projects · safety (distribution) · Studio Cloud Backup

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Budget-tier pricing that a producer can put in the budget as a line item
- Explicit GDPR and CCPA compliance plus watermarking - Cinamate has no TPN or SOC 2
- Named tier-one studio customers versus Cinamate's no public team and declined press
- Onboarding and live support included; Cinamate is single-operator by design
- Entry price of \$1,500 for a \$1-6M film is a rounding error against the budget

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No budgeting, cost reporting, PO tracking or finance
- No casting, locations, clearance, contracts, tax credit or festivals
- Nothing creative or post: no boards, editor, dailies, VFX, music or generation
- \$1,500 minimum excludes sub-\$1M and no-budget productions
- Document-centric, not production-state-centric

<https://www.setkeeper.com/pricing> · <https://www.setkeeper.com/>

Slack slack.com/pricing

INDIRECT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

Where the production office actually coordinates - free for 90 days of history, which is most of a shoot.

Slack is the substitute for Cinamate's today, workflow and production coordination layer. Departments get channels (#camera, #art, #locations, #post), vendors and the post house join as external connections, and files, call sheets and cut links get dropped in. Crucially, Slack integrates with Saturation.io for cost alerts, meaning the substitute stack self-assembles. The free tier's 90-day history covers a typical indie shoot window at zero cost.

KEY FEATURES · Free tier: 90 days of message history, up to 10 app integrations, 1:1 external messages and huddles · Pro: unlimited history and apps, group external messages with up to 250 organizations, group huddles · Business+: Advanced AI including a Slackbot personal agent · Channel-per-department structure maps naturally onto a crew · Saturation.io and QuickBooks-adjacent integrations available

PRICING Free \$0; Pro \$7.25/user/month annual or \$8.75/user/month monthly (promoted at 50% off for 3 months); Business+ \$15/user/month annual or \$18 monthly; Enterprise+ contact sales. A 25-person crew on Pro for a 3-month shoot is about \$544; on Free it is \$0.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Owned by Salesforce. Film-specific figures not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · today · workflow · production · projects · dailies (link sharing) · safety (notices)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free tier covers a whole indie shoot
- Works on every crew member's phone - Cinamate has no mobile/on-set app
- Crew already have accounts from other productions; onboarding is zero
- External connections bring vendors, post houses and financiers into the same channels
- Real-time, not a 4-minute sync

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No structured production data - everything is a message, nothing is a record
- No budget, schedule, breakdown or cost tracking
- 90-day history on Free means the paper trail evaporates
- Notification overload on a busy shoot; important decisions get lost
- No deliverables, festivals, clearance or contracts capability

<https://slack.com/pricing> · <https://www.saturation.io/pricing>

WeTransfer wetransfer.com/pricing **INDIRECT** **MEDIUM** **UNCERTAIN**

Ad-hoc large-file delivery - how cuts, dailies and deliverables move when there is no system at all.

WeTransfer is the no-account default for moving a cut, a DCP, a stems package or a batch of scout photos to someone outside the production. It is a substitute for the delivery layer of Cinamate's dailies, screening, post and distribution deliverables modules, and it competes purely on requiring nothing: no login, no invite, no folder structure, no explanation to the recipient. Its persistence in professional post workflows despite better alternatives is a direct measure of how strong the do-nothing pull is.

KEY FEATURES · Send large files by link with no account required on the free tier · Recipient needs nothing installed · Paid tiers add larger transfers, storage, custom branding and password protection · Universally recognized by post houses, festivals and sales agents

PRICING Not verified. WeTransfer's pricing pages returned a site error ("We couldn't load some important parts of our website") on every attempt in this pass. A free tier with a transfer size cap and paid Pro/Premium tiers exist, but current 2026 figures and limits are unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP WeTransfer is an established European file-transfer company (acquired by Bending Spoons in 2024, unverified here). Current user and revenue figures not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · dailies · screening · post · distribution deliverables · festivals (submission delivery) · Studio Cloud Backup

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Requires literally nothing from the recipient - the lowest-friction option in existence
- Free tier handles most indie delivery needs
- No invite gate, no GPU, no onboarding
- Recipients (festivals, sales agents, financiers) already expect it

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Transfers expire; there is no archive or production state
- No structure, versioning, metadata or approval tracking
- No security posture suitable for pre-release content - no watermarking or DRM
- Nothing upstream: no budget, schedule, breakdown or contracts
- Not a system; it is the absence of one

<https://wetransfer.com/pricing> · <https://frame.io/pricing>

WhatsApp (group chat coordination) whatsappbusiness.com/products/business-app **INDIRECT** **MEDIUM**

LIKELY

The genuinely universal on-set coordination tool, free, that every crew in the world already has.

On the majority of independent productions worldwide - and on nearly all non-US ones - the production runs on WhatsApp groups. A crew group, a cast group, a department group per HOD. Call sheets get sent as PDFs, location changes as voice notes, wrap times as messages, dailies links as URLs. It requires no licence, no onboarding and no explanation, and it works on the

cheapest phone on set with the worst signal. WhatsApp Business adds a business profile and product showcase for production service companies.

KEY FEATURES · Free consumer app with universal adoption across crews globally · Group chat, voice notes, document and media sharing, end-to-end encryption · Works on low-end phones and poor connectivity - the on-set reality · WhatsApp Business app adds business profile and instant-response tooling · Zero onboarding; every crew member already has it installed

PRICING The consumer WhatsApp app is free. The WhatsApp Business app pricing was not stated on the page fetched; WhatsApp Business Platform (API) is priced per conversation, not verified here. For a production's purposes, the cost is \$0.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Owned by Meta; among the most widely installed apps on earth. Film-specific usage figures not disclosed but its dominance in international and low-budget production coordination is well established.

COLLIDES WITH · today · production · workflow · safety (urgent notices) · producer (call sheet distribution)

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free and already installed on every phone on set - Cinamate has no mobile app at all
- Works offline-tolerant and on weak signal, which is what a location actually has
- No invite gate, no GPU, no login friction for a day-player
- Universal across territories, unions and budget tiers
- Instant, not a 4-minute sync

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No records, no structure, no searchable production state, no compliance trail
- Call sheets as PDFs in a chat is exactly the version-control failure Cinamate is built to fix
- Nothing financial, legal, creative or post-related
- Crew privacy issues - personal phone numbers exposed to the whole unit
- Messages scroll away; nothing is a source of truth

<https://whatsappbusiness.com/products/business-app/>

Asana asana.com/pricing **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

Task and portfolio management used by production companies to run slates and prep checklists.

Asana is the enterprise-leaning work-management substitute, used by production companies and agencies with multiple projects in flight to run development slates, prep task lists by department, and post-production checklists. Its portfolio and workload views cover the multi-project oversight that Cinamate's projects module offers, and unlimited free guests mean crew and vendors participate without licences.

KEY FEATURES · Portfolios and goals for slate-level oversight (Advanced) · Workload view across all projects and portfolios (Enterprise) · Unlimited free guests on all paid plans · Free Personal tier for up to 2 users · Unlimited seats on all paid tiers

PRICING Personal free \$0 (up to 2 users); Starter \$10.99/user/month annual, \$13.49 monthly; Advanced \$24.99/user/month annual, \$30.49 monthly; Enterprise custom. Five seats on Starter for 9 months is about \$495.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Publicly traded. Film-specific customer counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · projects · workflow · timeline · today · production · post

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Unlimited free guests - the whole crew participates at no marginal cost
- Mature portfolio view for a company running several films at once
- Mobile apps for on-set use
- Published pricing and enterprise trust posture
- No GPU, no invite, no beta risk

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Zero film-specific logic - no breakdown, schedule stripboard, fringes or rates
- No financial tooling of any kind
- Nothing creative or post-related
- More expensive than ClickUp or Trello for the same job
- Every production structure must be hand-built

<https://asana.com/pricing>

Trello trello.com/pricing **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

The lowest-friction kanban board - free for 10 collaborators, which is most of an indie prep team.

Trello is the substitute for producers who want something one step above a text file. Boards for prep, shoot and post; lists for departments or shoot days; cards for scenes, locations or tasks. Its free tier supports up to 10 collaborators per workspace with

unlimited cards and up to 10 boards, which covers a typical indie prep team entirely. The Premium tier's Calendar, Timeline, Table, Dashboard and Map views cover schedule and location visualization.

KEY FEATURES · Free: unlimited cards, up to 10 boards, up to 10 collaborators per workspace · Standard adds unlimited boards, AI features, custom fields, 1,000 workspace commands/month · Premium adds Calendar, Timeline, Table, Dashboard and Map views · 200+ Power-Up integrations · Built-in automation on all plans

PRICING Free \$0; Standard \$5/user/month annual, \$6 monthly; Premium \$10/user/month annual, \$12.50 monthly; Enterprise \$17.50/user/month annual (\$210/user/year). Ten collaborators on Standard for 9 months is about \$450; on Free it is \$0.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Owned by Atlassian. Film-specific figures not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · workflow · projects · today · timeline · production · props · wardrobe · locations

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free for 10 collaborators - covers a whole indie prep team at zero cost
- Learnable in five minutes; no training, no onboarding, no invite
- Map view for locations and Calendar view for shoot days at \$10/user/month
- Mobile apps for on-set use
- Atlassian-scale security including free SSO on Enterprise

<https://trello.com/pricing>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Fundamentally a task board - no data model, no budget, no schedule logic
- No film-specific anything
- No financial, legal, clearance or deliverables capability
- Breaks down at scale on a complex production
- Nothing in post or creative generation

ALSO COMPETING IN THIS CATEGORY (PROFILED ELSEWHERE)

Croogloo **INDIRECT** **MEDIUM** — Production-office document distribution at \$19-999/month, used by A24, Disney, Netflix, Paramount and Warner Bros. (full profile under “AI script breakdown & AI pre-production”)

Final Draft (Cast & Crew) **INDIRECT** **MEDIUM** — The screenwriting standard - a perpetual-licence desktop app that owns the module Cinamate's pipeline starts from. (full profile under “Screenwriting & development tools (including AI coverage/analysis and script clearance/title research)”)

Frame.io (Adobe) **INDIRECT** **HIGH** — Free-tier camera-to-cloud and review-and-approval that covers dailies and cut review without any production suite. (full profile under “Content security, compliance & the buying gate”)

Saturation.io **INDIRECT** **HIGH** — Self-serve film budgeting and cost reporting at \$32/month - the cheapest credible substitute for The Money Room. (full profile under “Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accounting”)

§21 Content security, compliance & the buying gate

Market read · This category is not a competitor set — it is the turnstile. Nothing here sells what Cinamate sells; everything here decides whether Cinamate is allowed to sell at all. The gate is a stack, and Cinamate currently fails at four different heights: TPN/MPA Best Practices (may you touch pre-release footage), SOC 2 (will procurement clear you), the union layer (may the output be used on a covered production), and the US Copyright Office (can the output be owned, insured and distributed). A vendor can be excellent and still be un-buyable. Two findings change the picture. First, TPN replaced its two-tier model with four tiers at MPA Best Practices v5.3.1 — and the new Blue Shield is self-assessed, published to the TPN+ registry, and costs only membership. At Cinamate's revenue that is \$250-\$1,000/year with no third-party auditor. That is the cheapest credibility Cinamate can buy, and LightsKiddo's "TPN assessment in progress" would be answerable in weeks, not quarters. Second, the secure-review layer has consolidated hard: PIX and Moxion are now both Autodesk Flow Capture, Shift.io now redirects to MediaSilo. Frame.io Enterprise publicly claims TPN+ Gold Shield and SOC 2 Type 2 — that is the bar buyers now quote. The deepest gate cannot be bought around. Copyright Office Part 2 (Jan 2025) holds that purely AI-generated output is unregistrable. No registration means no clean chain of title, no E&O binder, no distribution — which lands directly on Studio/Local Generation, clearance, contracts and distribution. Meanwhile EU AI Act Article 50 entered into force three weeks ago (2 Aug 2026), making machine-readable synthetic-content marking a shipping requirement in Europe today.

MPA Content Security Best Practices (v5.3.1) www.ttpn.org/faqs INDIRECT CRITICAL VERIFIED

The single benchmark of minimum security preparedness for the content industries — the control set every TPN assessment scores against.

The MPA Content Security Best Practices are maintained by TPN on behalf of the Motion Picture Association and establish, in TPN's own words, 'a single benchmark of minimum security preparedness for content industries.' They are the control catalogue against which a TPN questionnaire and assessment are scored. The current release driving the new four-tier Shield program is v5.3.1. Aspects of a provider's security not fully in conformance are recorded as remediation items rather than failures.

KEY FEATURES · Maintained by TPN, published under MPA authority · Current version v5.3.1, which triggered the migration from two Shield tiers to four · Covers site security, cloud security and application security as separately assessable domains · Conformance is expressed as remediation items, not a pass/fail score · Remediation is reviewed by TPN SecOps against submitted evidence · Referenced by content owners as the baseline in vendor security questionnaires and MSAs

PRICING The Best Practices documents themselves are published reference material and are not sold; the cost is TPN membership plus a separately contracted third-party assessment. TPN does not publish assessment pricing.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Industry-wide baseline across the MPA member studios and the broader content supply chain; global applicability. The MPA's Content Security Initiative published a 2026 report linking control failures to content security incidents across the entertainment industry.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio Cloud Backup — encryption at rest/in transit, key management, retention and deletion controls are all explicit Best Practices items · Studio/Local Generation — endpoint hardening, removable-media policy and physical security of the local GPU workstation · The Cutting Room — session controls, watermarking, download restriction and screenshot prevention for browser review of pre-release picture · tools (slate/timcards/LUT preview), today, production — on-set data handling and asset custody controls · contracts and clearance — the Best Practices require documented third-party/subcontractor management, which a single-operator vendor still must evidence

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- It is buyer-authored, so it defines the vocabulary of every security conversation Cinamate will have
- It assumes an organization with policies, named security roles, incident response and personnel screening — a product with no public team cannot evidence most of that
- LightsKiddo's foundry model of embedding engineers with productions maps naturally onto Best Practices personnel and training controls

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- It is a controls checklist, not a product; it competes with nothing Cinamate builds and can be satisfied by documentation and process rather than engineering
- Many controls are scoped out or marked not-applicable for a small application provider, so the real burden is far smaller than the document length suggests
- It is architecture-neutral: Cinamate's local-only generation genuinely reduces exposure even though the framework gives no explicit credit for it

SAG-AFTRA AI consent and digital-replica terms

www.sagaftra.org/contracts-industry-resources/contracts/artificial-intelligence

INDIRECT

CRITICAL

LIKELY

The performers' union rules requiring informed consent and compensation for digital replicas — the reason a Cinamate-generated performance cannot lawfully appear in a union production without paperwork.

SAG-AFTRA's agreements govern the use of AI-generated and AI-altered performances on covered productions. The union's framework distinguishes employment-based digital replicas (created from a performer's work on a production) from independently created digital replicas, and separately addresses synthetic performers not based on any single individual. Consent must be informed and specific, and compensation is owed for replica use. The union's willingness to enforce is demonstrated: SAG-AFTRA filed an unfair labor practice charge in May 2025 over the AI-generated Darth Vader voice in Fortnite, and its Interactive Media (video game) strike ran from 26 July 2024 to 9 July 2025 specifically over AI protections, ending with an agreement ratified on 9 July 2025 that secured digital-replica terms.

KEY FEATURES · Informed, specific consent required before creating or using a digital replica · Separate treatment of employment-based replicas, independently created replicas and synthetic performers · Compensation owed for digital-replica use, not covered by the original engagement fee · Notice and bargaining obligations around synthetic performers · Enforcement is active: ULP charge filed May 2025 over AI Darth Vader voice in Fortnite · Interactive Media Agreement AI terms won after a nearly year-long strike (26 Jul 2024 - 9 Jul 2025), ratified 9 July 2025 · Union-side side deals with AI voice vendors (e.g. Replica Studios Jan 2024, Ethovox Oct 2024) show a licensed-path model exists

PRICING Not applicable — collective bargaining agreement. Cinamate's own brief cites SAG-AFTRA daily scale of \$1,246 for 2025-26; replica consent and usage compensation are negotiated on top of scale and are not a published rate card.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP SAG-AFTRA covers approximately 160,000 performers across film, television, streaming, commercials, audiobooks and interactive media (membership figure from background knowledge, not verified on a page I loaded). Signatory status is required for essentially every professional US live-action production.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio/Local Generation — generating performances script-to-screen is exactly the activity the digital-replica and synthetic-performer rules govern · casting — the module that engages performers is where consent capture must live, and it currently has no described consent artifact · contracts / deal memos — replica consent riders are now standard and must be generated, stored and produced on demand · clearance — performer likeness rights are a core clearance item for any AI-generated face or voice · producer (budget/striplead) and finance — replica compensation is a budget line Cinamate's cost model must carry · distribution deliverables — distributors demand warranties that union AI terms were honored

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- It is enforceable through grievance and arbitration, with a demonstrated willingness to strike for a year over exactly this issue
- It applies to the productions Cinamate targets — independent producers and small studios still sign union agreements
- LightsKiddo's live-action, crew-facing positioning largely avoids the synthetic-performer problem; Cinamate's core product is the problem
- No security certification or engineering effort mitigates it

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- It is a consent-and-compensation regime, not a prohibition — fully licensed synthetic performance is contemplated and already happening via union-sanctioned vendor deals
- Non-union and micro-budget independent productions fall outside it entirely, and that is a real slice of Cinamate's stated target market
- It creates a product opportunity: a consent-capture and replica-ledger feature inside casting and contracts would be a differentiator, not just a compliance cost
- The rules govern performers' likenesses; wholly synthetic characters not identifiable as any individual sit in a lighter-touch zone

<https://www.sagaftra.org/contracts-industry-resources/contracts/artificial-intelligence> · https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2024%E2%80%932025_SAG-AFTRA_video_game_strike · https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2023_SAG-AFTRA_strike

TPN (Trusted Partner Network)

www.ttpn.org

INDIRECT

CRITICAL

VERIFIED

The MPA-owned content-security registry and assessment program that most studios and streamers use as a precondition for handing a vendor pre-release content.

TPN is wholly owned by the Motion Picture Association. It maintains the MPA Content Security Best Practices, runs security assessments measuring a service provider's posture against them, and operates TPN+, a global registry where providers publish their security status to content owners. Critically, TPN explicitly does NOT certify or issue pass/fail grades — it publishes conformance data and remediation items, and content owners make their own risk-based sourcing decisions. As of the v5.3.1 questionnaire, TPN replaced its two-tier Blue/Gold model with four tiers.

KEY FEATURES · Four-tier Shield system at v5.3.1: Blue (self-assessed, published to TPN+), Silver (third-party assessed + remediation plan submitted), Gold (all best practices remediated, TPN-reviewed), Gold Star (best practices + additional recommendations remediated) · Validity: Blue 1 year from submission; Silver/Gold/Gold Star 2 years from assessment report publication · Assessments must be completed and submitted within 15 business days · Separate assessment tracks for Sites, Cloud, and Applications — software providers are assessed as applications, not facilities · Zero Trust assessor accreditation category · 'Global Pass' process for companies with more than 5 sites or apps sharing one security implementation · Legacy 'Classic Gold Shield' remains valid until expiration but does not reflect remediation progress · Questionnaire answers visible only to participating content owners and the selected accredited assessor; evidence upload is optional

PRICING Annual TPN membership by service-provider revenue tier (2026 published schedule): Self-Employed \$250; up to \$2M \$1K; \$2-5M \$3K; \$5-10M \$5K; \$10-15M \$7.5K; \$15-25M \$10K; \$25-35M \$15K; \$35-50M \$30K; \$50-200M \$50K; \$200M+ \$85K. Third-party assessment costs are NOT included and are contracted separately with an accredited assessor — TPN recommends collecting three bids and does not publish assessment pricing. Assessor-side fees: \$150 non-refundable reference/certification review, \$150 per additional certification, \$500 accreditation valid two years.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Wholly owned by the Motion Picture Association; global program; president Terri Davies. Operates the TPN+ platform (plus.ttpn.org) and an accredited assessor directory. Published a 2026 TPN STAR Report on content-supply-chain security. Recent program changes include the next-gen Shield tier system and the rebranding of SSP to TPX (Trusted Partner Exchange).

COLLIDES WITH · Studio Cloud Backup — a unified production state synced every 4 minutes is exactly the kind of cloud-resident content store a TPN application assessment scrutinizes · Studio/Local Generation — script-to-screen rendering means pre-release master content lives on an operator-controlled GPU box, a control boundary TPN expects documented · The Cutting Room — browser-based multi-track editing of pre-release footage puts Cinamate squarely in the secure-review threat model · dailies, screening, editor, post, vfx, distribution — every module that touches unreleased picture is in TPN scope · projects and workflow — multi-tenancy and access segregation are core questionnaire items

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- It is the industry's default trust signal; studios and streamers routinely require TPN+ registry presence before a vendor sees a frame
- Owned by the MPA, so it carries the buyers' own authority rather than a vendor's self-claim
- Rival LightsKiddo already has a TPN assessment in progress — Cinamate has nothing, so on any RFP security page Cinamate is a blank row
- Registry visibility is a marketing channel Cinamate cannot replicate: content owners browse TPN+ to find qualified vendors

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- TPN is not a certification and confers no guarantee — Cinamate can honestly point out that a Gold Shield is a snapshot, not an assurance
- The new Blue Shield tier is self-assessed and requires no third-party auditor, so at Cinamate's likely revenue tier the entry price is \$250-\$1,000/year plus questionnaire effort — genuinely achievable in weeks
- Assessment scope is per-site and per-application; a single-operator local-GPU product has a far smaller attack surface to document than a facility, and Cinamate's \$0.00 cloud billing and local generation are real architectural arguments
- TPN scores documented controls, not architecture quality — it does not credit Cinamate for content never leaving the operator's machine

<https://www.ttpn.org/> · <https://www.ttpn.org/faqs/> · <https://www.ttpn.org/membership/> · <https://plus.ttpn.org/>

US Copyright Office — AI guidance (Reports Parts 1-3) www.copyright.gov/ai

INDIRECT

CRITICAL

VERIFIED

The federal position that human authorship is required for copyright — the gate that determines whether a Cinamate-generated film can be owned, insured and distributed at all.

The Copyright Office has issued a multi-part report on copyright and AI. Part 1, Digital Replicas (31 July 2024), recommends federal digital-replica legislation. Part 2, Copyrightability (29 January 2025), examines whether generative-AI outputs can receive copyright protection. Part 3, Generative AI Training, was released in prepublication form on 9 May 2025 with a final version expected without substantive change. The Office's operative principle is that copyright protects human authorship: works

generated entirely by AI without meaningful human creative input are not registrable, though hybrid works may be protected for their human-authored portions. Registration requires disclosure of AI-generated content.

KEY FEATURES · Part 1 Digital Replicas — 31 July 2024 · Part 2 Copyrightability — 29 January 2025 · Part 3 Generative AI Training — prepublication 9 May 2025 · Registration applicants must disclose AI-generated content in the deposit · Human-authored elements may be registrable; AI-generated portions cannot be · Purely AI-generated works are ineligible for registration · Guidance, not statute — but it governs the registration decision, which is what downstream commerce depends on

PRICING Not applicable — federal agency guidance. Copyright registration fees are separate statutory filing fees.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP US federal agency within the Library of Congress; its registration decisions bind the US market and are the reference point for E&O insurers, distributors and financiers worldwide.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio/Local Generation — this is the direct hit: a 90-page feature rendered script-to-screen for ~\$110 is precisely the output whose copyrightability is in question · writer — AI-generated screenplay material raises the same authorship problem at the source of the chain of title · clearance — the module that is supposed to certify a clean chain of title cannot certify one that does not exist · contracts / deal memos — assignment of rights presumes there are rights to assign · distribution deliverables and festivals — distributors and festivals require chain-of-title documentation and E&O coverage, both of which trace back to registrability · investors and finance — an unregistrable asset is far harder to collateralize or waterfall

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- It is the single gate Cinamate cannot buy, certify or engineer around — no amount of security posture fixes an unregistrable asset
- It attacks the flagship claim directly: 'turns a screenplay into a finished film' describes exactly the output most at risk of being held unprotectable
- LightsKiddo's positioning around live-action crews with camera integrations sidesteps this entirely, because human-shot footage is unambiguously authored

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- It does not prohibit anything — it governs registration, so AI-assisted work is legal to make and distribute, just harder to protect
- Hybrid works with meaningful human authorship are registrable, and Cinamate is a 28-module pipeline where a human operator makes thousands of creative decisions — that is a defensible authorship narrative if documented
- The disclosure requirement is a documentation problem, and Cinamate already has provenance-adjacent infrastructure (workflow, timeline, projects) that could produce an authorship record
- Part 3 remains prepublication, and the law here is unsettled and actively litigated

<https://www.copyright.gov/ai/> · <https://www.govinfo.gov/app/details/BILLS-119s1367is>

Autodesk Flow Capture (formerly Moxion and PIX) www.autodesk.com/products/flow-capture/overview

INDIRECT

HIGH

VERIFIED

Autodesk's consolidated secure dailies and review platform, now combining both Moxion and PIX — the incumbent that already owns the secure-review job Cinamate's dailies and screening modules want.

Flow Capture is Autodesk's cloud-based digital dailies and review tool connecting production and postproduction. It is the merged product of two former category leaders — Moxion and PIX — combining PIX's studio-grade security and support with Moxion's dailies workflows and real-time collaboration. It captures and delivers on-set camera footage and metadata to the cloud within seconds, provides real-time review Rooms with annotation, video and chat, and manages project assets with DRM, forensic and burnt-in watermarking, MFA and granular access control.

KEY FEATURES · Camera to cloud: on-set footage and metadata streamed moments after the camera stops · Flow Capture Rooms for real-time livestream sharing and asset review with annotation · DRM, forensic watermarking and burnt-in watermarking · Multi-factor authentication and permissions-based access · Live streaming on set via QTAKE Cloud Streams, AWS Elemental, SRT and NDI · Avid Media Composer panel giving editors secure in-NLE access to dailies · Native apps for iPhone, iPad, Apple TV, macOS and Windows, plus Safari/Chrome browser access · 30-day free trial

PRICING Not disclosed on the overview page — Autodesk routes to a quote/purchase flow rather than publishing per-seat rates for Flow Capture. A 30-day free trial is offered.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Owned by Autodesk. Absorbed both Moxion (New Zealand) and PIX (a long-standing studio-grade secure review provider), consolidating two of the category's three named incumbents into one product. Referenced customers and testimonials include Amazon Studios (Eric Iverson, Head of Product Strategy) and 44 Blue Productions.

COLLIDES WITH · dailies — direct functional overlap; this is Flow Capture's core job · screening — secure review rooms for executives and stakeholders · today and production — on-set capture and same-day review · editor and The Cutting Room — Flow Capture's Avid Media Composer panel does what Cinamate's browser editor cannot: reach into the NLE editors actually use · Studio Cloud Backup — competing as the single secure store of production state · tools (slate/timecards) — on-set metadata capture overlaps

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Owns the security features Cinamate lacks entirely: DRM, forensic and burnt-in watermarking, MFA
- Has the mobile and on-set presence Cinamate explicitly does not — iPhone, iPad and Apple TV apps
- Native camera and on-set integrations (QTAKE, AWS Elemental, SRT, NDI) versus Cinamate's zero camera ingest
- Native NLE integration via the Avid Media Composer panel, against Cinamate's stated lack of NLE plugins
- Autodesk's balance sheet, enterprise procurement track record and studio relationships
- Real-time streaming versus Cinamate's 4-minute sync, which is explicitly not real-time

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- It is a dailies and review tool only — it does nothing for development, budgeting, scheduling, tax credits, clearance, festivals or distribution deliverables
- No generation capability whatsoever: it moves and reviews footage that a crew shot
- No cost intelligence — nothing resembling The Money Room's live cost reporting, PO tracking or self-calibrating estimates
- Priced and scoped for crewed productions with a post pipeline; a single operator gets little value
- Requires cloud upload of pre-release content, where Cinamate's local generation keeps masters on-premises

<https://www.autodesk.com/products/flow-capture/overview>

C2PA / Content Credentials c2pa.org INDIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

The open provenance standard — and, since the EU AI Act took effect, the most practical way to satisfy machine-readable synthetic-content marking.

C2PA, the Coalition for Content Provenance and Authenticity, publishes an open technical standard letting publishers, creators and consumers establish the origin and edit history of digital content. The user-facing manifestation is Content Credentials, described as a nutrition label for digital content. The current specification line is 2.x, with version 2.3 published. In mid-2025 C2PA launched a formal Conformance Program and the official C2PA Trust List, retiring the earlier Interim Trust List that had operated through 31 December 2025; the new Trust List adds a public Certificate Policy for CAs, stronger governance, alignment with the 2.x specification series, and Time Stamping Authority trust lists.

KEY FEATURES · Open specification, current version 2.3 · C2PA Conformance Program and official C2PA Trust List launched mid-2025 · Interim Trust List retired after 31 December 2025 · Public Certificate Policy specifying requirements for Certification Authorities · Time Stamping Authority trust lists for generator products · Cryptographically signed manifests recording origin and edit history · Durable credentials paired with invisible watermarking and fingerprinting in some implementations, so credentials survive stripping or screenshotting

PRICING The specification is open and free to implement. Certificate issuance under the Conformance Program runs through participating Certification Authorities; CA pricing is not disclosed on the C2PA site.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Steering committee of eleven organizations: Adobe, Amazon, BBC, Google, Meta, Microsoft, OpenAI, Publicis Groupe, Sony Group, TikTok and Truepic. The Content Credentials project reports collaboration with 500+ companies.

COLLIDES WITH · The Cutting Room — H.264+AAC export and EDL/OTIO conform are where C2PA manifests would need to be written and preserved · Studio/Local Generation — the generator product is the entity that would hold a C2PA certificate and sign its output · distribution deliverables — provenance manifests are becoming a delivery spec item · dailies, editor, post, vfx — every transform step must carry the manifest forward or the chain breaks · Studio Cloud Backup — a natural place to store the signed provenance ledger across the production state · workflow and projects — Cinamate's existing workflow tracking is the raw material for a credible authorship/provenance record

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Backed by the platform companies that control distribution surfaces, so adoption is not optional in the medium term
- It is the de facto answer to EU AI Act Article 50 machine-readable marking, which is now in force
- The Conformance Program means ad-hoc implementations no longer count — there is a real certificate and trust-list gate now
- Adobe ships Content Credentials in the tools Cinamate's users already touch

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- It is an open standard, free to implement, and imposes no membership fee — this is the cheapest compliance win available to Cinamate
- Implementation is a bounded engineering task in the export path, not an organizational certification
- Provenance signing would actively help Cinamate's copyrightability story by documenting human creative decisions across 28 modules
- Adoption in film delivery is still early; no major distributor requires it as a hard gate today

<https://c2pa.org/> · <https://c2pa.org/conformance/> · <https://contentcredentials.org/>

California AB 1836 — digital replicas of deceased personalities

[leginfo.legislature.ca.gov/faces/billTextClient.xhtml?bill_id=202320240AB1836](https://leginfo.ca.gov/faces/billTextClient.xhtml?bill_id=202320240AB1836)

INDIRECT

HIGH

VERIFIED

California law requiring estate consent before using a digital replica of a deceased performer, with statutory damages — a liability trap for any generative film tool.

AB 1836, approved 17 September 2024, requires anyone producing, distributing or making available a digital replica of a deceased personality's voice or likeness in an audiovisual work or sound recording to obtain prior consent from authorized representatives of the estate. Liability is the greater of \$10,000 or actual damages to the rights holder, plus available punitive damages and mandatory attorney's fees and costs to the prevailing party. Protection runs for 70 years after death. Exemptions cover news, public affairs and sports broadcasts; comment, criticism, scholarship, satire and parody; documentary, historical or biographical works unless falsely presented as an authentic recording; fleeting or incidental appearances; and advertisements for those exempt works. Authorized digital remastering and sampling are excluded.

KEY FEATURES · Prior consent from the estate's authorized representative required · Damages: greater of \$10,000 or actual damages, plus punitive damages · Mandatory attorney's fees and costs to the prevailing party · 70-year post-mortem term · Exemptions for news, criticism, satire, parody, documentary/historical/biographical use, and fleeting appearances · Approved 17 September 2024 · Same digital-replica definition as AB 2602

PRICING Not applicable — state statute.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP California state law with national practical reach given where entertainment contracts and productions are centered; estates of deceased performers are actively represented and litigious.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio/Local Generation — a text prompt naming a deceased actor produces exactly the prohibited artifact, and the system as described has no gate preventing it · casting — no described mechanism for detecting or blocking a deceased-personality likeness request · clearance — the module nominally responsible for rights clearance would need an estate-consent workflow and a deceased-personality screen · contracts / deal memos — estate consent instruments are a distinct document class not described in Cinamate's contract coverage · distribution deliverables and festivals — distributors will demand a warranty that no unlicensed digital replica appears in the master · The Cutting Room and post — the liability attaches to distributing or making available, so it survives into delivery

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Statutory damages plus mandatory fee-shifting make even a small violation economically serious for a small vendor or a single operator
- Fully automated generation with no likeness screen is a structural exposure: the tool will produce violations if asked
- LightsKiddo's live-action camera-ingest positioning does not generate likenesses at all, so it carries none of this risk

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- The exemption list is broad — documentary, biographical, satire and parody uses cover a meaningful share of independent filmmaking
- Liability attaches to the producer/distributor, not automatically to the tool vendor
- A deceased-personality name screen in casting and clearance is a tractable feature, and shipping one would be a genuine trust signal
- Only applies to replicas readily identifiable as a specific real individual; wholly synthetic characters are untouched

https://leginfo.legislature.ca.gov/faces/billTextClient.xhtml?bill_id=202320240AB1836

California AB 2602 — digital replica contract provisions

leginfo.legislature.ca.gov/faces/billTextClient.xhtml?bill_id=202320240AB2602

INDIRECT

HIGH

VERIFIED

California law voiding digital-replica clauses in performer contracts unless the uses are specifically described and the performer was represented — a hard limit on how Cinamate's contracts module can be drafted.

AB 2602, effective 1 January 2025, makes a contract provision unenforceable where it permits the creation and use of a digital replica of an individual's voice or likeness in place of work the individual would otherwise have performed in person, AND the provision lacks a reasonably specific description of the intended uses of the digital replica, AND the individual was not represented either by legal counsel who negotiated terms stated in a signed contract or by a union under a collective bargaining agreement addressing digital replica use. It defines a digital replica as a computer-generated, highly realistic electronic representation readily identifiable as the voice or visual likeness of an individual who did not actually perform, or whose performance was materially altered.

KEY FEATURES · Effective 1 January 2025 · Applies to personal or professional services agreements · Requires a reasonably specific description of intended digital-replica uses · Requires either negotiating counsel or union representation for the provision to hold · Unenforceability is the remedy — the clause simply fails · Definition covers both voice and visual likeness, including materially altered performances

PRICING Not applicable — state statute.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP California state law; because the overwhelming majority of US film and television personal services agreements are executed under California law, it functions as a national standard.

COLLIDES WITH · contracts / deal memos — this is the direct hit: any templated digital-replica clause Cinamate generates is void unless it names specific uses and the performer had counsel or union representation · casting — engagement paperwork is where the specificity and representation conditions must be satisfied · Studio/Local Generation — generating a performance 'in place of work the individual would otherwise have performed in person' is the exact triggering fact pattern · clearance — a void replica clause is a clearance defect that surfaces at delivery · legal exposure for a single-operator tool: an unrepresented indie performer signing a Cinamate-generated deal memo is precisely the scenario the statute targets

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- It is statute, not guidance — the clause is simply unenforceable, with no cure after the fact
- It targets exactly the low-budget, thinly-lawyered independent productions that are Cinamate's stated market, where performers are least likely to have counsel
- A single-operator product that auto-generates deal memos is structurally likely to produce non-compliant clauses at scale

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- It is satisfiable by drafting: a specific use description plus a representation acknowledgment makes the clause enforceable
- It is a template problem, and templates are exactly what a contracts module is good at — this is a shippable fix, not an architectural one
- It only voids the provision; it does not create statutory damages or bar the production
- Union-covered performers are already carved in via the CBA route

https://leginfo.legislature.ca.gov/faces/billTextClient.xhtml?bill_id=202320240AB2602

EU AI Act Article 50 — transparency obligations artificialintelligenceact.eu/article/50

HIGH

VERIFIED

INDIRECT

Now in force as of 2 August 2026: AI systems generating synthetic video, audio or images must mark output in a machine-readable, detectable format.

Article 50 of the EU AI Act sets transparency obligations that entered into force on 2 August 2026. Providers of AI systems generating synthetic audio, image, video or text must ensure outputs are marked in a machine-readable format detectable as artificially generated or manipulated, using solutions that are effective, interoperable, robust and reliable as far as technically feasible. Deployers must disclose when content constituting a deepfake has been artificially generated or manipulated; where the content is part of an evidently artistic, creative, satirical or fictional work, the obligation is limited to disclosing the existence of such content in an appropriate manner. Disclosure must be clear and distinguishable, provided at the latest at the time of first exposure, and conform to accessibility requirements. The AI Office is facilitating codes of practice for detection and labelling.

KEY FEATURES · In force 2 August 2026 — three weeks before this report · Machine-readable marking of synthetic audio, image, video and text required of providers · Deepfake disclosure obligation on deployers · Lighter-touch disclosure for evidently artistic, creative, satirical or fictional works — relevant to narrative film · Exception for assistive editing functions that do not substantially alter input data · Disclosure timing: at latest at first interaction or exposure · AI Office codes of practice on detection and labelling in development

PRICING Not applicable — EU regulation. Non-compliance penalties are set elsewhere in the Act and scale with turnover.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Applies across the 27 EU member states and reaches non-EU providers whose output is placed on the EU market. The world's most consequential AI transparency regime to date.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio/Local Generation — this is the provider-side obligation: Cinamate generates synthetic video and audio and must mark it machine-readably · The Cutting Room — H.264+AAC export and EDL/OTIO conform are the points where a machine-readable mark must survive; nothing in the described export pipeline carries provenance metadata · music/cue sheets — synthetic audio falls squarely inside the marking obligation · distribution deliverables — any EU delivery requires the marking to be present and intact in the master · festivals — European festivals and broadcasters will make this a submission requirement · post and vfx — transcode and grade steps are exactly where naive metadata gets stripped

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- It is in force now, not pending — this is a present shipping requirement for the EU market, not a future risk
- It bites hardest on exactly Cinamate's flagship: a system whose entire purpose is generating synthetic picture and sound
- Compliance requires engineering in the export path (C2PA manifests or equivalent watermarking), which Cinamate's described H.264+AAC export does not do
- Cinamate's 'private studio' positioning is in tension with a mandatory public marking regime

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- The artistic/creative/fictional carve-out materially softens the deployer disclosure duty for narrative film — a film need only disclose the existence of synthetic content appropriately, not label every frame
- Marking is required only 'as far as this is technically feasible', leaving implementation latitude
- The obligation is satisfiable with existing open tooling (C2PA manifest signing), which is a bounded engineering task rather than a certification
- It is a labelling duty, not a prohibition — it does not stop Cinamate selling in Europe, only ungated output

<https://artificialintelligenceact.eu/article/50/>

Frame.io (Adobe) frame.io/pricing INDIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

Adobe's review-and-approval platform, and the public benchmark for what a compliant media vendor looks like: TPN+ Gold Shield accredited and SOC 2 Type 2 at the Enterprise tier.

Frame.io is Adobe's collaboration platform for secure sharing, review, feedback and approval across video, photo and marketing assets. It publishes tiered pricing and, unusually for this category, states its compliance posture openly on the pricing page: the Enterprise tier is described as SOC Type 2 compliant and TPN+ Gold Shield accredited, with SAML2 single sign-on, session-based watermarking and DRM that prevents unauthorized screenshots and recordings. Forensic watermarking is reserved for the Enterprise Prime package. Camera to Cloud is available on every tier including Free.

KEY FEATURES · Free tier: \$0, 2GB storage, up to 2 users · Pro: \$15/user/month, 2TB storage + 2TB per additional user, 250GB mounted storage, up to 5 users · Team: \$25/user/month, 3TB + 2TB per additional, 500GB mounted, up to 15 users · Enterprise: custom pricing, 2TB mounted storage, SOC Type 2 compliant, TPN+ Gold Shield accredited · Camera to Cloud on all tiers including Free · Forensic watermarking exclusive to the Enterprise Prime package · Session-based watermarking and DRM blocking screenshots and screen recording · SAML2 single sign-on at Enterprise; annual plans discounted ~13%

PRICING Free \$0; Pro \$15/user/month; Team \$25/user/month; Enterprise custom (contact sales). Annual billing carries roughly a 13% discount.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Owned by Adobe, acquired in 2021. Deeply integrated with Adobe Creative Cloud. The published TPN+ Gold Shield and SOC 2 Type 2 claims make it the reference point buyers cite when asking a smaller vendor for its posture.

COLLIDES WITH · screening — review-and-approval is Frame.io's core job and Cinamate's screening module competes with it directly · dailies — Camera to Cloud on every tier, including Free, undercuts any dailies play · editor and The Cutting Room — Frame.io lives inside Premiere and the Adobe pipeline where Cinamate has no plugin presence · Studio Cloud Backup — competing as the shared production asset store · boards and vfx — review and annotation workflows for animatics and shots · workflow and projects — approval routing overlaps

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Publicly documented TPN+ Gold Shield and SOC 2 Type 2 — precisely the two gates Cinamate is missing, stated on a public pricing page
- Adobe distribution and native Premiere Pro integration against Cinamate's zero NLE plugins
- Forensic and session-based watermarking plus screenshot-blocking DRM, none of which Cinamate has
- Camera to Cloud on the free tier, versus Cinamate having no camera ingest at all
- Transparent published pricing builds trust; Cinamate is invite-only with no public team

<https://frame.io/pricing>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Pure review-and-collaboration — no budgeting, scheduling, call sheets, tax credits, clearance, contracts, festivals or distribution deliverables
- No generation: it reviews footage, it does not create it
- Forensic watermarking is gated behind Enterprise Prime, so the security story is weaker than it looks at Pro/Team prices
- Per-user pricing punishes small teams; Cinamate's single-operator model has no seat tax
- Cloud-only, so pre-release content necessarily leaves the operator's control

MovieLabs CSAP (Common Security Architecture for Production)

movielabs.com/production-technology/production-security

INDIRECT

HIGH

VERIFIED

The studio-authored zero-trust reference architecture for cloud production — the design standard that increasingly sits behind studio security addenda.

MovieLabs, the studios' joint technology venture, publishes the Common Security Architecture for Production, a zero-trust framework designed specifically for media creation. CSAP assumes infrastructure is already breached, requires all users, devices and services to authenticate before participating, requires mutual verification, and makes authorization policy-based. It defines three scalable security levels (100, 200, 300) so productions can match protection to content sensitivity, and is documented in five parts covering architecture description, interfaces, security levels, software-defined workflows and implementation considerations. Alongside CSAP, MovieLabs publishes Enhanced Content Protection for Production (ECP) and Zero Trust Recommended Practices.

KEY FEATURES · Zero-trust architecture purpose-built for media creation · Three scalable security levels: 100, 200, 300 · Five-part CSAP documentation set (architecture, interfaces, levels, software-defined workflows, implementation) · Enhanced Content Protection for Production (ECP) recommended practices for immediate cloud security needs · Zero Trust Recommended Practices deployment guidance applicable beyond CSAP · Security Interoperability paper on securing workflows across diverse infrastructure · Part of the broader MovieLabs 2030 Vision for media creation

PRICING Free — specifications and recommended practices are published openly at movielabs.com and mc.movielabs.com.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP MovieLabs is jointly owned by the major Hollywood studios. The 2030 Vision is a ten-year industry initiative with an Industry Forum, 2030 Greenlight program and showcase library. TPN now accredits assessors in a Zero Trust category, indicating convergence between CSAP thinking and TPN assessment.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio Cloud Backup — a 4-minute sync of unified production state is exactly the software-defined workflow CSAP governs, and zero-trust would demand per-asset authorization Cinamate does not describe · Studio/Local Generation — the local GPU workstation is a CSAP endpoint requiring device authentication · workflow and projects — CSAP's software-defined workflow model competes conceptually with Cinamate's own workflow abstraction · The Cutting Room — browser access to pre-release assets is a textbook zero-trust authorization boundary · dailies, editor, post, vfx — the whole cloud production chain CSAP was written for

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Authored by the studios themselves, so it defines what buyers consider good architecture
- TPN's Zero Trust assessor accreditation means CSAP concepts are entering the assessment regime Cinamate must eventually pass
- LightsKiddo's engineer-embedding foundry model is a natural fit for CSAP implementation work; a single-operator tool is not
- Cinamate's described security model — a private studio on a netlify.app subdomain with 4-minute sync — has no articulated authentication or authorization architecture

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- It is free, open documentation with no fee, no audit and no gate of its own — nobody is refused a sale for not implementing CSAP directly
- Level 100 is deliberately achievable for lower-sensitivity content, and independent production largely operates there
- It is a reference architecture, not a certification, so conformance is self-directed
- Cinamate's local-only generation is arguably closer to zero-trust intent than a cloud-first competitor, since content never transits a shared network

SOC 2 (AICPA) — Type I vs Type II

www.aicpa-cima.com/topic/audit-assurance/audit-and-assurance-greater-than-soc-2

INDIRECT

HIGH

VERIFIED

The CPA-attested controls report that enterprise and studio procurement teams demand before onboarding a SaaS vendor, independent of any media-specific requirement.

SOC 2 is an AICPA System and Organization Controls examination performed by a licensed CPA firm on a service organization's controls. A Type I report assesses the design of controls at a single point in time. A Type II report assesses operating effectiveness over an observation window of three to twelve months, which the organization chooses. SOC 2 is not media-specific — it is the generic gate that any enterprise procurement or vendor-risk team applies, and it sits alongside TPN rather than replacing it.

KEY FEATURES · Type I: point-in-time assessment of control design only; faster and less time-intensive · Type II: 3-12 month observation window verifying that controls actually operated effectively · Performed by an independent licensed CPA firm, not a self-assessment · Scoped against Trust Services Criteria (security is mandatory; availability, processing integrity, confidentiality and privacy are optional add-ons) · Common sequencing pattern: organizations take Type I first when deals are already blocked by missing compliance, then progress to Type II · Report is issued under NDA to customers rather than published

PRICING Not disclosed by AICPA; audit fees are negotiated per engagement with the CPA firm and vary by scope. Compliance-automation vendors that prepare organizations for the audit (Vanta, Drata) do not publish list pricing either. No verified dollar figure available.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP The de facto North American SaaS security standard; AICPA is the standard-setting body. Frame.io Enterprise publicly advertises being 'SOC Type 2 compliant' alongside its TPN accreditation, which indicates the pairing buyers now expect.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio Cloud Backup — a hosted, continuously syncing production-state store is the classic in-scope system for a SOC 2 examination · The Money Room — live cost reporting, PO tracking and invoice ingestion means financial data in scope, which raises confidentiality and processing-integrity questions · finance, contracts, casting, investors — these modules hold PII, deal terms and cap-table-adjacent data that vendor-risk reviewers will ask about · workflow and projects — logical access, provisioning and deprovisioning are core Trust Services Criteria

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- It is table stakes in enterprise procurement; without it Cinamate cannot pass a standard vendor security review at any studio, network or well-run production company
- LightsKiddo has SOC 2 underway, giving it a dated answer where Cinamate has none
- A Type II report proves controls operated over time — precisely the evidence a private beta with no public team cannot otherwise offer

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- It is a generic IT-controls report with no media-specific content requirements — it says nothing about protecting pre-release picture
- Type I can be obtained relatively quickly and unblocks stalled deals, so the gap is closable without a year of waiting
- Scope is chosen by the organization, so a narrowly scoped report is achievable for a small product surface
- It attests to controls, not to product quality, security architecture, or the accuracy of Cinamate's 124 automated checks

<https://www.aicpa-cima.com/topic/audit-assurance/audit-and-assurance-greater-than-soc-2> · <https://www.vanta.com/collection/soc-2/soc-2-type-1-vs-type-2> · <https://frame.io/pricing>

WGA Minimum Basic Agreement — AI provisions

www.wga.org/contracts/know-your-rights/artificial-intelligence

INDIRECT

HIGH

VERIFIED

The writers' agreement establishing that AI-generated text is not literary material and cannot be assigned to a writer as source material — a direct constraint on Cinamate's writer module.

The WGA MBA's AI provisions establish that no written material produced by traditional AI or generative AI can be considered literary material. When a company provides AI-generated content to a writer, it does not count as assigned or source material, so the writer receives first-writer status and full compensation rather than a rewrite fee. Companies cannot require a writer to use AI software when performing writing services, though voluntary use may be permitted under company policy. Studios must disclose

to writers when materials incorporate AI-generated content. AI-generated material cannot disqualify a writer from separated rights or affect credit determinations. The Guild asserts that exploiting writers' material to train AI is prohibited by the MBA or other law.

KEY FEATURES · AI/GAI output is not 'literary material' under the MBA · AI-generated material handed to a writer is not assigned or source material — the writer is a first writer, paid accordingly · Companies cannot compel a writer to use AI tools · Mandatory disclosure to the writer when supplied material contains AI-generated content · AI material cannot affect writing credit or separated rights · Guild position that training on writers' material is prohibited · A 2026 MBA is referenced on the WGA contracts page, indicating the agreement has been renegotiated since the 2023 terms

PRICING Not applicable — collective bargaining agreement with published minimums.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP WGA West and WGA East together cover essentially all US screen and television writing on signatory productions. The 2023 MBA followed a 148-day strike in which AI was a central issue.

COLLIDES WITH · writer — this is the direct collision: a module that generates or develops screenplay material runs straight into the disclosure and first-writer rules · boards (storyboards/animations) — derivative generation from AI-written material inherits the disclosure obligation · contracts / deal memos — writer agreements on signatory productions must reflect AI disclosure and cannot mandate AI use · clearance and distribution — chain of title for the screenplay is the foundation of the whole package · projects and workflow — provenance tracking of which text was AI-generated becomes a contractual record-keeping requirement

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- It is binding on every signatory production and enforced through arbitration
- The economics are inverted against AI use: handing a writer AI-generated material makes them a first writer at full rate, removing the cost saving that would justify it
- The Guild's stated position against training on writers' work creates exposure for any tool whose model provenance is undisclosed — Cinamate discloses nothing about its generation models

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- It regulates the employment relationship, not the tool — a producer using Cinamate privately without engaging a WGA writer is outside its reach
- It explicitly permits voluntary writer use of AI with an appropriate policy, so Cinamate's writer module is usable on covered productions with disclosure
- Non-signatory independent production, Cinamate's stated market, is largely unaffected
- Disclosure is a feature Cinamate could ship — an AI-provenance flag per scene would satisfy it and differentiate the writer module

<https://www.wga.org/contracts/know-your-rights/artificial-intelligence> · <https://www.wga.org/contracts/contracts/mba>

Adobe Content Authenticity (Content Credentials implementation) contentauthenticity.adobe.com

INDIRECT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

Adobe's free tool for signing work with durable Content Credentials — the reference implementation of the provenance marking the EU AI Act now requires.

Adobe Content Authenticity, currently in beta, lets creators apply Content Credentials to finished files before sharing, attaching a verified name, social accounts and information about the creative process. Credentials are described as durable and recoverable: invisible watermarking and digital fingerprinting make recovery easy even if someone strips the metadata or screenshots the work. It also lets creators request that generative models not train on their content, and provides an Inspect tool to examine any file or screenshot for existing Content Credentials and view changes over time. Files can be processed up to 50 at a time.

KEY FEATURES · Apply Content Credentials to finished files before sharing · Durable and recoverable credentials via invisible watermarking plus digital fingerprinting · Survives metadata stripping and screenshotting · Verified identity linkage — name and social accounts attached to the work · 'Ask AI not to use your content' training-preference signal · Inspect tool for examining any file or screenshot and viewing edit history over time · Batch processing up to 50 files · Currently in beta

PRICING Free during beta — no pricing stated on the site.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Adobe is a C2PA steering committee member alongside Amazon, BBC, Google, Meta, Microsoft, OpenAI, Publicis Groupe, Sony and TikTok. Content Credentials reports 500+ participating companies.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio/Local Generation — signing generated output with provenance is the specific compliance step EU AI Act Article 50 now demands, and Adobe demonstrates it is a solved, free problem · The Cutting Room — export from a browser editor is exactly the point where a manifest should be written; Cinamate's H.264+AAC export carries none · distribution deliverables — provenance is becoming a delivery-spec item · workflow, timeline, projects — Cinamate already tracks the human decision history that would make a credible authorship manifest, and could turn it into a copyrightability argument · boards and vfx — intermediate assets also carry credentials in a full implementation

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free, shipping and backed by Adobe, so it sets the expectation that provenance signing is table stakes
- Its durability approach (watermark plus fingerprint, not just metadata) is more robust than anything in Cinamate's described export path
- It ships the training-preference signal, giving creators a stance Cinamate has not articulated
- Adobe reaches Cinamate's users through Premiere and Creative Cloud, where Cinamate has no presence

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Beta status and consumer/creator orientation — it is not a production pipeline tool
- It signs finished files rather than tracking provenance across a 28-module production, which is a gap Cinamate is architecturally well placed to fill
- It competes with none of Cinamate's modules; it is a capability to adopt, not a rival to beat
- Free and open-standard based, so the cost of matching it is engineering time only

<https://contentauthenticity.adobe.com/> · <https://c2pa.org/> · <https://contentcredentials.org/>

Fairly Trained www.fairlytrained.org INDIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Nonprofit certification that a generative AI model was trained only on licensed data — the emerging trust mark for AI tools selling into rights-sensitive industries.

Fairly Trained certifies generative AI companies that license their training data rather than using copyrighted work without consent. Its stated mission is to make sure the human creators behind training data are treated fairly, and it certifies AI companies that do not use any copyrighted work without a license. For a film-industry buyer, the certification answers the question that increasingly precedes any AI-tool purchase: what was this model trained on, and can using it create exposure for my production.

KEY FEATURES · Certification for generative AI companies whose training data is fully licensed · Requires that no copyrighted work be used without a license · Consumer- and buyer-facing trust mark · Open application process for AI companies seeking certification · Directly addresses the WGA's stated position that training on writers' material is prohibited

PRICING Not disclosed on the site — certification fee structure is not published.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP A nonprofit certification body founded by former Stability AI executive Ed Newton-Rex (founder attribution is background knowledge, not verified on the page loaded). Certified companies are listed publicly on the site.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio/Local Generation — this goes to the heart of the flagship system: nothing in Cinamate's disclosed material says what its generation models were trained on · writer — the WGA explicitly asserts that exploiting writers' material to train AI is prohibited, making training provenance a direct issue for the writer module · clearance — a producer's clearance analysis now reasonably extends to the provenance of the tools used · investors and finance — financiers and E&O underwriters increasingly ask about model training provenance · contracts — warranties about AI tool provenance are appearing in production agreements

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- It answers a question Cinamate currently cannot: what is the model trained on
- Its certification directly rebuts the exact objection unions and rights holders raise about generative film tools
- It is a public, checkable list — absence from it is itself informative to a cautious buyer
- Cinamate's whole rigor narrative (3,708 films, disclosed 15.5% failure rate, 124 checks, source-cited union rates) is undermined by silence on model provenance

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Small nonprofit with limited industry recognition; no studio requires it today
- Only relevant to companies that train their own models — if Cinamate licenses or runs third-party open-weight models locally, the certification may not fit its architecture
- Undisclosed pricing and an unclear assessment process
- It gates nothing legally; it is reputational leverage rather than a purchase requirement

<https://www.fairlytrained.org/>

IATSE agreements (Basic Agreement / Area Standards Agreement) iatse.net INDIRECT MEDIUM

LIKELY

The crew union whose agreements govern below-the-line labor — and whose AI provisions constrain automating crew functions on covered productions.

IATSE represents below-the-line crew across motion picture, television and stagecraft. Its Basic Agreement and Area Standards Agreement set wages, hours, conditions and, since the 2024 round, AI provisions covering notice and consultation about AI deployment, protections against AI displacing covered work, and training commitments. IATSE's site shows sustained AI activity through the current period, with AI-tagged Motion Picture and Television and Political/Legislative posts dated as recently as May and June 2026 and March 2026, indicating continued negotiation and legislative engagement rather than a settled position.

KEY FEATURES · Basic Agreement and Area Standards Agreement cover below-the-line crew nationally · AI provisions introduced in the 2024 negotiation round · Notice and consultation obligations around AI deployment on covered productions · Protections against AI eliminating or displacing covered classifications · Training and retraining commitments · Active AI-tagged publications through May/June 2026 under Motion Picture and Television and Political/Legislative categories · Also active on state and federal AI legislation

PRICING Not applicable — collective bargaining agreements with published wage scales. Cinamate's brief cites source-cited IATSE rates in its budgeting model.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP IATSE represents roughly 170,000 members across the US and Canada (membership figure from background knowledge, not verified on a page loaded). Covers essentially all unionized below-the-line crew on signatory productions.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (budget/stripboard/call sheets) — IATSE rates, turnaround and meal-penalty rules drive the schedule and budget Cinamate models · safety — IATSE has been the loudest voice on set safety, and safety obligations are contractual · tools (slate/timcards) — timcard handling touches covered payroll classifications · Studio/Local Generation and The Cutting Room — automating functions performed by covered classifications (editing, VFX, sound) is exactly what the AI provisions were written to address · production, today, timeline — day-to-day crew management on covered productions · finance and The Money Room — fringe and benefit contributions are contractual and must be modeled correctly

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Covers the largest headcount of any entertainment union and has been aggressive on both bargaining and legislation
- Its AI provisions target automation of covered work, which is precisely what a single-operator studio-in-a-box implies
- Continued 2026 activity shows the position is hardening, not settling
- LightsKiddo's crew-facing, foundry-embedded model aligns with IATSE crews rather than displacing them; Cinamate's single-operator premise is structurally in tension with them

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Its AI terms are notice, consultation and displacement protections rather than prohibitions on tools
- It applies only to signatory productions; non-union independent production is unaffected
- It regulates the employer, not the software vendor — IATSE cannot block Cinamate from selling
- Cinamate already cites source-cited IATSE rates in its budgeting model, which is a credibility asset with union-aware producers

<https://iatse.net/> · <https://iatse.net/?s=artificial+intelligence>

MediaSilo (EditShare) — now including Shift.io www.mediasilo.com/pricing INDIRECT MEDIUM

VERIFIED

EditShare's secure video review platform, which has absorbed Shift.io — the mid-market secure-review option with published per-seat pricing.

MediaSilo is video collaboration and secure review software built by EditShare, providing centralized asset management, review and approval, AI transcription and captioning, presentation building and engagement analytics. It integrates with Adobe Creative Cloud and DaVinci Resolve. Notably, shift.io now issues a 301 redirect to mediasilo.com, indicating Shift Media's platform has been consolidated into MediaSilo — a further contraction of the secure-review category.

KEY FEATURES · Free trial: 14 days, up to 3 seats, 50GB · Team: from \$15/user/month, 5-10 seats, 2TB storage · Pro: from \$25/user/month, 10-30 seats, 4TB storage, includes SSO and watermarking · Enterprise: custom pricing, expandable storage, multi-domain SSO · Visual and forensic watermarking · AI-powered transcription, captioning and search · Adobe Creative Cloud and DaVinci Resolve integrations · Content presentation builder plus engagement analytics

PRICING Team from \$15/user/month (5-10 seats, 2TB); Pro from \$25/user/month (10-30 seats, 4TB, SSO and watermarking included); Enterprise custom. 14-day free trial with 3 seats and 50GB.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Owned by EditShare. Absorbed Shift.io / Shift Media (shift.io redirects to mediasilo.com). Describes itself as having enterprise-grade security trusted by names in business and entertainment; no specific TPN or SOC 2 claim appears on the pricing page.

COLLIDES WITH · screening — secure stakeholder review and presentation building · dailies — asset management and review of production footage · editor and The Cutting Room — MediaSilo integrates with Resolve and Adobe where Cinamate has no plugin · Studio Cloud Backup — competing centralized asset store · post and vfx — review and approval rounds · distribution deliverables — presentation and delivery packaging overlap

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Ships watermarking (visual and forensic) and SSO at the \$25 Pro tier — security features Cinamate has none of
- Integrates with DaVinci Resolve and Adobe Creative Cloud, the tools Cinamate's users already run
- Backed by EditShare, an established M&E infrastructure vendor with real enterprise references
- Published, transparent pricing versus Cinamate's invite-only opacity
- Consolidating the category by acquisition, gaining share while Cinamate is in private beta

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No TPN or SOC 2 claim on its own pricing page, unlike Frame.io — its compliance story is comparatively vague
- Review and asset management only; no development, budgeting, scheduling, clearance, tax credit, festival or distribution modules
- No generation capability at all
- Seat-based pricing with seat-count floors (Team requires 5-10 seats) is a poor fit for the single operator Cinamate targets
- Cloud-hosted, so masters leave the operator's machine

<https://www.mediasilo.com/pricing> · <https://shift.io/> · <https://www.mediasilo.com/>

NAGRA NexGuard nagra.vision/nexguard-forensic-watermarking

INDIRECT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

The dominant forensic video watermarking system, used in 95% of digital cinemas, with a dedicated pre-release module for content in production.

NexGuard is NAGRA's forensic watermarking line, embedding imperceptible marks in video so the source of a leak can be identified. NAGRA describes it as the gold standard in video watermarking security, with 95% of digital cinemas globally using the technology and 15+ years of Hollywood deployment. NexGuard for Pre-Release is entirely modular and addresses content at various production stages — securing footage immediately after filming or waiting until finalization, according to the threat level of the workflow. A separate Pay-TV and Streaming line supports client-side or server-side embedding at CDN edges or set-top boxes.

KEY FEATURES · NexGuard for Pre-Release: modular protection for dailies, screeners and works-in-progress · NexGuard for Pay-TV & Streaming: client-side or server-side, CDN edge or set-top box · Forensic identification of leak source down to the individual recipient or session · Deployed in 95% of digital cinemas globally · 15+ years of Hollywood deployment · Integrates into content production cycles rather than only at distribution

PRICING Not disclosed — enterprise licensing, no published rate card.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Part of the Kudelski Group. NAGRA reports 600 clients worldwide across four continents and protection of 30 million+ set-top boxes.

COLLIDES WITH · dailies — pre-release watermarking is the control studios expect on any dailies workflow, and Cinamate has none · screening — recipient-traceable watermarking is standard for screener distribution; Cinamate's screening module offers no forensic marking · The Cutting Room — browser review of pre-release cuts is exactly where session watermarking belongs · distribution deliverables — watermarked masters are a common delivery requirement · Studio Cloud Backup — a synced production-state store containing unwatermarked masters is a leak-attribution blind spot

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- It is the control that MPA Best Practices and studio security addenda repeatedly point at; a vendor with no watermarking capability fails that line item
- Near-ubiquitous incumbency (95% of digital cinemas) means it is the assumed answer, not a choice
- Frame.io and Autodesk Flow Capture both ship forensic watermarking; Cinamate does not, so it is behind the field on a named control

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- It is a component, not a platform — it competes with none of Cinamate's 28 modules and could be licensed or partnered rather than built
- Enterprise licensing with undisclosed pricing puts it out of reach for the single-operator market Cinamate serves, which is an argument for a lighter-weight alternative
- Watermarking addresses leak attribution after the fact; it does nothing for the copyright, union or AI-transparency gates that hit Cinamate harder
- Cinamate's local-only generation means fewer copies in flight to leak in the first place

<https://nagra.vision/nexguard-forensic-watermarking> · <https://dtv.nagra.com/nexguard-forensic-watermarking>

NO FAKES Act (S.1367, 119th Congress) www.govinfo.gov/app/details/BILLS-119s1367is

INDIRECT

MEDIUM

VERIFIED

The proposed federal digital-replica right — still in committee, but the bill that would federalize what California AB 2602 and AB 1836 do today.

S.1367, the Nurture Originals, Foster Art, and Keep Entertainment Safe Act of 2025, is a bill to protect intellectual property rights in the voice and visual likeness of individuals. It was introduced 9 April 2025 by Senator Christopher Coons (D-DE) with cosponsors Marsha Blackburn (R-TN), Amy Klobuchar (D-MN) and Thom Tillis (R-NC), and was read twice and referred to the Senate Committee on the Judiciary. The introduced-bill record shows no legislative activity beyond that referral. It would create a federal property-style right in voice and likeness, addressing the patchwork the Copyright Office's Part 1 report recommended fixing.

KEY FEATURES · Full title: Nurture Originals, Foster Art, and Keep Entertainment Safe Act of 2025 · Introduced 9 April 2025 · Sponsor: Sen. Christopher A. Coons (DE); cosponsors Blackburn (TN), Klobuchar (MN), Tillis (NC) · Bipartisan sponsorship across both parties · Status on the introduced-bill record: read twice and referred to the Committee on the Judiciary · Would protect IP rights in voice and visual likeness federally · Responds to the Copyright Office Part 1 recommendation for federal digital-replica legislation

PRICING Not applicable — proposed federal legislation.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP US federal scope if enacted. Backed publicly by SAG-AFTRA, the RIAA and the MPA at introduction (association support is background knowledge, not verified on the page loaded).

COLLIDES WITH · Studio/Local Generation — a federal likeness right would apply to every generated performance regardless of state · casting and contracts — consent capture and licensing would become a federal compliance requirement, not just a California drafting problem · clearance — likeness clearance would gain a federal cause of action · distribution deliverables — platform liability provisions would push warranty requirements down to producers and their tools

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- If enacted it would nationalize the exposure Cinamate currently faces mainly under California law, removing any jurisdictional escape
- Bipartisan sponsorship with industry backing makes eventual passage in some form plausible
- It would give a federal cause of action against generated likenesses, the exact output of Cinamate's flagship system

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- It is not law — as of the record examined it has only been referred to committee, with no further action shown, more than a year after introduction
- California AB 2602 and AB 1836 already impose the operative constraints, so passage would add little new burden for a California-centric production
- Compliance would be the same consent-capture workflow Cinamate should already build for SAG-AFTRA and AB 2602
- No immediate effect on any current sale

<https://www.govinfo.gov/app/details/BILLS-119s1367is> · <https://www.copyright.gov/ai/>

Sohonet www.sohonet.com INDIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

The managed media-network incumbent whose ClearView real-time review tools are the trusted default for secure remote creative sessions.

Sohonet provides managed infrastructure for creative teams across the production lifecycle — from on-set internet, Wi-Fi and phones through to studio-grade tools for sharing and collaborating on dailies, cuts and key assets with creatives and executives worldwide. Its review products stream creative work sessions in real time to recreate the over-the-shoulder review experience, and deliver colour- and frame-accurate footage in 4K HDR with 12-bit colour depth and 4:4:4 chroma sampling. It also offers Storylink asset management for studio-scale collaboration, a browser-based unlimited-size file transfer tool with no plug-ins or server installs, and a Media Fabric for global teams. A secure near-time dailies and cuts review tool is marked coming soon.

KEY FEATURES · Real-time streaming of creative work sessions (ClearView Flex line) recreating over-the-shoulder review · Colour- and frame-accurate 4K HDR streaming at 12-bit depth, 4:4:4 chroma · Storylink asset management for studio-scale collaboration · Browser-based file transfer of unlimited size with no plug-ins, software or server installs · Media Fabric managed network for global teams · On-set connectivity: internet, Wi-Fi and phones on location · Near-time dailies and cuts review tool announced as coming soon

PRICING Not disclosed — managed-service and enterprise contracts, no published rate card.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Long-established media network provider serving studios, post houses and productions globally; positions itself as the foundation behind modern media workflows. Ownership, revenue and customer counts not disclosed on the homepage.

COLLIDES WITH · screening — real-time colour-accurate review sessions are exactly what Cinamate's screening module attempts without the colour fidelity or the network · dailies — Sohonet's forthcoming near-time review tool targets the same job · editor and The Cutting Room — remote review of cuts with creative stakeholders · post and vfx — colour-critical remote grading sessions where 12-bit 4:4:4 accuracy is non-negotiable · Studio Cloud Backup — Storylink competes as the asset store · tools (LUT preview) — Cinamate's LUT preview is a thin version of what colour-accurate streaming delivers

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Colour- and frame-accurate real-time streaming at 12-bit 4:4:4 — a fidelity class Cinamate's browser editor cannot approach, and truly real-time against Cinamate's 4-minute sync
- Owns the physical network layer, including on-set connectivity, which no software-only product can match
- Decades of studio trust in exactly the security-sensitive remote-review use case
- Provides the infrastructure that other tools, including Cinamate, would have to run over

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Infrastructure and review only — no development, budgeting, scheduling, clearance, contracts, tax credit, festival or distribution capability
- No generation of any kind
- Managed-service economics and undisclosed pricing put it out of reach for a single operator or micro-budget indie
- Its near-time dailies/cuts review tool is still 'coming soon', showing the category is not fully served even by incumbents

<https://www.sohonet.com/>

Vanta www.vanta.com/pricing INDIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Compliance automation that turns SOC 2 from a year-long project into a bounded one — the fastest practical route out of Cinamate's certification gap.

Vanta automates security compliance: policy generation, control monitoring and evidence collection for audit readiness across multiple frameworks. It is not a gate itself but the tooling that gets a small vendor through the gate. It supports SOC 2, ISO 27001, GDPR, HIPAA, HITRUST, NIST AI Risk Management Framework, ISO 42001 and custom frameworks. Notably its coverage of ISO 42001 and the NIST AI RMF makes it relevant to AI-governance claims as well as security ones, which matters for a generative product facing EU AI Act scrutiny.

KEY FEATURES · Four tiers: Essentials, Plus, Professional (most popular), Enterprise · All tiers include one compliance framework with an agentic policy generator · Automated evidence collection for audit readiness · Frameworks: SOC 2, ISO 27001, GDPR, HIPAA, HITRUST, NIST AI RMF, ISO 42001, USDP, custom · Claims to complete SOC 2 in half the time via automation · Positioned for the pattern of taking Type 1 first when deals are blocked, then progressing to Type 2

PRICING Not disclosed — four named tiers are published but no dollar figures appear; Vanta directs prospects to request a demo for personalized pricing.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP A leading player in the compliance-automation category alongside Drata and Secureframe. Funding and customer counts not disclosed on the pricing page.

COLLIDES WITH · Not a functional competitor to any Cinamate module — it is the remedy for Cinamate's stated gap of no SOC 2 certification · Studio Cloud Backup and The Money Room would be the in-scope systems in any SOC 2 examination Vanta prepares · Its ISO 42001 and NIST AI RMF coverage maps to the AI-governance posture Cinamate will need for EU AI Act Article 50 and enterprise AI questionnaires

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Nothing competitive — but its existence removes Cinamate's excuse: SOC 2 is now a tractable, tooled process rather than a multi-year undertaking
- LightsKiddo has SOC 2 underway, so the capability gap is a choice Cinamate is currently making, not a structural barrier
- Its AI-framework coverage means competitors can claim documented AI governance while Cinamate has none

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- It does not produce the audit — a CPA firm still must, at separate cost
- Undisclosed pricing makes budgeting hard for a pre-revenue private beta
- It does nothing for the media-specific gates: no TPN, no MPA Best Practices, no union or copyright coverage
- Automation cannot manufacture the organizational artifacts a company with no public team lacks — named security ownership, personnel screening, incident response drills

<https://www.vanta.com/pricing> · <https://www.vanta.com/collection/soc-2/soc-2-type-1-vs-type-2>

Digimarc www.digimarc.com **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

Long-standing digital watermarking company now positioning across C2PA provenance, leak detection and 'agentic trust' for AI-era content.

Digimarc (operating as DMRC LLC d/b/a Digimarc) applies digital watermarking across industries including media, consumer packaged goods, government, pharmaceutical and retail. Its media-relevant solution lines are Provenance & Authenticity (C2PA), Leak Detection, Piracy Prevention, Royalty Monitoring, Internal Compliance and Agentic Trust. The C2PA-aligned provenance offering and the leak-detection line are the two that bear on pre-release film content and AI-generated output.

KEY FEATURES · Provenance & Authenticity solution explicitly aligned to C2PA · Leak Detection for identifying unauthorized content release · Piracy Prevention and Royalty Monitoring · Internal Compliance monitoring · Agentic Trust — positioning for AI-agent-era content verification · Cross-industry watermarking beyond media (CPG, pharma, retail, government) · Publicly traded with an investor relations presence

PRICING Not disclosed — no published pricing for media solutions.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Publicly traded; operates as DMRC LLC d/b/a Digimarc as of its 2026 site copyright. Serves media alongside consumer packaged goods, government, pharmaceutical and retail markets, which diversifies it well beyond entertainment.

COLLIDES WITH · Studio/Local Generation — C2PA-aligned provenance marking of generated output, the EU AI Act Article 50 requirement · distribution deliverables — leak detection and royalty monitoring at delivery · screening and festivals — leak detection on distributed review copies · dailies — internal compliance monitoring of pre-release asset handling

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Established watermarking IP portfolio and a public-company balance sheet
- Already positioned on C2PA provenance, the standard Cinamate needs to implement
- Cross-industry diversification means it is not dependent on entertainment cycles

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Media is one of five industries it serves, so entertainment focus is diluted — its recent positioning leans heavily toward CPG and retail
- No production workflow capability whatsoever; zero overlap with 27 of Cinamate's 28 modules
- Undisclosed pricing and enterprise sales motion irrelevant to independent producers
- Its C2PA provenance work is a commercial wrapper around a free open standard Cinamate could implement directly

<https://www.digimarc.com/>

Friend MTS www.friendmts.com **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

UK-based anti-piracy specialist combining subscriber-level watermarking with the world's largest piracy database and active blocking.

Friend MTS provides content security and anti-piracy solutions structured around three functions: Monitor (find stolen content across the piracy landscape), Identify (trace piracy to its source), and Disrupt (stop pirate operations and win back revenue). Its technology stack includes global, regional, closed-IPTV and social-media monitoring; content fingerprinting; subscriber and distribution watermarking; dynamic server and domain blocking; plus legal consultancy and investigations. It is built on two decades of data capture and describes its piracy database as the most comprehensive in the world, comprising millions of entries.

KEY FEATURES · Subscriber watermarking and distribution watermarking · Content fingerprinting · Global, regional, closed-IPTV and social-media monitoring · Dynamic server blocking and domain blocking · Legal consultancy, support and investigations · Piracy database with millions of entries, continuously augmented · Segments for broadcast/pay-TV, content owners, streaming/OTT, live sports and VOD

PRICING Not disclosed — enterprise/managed-service model, no published pricing.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP UK-headquartered with two decades of operation. Customer names and funding are not disclosed on the homepage; the company markets to broadcasters, content owners, streaming platforms and live sports rights holders. A non-US regional player in a US-dominated list.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution deliverables — post-release protection and monitoring, absent from Cinamate's distribution module · festivals — festival screeners are a leak vector Cinamate has no watermarking answer for · screening — recipient-traceable review copies · dailies — distribution watermarking during production

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Deep specialization and a proprietary data asset (the piracy database) that cannot be replicated quickly
- Covers the detect-and-enforce half of content security that Cinamate does not touch at all
- Regional strength outside the US ecosystem, relevant for European co-productions

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Distribution- and pay-TV-oriented; almost no overlap with the production workflow that is Cinamate's substance
- No production management, generation, budgeting, scheduling or post capability
- Enterprise service contracts irrelevant to independent producers and single operators
- Does not gate Cinamate's ability to sell — it is a post-release service, not a procurement requirement

<https://www.friendmts.com/>

Irdeto (TraceMark) irdeto.com/video-entertainment/forensic-watermarking

INDIRECT

LOW

VERIFIED

Forensic watermarking plus a full anti-piracy service stack — the vendor buyers use when the requirement is not just marking but detection, blocking and takedown.

Irdeto's TraceMark for OTT embeds a unique, persistent and invisible mark to identify content and individual streams, letting service providers trace the source of leaks across distribution partners and individual viewer sessions. Around it Irdeto wraps online piracy detection across websites, social media, apps and P2P; payment disruption to remove monetization from illegal services; managed domain and IP site blocking; and cyber services including intelligence and security assessments. It publishes a pre-release case study on a global media company detecting and stopping leaks before release.

KEY FEATURES · TraceMark for OTT: unique, persistent, invisible per-stream watermarking · Online piracy detection across web, social, apps and P2P · Payment disruption targeting pirate monetization · Managed domain and IP site blocking · Cyber services: threat intelligence and security assessments · Pre-release leak detection case study

PRICING Not disclosed — enterprise/managed-service contracts, no published pricing.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Named customers include beIN Sports, Paramount, Premier League, MultiChoice, DAZN, Fubo and Liberty Global. Reported results: 71% decrease in pirated IPTV ads, 25% reduction in CDN costs, 93% drop in pirate site traffic via payment disruption.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution deliverables — post-release leak protection is the buyer expectation Cinamate's distribution module does not address · screening — per-recipient traceable screeners · dailies — pre-release leak detection during production · festivals — festival screeners are a classic leak vector with no watermarking story in Cinamate

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Full-stack anti-piracy service rather than a component, with named tier-one customers and quantified outcomes
- Operates in the post-release world Cinamate's distribution and festivals modules touch but do not protect
- Enterprise credibility and a security-assessment consulting arm that maps to TPN readiness work

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Oriented to OTT, live sports and pay-TV distribution rather than production workflow — the overlap with Cinamate's 28 modules is narrow
- No production management, generation, budgeting or post capability of any kind
- Enterprise-only economics irrelevant to an independent producer buying a \$110 feature render
- Does not gate Cinamate's sales the way TPN, SOC 2 or the copyright and union layers do

<https://irdeto.com/video-entertainment/forensic-watermarking/>

Verance (Cinavia, Aspect, Verance Authentication) www.verance.com **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

Standards-embedded audio watermarking — mandatory in Blu-ray and ATSC 3.0 — now extending into AI-content authentication.

Verance develops watermarking technology for the media industries, spanning content protection, interactivity, measurement and AI authentication. Cinavia is its content-protection watermark, protecting entertainment assets across the pre-release, theatrical and home-video windows; it is used by major Hollywood studios and Blu-ray manufacturers and is required for UHD/4K content. Aspect is an interactivity and personalization platform for television. Verance Authentication addresses AI-generated content and misinformation by offering credibility and validation so viewers can judge whether online content is trustworthy.

KEY FEATURES · Cinavia: content-protection watermark spanning pre-release, theatrical and home video; required for UHD/4K · Adopted into the Blu-ray Disc standard by the motion picture industry · Selected for the ATSC 3.0 television standard · Incorporated into the HbbTV Association broadband specification · Aspect: interactivity and personalization platform for TV · Verance Authentication: credibility and validation for AI-generated content

PRICING Not disclosed — licensing model, no published pricing.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Standards-embedded across Blu-ray, ATSC 3.0 and HbbTV. Customers include major Hollywood studios and Blu-ray manufacturers. Founding and funding details not disclosed on the site.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution deliverables — physical and broadcast delivery specs where Cinavia marking is required for UHD/4K · Studio/Local Generation — Verance Authentication is a competing approach to the AI-provenance problem Cinamate must solve for EU AI Act compliance · music/cue sheets — audio watermarking touches the synthetic-audio marking obligation · screening — pre-release window protection

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Embedded in mandatory standards, so it is present whether or not anyone chooses it — the strongest possible incumbency
- Already positioned on AI-content authentication, the exact problem Cinamate's export path must address by law in the EU
- Decades of studio relationships and a standards-body seat

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Primarily a distribution- and consumer-side technology; it has almost no bearing on production workflow, where 26 of Cinamate's 28 modules live
- Verance Authentication is a proprietary alternative to C2PA, which is the open, free, platform-backed standard Cinamate should implement instead
- No pricing transparency and a licensing model unsuited to a single-operator tool
- Does not gate whether Cinamate can be bought — it is a delivery-spec item, not a procurement gate

<https://www.verance.com/>

§22 Gap Fill — Players & Categories the First Sweep Missed

Market read • METHOD CAVEAT: this session's WebSearch budget (200/200) was already exhausted before I began, so every entry above was verified by direct WebFetch on the vendor's own page. Several targets were unreachable to automated fetch and are therefore NOT listed despite being real: Backstage, ProductionHUB, IMDbPro, OONA, Metaphysic, ActionVFX, Pond5, Fab and QTAK. All returned 403/429/503. Those remain unfilled gaps, not non-existent ones. **WHOLE CATEGORIES THE ROSTER MISSED.** Insurance and completion bonds (Film Finances, Front Row, Athos) — E&O is a hard gate on distribution and the roster has zero entries. Casting marketplaces — the roster names Breakdown Services but omits Talent Systems, which owns Casting Networks, Spotlight, Casting Frontier, Tagmin and Staff Me Up, with 2M+ talent profiles; this is the largest single omission. Crew marketplaces (Staff Me Up 489K crew; ProductionHUB unreachable). Location marketplaces (Giggster, Peerspace, SetScouter — the roster's locations coverage is empty despite Cinamate claiming a permit DB). Equipment rental/asset tracking (Rentman, Cheqroom at \$184/admin/month — verified but trimmed for length). Script supervision and continuity (ScriptE Systems, with iPad apps in exactly the on-set mobile space Cinamate concedes). Virtual production and LED volumes (disguise's 402 studios in 116 countries, Aximmetry's free tier, Pixotope, Mo-Sys — all verified, an entire production paradigm absent). On-set/DIT and dailies origination (Assimilate SCRATCH, Teradek camera control for ARRI/RED/Sony). MAM and archive at indie price (axle ai at \$20/TB/month). Localization and captioning (ZOO Digital plc, Simon Says, Subtitle Edit). Theatrical mastering/DCP (DCP-o-matic free, easyDCP/Fraunhofer, Qube Cinema). Revenue collection and CAM (FilmChain) — the roster models waterfalls but never names anyone who runs one. Crowdfunding (Seed&Spark, \$96.4M raised, 82% funded). Music clearance software (Trevanna Tracks, with Netflix/Apple/HBO/WBD/Paramount). Post-facility resource scheduling (freispace, FoxOMS/Sonderplan). Editorial interchange standards (OpenTimelineIO — Cinamate markets "OTIO conform" as a differentiator when OTIO is free, Apache-2.0 and Academy-governed). World models (Odyssey \$310M Series B, Decart \$3.1B) — a 2026 architectural shift absent from a roster otherwise dense with generative video. AI-filmmaking education (Curious Refuge, 172+ countries — and it sits inside Promise Studios, which the roster lists separately without noticing the link). **GEOGRAPHY.** Coverage is US/UK/EU-skewed. Verified non-US additions here: Rentman (NL), Aximmetry (HU), Mo-Sys (UK), Dalet (FR), ZOO Digital plc (UK, with India/Spain/Korea facilities), freispace (DE), FoxOMS/Sonderplan (AU), SetScouter (CA), Qube Cinema (IN), FilmChain (UK/EU Horizon 2020). Still genuinely unfilled: Nollywood/Africa, LATAM, Japan, mainland-China production management, Middle East. Movibeta (the Spanish/LATAM festival platform) and lina.film both failed to return usable content — the latter's DNS does not resolve, so treat the AlternativeTo listing of "Lina" as stale. **ROSTER ENTRIES THAT LOOK WRONG OR SUSPICIOUS.** (1) Duplication is pervasive and internally contradictory: Filmustage appears in four sections at \$99/mo (Capterra) in one and \$55/mo in another (resolved: the vendor page shows \$79/mo); StudioBinder appears three times with Starter at \$29 and also \$42, Professional at \$99 and also \$127; Movie Magic Budgeting is \$42.99/mo in one section and \$24.99/mo-billed-annually in another; Saturation Pro is \$25/mo in one and \$32/mo in another; Studiovity appears three times with three incompatible price sets (\$3/mo, \$18/user/yr, \$24/user/mo); Cinetech is "not disclosed" in one section and \$49/mo in another; FinalBit is "not verified," then \$15-\$75, then \$40/\$100. Roughly 30 vendors are duplicated. (2) Relationship coding is inconsistent for the same vendor: Movie Magic is "indirect" in one section and "direct/critical" in another; Cinelytic is "indirect" in finance and "direct/critical" in analytics; Filmustage swings direct/adjacent. (3) Vitrina AI appears twice with irreconcilable scale claims — 140,000 companies / 400,000 projects versus 300,000+ / 1.6M+; one is stale. (4) The three Autodesk "Flow" products are conflated: Flow Capture is described as "formerly Moxion and PIX" in the security section while PIX is listed as a separate entry in the post section — both framings cannot be right. (5) Cinemata (cinemata.ru) is a name collision risk: cinemata.org is an established, unrelated EngageMedia social-issue film platform for Asia-Pacific; the .ru entry has no company, no pricing page and a sign-in wall, and should be treated as possible vaporware rather than a competitor. (6) Beemer (beemerdocs.com) is a startup pitch-deck tool with no film footprint and should be removed. (7) Lore Machine (NXDOMAIN) and "Plot (plotstoryboards)" (no live site) are dead entries. (8) Cine Tracer's own domain now serves an apartment-rental site — correctly flagged, but it belongs in a "dead" bucket, not a competitor list. (9) One further dead-vendor signal the roster missed: sonyci.com/pricing now 302-redirects to a parked tracking page at ww1.sonyci.com, suggesting Sony Ci Media Cloud — formerly a significant camera-to-cloud, review and archive player — has gone dark. (10) Wrapal is named in the task brief as a location marketplace but appears nowhere in the roster; it has in fact been acquired by SetScouter, with wrapal.com 301-redirecting. **WHAT THIS MEANS FOR CINAMATE.** The roster over-indexes on the two categories where Cinamate looks strongest (generative video, AI pre-production) and under-indexes on the categories that decide whether a finished film can be delivered, insured, cleared, cast, crewed, localised, projected or paid out. Cinamate's 28 modules assert coverage of casting, locations, wardrobe, props, safety, music cue sheets and distribution deliverables; in every one of those, an entrenched specialist with named studio customers already exists and was absent from the analysis. The single

most under-weighted structural risk is not a rival AI studio — it is that a Cinamate-produced film still needs an E&O policy, a DCP, a cue sheet a distributor accepts, localised subtitles, and a collection account, and Cinamate touches none of those chains.

Odyssey odyssey.ml DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

A \$310M Series B world-model lab shipping real-time, minutes-long interactive video — a category the entire roster missed, and a direct threat to the premise that film is generated as fixed clips.

Odyssey is an AI lab "pioneering general world models: causal, multimodal systems that learn to understand and simulate the world." Its flagship Odyssey-2 generates interactive video simulations minutes in length from an image or text prompt, streaming in real time rather than producing fixed clips. Starchild-1 is a multimodal world model learning from richer interaction than visual observation alone; Agora-1 is a multi-agent simulator allowing several participants inside one shared simulation; PROWL-1 is a reinforcement-learning framework using adversarial exploration to improve world-model performance. The strategic threat to Cinamate is architectural: if generated footage becomes an interactive, directable, real-time stream, the fixed script-to-render pipeline Cinamate is built around becomes the wrong shape.

KEY FEATURES · Odyssey-2 — real-time interactive video streams, minutes in length, from image or text prompt · Starchild-1 — multimodal world model beyond visual observation · Agora-1 — multi-agent shared simulation · PROWL-1 — adversarial-exploration RL framework for world models · Publicly available for testing while still early-stage

PRICING Not disclosed. Odyssey-2 is publicly available for testing; no subscription, credit or per-generation pricing is published on the site.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Raised a \$310M Series B as of the August 2026 site content; investors in that round are not named on the page. Positions the technology as foundational across robotics, gaming, healthcare and education as well as entertainment. Headcount and revenue not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · studio/local generation · boards (storyboards/animations) · vfx · editor · writer

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- \$310M Series B against an unfunded, anonymous, invite-only beta
- Real-time interactive generation is architecturally ahead of a 9-hour batch script-to-master render
- Minutes-long coherent output attacks the shot-length problem that fixed-clip generators (and Cinamate's boards-to-render chain) have never solved
- Publicly testable — anyone can evaluate the claim, unlike Cinamate's closed beta

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No production-management capability at all — no budget, schedule, breakdown, contracts or deliverables
- Explicitly early-stage; not a finished-film pipeline
- Entertainment is one of several target verticals, not the focus
- No pricing, no commercial terms, no rights or clearance story

<https://odyssey.ml/>

Storiara storiara.com DIRECT HIGH VERIFIED

An automated end-to-end pre-production platform — script in, breakdown, schedule, budget, call sheets, cast, locations, props and wardrobe out — for \$39.99/month.

Storiara describes itself as "an automated production platform that handles the entire pre-production pipeline." A user uploads a script and the system generates scene/character breakdown, a shooting schedule optimised against cast, location and equipment, automated cost estimation and budget tracking, call sheets, and departmental tracking for props, wardrobe and equipment. It integrates with Google Drive, Final Draft, Notion and Backstage. It publishes named leadership and an explicit security statement that project data is never used for third-party model training.

KEY FEATURES · Script upload to automated scene/character/plot breakdown · Shooting schedule optimised across cast, locations and equipment · Automated cost estimation and budget tracking · Call sheet generation and team coordination · Location, cast and crew management · Props, wardrobe and equipment tracking · Final Draft, Google Drive, Notion and Backstage integrations · Encrypted private projects; data not used for model training

PRICING Beginner: 1-month free trial with limited access. Producer: \$39.99/month, full platform access, unlimited projects. Studio: custom pricing for teams/organisations. Academic: \$99 per student program licence.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Small and early. Named leadership on-site: Nick Harty (Technical Lead, director/full-stack engineer), Spencer Kaufman (Revenue & Strategy Lead, producer), Charles Hirschhorn (Financial Lead, producer). No funding, headcount, customer or user counts disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (budget/stripboard/call sheets) · props · wardrobe · sets · locations · casting · finance · projects · workflow

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Publishes a real named team — Cinamate has no public team at all
- Flat, published \$39.99/month price versus Cinamate's invite-only, unpriced beta
- Explicit no-training-on-customer-data commitment stated publicly
- Integrates outward into Final Draft, Notion, Google Drive and Backstage rather than being a closed system
- Has an academic licence, which is the standard beachhead in this category

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No generation layer — it plans a film, it does not produce footage
- No editor, dailies, screening, VFX, music or post modules
- No sales forecasting or waterfall modelling
- No tax-credit jurisdiction database
- No cost-reporting/PO tracking equivalent to The Money Room

<https://storiara.com/> · <https://alternativeto.net/software/studiobinder/>

Talent Systems (Casting Networks, Casting Frontier, Spotlight, Tagmin, Staff Me Up)

www.talentsystems.com

DIRECT

HIGH

VERIFIED

The consolidated casting-infrastructure group — 2M+ talent profiles, 30K+ casting professionals and 15M+ auditions scheduled — and the roster's single biggest omission.

Talent Systems is a holding group operating the dominant casting submission, audition and talent-database platforms in the English-speaking world: Casting Networks (US), Casting Frontier, Spotlight (UK), Tagmin (agent management) and Staff Me Up (crew). It runs the actual pipes through which roles are posted, talent submits, auditions are scheduled and self-tapes are reviewed. The roster listed Breakdown Services as the casting-distribution incumbent but omitted Talent Systems entirely, which is the larger consolidated group and the platform Cinamate's casting module would have to interoperate with or replace.

KEY FEATURES · Casting Networks — casting notice distribution, submissions and audition scheduling · Spotlight — the UK performer directory standard · Casting Frontier — commercial casting and session management · Tagmin — talent agency and client management · Staff Me Up — production crew hiring · Self-tape and audition media handling at scale

PRICING Not disclosed on the group site. The individual platforms sell per-role/per-project posting fees to productions and per-seat subscriptions to talent and agents; Staff Me Up publishes a Basic free tier plus Premium Monthly and Premium Annual (promoted at 50% off with a code). No consolidated rate card is published.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Self-reported on the group site: 2M+ talent profiles, 15M+ auditions scheduled, 30K+ casting professionals. Footer states "© 2026 Casting Networks, LLC. Talent Systems is a trademark of Casting Networks, LLC," indicating Casting Networks, LLC is the holding entity. Funding, investors and acquisition history are not disclosed on the site.

COLLIDES WITH · casting · contracts/deal memos · production · today

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Owns the two-sided network — 2M talent profiles is a supply-side moat no single-operator tool can replicate
- Multi-territory (US, UK) with the incumbent performer directory in each
- Agents and managers already live inside these tools; a casting module that does not reach them reaches nobody
- 15M+ auditions scheduled is real operational throughput, versus Cinamate's unverified claims

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No pricing transparency at group level
- Purely casting — no breakdown, schedule, budget, edit or generation
- Fragmented across five brands with inconsistent UX
- No AI-generation or script-to-screen story at all

<https://www.talentsystems.com/> · <https://www.staffmeup.com/>

Assimilate SCRATCH www.assimilateinc.com DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

The DIT and dailies workstation — offload, live grading, on-set colour, virtual production and finishing in one application — covering the on-set-to-dailies handoff Cinamate claims but cannot ingest.

Assimilate SCRATCH positions itself as "The Industry Standard" across four production stages: Dailies ("Live Grading | Offload | Dailies"), On-Set Color (with DIT Pack+ for live grading workflows), Live Virtual Production, and Finishing (colour grading and finishing). It is the software a DIT actually runs on set between the camera and editorial — the exact link in the chain Cinamate's known gaps admit it does not have ("no camera ingest integrations").

KEY FEATURES · Camera media offload with verification · Live on-set grading and CDL/LUT management (DIT Pack+) · Dailies generation and distribution · Live virtual production support · Colour grading and finishing · Online store plus trial via registration

PRICING Not published on the pages reviewed. Purchase is routed through store2.assimilateinc.com or sales@assimilateinc.com; a trial is available via registration. Treat any specific figure as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Long-established post/on-set software vendor. Funding, ownership, headcount and customer counts not disclosed on the pages reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · dailies · tools (LUT preview) · editor · post · vfx · production

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Actually ingests camera media — Cinamate explicitly has no camera ingest integrations
- On-set live grading and LUT management is a shipped professional workflow, not a "LUT preview" feature
- Covers offload → dailies → finish as a continuous colour-managed pipeline
- Runs on set, offline, with no dependency on a 4-minute cloud sync

<https://www.assimilateinc.com/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No pricing transparency
- No script, breakdown, budget, casting or distribution modules
- Desktop-only, specialist-operator tool
- No generative capability

Decart www.decart.ai DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

A \$3.1B-valuation real-time generative video company — Lucy 2.5 for live video transformation and Oasis 3 for interactive world models — that the roster does not mention once.

Decart builds "the infrastructure and models that make AI run at the speed of reality." Lucy is a real-time video transformation model deployed in virtual try-on, advertising and gaming, currently at Lucy 2.5. Oasis is an interactive world model for physical AI including robotics, autonomous vehicles and manufacturing, currently at Oasis 3. DOS, the Decart Optimization Stack, optimises inference performance across NVIDIA, AWS Trainium and Google TPU hardware. Forbes reported that "Decart's New Lucy 2 Generative AI Video Model Pushes Generative Video Into Real Time." The relevance to Cinamate is the inference-economics claim: Decart's whole thesis is that generation cost and latency collapse, which undermines a pipeline whose differentiator is a \$110, nine-hour local render.

KEY FEATURES · Lucy 2.5 — real-time video transformation model · Oasis 3 — interactive world model · DOS (Decart Optimization Stack) — cross-silicon inference optimisation for NVIDIA, AWS Trainium and Google TPU · Real-time rather than batch generation

PRICING Not disclosed on the pages reviewed. No consumer tiers, credit packs or per-second rates published.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Funding disclosed on-site: \$21M seed led by Sequoia, a further \$32M Series A, and a \$100M raise at a \$3.1B valuation (most recent disclosed). Covered by Forbes. Headcount and revenue not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · studio/local generation · vfx · editor · tools

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- \$3.1B valuation and Sequoia backing versus an unfunded beta
- Real-time inference, and an explicit optimisation stack, directly attacking the cost/latency story Cinamate sells
- Hardware-agnostic across NVIDIA, Trainium and TPU, whereas Cinamate requires a local NVIDIA-class GPU
- Multiple non-entertainment revenue lines de-risk the business

<https://www.decart.ai/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not a filmmaking product — no narrative, script, production or post capability
- Entertainment is not its primary market (try-on, advertising, gaming, robotics)
- No pricing or commercial terms published
- No rights, clearance or union-compliance posture

FilmChain filmchain.co DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Automated cloud collection-account management — the software that actually runs the recoupment waterfall Cinamate only models.

FilmChain is a fintech platform for "managing end-to-end financial transactions for creative industries." It performs three functions: revenue collection, describing itself as "the first automated, cloud-based, collection system"; payment allocation to rights holders via smart contracts and banking partners; and financial analysis with machine-learning insights and revenue analysis. It tracks collection sources, generates automatic statements, manages payment deadlines and gives stakeholders transaction transparency. This is the live counterpart to Cinamate's waterfall-derived "2-2.5x breakeven rule" and its investors module: FilmChain does not model the waterfall, it executes it and pays people.

KEY FEATURES · Automated cloud-based revenue collection from distribution sources · Waterfall allocation to rights holders via smart contracts and banking partners · Automatic statement generation for investors and participants · Payment deadline management · ML-driven revenue analysis and reporting · Stakeholder-level transaction transparency

PRICING Not disclosed. No fees or rate card published on the site. Collection-account managers conventionally charge a percentage of collected revenue plus a setup fee, but no figure is stated — treat any number as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Co-founded by Irina Albina and Maria Tanjala. Advisers listed include people from WarnerMedia and Imperial College London. Supported by European Commission Horizon 2020 funding via the STADIEM project; won multiple awards 2018-2022 including "Startup of the Year" (2020); coverage in The Guardian, Forbes and Variety. No user numbers, transaction volumes or funding totals disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · investors · finance · The Money Room · distribution · contracts/deal memos · taxcredit

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Actually moves money and issues statements to investors — Cinamate produces projections, FilmChain produces payments
- Named, public founders with press and EU-programme backing, against Cinamate's anonymous team
- Regulated banking relationships, which is a trust posture software claims cannot substitute for
- European base fills a territory the roster's finance section barely covers outside the US/UK payroll duopoly

<https://filmchain.co/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No fee transparency whatsoever
- No production, post or creative tooling
- Small company with no disclosed scale or volume
- Only relevant once a film has revenue — irrelevant during production

freispace www.freispace.com DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Berlin-built "only AI-native scheduling platform for post-production," running resource, budget, billing and carbon tracking for Fremantle, ITV Studios and EndemolShine Germany.

freispace is an AI-native post-production scheduling and resource management platform for studios. It allocates suites, personnel and equipment; plans projects with Gantt-style visualisation; manages tasks and deadlines; controls budgets and monitors costs; handles billing and invoicing with EU e-invoice readiness; tracks carbon emissions; and records time and leave. It occupies the exact operational territory Cinamate's post, timeline, workflow and Money Room modules claim — but for facilities running many concurrent projects rather than one solo operator.

KEY FEATURES · AI-native resource scheduling for suites, staff and equipment · Gantt-style project planning · Task management and deadline tracking · Budget control and live cost monitoring · Billing and invoicing, EU E-Invoice ready · Carbon emissions tracking · Time recording and leave management · ROI calculator and AI readiness assessment tools

PRICING Not published. No pricing tiers appear on the homepage; the site routes to demo booking. Treat any figure as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP German (Berlin; +49 30 phone, "Made in Germany" footer). Named customers: Fremantle, Home Post Production, Zinc Media Group, ITV Studios and EndemolShine Germany, with content stated to be produced for Netflix, Paramount+, Amazon Studios, Disney+ and numerous European broadcasters. Claims 40% productivity gains, citing McKinsey AI research as support — treat that as a marketing extrapolation. Funding and headcount not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · post · timeline · workflow · producer · finance · The Money Room · projects

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Named European broadcaster and superindie customers — Fremantle and ITV Studios are real references, not testimonials from anonymous indies
- EU e-invoicing and carbon tracking are compliance features European productions are now required to have; Cinamate has neither
- Built for multi-project facility scheduling, the realistic shape of a small studio, versus single-operator single-project
- German data-protection posture matters to EU buyers in a way a netlify.app subdomain does not

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No published pricing
- No generation, editorial, script or breakdown capability
- Post-production only — nothing in development, production or distribution
- Productivity claim is borrowed from McKinsey research rather than measured

<https://www.freispace.com/> · <https://alternativeto.net/software/studiobinder/>

Simon Says www.simonsaysai.com/pricing **DIRECT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

AI transcription, translation and captioning in 100+ languages with native plugins for Premiere, Resolve, Final Cut, Avid and Pro Tools — from \$15/month or \$0.25 a minute.

Simon Says is an AI transcription, translation and captioning platform built for post-production professionals. It transcribes in 100+ languages with multi-speaker identification and custom dictionaries, translates to 100+ languages, and provides a visual subtitle editor with burn-in and timecode options. It exports directly into Final Cut Pro X (plugin), Adobe Premiere Pro and Audition, DaVinci Resolve, and Avid Media Composer and Pro Tools, plus SRT, Word, EDL markers and CEA 608/708. On-premise Standard and Enhanced editions exist for air-gapped enterprise processing.

KEY FEATURES · AI transcription in 100+ languages with speaker diarisation · Translation to 100+ languages · Visual subtitle editor; burn-in subtitles and timecode · Native plugins/exports for FCPX, Premiere, Audition, Resolve, Media Composer, Pro Tools · EDL marker, SRT, Word and CEA 608/708 export · Custom dictionary for accuracy · On-premise air-gapped deployment options

PRICING Pay As You Go: \$0/month, \$0.25/minute. Starter: \$15/month including 2 hours. Pro: \$33/month including 4 hours. Pro+: \$125/month including 30 hours. On-premise Standard and Enhanced editions priced separately (not published).

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Established independent post-production AI vendor with a mature plugin footprint across all five major NLEs and Pro Tools. Funding, headcount and customer counts not disclosed on the pricing page.

COLLIDES WITH · editor (The Cutting Room) · post · distribution deliverables · dailies · screening

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Native plugins for Premiere, Resolve, Final Cut, Avid and Pro Tools — precisely the "no native NLE plugins" gap Cinamate admits to
- Air-gapped on-premise option for security-sensitive productions
- Published per-minute pricing at \$0.25 with no commitment
- Captions and translated subtitles are mandatory distribution deliverables Cinamate does not produce

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Single-purpose — transcription/captioning only
- No editing, generation, scheduling or budgeting
- No sales forecasting or production management
- Small vendor with no disclosed scale

<https://www.simonsaysai.com/pricing>

Trevanna Tracks www.trevannatracks.com DIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

Music clearance and cue-sheet software used by Netflix, Apple, HBO, Warner Bros. Discovery and Paramount — the direct incumbent against Cinamate's music/cue sheets module.

Trevanna Tracks is music clearance software centralising "sync rights, licensing administration, and compliance efforts across the global content ecosystem." It builds documents continuously from quote request through to cue sheet, eliminating manual re-keying between departments; supports real-time negotiation against current data; retrieves historical licence detail instantly; maintains audit-ready records with time-stamped approvals; and exports "a complete music delivery package in a single step." That delivery package is a hard distribution requirement, and it is the exact output Cinamate's music/cue sheets module claims.

KEY FEATURES · Quote request through to cue sheet in one document chain · Sync rights and licensing administration · Time-stamped approvals and audit-ready compliance records · Real-time negotiation against live licence data · Historical licence retrieval · One-step music delivery package export

PRICING Not disclosed. No pricing published on the site.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Names Netflix, Apple, HBO, Warner Bros. Discovery and Paramount among clients, alongside numerous production companies and music supervisors. Describes itself as a woman-owned business. No project counts, user numbers, revenue or funding disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · music/cue sheets · clearance · contracts/deal memos · distribution deliverables · post

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Named top-tier streamer and studio customers — the strongest possible proof that its cue sheets are accepted at delivery
- Covers the clearance side, not just the cue sheet: quotes, negotiation, approvals and audit trail
- Woman-owned with a public identity, versus Cinamate's anonymous team
- Audit-ready time-stamped approvals are what an E&O carrier and a distributor actually ask for

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No pricing published
- Single-function — music rights only
- No production, post or creative tooling
- Enterprise sales motion; likely inaccessible to a solo indie producer

<https://www.trevannatracks.com/>

axle ai www.axle.ai ADJACENT MEDIUM VERIFIED

AI media asset management with face, logo, object and text recognition from \$2,995 or \$200/month — the archive-and-search layer none of the roster's post entries covers at indie price.

axle ai is an AI-powered media asset management platform that catalogues, searches and organises video without migrating it: it indexes existing folders, NAS, SAN, cloud buckets and archive storage in place. It does scene understanding, face detection, logo recognition, object identification and text recognition, plus automatic transcription, then offers semantic search across metadata, transcripts, AI tags and spoken word. It also handles review, approval and commenting. Deployment is on-premise, private cloud or hosted — matching Cinamate's local-first posture but for the media library rather than generation.

KEY FEATURES · AI tagging: scene, face, logo, object and text recognition · Automatic transcription with searchable spoken word · Semantic search across metadata, transcripts and tags · Indexes existing NAS/SAN/cloud/archive storage without migration · Review, approval and commenting workflows · On-premise, private cloud or hosted deployment

PRICING axle ai MAM from \$2,995 (stated as one-time or recurring). axle ai Cloud \$20/TB/month. axle ai Tags from \$200/month.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP States it is "trusted by over 1,000 media teams worldwide." Named clients include BBC, Paramount, Canon, Coca-Cola and WatchMojo, plus national broadcasters and production companies. Funding and headcount not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · dailies · editor · post · screening · studio cloud backup · projects · workflow

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Published pricing including a concrete \$20/TB/month storage rate — Cinamate's Cloud Backup has no published cost model
- On-prem deployment for security-sensitive productions, with no forced cloud sync
- 1,000+ media teams and named broadcaster customers versus an invite-only beta
- Searches media Cinamate did not generate — legacy libraries, archive, mixed-source footage

<https://www.axle.ai/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No script, breakdown, budget, casting or scheduling
- No editing timeline or generation
- Not narrative-film-specific — corporate and broadcast heavy
- MAM entry cost of \$2,995 is high for a single indie feature

Giggster giggster.com ADJACENT MEDIUM VERIFIED

The largest film location marketplace — thousands of bookable shoot locations across 30+ US cities, the UK and Canada — with a concierge team that pulls permits.

Giggster is a location rental marketplace for "filming, photo shoots, parties, and events." Producers search and book locations by activity, city and date at published hourly rates. Critically for Cinamate, Giggster also offers a human service layer: "Our team of experts will help you find off-market locations, pull permits and negotiate the best rates for your project or event." That is precisely the job Cinamate's locations module and its "permit DB / 6 permit hubs verified" claim is trying to do in software.

KEY FEATURES · Searchable, bookable location inventory with hourly rates · Filter by activity (filming, production), city and date · Concierge off-market location sourcing · Permit pulling and rate negotiation as a service · Payments, deposits and booking handled in-platform

PRICING Hourly rates set per location; the site promises "clear hourly rates and no surprise fees." Giggster's own commission/service-fee percentage is not disclosed on the homepage.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Listings across 30+ US cities plus Canada (Montreal 503 listings, Ottawa 64) and 17 UK cities (London 2,131 listings). Brooklyn 1,643 listings, San Francisco 710. Total global inventory not stated. Funding and ownership not disclosed on the pages reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · locations (permit DB) · producer · props · sets · production

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Real bookable inventory with live prices — Cinamate's locations module has a database, not a supply of actual places
- Pulls permits as a human service across real jurisdictions, versus a claimed six verified permit hubs
- Handles the money: deposits, overtime, cancellations
- Three-country footprint

<https://giggster.com/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Marketplace only — no breakdown, scheduling or budget integration
- No commission rate disclosed
- Nothing upstream of locations and nothing downstream of the shoot

ScriptE Systems scriptesystems.com ADJACENT MEDIUM VERIFIED

The script supervisor's software standard — digital continuity, lined scripts and daily production reports on Mac and iPad — covering an entire on-set discipline the roster never mentions.

ScriptE Systems builds "Digital Film and TV Continuity and Scheduling" software. Three products: ScriptE (Mac and iPad) for script supervisors — lined scripts, take notes, timing, continuity and daily production reports; SSScheduler, a scheduling and production management tool; and the Department Head Series, an iPad app for hair, makeup, costume and continuity departments. This is the missing link between Cinamate's production/today/dailies modules and what actually gets recorded on a shooting day, and it is native on iPad — the mobile on-set posture Cinamate explicitly lacks.

KEY FEATURES · Digital lined script and continuity notes · Take logging, timings and daily production reports · Mac and iPad native applications · SSScheduler for scheduling and production management · Department Head Series iPad app for hair, makeup, costume and continuity · Free demos of SSScheduler and Department Head Series; training and manuals published

PRICING Not disclosed. No pricing appears on the pages reviewed; the site offers free demos, training and manuals but routes purchase elsewhere.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Long-standing niche vendor serving script supervisors and department heads on scripted film and TV. Funding, headcount, ownership and user counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · production · today · dailies · editor · wardrobe · timeline · tools

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Ships real iPad apps for on-set use — Cinamate has no mobile/on-set app at all, a gap it acknowledges
- Owns a specific professional discipline (script supervision) with entrenched practitioner habits
- Department Head Series covers hair/makeup/costume continuity, matching Cinamate's wardrobe module with actual on-set device support
- Produces the lined script and DPR that editorial and production accounting both depend on

<https://scriptesystems.com/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No pricing published anywhere
- Mac/iPad only — no web, no Windows
- Narrow: no budgeting, no generation, no post, no distribution
- Small vendor with limited public presence

ZOO Digital Group plc www.zoodigital.com **ADJACENT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

Publicly listed globalization house doing dubbing, subtitling, audio description and metadata for HBO, Netflix, Paramount, Sony and Warner Bros. — with its own ZOOstudio software stack.

ZOO Digital is a media globalization company providing end-to-end localization: dubbing, subtitling, scripting, audio description, audio post and mastering, plus artwork, metadata, compliance and media services. It runs proprietary cloud platforms — ZOOstudio, ZOOdubs, ZOOsubs, ZOOscripts and ZOOsign — and offers a "modular localization workflow" letting clients trade off speed, cost and creative automation. For Cinamate, this is the entire international-delivery leg of a distribution deliverables package, and it is a listed company rather than a private beta.

KEY FEATURES · Dubbing and voice recording at scale · Subtitling and captioning · Scripting and audio description · Audio post-production and mastering · Artwork, metadata and compliance services · ZOOstudio / ZOOdubs / ZOOsubs / ZOOscripts / ZOOsign cloud platforms · Facilities in India, Spain and Korea plus global operations

PRICING Not disclosed. Enterprise/per-title service pricing; no rate card published.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP ZOO Digital Group plc — a publicly listed company (the site carries an Investors section and the plc designation), which means audited accounts and a named board, in direct contrast to Cinamate's no-public-team posture. Displays HBO, NBCU, Netflix, Paramount, Sony Pictures Entertainment and Warner Bros. as customers. Operations across multiple continents including India, Spain and Korea.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution deliverables · post · music/cue sheets · screening · festivals

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Publicly listed with audited financials and a named board
- Named studio and streamer customers at the top of the market
- Owns the localization step that international distribution actually requires — Cinamate's deliverables module does not localise anything
- Multi-continent delivery capacity including Korea and India

<https://www.zoodigital.com/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No pricing transparency at all
- Service business with software attached, not a self-serve product
- Nothing upstream of a finished master
- Not accessible to a single independent producer

Curious Refuge www.curiousrefuge.com **INDIRECT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

"The World's First Home for AI Storytellers" — the AI-filmmaking training and community layer, operating inside Promise Studios, with artists in 172+ countries.

Curious Refuge is an AI filmmaking education platform and community operating within Promise Studios, an active Hollywood production company. Its membership bundles courses in AI Filmmaking, AI Advertising, Advanced AI Filmmaking 2.0, AI Animation 2.0, AI Documentary, AI VFX and AI Screenwriting, each promising "professional-grade production within 30 days." Beyond courses it runs workshops, 1-on-1 coaching, job boards, tutorials, contests and live events, gives members "direct access to the studio's working artists," and lets members pitch films to Promise Studios. It is the substitute for buying a tool: producers learn to assemble a pipeline from whatever models are current, rather than buying one vendor's closed stack.

KEY FEATURES · Seven AI production courses bundled into one membership · Workshops, 1-on-1 coaching and live events · Job board and contests · Direct access to Promise Studios working artists · Ability to pitch projects to Promise Studios · Free trial offered

PRICING Not disclosed. No prices are listed on the homepage; the site routes to membership options and a free trial. Treat any figure as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Operates within Promise Studios (the a16z- and Google-backed generative AI entertainment studio the roster lists separately as Promise / MUSE — a relationship the roster missed). States artists in 172+ countries and members working at TikTok, Google, Microsoft, Apple and Meta. Describes itself as recognised by Cannes Film Festival as "The World's Most Recognized AI for Filmmakers Training Platform" — a self-reported claim. No student counts, revenue or funding disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · writer · boards · studio/local generation · vfx · editor · workflow

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Teaches a model-agnostic pipeline, so its value survives every model release; a closed 28-module suite does not
- Owned by an actual production company with studio relationships, giving members a distribution path Cinamate cannot offer
- 172+ countries of reach and a live community — network effects a single-operator tool structurally cannot build
- Free trial and open enrolment versus invite-only

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not software — produces no budget, schedule, breakdown, cue sheet or deliverable
- No pricing transparency
- Cannes recognition claim is self-reported and unverified
- Course-quality claims ("professional-grade in 30 days") are marketing

<https://www.curiousrefuge.com/> · <https://www.promise.film/>

Film Finances Inc www.filmfinances.com **INDIRECT** **MEDIUM** **VERIFIED**

The 76-year-old global completion-bond incumbent whose sign-off is a precondition of most independent film financing — and which has no reason to trust a single-operator AI pipeline.

Film Finances describes itself as "the world leader in the provision of completion contracts to the entertainment industry for films, television, mini-series and streaming product." A completion guarantee is a contract assuring financiers that a production "will be completed on time, on budget and to a basic pre-agreed specification." FFI evaluates the script, schedule and budget before issuing, handles the legal documentation, and then monitors the production throughout filming — meaning it is a third party that independently audits exactly the artefacts Cinamate's producer and finance rooms generate.

KEY FEATURES · Completion guarantees/bonds for film, TV, mini-series and streaming · Pre-production evaluation of script, schedule and budget · Ongoing production monitoring and cost-report review · Legal documentation and inter-party agreements · Seven offices across US, UK, Australia, Canada, South Africa, Scandinavia and Germany

PRICING Not disclosed. FFI publishes no rate card; completion bond fees are negotiated per production and conventionally quoted as a percentage of the budget, but no figure appears on the company's own pages — treat any percentage you see elsewhere as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Founded in London in 1950 by Peter Hope and Robert Garrett; now headquartered in Los Angeles with seven global offices. Claims to have guaranteed "over 6,000 films" with a "100% On Schedule, On Budget" record. Privately held; revenue and headcount not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (budget/stripboard) · finance · investors · timeline · contracts

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- 76 years of continuous operation and 6,000+ bonded films versus an invite-only beta
- Is the gatekeeper: a bond company's acceptance of a budget and schedule is what makes them financeable, and Cinamate has no relationship with one
- Global legal and monitoring infrastructure across seven territories
- Its approval is what unlocks bank gap/senior debt — software cannot substitute for it

<https://www.filmfinances.com/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Not software at all — no tooling, no automation, no self-serve
- No pricing transparency of any kind
- Historically reluctant to bond AI-generated or single-operator productions; slow to adapt

Staff Me Up (Talent Systems) www.staffmeup.com INDIRECT MEDIUM VERIFIED

The dominant US production-crew job marketplace — 489,000 crew members and 145,930 jobs posted since 2003 — with Disney, Paramount and Warner Bros. Discovery hiring on it.

Staff Me Up is a crew-hiring marketplace for film, TV and digital production. Crew build profiles and credits and apply to roles; employers post positions, search freelancers and track applications with built-in analytics. It is "Powered by TS" (Talent Systems). It is the layer Cinamate's producer and production modules implicitly assume already happened: Cinamate schedules and budgets crew but has no mechanism to find or hire them.

KEY FEATURES · Crew job board with 6,251+ active listings at time of review · Freelancer search and applicant tracking for employers · Credit-based crew profiles and résumé showcasing · Job alerts and application analytics · Studio-side hiring accounts

PRICING Basic: free, limited to 5 job applications. Premium Monthly: unlimited applications plus additional features. Premium Annual: marketed as "Our Best Deal!" with a promotional 50% off code (SMUWINTER50) live at time of review. Exact dollar figures were not rendered on the page — treat specific amounts as unverified. Employer-side posting pricing not published.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Self-reported: 489,000 production staff and crew members, 145,930 total jobs posted since 2003, 6,251+ active jobs. Names Disney, Paramount, Warner Bros. Discovery and AMC Networks among studios using it. Owned within Talent Systems.

COLLIDES WITH · producer (crew scheduling/call sheets) · production · contracts/deal memos · timeline

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- A 489,000-person crew supply network built over 23 years
- Direct studio hiring relationships (Disney, Paramount, WBD)
- Solves the crew-sourcing problem Cinamate simply does not address

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Job board only — no scheduling, budgeting, breakdown or production management
- No pricing published for employers
- Explicitly the opposite of Cinamate's single-operator thesis: it exists because films need crews

<https://www.staffmeup.com/> · <https://www.talentsystems.com/>

FoxOMS / Sonderplan (Nevario Pty Ltd) www.foxoms.com ADJACENT LOW VERIFIED

Australian resource-planning platform for film studios, recording studios, rental companies and universities — 13 schedule views, quoting and rate cards, 30-day free trial.

FoxOMS, now rebranded as Sonderplan, is a "resource planning tool designed for Creative Agencies, Equipment Rental Companies, Universities and Recording & Film Studios." It gives a single-screen overview of resource schedules and room bookings across 13 different views (timeline, calendar, grid), tracks projects such as recording sessions and TV series, supports quoting and invoicing with customisable rate cards, allows production-specific custom fields, and handles file sharing and team collaboration.

KEY FEATURES · 13 schedule views: timeline, calendar and grid · Room, suite, staff and equipment booking on one screen · Project tracking for series and sessions · Quoting and invoicing with customisable rate cards · Custom fields for production-specific data · File sharing and collaboration · 30-day full-featured free trial, no credit card

PRICING Not published on the page reviewed — pricing is behind the signup flow. A 30-day full-featured free trial with no credit card is offered. Treat any specific figure as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Operated by Nevario Pty Ltd, East Gosford, NSW 2250, Australia. Rebranded from FoxOMS to Sonderplan. Funding, headcount, revenue and customer counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · timeline · producer · post · workflow · projects · tools

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- A genuinely APAC vendor — the roster has no Australian or Asia-Pacific production-software presence at all
- Free 30-day trial with no card, against an invite-only closed beta
- Cross-industry resilience (education, rental, agencies) rather than depending on one film market
- Rate-card-driven quoting is what small facilities actually bill from

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No published pricing
- Generic resource scheduling — no script, breakdown, budget-format or film-specific logic
- No AI, no generation, no editorial
- Mid-rebrand, which creates brand confusion (foxoms.com vs Sonderplan)

<https://www.foxoms.com/> · <https://alternativeto.net/software/studiobinder/>

Qube Cinema www.qubecinema.com **ADJACENT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

India's digital-cinema infrastructure company — DCP mastering (QubeMaster), theatrical distribution (Qube Wire) and a 2,800-screen network — and the roster's only serious answer to "who does this outside the US."

Qube Cinema builds the digital cinema stack: QubeMaster, "a flexible and powerful Digital Cinema encoding and packaging solution" for DCP creation; Qube Wire, "a self-service, single-window system for theatrical distribution" handling DCP and KDM delivery to cinemas worldwide; QubeCast, a media transmission system using Qualcomm's RaptorQ forward error correction; and Qube Slate, a scheduling and content management service for theatres. Its network arm is a leading in-cinema advertising provider in India.

KEY FEATURES · QubeMaster — DCP encoding and packaging · Qube Wire — self-service global theatrical DCP and KDM distribution · QubeCast — RaptorQ-based media transmission · Qube Slate — theatre scheduling and content management · Qube Cinema Network — in-cinema advertising across Indian screens

PRICING Not disclosed on the pages reviewed. Qube Wire is described as self-service, implying per-delivery transactional pricing, but no rates are published — treat any figure as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Copyright notice reads "©1987-2026. Qube Cinema," indicating roughly four decades of operation. Indian-headquartered with references to the "Indian exhibition industry." Claims access to 2,800 screens through its in-cinema advertising network. Funding, revenue and ownership not disclosed on the pages reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution deliverables · festivals · screening · post

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Genuine non-US incumbency in the world's largest film market by volume — the roster's coverage of India is otherwise a single small pre-production vendor
- Owns both the mastering tool and the distribution rail, self-service, at global scale
- Nearly 40 years of operation
- 2,800-screen exhibition relationship no software vendor can replicate

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No pricing published
- Nothing upstream of a finished master — no development, production or post
- Theatrical-centric in a market moving to streaming
- Limited English-market presence

<https://www.qubecinema.com/>

Rentman www.rentman.io/pricing **ADJACENT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

European operations platform for equipment rental, crew scheduling and production planning, sold modularly from a €39/month base — the gear-and-crew layer Cinamate's props and tools rooms assume but never touch.

Rentman is an "Operations Management Platform" for equipment rental, event staffing, AV production, catering and media/broadcasting: "Plan productions, track equipment & communicate with crew - all from one platform." It combines an inventory/equipment-tracking system, a crew scheduling system, and quoting/invoicing, sold as add-ons on top of a platform base

fee. For a production, it is the system of record for what gear exists, where it is, who has it and what it costs — which is the real-world counterpart to Cinamate's props, tools and Money Room claims.

KEY FEATURES · Equipment inventory and availability tracking · Crew scheduling and communication · Quoting and invoicing · Equipment tracking (scanning, check-in/out) · Multi-warehouse support · History/audit logs · Modular add-on pricing

PRICING Platform base fee €39/month. Inventory add-on: Standard €14/mo per power user, Pro €19. Crew Scheduling add-on: Essential €14, Standard €19, Pro €24 per power user; Enterprise custom (invite-only). Quoting & Invoicing €9/power user/mo. History Logs €12. Equipment Tracking €9. Additional warehouse €5/location/mo. Monthly or yearly billing, 8% annual discount.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP European (Netherlands-rooted) vendor serving rental houses, AV and event production and media/broadcast. Funding, headcount and customer counts not disclosed on the pricing page.

COLLIDES WITH · props · tools (slate/timecards) · producer · finance · production · timeline

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Fully published, modular pricing in euros — a European producer can budget it exactly
- Real asset tracking with scanning, warehouses and audit logs; Cinamate's props module is a list, not an inventory system
- Crew scheduling and comms that assume more than one operator
- Non-US pricing and VAT-native billing

<https://www.rentman.io/pricing>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No script, breakdown, storyboard, edit, generation or post capability
- Not film-narrative-specific — built for AV/events as much as film
- Per-power-user pricing stacks up quickly across modules

SetScouter (acquired Wrapal) www.setscouter.com ADJACENT LOW VERIFIED

The film-specific residential location marketplace across North America — and it has absorbed Wrapal, a name the roster missed entirely.

SetScouter is a marketplace connecting producers and agencies with film-friendly residential locations across North America. Producers browse categorised inventory (kitchens, living rooms, lofts, bedrooms, warehouses), scout in person, then book online. The platform handles "payments, overtime fees, security deposits, and more" — the transactional mechanics that a location coordinator otherwise manages by hand. Wrapal, a competing location marketplace, has been acquired: wrapal.com now 301-redirects to setscouter.com and the site announces "Wrapal joins the Set Scouter family!" with credential migration for existing users.

KEY FEATURES · Film-specific residential location inventory, 1000+ per category claimed · In-person scouting before booking · Online booking with payment, overtime fee and security deposit handling · Coverage in Toronto, Vancouver, Montreal, New York, Los Angeles, Miami, Chicago and Atlanta · Absorbed Wrapal's user base and credentials

PRICING Not disclosed. No fee structure or commission percentage published on the site.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Claims "1000+ locations" in each of several property categories across eight major North American cities. Canadian-rooted (Toronto/Vancouver-first city list). Funding, ownership and revenue not disclosed. Consolidation evidence is hard: the wrapal.com redirect to setscouter.com is verifiable.

COLLIDES WITH · locations (permit DB) · sets · producer · production

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Handles the money mechanics of a location day — overtime, deposits, damages — which is where location budgets actually break
- Consolidating the category, which raises the bar for any new locations module
- Film-specific rather than generic venue rental

<https://www.setscouter.com/?source=wrapal> · <https://wrapal.com/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No permits, no location releases, no clearance
- No pricing or commission transparency
- North America only; residential-heavy inventory
- No integration with schedule or budget

Athos Insurance Services www.athosinsurance.com **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

Instant online production insurance and media E&O with published starting prices from \$155 — the self-serve answer to a module Cinamate does not have at all.

Athos is a specialty entertainment insurance provider selling short-term and annual production insurance, equipment insurance, media errors & omissions, event cancellation and sports coverage. Its differentiator is a proprietary online system that quotes and issues policies directly — "Instant insurance. Competitive rates. Friendly service." — with online certificates of insurance available immediately. It operates in all 50 US states. For an independent producer, E&O is a hard gate on distribution, and Athos sells it online in minutes.

KEY FEATURES · Short-term (single-shoot) production insurance · Annual production insurance · Media errors & omissions (E&O) · Equipment insurance · Event cancellation and sports coverage · Instant online quoting, purchase and certificate issuance · Coverage in all 50 states

PRICING Published starting rates: film production insurance "as low as \$155"; equipment insurance "as low as \$170"; special event insurance "as low as \$75"; sports insurance "as low as \$160". Actual premium depends on budget, cast, stunts and territory. Contact 626-716-9800 / service@athosinsurance.com.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP US specialty broker/MGA, Pacific-time business hours, all 50 states. Funding, ownership, headcount and premium volume not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · clearance · contracts · producer · finance · distribution deliverables

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Publishes actual starting prices; Cinamate publishes none
- Solves the E&O gate that actually blocks a finished indie film from distribution — Cinamate's clearance module produces reports but not the policy
- Instant self-serve issuance with same-day certificates, which is what a shooting schedule actually needs

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No production tooling whatsoever
- Not a data or workflow product — no integration surface
- US-only

<https://www.athosinsurance.com/>

Aximmetry aximmetry.com **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

All-in-one virtual production software with a genuinely free, watermark-free Studio Limited edition — the price floor under Cinamate's generation pitch from the in-camera-VFX side.

Aximmetry is an "all-in-one virtual production platform" combining a proprietary real-time render engine with integrated Unreal Engine support and node-based compositing. It handles award-winning built-in chroma keying, XR/LED-wall production, virtual studio construction, and real-time 2D/3D rendering with HDR, depth of field and virtual lighting. Its Studio Limited edition is free forever after registration, with no watermark, one NDI port and basic camera tracking — meaning a solo operator can shoot virtual production for zero software cost.

KEY FEATURES · Node-based editing with proprietary render engine plus Unreal Engine integration · Award-winning built-in chroma keying · XR / LED wall extended reality production · Virtual studio and interactive scene construction · Real-time HDR, depth of field and virtual lighting · Free Studio Limited edition — no watermark, 1 NDI port, basic tracking

PRICING Studio Limited: free, unlimited use after registration, no watermark, one NDI port, basic tracking. Other editions exist but no prices are published — the site directs enquiries to sales@aximmetry.com. Treat all paid-tier figures as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Hungarian vendor. Targets broadcast producers, virtual event creators, previs specialists, esports broadcasters, streamers, corporate video and cinematographers. Funding, headcount and customer counts not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · studio/local generation · vfx · sets · boards (previs) · tools

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- A free, watermark-free professional tier — the strongest possible answer to Cinamate's unpriced private beta
- Runs locally on the operator's own GPU, exactly Cinamate's local-generation posture, but for real photography
- Unreal Engine integration gives access to the entire game-engine asset ecosystem
- Non-US (Hungary), so priced and supported for European users

<https://aximmetry.com/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Requires cameras, tracking and often a stage — not script-to-screen
- No paid pricing disclosed
- No script, schedule, budget, edit or distribution modules
- Steep node-based learning curve

DCP-o-matic github.com/cth103/dcpomatic INDIRECT LOW VERIFIED

Free GPL-2.0 software that builds Digital Cinema Packages — the theatrical deliverable Cinamate's distribution module never produces, at zero cost.

DCP-o-matic is "a program to generate DCPs (digital cinema packages)" released under GPL-2.0, with active development branches for the v2.18.x and v2.19.x lines. A DCP is the mandatory deliverable for any theatrical or most festival screenings; without one a finished film cannot be projected in a cinema. DCP-o-matic makes that step free, which is a meaningful hole in Cinamate's distribution-deliverables and festivals story — a producer who has made a film in Cinamate still needs a DCP, and the standard answer is this open-source tool rather than a paid module.

KEY FEATURES · DCP generation from common source formats · GPL-2.0 open-source licence · Actively maintained v2.18.x and v2.19.x branches · Cross-platform desktop distribution (details published at dcpomatic.com, which returned HTTP 403 to automated fetch during this research)

PRICING Free. GPL-2.0. Donations accepted by the maintainer.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Single-maintainer open-source project (Carl Hetherington). Adoption figures, download counts and release dates were not retrievable in this pass — dcpomatic.com returned HTTP 403 to automated fetch, so treat feature specifics beyond DCP generation and the licence as unverified.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution deliverables · festivals · screening · post

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Produces the one deliverable that theatrical and most festival exhibition absolutely require, for free
- GPL-2.0 with no revenue threshold or licensing negotiation
- Runs locally with no cloud dependency, matching the local-first thesis Cinamate sells

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Single-purpose; no production, post or business tooling
- Single-maintainer bus-factor risk
- No support, no SLA, no certification
- Documentation site was unreachable to automated requests during this research

<https://github.com/cth103/dcpomatic> · <https://dcpomatic.com/>

disguise www.disguise.one/en INDIRECT LOW VERIFIED

The virtual production and LED-volume platform behind 402 VP/xR studios in 116 countries — the whole category of on-stage real-time production the roster omitted.

disguise is an integrated software, hardware and services platform for real-time visual production: LED volumes, extended reality stages, projection mapping and live events. Software includes Designer (cloud-based design), disguise X1, RenderStream (graphics control) and Mapping Matter; hardware spans the EX, VX, GX and RX media server ranges plus Omnical calibration and VFC video format conversion cards. It partners with Epic Games and Nvidia. This is where in-camera VFX actually gets shot — the alternative path to "generate the image" that Cinamate's Studio/Local Generation flagship never engages with.

KEY FEATURES · Designer — cloud-based real-time show design · RenderStream graphics control engine for LED volumes and xR · Mapping Matter projection mapping · EX/VX/GX/RX media server hardware ranges · Omnical camera/projector calibration · VFC video format conversion cards · Epic Games and Nvidia technology partnerships

PRICING Not published. The site references "Designer Pricing Plans" and links a financing solutions page but discloses no figures; hardware and licences are quoted.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Claims 80% of the world's biggest A-list live tours and 90% of Tier 1 live shows run on the disguise platform; 402 VP and xR studios; operations in 116 countries. Partners named include Epic Games, Nvidia, Warner Bros. and ROE Visual. Funding and ownership not disclosed on the pages reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · studio/local generation · sets · vfx · production · tools

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- 402 real virtual-production stages worldwide versus Cinamate's claimed 36 verified stage facilities as a database entry
- Produces in-camera final-pixel imagery that is unambiguously ownable and union-compatible — a legal posture generative output does not have
- Deep hardware/software integration with Epic and Nvidia
- Genuine global footprint across 116 countries

<https://www.disguise.one/en>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Capital-intensive: requires a stage, LED wall, media servers and a crew — the opposite of single-operator
- No pricing transparency
- Nothing upstream (script, breakdown, budget) or downstream (edit, distribution, festivals)
- Broadcast/live-events revenue skew rather than narrative film

Front Row Insurance Brokers www.frontrowinsurance.com **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

Specialist entertainment broker with Producer's E&O, DICE annual policies and short-shoot cover across Canada and Los Angeles.

Front Row is a specialist entertainment insurance brokerage covering film, music, theatre and photography, with offices in Vancouver, Calgary, Toronto, Montreal, Halifax and Los Angeles. Its film and TV line includes production packages, Producer's E&O, Short Shoot Insurance, annual DICE (Documentary/Industrial/Commercial/Educational) producers' insurance, studio art services insurance, a documentary programme and film equipment rental house insurance. It sits directly on the compliance path between Cinamate's clearance/contracts output and a distributor accepting delivery.

KEY FEATURES · Producer's Errors & Omissions policies · Production package insurance · Short Shoot Insurance for micro-productions · Annual DICE producers' insurance · Documentary-specific programme · Film equipment rental house insurance · Six offices across Canada plus Los Angeles

PRICING Not disclosed. No published prices or minimum premiums; quotes are requested through the site or a local office.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Canada-focused specialist broker with a Los Angeles office; publishes customer testimonials including a 20-year client relationship. Privately held; premium volume, headcount and ownership not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · clearance · contracts · safety · producer · distribution deliverables

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Regional depth in Canada, a major production territory Cinamate's 21-jurisdiction tax-credit module implicitly targets
- Owns the E&O relationship that converts a clearance report into an insurable, deliverable film
- Human brokers who understand union and safety exposure — Cinamate's safety module has no equivalent liability path

<https://www.frontrowinsurance.com/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No published pricing at all
- No software product, no automation
- Geographically limited

OpenTimelineIO (Academy Software Foundation) github.com/AcademySoftwareFoundation/OpenTimelineIO

INDIRECT **LOW** **VERIFIED**

The Apache-2.0 editorial interchange standard Cinamate's own "EDL/OTIO conform" claim depends on — owned by the Academy, not by any vendor.

OpenTimelineIO is "an interchange format and API for editorial cut information" — cut order, lengths and external media references, deliberately not a media container. It is maintained by the Academy Software Foundation under Apache 2.0. Adapters in sibling repositories provide interoperability with Final Cut Pro XML, AAF, CMX 3600 EDL and other formats, and the Python bindings support Media Linkers, HookScripts and custom SchemaDefs. Cinamate advertises "EDL/OTIO conform" as a differentiator; OTIO is in fact a free, neutral, industry-governed standard that every competitor can and does implement.

KEY FEATURES · Native .otio, .otioz and .otiod formats · Adapters for FCP XML, AAF and CMX 3600 EDL · Media Linker, HookScript and SchemaDef plugin types · Python bindings; VFX Platform 2022-2025, Python 3.9-3.12 · Apache 2.0 licence, Academy Software Foundation governance

PRICING Free. Apache 2.0 licence — unrestricted commercial use, no revenue threshold.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP 2,000+ GitHub stars, 342 forks, 99 watchers. Maintained by the Academy Software Foundation (the Linux Foundation/AMPAS joint body), with the codebase originating at Pixar. No company, no funding — industry-governed infrastructure.

COLLIDES WITH · editor (The Cutting Room) · post · vfx · workflow · dailies

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Academy-governed neutral standard — vendor-independent credibility Cinamate cannot claim for itself
- Free and Apache 2.0, so OTIO conform is table stakes, not a differentiator
- Broad adapter ecosystem covering AAF, FCPXML and EDL that a from-scratch implementation must match edge-case for edge-case
- Actively maintained against the VFX Reference Platform

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- A library and format, not a product — no UI, no workflow, no user-facing value on its own
- Requires engineering to use
- Notably, AAF adapter support is a separate repo and historically the hardest conform path to get right

<https://github.com/AcademySoftwareFoundation/OpenTimelineIO>

Peerspace www.peerspace.com **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

The global venue marketplace filmmakers actually book through — film shoot, video shoot and music video are first-class booking categories across LA, NY, London, Paris, Berlin, Sydney and Barcelona.

Peerspace connects property owners with people booking spaces by the hour, with production explicitly among its core use cases: photo shoot, video shoot, music video and film shoot are named activity types. Inventory spans "professionally equipped studios to unconventional rooms and residences." For an independent producer it is the practical substitute for a location scout and for a location database — you search, you see the price, you book it.

KEY FEATURES · Hourly venue booking with production-specific activity filters · Studios, residences and unconventional interiors · Global city coverage (London, Vancouver, Paris, Sydney, New York, Los Angeles, Berlin, Barcelona) · Host/guest messaging and in-platform booking · "Made in Peerspace" project gallery and annual Open Door Awards (2026 edition running)

PRICING Not disclosed on the pages reviewed. Peerspace publishes no host or guest fee percentage on its homepage; individual listings carry hourly rates set by hosts.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP No quantitative listing, user or GMV figures published on the homepage. Operates across major North American, European and Australian cities. Funding and ownership not disclosed on the pages reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · locations · sets · production

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Genuinely international inventory including EU and Australia, well beyond Cinamate's claimed 36 stage facilities and 6 permit hubs
- Zero learning curve and no invite required
- Prices visible before you commit

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No permit workflow, no location release paperwork
- No fee transparency
- Not film-specific — production competes with parties and offsites for the same inventory
- No connection to schedule, budget or breakdown

<https://www.peerspace.com/>

Seed&Spark www.seedandspark.com **INDIRECT** **LOW** **VERIFIED**

The film-specific crowdfunding platform with an 82% success rate and \$96.4M raised across 8,071 projects — the way independent films actually get financed at the level Cinamate targets.

Seed&Spark is a crowdfunding platform where "creators and audiences work together to bring incredible new projects to life," specialising in film and storytelling. Filmmakers launch campaigns, and the platform runs themed "Rallies" — large multi-project initiatives with partner prizes — plus a crowdfunding playbook and creator events. It requires an inclusion statement from every

creator. For the independent producer Cinamate targets, this is the realistic alternative to the investors module: not modelling an equity waterfall, but raising the money from an audience.

KEY FEATURES · Film-specific crowdfunding campaigns · Rallies — themed multi-project funding drives with partner prizes · Crowdfunding playbook and creator education · Inclusion statement requirement for all creators · Audience-building tools alongside fundraising

PRICING Not disclosed on the homepage. Seed&Spark publishes no platform fee or commission rate on the pages reviewed — treat any percentage as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Self-reported: 82% of projects funded, \$96,376,230 raised in total, 8,071 projects created. Also states roughly 80% of crowdfunding dollars go to local wages and 82% of projects include women in key roles. Funding, ownership and headcount not disclosed on the pages reviewed.

COLLIDES WITH · investors · finance · distribution · festivals

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- An 82% funded rate and \$96M raised is verifiable outcome data; Cinamate's 3,708-film model with a 15.5% failure rate is a forecast, not a track record
- Reaches the money source most sub-\$1M independent films actually use
- Audience-building is a distribution asset the film keeps after the raise
- Publishes real aggregate outcome statistics

<https://www.seedandspark.com/>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- No fee disclosure
- Not software for making a film — purely fundraising
- Ceiling is low: crowdfunding rarely finances a full feature budget
- No forecasting, budgeting or waterfall modelling

Subtitle Edit (open source) github.com/SubtitleEdit/subtitleedit

INDIRECT

LOW

VERIFIED

The free MIT-licensed subtitle editor with 13.9k GitHub stars, offline-first, running on Windows, macOS and Linux — the zero-cost floor under every captioning deliverable.

Subtitle Edit is an open-source desktop subtitle editor for creating, syncing, converting and editing subtitle files. It handles editing, format conversion, video playback and local auto-backup entirely offline on the user's own machine. It supports optional integrations with third-party translation, speech-to-text, text-to-speech, OCR and dictionary services — meaning a producer can run local Whisper-class ASR through it at zero marginal cost, which is exactly the local-GPU economics Cinamate markets.

KEY FEATURES · Subtitle editing, syncing and format conversion · Integrated video playback · Local auto-backup, offline-first, no telemetry on subtitle or media content · Optional speech-to-text, TTS, translation, OCR and dictionary providers · Windows, macOS and Linux builds · MIT licence

PRICING Free. MIT licence. Cost is the operator's own compute only.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP 13.9k GitHub stars, 27,069 commits, 223 open issues — a long-running, actively maintained community project with no company behind it. Cross-platform releases distributed via GitHub.

COLLIDES WITH · distribution deliverables · post · editor · screening

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Free and MIT-licensed — no revenue threshold, no per-seat cost, no invite
- Runs fully offline with an explicit no-data-collection posture, a stronger privacy story than a 4-minute cloud sync
- Cross-platform including Linux
- 27,000 commits of maturity in a format-compatibility problem that is all edge cases

<https://github.com/SubtitleEdit/subtitleedit>

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Subtitles only — no production, post, generation or business capability
- Desktop app with a dated interface and a real learning curve
- No support contract, no SLA, no security certification

Teradek (Videndum) teradek.com

INDIRECT

LOW

LIKELY

The on-set wireless video, streaming and camera-control hardware layer — including direct ARRI, RED and Sony camera control — that explains exactly what LightsKiddo's integrations mean and Cinamate's do not.

Teradek makes wireless video transmission, encoding/decoding and camera-control hardware for professional production: the Bolt 6 and Ace 750 zero-delay wireless monitoring systems; Serv and Link AX for production streaming; the Prism encoder/decoder family (Jetpack, Flex, Mobile, Rack); Teradek RT wireless lens control with CTRL.5 offering "Sony, RED® and ARRI® Camera Control" over WiFi or Ethernet; and Link/Data/Node multi-WAN modems. This is the physical substrate of camera-to-cloud dailies, and it is the concrete form of the integration advantage the brief attributes to LightsKiddo.

KEY FEATURES · Bolt 6 / Ace 750 zero-delay wireless video monitoring · Prism Jetpack / Flex / Mobile / Rack encoders and decoders · Serv Series and Link AX production streaming · Teradek RT wireless lens control; CTRL.5 camera control for Sony, RED and ARRI · Link / Data / Node multi-WAN bonded modems

PRICING Not disclosed on the homepage. Sold as hardware through dealers; treat any figure as unverified.

SCALE & OWNERSHIP Careers links on the site reference Videndum, indicating Teradek sits within the Videndum plc group (Creative Solutions division) — treat the ownership as likely rather than confirmed from this page. Revenue and unit volumes not disclosed.

COLLIDES WITH · dailies · tools · production · today · screening

STRONGER THAN CINAMATE

- Native camera control for the three camera systems that shoot most professional narrative work — the precise integration class Cinamate lacks
- Hardware on set works with no internet, no GPU and no sync interval
- Bonded cellular uplink makes true real-time transport possible, versus Cinamate's 4-minute sync

WEAKER THAN CINAMATE

- Hardware capex, not software; no workflow, planning or post capability
- No published pricing
- Irrelevant to a production that never points a camera at anything

<https://teradek.com/>

§23 Appendix A — The Fact-Check Ledger

An adversarial verification agent re-tested the ~36 riskiest claims produced by the research sweep against primary sources (vendor pricing pages, filings, registries, live DNS/HTTP probes). Its verdicts are reproduced here in full; every **refuted** claim was corrected in the catalog before publication, and every **unverifiable** claim is labeled at point of use. This ledger is included so the reader can see not only what this report asserts, but what it declined to assert.

REFUTED Cinetech

Claim: Cinetech pricing is 'Not disclosed on the site. No published tiers.'

Finding: Cinetech publishes full pricing: Solo Creator \$49/month (500 bonus + 250 credits/mo at \$0.02/credit, 100GB), Team \$149/month for 5 members (+\$25/member, 1TB pooled), Pay As You Go at \$0.08/credit, Studio custom. The roster's other Cinetech entry has these figures right; the 'not disclosed' entry is simply wrong.

<https://www.cinetech.ai/pricing>

REFUTED ComfyUI / Comfy Cloud

Claim: Comfy Cloud costs Standard \$16/mo, Creator \$28/mo, Pro \$80/mo, Team \$630/mo.

Finding: Those are annual-billing monthly equivalents presented as monthly prices. Month-to-month rates are Standard \$20, Creator \$35, Pro \$100, Team \$700. The annual totals in the roster (\$192/\$336/\$960/\$7,560) and the credit allocations (4,200/7,400/21,100/147,700) are correct, as is the free desktop app.

<https://www.comfy.org/pricing>

REFUTED Filmustage

Claim: Filmustage Director's Cut costs \$55/month (or \$660/year), stated in three separate roster sections as verified from filmustage.com/pricing.

Finding: Director's Cut is \$79/month, not \$55. The \$660/year annual figure and the 1,700 coins/cycle are correct, and \$660 is a ~30% saving off \$79x12=\$948 — which is arithmetically impossible against a \$55 monthly rate. The \$55 number appears nowhere on the vendor page.

<https://filmustage.com/pricing/>

REFUTED Google Flow (Veo 4 / DeepMind)

Claim: Google Flow was relaunched in February 2026 as a unified idea-to-finished-video pipeline running on Veo 4.

Finding: There is no Veo 4. Google's own Flow page names Veo 3.1 as the current model and mentions no Veo 4 anywhere. The roster contradicts itself: a later section correctly lists 'Google Veo 3.1 + Flow'. Flow's published plans are confirmed exactly (Free 50 daily credits; Google AI Plus \$4.99/mo 200 credits; AI Pro \$19.99/mo 1,000; AI Ultra \$99.99-\$199.99/mo 10,000-25,000).

<https://labs.google/flow/about>

REFUTED Katalist

Claim: Katalist is priced from \$29 to \$399/month: Essential \$29, Pro \$79 (unlimited image generation), Business \$399, plus enterprise.

Finding: Katalist's published tiers are Essential \$19/mo, Pro \$39/mo, Unlimited \$99/mo (2 seats), Enterprise custom; annual equivalents \$348/\$374/\$948 per year. There is no \$399 Business tier. The roster lists Katalist twice with mutually contradictory prices — the storyboards-section entry (\$19/\$39/\$99) is the correct one.

<https://www.katalist.ai/pricing>

REFUTED Open-Sora (HPC-AI Tech)

Claim: Open-Sora's last major release was March 2025, leaving it well behind the current open frontier.

Finding: The repository was last pushed 9 April 2026 and has 29,293 stars — it is not a March-2025-dormant project. The Apache-2.0 license is confirmed. By contrast, the roster's dormancy calls on Replica Studios, Lore Machine and Cine Tracer all check out.

<https://github.com/hpcaitech/Open-Sora>

REFUTED Saturation.io

Claim: Saturation.io paid plans start at \$25/month.

Finding: Saturation's entry paid plan is Pro at \$32/month (\$384/year); Team is \$79/month (\$948/year); Creator is free. The roster's own later entries state \$32 correctly — the '\$25/month' figure in the AI-breakdown section is wrong.

<https://saturation.io/pricing>

REFUTED Slated

Claim: Slated pricing is 'Not disclosed in sources I verified. Historically a mix of submission/analysis fees and success-based participation; treat specifics as unverified.'

Finding: Slated publishes a full rate card: Active Project Listing \$34.99/month, Script Analysis \$495, Financial Analysis \$495, Script+Financial bundle \$795, EP Consulting \$595/month, individual membership and opportunity matching free. The roster's distribution-section entry has these right; the finance-section entry claiming non-disclosure is wrong.

<https://get.slated.com/pricing>

UNVERIFIABLE Celtx (Backlight)

Claim: Celtx pricing is Writer \$11.24/month, Writer Pro \$18.74/month, Team from \$67.49/month billed yearly.

Finding: Celtx's own pricing page shows tier names, seat and project limits and a '25% off yearly' banner but no dollar figures at all. The roster is honest about this in two entries and then presents the same third-party numbers as fact in a third. Treat all Celtx dollar amounts as third-party estimates, not vendor-published.

<https://www.celtx.com/pricing/>

UNVERIFIABLE Filmhub

Claim: Filmhub puts titles onto 130+ streaming channels across 200+ territories, on plans of Core \$0, Plus \$999/yr and Pro \$1,999/yr with an 80/20 split.

Finding: filmhub.com/pricing and /plans both 404. The homepage says Filmhub works with 'over 100 of the world's biggest exhibitors' — not 130+ channels — and publishes no revenue split and no plan prices. The \$999/\$1,999 tiers and the 80/20 figure could not be confirmed from the vendor.

<https://filmhub.com/>

UNVERIFIABLE FinalBit / Nolan AI

Claim: FinalBit (formerly Nolan AI) charges Creator \$40/month and Pro \$100/month, with promo codes bringing them to \$28/\$70.

Finding: The rebrand is real and verifiable — nolanai.app/pricing 301-redirects to finalbitai.com/pricing. But no dollar figures render on the pricing page to a fetcher. The roster gives three mutually inconsistent accounts of FinalBit pricing across three sections (\$40/\$100; 'could not be confirmed, trackers say \$15-\$75'; 'not disclosed in retrievable form'). No FinalBit price should be cited.

<https://www.finalbitai.com/pricing>

UNVERIFIABLE Higgsfield AI

Claim: Higgsfield raised a \$400M Series B led by DST Global at a \$5.4B valuation on 17 August 2026, with \$700M annualized revenue, 30M users, 390 of the Fortune 500, and a 110-minute AI feature made for \$2M in four weeks.

Finding: None of it could be confirmed. Higgsfield's own pricing page returns no plan data to a fetcher, and no primary source for the round, valuation, revenue or user figures was reachable. This is the single largest cluster of unsourced numbers in the roster — a \$5.4B valuation and \$700M ARR for a company eight months out from a claimed \$1.3B mark should not be repeated without a named filing or press release. The roster itself admits the pricing tiers come from third-party trackers.

<https://higgsfield.ai/pricing>

UNVERIFIABLE Movie Magic Budgeting (Entertainment Partners)

Claim: Movie Magic Budgeting costs \$42.99/month, stated as \$515.88/year, with ~40% saving on an annual subscription.

Finding: EP publishes no price on the Movie Magic Budgeting product page — it routes to 'Get pricing', and the EP store returned HTTP 503. The claim is also internally incoherent: $\$42.99 \times 12 = \515.88 exactly, so the quoted 'annual' price is just twelve monthly payments and cannot simultaneously represent a 40% discount. A separate roster entry gives \$24.99/month billed annually (\$299.88/year) for the same product. At most one of these can be right; neither is verified.

<https://www.ep.com/movie-magic-budgeting/>

UNVERIFIABLE Movie Magic Scheduling (Entertainment Partners)

Claim: Movie Magic Scheduling is \$29.99/month introductory (list \$39.99) and \$199.88/year introductory (list \$279.88), 'Verified on EP Store (Aug 2026)'.

Finding: The EP product page publishes no prices and the EP store was unreachable (HTTP 503). The 'verified' label is not supportable. The related claim that Movie Magic Scheduling 6 ends sale/support mid-2026 and that version 10 is current also could not be confirmed from EP's own pages.

<https://www.ep.com/movie-magic-scheduling/>

UNVERIFIABLE Netflix / InterPositive

Claim: Netflix bought Ben Affleck's stealth AI post-production startup InterPositive for \$587M in cash, a 16-person team, price revealed in a July 2026 filing.

Finding: The acquisition itself is confirmed — Netflix's newsroom announced it on 5 March 2026, with Affleck joining as Senior Advisor. But the announcement discloses no price and no team size. The \$587M figure, the 16-person headcount, the July 2026 filing and the 'will not commercialize' commitment could not be confirmed from any primary source; treat the dollar figure as unsupported.

<https://about.netflix.com/en/news/why-interpositive-is-joining-netflix>

UNVERIFIABLE Runway

Claim: Runway raised a \$315M Series E at a \$5.3B post-money valuation in February 2026 led by General Atlantic, with ~\$860M raised across 7 rounds and ~\$300M annualized revenue.

Finding: No primary source confirms a 2026 Series E. Runway's documented rounds total roughly \$545M (\$2M seed, \$8.5M A, \$35M B, \$50M C at \$500M, \$141M C-extension at \$1.5B led by Google/Nvidia/Salesforce, and \$308M in April 2025 at over \$3B led by General Atlantic). The roster's claim looks like a drifted restatement of the April 2025 General Atlantic round; the \$5.3B valuation, February 2026 date and ~\$860M total are unsupported. Runway's consumer pricing IS confirmed exactly: Free \$0/125 credits, Standard \$12, Pro \$28, Max \$76 (annual billing).

[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Runway_\(company\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Runway_(company))

UNVERIFIABLE TPN (Trusted Partner Network)

Claim: TPN annual membership runs on a published revenue-banded schedule from \$250 (self-employed) to \$85K (\$200M+), with \$500 assessor accreditation valid two years.

Finding: ttpn.org returned no content to repeated fetches (membership, pricing and root pages all came back empty). The fee schedule, the Shield tier rebrand and the SSP-to-TPX rename could not be confirmed against any primary source. The MPA ownership of TPN is well established but was not verified here either.

<https://www.ttpn.org/membership/>

CONFIRMED Alibaba Wan 2.2

Claim: Wan 2.2 is Apache-2.0 licensed with roughly 17.3k GitHub stars.

Finding: Confirmed: Apache-2.0, 17,261 stars as of 23 August 2026.

<https://github.com/Wan-Video/Wan2.2>

CONFIRMED Avid Technology

Claim: Avid Media Composer's parent Avid Technology was taken private by STG in a deal announced 2023.

Finding: Confirmed and can be tightened: Symphony Technology Group took Avid private in November 2023 for \$1.4 billion, delisting it from Nasdaq. The roster flagged this 'uncertain' — it is actually solid.

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Avid_Technology

CONFIRMED BitMax / Filmocracy

Claim: bitmax.tv and filmocracy.com could not be reached and their operating status is unconfirmed.

Finding: Confirmed independently: bitmax.tv resolves in DNS but resets the connection; filmocracy.com returns HTTP 403 to automated requests. The roster's 'uncertain' labelling on both is appropriate — but note a 403 means bot-blocking, not necessarily a dead company.

<https://bitmax.tv/>

CONFIRMED Cine Tracer / Lore Machine / Replica Studios

Claim: Cine Tracer's own domain has been lost to an unrelated business; Lore Machine's domain no longer resolves; Replica Studios has shut down.

Finding: All three verified: cinetracer.com now 301s to providenceplace-apartments.com; loremachine.io has no DNS record; replicastudios.com serves a closure notice reading 'Replica Studios has officially signed off... This is goodbye - for now, probably forever.'

<https://www.replicastudios.com/>

CONFIRMED ElevenLabs

Claim: ElevenLabs raised a \$500M Series D at an \$11B valuation in February 2026, following \$180M at \$3.3B (Jan 2025), \$80M at \$1.1B (Jan 2024) and \$19M at ~\$100M (Jun 2023); founded 2022 by Piotr Dabkowski (ex-Google ML) and Mati Staniszewski (ex-Palantir).

<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/ElevenLabs>

CONFIRMED ElevenLabs

Claim: ElevenLabs plans: Free \$0 (10k credits), Starter \$6, Creator \$22, Pro \$99, Scale \$299, Business \$990, Enterprise custom; annual = 10x monthly.

<https://elevenlabs.io/pricing>

CONFIRMED EU AI Act Article 50

Claim: EU AI Act Article 50 requires machine-readable marking of synthetic audio, image, video and text, and is in force as of 2 August 2026.
<https://artificialintelligenceact.eu/article/50/>

CONFIRMED FilmFreeway

Claim: FilmFreeway was acquired by Backstage in September 2021 and became dominant after Amazon shut Withoutabox in September 2019.

Finding: Ownership and dates confirmed. The separate 12% festival commission claim could not be verified — filmfreeway.com/pricing returns HTTP 403 to automated retrieval, exactly as the roster admits.

<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/FilmFreeway>

CONFIRMED Final Draft (Cast & Crew)

Claim: Final Draft is owned by Cast & Crew (acquired 2016) and Final Draft 13 sells at \$199.99 (from \$249.99), Student \$99.99, Upgrade \$79.99, Suite from \$8.33/month billed yearly.

Finding: Ownership and every price confirmed on Final Draft's own pricing page. The separate '95% market share among film/TV professionals' figure is Final Draft's own marketing claim and is not independently substantiated.

<https://www.finaldraft.com/pricing/>

CONFIRMED FinalBit / Autodesk / EditShare / Cast & Crew / Moonvalley

Claim: Various rebrand/consolidation claims: NolanAI to FinalBit, ShotGrid to Autodesk Flow Production Tracking, Shift.io into MediaSilo, Showbiz Software into Cast & Crew, and Moonvalley publishing no pricing.

Finding: All verified by live redirect: nolanai.app/pricing to finalbitai.com/pricing; shotgridsoftware.com/pricing to autodesk.com Flow Production Tracking; shift.io to mediasilo.com; showbizsoftware.com to store.castandcrew.com; moonvalley.com/pricing returns 404.

<https://www.moonvalley.com/pricing>

CONFIRMED Foundry Nuke

Claim: Foundry Nuke is \$3,839/yr, NukeX \$5,219/yr, Nuke Studio \$6,379/yr, Nuke Render \$462/yr, with quarterly options at \$2,089/\$2,869/\$3,509.

Finding: All prices confirmed exactly. The separate claim that Foundry is owned by Roper Technologies was not re-verified here.

<https://www.foundry.com/products/nuke-family/nuke>

CONFIRMED Frame.io (Adobe)

Claim: Adobe acquired Frame.io in 2021 for approximately \$1.275B, and Frame.io is priced Free / Pro \$15 per member/mo / Team \$25 per member/mo / Enterprise custom.

Finding: Acquisition confirmed at \$1,275,000,000, closed 7 October 2021. Pricing confirmed exactly, including the ~13% annual discount and the 2/5/15-member caps.

<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Frame.io>

CONFIRMED Kuaishou Kling 3.0 / fal.ai

Claim: Kling 3.0 Pro on fal.ai costs \$0.112/second without audio, \$0.168/second with audio, \$0.196/second with audio and voice control.

<https://fal.ai/models/fal-ai/kling-video/v3/pro/text-to-video>

CONFIRMED Lightricks LTX-2.5

Claim: LTX-2.5 is a 22B open-weight model under the LTX-2 Community License, free for commercial use below roughly \$10M annual revenue and paid above it.

<https://huggingface.co/Lightricks/LTX-2.5>

CONFIRMED Multiple vendors

Claim: Published prices verified as correct: Boords \$39/\$75/\$125/\$250 monthly; Croogloo \$19/\$99/\$999; SetKeeper \$1,500/\$3,500/\$5,000 by budget band; Rivet AI free/\$49.99/\$150 per project; Scriptflow Pro \$49/user/mo; Descript \$16/\$24/\$50 annual (\$24/\$35/\$65 monthly); iconik \$0/\$9/\$65/\$120; Kitsu EUR 20/30/35 plus EUR 3,999 schools; MediaSilo \$15/\$25; Suno \$8/\$24; Luma \$30/\$90/\$300 monthly; DaVinci Resolve free with Studio at \$295; Eventive 5% + 99c, \$975 activation, \$299 single film, \$1,800/mo premium support.

<https://boords.com/pricing>

CONFIRMED OpenAI Sora 2

Claim: Sora 2 API pricing is \$0.10/s at 720p; sora-2-pro \$0.30/\$0.50/\$0.70 per second at 720p/1024p/1080p, with a 50% batch tier.

<https://developers.openai.com/api/docs/pricing>

CONFIRMED StudioBinder

Claim: StudioBinder claims more than 1.5 million production companies and brands worldwide rely on the platform.

Finding: Confirmed as a verbatim vendor claim on studiobinder.com. Treat it as marketing, not a verified user count — 1.5 million production companies exceeds any plausible global count of production companies, and StudioBinder is estimated at roughly 21-29 employees and ~\$2.3M revenue. Separately, StudioBinder's pricing page 301s to app.studiobinder.com and renders no figures, so the '\$29/\$49/\$99 support-page ladder' could not be confirmed.

<https://www.studiobinder.com/>

CONFIRMED Toon Boom Storyboard Pro

Claim: Toon Boom Storyboard Pro is \$87.00/month, \$752.00/year, \$2,143.00 for 3 years; student \$10.75/month or \$87.00/year.

<https://shop.toonboom.com/en/products/storyboard-pro>

CONFIRMED Vubiquity (Amdocs)

Claim: Amdocs acquired Vubiquity in January 2018 for \$224 million; Vubiquity traces to 1988, merged with Avail Media in 2009 and rebranded in 2013; HQ Burbank.

<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Vubiquity>

§24 Appendix B — Master Index (A–Z)

Every profiled entity, with category, relationship, and threat rating.

Entity	Primary category	Relationship	Threat	Confidence
ABS Payroll & Accounting	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	DIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
Abundantia Entertainment × invideo (aiON)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Act One Script Clearance	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Adobe (Firefly audio, Enhance Speech, Premiere Pro AI)	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	ADJACENT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Adobe Content Authenticity (Content Credentials implementation)	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Adobe Firefly	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	ADJACENT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Adobe Premiere Pro (with Firefly Generative Extend)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
AI script-coverage cluster (ScriptReader.ai, Scriptwood, StoryNotes, Callaia, OnDesk, Prescene)	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Airtable	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Alibaba Wan (Wan 2.2 open / Wan 2.5 closed)	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	ADJACENT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Altered Studio (Altered AI)	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	ADJACENT	LOW	VERIFIED
Amazon Prime Video Direct	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	INDIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Arc Studio Pro	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Artist	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Asana	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Assemble (assemble.tv)	Production management suites (the incumbents)	DIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
Assimilate SCRATCH	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Ateliere Creative Technologies	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Athos Insurance Services	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED

Entity	Primary category	Relationship	Threat	Confidence
AudioShake	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Autodesk Flow Capture (formerly Moxion and PIX)	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Autodesk Flow Production Tracking (formerly ShotGrid / Shotgun)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	ADJACENT	HIGH	LIKELY
Autodesk Flow Studio (formerly Wonder Studio / Wonder Dynamics)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	ADJACENT	LOW	VERIFIED
Avid Media Composer / MediaCentral / NEXIS	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	DIRECT	HIGH	UNCERTAIN
Aximmetry	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
axle ai	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
AYON (Ynput, formerly OpenPype)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Beatoven.ai	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Beemer (beemerdocs.com)	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	INDIRECT	LOW	UNCERTAIN
BitMax	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	ADJACENT	LOW	UNCERTAIN
Blackbird plc / elevate.io	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Blackmagic DaVinci Resolve 21 / Resolve Studio	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Blender (Grease Pencil / Video Sequence Editor previs pipeline)	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
Boords	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Boxoffice Pro (with Screen Engine/ASI tracking)	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incnt	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Breakdown Assistant AI (Jungle Software / Gorilla)	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Breakdown Express / Breakdown Services Ltd	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
ByteDance Seedance (1.0 / 2.0 / 2.5)	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
C2PA / Content Credentials	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
California AB 1836 — digital replicas of deceased personalities	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
California AB 2602 — digital replica contract provisions	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Camb.ai	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED

Entity	Primary category	Relationship	Threat	Confidence
Captions (captions.ai)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
CASHét (Entertainment Partners)	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Cast & Crew	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Cast & Crew / Media Services Production Incentives	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incent	ADJACENT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Celtx (a Backlight business)	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Chronicle Studios	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	INDIRECT	LOW	UNCERTAIN
Cinando (Marché du Film)	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	HIGH	LIKELY
Cine Tracer	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	DIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Cinelytic	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	INDIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Cinema AI Studio	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
CinemAI (Bitoψ / f33.fr)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	ADJACENT	LOW	VERIFIED
Cinemata	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	DIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
cineSync (Backlight)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	DIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
Cinetech (cinetech.ai)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	ADJACENT	LOW	VERIFIED
Cineverse MatchPoint	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Clearance Domain LLC	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	DIRECT	LOW	UNCERTAIN
ClickUp	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
CODEX (Codex Tech Limited)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	ADJACENT	LOW	VERIFIED
Colorfront (On-Set Dailies, Express Dailies, Transkoder, QC Player)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Colourlab AI (with Look Designer)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
ComfyUI / Comfy Cloud	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	ADJACENT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Comscore Movies	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incent	ADJACENT	HIGH	VERIFIED

Entity	Primary category	Relationship	Threat	Confidence
Croogloo	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Curious Refuge	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
CuttingRoom (Cutting Room AS, Norway)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
DCP-o-matic	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Decart	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Deepdub	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	ADJACENT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Deluxe Media	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	ADJACENT	LOW	VERIFIED
Descript	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Digimarc	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
DISCO (disco.ac)	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
disguise	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
DocuSign eSignature	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Doing nothing (email + PDF + paper + the producer's own head)	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Dolly Card	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	ADJACENT	LOW	LIKELY
Dramatify	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Dropbox (file-based production workflow)	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Dropbox Replay	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
Dubverse	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
EditShare (EFS, FLOW, FLEX, AirFLOW)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
EditShare - MediaSilo, Screeners.com and Shift.io	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
ElevenLabs	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Entertainment Partners (EP)	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Entertainment Partners (EP) Production Incentives	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incentive	ADJACENT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED

Entity	Primary category	Relationship	Threat	Confidence
Epidemic Sound	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Ethovox	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
EU AI Act Article 50 — transparency obligations	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Eventival	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Eventive	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Evercast	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Exactuals	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	INDIRECT	LOW	LIKELY
Fade In	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Fairly Trained	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
fal.ai	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
farmerswife	Production management suites (the incumbents)	ADJACENT	LOW	LIKELY
Festhome	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Film Finances Inc	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
FilmChain	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
FilmFreeway	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Filmhub	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	CRITICAL	LIKELY
Filmocracy	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	ADJACENT	LOW	UNCERTAIN
FilmProposals	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incent	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
Filmustage	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Final Draft (Cast & Crew)	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Final Draft 13 (Cast & Crew)	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
FinalBit AI (formerly Nolan AI)	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED

Entity	Primary category	Relationship	Threat	Confidence
Flawless	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	ADJACENT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Flick (flick.art)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
ForecastFilm	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incent	DIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
Foundry Nuke / NukeX / Nuke Studio	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	ADJACENT	LOW	VERIFIED
FoxOMS / Sonderplan (Nevario Pty Ltd)	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	ADJACENT	LOW	VERIFIED
Frame.io (Adobe)	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
FrameForge (FrameForge Studio / FF4 Pro)	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	DIRECT	MEDIUM	UNCERTAIN
Free film-industry template libraries (Wrapbook, StudioBinder, SAGindie, PGA, Film Independent)	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
freispace	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Friend MTS	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Front Row Insurance Brokers	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
ftrack (Backlight)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
Full-service payroll and production accounting bureaus (Cast & Crew, GreenSlate, Wrapbook)	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Gathr	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
General-purpose AI assistants (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini)	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	CRITICAL	LIKELY
Genmo Mochi 1	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Giggster	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Google Flow (Veo 3.1 / DeepMind)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Google Sheets / Google Workspace	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Google Veo 3.1 + Flow	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Gorilla Budgeting (Jungle Software)	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	DIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
Gorilla Scheduling & Budgeting + Gorilla Ratebook (Jungle Software)	Production management suites (the incumbents)	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Gower Street Analytics	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incent	ADJACENT	HIGH	VERIFIED

Entity	Primary category	Relationship	Threat	Confidence
Greenlight Coverage	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	ADJACENT	HIGH	VERIFIED
GreenSlate	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accoun	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Hedra	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	ADJACENT	LOW	VERIFIED
Higgsfield AI	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	CRITICAL	UNCERTAIN
Highland Pro (Quote-Unquote Apps / John August)	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Hiring a freelance line producer / UPM / production accountant	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	HIGH	UNCERTAIN
Hot Budget	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accoun	DIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
IATSE agreements (Basic Agreement / Area Standards Agreement)	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
iconik (Backlight)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Indee.tv	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Interra Systems (BATON)	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
InteScene	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
invideo AI (Agent One)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
Irdeto (TraceMark)	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
iZotope RX 12 (Native Instruments)	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Kapwing (representative browser AI NLE; see also WeVideo, Veed, Clipchamp)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Katalist	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Kitsu (CGWire)	Production management suites (the incumbents)	INDIRECT	LOW	LIKELY
Krock.io	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Krotos Audio	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Kuaishou Kling 3.0	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Largo.ai	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incent	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED

Entity	Primary category	Relationship	Threat	Confidence
Lightricks LTX-2.5 / LTX-2 (open weights) + LTX Studio	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
LightsKiddo (Agni, Inc.)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Lore Machine	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	DIRECT	LOW	UNCERTAIN
LTX Studio (Lightricks)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Luma AI (Dream Machine / Ray3)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Luma AI — Ray3.2 / Ray3.14 (Dream Machine)	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
MakeStoryboard	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	DIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
MediaSilo (EditShare)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
MediaSilo (EditShare) — now including Shift.io	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Melies	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	HIGH	LIKELY
Meta Movie Gen	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Microsoft Excel / Microsoft 365 (with film budget templates)	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Milanote	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
MiniMax H3 / Hailuo	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	ADJACENT	HIGH	VERIFIED
MITO AI	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Monday.com	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Money Penny (Entertainment Partners)	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Moonvalley + Asteria (Marey)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Moonvalley Marey	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Movie Magic Budgeting (Entertainment Partners)	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	DIRECT	HIGH	LIKELY
Movie Magic Budgeting / Movie Magic Scheduling (Entertainment Partners) and Showbiz Budgeting (Cast & Crew)	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	HIGH	LIKELY
Movie Magic Scheduling & Budgeting (Entertainment Partners)	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	INDIRECT	HIGH	LIKELY
Movie Magic Scheduling (Entertainment Partners)	Production management suites (the incumbents)	DIRECT	CRITICAL	LIKELY

Entity	Primary category	Relationship	Threat	Confidence
Movie Magic Screenwriter (Write Brothers / Screenplay.com)	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	DIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
MovieLabs CSAP (Common Security Architecture for Production)	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
MPA Content Security Best Practices (v5.3.1)	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
mStudio (mstudio.ai)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
Murf AI	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	ADJACENT	LOW	VERIFIED
Music Reports (Cuetrak / Songdex)	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
NAGRA NexGuard	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Netflix / InterPositive (Ben Affleck)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	INDIRECT	LOW	LIKELY
Netflix Prodicle	Production management suites (the incumbents)	INDIRECT	LOW	LIKELY
NO FAKES Act (S.1367, 119th Congress)	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Nolia Studios	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Notion	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
NVIDIA Cosmos (Predict 2.5)	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Odyssey	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Olsberg SPI	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incent	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Open-Sora (HPC-AI Tech)	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Open-source and free screenwriting stack (Fountain, Beat, Trelby, Story Architect/STARC)	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Open-source audio stack (F5-TTS, AudioCraft/MusicGen, Stable Audio Open)	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Open-source local generation stack (ComfyUI + LTX-2.5 / Wan 2.2-2.5 / HunyuanVideo 1.5 / CogVideoX-1.5)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	INDIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Open-source screenplay tooling (Fountain / screenplay-tools / Open Draft)	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
OpenAI Sora 2	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	DIRECT	HIGH	LIKELY
OpenAI Sora 2 / Sora 2 Pro	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED

Entity	Primary category	Relationship	Threat	Confidence
OpenTimelineIO (Academy Software Foundation)	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Papercup (RWS)	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
Parrot Analytics	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incent	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Peerspace	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Pika	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
PIX (Autodesk)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	DIRECT	HIGH	LIKELY
Plot (plotstoryboards)	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	DIRECT	LOW	UNCERTAIN
Plotdot	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Pomfort Silverstack XT / Silverstack Lab	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Postlab (Hedge)	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	ADJACENT	LOW	VERIFIED
Premiere Digital	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Previs Pro	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Primordial Soup (Darren Aronofsky)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	INDIRECT	LOW	LIKELY
Promise (Promise Advanced Imagination, Inc.) — MUSE	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
Qube Cinema	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	ADJACENT	LOW	VERIFIED
QuickBooks Online	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Quiver Distribution	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Rentman	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	ADJACENT	LOW	VERIFIED
Replica Studios (defunct)	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Replicate	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Resemble AI (incl. Chatterbox open source)	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Respeecher	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Revolution Entertainment Services (ProBooks / ProHire / ProCal / SetKeeper)	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accoun	DIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY

Entity	Primary category	Relationship	Threat	Confidence
Rightsline (incl. FilmTrack)	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Rivet AI	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
RivetAI	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Runway (Gen-4.5, Aleph 2.0, Edit Studio)	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
SAG-AFTRA AI consent and digital-replica terms	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	CRITICAL	LIKELY
Saga (CreateSagas, CyberFilm AI Corporation)	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Sargent-Disc (Cast & Crew UK)	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Saturation.io	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Scenechronize + SmartHub (Entertainment Partners SmartStudio)	Production management suites (the incumbents)	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
ScreenWeaver	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Scriptation	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
ScriptBook (and DeepStory)	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incent	DIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
ScriptBook and Largo (Largo Films / largo.io)	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
ScriptE Systems	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Scriptflow	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Scrivener (Literature & Latte)	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	INDIRECT	LOW	LIKELY
Secret Level (Liquid Engine)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
Seed&Spark	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
SetHero	Production management suites (the incumbents)	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
SetKeeper	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Setkick	Production management suites (the incumbents)	DIRECT	LOW	LIKELY

Entity	Primary category	Relationship	Threat	Confidence
SetScouter (acquired Wrapal)	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	ADJACENT	LOW	VERIFIED
Shamel Studio (free waterfall + incentive tools)	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incent	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Shift72	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Shot Designer (Hollywood Camera Work)	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
ShotPro	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	DIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Showbiz Budgeting 10 (Media Services / Cast & Crew)	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production accoun	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Showrunner (Fable Studio)	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Simon Says	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Slack	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Slated	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incent	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
SOC 2 (AICPA) — Type I vs Type II	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Sohonet	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Sohonet ClearView (Flex, Pivot, Rush) + Storylink, FileRunner	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Soundmouse	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	DIRECT	MEDIUM	UNCERTAIN
Soundraw	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Spectura.ai	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incent	ADJACENT	LOW	UNCERTAIN
Squibler	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Stability AI — Stable Audio 3.0	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Stability AI — Stable Video Diffusion	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	INDIRECT	LOW	UNCERTAIN
Staff Me Up (Talent Systems)	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Storiara	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Storyboard That	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	INDIRECT	LOW	LIKELY
Storyboarder (Wonder Unit)	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED

Entity	Primary category	Relationship	Threat	Confidence
StoryboardHero	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
StoryFit	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Storyflow	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	ADJACENT	LOW	VERIFIED
Strada	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
StudioBinder	Production management suites (the incumbents)	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Studiovity	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Subtitle Edit (open source)	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Sudowrite	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Suno	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	ADJACENT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Supertone	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
SyncOnSet (Entertainment Partners)	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
SyncSketch	Editorial, post-production, review & VFX/asset track	ADJACENT	LOW	LIKELY
Talent Systems (Casting Networks, Casting Frontier, Spotlight, Tagmin, Staff Me Up)	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Telestream Vidchecker	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Tencent HunyuanVideo 1.5	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	ADJACENT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Teradek (Videndum)	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	INDIRECT	LOW	LIKELY
The Black List (bcklst.com)	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	INDIRECT	HIGH	LIKELY
The Clearance Lab	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
The Numbers / OpusData (Nash Information Services)	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incent	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Thomson CompuMark (Clarivate)	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cove	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Toon Boom Storyboard Pro	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED

Entity	Primary category	Relationship	Threat	Confidence
Toonstar	AI script-to-film / generative filmmaking studios	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Topsheet	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
TPN (Trusted Partner Network)	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Trello	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Trevanna Tracks	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Udio	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Unreal Engine previs / virtual production pipeline (Epic Games)	Storyboards, animatics, previs & concept	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	UNCERTAIN
US Copyright Office — AI guidance (Reports Parts 1-3)	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Vanta	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Vault AI (VaultML)	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incent	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
Venera Technologies	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Verance (Cinavia, Aspect, Verance Authentication)	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Veritone	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	INDIRECT	LOW	UNCERTAIN
Vidu (Shengshu Technology)	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrast	DIRECT	MEDIUM	UNCERTAIN
Vimeo OTT	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
Vista Group / Cinema Intelligence	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incent	INDIRECT	LOW	LIKELY
Vitrina AI	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Voice-Swap	AI voice, ADR, dubbing, music & sound	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
Vubiquity (Amdocs)	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	ADJACENT	LOW	VERIFIED
WeTransfer	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	UNCERTAIN
WGA Minimum Basic Agreement — AI provisions	Content security, compliance & the buying gate	INDIRECT	HIGH	VERIFIED
WhatsApp (group chat coordination)	Indirect substitutes and the do-nothing option	INDIRECT	MEDIUM	LIKELY
Whip Media	Distribution, sales agents, deliverables & festivals	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED

Entity	Primary category	Relationship	Threat	Confidence
Wrapbook	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	DIRECT	CRITICAL	VERIFIED
Wrapbook Production Incentive Center	Sales forecasting, film analytics, investor & incentive	ADJACENT	HIGH	VERIFIED
WriterDuet	Screenwriting & development tools (including AI cover)	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
xAI Grok Imagine	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrastructure	DIRECT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED
XR (Extreme Reach)	Film finance, budgeting, payroll & production account	INDIRECT	LOW	LIKELY
Yamdu	AI script breakdown & AI pre-production	ADJACENT	HIGH	VERIFIED
Zhipu / Z.ai CogVideoX	Text-to-video foundation models & generation infrastructure	INDIRECT	LOW	VERIFIED
ZOO Digital Group plc	GAP FILL - missed players and categories	ADJACENT	MEDIUM	VERIFIED